RevenueCat

# State of Subscription Apps

2026

The definitive benchmark report on subscription app performance, built on the world's largest in-app subscription data set.

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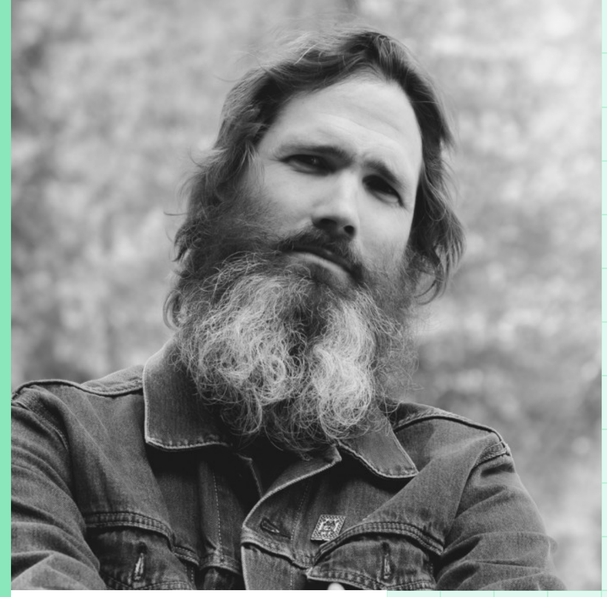
**Three years ago, about 2,000 new subscription apps launched every month. Today that number is almost 15,000. AI removed a decade old supply constraint on apps, and now we're going to have to process this glut of apps as consumer demand most likely lags. This will be seen as more competition, higher CACs, and higher churn.**

But the silver lining is that I think this is just a shock. New apps are being invented with new capabilities never seen before. The relatively low cost of trying software is allowing apps to be built for niches never before economically viable. This smorgasbord of software will, in itself, incur more demand as consumers find more solutions to their problems in the app stores. On the demand side, if AI ushers in an unprecedented era of productivity and consumer surplus, it's inevitable that some of that surplus will be spent in the app store. At least we hope.

We built SOSA 2026 from over 115,000 apps, $16 billion in revenue, and more than a billion transactions. We sliced it by category, platform, trial length, paywall strategy, AI vs. non-AI, and probably a few dimensions we'll forget we included until someone tweets about them. It's a lot. We know.

The subscription app market is bigger, faster, and more unforgiving than it's ever been. But the patterns are there if you look. The operators who study the data, and learn the tools, are the ones who will come out ahead. My hope is this report helps you be one of them.



**Jacob Eiting**
Big Boss & Co-Founder

## Overview of the dataset

This report draws on subscription app performance data from a wide range of apps that use RevenueCat's platform. Our goal is to provide a comprehensive snapshot of how apps are performing under different scenarios, across iOS, Android and web ecosystems.

- **Scope of apps included:** we included apps that have active subscription revenue, meet a minimum threshold of installs or revenue (to ensure statistically meaningful findings), and have integrated RevenueCat for in-app subscription management.
- **Time frame:** the target time frame for metrics in this report is 2025. In some cases we have pulled older data to run certain calculations (we can't calculate third renewal rate for annual subscriptions bought in 2024, for example)
- **Size and composition:** we analyzed over 115,000 apps apps across all app categories, covering more than $16 billion in revenue across more than a billion transactions. The apps vary in scale, from indie teams to mid-size organizations and large publishers.
- **Revenue channels:** the dataset includes both apps that primarily generate revenue from in-app subscriptions and those that generate a portion of revenue from subscriptions alongside other revenue channels.
- **Anonymity:** all data is anonymized and aggregated, ensuring that no single app's performance metrics are individually identifiable. The findings are presented as aggregated performance benchmarks across segments, categories, and platforms.

## Anonymization and data privacy

To preserve the confidentiality of individual apps, we apply controls to ensure that if a segment has too few apps, results are either omitted from the report or combined with a larger segment to avoid the possibility of inferring any single app's data. Throughout this report, numbers represent aggregated totals, averages, medians, quartiles, or other summary statistics. No app-specific or developer-specific details are ever disclosed.

## Statistical definitions

Throughout this report we aim to use clear, accessible language and minimize unnecessary jargon. However, some key statistical terminology is used at times.

The following measures of central tendency and spread have been used to illustrate app performance.

- **Bottom quartile (Q1):** The value below which 25% of the dataset falls. An app that falls into the bottom quartile is among the lower 25% of performers on that metric.
- **Median (Q2):** The middle value, with half of the data above and half below. When comparing your own metrics to the median, you can see if you are performing above or below the midpoint of the industry.
- **Upper quartile (Q3):** The value above which 25% of the dataset falls. An app in the upper quartile is among the top 25% of performers for that metric.
- **P90:** The 90th percentile. This indicates the point at or above which 10% of the dataset lies. An app at P90 is outperforming 90% of apps in that particular metric (aka, crushing it).

## Reading the charts

We often use **candlestick (box-and-whisker–style) charts** to show the distribution of a given performance metric (e.g. RPI, LTV) across apps. The 'box' represents the bulk of distribution, the interquartile range, while the 'whiskers' represent the lower and upper bounds of performance.

### Percentile mapping:

- **Lower ‘whisker’:** marks P10 (10th percentile), the bottom 10% of app performance
- **Bottom of the ‘box’:** marks P25 (25th percentile) and represents Q1 (bottom quartile) — apps below this make up the lowest 25% of performers
- **Marker inside the ‘box’:** marks P50 (50th percentile) and represents Q2 (median) — this is the midpoint of app performance
- **Top of the ‘box’:** marks P75 (75th percentile) and represents Q3 (upper quartile) — apps above this fall into the top 25% of performers
- **Upper ‘whisker’:** marks P90 (90th percentile) — apps here or above are the highest performers
- Any points outside **P10–P90** indicate unusually low or high performance outliers

## Data not based on RevenueCat

While the majority of the metrics in this report derive from aggregated app subscription data (via RevenueCat), two charts within the State of the market chapter feature data not from RevenueCat. This data has been provided by Appfigures, and is indicated on the relevant pages.

## Measures we include

Below are some of the included metrics in this report that benefit from some additional context. Each metric is calculated consistently across all apps to allow for accurate comparison.

- **Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer:** the net value of an average paying user over a specific period of time, including initial subscriptions, reactivations, expansion, and one-time purchases.
- **Revenue per install (RPI):** total revenue earned divided by total installs. This metric highlights how well an app monetizes each new user.
- **Active renewal rate:** the share of renewals that are done by subscribers that were active in the second half of the previous subscription period (in case of a monthly subscription, this asks if the user was seen in the app in the second half of the month previous to the renewal).
- **Reactivation rate:** the share of churned subscribers that become active in the 12 months following a churn event.
- **MRR growth rate (year-on-year):** the percentage change in an app’s monthly recurring revenue between two point-in-time snapshots (end of the previous year vs. end of the current year). MRR is normalized to a 30-day basis regardless of plan duration.
- **Download-to-paid conversion rate (D35):** the share of installs that result in at least one paid subscription within 35 days of the install date. This metric captures how effectively an app converts new users into paying customers in the first ~5 weeks.
- **Download-to-trial conversion rate:** the share of installs that start a free trial within 30 days of the download date. This metric is calculated for apps that use a trial-based acquisition strategy.
- **Trial-to-paid conversion rate:** the share of free trial starts that convert into a paid subscription.
- **Retention rate:** the share of paid subscriptions that remain active after a given time period (e.g. 6 months, 12 months). A subscription is considered ‘retained’ if it has accumulated enough paid renewals to cover the elapsed time — for example, 12 monthly renewals for 12-month retention, or 1 annual renewal for yearly plans. This is a subscription-level metric, not a user-level metric.
- **Renewal rate (1st, 2nd, 3rd):** the share of subscriptions that successfully renew at each sequential billing cycle. This

differs from retention rate, which measures cumulative survival over calendar time.

- **Refund rate:** the share of paid subscriptions that are refunded during their first billing period.
- **Monthly trailing revenue (MTR):** a 30-day rolling revenue figure at a specific point in time, used to measure an app's revenue run-rate. This is the basis for the 'monthly revenue 1 year after launch' and 'time to revenue milestones' metrics in this report.

## Segments we cover

To provide nuanced insights, we break down certain metrics by segments. These segments offer a closer look at how different development choices and distribution methods might impact subscription metrics.

- **Access method:** how users primarily access the app (freemium, via a hard paywall)
- **App development framework:** the primary technology stack used for app development (e.g., native iOS/Android, Flutter, React Native, Other)
- **Pricepoint:** how an app's average pricepoint compares to the rest of the measured apps (below average, average, above average)
- **Developer HQ:** the (estimated) region the app developer team is based in
- **Geography:** the region users are based in
- **AI vs. non-AI app:** whether an app uses AI/ML models for its primary value (e.g. generative AI, chatbots and AI assistants, predictive analytics, AI photo/video editing, AI writing tools) *Note: apps not categorized as 'AI apps' may still use basic ML or have minor AI features*

## Regional definitions

- **North America:** United States, Canada
- **Western Europe:** United Kingdom, Germany, France, Spain, Italy, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, Finland, Belgium, Austria, Switzerland, Denmark, Ireland, Portugal, Luxembourg, Liechtenstein, Iceland, Monaco, Malta
- **Asia-Pacific:** Japan, South Korea, Australia, New Zealand
- **Latin America:** Brazil, Mexico, Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Peru
- **MEA (Middle East & Africa):** Saudi Arabia, South Africa, United Arab Emirates, Egypt, Nigeria, Kenya, Turkey
- **IN/SEA (India & Southeast Asia):** India, Indonesia, Thailand, Philippines, Vietnam, Malaysia, Singapore

## Category bucketing (App Store and Google Play)

The App Store (iOS) and Google Play (Android) each have numerous categories. For clearer analysis, we've aggregated or 'bucketed' closely-related categories under common labels:

- **Utilities:** includes Weather, Reference, Utilities, Finance, Tools, and more
- **Health & Fitness:** includes Health & Fitness, Medical
- **Media & Entertainment:** includes Entertainment, Music, News, Magazines & Newspapers, Sports, and more
- **Education:** includes Education, and Educational
- **Productivity:** includes Graphics & Design, Art & Design, Developer tools
- **Social & Lifestyle:** includes Lifestyle, Social Networking, Social, Dating
- **Gaming:** includes Games, Puzzle, Casual, Word, Simulation, Board, and more
- **Photo & Video:** Includes Photo & Video, Photography, Video Players & Editors
- **Business:** Includes Business
- **Travel:** Includes Travel, Travel & Local
- **Shopping:** Includes Shopping

We have done this to simplify comparisons — especially when certain official categories have too few apps to provide stable, anonymized benchmarks.

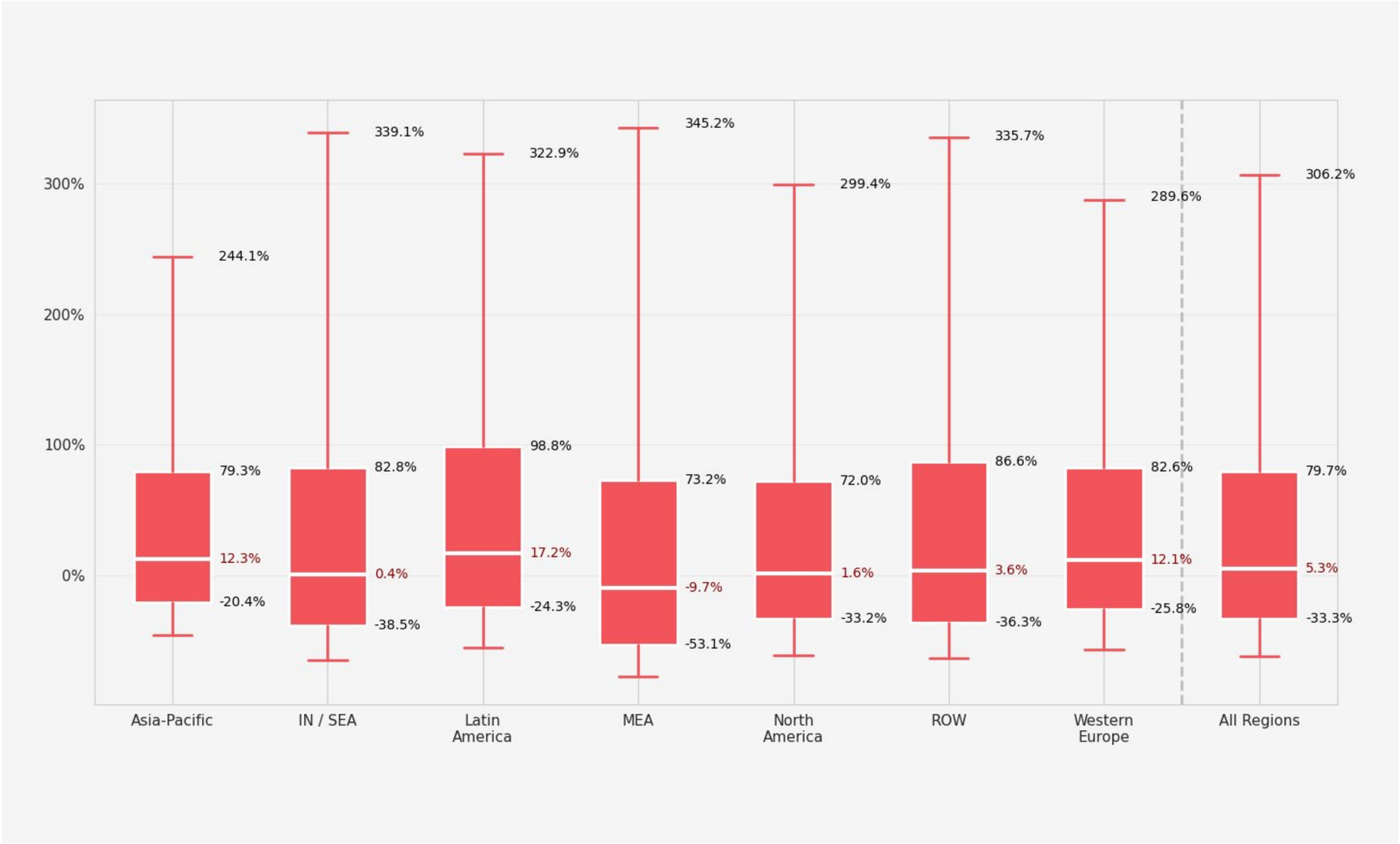
## Key insights

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 80%+ | The subscription divide is accelerating | The top 25% of apps grew 80% year-over-year, while the bottom 25% shrank by 33%. Subscription app revenue is a winner-take-more market. A small number of apps are capturing outsized growth, while everyone else sees far more modest gains – or even declines. |
| 5x | Hard paywalls crush freemium on conversion | Apps that ask for money upfront convert 5x better than freemium (10.7% vs. 2.1%). But the advantage disappears over the long run: after one year, retention for both models is nearly identical. |
| 55% | The window to win a user is closing | 55% of all 3-day trial cancellations happen on Day 0. The battle for the subscriber is won or lost in the first session, forcing developers to deliver an 'aha!' moment instantly. |
| 31% | Google Play's billion-dollar leak | Nearly a third of all subscription cancellations on Google Play are involuntary billing failures — more than double the rate on the App Store (14%). For Android developers, fixing billing is the new growth hack. |
| 41% | AI sells, but it doesn't stick | AI-powered apps generate 41% more revenue per payer, but they churn 30% faster. The data shows that while AI hype can drive initial sales, it's not yet creating the lasting value needed for long-term retention. |
| 70% | Apps are shortening trials despite the data | Trials of 17+ days convert 70% better than short trials (42.5% vs. 25.5%), yet apps keep shifting to 3-day trials. Nearly half of all apps now use trials of four days or less, leaving conversion on the table. |

# 01
# State of the market

# Median year-on-year monthly recurring revenue growth rate, by developer HQ

Where are subscription apps growing fastest, based on developer HQ?




## Key takeaway

Half of all apps grew MRR by at least 5.3% YoY, but the spread is enormous: the top 10% grew 306%+, while the bottom 10% shrank sharply.

## Benchmarks to know:

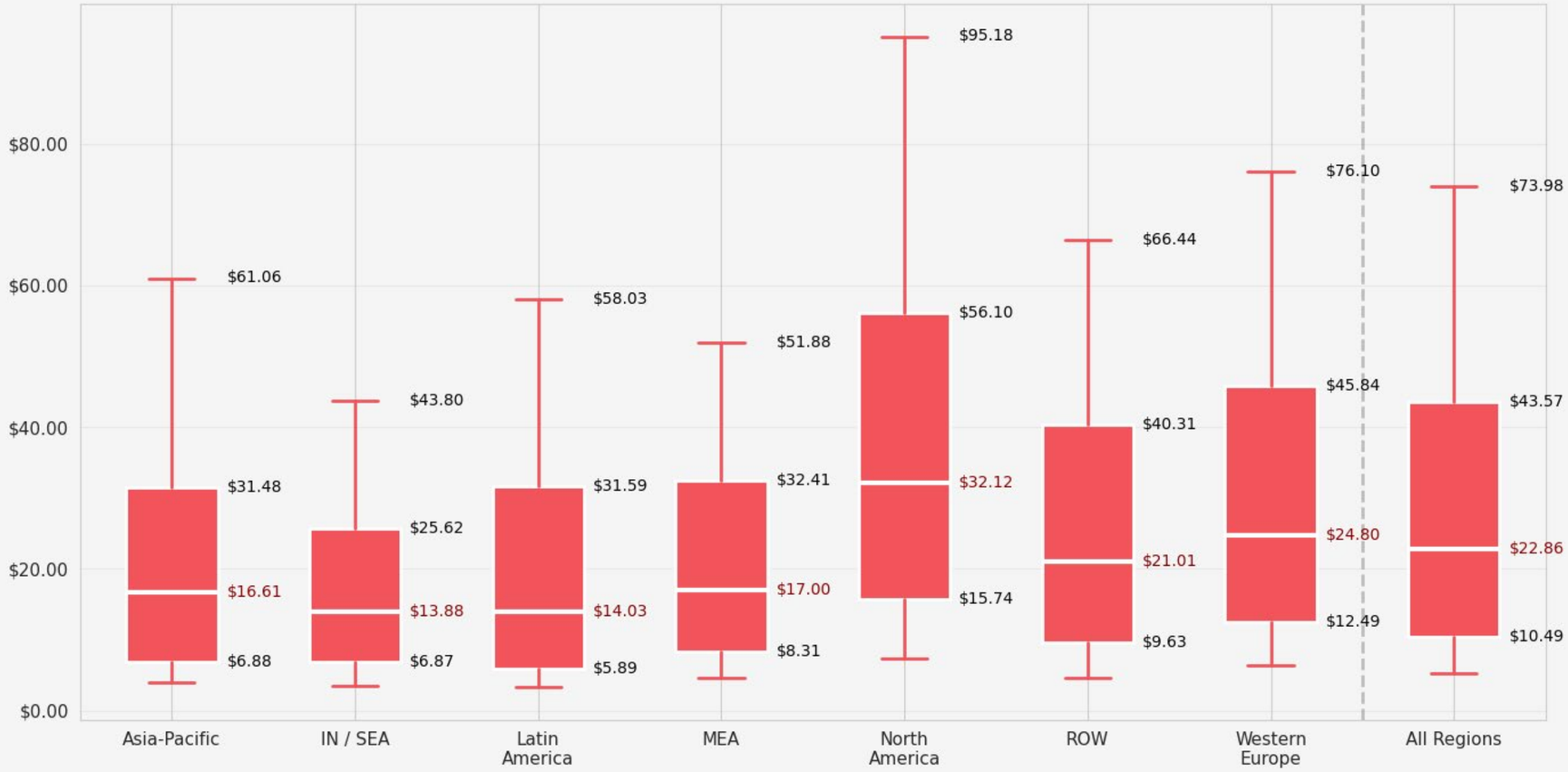
- Median growth of ~5–17% puts you in the middle of the pack
- Shrinking by more than 33% places you in the bottom quartile
- Growing 80%+ means you're outpacing 75% of apps

## What stands out:

- MEA is the only geography with negative median growth (-9.7%)
- Latin America shows the highest median growth (17.2%)
- Several geographies show extreme right-tail outliers above 300% growth (IN/SEA, Latin America, MEA, ROW, and overall)

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after Year 1, by developer HQ

What annual value does each payer generate?




### Key takeaway

North American apps realize about 40% more annual value per payer ($32) than the global median ($23), while IN/SEA apps realize the least at $14.

### Benchmarks to know:

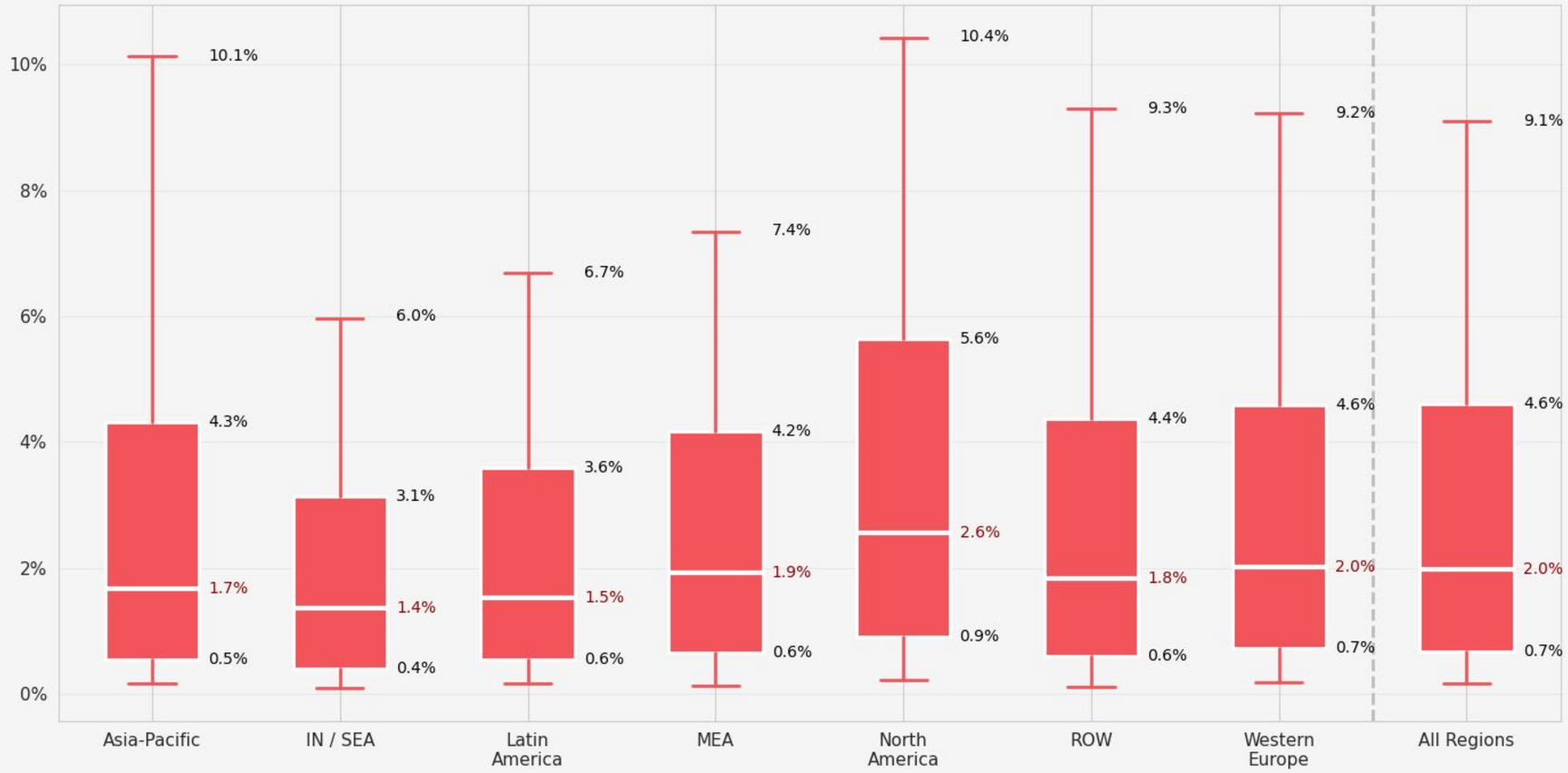
- $23 annual RLTV per payer is the global median
- $44+ puts you in the top quartile globally
- Below $10 places you in the bottom quartile in many geographies

### What stands out:

- North America's median ($32) is 2.3× higher than IN/SEA ($14)
- Western Europe is the next-highest median ($25)
- IN/SEA has a relatively tight middle range compared to other geographies, suggesting less variance in payer value

# Conversion rate to payer, by developer HQ

What's the D35 download-to-paid conversion rate by developer HQ geography?




### Key takeaway

North America leads D35 conversion at 2.6% median, nearly 2× IN/SEA's 1.4%.

### Benchmarks to know:

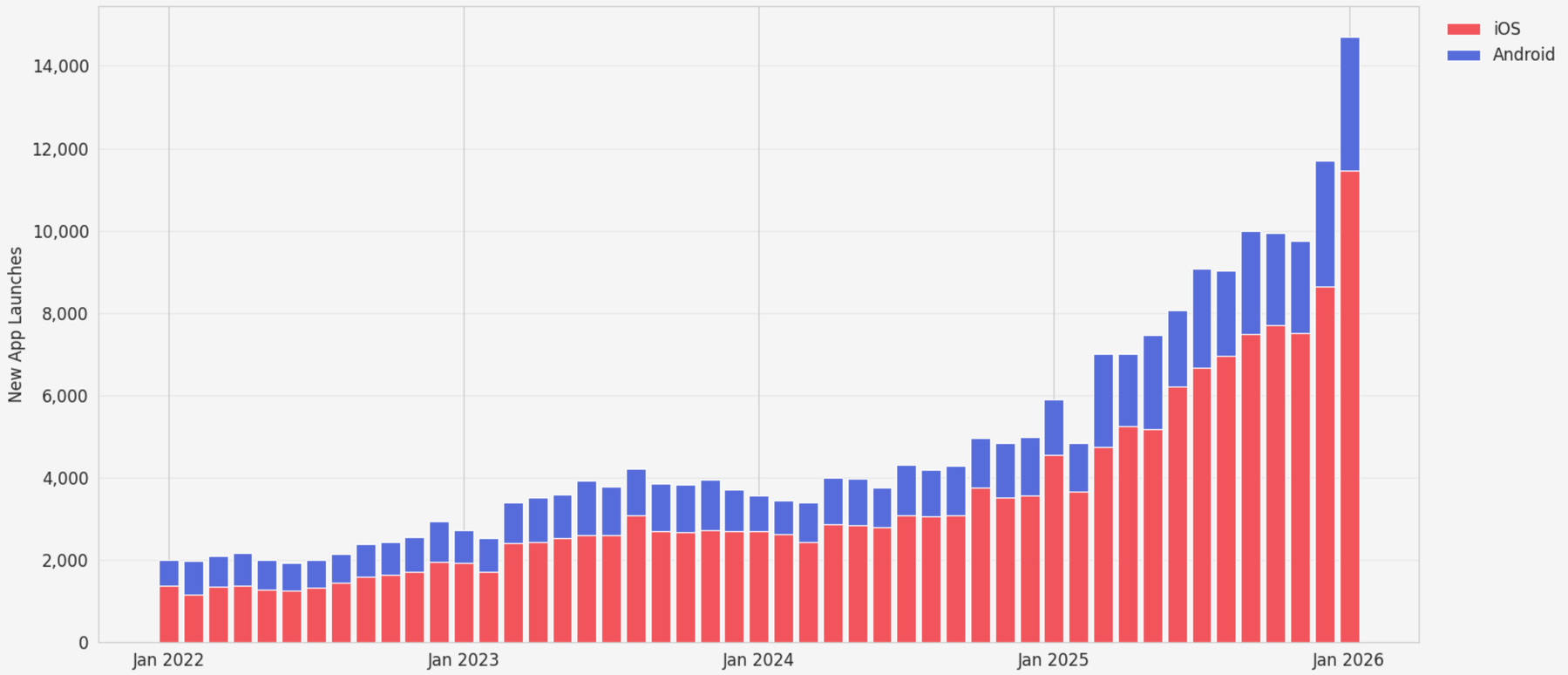
- North America median: 2.6%, top quartile above 5.6%
- Western Europe median: 2.0%, higher than every other geography outside of North America
- IN/SEA median: at 1.4%, converts at the lowest rate of all geographies

### What stands out:

- North America top performers reach 10.4% at the 90th percentile
- Latin America (1.5%) sits toward the bottom, closer to IN/SEA than North America or Western Europe
- Geographical gaps in conversion are narrower than other revenue metrics

# New subscription apps launched per month (Feb 2022–Feb 2026)

What does the iOS vs. Android split of new subscription app launches look like, and how has it changed?




Data provided by appfigures

## Key takeaway

Monthly subscription app launches have grown 7× since January 2022, but this is almost entirely an iOS story. Android has grown at roughly half the rate, and the gap is widening.

## Benchmarks to know:

- ~2,000 new subscription apps launched per month in Jan 2022; 14,700+ by Jan 2026
- iOS now accounts for ~77% of all new subscription app launches, up from ~67% in 2023
- Android absolute launches have grown – from ~700 to ~3,300/month – but iOS has lapped it

## What stands out:

- The steepest iOS acceleration begins in early 2025, coinciding with the rise of AI-assisted development tools, which appear to default to App Store-first
- Android's share of new launches has been declining since mid-2023, despite growing in absolute terms

# Growth teams of 2026 won't look the same as they do today

Every month we're seeing increased waves of vibecoded apps hit the stores, with some of these going on to generate substantial revenue.

But it's not just development that's changing, the game is changing for app growth teams too.

AI driven pricing, AI paywall designs, AI ad creatives, AI web funnels, AI driven keyword optimization. Pretty much every aspect of mobile growth has been prefixed by AI in some way over the last 12 months. And that's only going to continue.

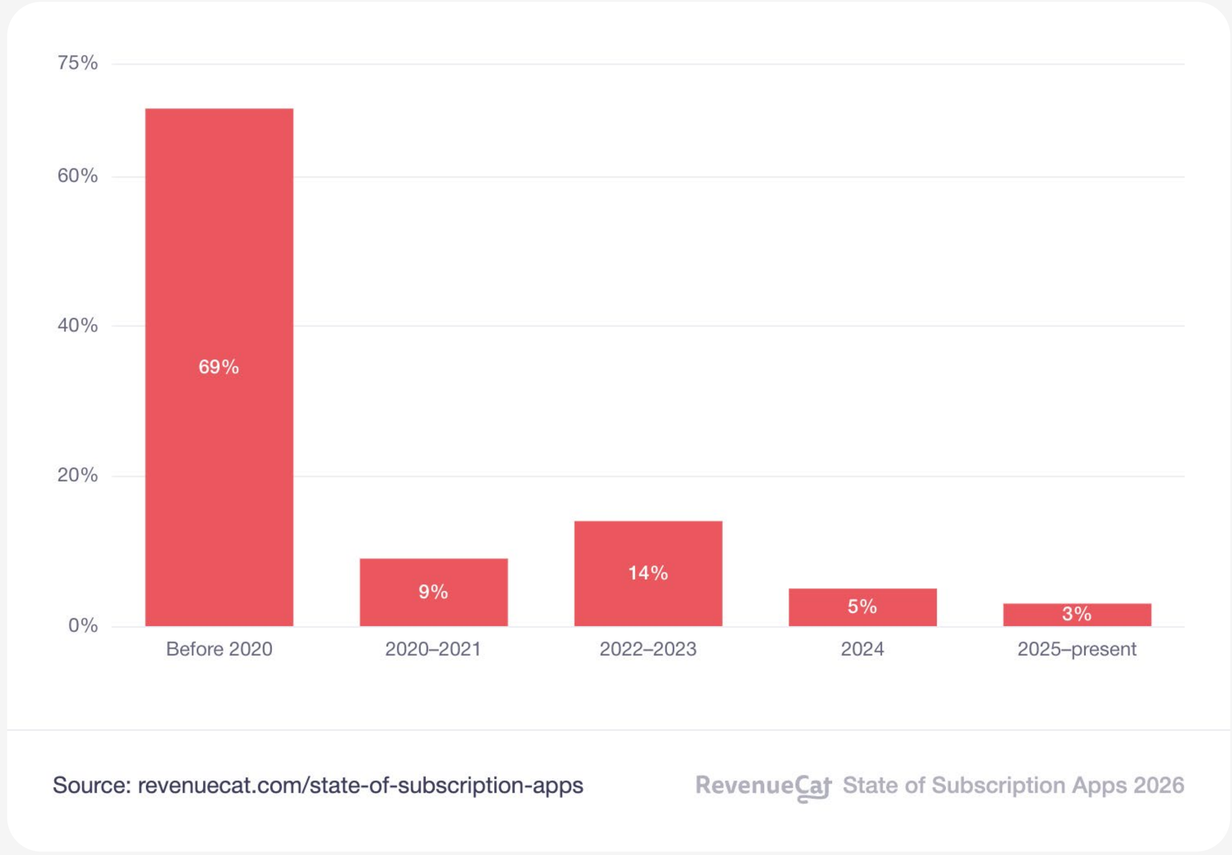
**So what should growth teams be doing:**

- Embrace the change and embrace it faster. Clinging to the old way of doing things is not the route forward. Those that adapt will simply outpace those that don't. And those that adapt first will have a real advantage.
- Spot the hype - Not every shiny new A.I solution is a winner. Some simply over promise and under deliver. I'm sure we've all seen that over the last year too...
- Don't retire just yet...Yes, AI is commoditizing execution across the growth stack. But when everyone has the same tools, then what? There's still an edge to be found in strategic judgment, taste and the ability to ask deeper questions.

**Nathan Hudson**
Founder and CEO, Perceptycs

# Monthly revenue by app launch cohort across all storefronts (Jan 2026)

Do older apps dominate the market?




Data provided by appfigures

## Key takeaway

The subscription economy runs on established apps: apps launched before 2020 generate 69% of all subscription revenue. Despite a 7× surge in new app launches since 2022, apps launched before 2020 still account for nearly 70 cents of every dollar generated. Apps launched in 2025 or later (aka, the vibecoding era) account for just 3%.

## What stands out:

- The ‘before 2020’ cohort generates more revenue per app than any other group by a wide margin — these are the apps that had years to build audiences, optimize monetization, and compound growth
- The 2022–2023 cohort outperforms 2020–2021 in absolute revenue, driven by a handful of breakout apps that launched in that window
- Apps launched in 2024 and 2025 are generating real revenue, but at a fraction of what older cohorts produce and with far more competition than those cohorts ever faced

# Winning big

**“Half of all apps grew MRR by at least 5.3% YoY, but the spread is enormous—top performers grew 3× faster than typical, while the bottom 10% shrank by more than 60%.”**

This is one of the main reasons why Apps M&A is getting so much interest: to win in the App Store you have to be a top performer. Big app publishing companies increase their winning possibilities by developing a portfolio mix of new in-house R&D apps, and top performers acquisitions.

As a portfolio owner, your apps might be generating revenue with slight YoY growth but not exponential growth. If that’s your case I’d advise you to keep testing until launching a top performer (or acquire one) since it’s the only game play that will make a big difference for your company.

Moreover, even top categories like Health & Fitness and Utilities take more than 100 days in reaching > $10k, which means that you’d have to wait around 30% of the year to confirm if your app has the chances to be a top performer.

Business is an overlooked category that monetizes and retains users the most and users are usually unhappy with the existing solutions. The creativeness and high standards of b2c apps + b2b monetization and retention can be one of the biggest opportunities for developers in 2026.

**Evelin Herrera**
Founder, EHVM Apps Capital

# Macro trends: key takeaways

The subscription market is expanding, but outcomes are uneven. The median app grew monthly recurring revenue (MRR) 5.3% year-on-year, but top-decile apps grew 306%+, while the bottom decile contracted sharply.

Monetization strength varies materially by developer HQ: North America leads with $32 median realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after Y1, compared to a $23 global median and $14 in IN/SEA.

Conversion gaps exist, but they're tighter than revenue gaps — North America's median D35 download-to-paid rate is 2.6% vs. 1.4% in IN/SEA. Meanwhile, supply is accelerating, but new ≠ better: monthly new subscription app launches increased from ~2,000 in January 2022 to 14,700+ by January 2026 (likely driven by the AI app explosion), yet apps launched before 2020 still generate 69% of all subscription revenue.

## What stands out

- → **Growth is concentrated in the right tail:** the median YoY MRR growth rate is 5.3%, but the 90th percentile exceeds 306%. Shrinking more than 33% places an app in the bottom quartile, underscoring how polarized outcomes are.
- → **Value-per-payer differs hugely between developer HQ regions:** median Y1 RLTV per payer is $32 for developers in North America, $25 for developers in Western Europe, $23 globally, and $14 for developers in IN/SEA. The spread between top and bottom regions is more than 2x.
- → **Conversion gaps are meaningful, but narrower than value-per-payer:** median D35 conversion is 2.6% for developers in North America, 2% for developers in Western Europe, and 1.4% for developers in IN/SEA. Even top North America performers (10.4% at the 90th percentile) don't offset weaker long-term monetization in lower-LTV regions.
- → **Launch growth is real — and skewed to iOS:** monthly launches grew roughly 7x over four years. iOS now represents ~77% of new subscription app launches, up from ~67% in 2023.
- → **Revenue remains anchored in older cohorts:** apps launched before 2020 account for 69% of all subscription revenue. Apps launched in 2025 or later contribute just 3%, despite the surge in new supply.

# Jacob and David read all 339 pages — here's what they thought

**Jacob Eiting &**
**David Barnard**
RevenueCat

Minisode

1 **The app economy is a sorting machine**

The top 10% of apps grew 306% while the median grew just 5.3%, and that gap is only widening as AI raises the ceiling for the best-positioned apps.

2 **Hard paywalls crush freemium on conversion, but context matters**

Hard paywalls convert five times better than freemium (10.7% vs 2.1% download-to-paid by day 35) with nearly identical year-one retention, but freemium remains the right call when free users drive word of mouth, network effects, or long-term brand scale.

3 **Day zero is your best shot at converting a user**

The first session is when users decide both whether to pay and whether to stay. The majority of trial cancellations happen on day zero, meaning users who don't see value immediately rarely come back to find it.

4 **AI apps sell, but they don't stick**

AI-powered apps generate 41% more revenue per customer but people churn 30% faster. Apps that solve that retention problem early will own their category; those that don't are just riding a wave of consumer curiosity.

5 **The App Store is experiencing a supply shock**

The number of new subscription apps launching each month has grown 7X since 2022, creating a hyper-competitive environment where distribution, not just features, is the primary barrier to success.

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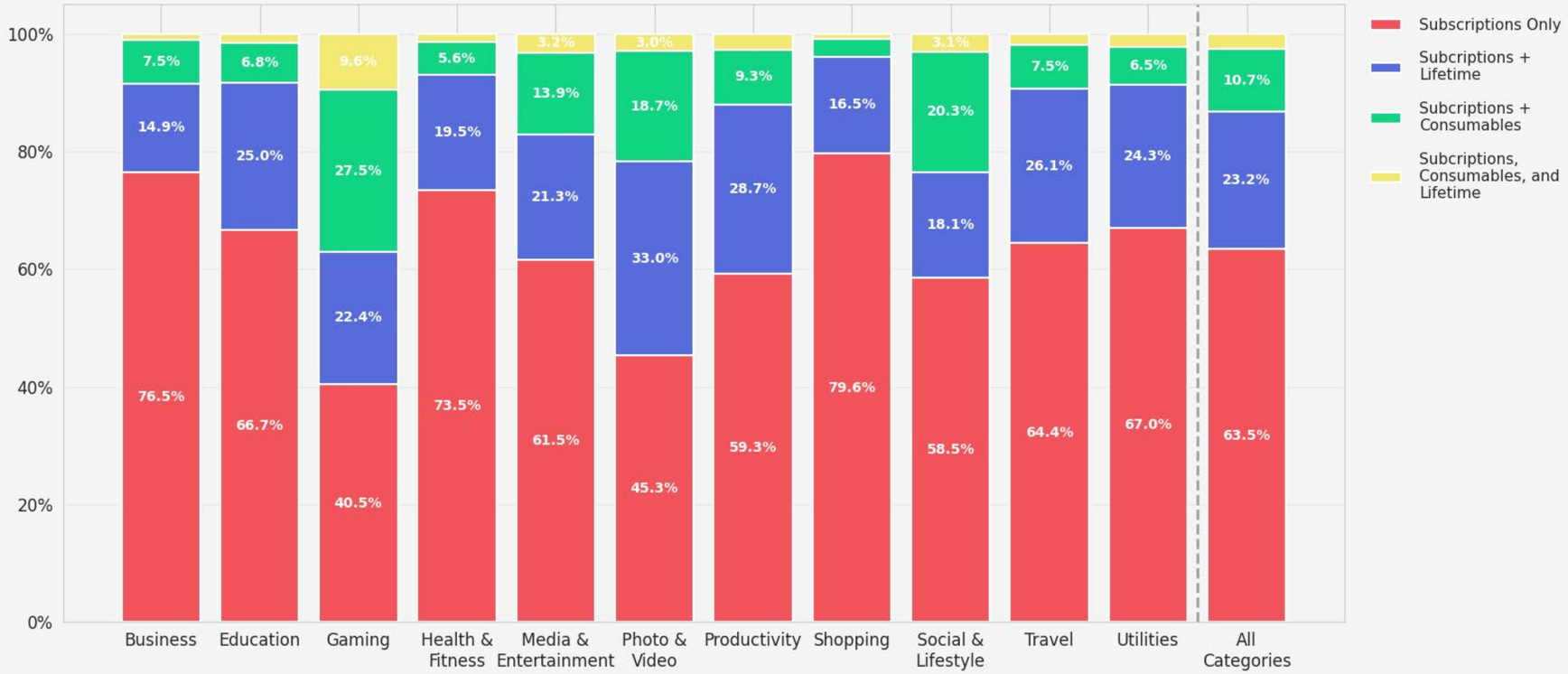
# 02
# Store and revenue economics

# Monetization mix, by category

How do monetization strategies differ across app categories?




## Key takeaway

Most categories favor pure subscriptions (63.5% overall); Gaming is the outlier at 40.5% subs-only with the heaviest consumable usage (27.5%).

## Benchmarks to know:

- Overall: 63.5% subs-only, 23.2% + lifetime, 10.7% + consumables, 2.5% all three
- Shopping (79.6%) and Business (76.5%) are the purest subscription categories
- Gaming is the most evenly split: 40.5% subs-only, 27.5% consumables, 9.6% all three

## What stands out:

- Gaming's 'all three' rate is 4× the overall average (9.6% vs. 2.5%)
- Photo & Video has highest lifetime combo usage at 33.0%

# Hybrid monetization: still nascent, with different paths opening up

**Data shows that subscriptions are at the heart of monetization: only 10% apps run true hybrid models, largely in gaming, where combining IAP, ads & subscriptions is more common (x4 the average).**

This may change in 2026, driven by AI-induced variable costs (read more), but also because mixed models are a lever to increase ARPU and counter increasing acquisitions costs.

Hybrid can mean ads, commerce, credits… but also complexity! This isn't for all apps. The biggest 2025 evolutions happened within subscriptions themselves. The lower hanging fruit sits in pricing and packaging optimization: trial duration, no-trials, numbers of plans, duration, price point, localization… The array of levers to pull is varied.

**Two examples:**

- One in four apps offer a lifetime plan
- Savvy apps within different verticals adapt to user intent and churn patterns: gaming selling 82% weekly, productivity 77% monthly, health & fitness 68% annual. Same model, three completely different strategies.

**Thomas Petit**
Independent App Growth Consultant

# What if you could see ad revenue and IAP revenue in one place?

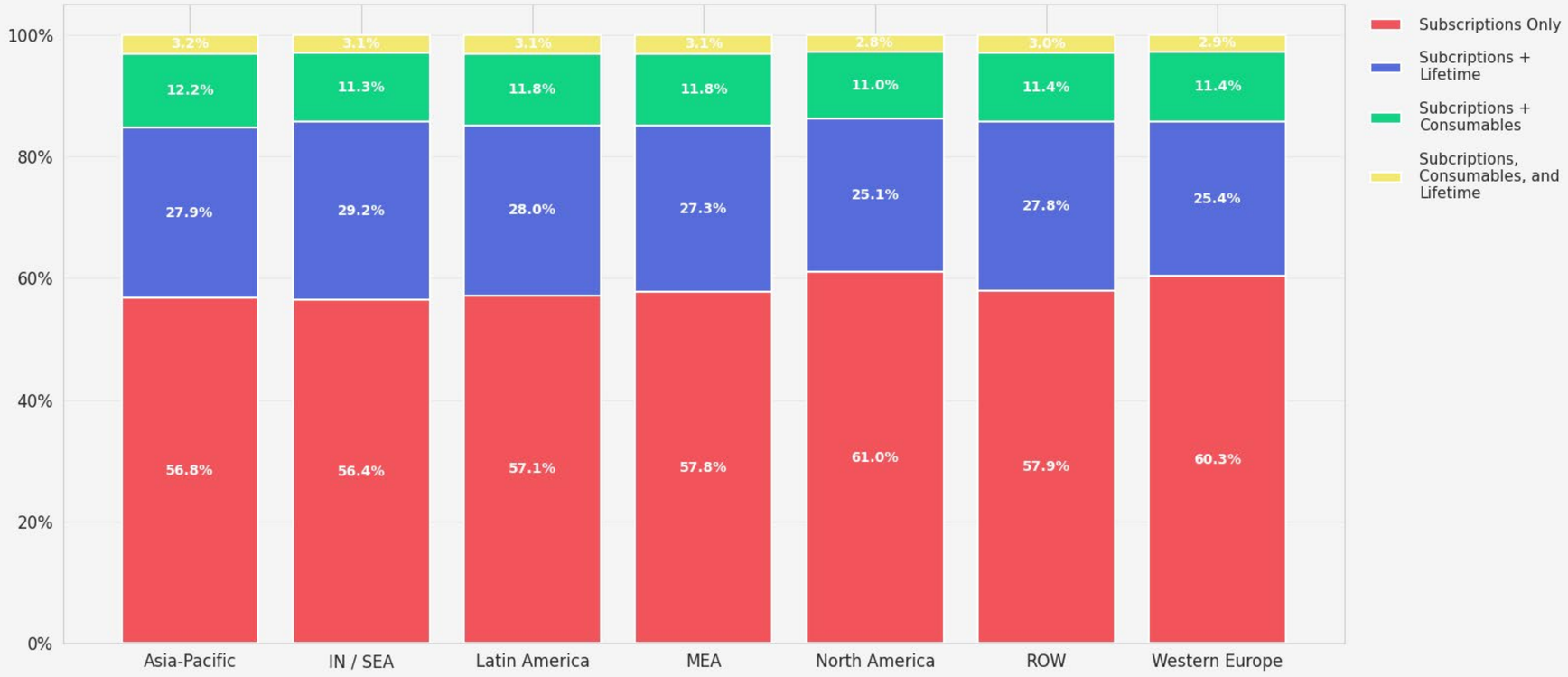
**As the data in this report shows, for many apps, subscriptions are just one piece of the monetization puzzle. But running a hybrid model with ads often means your revenue data is siloed.**

We're building a way to see your revenue from both in-app purchases and ads in one unified dashboard, so you can finally understand your true LTV and make smarter decisions. Coming soon.

**Follow our changelog to see the latest updates as they come**

# Monetization mix, by geography

How do monetization strategies differ across geographies?




## Key takeaway

Geography barely moves the needle: subscriptions-only spans 56.4–61.0% across all geographies, a spread of just 4.6pp.

## Benchmarks to know:

- North America: 61.0% subs-only (highest)
- Western Europe: 60.3% subs-only
- IN/SEA: 56.4% subs-only (lowest), 29.2% + lifetime (highest)
- All geography: ~3% use all three types

## What stands out:

- Asia-Pacific has highest consumable combination at 12.2%
- Lifetime combos range 25–29% across geographies — tight clustering
- Geographic uniformity is extreme — all within 4.5% of baseline across all models
- North America slightly favors subs-only, while N/SEA favors lifetime (+1.3 points)
- No meaningful geographic preference for any monetization approach

# Don’t settle for one paywall design

**Michal Parizek**
Senior Growth PM, Mojo

## Every user is different and so are the triggers that convert them.

If your app operates globally, you’ve likely seen paywall performance vary significantly by region. Yet many teams localize pricing and offers while keeping the same layout, hierarchy, and messaging everywhere.

That’s a missed opportunity.

At Mojo, we’ve seen different designs outperform depending on the market. In Japan, a long scrolling paywall with strong social proof and a clear Free vs. Pro comparison outperformed our US-style layout with interactive sliders by over 20%.

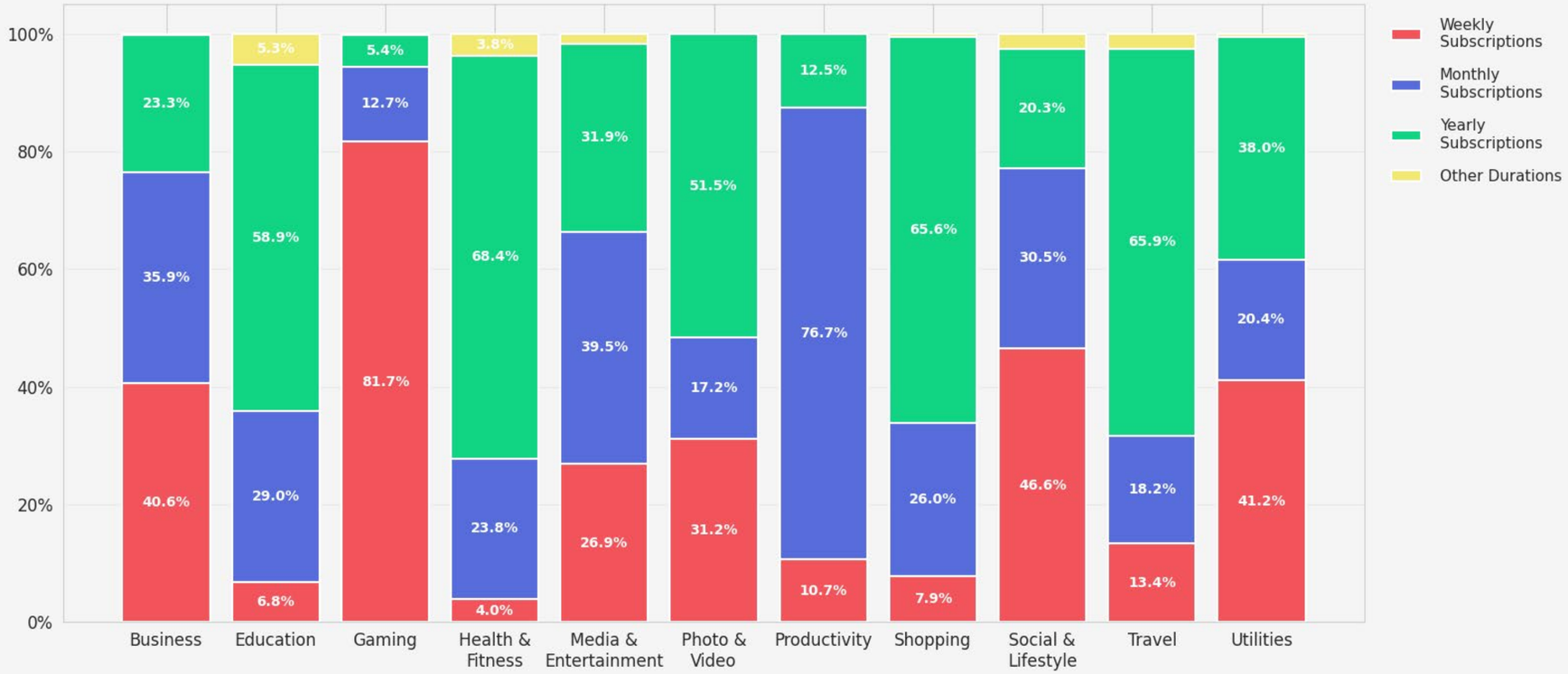
In parts of Latin America, we anchored our default yearly plan to its monthly equivalent (e.g., “just $X per month”). Trial start rate increased by 30% with no impact on trial-to-paid conversion, and yearly take rate lifted by 10%. Framing changed perceived affordability, without changing price.

When running paywall experiments, always break down results by key geos. Aggregate results often hide meaningful regional differences.

User psychology, price sensitivity, and trust signals vary by region. Your paywall should reflect that.

# Plan duration mix, by category

Which plan durations do subscribers choose by category?




## Key takeaway

Gaming is dominated by weekly plans (82%), while Health & Fitness leads annual adoption at 68%. Plan duration strategy varies dramatically by category economics.

## Benchmarks to know:

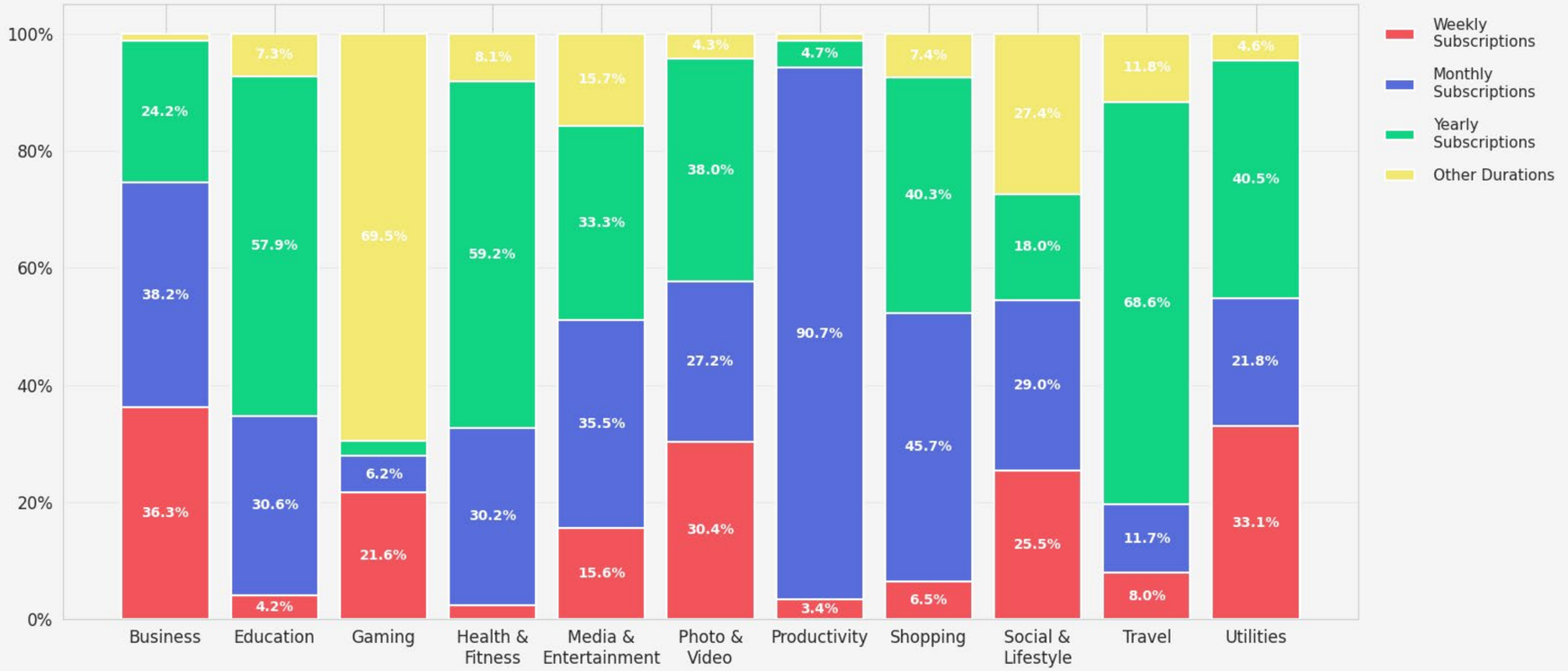
- Weekly, monthly, and annual each capture roughly a third overall
- 68%+ annual indicates retention-focused strategy
- 80%+ weekly signals high-churn, high-volume model

## What stands out:

- Gaming (82% weekly) and Health & Fitness (68% annual) represent opposite extremes
- Productivity is the monthly outlier at 77%
- Education, Travel, and Shopping all favor annual plans (59–66%)

# Revenue share, by subscription duration

Which plan durations drive revenue by category?




## Key takeaway

Revenue concentration by duration diverges sharply from volume — Productivity drives 90.7% of revenue from monthly plans, while Health & Fitness captures 59.2% from annual.

## Benchmarks to know:

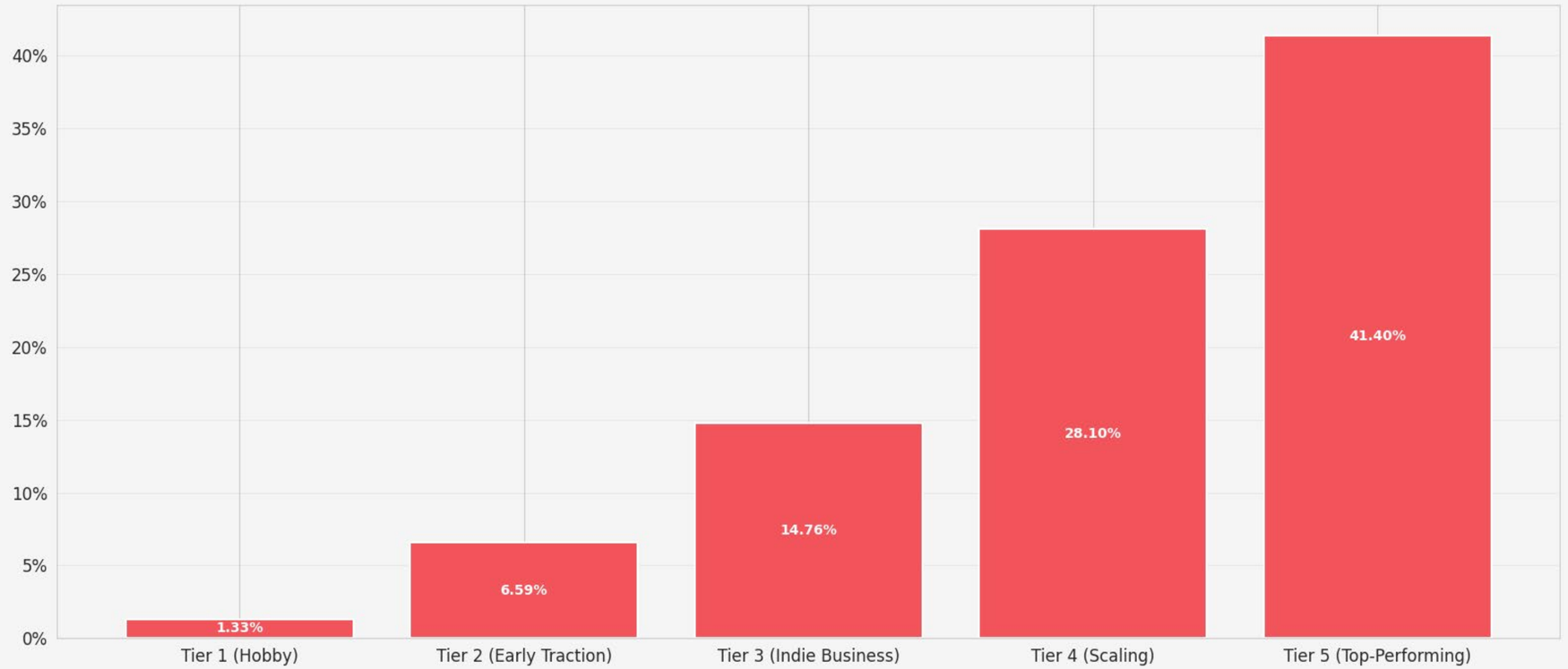
- Monthly subscriptions dominate overall revenue share
- Annual plans drive majority revenue in Health & Fitness, Education, Travel
- Weekly plans rarely exceed 30% of category revenue except Gaming

## What stands out:

- Productivity's 77% monthly revenue share is highest of any category-duration
- Gaming's weekly volume (82%) translates to lower revenue share due to price
- Shopping shows 66% annual revenue despite lower volume penetration

# Share of projects with any web revenue, by revenue tier

How does web revenue adoption vary by app revenue tier?




### Key takeaway

Web revenue adoption scales dramatically with tier: 41% of top-performing apps (Tier 5) generate web revenue vs. just 1.3% of hobby apps (Tier 1).

### Benchmarks to know:

- Tier 5: 41% web adoption
- Tier 4: 28% web adoption
- Tier 1: 1.3% web adoption

### What stands out:

- 31× difference between Tier 5 (41%) and Tier 1 (1.3%)
- Clear step function: each tier roughly doubles the previous
- Suggests web infrastructure investment correlates with scale

# The rise of web revenue blends three different tactics quietly routing around platforms

**Thomas Petit**
Independent App Growth Consultant

Web revenue in apps didn't gradually grow. From a niche, pioneer and daring tactic, it suddenly exploded in 2025, driven by three growth playbooks running in parallel:

- **Web-to-app is now mainstream** – Acquire on web, onboard and convert outside IAP, only into the app for better product experience and higher retention. Noom proved this worked a decade ago. Web flow are winning over flexibility, speed and media channels constraints (margins and attribution also factors, but less than most imagine).
- **App-to-web emerged, doomed to explode next** – Developers can, cautiously, redirect users from the app towards non store payments. This is just starting to materialize, only a few pioneers dared make the move early.
- **Games took a third path.** Different funnel mechanics requires another strategy: a whale won't be caught in a quiz net. Instead, new user experience still happens in app, and Web stores target retained high value users. Playtika is already past 25% of revenue, gunning for 40%.
- **Distribution is concentrated unevenly:** Two thirds sits in the US. A few vertical dominates. "Scaling phase" apps drive the charge: they get strong CAC pressure, have the resources to move fast but lack big brands inertia & risks.

# Why Web Onboarding Should Sell The Problem, Instead Of The Solution

**Leon Sasson**
Rise Science

Minisode

1 **Web funnels should sell the problem, not the solution**

App onboarding works by rushing users to an ‘aha!’ moment because they already want a solution. Web audiences are higher in the consideration phase, so effective web funnels go deeper on helping users recognize and personalize the problem before introducing the product.

2 **Discounted paid trials outperform free trials on web**

Rise found that offering a heavily discounted first month instead of a free trial improves both conversion quality and ad optimization. Free trials often attract users who cancel immediately, polluting the signal that ad platforms use to find high-value customers.

3 **Creative that flops on app campaigns can crush it on web, and vice versa**

Web funnels attract a different audience than app install campaigns, often older and more e-commerce minded. Rise runs creative across both channels separately and regularly finds winners on one side that failed on the other, effectively doubling the chances of finding a hit from every creative concept.

**Listen to Leon’s minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast**

Sub Club

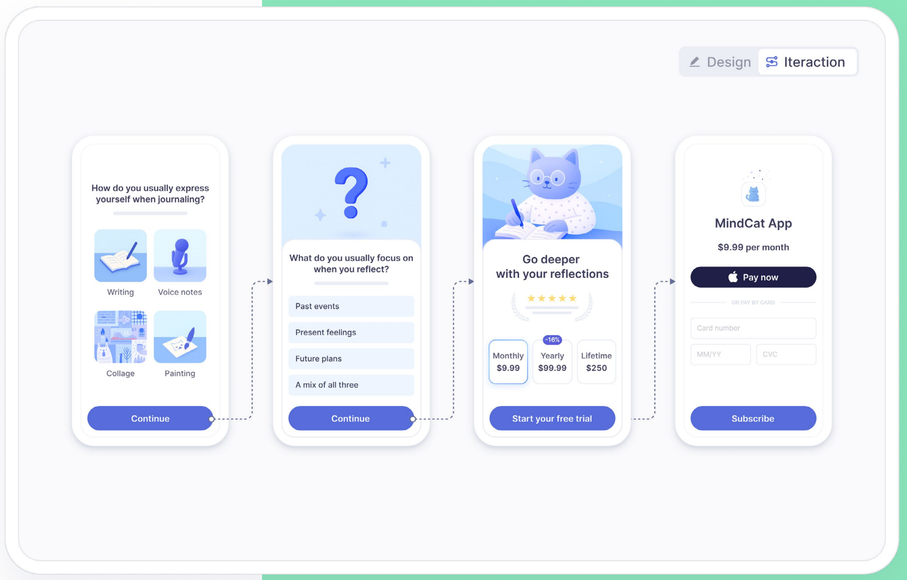
Apple Podcasts  Spotify  YouTube

# Build web-to-app funnels to convert users before the App Store

**As the last chart shows, 41% of the top performing apps have web revenue, compared to only 1.3% of small apps. That's a 31x gap and it's not because small apps can't do it. It's because they haven't tried yet.**

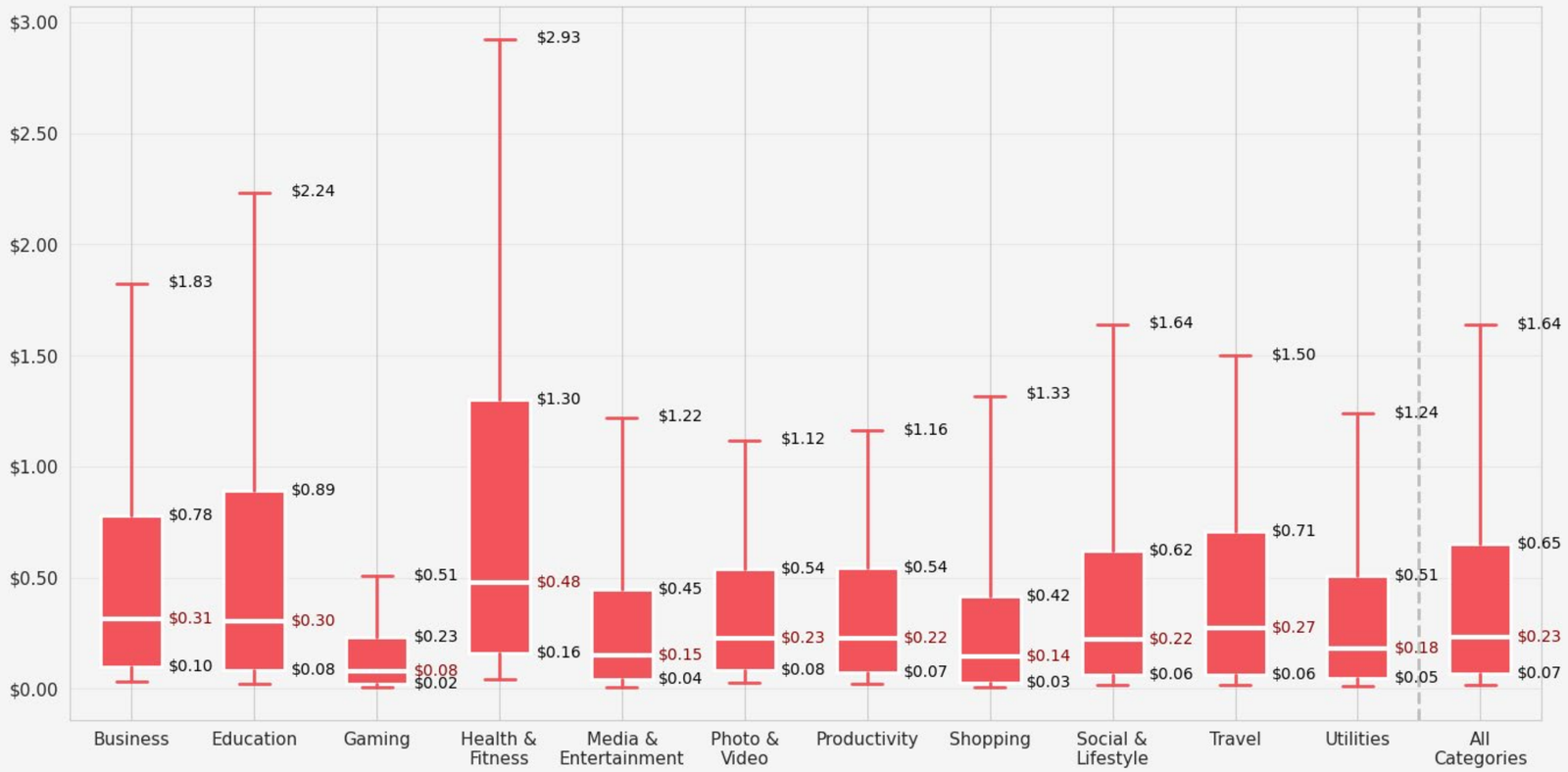
RevenueCat is working on a product that lets you build web-based funnels that convert users on your site, then seamlessly sync their access the moment they open your app. You can convert your web traffic, email lists, and social followers into paying subscribers before they download the app.

**Learn more and join the Funnels Beta waitlist**



# Average revenue per install (RPI) at Day 14, by category

What's the D14 revenue benchmark?




## Key takeaway

Health & Fitness leads early monetization at $0.48 median RPI at D14, nearly 6× higher than Gaming's $0.08 — category economics diverge sharply.

## Benchmarks to know:

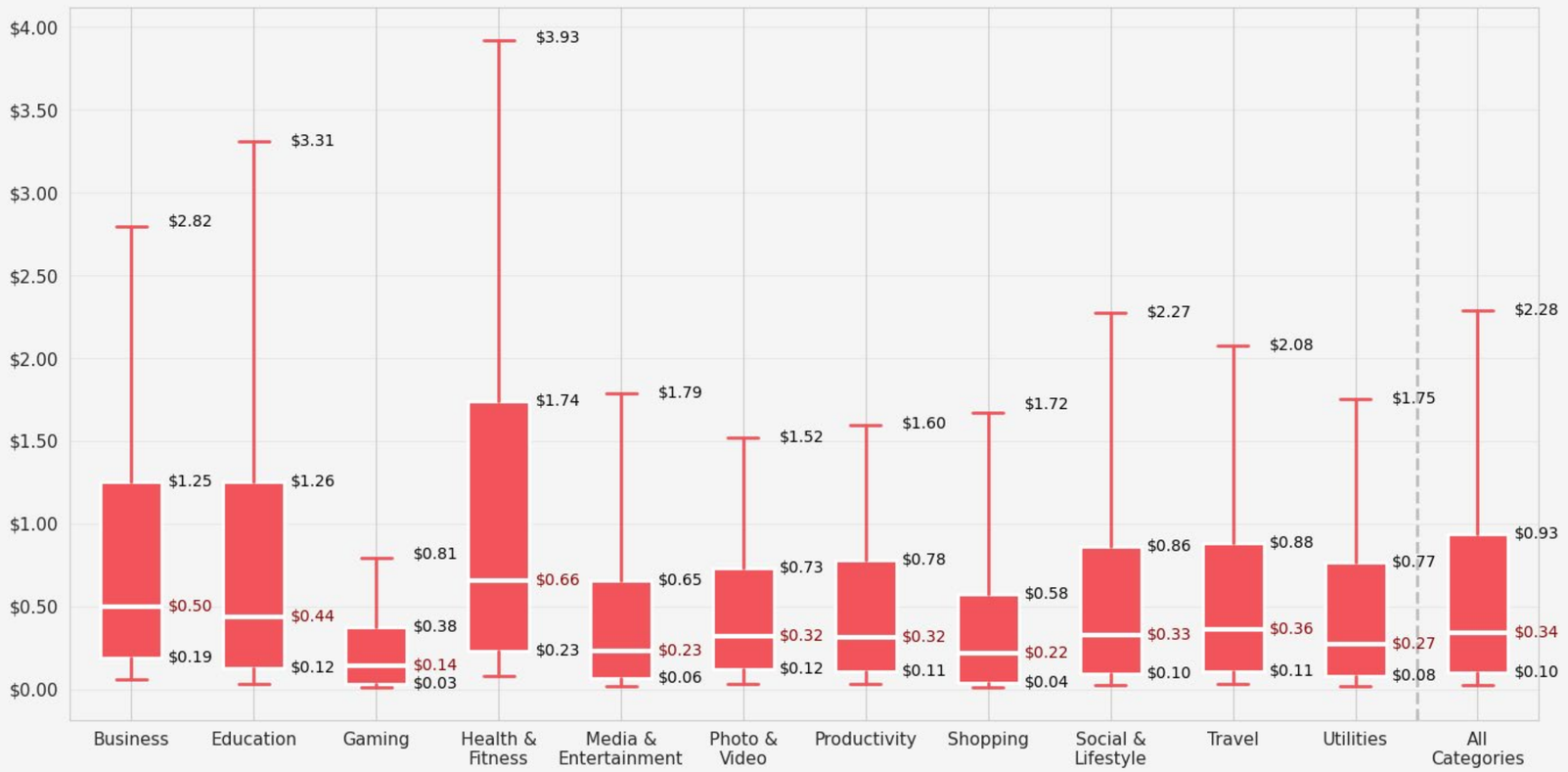
- $0.23 median at D14 across all categories
- $0.48+ indicates strong early monetization (top quartile Health & Fitness)
- Under $0.10 suggests volume-dependent business model

## What stands out:

- Health & Fitness ($0.48) leads; Gaming ($0.08) trails
- Business ($0.31) and Education ($0.30) monetize early
- Gaming's tight spread suggests consistent low-average RPI model

# Average revenue per install (RPI) at Day 60, by category

How does revenue grow from D14 to D60?




### Key takeaway

By D60, Health & Fitness reaches $0.66 median RPI (still 4.7× Gaming's $0.14) with gaps widening as retention-focused categories compound value.

### Benchmarks to know:

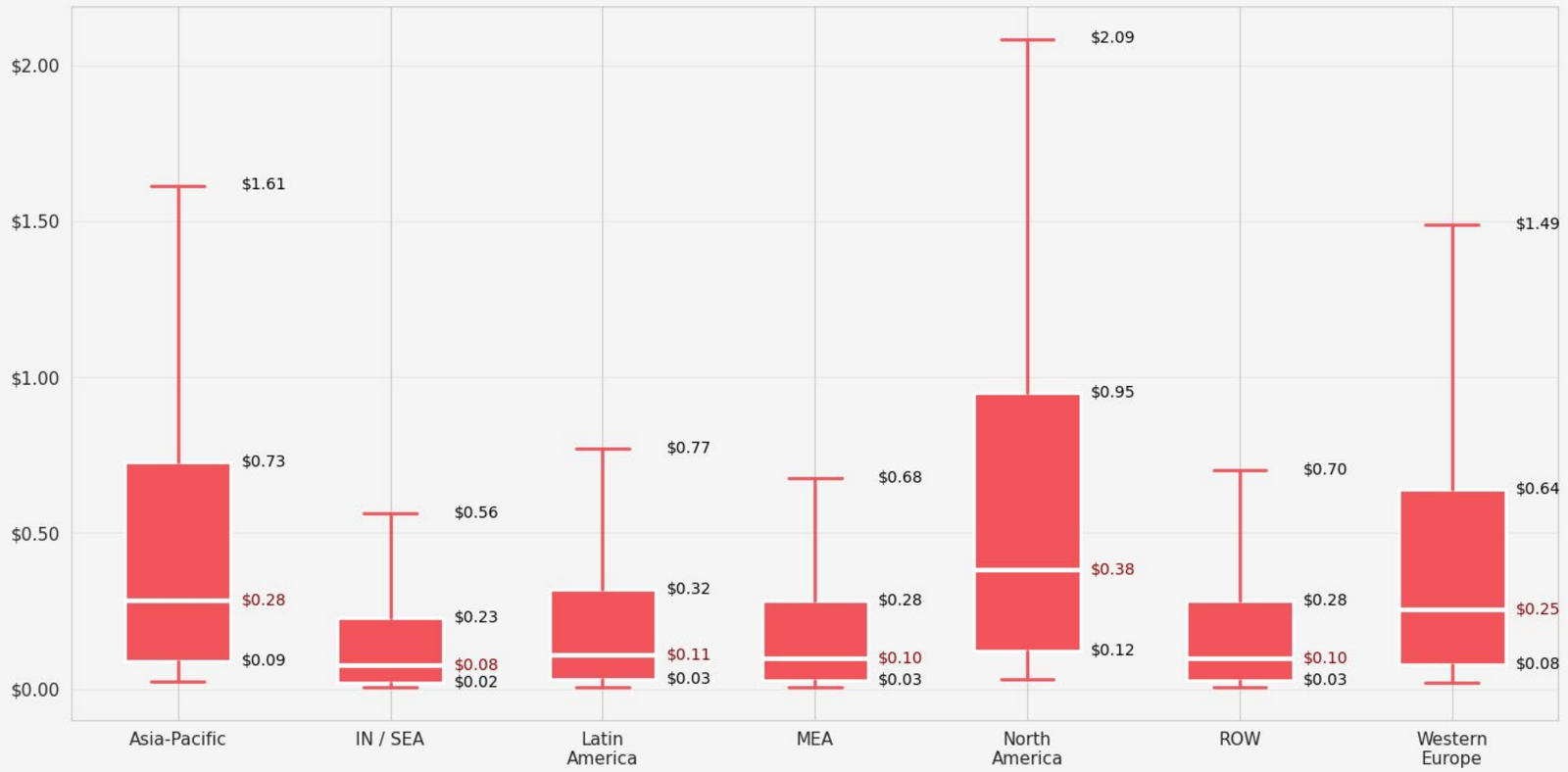
- $0.34 median at D60 across all categories
- $0.66+ indicates strong 60-day monetization
- 1.5× D14→D60 multiplier is typical

### What stands out:

- Health & Fitness grows from $0.48 (D14) to $0.66 (D60): 1.4× multiplier
- Gaming grows from $0.08 to $0.14: 1.7× multiplier but low absolute value
- Business shows highest absolute $ growth: $0.31 to $0.50 (+$0.19)

# Average revenue per install (RPI) at Day 14, by geography

Which geographies generate the highest D14 revenue?




## Key takeaway

North American users generate $0.38 median RPI at D14 (5× higher than IN/SEA's $0.08), reflecting purchasing power and monetization maturity.

## Benchmarks to know:

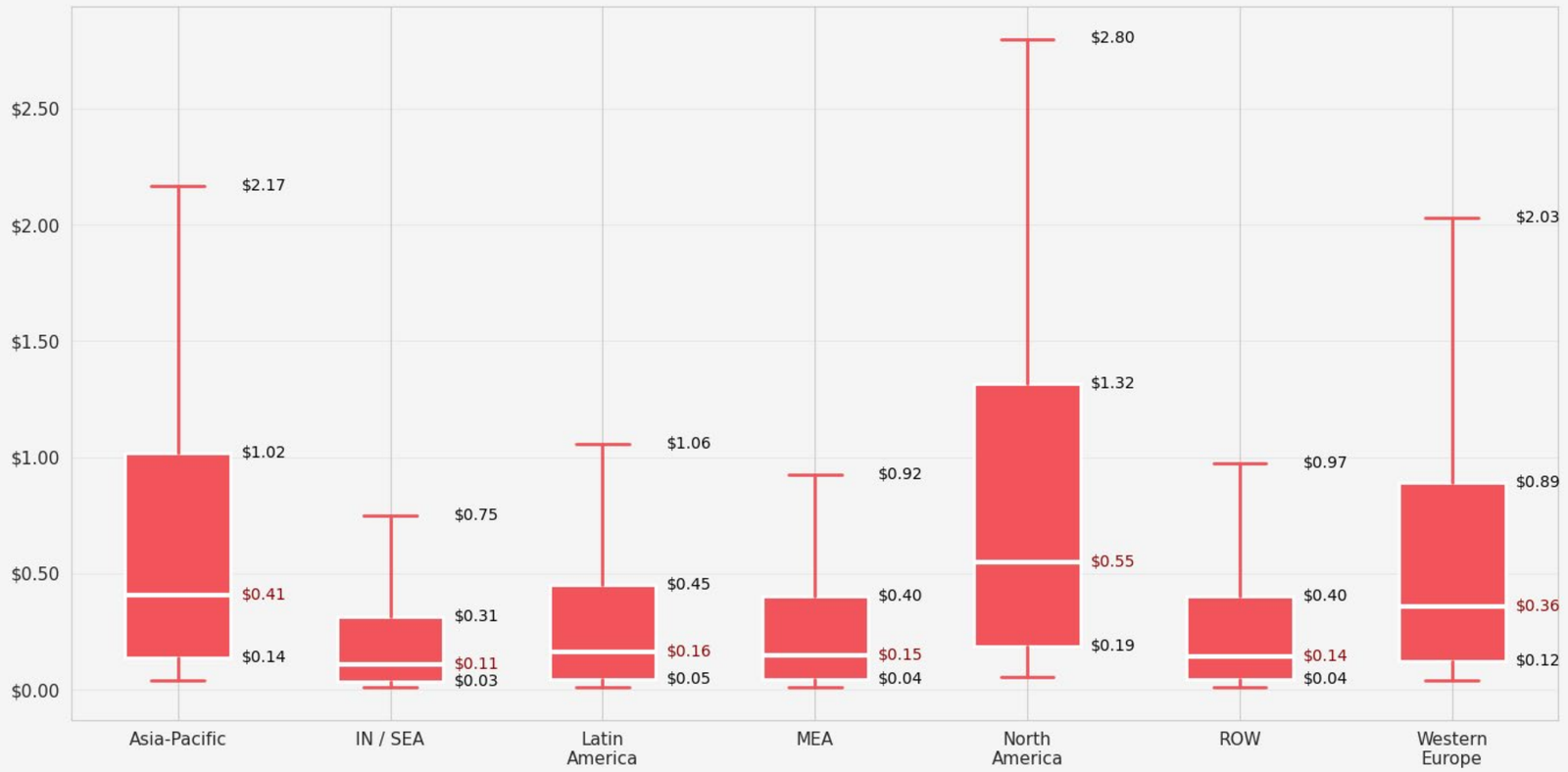
- North America: $0.38 median
- Western Europe: $0.25 median
- IN/SEA: $0.08 median

## What stands out:

- 5× gap between North America ($0.38) and IN/SEA ($0.08)
- Asia-Pacific ($0.28) outperforms Western Europe ($0.25)
- Latin America, MEA, ROW cluster tightly around $0.10

# Average revenue per install (RPI) at Day 60, by geography

How does D60 revenue vary by geography?




### Key takeaway

North American apps generate 5× higher D60 RPI than IN/SEA apps, with a median of $0.55 vs. $0.11.

### Benchmarks to know:

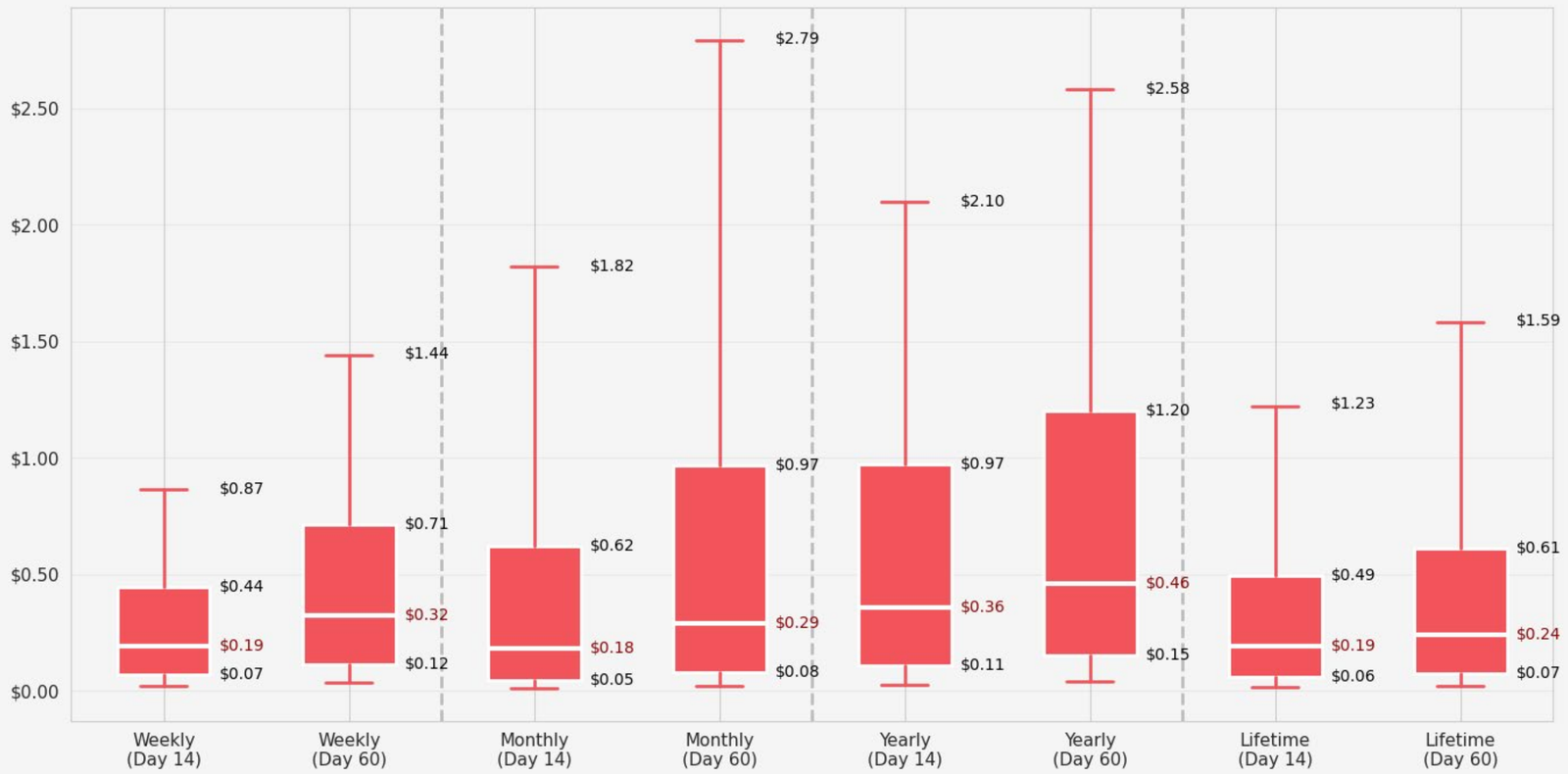
- North America median: $0.55, top quartile above $1.39
- Europe median: $0.33, balanced performance
- IN/SEA median: $0.11, reflects lower pricepoints

### What stands out:

- 5× gap between highest and lowest geographies
- North America's top performers reach $3.19 at the 90th percentile
- LATAM tracks closer to Europe than to IN/SEA

# Average revenue per install (RPI) after 14 and 60 days, split by plan duration

Do longer plans drive more revenue?




### Key takeaway

Apps whose most popular plan is yearly generate the highest total RPI at both D14 ($0.36) and D60 ($0.46). Note: each app is classified by its most-sold plan duration, but the revenue figure reflects all revenue from that app — not just revenue from that plan type.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Yearly-dominant apps: D14: $0.36, D60: $0.46
- Monthly-dominant apps: D14: $0.18, D60: $0.29
- Weekly-dominant apps: D14: $0.19, D60: $0.32
- Lifetime-dominant apps: D14: $0.19, D60: $0.24

### What stands out:

- Apps that primarily sell yearly subscriptions monetize installs ~2× better than other groups at D14, widening slightly to D60
- The spread for yearly-dominant apps is notably large, suggesting high variance; some monetize extremely well, others modestly
- Growth from D14→D60 is strongest for weekly (+68%) and monthly (+61%) dominant apps, consistent with recurring short-cycle billing accumulating over time

# Most subscription apps should optimize their monetization strategies to maximize RPI, particularly those supporting AI-powered features with non-trivial underlying costs

**Phil Carter**
Founder and CEO, Elemental Growth

The data highlights two key insights for subscription apps looking to maximize revenue per install (RPI):

**Hard paywall apps generate ~8-9x higher RPI vs. freemium apps**

- D14 median RPI: $2.32 vs. $0.27
- D60 median RPI: $3.09 vs. $0.38

**Annual plans generate ~2x higher RPI vs. monthly plans and ~5x higher RPI vs. weekly plans**

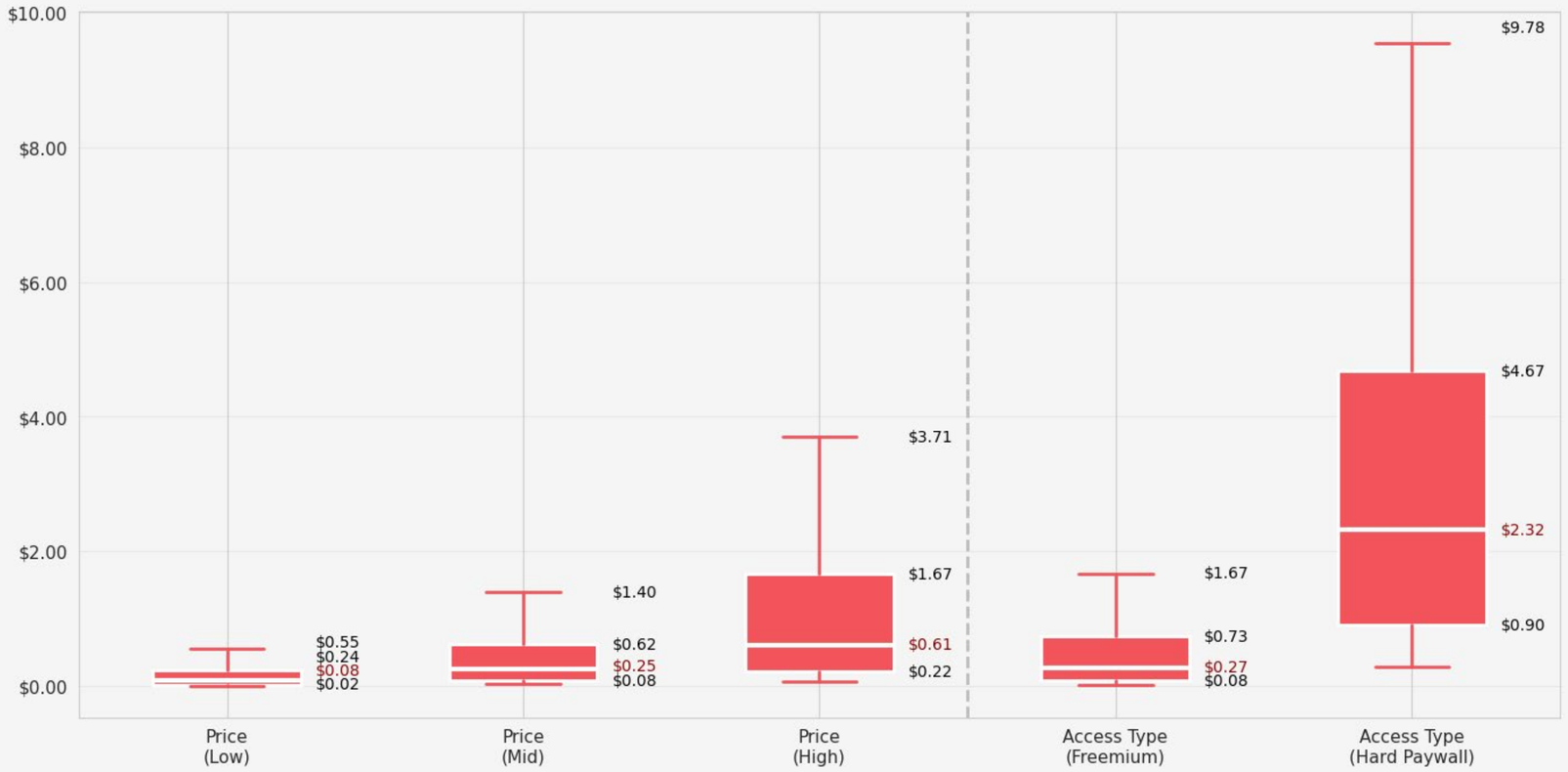
- D14 median RPI: $0.36 vs. $0.18 vs. $0.07
- D60 median RPI: $0.46 vs. $0.24 vs. $0.09

The implications are clear - the most reliable way for subscription apps to generate revenue quickly is by paywalling new users immediately after they understand the product's core value proposition and nudging them towards annual plans. This maximizes short-term cash flow, allowing companies to re-invest more money into paid user acquisition without having to raise large amounts of capital.

This is particularly important for AI apps. The cost to serve a marginal subscriber used to be near-zero, but that's not true for products using LLMs to support AI-powered features. As a result, many AI apps are offering less generous freemium products, shortening free trial lengths, pushing new users towards annual plans, and/or introducing higher-priced subscription tiers for AI features to cover their costs. This helps them maintain healthy unit economics as they scale.

# Average revenue per install (RPI) after 14 days, split by access method and pricepoint

Does pricing strategy affect D14 revenue?




### Key takeaway

Hard paywall apps generate 9× more D14 RPI than low-priced freemium apps, with a median of $2.32 vs. $0.27.

### Benchmarks to know:

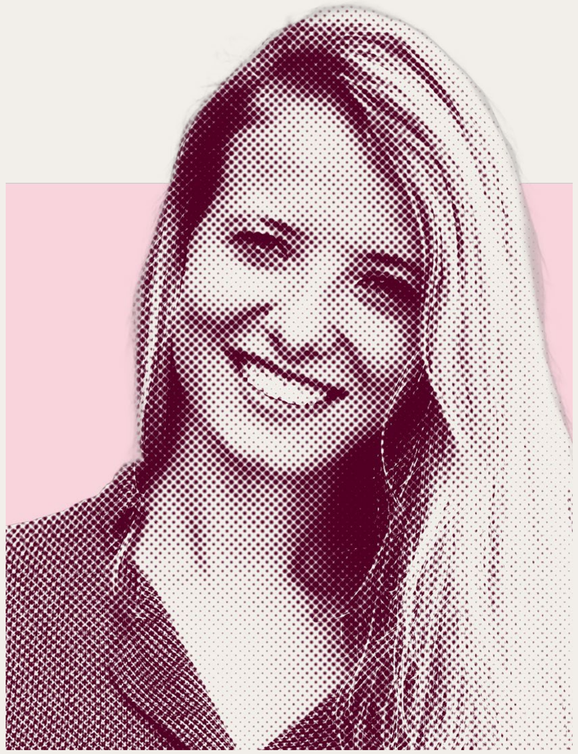
- Hard paywall median: $2.32, top quartile above $4.50
- High-priced median: $0.61, solid middle ground
- Low-priced median: $0.08, volume-dependent model

### What stands out:

- Hard paywalls dominate early monetization
- 8× spread between highest and lowest pricing tiers
- Freemium sits at ~12% of hard paywall performance

StartApp School

# How to make an app people will pay for, by Daphne Tideman



**Daphne Tideman**
Growth Advisor & Consultant

Instructor Daphne Tideman delivers the ultimate lesson on nailing product-market fit (PMF), before chasing growth. This foundational course helps early-stage founders map out the fundamentals of PMF: who you're building for, what problem your app solves, and how to monetize it. This ensures you avoid building the wrong product before it's too late.

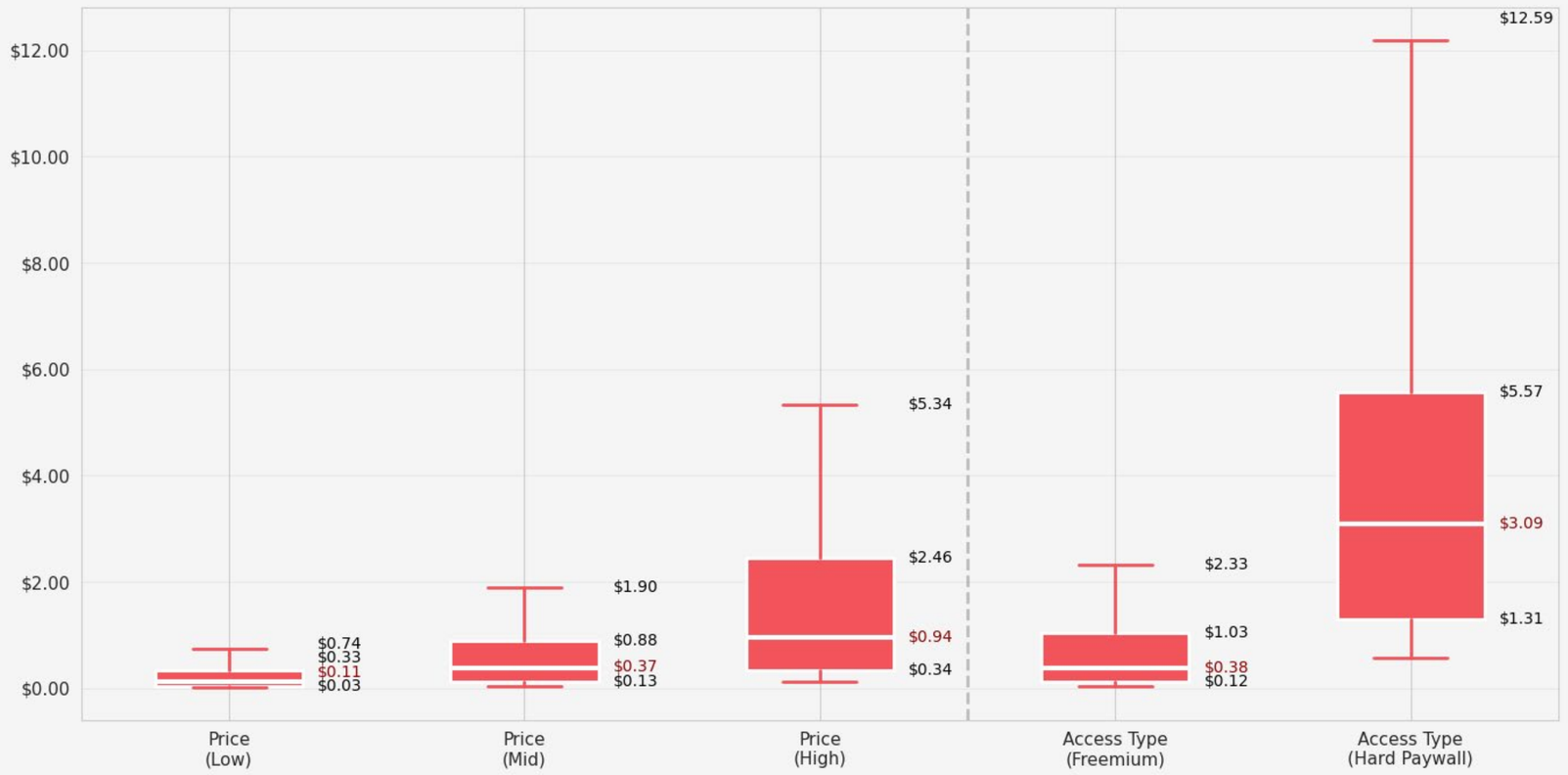
Explore Daphne's Course

**What you'll learn:**

- How to define a clear product strategy
- How to identify and validate your niche
- How to test assumptions early
- How to define your North Star metric
- How to assess willingness to pay
- How to build toward product-market fit

# Average revenue per install (RPI) after 60 days, split by access method and pricepoint

How does pricing strategy affect D60 revenue?




### Key takeaway

Hard paywall apps maintain dominance at D60 with $3.09 median, 8x higher than freemium at $0.38.

### Benchmarks to know:

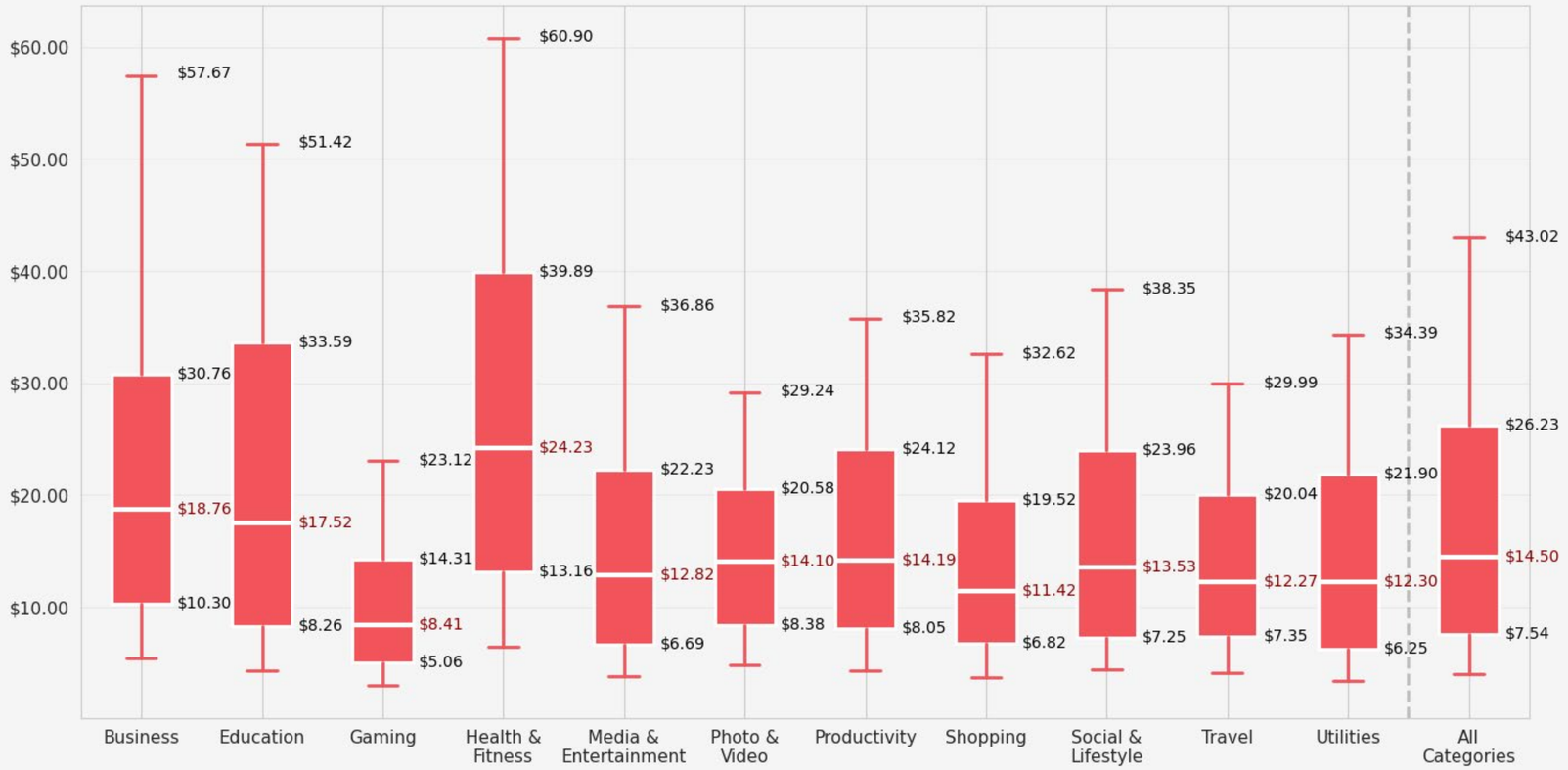
- Hard paywall median: $3.09, top quartile above $5.50
- High-priced median: $0.94, growth continues post-D14
- Low-priced median: $0.11, modest gains from D14

### What stands out:

- Hard paywalls grow 33% from D14 to D60
- Gap between tiers persists through the funnel
- Low-priced apps see only $0.03 increase from D14

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 month, by category

What's monthly revenue per paying customer?




## Key takeaway

Health & Fitness leads month 1 RLTV at $24.23 median, nearly 3× Gaming's $8.41.

## Benchmarks to know:

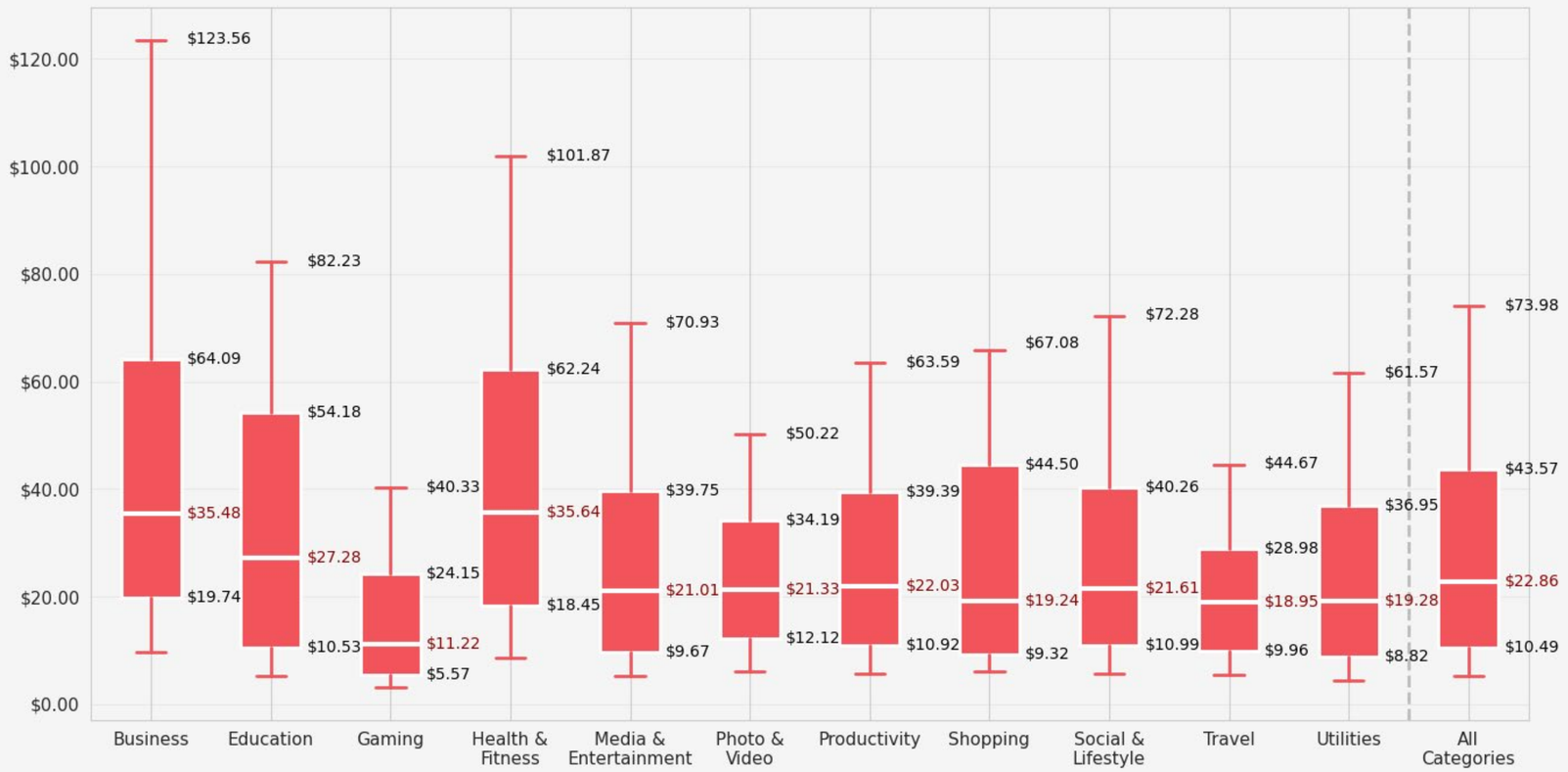
- Health & Fitness median: $24.23, top quartile above $39.00
- Business median: $18.76, strong B2B positioning
- Gaming median: $8.41, lower pricepoints but higher volume

## What stands out:

- 3× spread between top and bottom categories
- Health & Fitness top performers exceed $60 RLTV
- Travel and Utilities cluster in the middle tier

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 year, by category

What's yearly revenue per payer?




## Key takeaway

Health & Fitness apps lead yearly RLTV at $35.64 median, more than 3× Gaming's $11.22.

## Benchmarks to know:

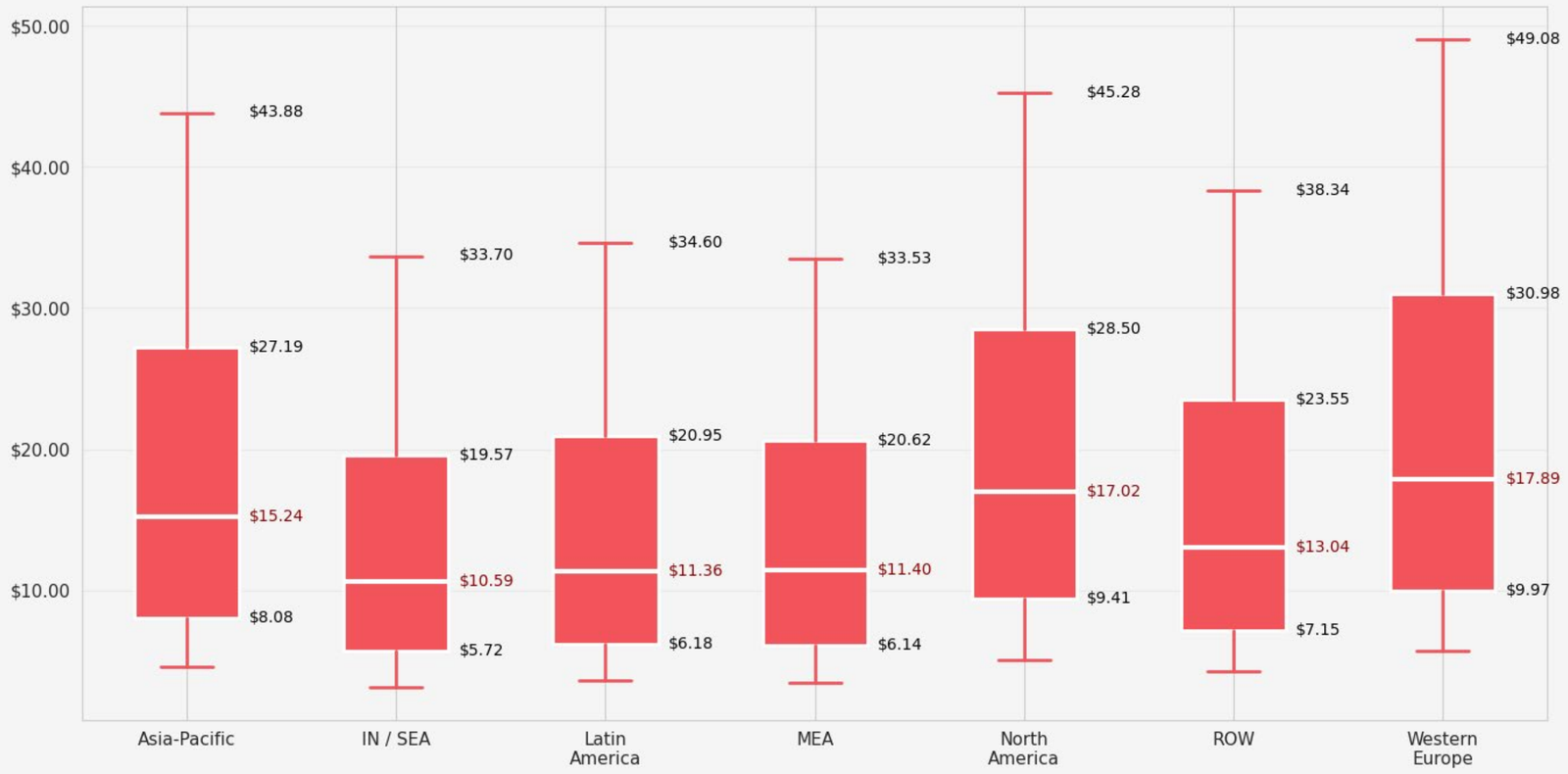
- Business median: $35.48, top quartile above $69.19
- Health & Fitness median: $35.64, strong retention value
- Gaming median: $11.22, lower annual commitment

## What stands out:

- The best Business apps see over $120 RLTV per payer after Y1
- 3× spread from top to bottom categories
- Productivity ($24.95) and Education ($22.82) form solid mid-tier

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 month, by geography

How does monthly RLTV vary by geography?




### Key takeaway

Western Europe leads monthly RLTV at $17.89 median, 69% higher than IN/SEA's $10.59.

### Benchmarks to know:

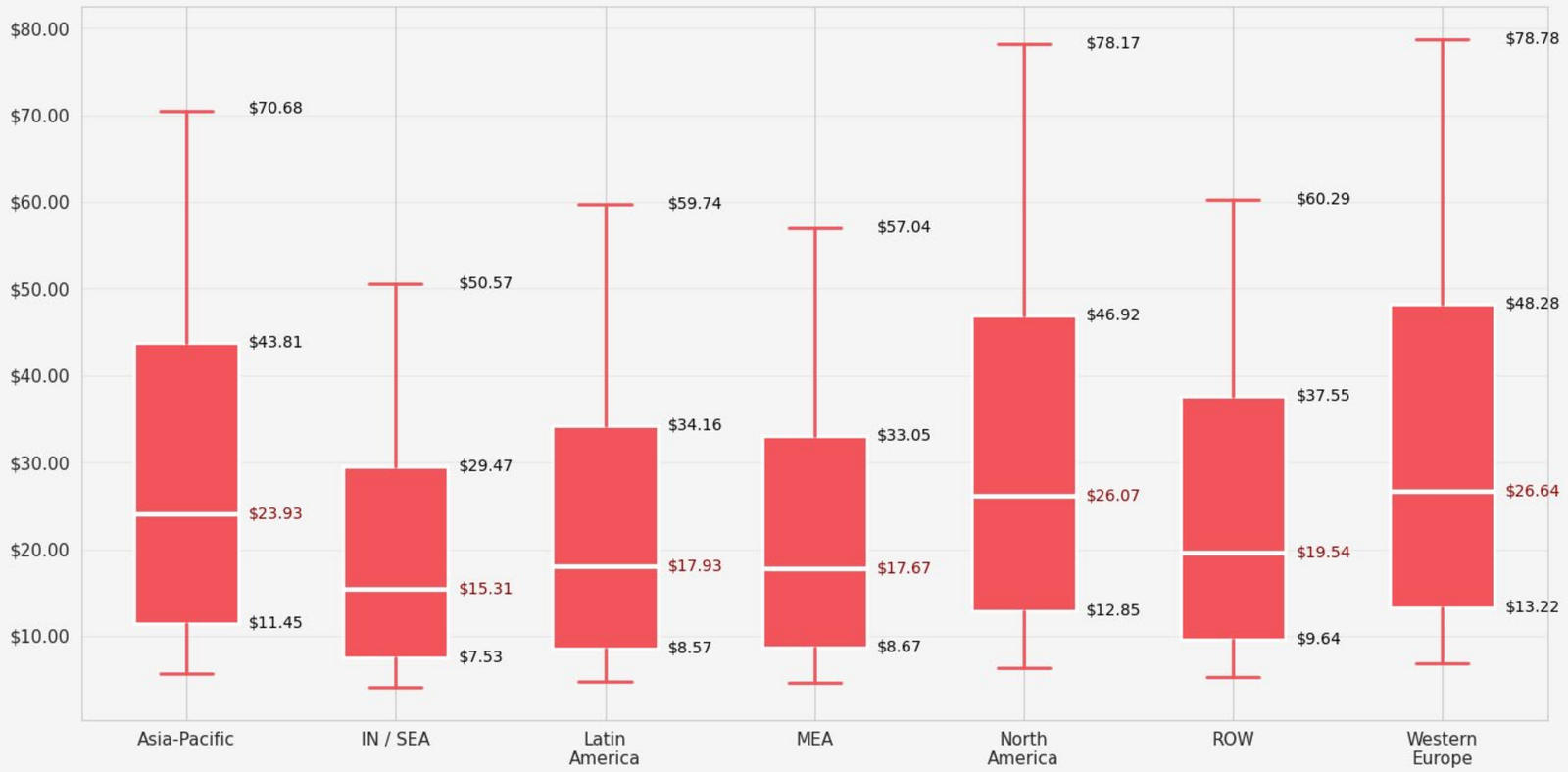
- North America median: $17.02. top quartile above $28
- Europe median: $17.89, outperforms NA
- IN/SEA median: $10.59, lowest but still substantial

### What stands out:

- Tighter geographical spread than revenue per install (RPI) metrics
- Europe spends more per payer, but converts at a lower rate
- All geographies show significant upside in top quartile

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 year, by geography

How does yearly RLTV vary by geography?




### Key takeaway

Western Europe leads yearly RLTV at $26.64 median, 38% higher than IN/SEA's $19.32..

### Benchmarks to know:

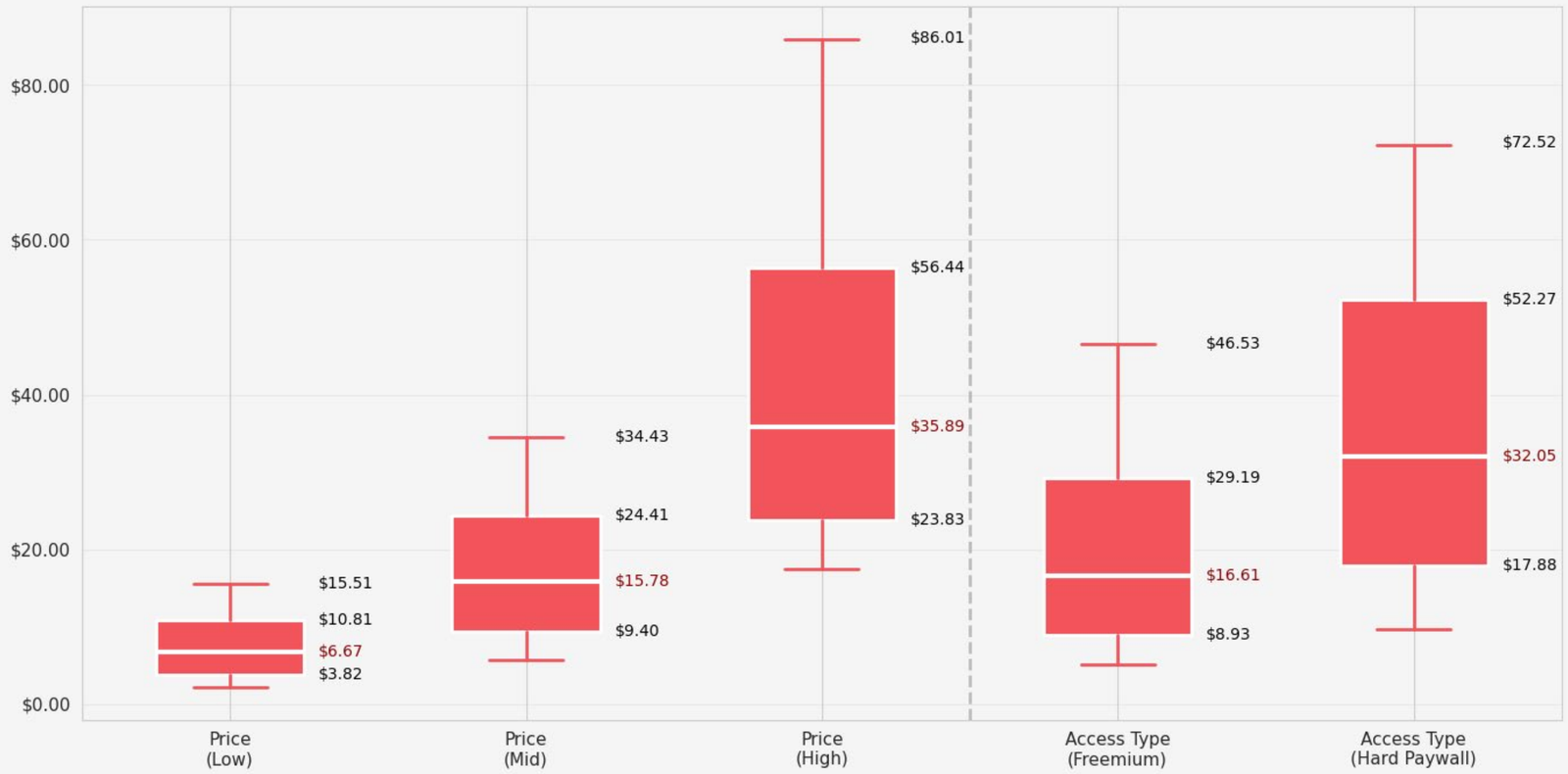
- North America median: $26.07 — top quartile above $46
- Europe median: $26.64 — just above NA
- IN/SEA median: $19.32 — lowest annual value

### What stands out:

- Geographical gaps narrower for payers after Y1
- Top quartile shows 2× upside across all geographies
- NA, APAC, and Western Europe make up Tier 1

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 month, by access method or pricepoint

How does pricing affect monthly RLTV?




### Key takeaway

High-priced apps generate $35.89 monthly RLTV median, 5.4× higher than low-priced apps at $6.67.

### Benchmarks to know:

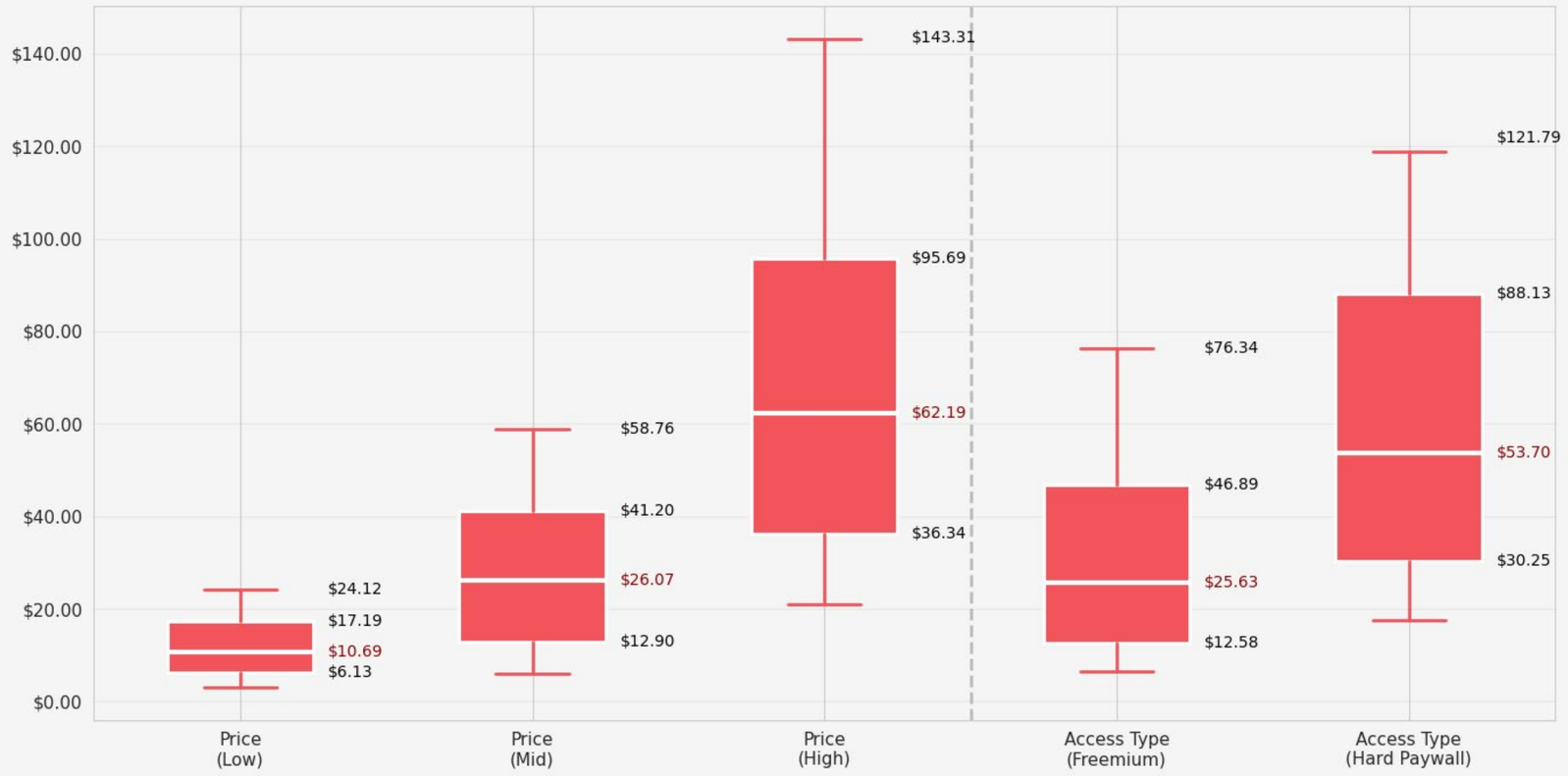
- High-priced median: $35.89, top quartile above $56
- Mid-priced median: $15.78, balanced positioning
- Low-priced median: $6.67, volume-dependent

### What stands out:

- 5.4× spread from high to low pricing tiers
- Mid-priced performs at roughly half of high-priced
- Hard paywall generates close to double revenue vs.freemium

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 year, by access method or pricepoint

What's the yearly revenue opportunity?




### Key takeaway

High-priced apps dominate yearly RLTV at $62.19 median, nearly 6× low-priced apps at $10.69.

### Benchmarks to know:

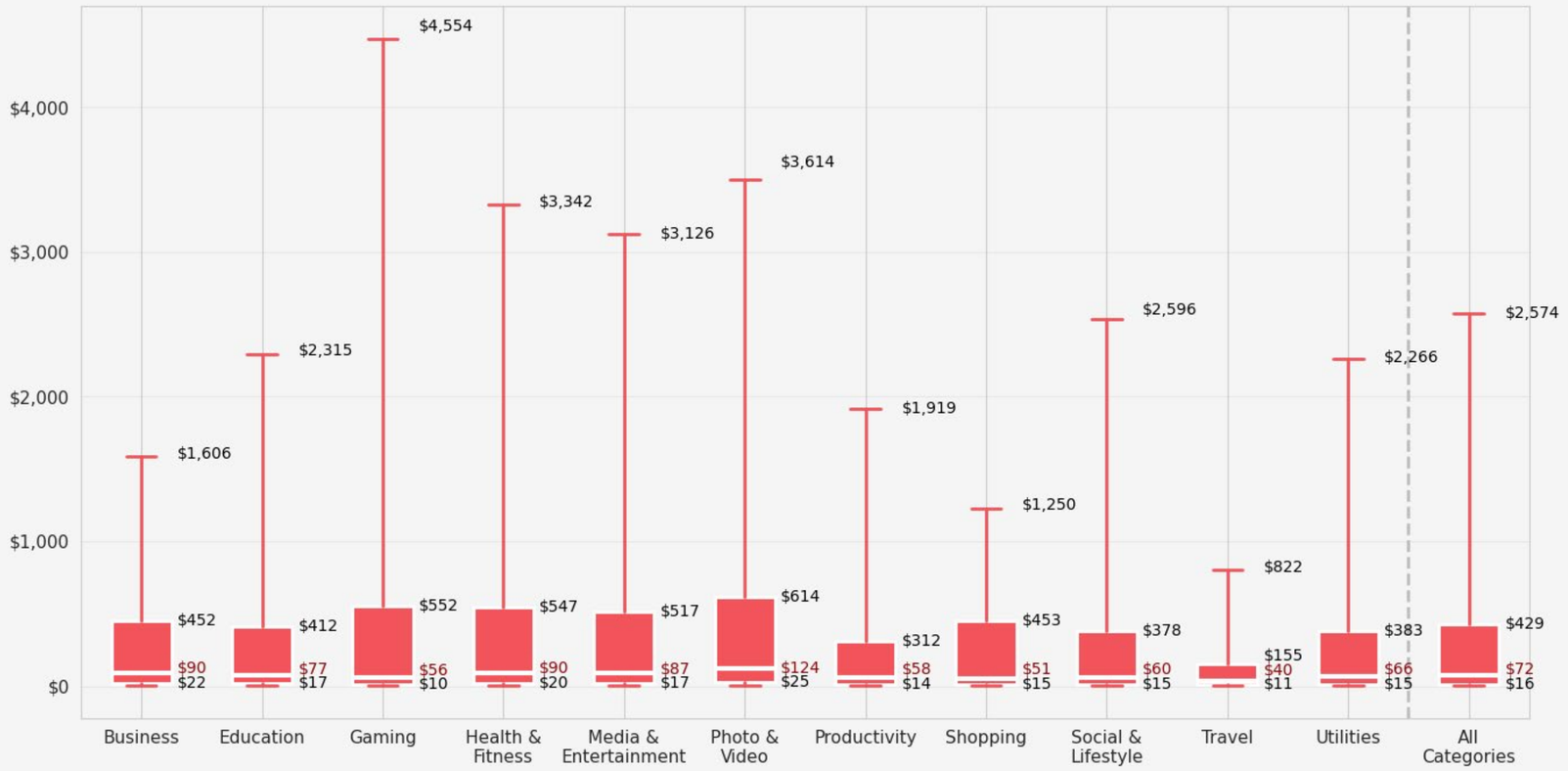
- High-priced median: $62.19, top quartile above $109.64
- Mid-priced median: $28.75, less than half of high-priced
- Low-priced median: $10.69, up $4.02 from month 1

### What stands out:

- High-priced Y1 RLTV is 79% higher than month 1
- 6× spread between pricing tiers
- Low-priced sees the smallest % lift from month 1 to Y1

# Monthly revenue 1 year after launch, by category

Which categories show best post-launch traction?




## Key takeaway

Cross-category median is ~$72, but the top 10% pull $2,500+, a 36× gap that defines this metric's extreme right skew.

## Benchmarks to know:

- If you're at ~$72/mo, you're at the overall median 1 year post-launch
- If you're above $429, you're in the top quartile
- If you're above $2,574, you're in the top 10% across all categories
- Photo & Video leads category medians at $124; Travel trails at $35

## What stands out:

- Gaming's top 10% reaches $4,554, nearly 2× the all-category top 10%, despite a below-median center ($56)
- The middle 50% spans $16–$429 overall, a 27× spread, unusually wide for a revenue metric
- Travel is the most compressed category: top 10% at just $822 vs. $3,600+ for Photo & Video

# The Boom In Non-Game App Revenue And What's Driving It

**Olivia Moore**
Andreessen Horowitz (a16z)

1 **The app revenue boom isn't just about AI apps**

Non-game in-app purchases grew 21% year over year, but only $3.5 billion came from generative AI. Billions more flowed into short dramas, social media, utilities, entertainment, and other categories.

2 **ChatGPT helped reset what consumers will pay**

Pre-AI, most consumer subscriptions topped out around $60 a year. ChatGPT normalized $20 a month, and usage-based pricing is pushing some users into hundreds monthly. AI apps monetize at 2x pre-AI ARPU.

3 **Vertical, opinionated products beat thin AI wrappers**

Build deep products around a specific use case bigger platforms won't prioritize. The litmus test: your product should get better, not fear for its life, when the underlying models improve.

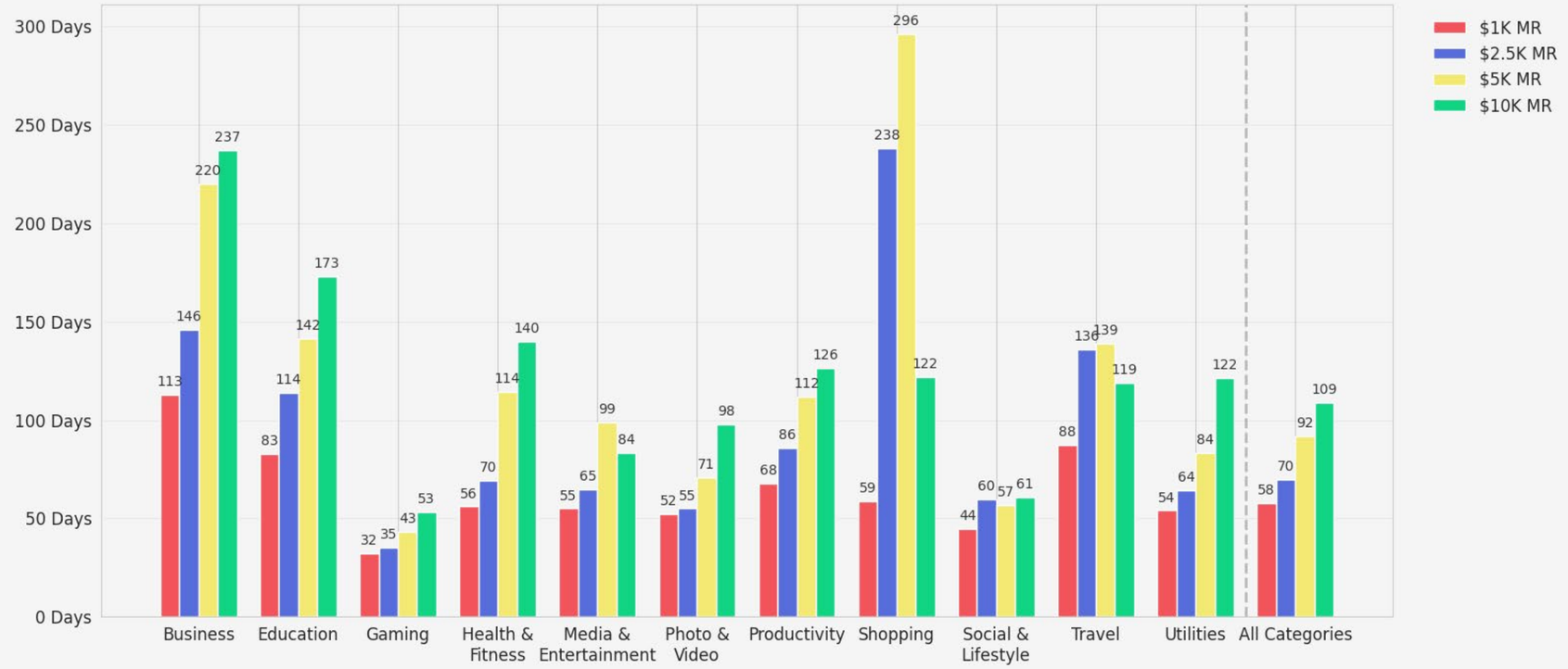
**Listen to Olivia's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast**

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

Minisode

# Median number of days from launch to revenue milestones

How long does it take apps to reach monthly revenue milestones?




### Key takeaway

Gaming reaches $1K monthly revenue fastest (32 days median), while Business takes 113 days, a 3.5× difference.

### Benchmarks to know:

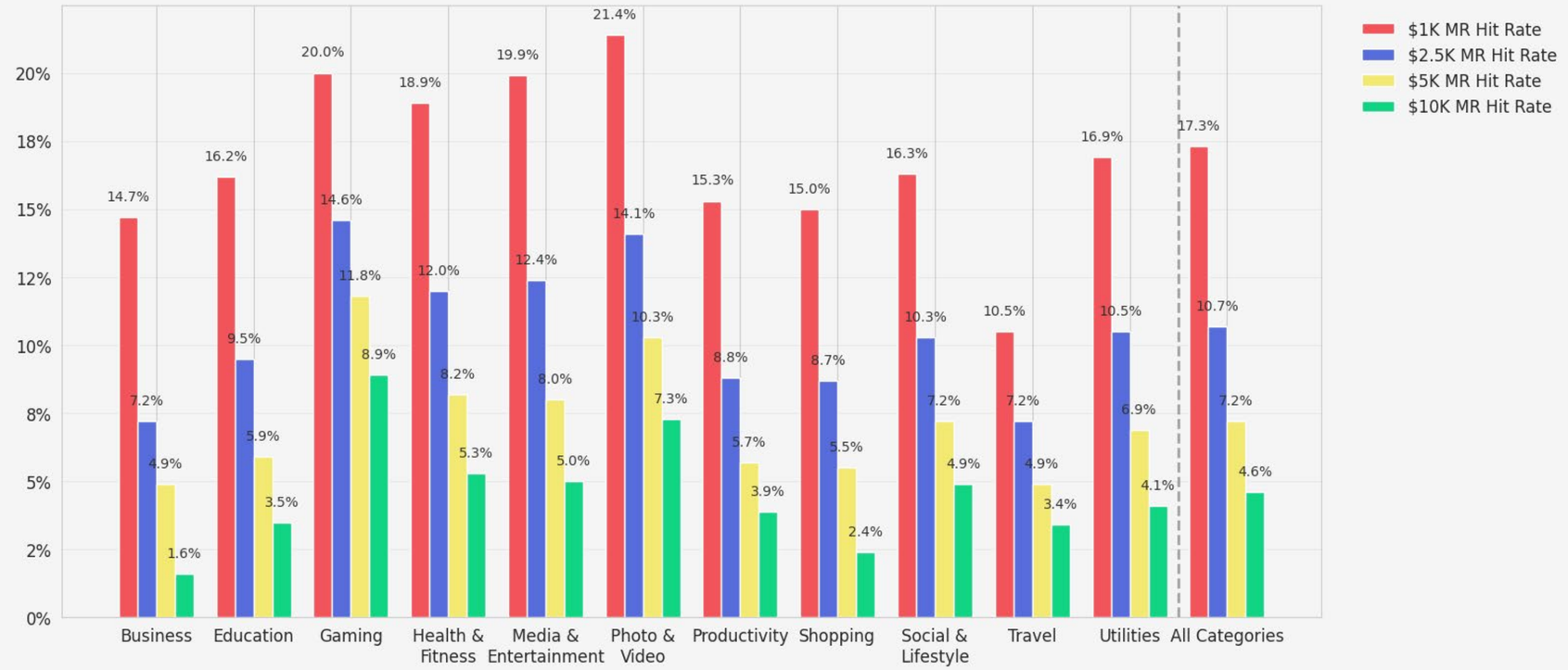
- Gaming to $1K: 32 days → to $10K: 53 days
- Social & Lifestyle to $1K: 45 days = fast early traction
- Business to $1K: 113 days = slower but higher lifetime value (LTV)

### What stands out:

- Gaming's speed advantage persists through $10K milestone
- Shopping shows erratic progression (59 → 238 → 296 days)
- All Categories median: 58 days to $1K, 109 days to $10K

# Share of newly-launched apps that hit revenue milestones in their first 2 years

What share of apps hit monthly revenue milestones?




### Key takeaway

Photo & Video leads with 21.4% hitting $1K monthly revenue, while only 4.6% of all apps reach $10K.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Photo & Video: 21.4% hit $1, 7.3% hit $10K
- Gaming: 20.0% hit $1K, 8.9% hit $10K (highest $10K rate)
- All Categories: 17.3% hit $1K, 4.6% hit $10K

### What stands out:

- Gaming has highest $10K hit rate despite mid-tier $1K rate
- Business: 14.7% hit $1K but only 1.6% reach $10K
- ~75% drop-off from $1K to $10K milestone across categories

# How To Repurpose Offline Events Into Millions Of Online Impressions

**Larissa Morimoto**
Photoroom

1 **Measure brand campaigns by search uplift, not cost per install**

Comparing offline and other brand campaign CPAs to paid acquisition CPAs kills creativity before it starts. Track branded search lift and run awareness surveys instead.

2 **Design every offline moment for online distribution**

Bring ad creatives to your events and plan for UGC from the start. An in-person activation that reached 15,000 people generated over 4 million impressions once repurposed across ads, social, and even LinkedIn.

3 **Celebrity reach without audience fit is wasted spend**

A famous partner whose audience doesn't overlap with your ICP will move zero needles. Calm's LeBron James partnership was their most expensive and worst-performing campaign because his fans care about basketball, not better sleep.

**Listen to Larissa's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast**

Sub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

# Store and revenue economics: key takeaways

Across the subscription ecosystem, revenue concentration is the defining theme. Time-to-revenue varies by more than 3x between categories. Only 4.6% of newly launched apps reach $10K in monthly revenue within two years. Pricing architecture drives a 3x+ spread in realized lifetime value (LTV). Geography creates up to 5x differences in revenue per install (RPI) by D60. And web revenue, while strategically important, remains just 3.2% of total revenue globally.

The pattern is consistent: outcomes cluster tightly around modest medians, with a long tail of high performers driving category economics. If you're benchmarking performance, the median tells you viability. The upper quartile tells you whether your model scales.

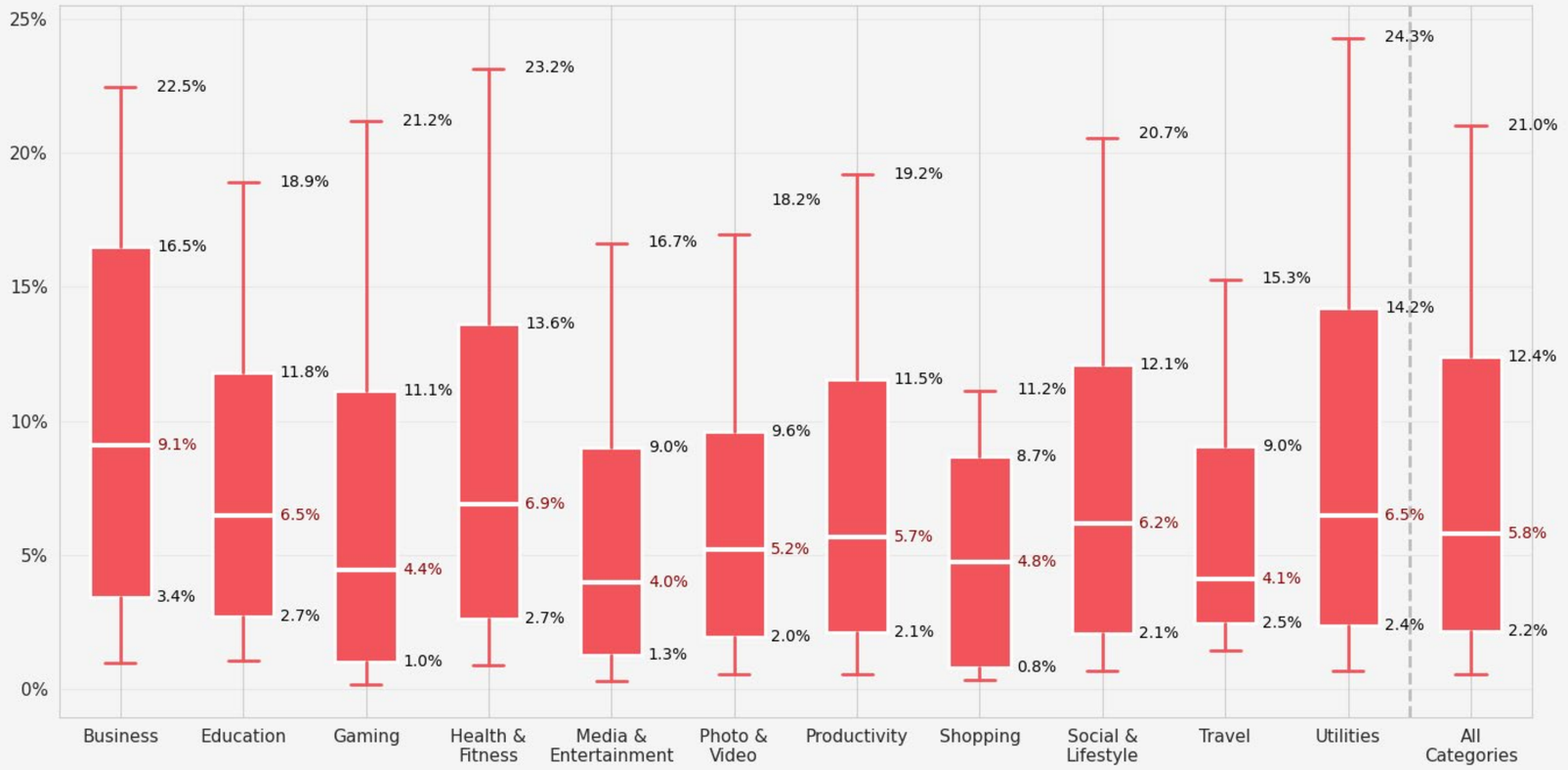
## What stands out

- Speed-to-revenue is category-dependent: Gaming reaches $1K MRR in 32 days (median), while Business takes 113 days. Only 4.6% of apps reach $10K MRR within two years, and just 1.7% reach $25K.
- Pricing power compounds: High-priced apps generate $34.82 monthly realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer, versus $10.69 for low-priced apps, showing a 3.3x spread. At Y1, that gap widens to $62.19 vs. $10.69.
- Retention and category model matter more than early ARPU: Health & Fitness leads D14 RPI at $0.48 and D60 at $0.66, nearly 5x Gaming at D60 ($0.14).
- Geography shapes ceiling outcomes: North America reaches $0.55 median RPI by D60, vs. $0.11 in IN/SEA — a 5x gap. Regional spreads narrow at annual LTV but remain material.
- Revenue mix is highly concentrated: Monthly plans dominate in categories like Productivity (77%), while Health & Fitness captures 68% from annual plans. Web revenue accounts for 3.2% globally, but 4.9% in North America and just 0.8% in IN/SEA.

# 03
# Funnel performance

# Download-to-trial, by category

How does D30 download-to-trial conversion vary by app category?




## Key takeaway

Business leads trial conversion at 9.1% median, more than 2× Gaming's 4.4%.

## Benchmarks to know:

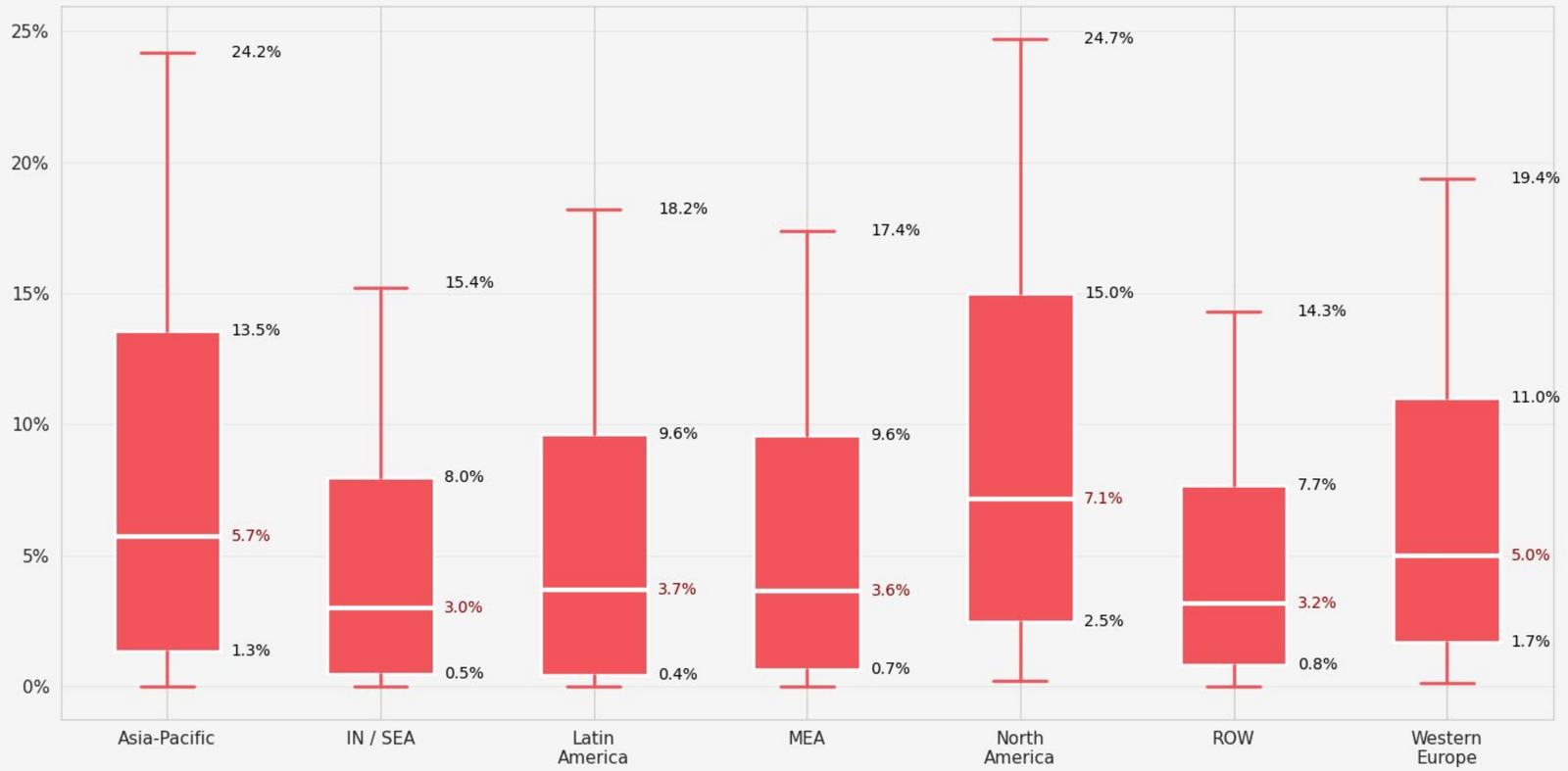
- Business median: 9.1%, top quartile above 16.2%
- Other high performers include: Health & Fitness (6.9%), Education (6.5%), and Utilities (6.5%)
- Media & Entertainment (4.0%) and Travel (4.1%) show lower median conversion than Gaming (4.4%)

## What stands out:

- Most non-Gaming categories convert between 5-6% from download-to-trial
- 2× gap between top and bottom categories
- Health & Fitness top performers convert over 23%

# Download-to-trial, by geography

How does D30 download-to-trial conversion vary by geography?




### Key takeaway

Download-to-trial rates differ 2× or more across geographies, with North America and Asia-Pacific leading.

### Benchmarks to know:

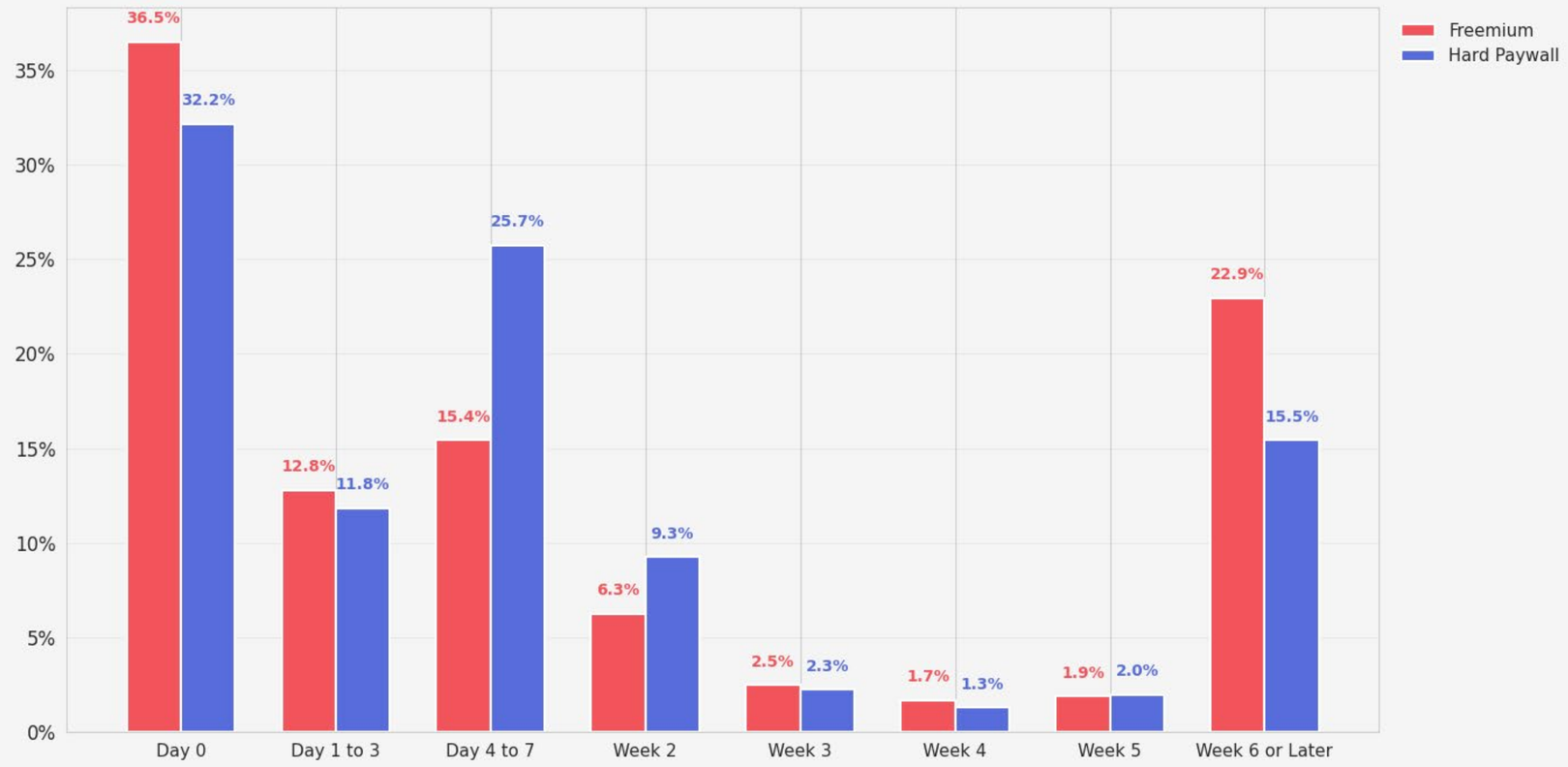
- North America median: 7.1% (top quartile above 15.0%)
- Asia-Pacific median: 5.7% (top quartile above 13.5%)
- Western Europe median: 5.0%
- All other geographies (IN/SEA, LATAM, MEA, and ROW) median between 3.0-3.7%.

### What stands out:

- North America's median is ~2x most of the rest of the world
- Bottom quartile apps in North America perform similarly to the median in many other geographies
- Top performers still manage above 14% in every geography
- Gap widens at higher percentiles: North America's top 10% reaches nearly 25% — 10% higher than ROW.

# Time-to-paid, freemium vs. hard paywall

How does time-to-paid differ by access method?




### Key takeaway

More than 60% of conversions happen by Day 7 for both models, but hard paywalls show a pronounced Day 4-7 spike (25.7%) while freemium apps have a longer tail (beyond 6 weeks)

### Benchmarks to know:

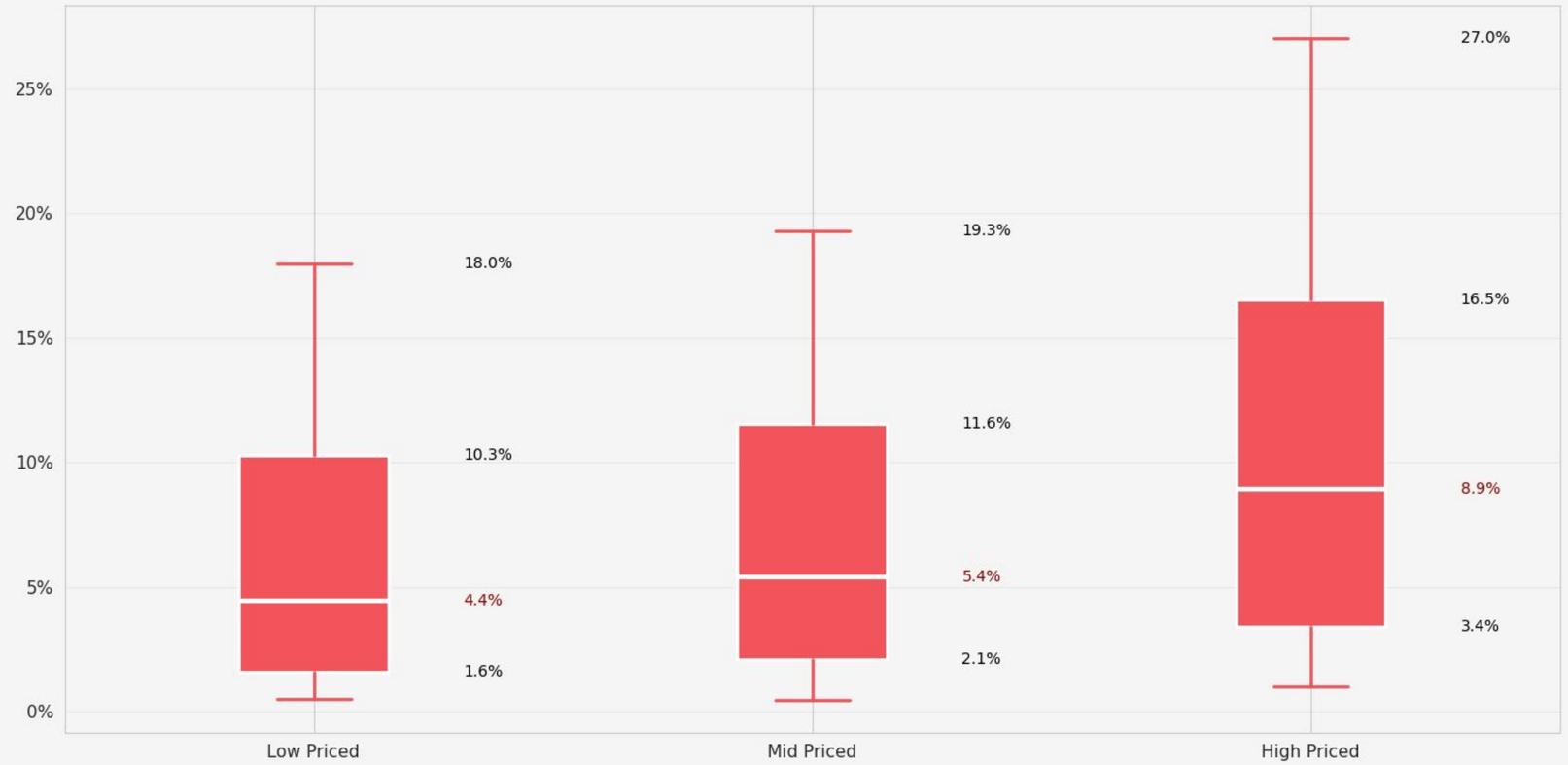
- 1/3 of all conversions happen on day zero for both methods
- 60%+ of conversions happen within 1 week
- For freemium apps, 23% of conversions do not occur until 6+ weeks after download.

### What stands out:

- Hard paywall Day 4-7 spike (25.7%) is driven by 7-day trial expirations
- Freemium has 1.5× higher late-stage conversions (Week 6+)
- Middle weeks (2-5) are quiet for both models (~1-2% each)
- Implication: Set conversion windows differently by access method — hard paywalls concentrate early, freemium spreads long.

# Download-to-trial, by pricepoint

How does download-to-trial conversion vary by pricepoint?




## Key takeaway

Higher-priced apps convert downloads to trials at nearly 2× the rate of low-priced, though with wider variability.

## Benchmarks to know:

- High-priced median: 8.9% (top quartile above 16.5%)
- Mid-priced median: 5.4% (top quartile above 11.6%)
- Low-priced median: 4.4% (top quartile above 10.3%).

## What stands out:

- Top 10% of high-priced apps reach 27.0% conversion
- Price tiers follow a consistent ~1.5–2× step pattern at each percentile
- Upper quartile rates are ~2x the median at every pricepoint

# Pricing strategy is playing into user psychology

**Daphne Tideman**
Growth Advisor & Consultant

**What stood out to me is that the shifts this year are not random, though they may seem that way at first glance.**

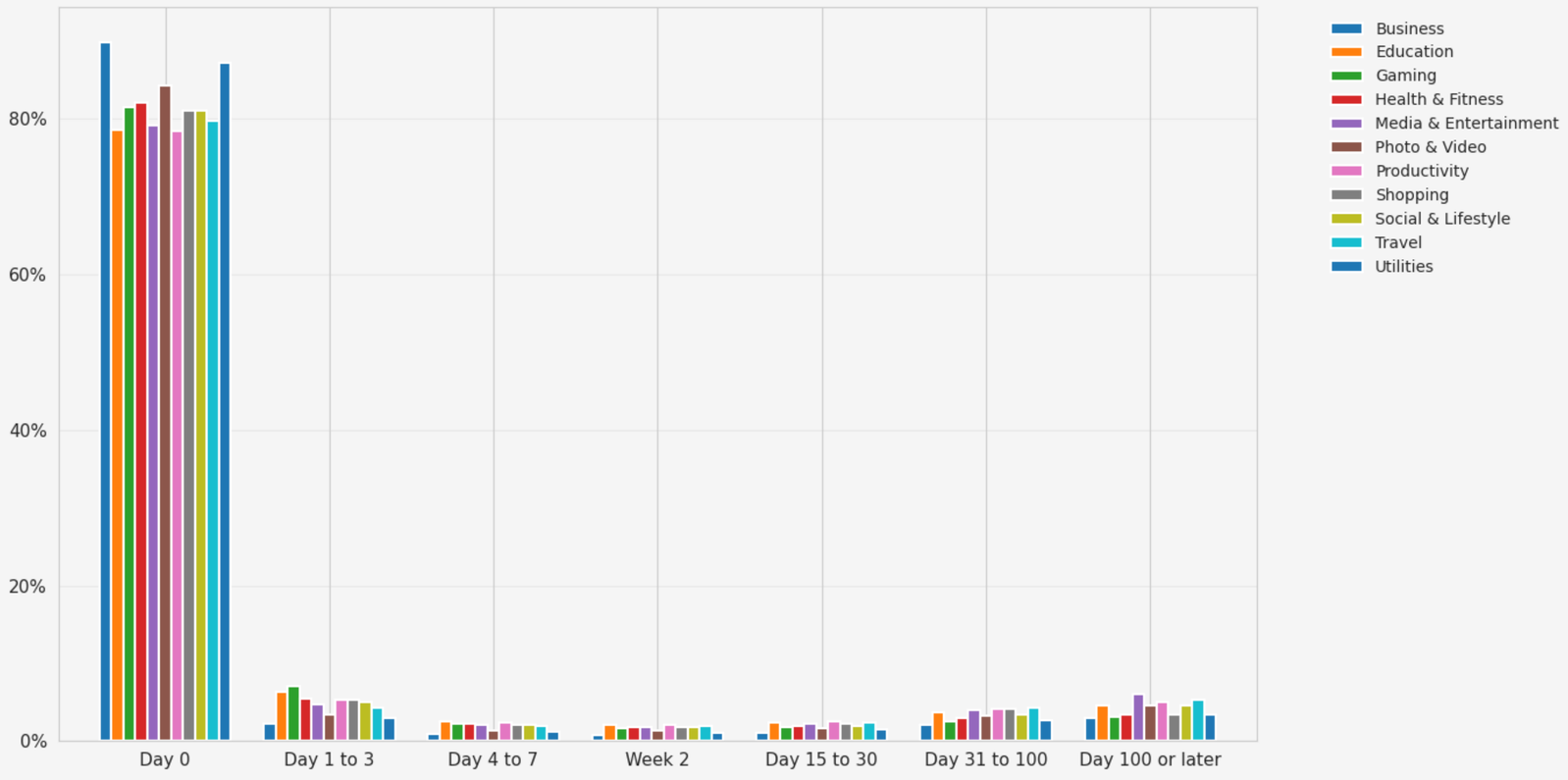
Annual subscriptions seem to have lost popularity (last year, 41.4% of all subscription durations; this year, only 33.6%), yet prices have stayed stable. Instead, monthly plans have risen, and in certain categories where they make sense, as have weekly plans. It feels like this could be users having commitment issues in the current economic climate and the rise in competition from AI.

One might expect trials to increase, yet they did not. Instead, trials shortened on average. Apps appear to be lowering entry friction by offering shorter plans while reducing the likelihood that users will passively sit through long trials.

I believe the apps that will win won't follow trends; they'll focus on the friction that holds their users back and build around that. Plan duration, trial offers, and pricing need to align with their time-to-value and confidence in your app.Rather than pushing aggressive pricing or trial changes, I feel the stronger strategy is to improve activation and trial experience, while balancing conversion and lifetime value across the plan durations offered.

# Time to trial, by category

How quickly do users in each app category start trials after downloading an app?




## Key takeaway

Nearly all trial starts happen on Day 0 across categories — users who don't try immediately rarely try at all.

## Benchmarks to know:

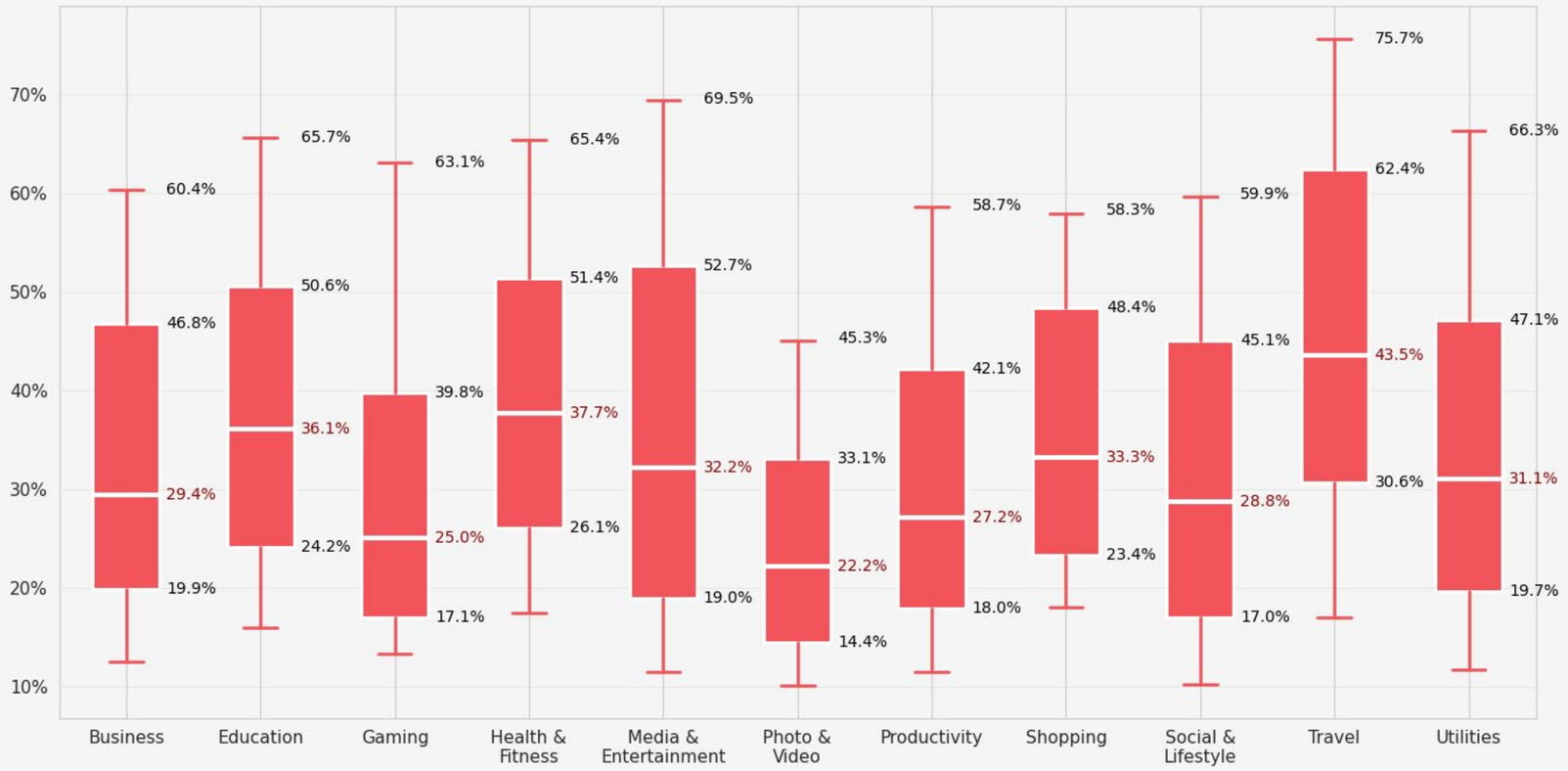
- Business: 89.9% on Day 0 (highest)
- Health & Fitness: 82.1% on Day 0
- Gaming: 81.5% on Day 0
- Productivity: 78% on Day 0 (lowest)

## What stands out:

- Business apps lead with nearly 90% same-day trial starts
- Productivity (ironically) shows the highest 'delayed trial' rate at 22%
- Day 1–3 captures most remaining starts: 5–12% across categories
- After Day 3, trial starts drop below 5% in all categories.

# Trial-to-paid, by category

How does trial-to-paid conversion vary by app category?




## Key takeaway

Travel and Health & Fitness lead with the highest median trial-to-paid conversion rates; Photo & Video and Gaming lag significantly.

## Benchmarks to know:

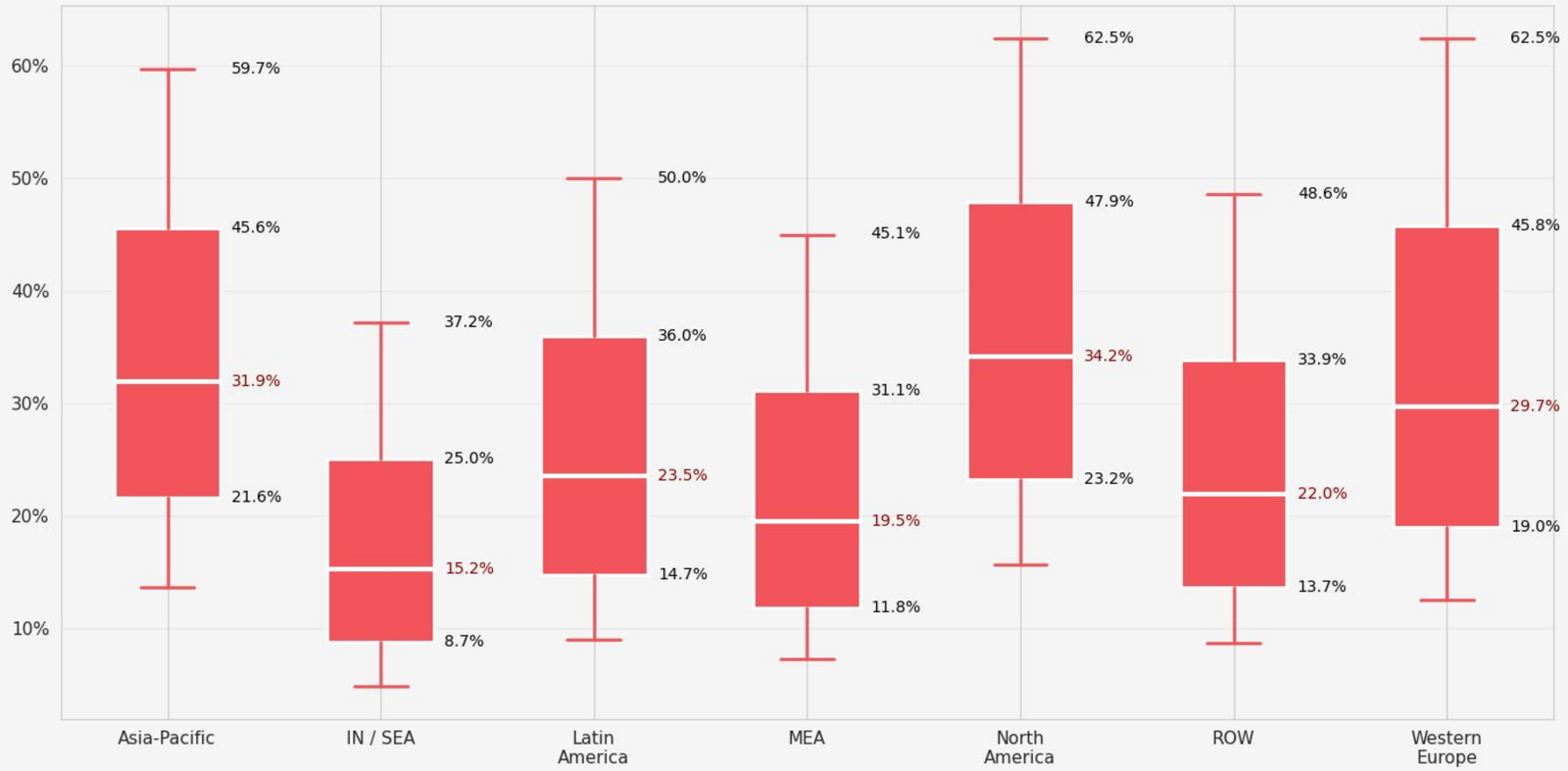
- Travel median: 43.5% (top quartile above 62.4%)
- Health & Fitness median: 37.7% (top quartile above 51.4%)
- Photo & Video median: 22.2% (lowest; top quartile above 33.1%)
- Gaming median: 25.0% (top quartile above 39.8%)

## What stands out:

- Travel, Shopping, and Health & Fitness apps boast the highest floors, with high conversion across all percentiles
- Media & Entertainment has widest spread: 11.5% to 69.5%
- Categories with wide variance (Gaming, Media & Entertainment, Utilities) suggest highly variable monetization

# Trial-to-paid, by geography

How does trial-to-paid conversion vary by geography?




### Key takeaway

North America, Asia-Pacific, and Western Europe lead; IN/SEA trails at less than half their rate.

### Benchmarks to know:

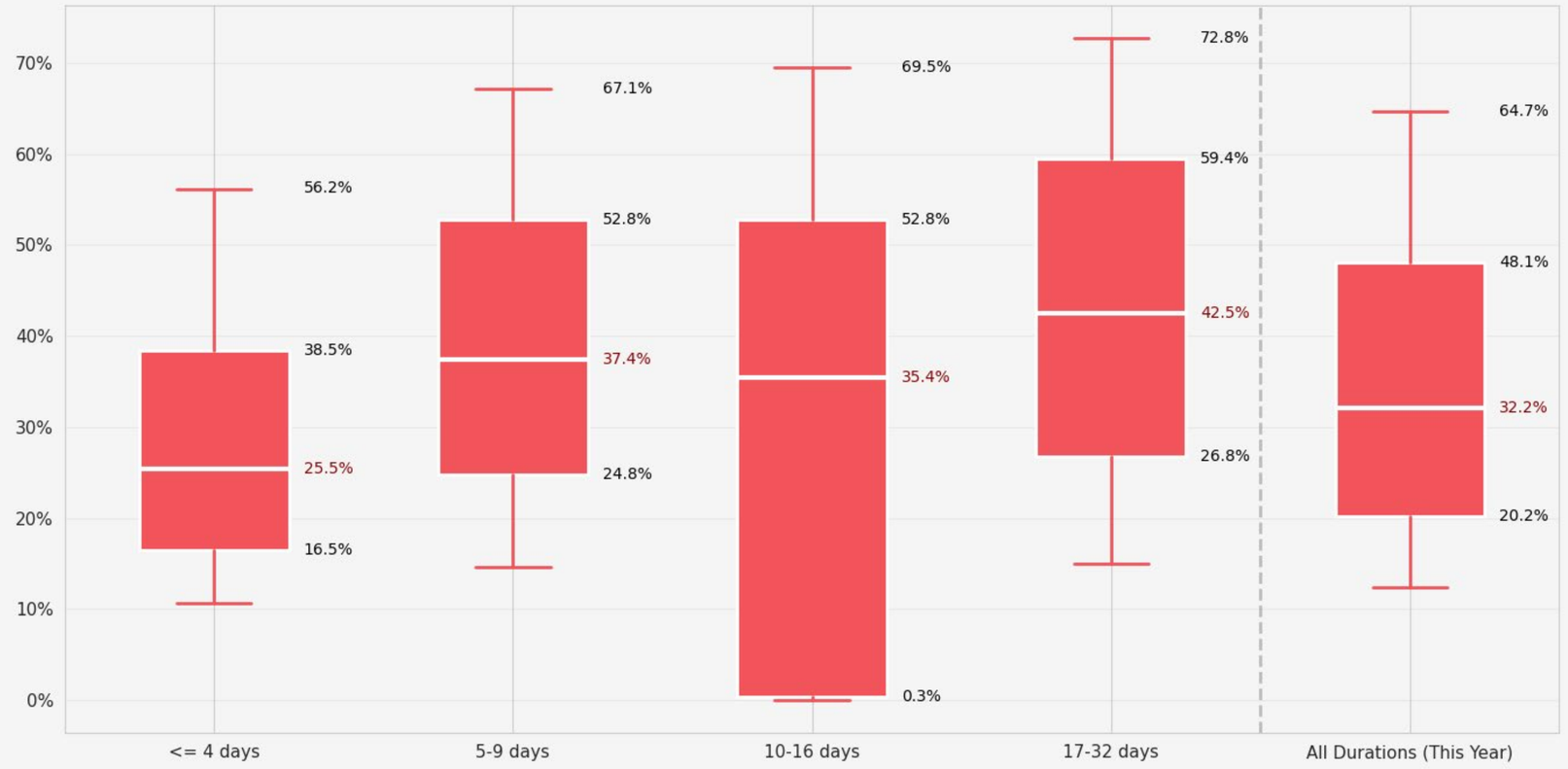
- North America median: 34.2% (top quartile above 47.9%)
- Asia-Pacific median: 31.9% (top quartile above 45.6%)
- IN/SEA median: 15.2% (lowest; top quartile above 25.0%)
- Western Europe median: 29.7%

### What stands out:

- IN/SEA's top quartile (25.0%) barely exceeds other geographies' medians
- North America's floor (15.6%) matches IN/SEA's median exactly
- Top 10% reach 60%+ in North America, Asia-Pacific, and Western Europe
- Latin America, MEA, and ROW cluster together at ~20–23% median

# Trial-to-paid, by trial duration

Does trial length affect trial-to-paid conversion rate?




## Key takeaway

Longer trials convert better: 17–32 day trials outperform short trials by ~17pp at median.

## Benchmarks to know:

- 17–32 day trials median: 42.5% (top quartile above 59.4%)
- 5–9 day trials median: 37.4% (top quartile above 52.8%)
- ≤4 day trials median: 25.5% (top quartile above 38.5%)

## What stands out:

- Longer trials show 1.7× better conversion than shortest trials
- The 10–16 day range has unusual spread: very low floor but strong upper quartiles
- 5–9 days appears to be a ‘sweet spot’ balancing length and conversion

# What if your paywall knew your user's name?

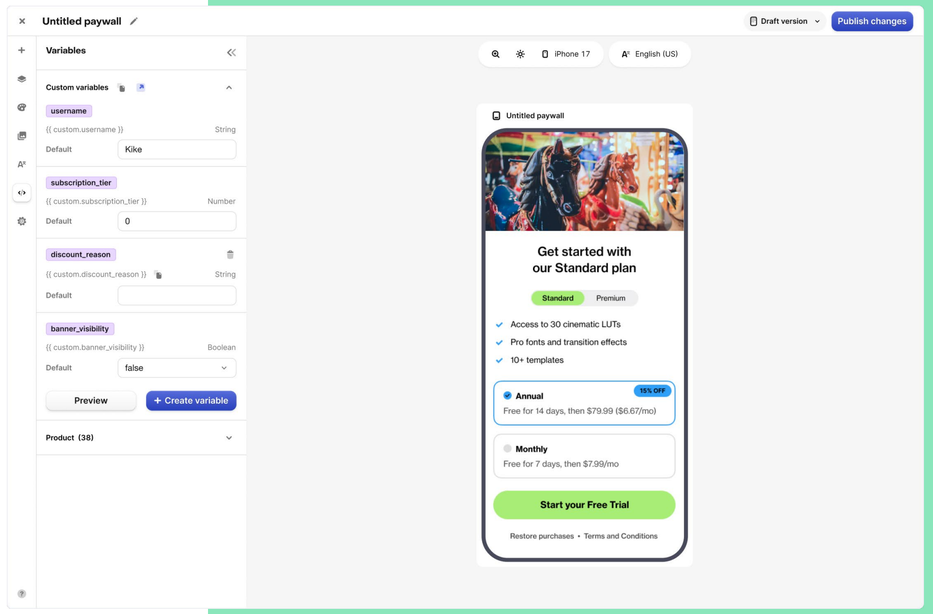
**So longer trials convert 1.7x better than shorter trials. But a longer trial also means you have more time to convince a user to subscribe. What if your paywall could help?**

You can now inject customer attributes, like first name or current plan, directly into your paywall text. It's a simple way to make your paywall more personal and remind users of the value they're getting during their trial.

Imagine showing something like: "{first_name} don't miss this exclusive offer!" or "Upgrade from {tier_title} to get access to {feature_name}".

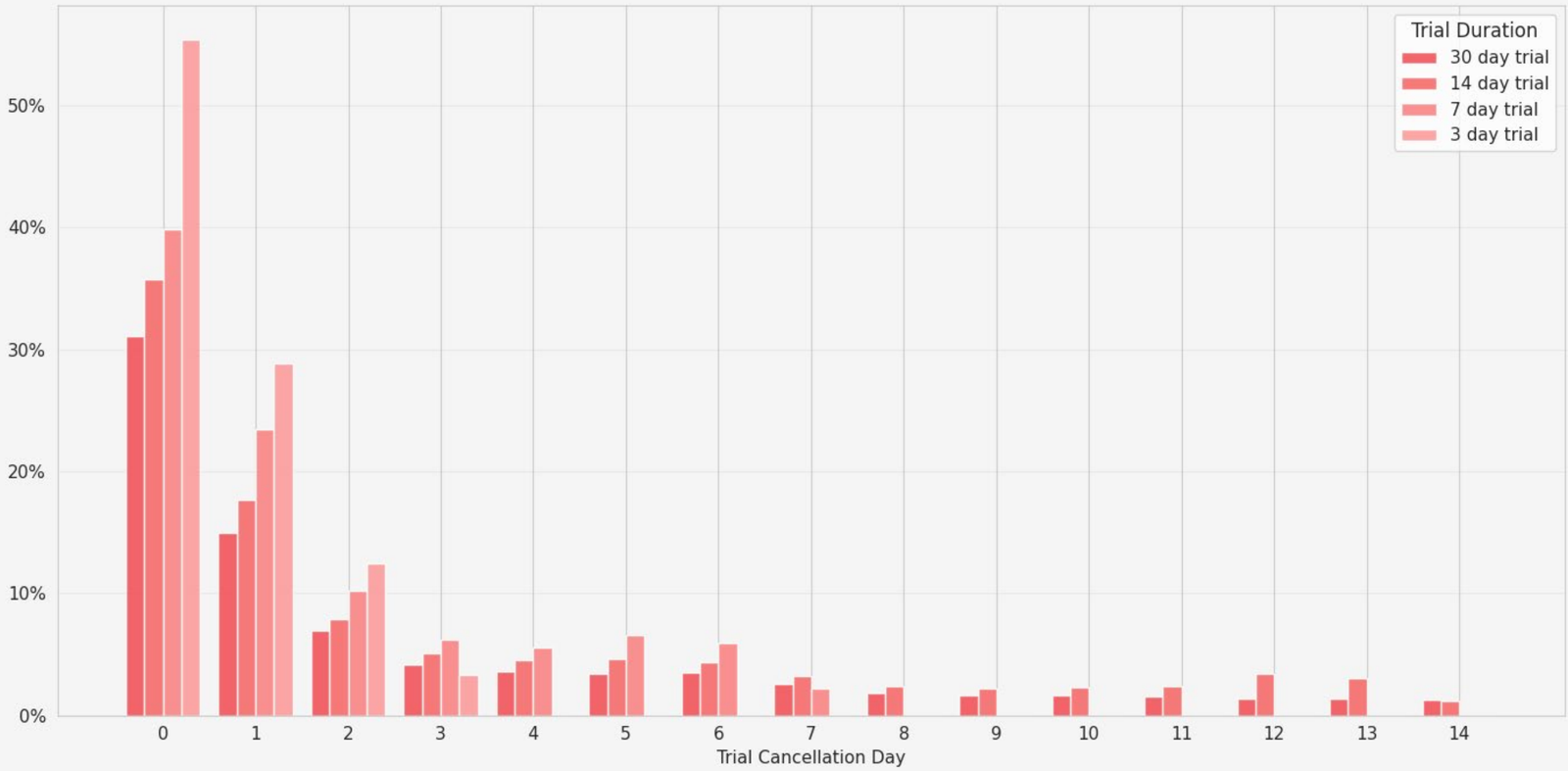
The more personal and relevant your paywall is, the better it will convert. Try out paywall personalization today.

**Try paywall personalization**



# % of trial cancellations, by day and trial duration

When do users cancel trials, and how does this vary by trial duration?




## Key takeaway

Most users cancel trials immediately: Day 0 dominates cancellations across all trial lengths. Shorter trials see especially front-loaded churn.

## Benchmarks to know:

- 3-day trials: 55.4% cancel on Day 0
- 7-day trials: 39.8% cancel on Day 0
- 14-day trials: 35.7% cancel on Day 0
- 30-day trials: 31.1% cancel on Day 0

## What stands out:

- Over half of 3-day trial cancellations happen within hours of starting
- 84% of 3-day trial cancellations and 64% of 7-day trial cancellations occur between Day 0 and Day 1
- 7-day trials show elevated cancellations between Days 3 through 6

# Stop Celebrating Conversion Wins Before Checking Renewals

**Sara Grana**
Yousician

1 **Map your revenue history before running new experiments**

Chart revenue across new subscribers, upgrades, renewals, and win-backs over time. Matching spikes and dips to past decisions reveals what actually moved the business and prevents you from re-learning expensive lessons.

Refunds and chargebacks are silent killers

2 **A paywall 'win' can quickly become a net negative**

If you aren't tracking the downstream effects of cancellations, refunds, and chargebacks, which often hide the true cost of a seemingly successful experiment.

3 **If your A/B test wins aren't showing up in top-line growth, something is wrong**

Stacking 5% and 10% experiment wins should compound, but many teams see modest growth despite a long list of 'winners'. Set calendar reminders to recheck winning cohorts at 3 and 6 months, especially for price changes, to catch lifts that don't hold.

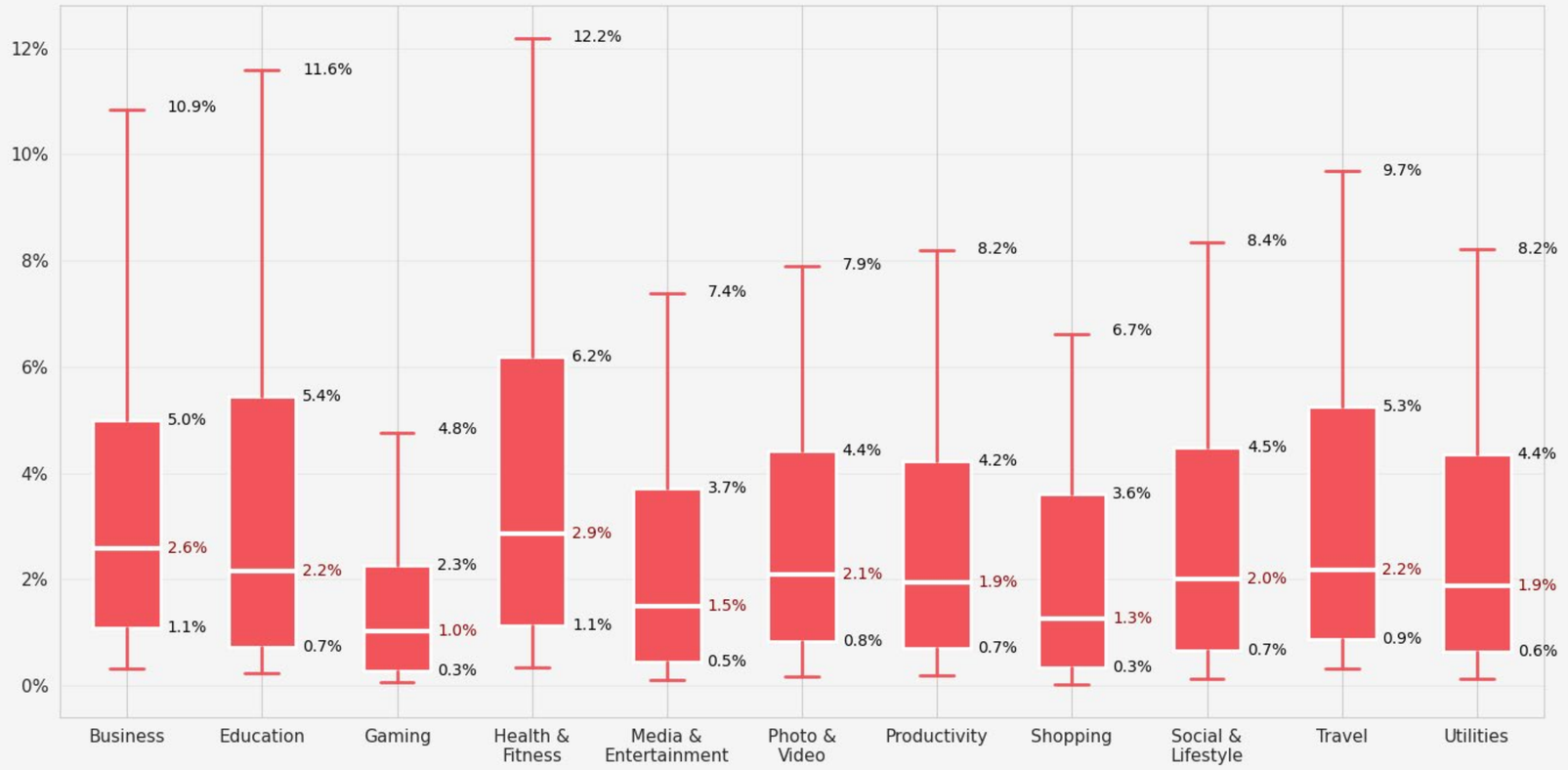
Listen to Sara's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

Sub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

# Day 35 download-to-paid, by category

Which categories best convert downloads into paid users?




## Key takeaway

Health & Fitness leads download-to-paid conversion; Gaming trails at roughly one-third the median rate.

## Benchmarks to know:

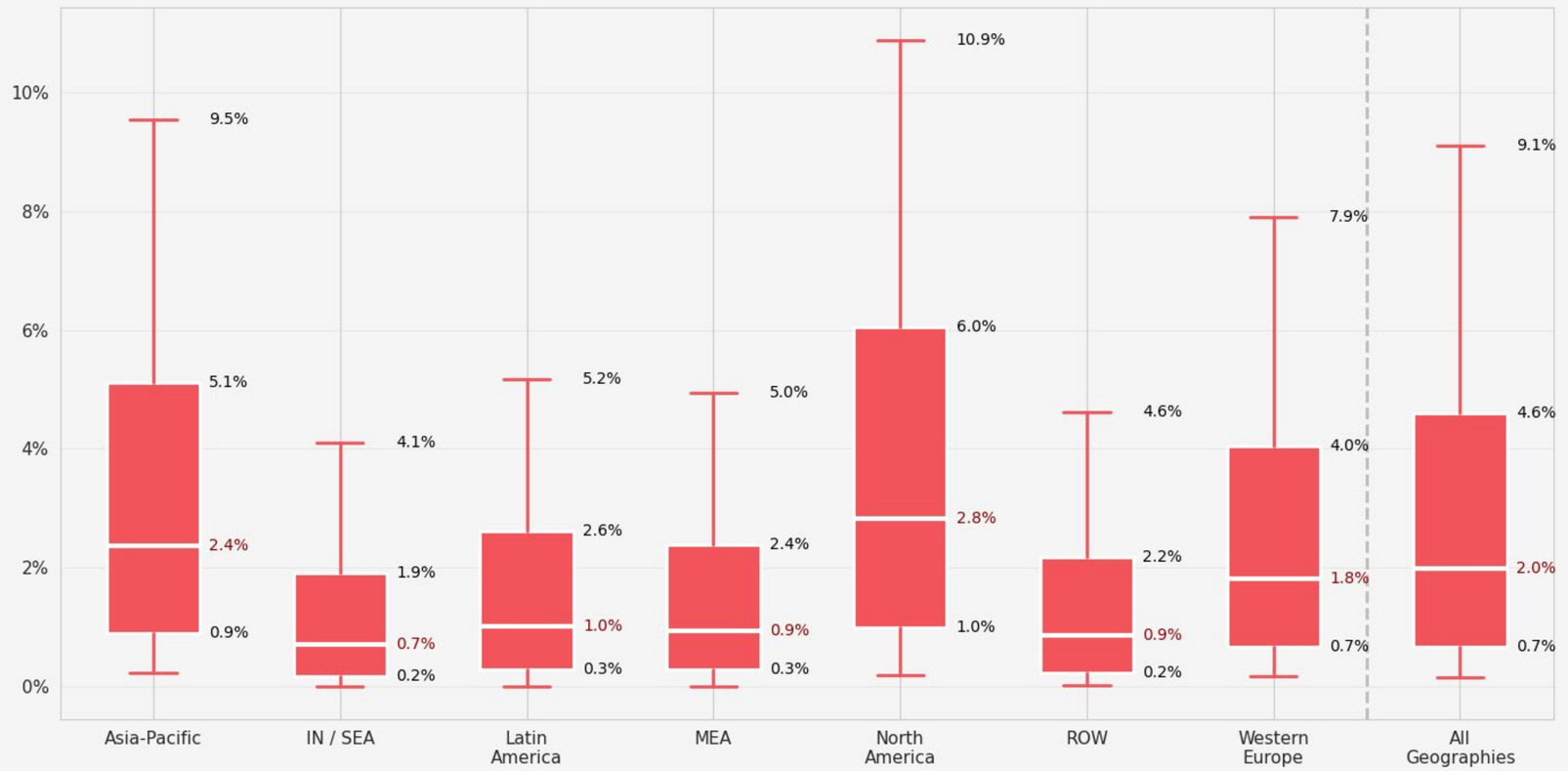
- Health & Fitness median: 2.9% (top quartile above 6.2%)
- Business median: 2.6% (top quartile above 5.0%)
- Gaming median: 1.0% (lowest; top quartile above 2.3%)
- Shopping median: 1.3%

## What stands out:

- The floor for most categories is fairly consistent (0 - 0.3%), but ceilings diverge sharply
- Gaming's top quartile (2.3%) barely exceeds many categories' medians
- Top performing categories (Health & Fitness, Education, Business) also show the largest spread between Upper Quartile and Top 10%

# Day 35 download-to-paid, by geography

How does download-to-paid conversion vary by geography?




## Key takeaway

North America converts downloads at 4× the rate of IN/SEA; Asia-Pacific follows closely behind.

## Benchmarks to know:

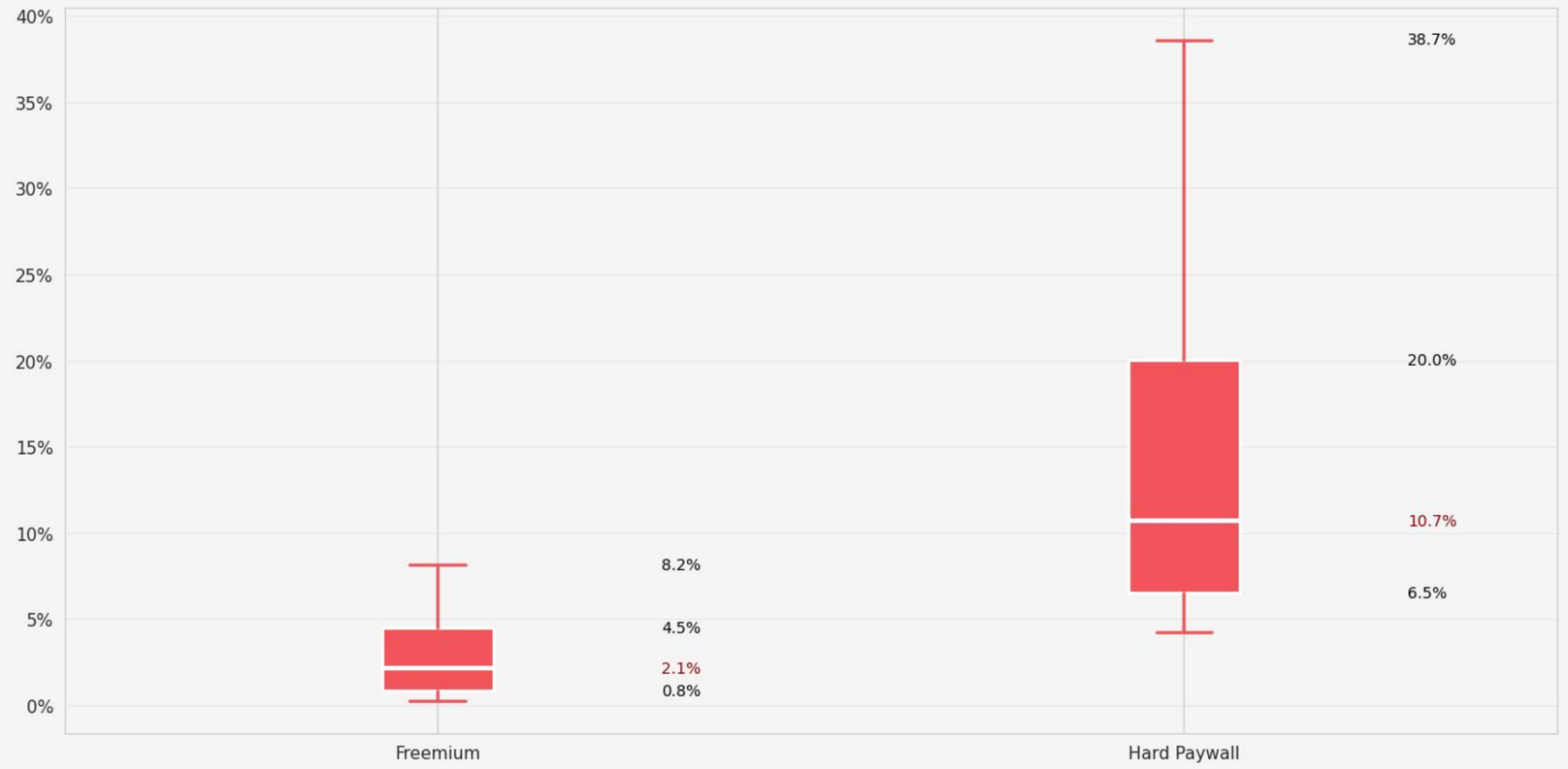
- North America median: 2.8% (top quartile above 6.0%)
- Asia-Pacific median: 2.4% (top quartile above 5.1%)
- IN/SEA median: 0.7% (lowest; top quartile above 1.9%)
- Globally, median lands at 2.0%

## What stands out:

- IN/SEA's top quartile (1.9%) falls short of most geographies' medians
- North America's top quartile beats most other geographies' medians
- Top 10% reach double-digit conversion only in North America (10.9%)

# Day 35 download-to-paid, freemium vs. hard paywall

Does access method impact download-to-paid conversion within 35 days?




## Key takeaway

Hard paywalls convert 5× better than freemium, but with significantly wider variance.

## Benchmarks to know:

- Hard paywall median: 10.7% (top quartile above 20.0%)
- Freemium median: 2.1% (top quartile above 4.5%)

## What stands out:

- Hard paywall's floor (4.2%) is 2× the freemium median
- Top 10% of hard paywall apps reach 38.7% conversion
- Freemium shows much tighter distribution: 0.3%–8.2% vs.hard paywall's 4.2%–38.7%
- Hard paywall's wide spread suggests execution matters more than model alone

# Maximize conversions with premium positioning and hard paywalls

**Hannah Parvaz**
Founder, Aperture

## Hard paywalls convert 5x better than freemium.

Median D35 conversion sits at 10.7% for hard paywalls. Freemium is 2.1%.

That gap alone should make you pause.

But the more revealing part is the distribution. Hard paywall top decile apps approach 40% conversion. That's insane. Even the lower end performs at roughly double the freemium median.

Behaviour isn't changing - it remains heavily front-loaded (it's the same story every year, and people still don't believe it).

Around 50% of paid conversions happen on Day 0. Trial starts overwhelmingly happen on Day 0. Cancellations cluster there too, especially on short trials, where over half occur within hours.

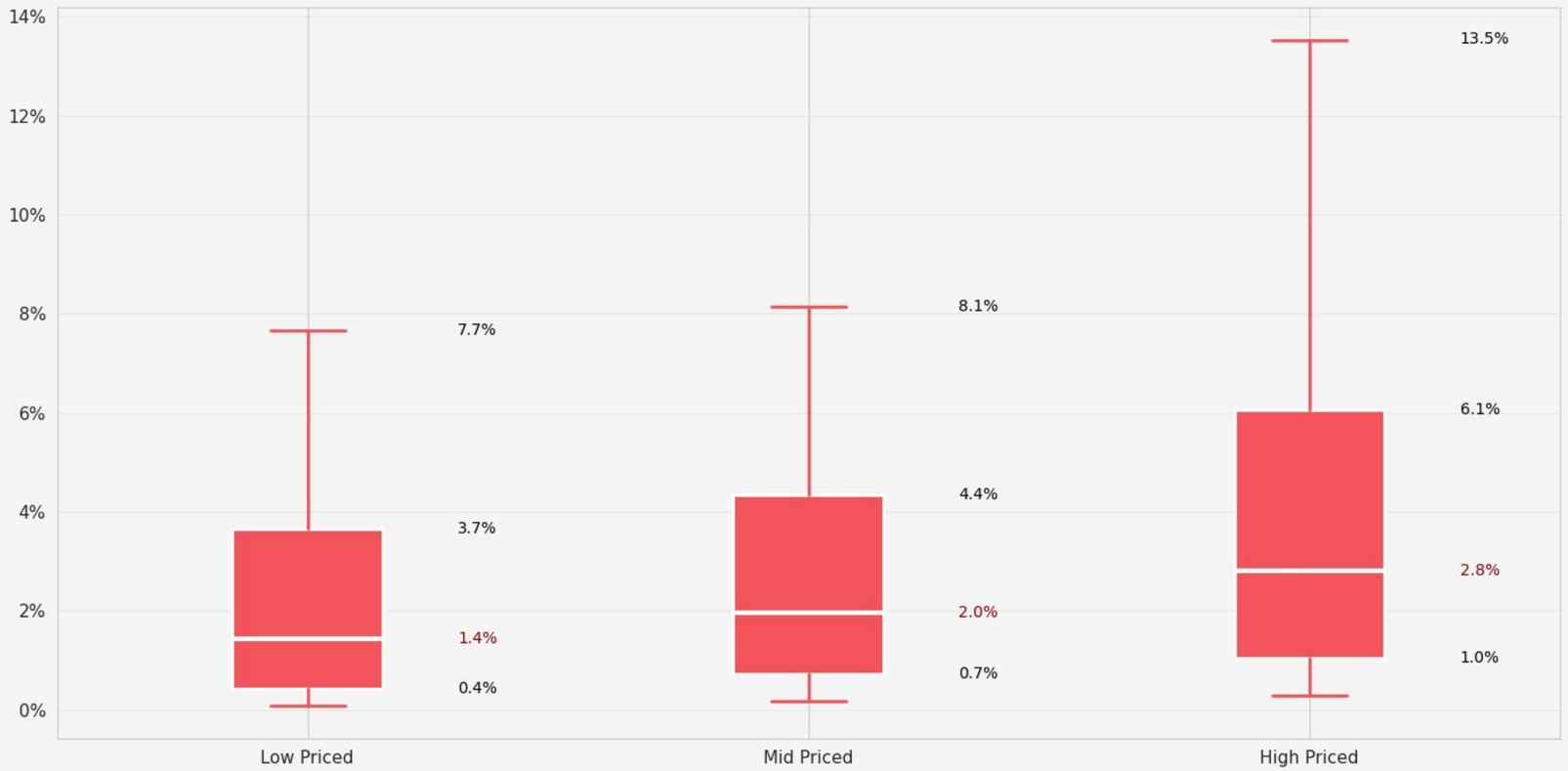
**Onboarding is faaaar more important than most teams treat it.** The first few minutes need to build trust, interrupt default behaviour, and show value quickly. If a paywall appears before context is established, it feels jarring. When onboarding builds momentum first, conversion looks very different.

Across trial lengths, access models, categories, and regions, the pattern holds: structural choices set the ceiling early.

**If you want to make money in 2026, start with Day 0.**

# Day 35 download-to-paid, by pricepoint

How does pricing affect download-to-paid rates?




### Key takeaway

Median high-priced apps convert downloads 2× better than low-priced apps.

### Benchmarks to know:

- High-priced median: 2.8% (top quartile above 6.1%)
- Mid-priced median: 2.0% (top quartile above 4.4%)
- Low-priced median: 1.4% (top quartile above 3.7%)

### What stands out:

- Price tiers show consistent ~1.4× step-up at each percentile
- High-priced apps show widest spread: top 10% reach 13.5%
- Low-priced floor (0.1%) vs. high-priced floor (0.3%) shows similar minimums
- Top performers at all pricepoints reach 4-5x the median

# Your entry price will heavily determine your success in paid campaigns

**David Vargas**
App Growth Consultant

When you run direct subscriptions without trials, having an attractive entry price has a massive impact on paid UA performance and how fast you can scale your growth loops. While category largely determines the download-to-paid conversion rate (with top performers reaching 10%+ CVR), offering introductory prices can increase your chances of reaching that top-performer tier, allowing you to grow a few 'Xs' faster than following the standard price of your niche.

### Hard paywalls work better with introductory prices

RevenueCat data shows a median of 10.7% for apps with hard paywalls versus 2.1% in freemium apps. This doesn't mean you can't have better direct conversion with paywalls that include free trial tiers, but you will see a much higher impact when there's no free option.

### Monitor very closely – you could be killing your payback period

Increasing conversion-to-paid is not everything. Every dollar you discount will negatively impact your payback period if paid campaigns don't cover that lifetime value (LTV) decrease with a significant uplift in conversion rate. The more you decrease the price, the better your creatives need to perform, so monitor closely to keep margins positive.

### Introductory prices can also work as premium trials

Intro pricing filters out users who just want a free sample, which makes free trial optimization a noisy signal for ad network machine learning. A low entry price removes that noise and gives algorithms cleaner signals about users likely to convert after the intro period, improving the delivery of your campaigns towards more valuable users.

StartApp School

# How to acquire users through paid marketing, by Natalia Drozd

**Natalia Drozd**
Marketing & Growth Lead

Join Natalia Drozd for a deep dive into paid marketing and user acquisition. This course reframes user acquisition through a behavioral and psychological lens, outlining the basics of user acquisition and exploring why modern UA channels matter in today's crowded App Store. Blending industry context and theory with modern paid UA execution principles, the course covers key user acquisition channels, tactics, creative production, and analytics.

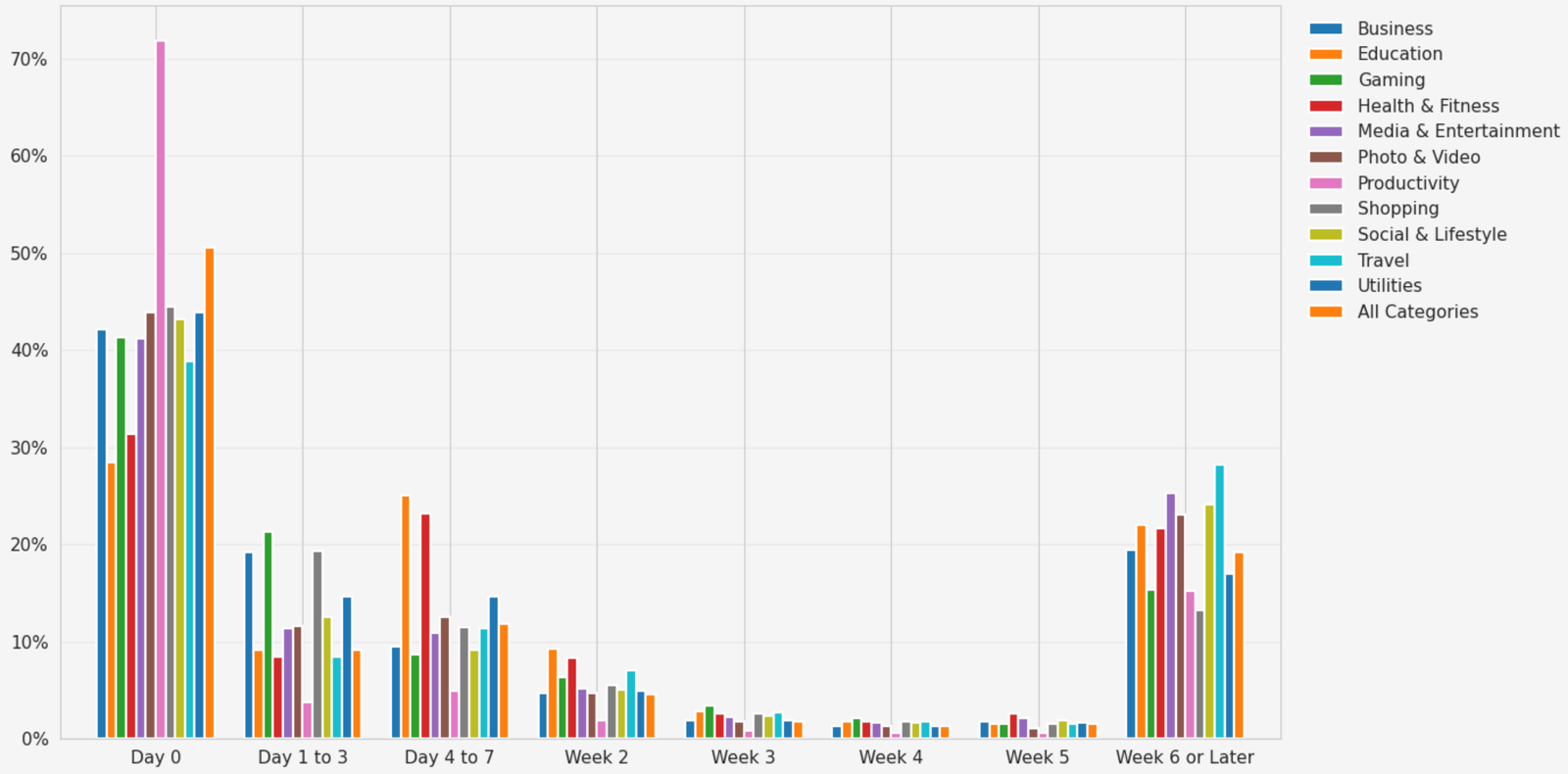
Explore Natalia's Course

**What you'll learn:**

- How marketing evolved and why attention is scarce
- The difference between brand and performance marketing
- How to hire and structure marketing roles
- How privacy and AI changed UA strategy
- How to position your app within the broader economy
- Why paid media is essential for scalable growth

# Time-to-paid, by category

How quickly do users convert from download-to-paid subscription, by category?




### Key takeaway

Half of all conversions happen on Day 0; Productivity leads significantly at nearly 72%, while Travel shows more delayed conversion.

### Benchmarks to know:

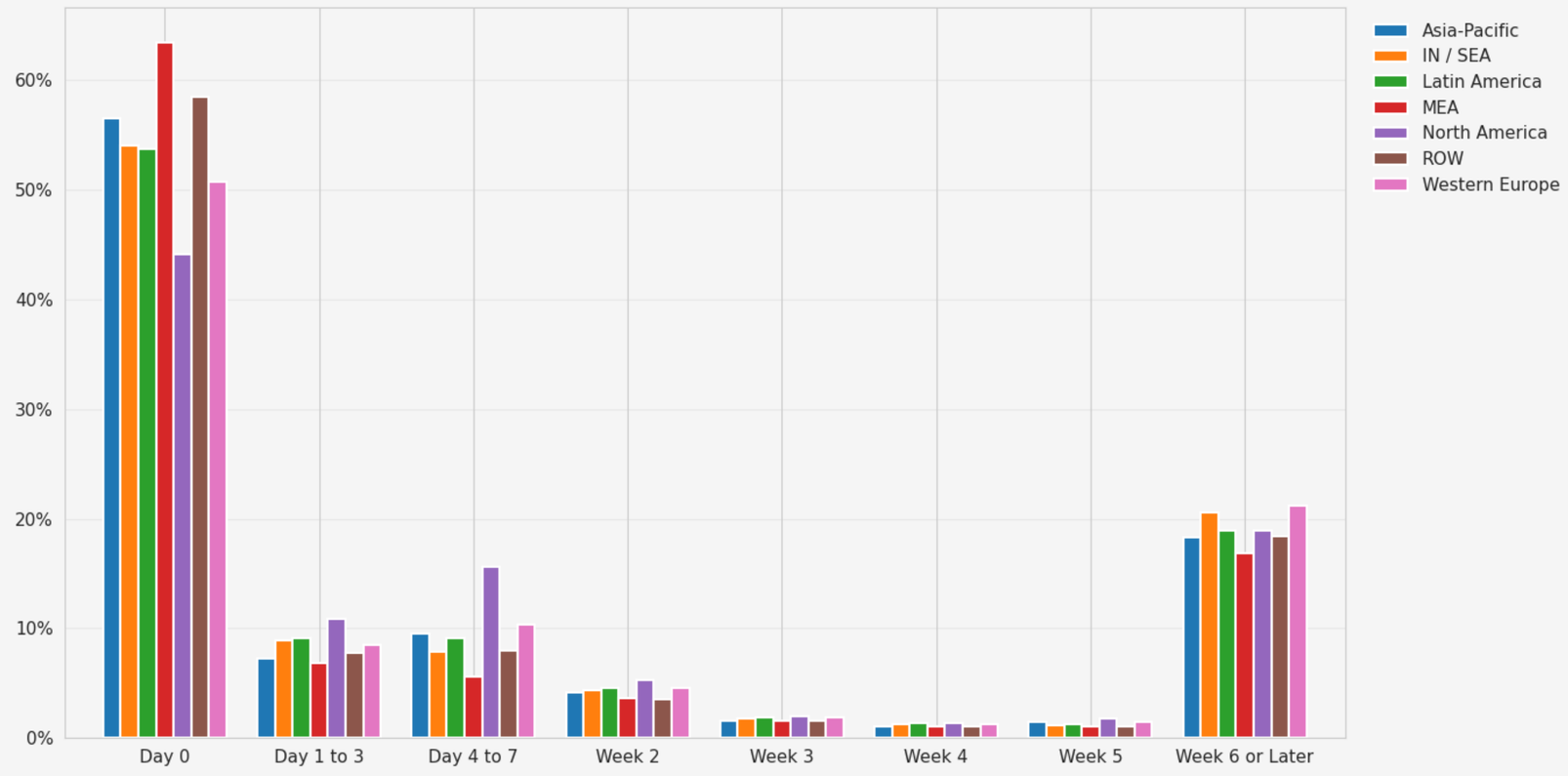
- Day 0 conversion: 50.6% overall, 71.9% for Productivity
- Week 6+ conversion: 19.2% overall, 28.2% for Travel
- Education: 28.5% on Day 0 (lowest immediate conversion)

### What stands out:

- Conversion timelines are impacted by trial lengths across categories: categories like Education and Health & Fitness, where 7-day trials are common, show increased conversion at the 7-day mark
- Travel has the longest tail: 28.2% convert after Week 6
- Media & Entertainment and Social & Lifestyle also show 24–25% late conversion
- Gaming shows moderate delay: 21.3% in Days 1–3 (second-highest)

# Time-to-paid, by geography

How quickly do users convert from download-to-paid, by geography?




### Key takeaway

MEA shows fastest conversion (63.5% on Day 0); North America has the slowest initial response.

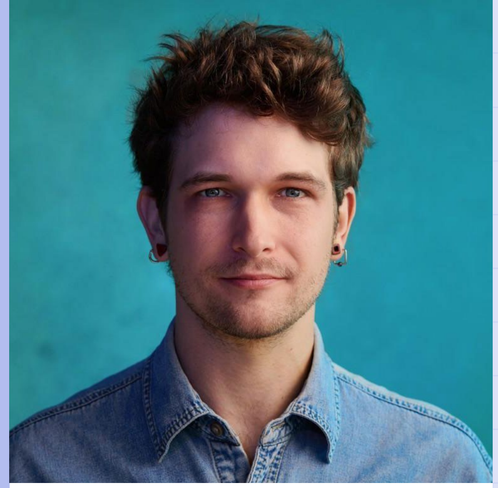
### Benchmarks to know:

- MEA: 63.5% convert on Day 0 (highest)
- North America: 44.2% convert on Day 0 (lowest)

### What stands out:

- North America's Day 0 rate trails MEA by nearly 20 percentage points
- Days 4–7 account for 15.6% in North America (highest late-week share); likely tied to 7-day trial expirations
- Western Europe shows longest conversion tail at 21.2% in Week 6+

# The measurement ceiling subscription apps don’t see



**Marcus Burke**
Meta Ads & App Growth Advisor

**Cost per trial is a useful starting point and a terrible finishing point. The moment you treat blended CPT as a reliable performance signal, you lose sight of the variables that actually move the needle.**

You’re averaging over geo, trial length, price point and audience. Variables that each shift trial-to-paid conversion meaningfully on their own. Geo alone moves the needle from a 19.5% median in MEA to 34.2% in North America, before you’ve accounted for lag conversions. Reported channel performance becomes a partial read at best. The CPT target you set won’t hold up the moment traffic composition or your upper funnel changes.

Disaggregate first. Understand how each dimension affects monetization independently. Then feed those insights back into your UA strategy. Use tools like Meta’s Value Rules or value-based bidding to give their algorithm real variance to bid against, instead of just maximizing the cheapest trials.

Every subscription app runs into a ceiling. For many it’s a measurement one.

# Funnel performance: key takeaways

Across subscription apps, performance is heavily front-loaded — but where and how that front-loading happens depends on geography, category, access model, pricepoint, and trial design. D0 dominates both trial starts and paid conversions. North America consistently leads on conversion-to-paid, while IN/SEA lags across most steps of the funnel. Higher pricepoints and longer trials correlate with stronger conversion, but also wider variance. Access model changes timing more than total volume, with hard paywalls concentrating conversion earlier, while freemium spreads it out.

Ultimately, if you benchmark against a single median without accounting for region, pricing tier, or trial length, you risk misdiagnosing performance. Funnel shape matters as much as top-line rate.

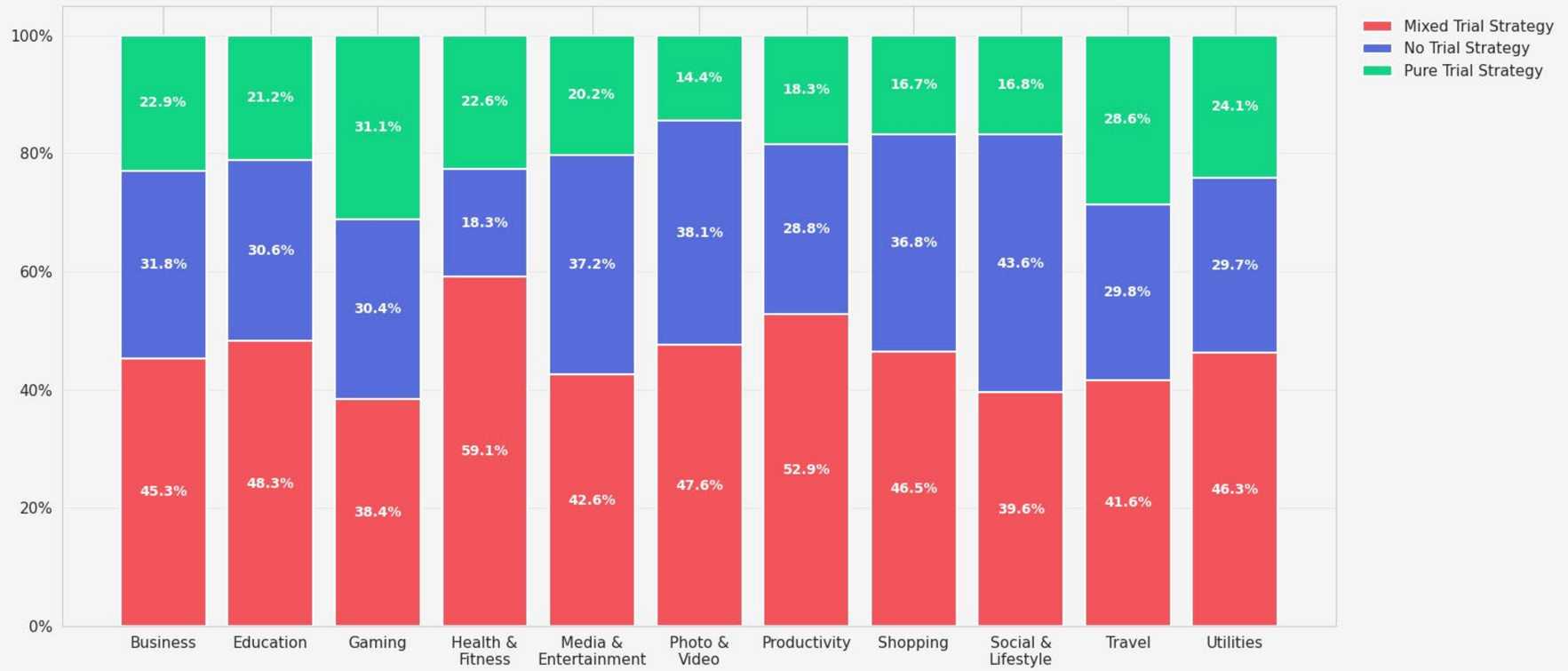
## What stands out

- North America sets the paid conversion ceiling: the median trial conversion varies over 2× by region. D35 download-to-paid median is 2.56% in North America vs. 1.37% in IN/SEA. North America's 90th percentile reaches 11.3%.
- Trial starts are immediate — or they rarely happen: in most categories, 80–89% of trials start on D0 (Business: 89.9%; Health & Fitness: 82.1%; Education lowest at 78.5%), suggesting delayed starts are a minority behavior.
- Longer trials outperform short ones: trial-to-paid median is 25.5% (≤4 days), 37.4% (5–9 days), and 42.5% (17–32 days). The 10–16 day bucket shows unusual dispersion (median 35.4%, floor near zero not fully legible).
- Hard paywalls convert ~5× higher than freemium at download-to-paid: median is 10.7% for hard paywalls converting vs. 2.1% for freemium. But the variance is wide, with the top 10% of hard paywalls reaching 38.7%.
- Price scales conversion — with clean step-ups by tier: download-to-paid medians: 1.4% (low), 2.0% (mid), 2.8% (high). Trial conversion medians are 4.4%, 5.4%, 8.9% respectively. Higher tiers also show wider spreads.
- Category performance spans nearly 3× at download-to-paid: Health & Fitness median: 2.9%. Gaming: 1.0%. Business leads trial conversion at 9.1% vs Gaming at 4.4%.
- Access model changes timing patterns: hard paywalls spike at D4–7 (25.7%), likely driven by seven-day expirations. Freemium sees stronger late conversion (week 6: 22.9% vs. 15.3% hard paywall).

# 04
# Pricing and packaging

# Trial strategy, by category

What trial strategy do different app categories favour?




## Key takeaway

Mixed strategies (trials + non-trial options) dominate; Health & Fitness leads at 59%, while Social relies more on no-trial.

## Benchmarks to know:

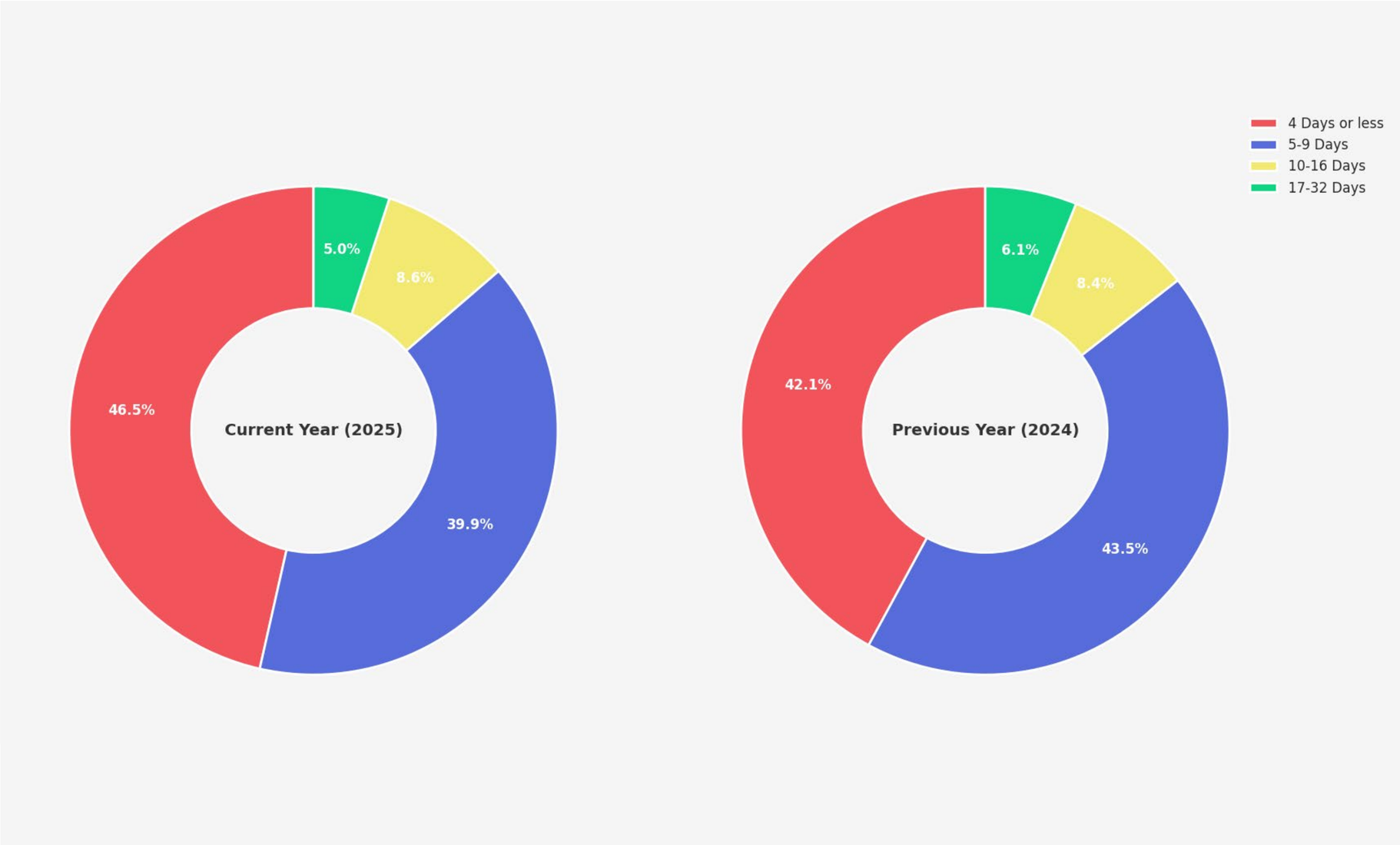
- Mixed strategy: 38–59% across categories (Health & Fitness highest)
- No trial strategy: 18–44% (Social & Lifestyle highest at 43.6%)
- Pure trial strategy: 14–31% (Gaming highest at 31.1%)

## What stands out:

- Health & Fitness has lowest no-trial share at 18.3%
- Social & Lifestyle is the only category where no-trial exceeds mixed trial strategy
- Gaming shows most balanced split between all three strategies

# Trial durations, year-on-year

Are trial periods getting shorter?




## Key takeaway

Short trials (≤4 days) gained share, rising from 42% to 46.5%; mid-length trials (5–9 days) declined.

## Benchmarks to know:

- Current year: 46.5% use ≤4 days, 39.9% use 5–9 days
- Previous year: 42.1% used ≤4 days, 43.5% used 5–9 days
- Longer trials (10+ days): relatively stable at ~14-15%

## What stands out:

- ≤4 day trials gained 4.4pp year-on-year
- 5–9 day trials lost 3.6 percentage points
- Longest trials (17–32 days) declined slightly from 6.1% to 5.0%
- The shift toward shorter trials continues despite data showing longer trials convert better

# The moment after the paywall is your best conversion lever

**Steve P. Young**
Founder and CEO, App Masters

The best way to activate freemium users isn't to shove a bigger discount in their face — it's to capitalize on the moment right after they close your paywall.

Instead of fighting the "no," use it.

The "reverse trial" strategy gives users temporary access to premium features after they dismiss the offer — no credit card required. Now they're not imagining value... they're experiencing it.

This is where loss aversion kicks in. Once premium becomes part of their workflow, removing it feels like taking something away. And psychologically, people fight harder to avoid a loss than to chase a gain.

But here's the key: engagement > exposure. If they don't actually use the premium features, nothing changes. The more they use them, the stronger the endowment effect becomes — it starts feeling like theirs.

At that point, conversion isn't about convincing. It's about preventing loss.

We've seen this increase freemium conversions from 0.4% to 4.5% — without changing traffic or pricing.

# How Adding Friction To Trial Reminders Boosted Conversions

**Anmol Tiwari**
Duolingo

1 **Prioritize clarity over persuasion on your paywalls**

Show users a timeline of exactly what happens during their trial, when they'll be charged, and how refunds work. Duolingo found that removing uncertainty about the purchase process drives more conversions than trying to sell harder.

2 **Shorter trials compound experimentation velocity**

Cutting their free trial from 14 days to 7 doubled Duolingo's experimentation velocity. Faster feedback loops let the team kill losing tests sooner and run significantly more experiments per quarter.

3 **Adding friction to trial reminders can boost conversions**

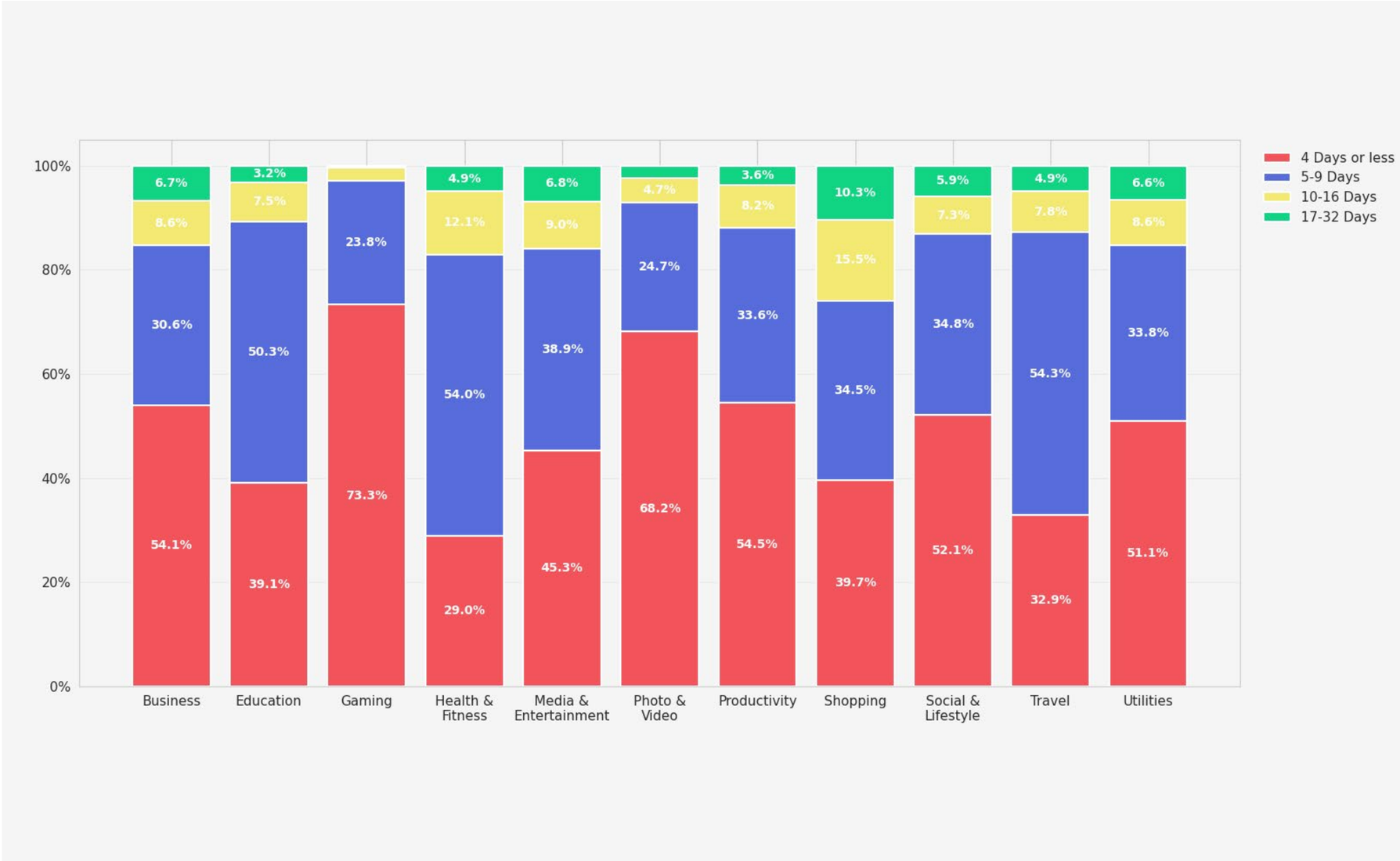
Duolingo tested letting users pick which day they get their expiration reminder. The extra step signaled transparency, built trust that they wouldn't be surprised by a charge, and gave them time to experience real value before deciding.

Listen to Anmol's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

Sub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

# Trial durations, by category




## Key takeaway

Gaming apps favor ultra-short trials (73% ≤4 days); Health & Fitness prefers mid-length (54% at 5–9 days); Photo & Video heavily skews short (68% ≤4 days).

## Benchmarks to know:

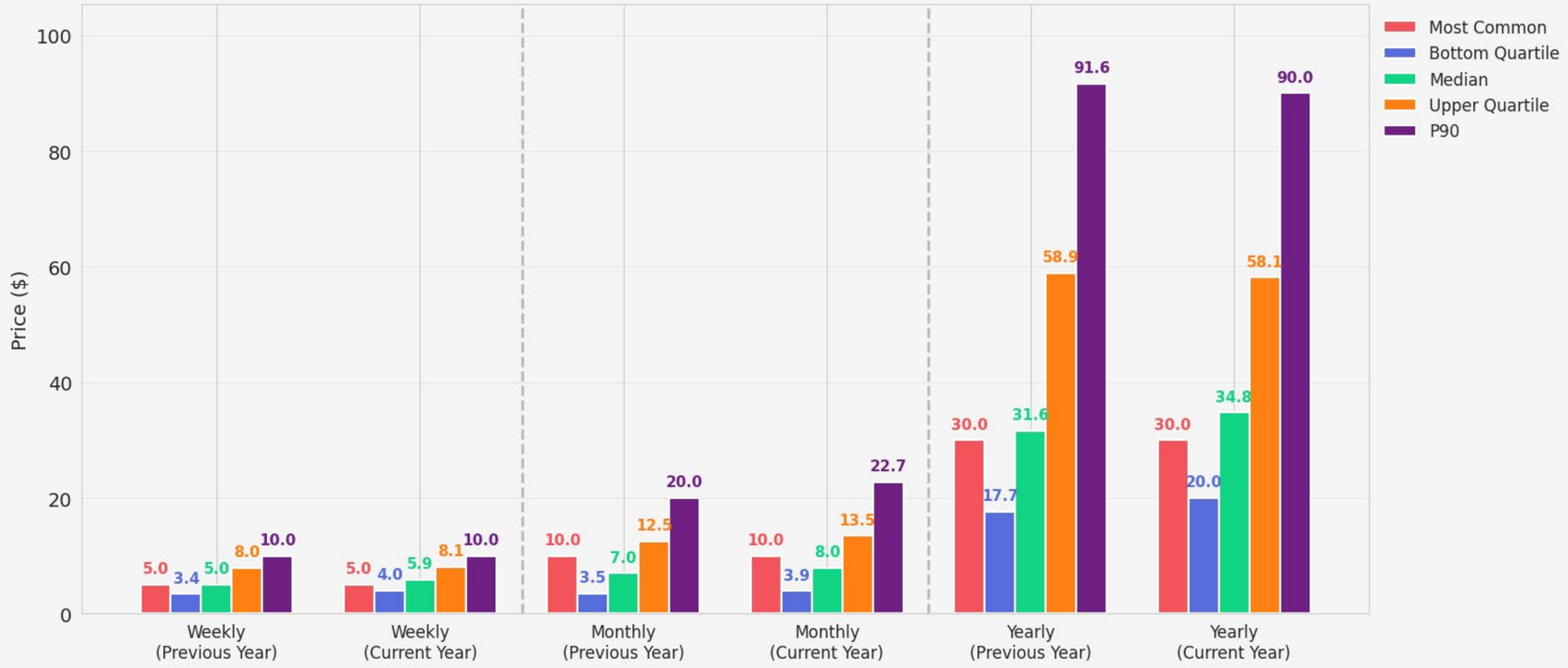
- Short trials (≤4 days): 29–73% across categories (Gaming highest, Health & Fitness lowest)
- Mid-length (5–9 days): 24–54% (Health & Fitness highest, Gaming lowest)
- Longer trials (10+ days): 3–26% range (Shopping highest at ~26% combined)

## What stands out:

- Gaming's 73.3% ≤4-day share is the highest of any category, heavily skewing toward ultra-short trials. Photo & Video follows closely, with 68.2% of trials at 4 days or less
- Travel leads in 5–9 day trials (54.3%), narrowly ahead of Health & Fitness (54.0%)
- Shopping stands out for longer trials, with the highest share of both 10–16 day (15.5%) and 17–32 day (10.3%) periods
- Education leans mid-length, with half of trials (50.3%) in the 5–9 day range

# Pricepoints by plan duration, year-over-year

How is pricing evolving across subscription lengths?




### Key takeaway

Prices remained remarkably stable; median yearly prices rose slightly from $31.60 to $34.80 while weekly and monthly held steady.

### Benchmarks to know:

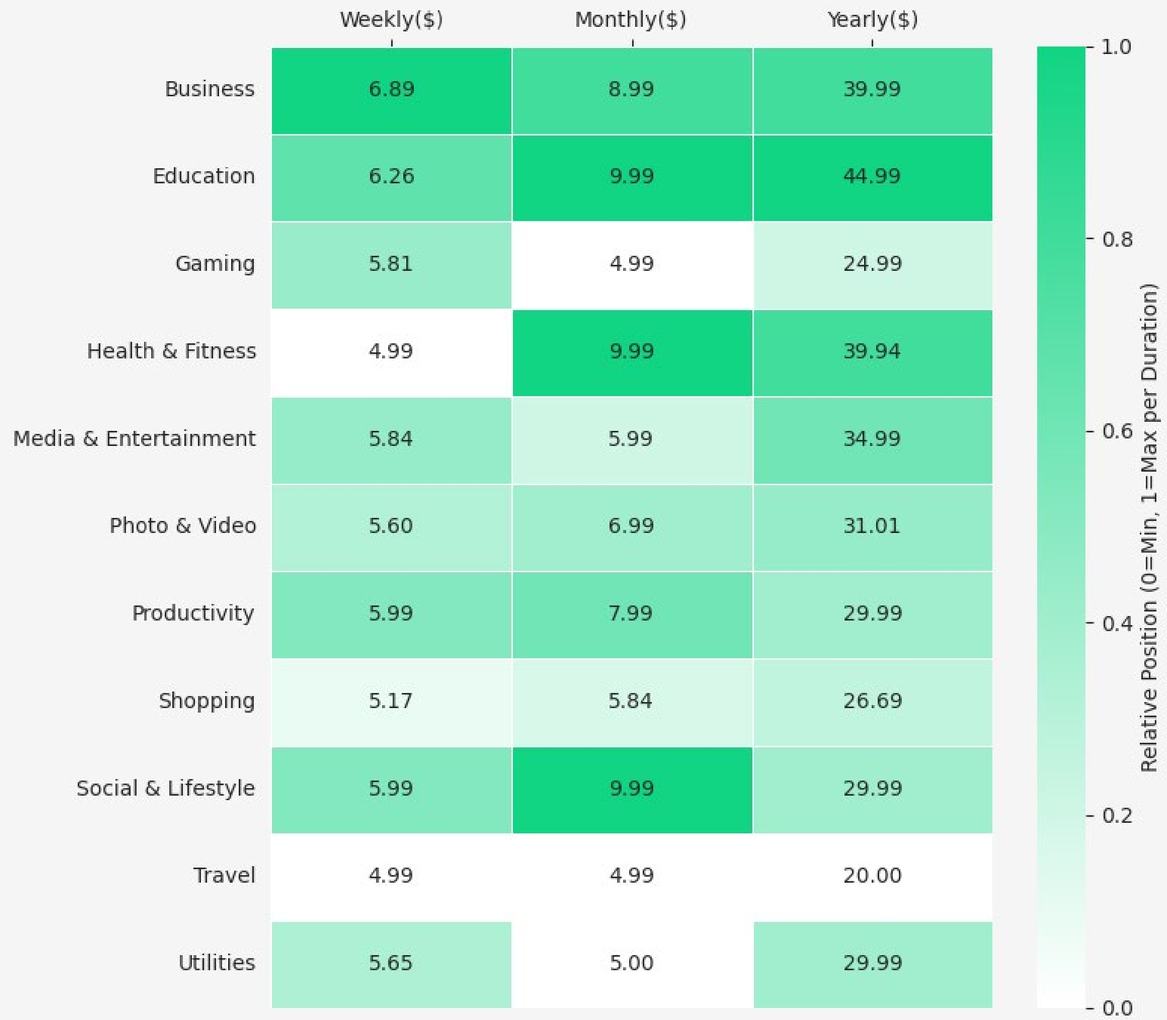
- Weekly: Most common at $5, median $5–$5.90, top percentile at $10 (unchanged YoY)
- Monthly: Most common at $10, median risen from $7 to $8, top performers went up from $20 to $22.70
- Yearly: Most common at $30, median up from $31.60 to $34.80, the top dropped from $92 to $90

### What stands out:

- Most common pricepoints ($5/$10/$30) are sticky psychological anchors
- Bottom quartile prices increased across all durations — floor is rising
- Yearly plans show widest spread (from $17–20 to $58–59)
- Monthly top percentile rose 13.5% ($20 → $22.70) — premium tier expanding
- Weekly pricing is most commoditized with tightest distribution

# Median price (mid value) per plan duration, by category

## What do apps charge by category?




### Key takeaway

Education commands premium pricing across yearly and monthly plans with Business having the highest weekly plans; Travel price is below market at every tier.

### Benchmarks to know:

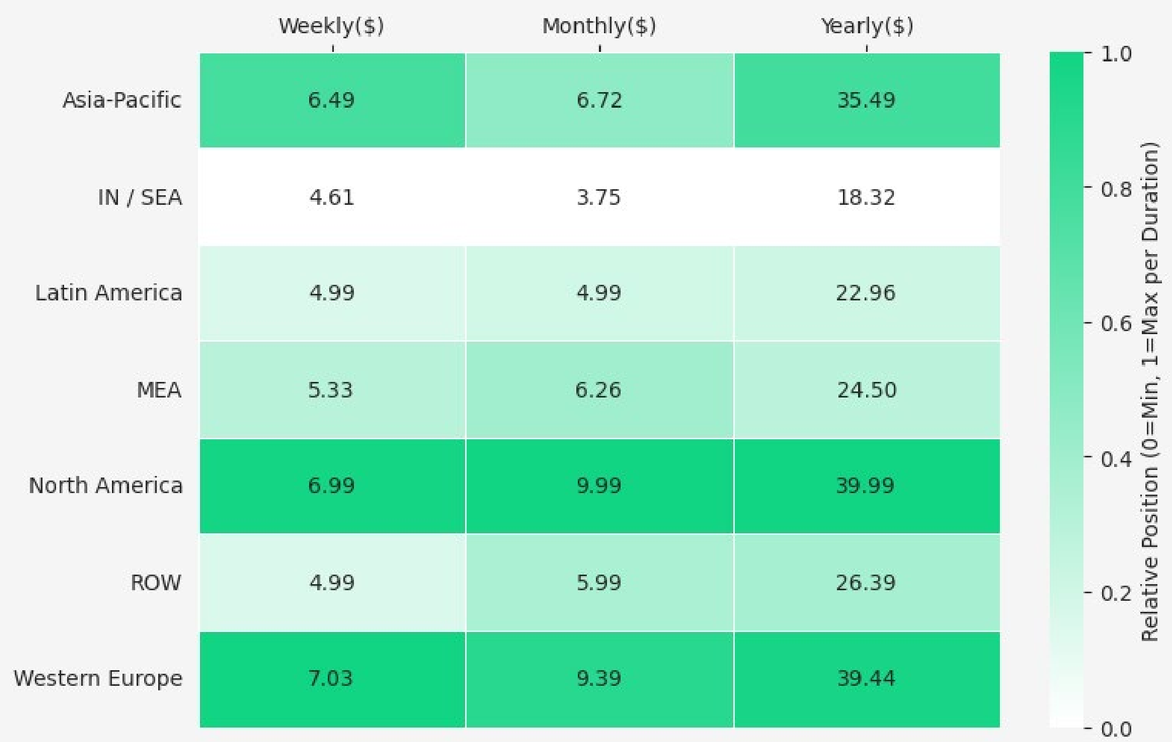
- Weekly median: $4.99–$6.89 (Business highest, Travel/Health lowest)
- Monthly median: $4.99–$9.99 (Education/Health/Social highest at $9.99)
- Yearly median: $20–$44.99 (Education highest, Travel lowest)

### What stands out:

- Education has highest yearly median at $44.99, 2.2× Travel's $20
- Gaming's $4.99 monthly is unusual and lower than its $5.81 weekly
- Health & Fitness charges premium monthly ($9.99) but value-prices weekly ($4.99)
- Business prices highest weekly ($6.89) but not highest yearly, suggesting weekly-focused monetization
- Travel consistently prices lowest across all three durations

# Median price per plan duration, by geography

Which geographies show the biggest spread between plan lengths?




### Key takeaway

Western Europe and North America command premiums; IN/SEA prices at ~50% of top markets.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly median: $4.61–$7.03 (Western Europe highest, IN/SEA lowest)
- Monthly median: $3.75–$9.99 (North America highest, IN/SEA lowest)
- Yearly median: $18.32–$39.99 (North America highest, IN/SEA lowest)

### What stands out:

- North America is consistently highest for monthly/yearly pricing
- IN/SEA prices at 46–54% of top-tier markets across all durations
- Western Europe exceeds North America on weekly but trails on monthly and yearly
- Latin America prices below MEA at all durations — unusual given GDP differences
- Asia-Pacific weekly ($6.49) nearly matches North America ($6.99) but yearly and monthly lag behind

# The Hidden Cost of Underpricing Your Subscription

**Patrick Rills**
Lose It!

1. **Retest prices you've already ruled out**

   Market conditions shift constantly. A price point that couldn't beat the control for years can suddenly break even as competitors raise prices and consumer expectations change.

2. **A higher base price unlocks more aggressive discounting**

   Going from $40 to $80 creates room for steeper percentage discounts that drive higher conversion, even when the absolute dollar price is still higher.

3. **Rising CACs demand pricing that funds acquisition**

   At $40/year, paid UA math barely worked. Doubling the price gave the marketing team room to compete on acquisition channels where costs keep climbing.

Listen to Patrick's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

Sub Club

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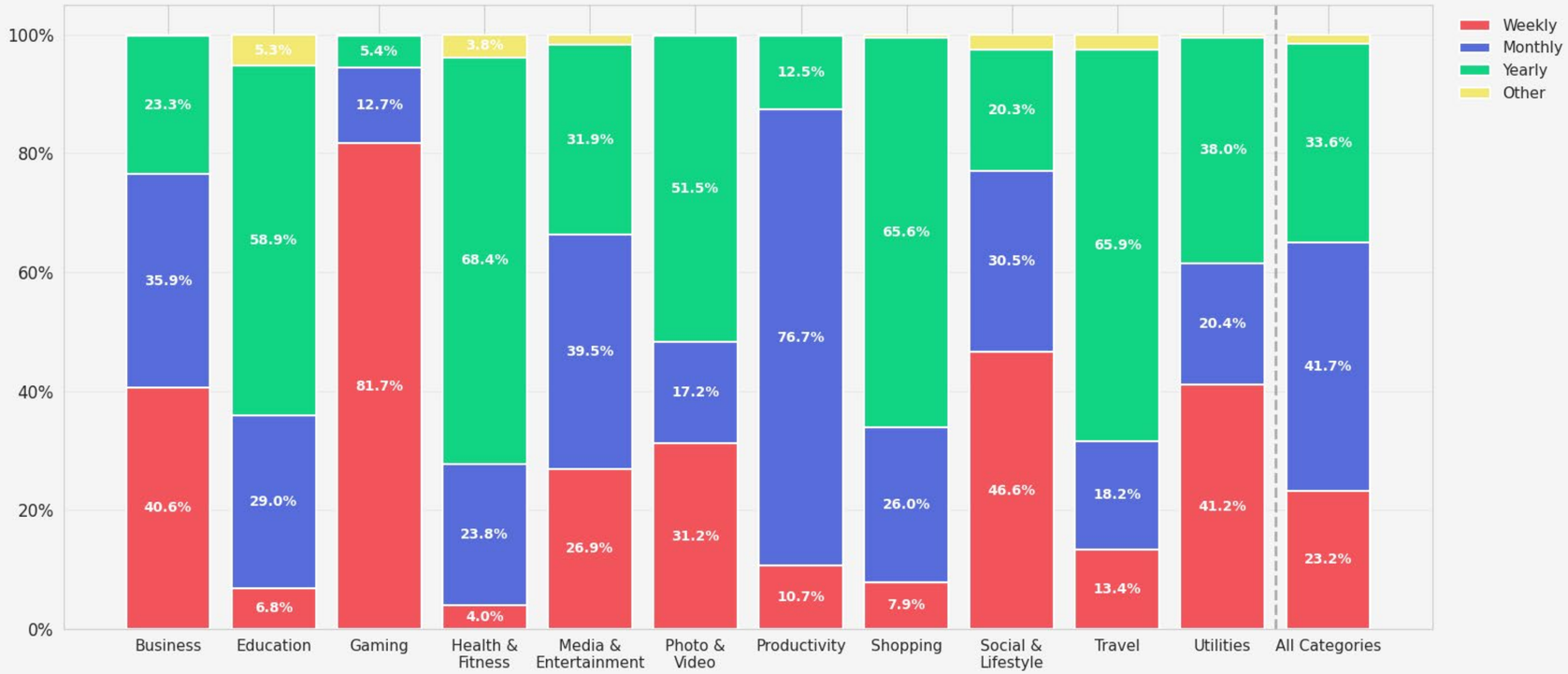
# Plan mix (subscriptions sold), by category

Where do weekly vs. yearly plans dominate subscription sales?




## Key takeaway

Gaming leans weekly (82%); Productivity favors yearly (77%); overall market: 42% monthly, 34% yearly.

## Benchmarks to know:

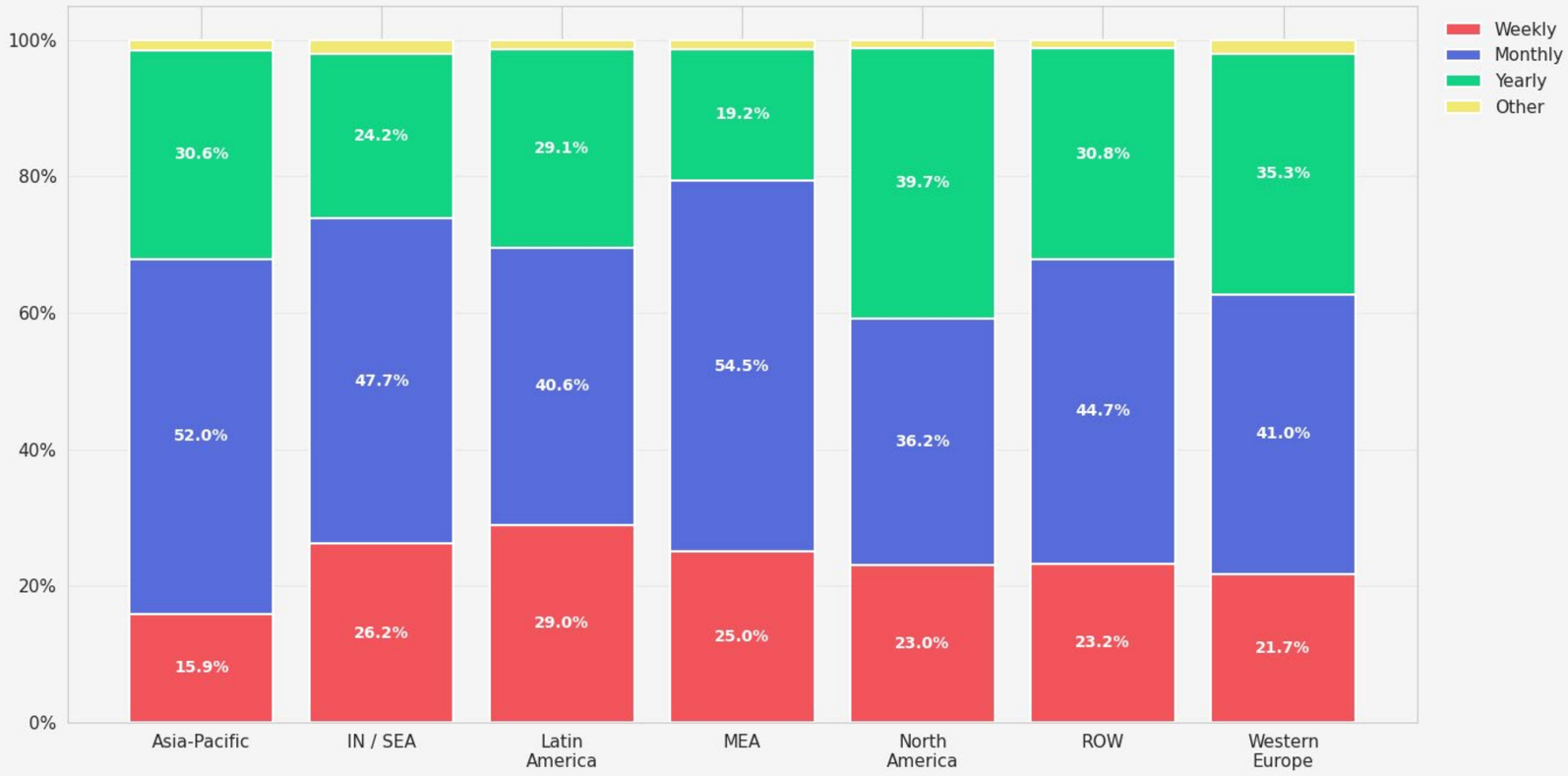
- Weekly: 4–47% across categories (Social highest, Health & Fitness lowest)
- Monthly: 13–77% (Gaming highest at 82% combined weekly + monthly, Productivity lowest)
- Yearly: 13–77% (Productivity highest, Gaming lowest at 13%)
- Lifetime/Other: 4–18% (Gaming highest, Health & Fitness lowest)

## What stands out:

- Gaming's 82% weekly dominance is extreme and matches its ultra-short trial strategy
- Productivity's 77% yearly mirrors enterprise/B2B purchasing patterns
- Health & Fitness is monthly-heavy (68%) despite premium positioning
- Shopping favors yearly (66%), likely bundled loyalty programs
- Travel also leans yearly at 66% with one of the lowest weekly (18%), matching seasonal booking patterns

# Plan mix (subscriptions sold), by geography

How does subscription duration mix vary across geographies?




### Key takeaway

MEA leads monthly (52%); North America balances monthly/yearly at 36%/40%.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly: 16–29% across geographies (Latin America highest, Asia-Pacific lowest)
- Monthly: 36–55% (MEA highest, North America lowest)
- Yearly: 19–40% (North America highest, MEA lowest)
- Lifetime/Other: <5% universally

### What stands out:

- North America is most yearly-skewed (40%), matching annual billing preferences
- Latin America favours weekly (29%), suggesting emerging market subscription patterns
- MEA's 55% monthly is highest, with pay-as-you-go preference in that geography
- Western Europe mirrors North America closely (35% yearly, 41% monthly)

# Pricing and packaging: key takeaways

Subscription pricing is more templatized than it appears, but with meaningful regional and category-level variation. Across geographies, the dominant architecture remains $4.99–$6.99 weekly, $7.99–$9.99 monthly, and $29.99–$39.99 yearly. North America and Western Europe anchor the high end of that range, while IN/SEA consistently prices at ~45–50% of North America's levels (across all durations).

Year-on-year, median pricing is largely stable. Weekly and monthly medians are flat ($5.99 and $10), while yearly medians ticked up from $31.60 to $34.80. Meanwhile, category differences are more pronounced: Education and Health & Fitness sustain $39.99–$44.99 annual pricing, while Gaming and Travel sit closer to $20–$29.99.

Trial strategy and duration further differentiate packaging: mixed trials dominate (44–59% by category), but short trials (≤4 days) now account for 46.5% of all trials — up 4.4pp YoY.

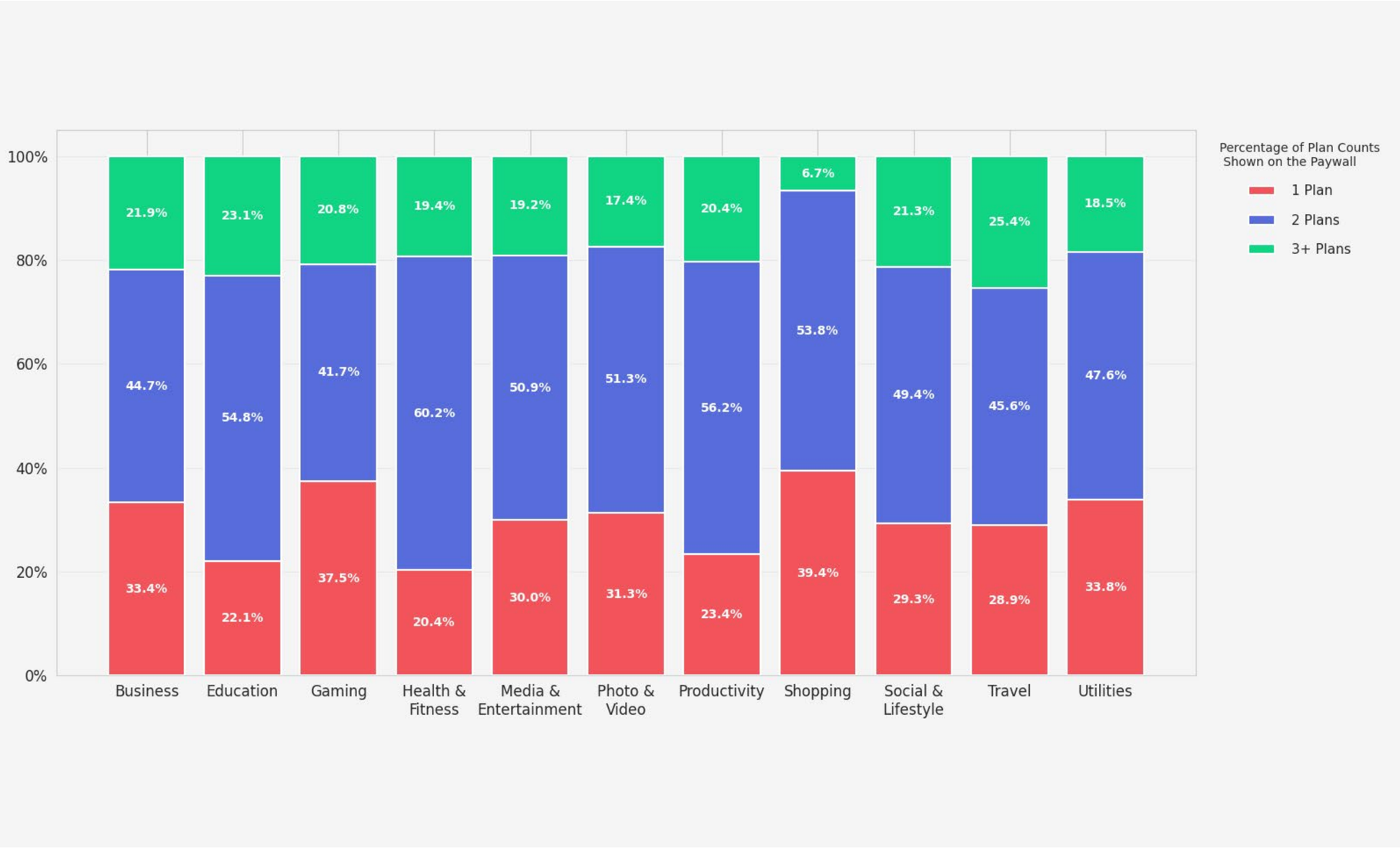
## What stands out

- **Regional compression with clear ceilings:** North America leads on monthly ($9.99) and yearly ($39.99), closely followed by Western Europe ($39.44 yearly). IN/SEA sits at $3.75 monthly and $18.32 yearly — roughly half of North American pricing across durations.
- **Annual pricing drifted up — weekly/monthly did not:** median yearly price increased to $34.80 (from $31.60), while weekly ($5.99) and monthly ($10) remained flat. The P90 yearly range expanded (up to $90), suggesting premium tier experimentation at the top end.
- **Category pricing power varies materially:** Education leads yearly at $44.99. Health & Fitness clusters at $39.94 yearly and $9.99 monthly. Gaming is structurally lower at $4.99 monthly and $24.99 yearly — a distinct pricing posture.
- **$9.99 monthly is the structural anchor:** estimated prices confirm $9.99 as the dominant monthly architecture across most categories. Yearly pricing concentrates at $29.99 or $39.99 in eight of 11 categories.
- **Short trials are gaining share:** ≤4 trials rose to 46.5% (from 42.1%), while longer trials (17–32 days) declined slightly to 5.0%. Despite evidence that longer trials convert better (see Funnel performance chapter), packaging is shifting shorter.

# 05
# Paywalls and offers

# Distribution of paywalls by number of plans shown (1/2/3+), by category

How many plan duration do paywalls offer by category?




### Key takeaway

Two-plan paywalls dominate (41–60% across categories); Shopping is the outlier with 40% single-plan paywalls.

### Benchmarks to know:

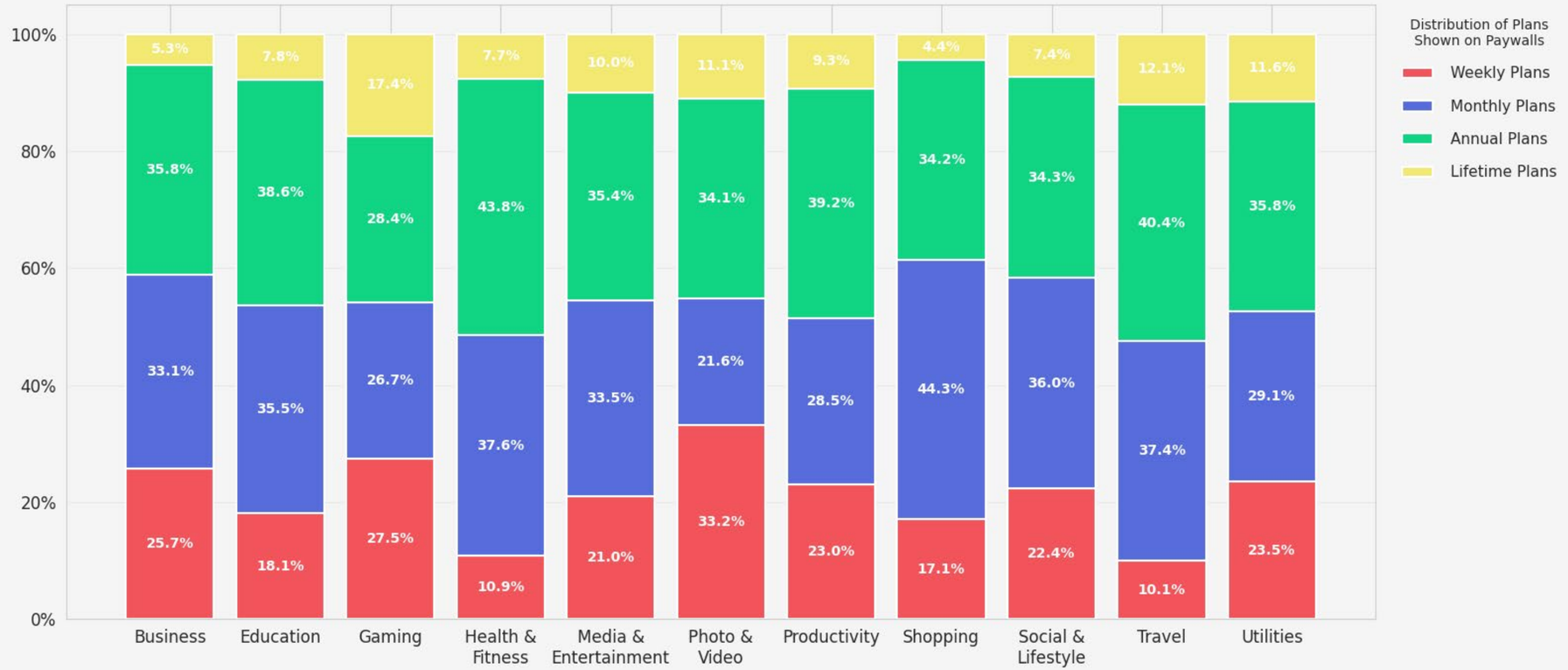
- 1 Plan: 20–40% (Shopping highest, Health & Fitness lowest)
- 2 Plans: 41–60% (Health & Fitness highest at 60%, Gaming lowest)
- 3+ Plans: 6–27% (Travel highest, Shopping lowest)

### What stands out:

- Shopping's 40% single-plan rate is 2× the Health & Fitness rate
- Travel leads 3+ plans at 27%; Shopping trails at 6%

# Distribution of plan durations offered (weekly, monthly, annual, lifetime), by category

Which plan durations appear on paywalls by category?




## Key takeaway

Annual plans lead across categories (28–44%), lifetime plans are most common in Gaming (18%), and weekly plans show significant variation (10–33%).

## Benchmarks to know:

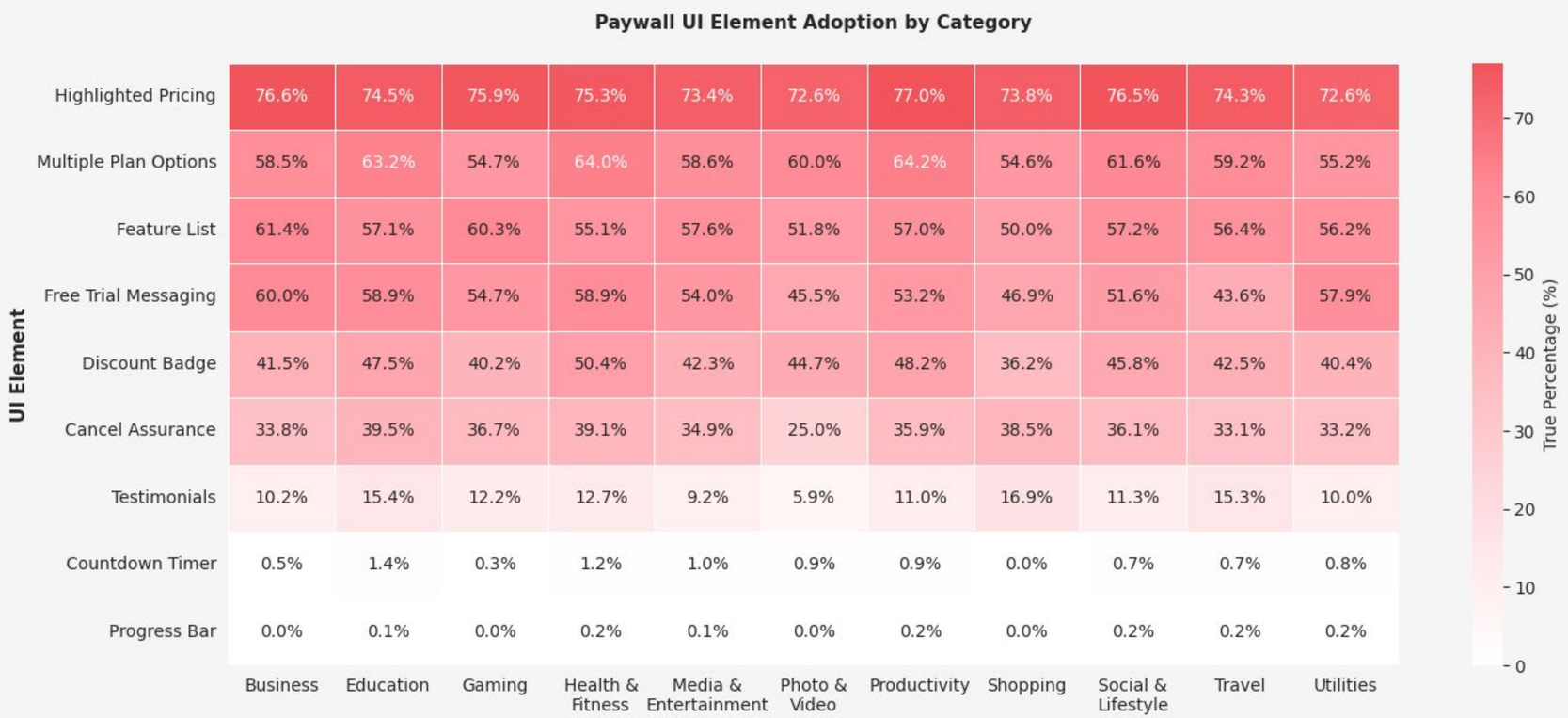
- Weekly shown: 10–33% (Photo & Video highest, Travel lowest)
- Monthly shown: 22–44% (Shopping highest, Photo & Video lowest)
- Annual shown: 28–44% (Health & Fitness highest, Gaming lowest)
- Lifetime shown: 5–18% (Gaming highest, Shopping lowest)

## What stands out:

- Gaming's 18% lifetime is 2–3× other categories
- Photo & Video leads weekly at 33%; Travel trails at 10.5%

# Distribution of UI elements in paywalls, by category

Which paywall UI elements are most widely-used?




## Key takeaway

Highlighted pricing leads at a 74.5% median. Countdown timers (≤1.4%) and progress bars (≤0.2%) are virtually absent.

## Benchmarks to know:

- Highlighted pricing: 74.5% median, tight spread (72.6–77.0%)
- Multi-plan options: 59.2% median; below 55.0% puts you alongside Shopping and Gaming
- Free trial messaging: 54.0% median; Travel (43.6%) is 1.4× below Business (60.0%)

## What stands out:

- Photo & Video cancel assurance (25.0%) is ~8pp below the next-lowest category
- Shopping leads testimonials (16.9%), nearly 3× Photo & Video's 5.9%
- Countdown timers and progress bars are near-zero in every category

# Dynamic Paywalls That Drove Millions in New Revenue

**Shawn Gong**
Tinder

Minisode

1 **Users need fewer options, not more**

Decision overload kills conversion. Tinder saw multimillion-dollar annual revenue gains by using ML to predict and surface the single best product for each user instead of showing every tier and plan at once.

2 **Anchor a la carte prices to subscriptions to prevent cannibalization**

Unbundling features can capture non-subscribers, but pricing too low steals from subscription revenue. Tinder priced its standalone Passport feature equal to the weekly equivalent of a full-featured subscription, making the subscription the obvious better deal.

3 **Design for emotional decisions, not logical ones**

Users don't read every feature comparison and weigh their options rationally. They decide in seconds based on feeling. Observe how users actually behave, not how you assume they should, and build your purchase flows around that.

Listen to Shawn's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

$ub Club

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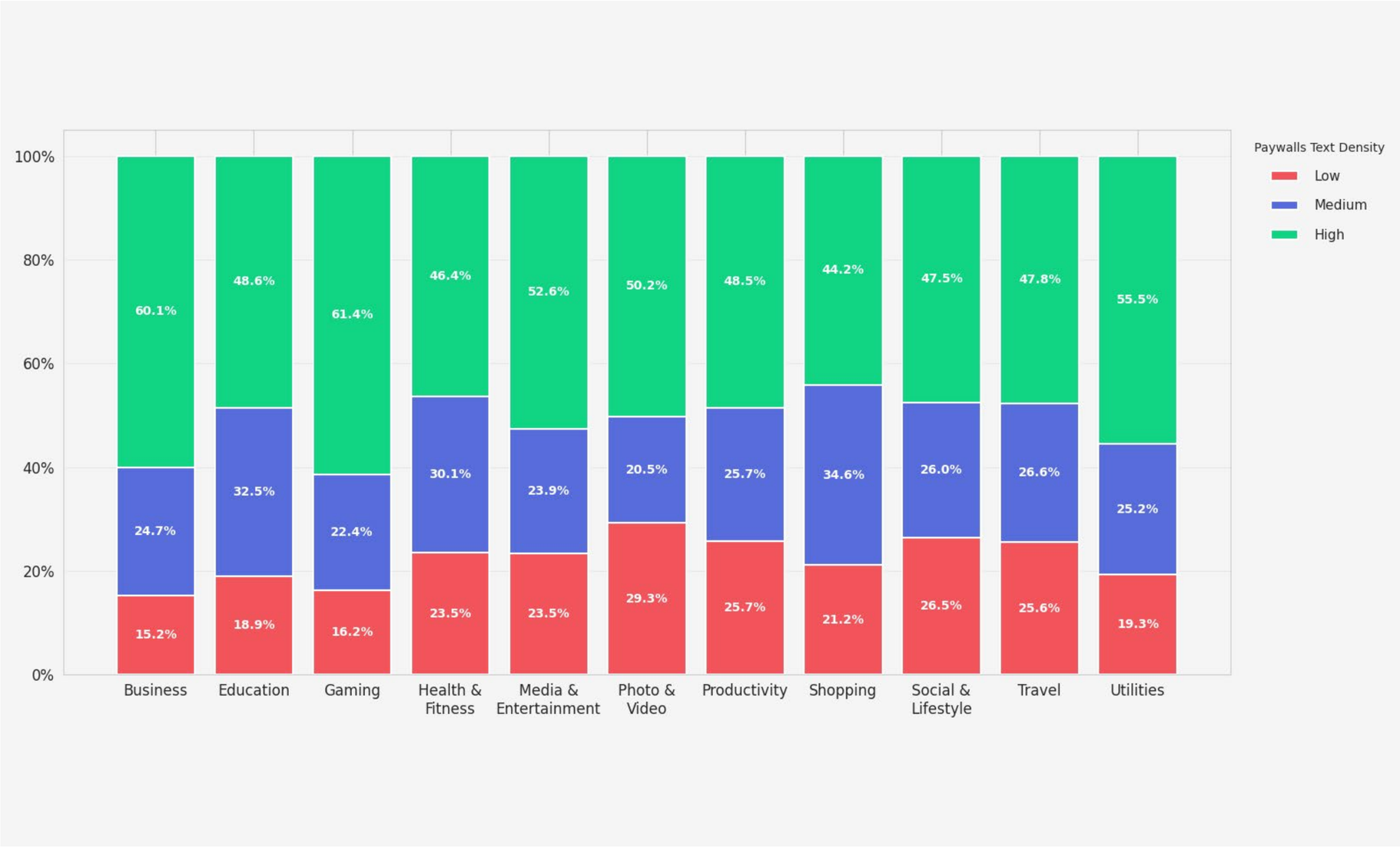
# Distribution of paywalls by text density, by category

How text-heavy are paywalls by category?




## Key takeaway

High text density dominates (45–63%); Gaming leads at 63%; Photo & Video uses most low-density paywalls (27%).

## Benchmarks to know:

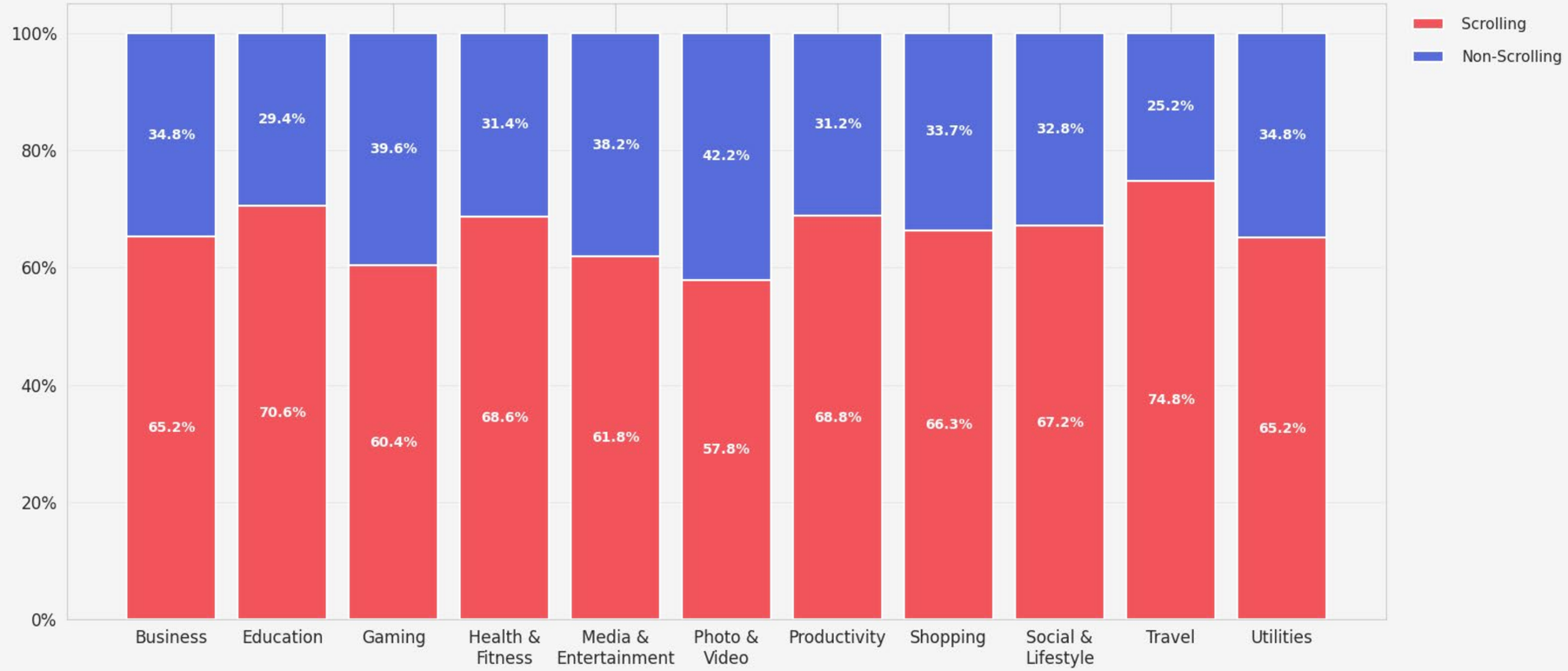
- Low text density: 13–27% (Photo & Video highest, Gaming lowest)
- Medium text density: 24–36% (Shopping highest, Gaming lowest)
- High text density: 45–63% (Gaming highest, Shopping lowest)

## What stands out:

- Gaming's 63% high-density rate is 18pp above Shopping's 45%
- Photo & Video's 27% low-density is 2× the Gaming rate (13%)

# Share of scrollable paywalls, by category

What's the split between static vs. scrolling paywalls by category?




### Key takeaway

Scrolling paywalls are the majority (59–76%); Travel leads at 76%; Photo & Video is lowest at 59%.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Scrolling paywalls: 59–76% (Travel highest, Photo & Video lowest)
- Non-scrolling paywalls: 24–41% (Photo & Video highest, Travel lowest)

### What stands out:

- Travel's 76% scrolling rate is 17pp above Photo & Video's 59%
- Education (72%) and Health & Fitness (70%) cluster near Travel

# Distribution of paywall call-to-action language, by category

What CTA button text is most common?

### Key takeaway

'Continue' dominates CTA buttons; 'Subscribe' and 'Start Free Trial' follow; dynamic pricing templates are common.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Top CTAs: Continue, Subscribe, Start Free Trial, Try Free
- Supporting CTAs: Unlock, Get Started, Upgrade to Premium
- Dynamic elements: price templates (product.price, product.price_per_period)

### What stands out:

- 'Cancel Anytime' appears prominently alongside primary CTAs
- Dynamic price templating is widespread across apps

# More is more... and the devil is in the details

**Sylvain Gauchet**
Head of Growth, Reading.com and Chief Insights Miner, GrowthGems.co

## The boom in subscription apps brought some customer fatigue and suspicion.

Developers know users don't want to get burned when forgetting to cancel and need to understand what they will get. As a result, most paywalls are scrollable and text-heavy. Another emerging trend is multi-step paywalls (not displayed here), which allow to break down all that information into several chunks: features, free trial terms, and pricing.

At the same time, conversion rate optimization is more important than ever. Details like highlighting pricing, showing discount badges, or "cancel anytime" are becoming table stakes. Unsurprisingly, the slightly ambiguous "Continue" remains the dominant CTA to trigger the payment/trial sheet. Fun fact: we already see "continue in-app" being used, indicating more app-to-web flows.

StartApp School

# Paywall optimization masterclass, by Vahe Baghdasaryan

**Vahe Baghdasaryan**
Founder & CEO, Tangent

Paywall expert Vahe Baghdasaryan runs through a masterclass on monetization's center of gravity: the paywall. Instead of focusing on surface-level tactics, Vahe teaches how to systematically experiment across paywall design, pricing, placement, and promotion — ultimately revealing the secrets to building a structured monetization framework for subscription apps.

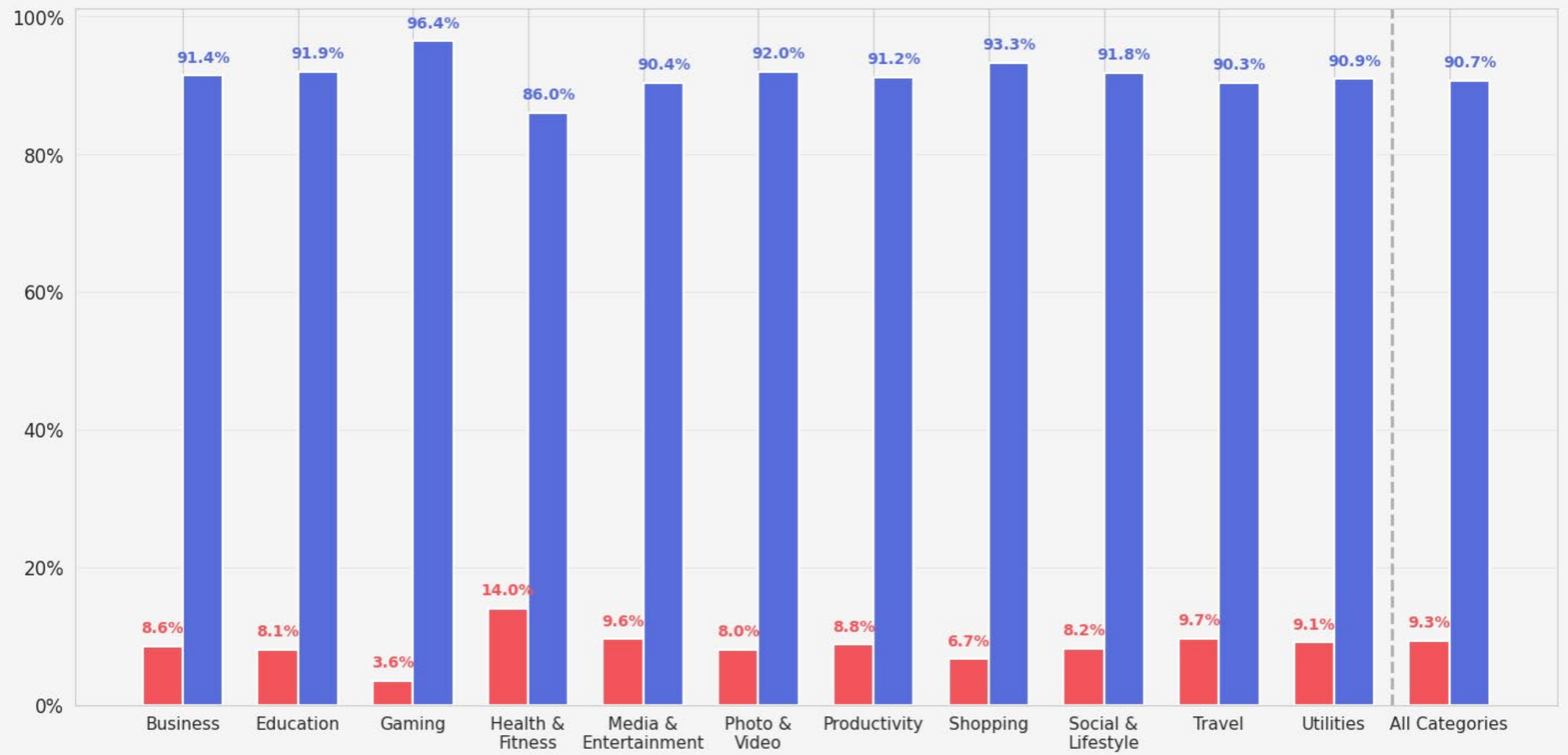
Explore Vahe's Course

**What you'll learn:**

- How to diagnose why users convert (or don't)
- How to choose the right monetization model
- How to define a measurable paywall objective
- Where to place paywalls for maximum impact
- How to design paywalls that reduce friction and increase trust
- How to build a sustainable experimentation process

# Offer usage, by category

How widely are promotional offers used across categories?




## Key takeaway

Under 10% of apps use offers overall (9.3%); Health & Fitness leads at 14%; Gaming trails at 3.6%.

## Benchmarks to know:

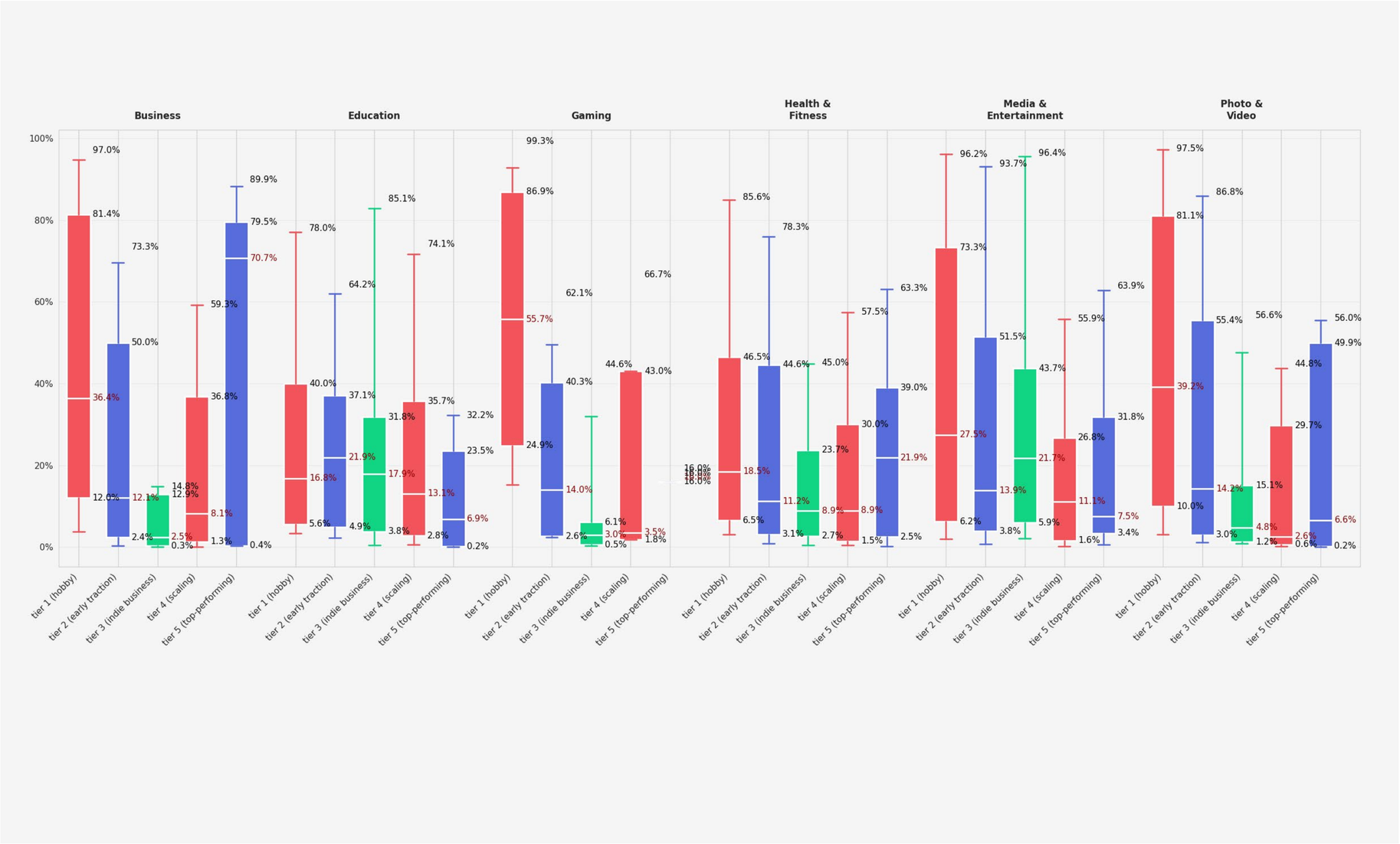
- Overall offer usage: 9.3% of apps
- Range across categories: 3.6–14.0%
- Leader: Health & Fitness (14.0%)
- Lowest: Gaming (3.6%)

## What stands out:

- Over 90% of apps don't use promotional offers
- Health & Fitness adoption is nearly 4× Gaming's rate

# Share of new payers acquired via an intro offer, by category and revenue tier

What share of new payers come through intro offers?




## Key takeaway

Overall median is ~30%, but the gap between hobby-tier apps (65–99%) and top-performers (0–10%) is the real story — offer reliance falls sharply as apps scale.

## Benchmarks to know:

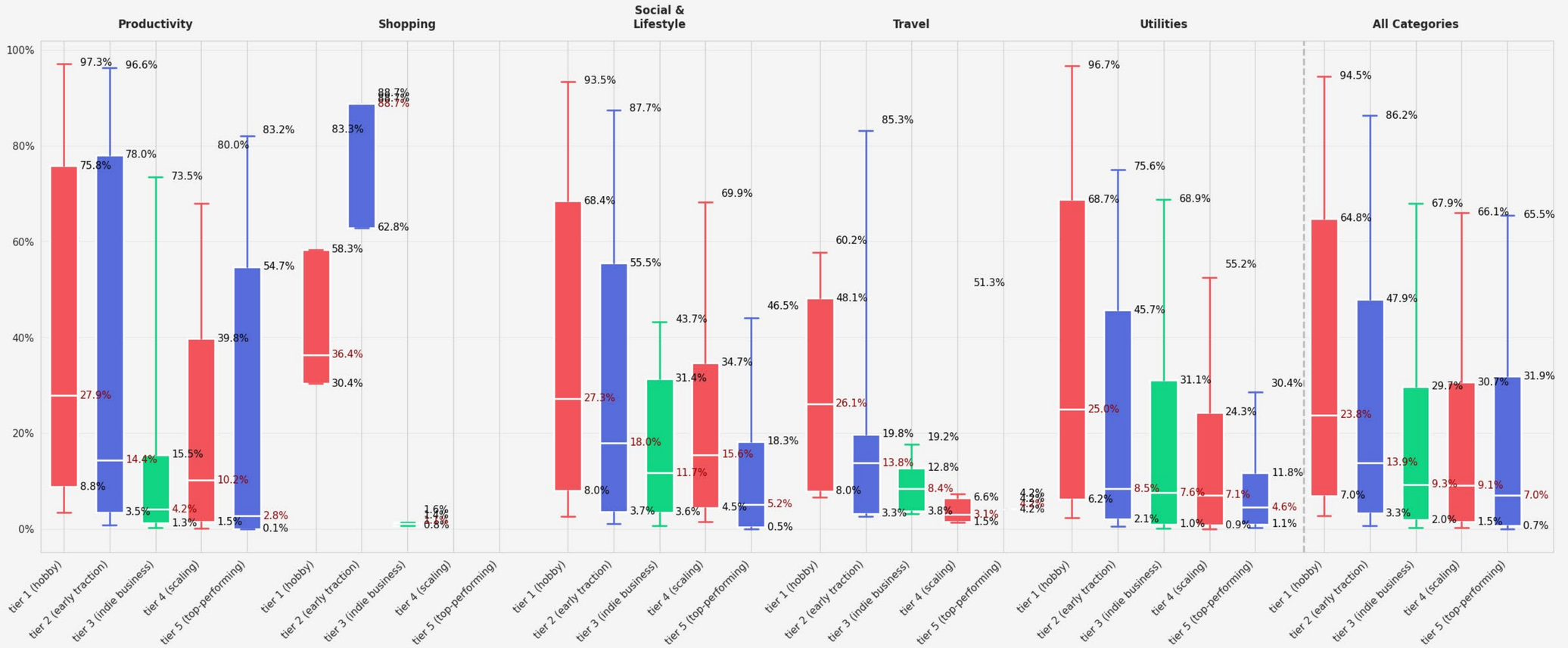
- If you're at ~30%, you're at the industry median
- If you're above 65%, you're in hobby-tier territory where nearly all payers enter via offers
- If you're below 10%, you're in top-performer range; offers play a minimal role
- Gaming spans the widest range: 99% at hobby tier to near-zero at top tier

## What stands out:

- The spread between tiers 1 and 5 is ~60–90pp across most categories; an unusually clean inverse pattern
- Gaming's hobby-to-top gap is the most extreme in the dataset (~99pp)
- Media & Entertainment and Photo & Video maintain higher offer share even in upper tiers

# Share of new payers acquired via an intro offer, by category and revenue tier

(Continued)



# Intro and promotional offers are becoming monetization infrastructure

**Vahe Bagdasaryan**
Founder & CEO, Tangent

One of the most important shifts in subscription monetization is the growing reliance on intro and promotional offers as structured revenue levers rather than temporary growth hacks. While only 9.3% of apps currently use promotional offers, their impact among those that do is significant. At the same time, intro offers remain a dominant acquisition mechanic, with ~30% of new subscribers entering through intro discounts (median) across categories.

Based on the data, reliance on intro offers varies dramatically by scale. Hobby-tier apps often see 65–99% of new subscribers coming through intro offers, while top-performing apps typically rely on them for only 0–10% of conversions. As apps mature, dependency on heavy discounting declines. However, the structure of those intro offers is evolving. Increasingly, paid intro offers are replacing free trials, models like $0.99 for the first month, then auto-renewing to full annual price, or heavily discounted first weeks that renew at standard pricing. These low upfront paid offers create commitment, reduce trial abuse, improve cash flow, and often convert at higher quality than traditional free trials.

By integrating promotional offers strategically — such as win-backs, second-time discounts, exit offers during cancellation, and transaction-abandonment recoveries — apps can capture otherwise lost demand and meaningfully increase blended ARPU. Rather than permanently lowering price, these offers act as targeted conversion tools that unlock incremental revenue from price-sensitive or churn-risk segments.

The key takeaway is that intro and promotional offers are no longer optional optimizations; they are becoming structured components of subscription strategy. As competition intensifies and acquisition costs rise, apps that operationalize paid intro offers and lifecycle promotional systems will be better positioned to increase ARPU, improve conversion efficiency, and sustain long-term growth.

# Why A Winning Paywall in Japan Completely Failed in the US

**Michal Parizek**
Mojo

1. **Show free users a paywall every week after onboarding**

   Triggering a paywall on app open once per week for free users drove 15% of new revenue with no backlash. The more generous your free tier, the more users tolerate the ask.

2. **A winning paywall in one region can completely fail in another**

   A long, detail-rich paywall lifted revenue 20% in Japan but flopped in the US, where cleaner designs with punchy copy outperformed. Always retest winners in each market before rolling out globally.

3. **Experiment velocity is a huge unlock for revenue optimization**

   Running parallel paywall tests across geo segments on a weekly cadence compounds gains fast. More iterations mean shorter feedback loops, faster learning, and fewer months leaving revenue on the table.

Listen to Michal's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

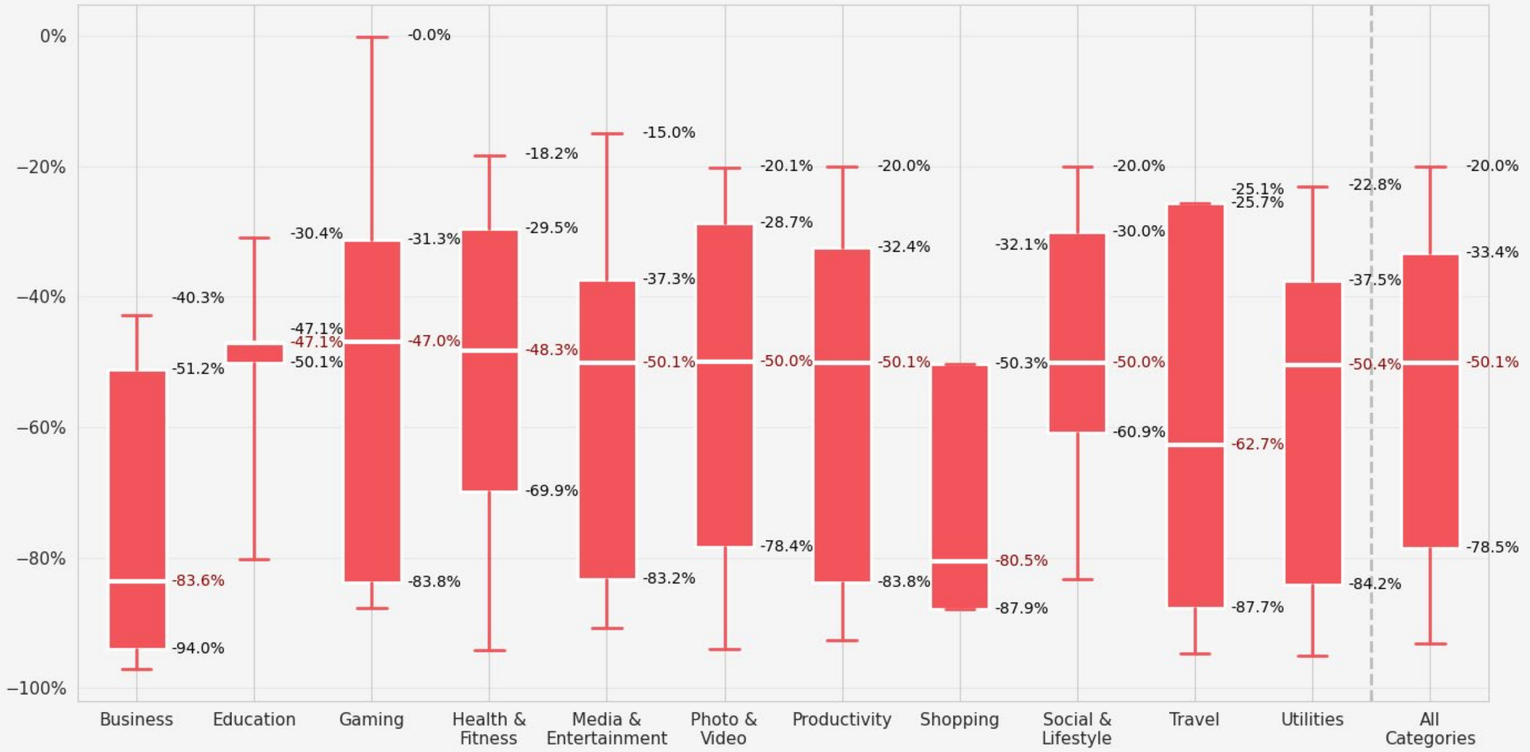
Sub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

Minisode

# Distribution of intro-offer discount levels by category

How large are intro offer discounts?




## Key takeaway

The industry anchors hard at 50% off, with median discount is -50.1% with remarkably tight clustering across categories, though Utilities pulls deepest at -63%.

## Benchmarks to know:

- If you're near -50%, you're at the median across all categories
- If you're shallower than -33%, you're in the top quartile (least discounting)
- If you're deeper than -79%, you're in the bottom quartile (heaviest discounting)
- Shallowest medians: Gaming and Health & Fitness at -47%

## What stands out:

- Utilities is an outlier at -63% median, ~16pp deeper than the overall median
- Business shows the widest IQR (~54pp spread), while Gaming's is among the tightest
- The gap between shallowest (-47%) and deepest (-63%) category medians is only 16pp, showing unusual uniformity

# Paywalls and offers: key takeaways

Across categories, promotional mechanics and paywall design follow a consistent pattern: most apps do not use intro offers, most paywalls default to two plans, annual pricing dominates presentation, and UI patterns are surprisingly standardized. Variation exists, especially by performance tier and category, but the center of gravity is tight. If you're benchmarking your paywall, the median experience is simpler than you might assume.

Overall, 9.3% of apps use promotional offers (ranging 3.6–14.0% by category). When intro offers are used, lower-performing tiers rely on them far more heavily (often 65–99% of new payers), while top performers sit closer to 0–10%. Median intro discounts cluster tightly around -50.1%. Two-plan paywalls account for 41–60% across most categories, and annual plans appear on 28–44% of paywalls. Highlighted pricing (74.5% median) and free trial messaging (54% median) are common, while countdown timers (1.4%) and progress bars (0.2%) are nearly absent.

## What stands out

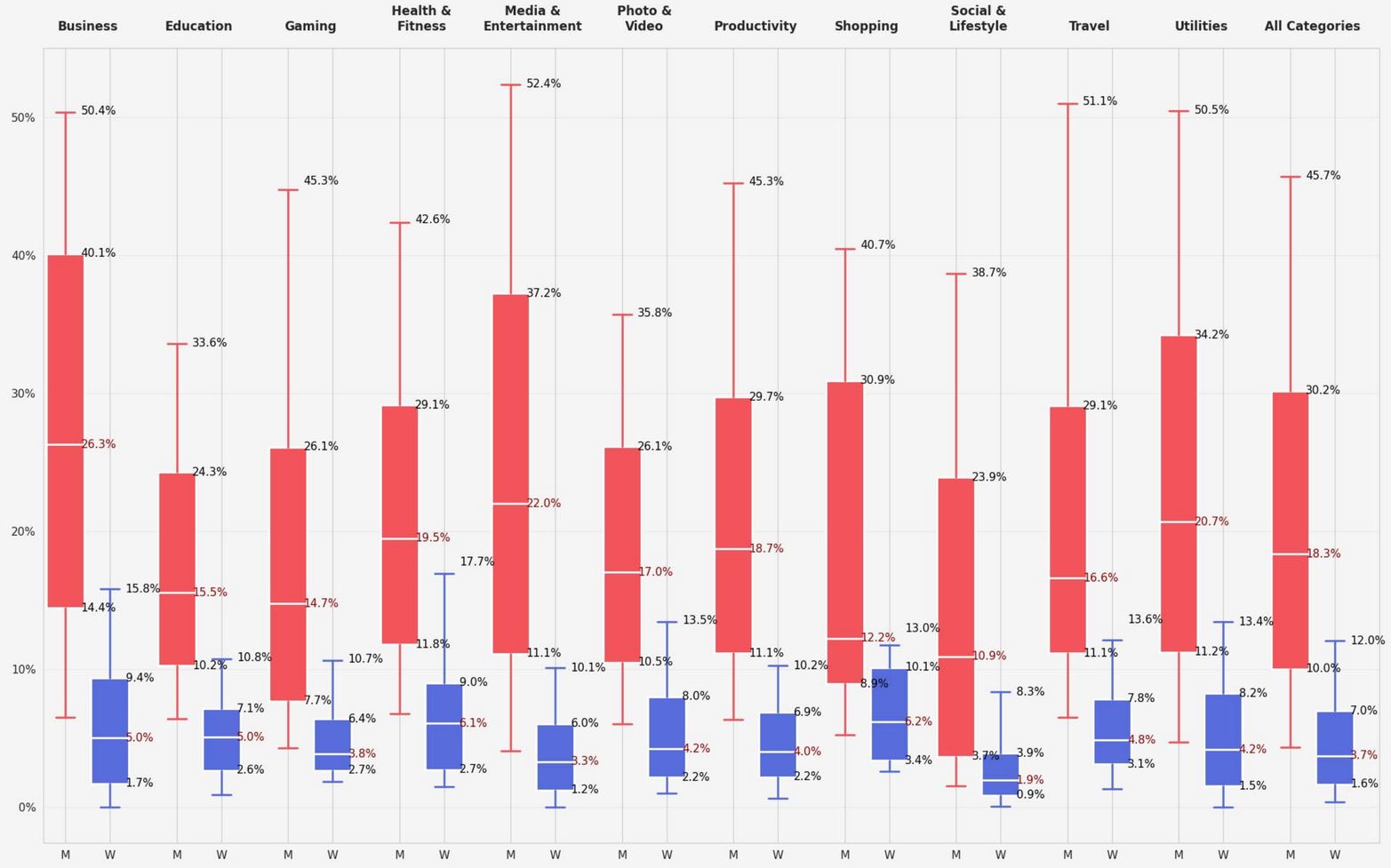
- Promo offers are the exception, not the norm: only 9.3% of apps use offers. Health & Fitness leads at 14.0% and Gaming is lowest at 3.6%. In practice, over 90% of subscription apps do not use promotional pricing at all.
- Heavy intro-offer reliance signals lower-tier performance: overall median share of new payers via intro offers is ~30%. Hobby tiers often sit at 65–99%, while top performers cluster near 0–10%. As apps scale, reliance on discounts drops sharply.
- The -50% discount is effectively industry standard: median intro discount is -50.1%, with remarkably tight clustering (most categories within ~3pp). Gaming is the only category where top performers offer -90%, creating wider dispersion.
- Two plans is the default structure: across most categories, 41–60% of paywalls show two plans. Shopping is the clearest outlier, with 40% single-plan paywalls. Three-plan layouts range 6–27%, highest in Travel.
- Annual framing dominates, but weekly can spike by category: annual plans appear on 28–44% of paywalls. Gaming shows the highest lifetime share at 18%. Weekly presentation varies widely (10–33%), with Photo & Video at 33% and Travel at 10.5%.
- UI experimentation is limited: most paywalls look structurally similar. highlighted pricing appears on 74.5% of paywalls and free trial messaging on 54%. Countdown timers (1.4%) and progress bars (0.2%) are almost nonexistent. High text-density paywalls range 45–63% across categories, led by Gaming (63%), and scrolling paywalls are the majority everywhere (59–76%), highest in Travel at 76%.

# 06

# Retention and billing health

# Retention of weekly and monthly plans 6 months in, by category

How many subscribers stay for 6+ months?




## Key takeaway

Monthly plans retain 2–5x better than weekly: median 14–26% (monthly) vs. 3–6% (weekly).

## Benchmarks to know:

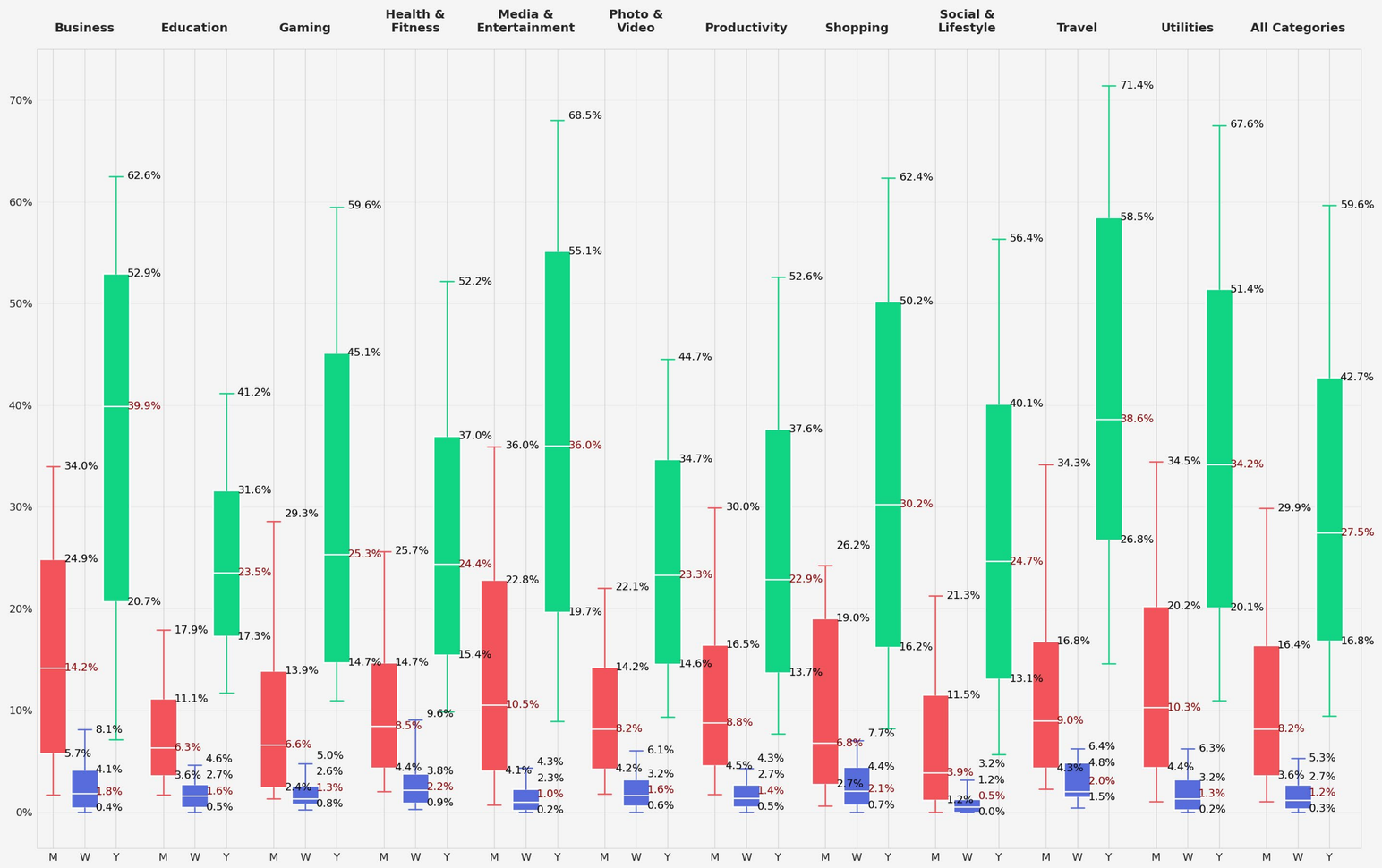
- Weekly: median 5–15%, top quartile 7–10%
- Monthly: median 14–26%, top quartile 30–50%
- Business category leads (26% weekly/40% monthly); Social & Lifestyle lags (11%/24%)

## What stands out:

- Monthly generally outperforms weekly by 15–25%
- The spread between quartiles is significantly higher for monthly plans compared to weekly

# Retained subscribers after 1 year, by plan duration

## How many subscribers stay for 12+ months?




### Key takeaway

Yearly plans achieve significantly higher Y1 retention: median 20–40% (yearly) vs. 1–2% (weekly) and 6–14% (monthly).

### Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly Y1: median 1–2%, essentially total churn
- Monthly Y: median 6–14%, top quartile 11–25%
- Yearly Y1: median 20–40%, top quartile 32–59%
- Travel leads yearly (39%); Productivity lags (23%)

### What stands out:

- Weekly users hemorrhage — lifetime value (LTV) depends entirely on early monetization
- Travel's yearly vs. weekly (39% vs. 9%) is a 4x multiplier

# The first renewal is where subscriptions are won or lost

**Certain plans survive longer because the billing cycle matches how frequently users experience value.**

Yearly plans retain 3–10× better than weekly by Year 1, not because users are inherently more loyal, but because higher upfront commitment filters for stronger need. Weekly plans depend on immediate perceived value and churn rapidly when that value is not reinforced.

**The clearest breakdown between expectations and value delivery happens at the first renewal.**

Nearly half of monthly subscribers and three in four yearly subscribers do not renew once. Retention jumps 18–30 percentage points between the first and second renewal across all durations, indicating that survival of the first billing cycle is the true inflection point. Users reassess value immediately after purchase and again before renewal.

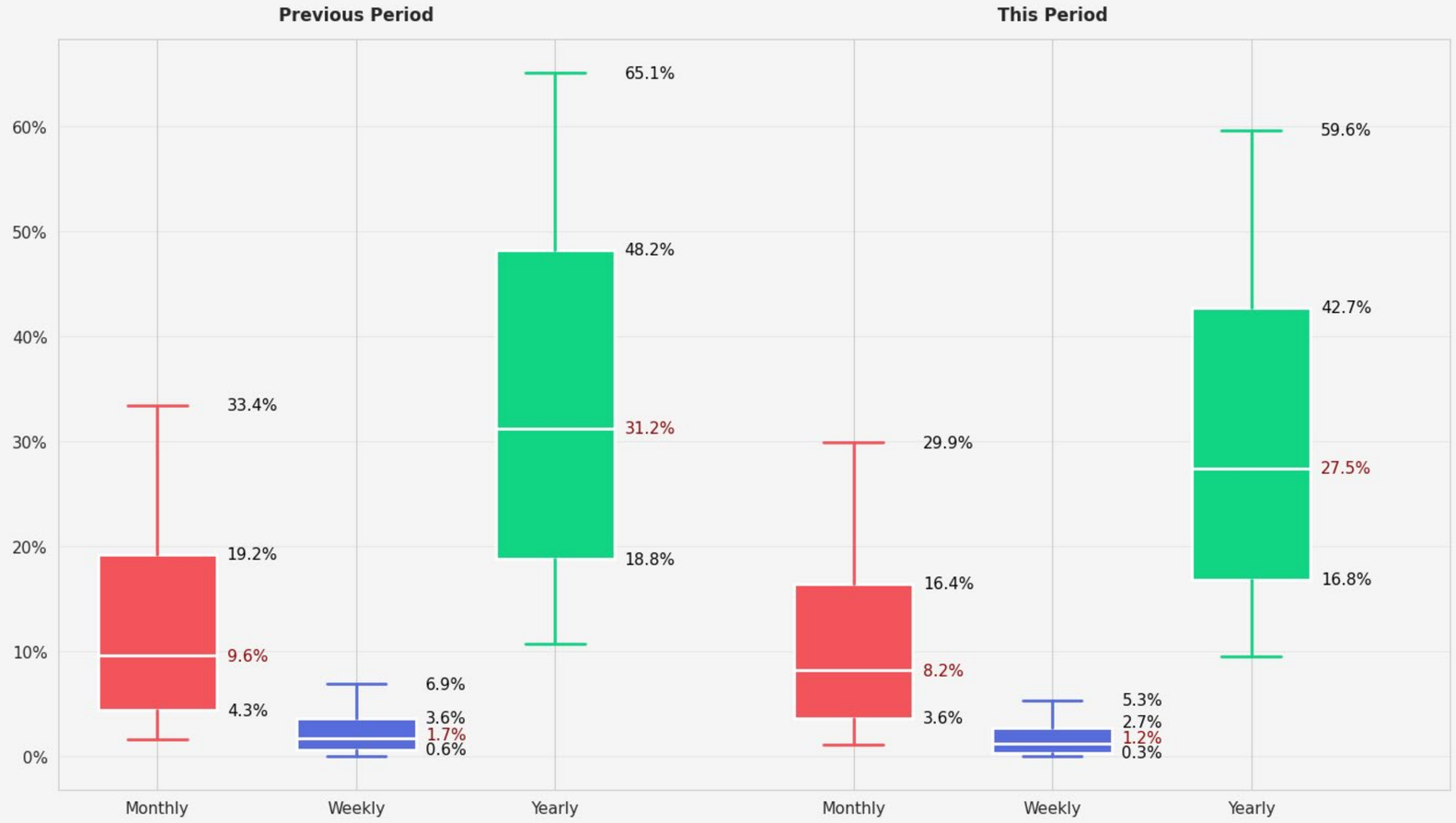
**The most sensitive intervention window is therefore Renewal #1.**

Price influences early churn, particularly on yearly plans, but whether you use freemium or a hard paywall does not meaningfully change retention. In a market where year-one retention is declining across all durations, the winning strategy is not gating harder or charging differently. It is accelerating time-to-value before the first renewal decision.

**Alice Muir Kocourková**
Independent Growth
& Subscription Consultant

# Year 1 retention 2023 compared to 2024, by plan duration

How did Y1 retention change in 2025 compared to 2024?




## Key takeaway

Retention declined slightly across the board from the 2023 cohort to the 2024 cohort.

## Benchmarks to know:

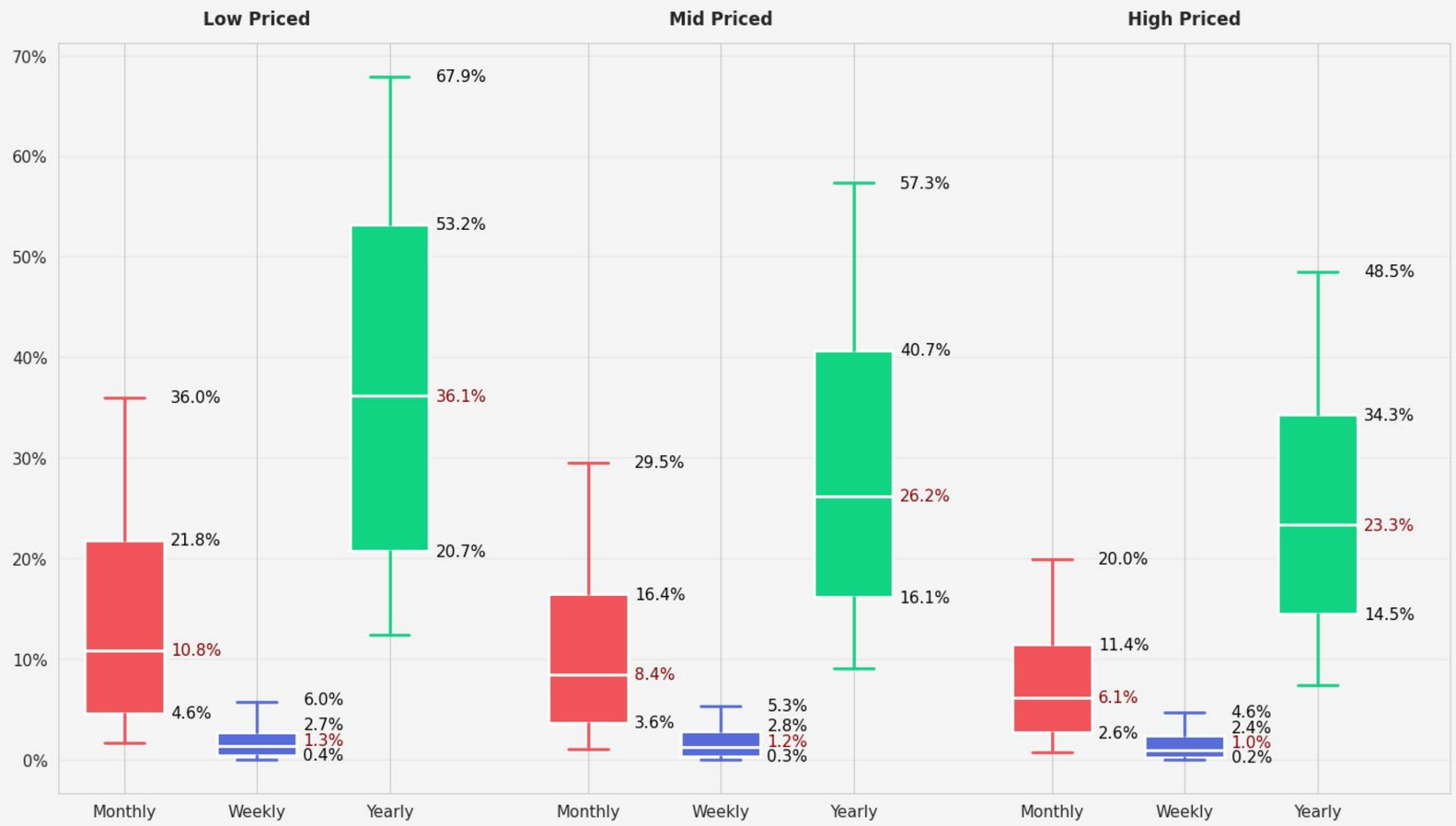
- Yearly: 31% → 28% median (-3%)
- Monthly: 10% → 8% median (-2%)
- Weekly: 1.7% → 1.2% (-0.5%)

## What stands out:

- Narrow shrinking of retention is somewhat notable, but at such small percentages it's likely just noise

# Retained subscribers after 1 year, by pricepoint

## Do pricing tiers affect Y1 retention?




### Key takeaway

Low-priced apps retain better on yearly plans: 36% (low) vs. 26% (mid) and 23% (high). The gap narrows on shorter durations.

### Benchmarks to know:

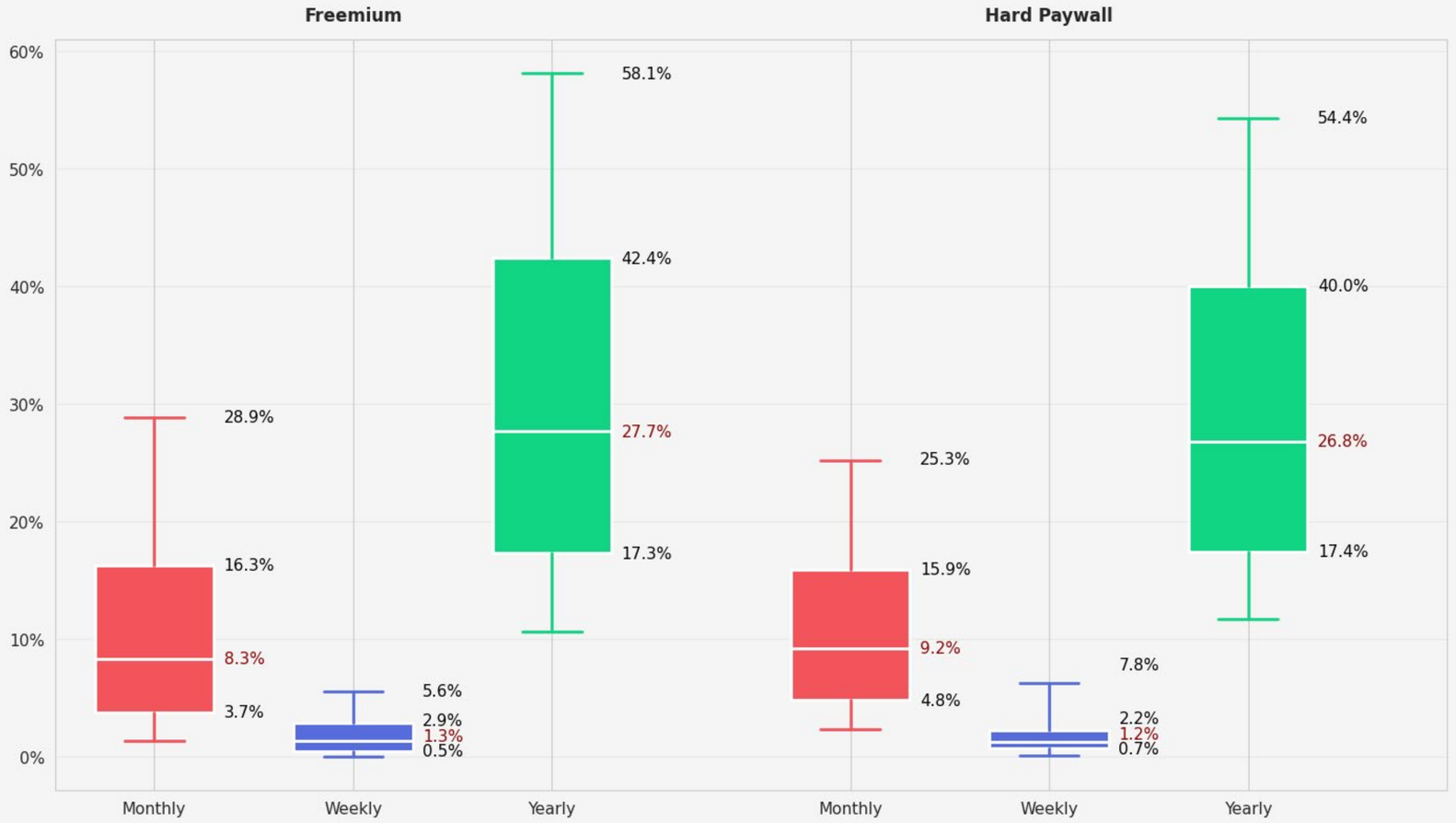
- Low-priced yearly: 36% median, top quartile 53%
- Mid-priced yearly: 26% median, top quartile 41%
- High-priced yearly: 23% median, top quartile 34%
- Monthly sees a similar drop as price increases
- Weekly seems much less impacted by price changes

### What stands out:

- Low-priced outperforms mid-price by 10-13% & high-price by 13-20%
- High-priced shows tightest yearly distribution (15-49%): predictable but lower retention
- Weekly uniformly poor regardless of price (<3% median)

# Retained subscribers after 1 year, by access methods

Does freemium vs. hard paywall affect Y1 retention?




## Key takeaway

No meaningful difference: freemium yearly at 28% vs. hard paywall at 27% median.

## Benchmarks to know:

- Freemium yearly: 28% median, range 17–58%
- Hard paywall yearly: 27% median, range 17–54%
- Monthly: 8% (freemium) vs. 9% (hard paywall)
- Weekly: ~1–2% for both

## What stands out:

- Access method is not a retention differentiator, 1% gap is noise
- Both show similar variance — product quality and category matter more
- Hard paywalls don't create stickier users despite filtering for higher intent
- Implication: access method is a conversion choice, not a retention strategy

# The biggest UA lever most app teams ignore isn't in their ad account

**Sven Jürgens**
Mobile Growth Consultant & Advisor

You test creatives. You refine audiences. You optimize bids. But one decision shapes your payback period more than almost anything else, and it's made long before you launch your first campaign. It's whether users hit a paywall the moment they open your app, or get to explore first.

**This choice changes your unit economics completely:** apps that show a hard paywall upfront convert downloads to paying users at roughly 5× the rate of freemium apps. Same ad spend. Dramatically different revenue on day one. That means faster payback. Which means you can reinvest sooner and bid more aggressively than competitors still waiting on their cohorts.

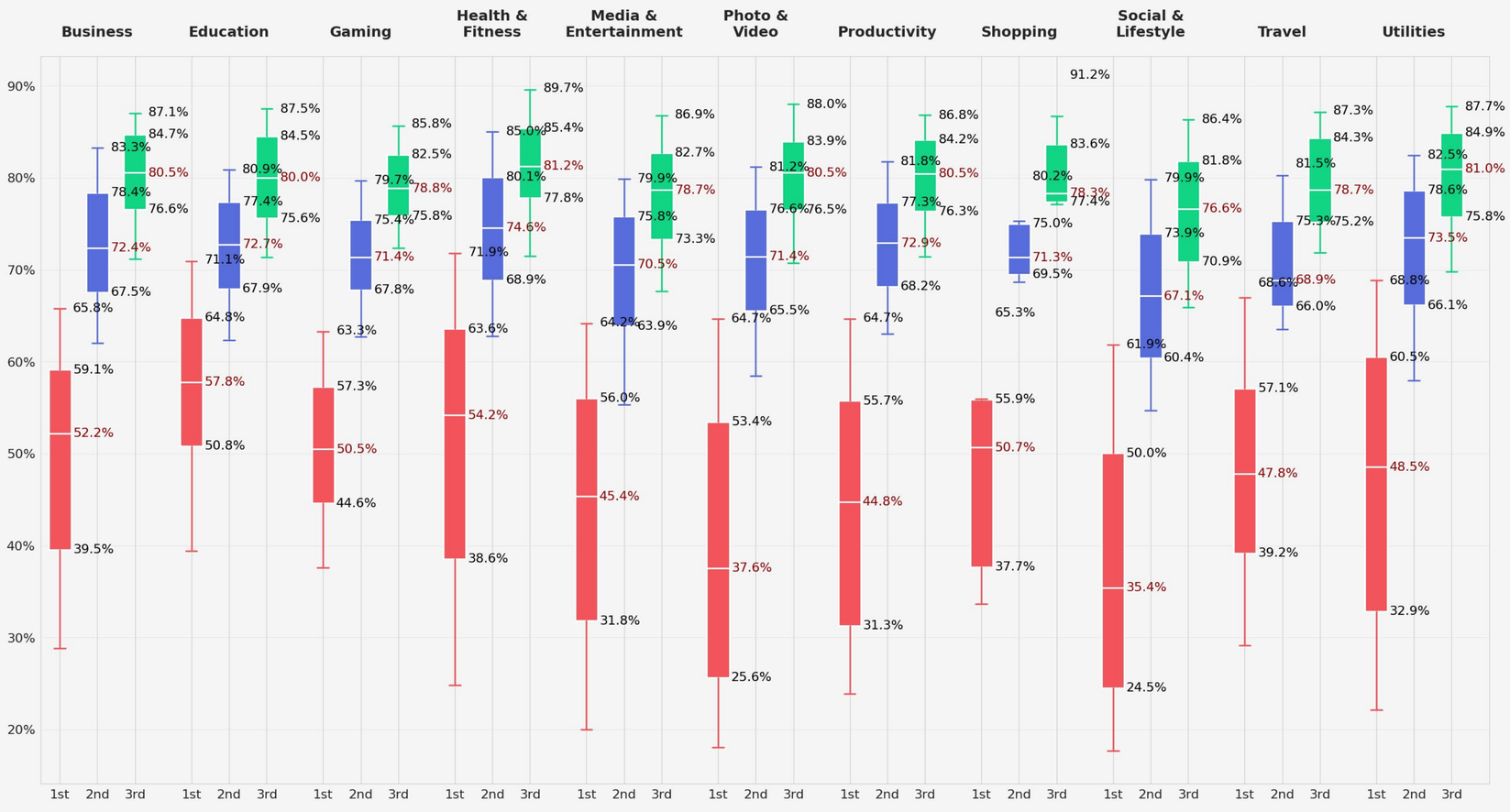
But here's the part most people miss: after a full year, retention looks almost the same regardless of which approach you use. The paywall type doesn't change who stays long term. It just changes how fast you get paid by the people who were always going to subscribe.

**Freemium apps convert users well into Week 6 and beyond.** If you're pulling ROAS reports at day seven, you're cutting off a big chunk of revenue that just hasn't landed yet and making scale decisions on incomplete data.

Figure out which model fits your app. Then build your reporting around it.

# First 3 weekly subscription renewals, by category

How do weekly renewal rates evolve across billing cycles?




## Key takeaway

Weekly renewals improve dramatically: 1st renewal 35–54%, jumping to 68–81% (2nd) and 74–85% (3rd).

## Benchmarks to know:

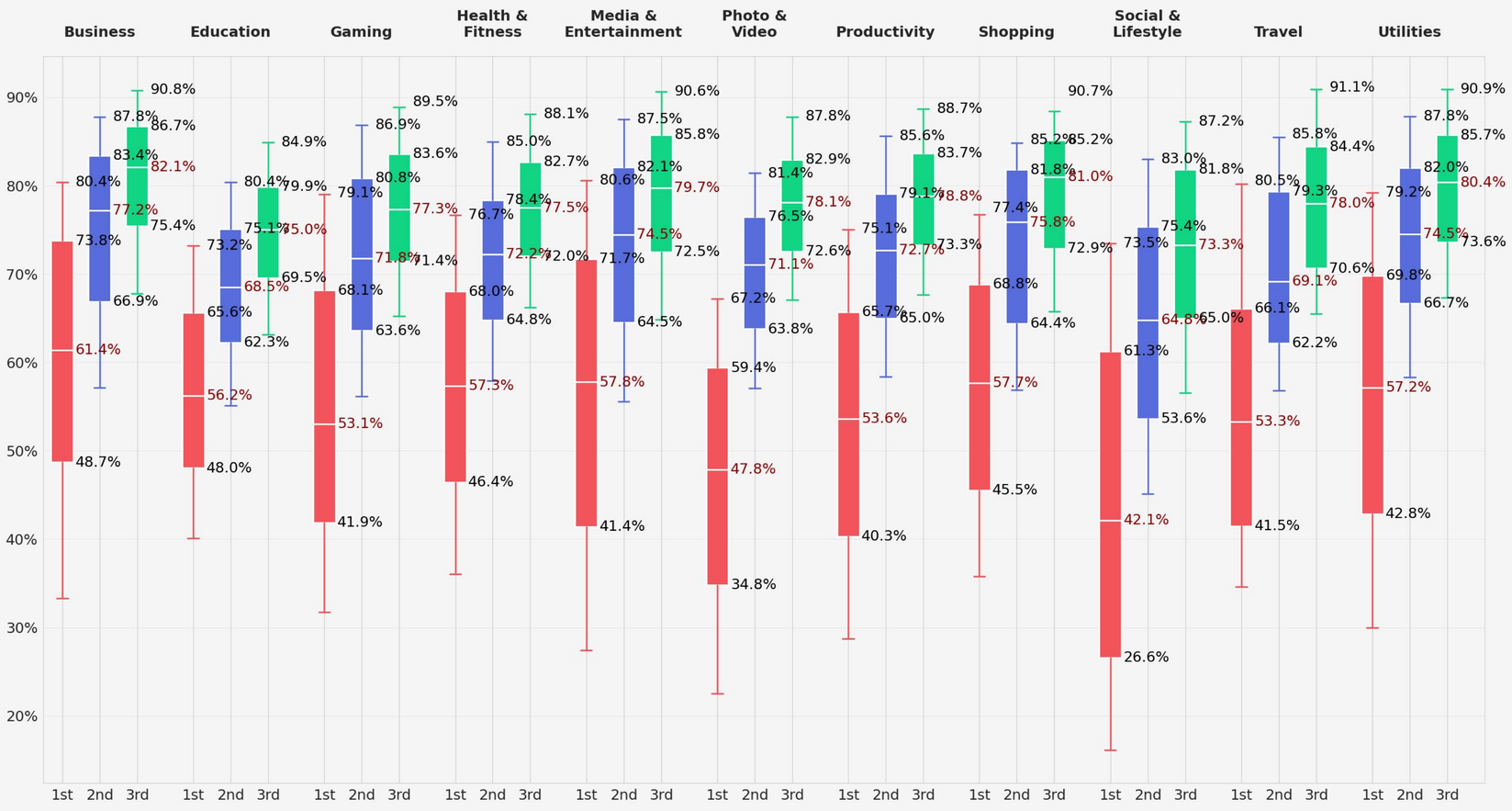
- 1st weekly renewal: median 35–58%
- 2nd weekly renewal: median 67–75%
- 3rd weekly renewal: median 77–81%
- Social & Lifestyle lowest across all renewals (35%)

## What stands out:

- 1st-to-2nd jump (~25–30%) is the critical inflection; surviving week 1 changes everything
- By 3rd renewal, all categories converge (74–91%), suggesting early selection dominates
- Social & Lifestyle: low 1st (35%) but mostly catches up to others by 3rd renewal (78%)

# First 3 monthly subscription renewals, by category

How do monthly renewal rates evolve across billing cycles?




## Key takeaway

Monthly follows a similar pattern to weekly: 1st renewal 53–61%, improving to 65–77% (2nd) and 73–82% (3rd).

## Benchmarks to know:

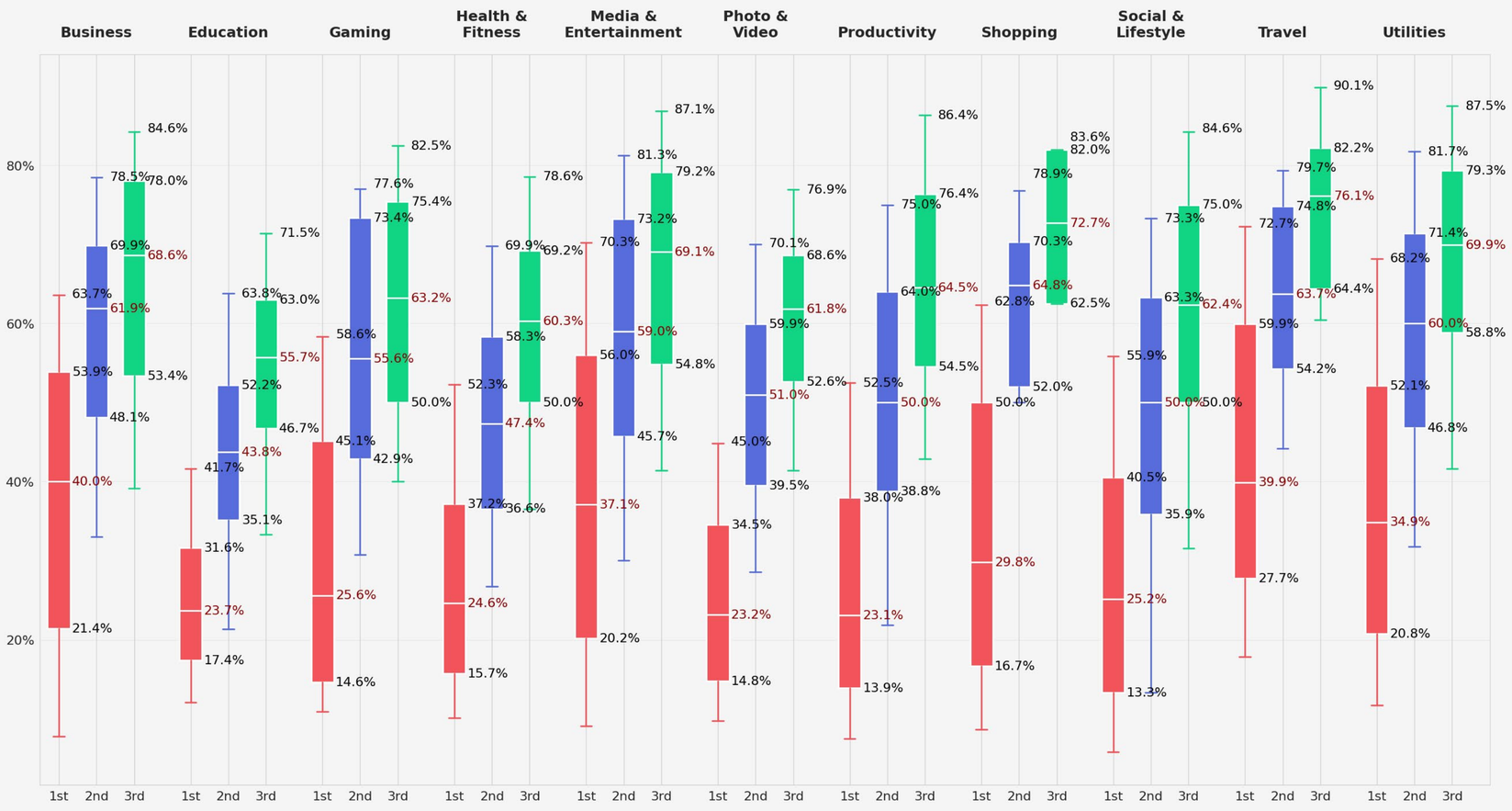
- 1st monthly renewal: median 53–61%
- 2nd monthly renewal: median 65–77%
- 3rd monthly renewal: median 73–82%
- Social & Lifestyle lowest 1st (42%); Business leads (61%)

## What stands out:

- Social & Lifestyle: weakest early (42%) but strong maturation (73% by 3rd)
- Business tightest distribution with higher overall retention each month

# First 3 annual subscription renewals, by category

How do annual renewal rates evolve across billing cycles?




## Key takeaway

Annual plans start lower but build loyalty: 1st renewal 24–47%, climbing to 52–70% (2nd) and 60–79% (3rd).

## Benchmarks to know:

- 1st annual renewal: median 23–40%
- 2nd annual renewal: median 44–64%
- 3rd annual renewal: median 56–70%
- Productivity lowest 1st (23%); Business leads (40%)

## What stands out:

- Annual 1st renewals lower than weekly/monthly — 12-month window creates more churn opportunities
- Survivors retain a much higher rates by 3rd renewal (60–79%)

# Most retention problems aren’t where we look for them

**Asya Paloni**
CPO, Welltory

**Reading through the benchmarks, a coupleof things I took for granted didn’t quite hold up.**

### Trials don’t create stickier users.

Freemium and hard paywall apps end up with almost identical year-one retention. Letting users try may increase how many convert, but it doesn’t seem to change how long they stay. Durability is about ongoing value, not paywall structure.

### Price risk hides in the first renewal.

Higher-priced annual plans lose more users at the first renewal (37% vs. 24%), but survivors behave similarly by the third cycle. Pricing doesn’t destroy long-term retention — it raises the bar at key checkpoints.

### Emerging markets aren’t “bad at retention.”

Most regional gaps show up in the first renewal and narrow over time. The issue looks more like early friction than weaker long-term loyalty.

### Users don’t leave because of better apps.

“Not enough usage” and “cost” dominate cancellations. In other words: value density matters more than competitive displacement.

Across the board, retention pressure concentrates around commitment and renewal moments. Retention doesn’t erode gradually — it breaks at commitment checkpoints. The real work is aligning expectation, price, and ongoing value at those moments.

# The Art of Driving Retention Through Product

**Ben Gammon**
Ladder

1. **Product-driven retention is the foundation for lifecycle marketing**

   Lifecycle marketing hacks and perfect push notifications won't save you if the core product doesn't deliver results. Work backwards from what users say in five-star reviews to identify the results that matter, then build the product loop around consistently delivering those results.

2. **Teach features in the moment, not in onboarding**

   Users adopt features at far higher rates when coached during the action itself. In-context prompts while users are actively engaged are far more effective than FAQs or standalone tutorials.

3. **Surveys beat user interviews for consumer product decisions**

   Individual interviews with five to ten users can lead you astray in diverse consumer markets. Large-scale recurring surveys provide stronger signal and reduce the risk of over-indexing on outlier feedback.

**Listen to Ben's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast**

Sub Club

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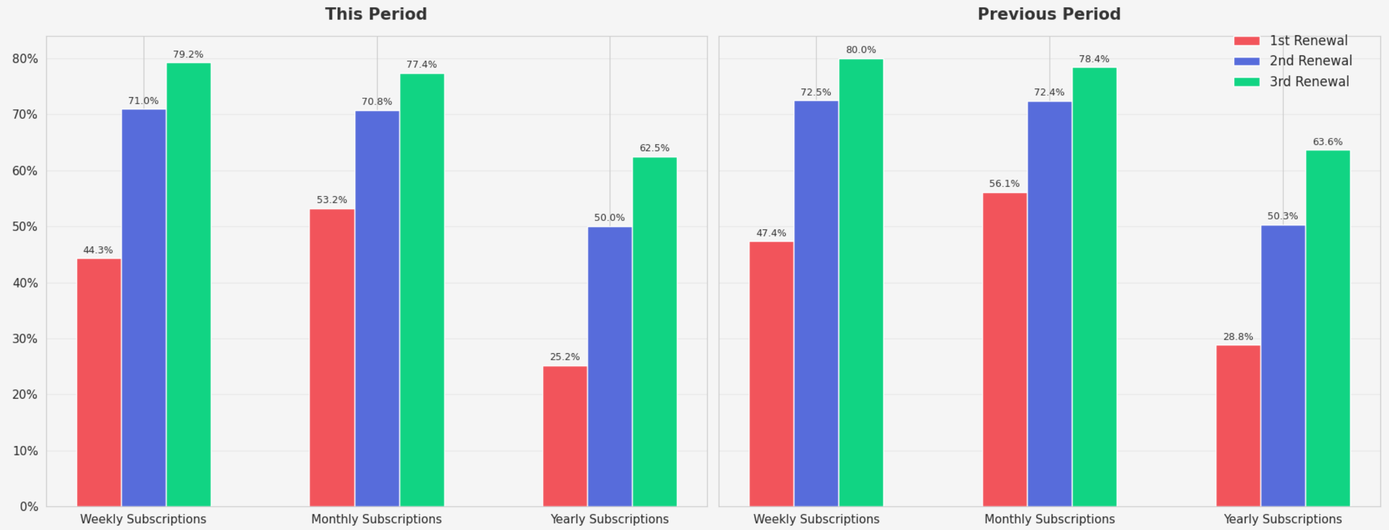
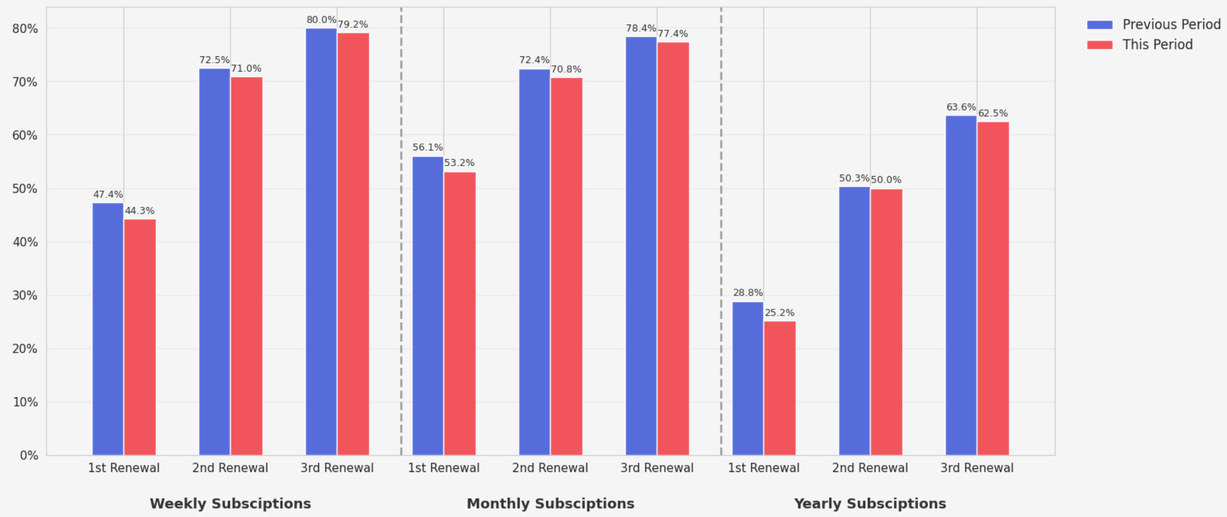
# Median renewal rates by subscription duration, compared to the previous period

How do median renewal rates compare by duration between 2024 and 2025?




## Key takeaway

Renewal rates declined slightly across the board, but not much.

## Benchmarks to know:

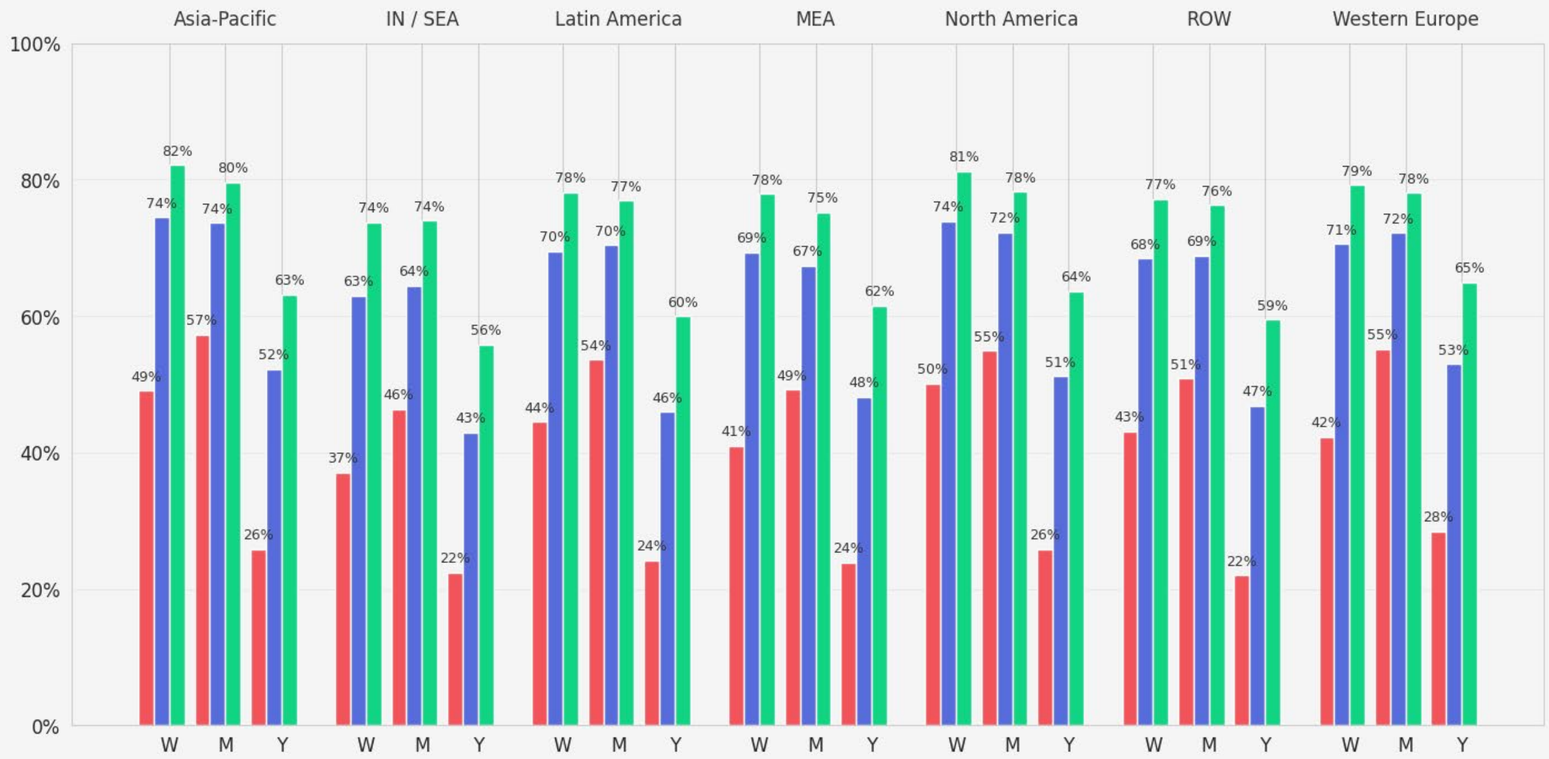
- Yearly 1st renewal dropped 3.6% — largest decline; 3rd renewals barely moved (~1%)
- Weekly and monthly 3rd renewals land at 77–79%; yearly lags at 62.5%
- The 1st-to-2nd renewal jump spans 18–27% — the critical retention inflection point

## What stands out:

- Monthly 1st renewal rates with the biggest change, up to 3.6%.
- 3rd renewal rates barely changed at all

# Median subscription renewal rates, by geography

How do renewal rates vary by geography and subscription duration?




## Key takeaway

North America and Asia-Pacific lead early renewals. IN/SEA trails by 10 to 15 percent on 1st renewals but every geography generally converges by the 3rd renewal.

## Benchmarks to know:

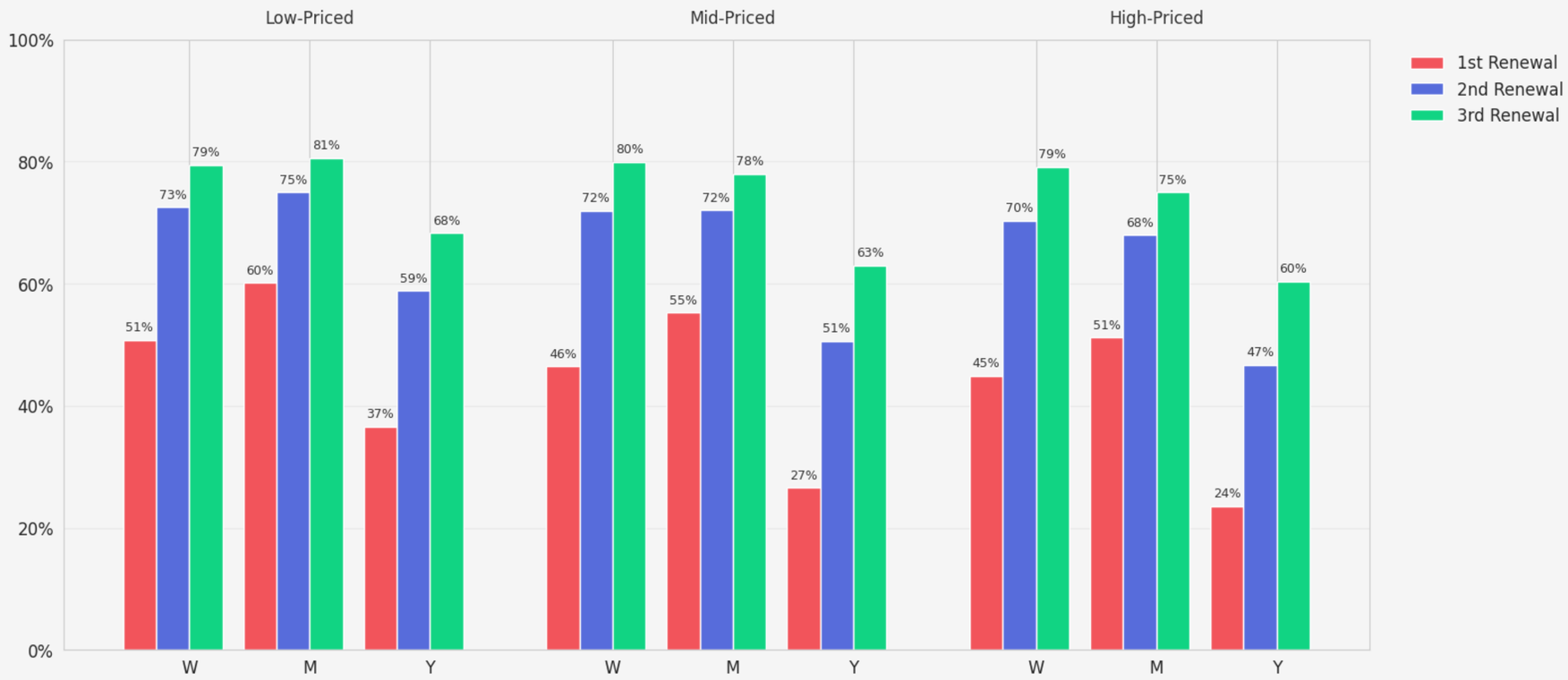
- Weekly 1st renewal: North America 55%, Western Europe 42%, IN/SEA 37%, Latin America 44%
- Monthly 1st renewal: North America 55%, Western Europe 55%, IN/SEA 46%
- Yearly 1st renewal: North America 26%, Western Europe 28%, IN/SEA 22%
- By the 3rd renewal, all geographies are within 5 to 10%.

## What stands out:

- IN/SEA 1st weekly renewal (37%) is 13% below North America.
- Convergence by 3rd renewal suggests quality users exist everywhere, just harder to find initially
- Geographical gaps are largest on weekly, smallest on yearly — committed annual buyers behave similarly globally.

# Median subscription renewal rates, by pricepoint

How do renewal rates vary by pricing tier and subscription duration?




## Key takeaway

Low-priced apps show better 1st renewals, but the gap narrows significantly by 3rd renewal. Gaps are more pronounced on yearly plans.

## Benchmarks to know:

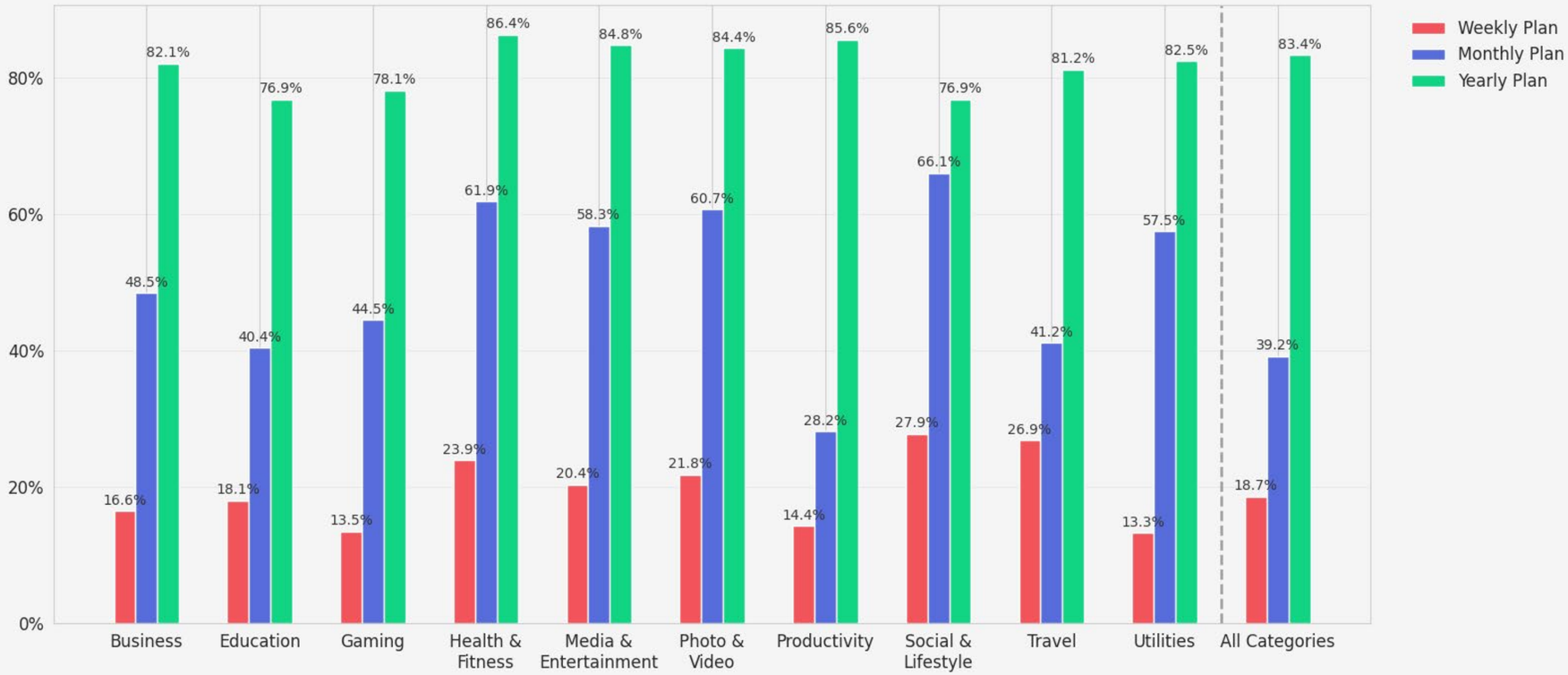
- Weekly 1st: Low 51%, Mid 46%, High 45%
- Monthly 1st: Low 60%, Mid 55%, High 51%
- Yearly 1st: Low 37%, Mid 27%, High 24%
- 3rd renewal converges to 68-81% across tiers

## What stands out:

- Price impact largest on yearly: low-priced 37% vs. high-priced 24% at 1st renewal
- High-priced lose more users early but retain survivors equally, showing 3rd renewal parity
- Monthly shows smallest price sensitivity (51-60% range)

# Active renewal rate, by category and plan duration

How do active renewal rates compare by category and plan duration?




### Key takeaway

Yearly plans renew at 83.4% overall — more than 4x weekly (18.7%) and roughly 2x monthly (39.2%). Across every category, yearly retention materially outperforms shorter durations.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly: 18.7% overall; above 25% is top-tier
- Monthly: 39.2% overall; below 35% signals weak retention
- Yearly: 83.4% overall; above 85% is strongest territory

### What stands out:

- Health & Fitness (86.4%) and Productivity (85.6%) lead yearly retention, both above 85%
- Productivity monthly retention (28.2%) is the clear laggard — 11pp below the 39.2% benchmark
- Every category shows yearly > monthly > weekly, reinforcing annual plans as the highest-quality billing relationship.

# Segment benchmarks for retention

**Jeff Morris**
Founder and General Partner, Chapter One

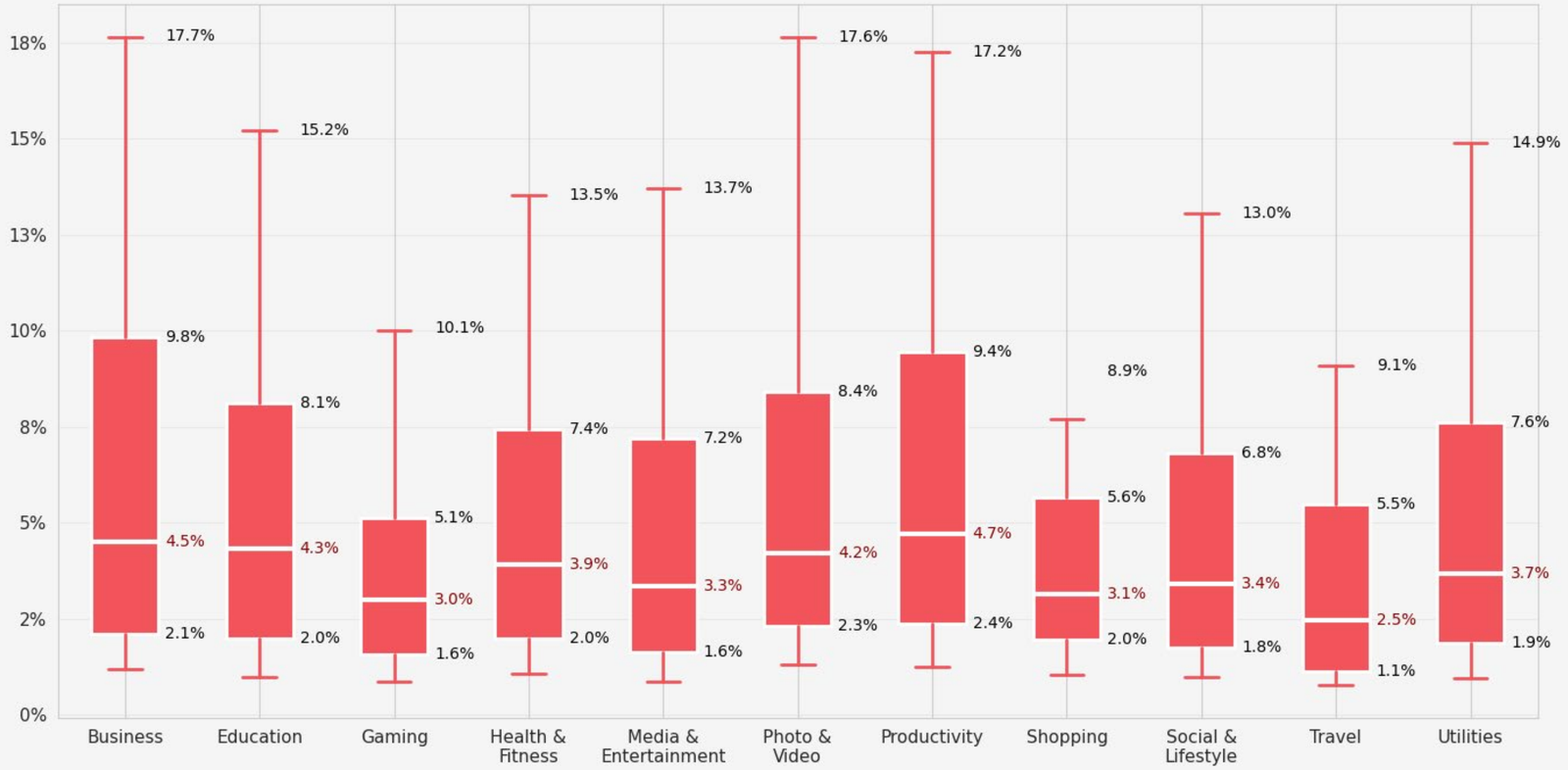
**The detailed retention and renewal data by geography and pricepoint emphasizes that while core retention is fundamentally tied to plan duration (yearly > monthly > weekly), market and pricing context introduce critical modulation.**

The finding that **low-priced annual plans retain better (36% Y1 median vs. 23% for high-priced)** is a powerful reminder that 'value' retention is as important as 'product' retention. Low-priced apps successfully lock in a large, less price-sensitive segment of annual subscribers, who demonstrate higher commitment than even the high-intent payers of premium apps.

Geographically, the **global convergence of renewal rates by the third cycle** is the most significant finding. Despite North America leading initial weekly renewal (55%) and IN/SEA trailing (37%), by the 3rd renewal, all geographies cluster tightly around 77–81%. This implies that high-quality, product-loyal users exist everywhere. The challenge in emerging markets isn't long-term retention of a good user, but rather **acquiring the good user and overcoming initial billing or usage friction** (as seen in the low 1st renewal rates). The global parity at the 3rd renewal suggests that once the 'fit' is found, geographic differences in retention largely disappear.

# Refund rate, by app category

What are typical refund rates by category?




## Key takeaway

Productivity leads at 4.7% median refund rate while Travel apps see lowest refunds at 2.5%, a 2.2% spread across categories.

## Benchmarks to know:

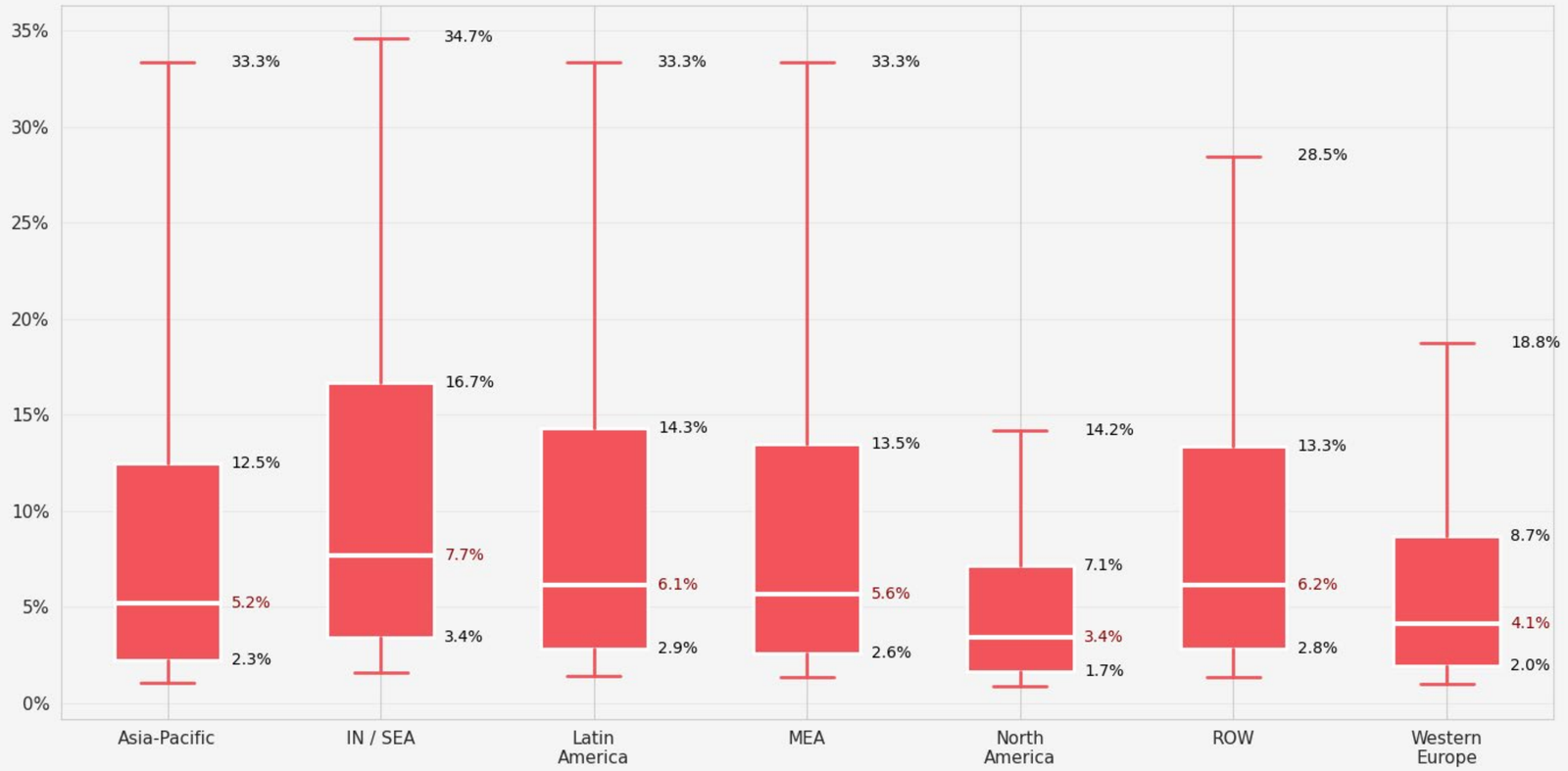
- Most categories cluster between 3–4% refund rate
- Outlier apps can reach 9–18% refund rates

## What stands out:

- Productivity, Business, and Photo & Video's higher refund rate (including higher p75 & outlier) may reflect that cohort better understands the refund procedure on the stores
- Travel and Gaming both have lower median rates, but also a tighter spread across the quartiles

# Refund rate, by geography

How much variance exists in geographic refund rates?




## Key takeaway

IN/SEA leads with a 7.7% median refund rate; North America's is significantly lower at 3.4%.

## Benchmarks to know:

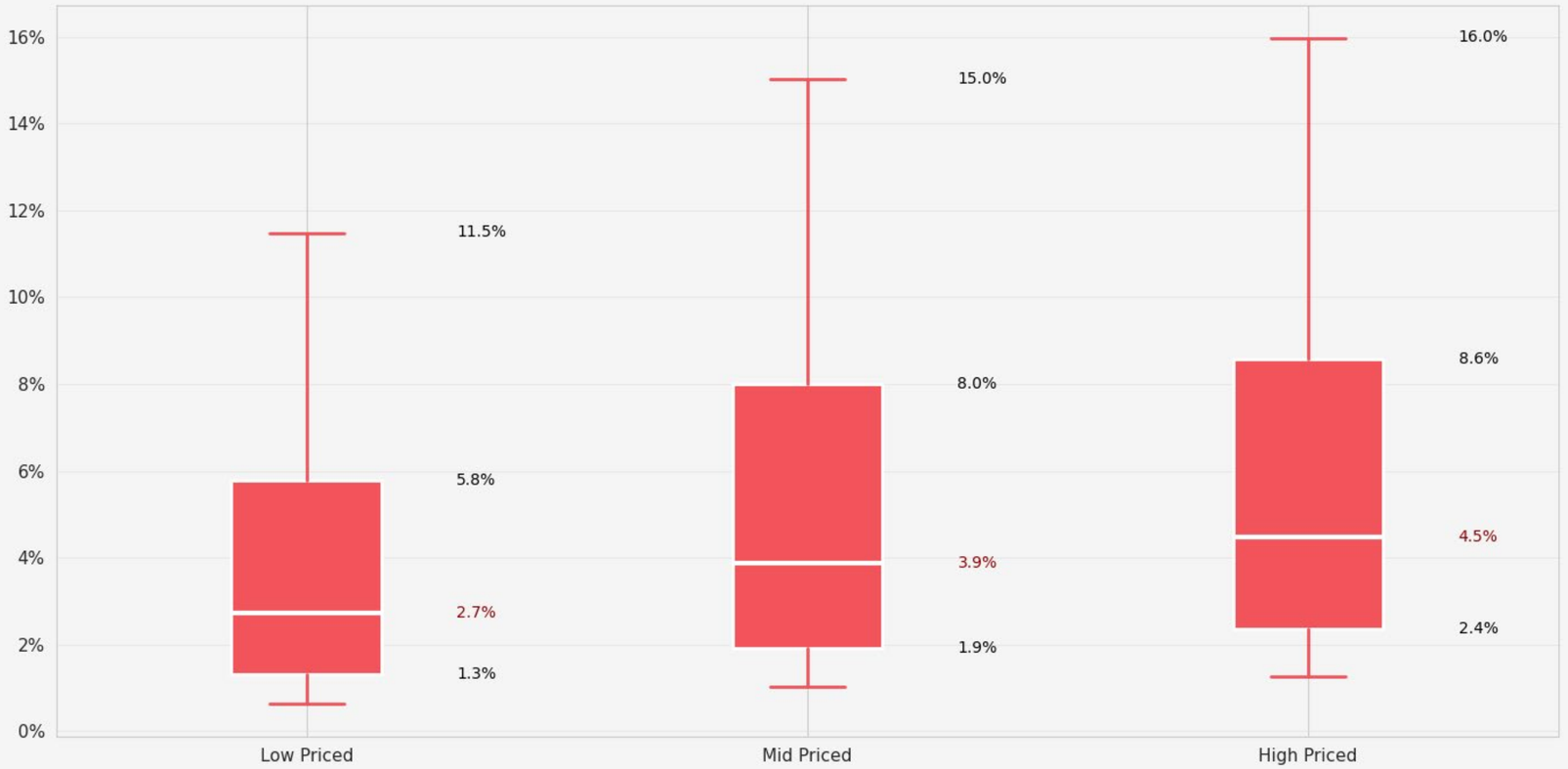
- Outliers refund rates in Asia-Pacific, IN/SEA, Latin America, and Middle East-Africa are in the 30s.
- P25–P75 range: 2–8% for all geographies

## What stands out:

- North America shows tightest distribution (3.4% median, 14.2% max) — most predictable market
- Emerging markets (APAC, LATAM, IN/SEA) show widest variance — highly app-dependent outcomes

# Refund rate, by pricepoint

## Does pricing tier affect refund rates?




### Key takeaway

Price increases do clearly correlate to higher refund rates (2.2% increase from low price to high price)

### Benchmarks to know:

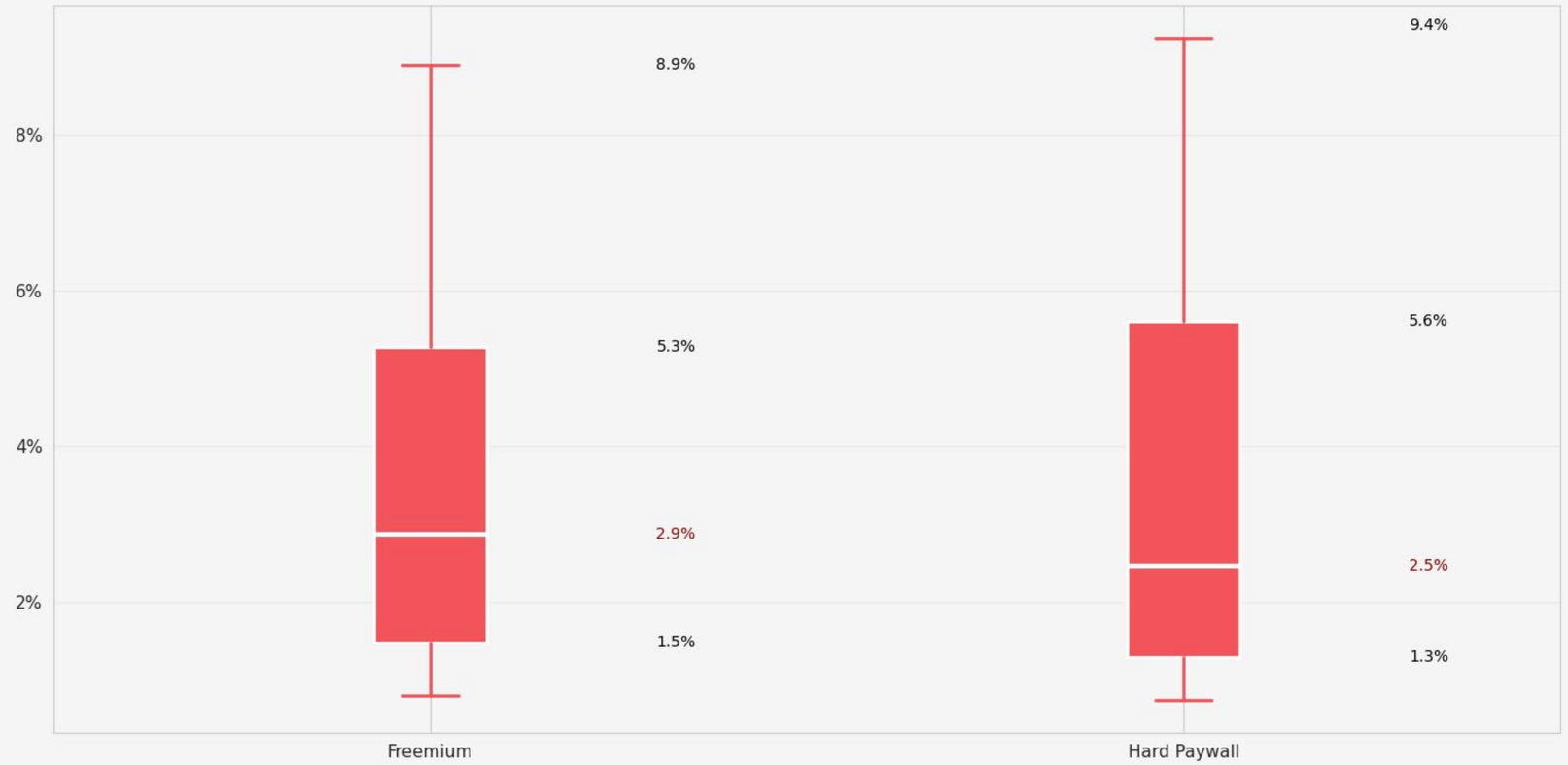
- Low-priced median: 2.7%
- Mid-priced median: 3.9%
- High-priced median: 4.5%
- Outlier refund rates: 11–16% across tiers

### What stands out:

- Higher price = higher refund rate: each tier step adds ~1% to median
- High-priced apps show widest distribution
- Low-priced tier has tightest distribution
- Premium apps reaching 16% refunds might represent overpriced subscriptions

# Refund rate, by access method

Does access method impact refund rates?




## Key takeaway

Hard paywall apps show 2.5% median refund rate vs. freemium's 2.9%, probably just noise.

## Benchmarks to know:

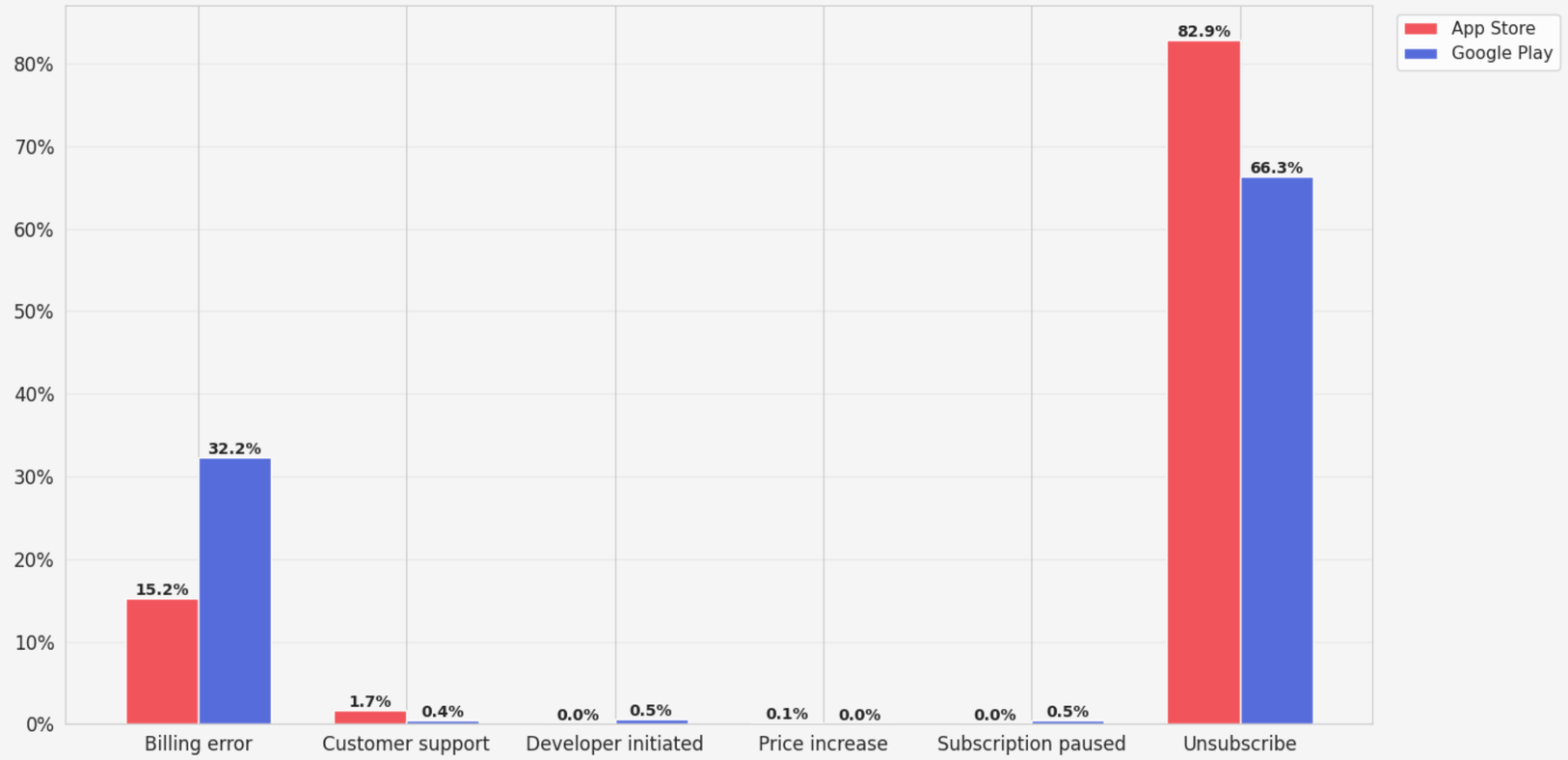
- P25–P75: 1.5–5.3% (freemium) vs. 1.3–5.6% (paywall)
- Max refund rates: ~9% for both models

## What stands out:

- Distribution shapes nearly identical; access method isn't a refund rate lever

# Cancellation reasons, by app store

Why do subscriptions end on each platform?




## Key takeaway

Billing errors account for 32.2% of Google Play cancellations versus 15.2% on the App Store — more than a 2x gap.

## Benchmarks to know:

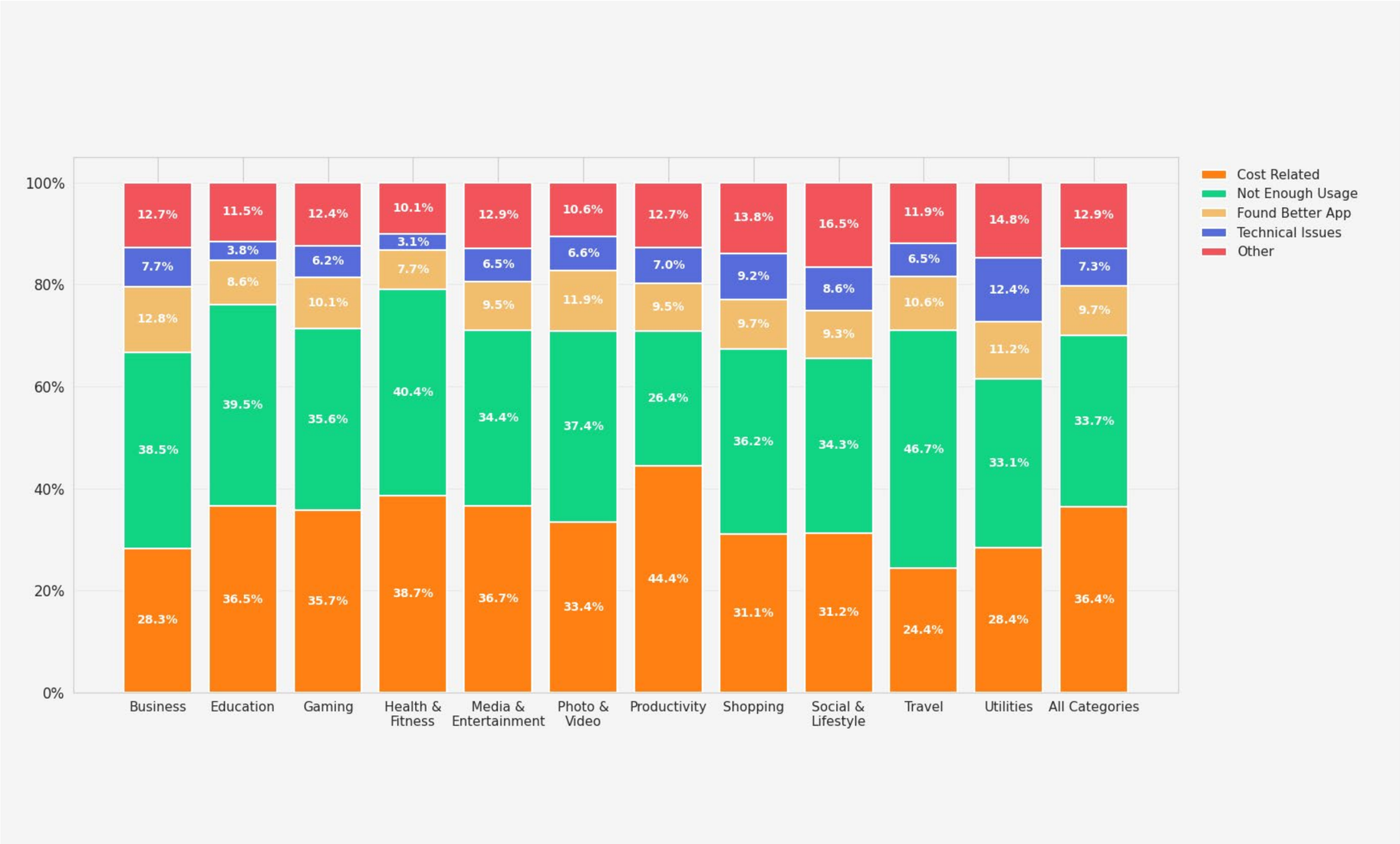
- App Store: 82.9% unsubscribe, 15.2% billing error
- Google Play: 66.3% unsubscribe, 32.2% billing error
- Developer-initiated, price increase, and pauses each represent ≤0.5% on both platforms

## What stands out:

- Voluntary unsubscribes dominate on both platforms, especially on the App Store (82.9% vs. 66.3% on Play)
- Billing errors are structurally higher on Google Play — a 17pp gap versus iOS
- Non-user-driven cancellations (developer-initiated, price changes) are statistically negligible (<1%), meaning churn is overwhelmingly user choice or payment failure
- The primary platform difference is not unsubscribe behavior — it's billing reliability.

# Google Play churn survey answers, by category

## Why do users cancel subscriptions?




### Key takeaway

Price and not enough usage are dominant, but it varies by category.

### Benchmarks to know:

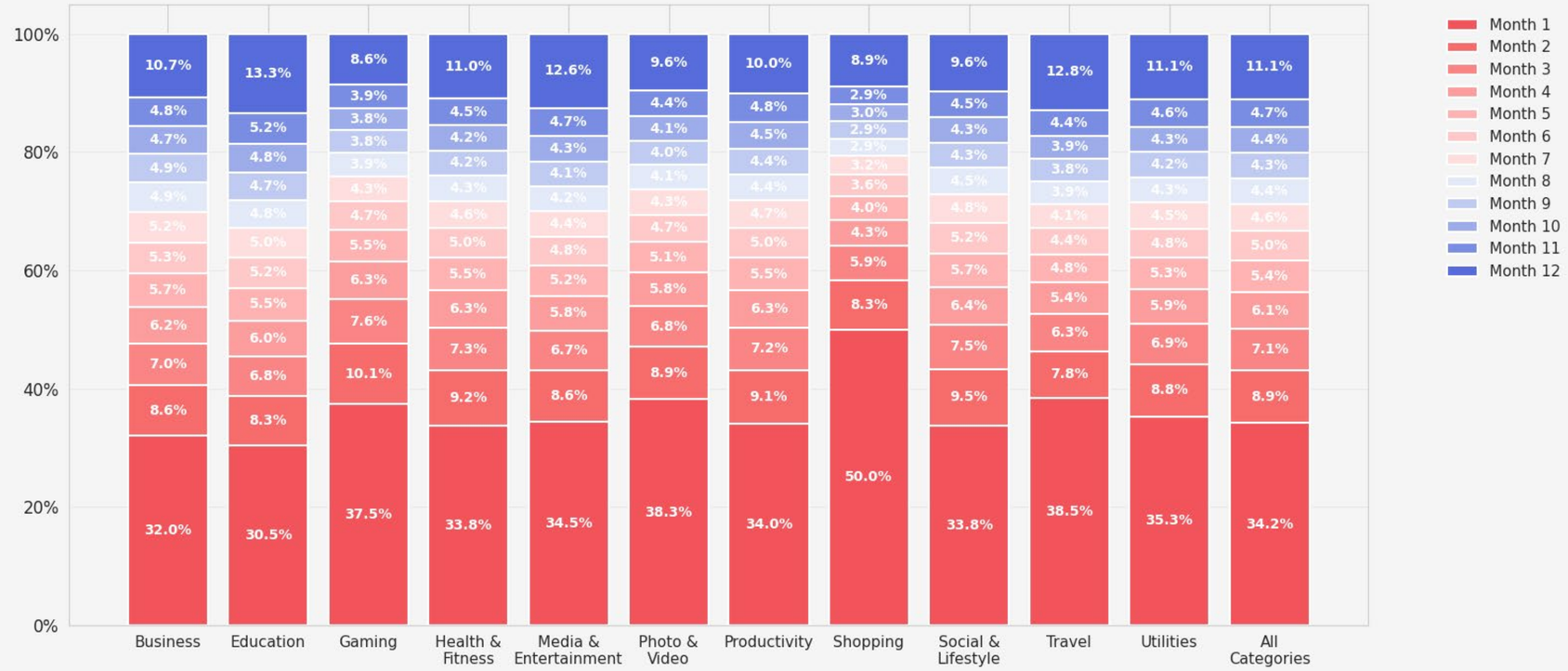
- ‘Cost Related’ churn reasons are between 25-45% for all categories
- ‘Not Enough Usage’ churn reasons are between 26-40% for all categories
- Technical issues are generally not the primary cause of churn, 3-7% for most categories

### What stands out:

- Productivity seems most price sensitive (or apps are overpriced) with 44% ‘Cost Related’
- Travel has highest ‘Not Enough Usage’ – perhaps reflecting the shorter term use case of Travel-related apps

# Cancellation timeline for annual subscriptions

When do annual subscribers cancel during their first year?




## Key takeaway

Month 1 accounts for 35% of all annual cancellations overall, decaying to ~5% mid-year before a Month 12 uptick (11%).

## Benchmarks to know:

- Month 1: 23–50% of annual cancellations (varies widely by category)
- Month 2: 8–10%; Months 3–11: 3–7% each
- Month 12 (pre-renewal): 9–14% across categories.

## What stands out:

- Shopping's Month 1 share of cancellations (~50%) is roughly 20% higher than Education (~30%)
- Month 12 uptick is universal; all categories show 9–14%.

# We built an AI agent to talk to our own data

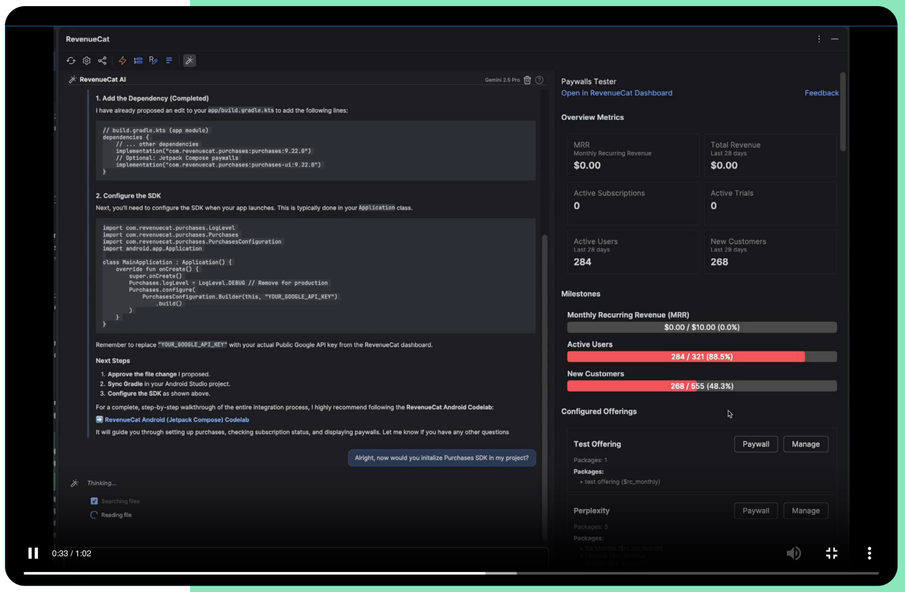
**So nearly a third of Google Play churn is involuntary. A billing failure, not a user choice. Would you have spotted that in your own data?**

**We built an AI agent that does. It connects to your RevenueCat data and can answer questions in seconds.**

**Here's a look at what's possible:**

- Conversational analytics: Instead of building reports, we can now just ask questions in plain English, like "What was our MRR from new users in Germany last month?" or "What's our trial conversion rate for users who came from a specific campaign?"
- Automated insights: The agent can automatically pull data, analyze trends, and surface insights that would have taken quite some dashboard browsing to find manually.

**You will be able to set up your own agent very soon. Stay tuned!**




Get inspired and see what's possible with AI

# Retention and billing health: key takeaways

Across billing intervals, early retention remains structurally strong — but year-on-year compression is visible, especially on annual plans. Weekly subscriptions still convert into high second/third-cycle renewals (median ~68–81% and 74–85%), and monthly follows a similar arc (53–75% 1st renewal to 74–86% by third). Annual plans start lower (24–47%) but climb meaningfully by renewal two and three (52–70% and 60–79%).

The bigger signal: Y1 retention has declined vs. the previous period. Annual median fell from 31% to 28% (–3pp), monthly from 10% to 8% (–2pp), while weekly remains ~1%. Annual still anchors lifetime value (LTV), but it's also where the softening is most visible. Pricing tier and access model show far less impact on retention than duration and category.

## What stands out

- Annual drives LTV, but is slipping: annual Y1 median retention is 28% (down from 31%). By contrast, weekly sits near 1% and monthly at 8%. Long-duration plans still define value capture, but pressure is emerging at the top.
- Renewal curves steepen after cycle one: weekly 1st renewal is ~35–54%, jumping to 68–81% on renewal two. Monthly shows the same pattern (53–75% → 72–83%). The 1st renewal remains the critical inflection point.
- Duration outweighs pricing and access model: low-, mid-, and high-priced annual plans cluster at 36%, 26%, and 23% year-one median retention, respectively. Freemium (28%) and hard paywall (27%) are nearly identical — access model is not a retention lever.
- Category dispersion is wide: Travel annual retention reaches ~39%, while Social & Lifestyle sits near 25%. Media & Entertainment shows the widest annual variance (~37–68%). Category dynamics materially shape renewal ceilings.
- Refund and billing health vary more by platform and region than model: Google Play billing errors (32.2%) are more than 2x the App Store's (15.2%). Refund medians cluster around 3–5% across pricing tiers and access models, with geography driving wider variance (e.g. IN/SEA higher spread, North America tighter).

# Access your subscription data via API

**This report gives you the benchmarks. But what about your own data? What if you could ask specific questions and get instant answers?**

**With the new Charts API, you can:**

- Pull your analytics into any tool: With the new Charts API, you can programmatically access your subscription data and pull it into any BI tool, custom dashboard, or application you use.
- Let an AI analyze your data for you: We've seen some amazing results by connecting the Charts API to AI platforms like ChatGPT, OpenClaw and Claude.

**Reduce your support burden and empower your customers with self-serve tools and a support team that has all the information they need at their fingertips.**

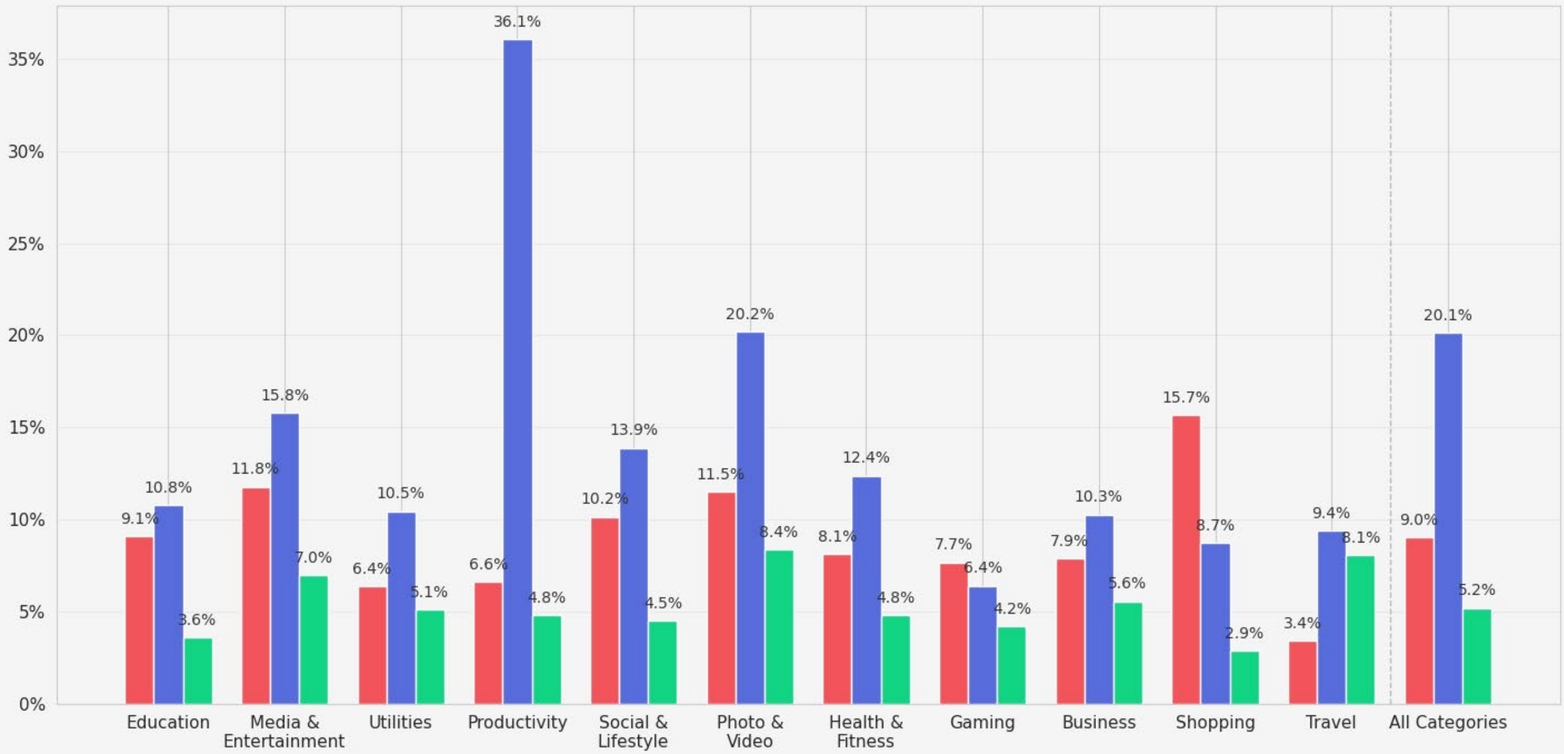
Explore the Charts API documentation

# 07

# Reactivation and post-churn behavior

# Reactivation rate within 1 year, by app category

How often do churned subscribers reactivate?




### Key takeaway

Monthly plan churners reactivate at 20% overall; weekly at 9%, annual at just 5% — shorter commitments enable winbacks. Productivity apps (largely AI apps) demonstrate an extreme reactivation rate.

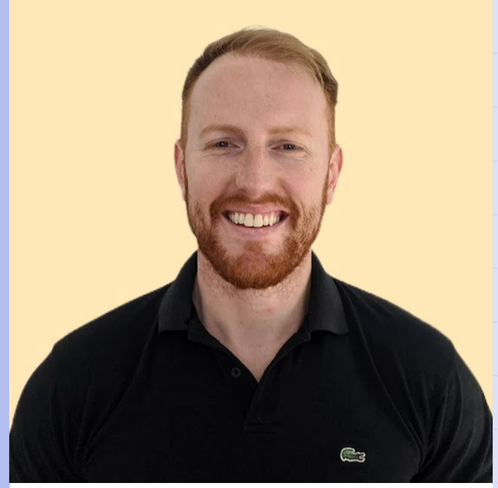
### Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly reactivation: 3–16% by category
- Monthly reactivation: 6–36% by category
- Annual reactivation: 3–8% by category

### What stands out:

- Productivity's 36% monthly reactivation is exceptional; SaaS 'come back when needed' behavior
- Shopping weekly reactivation (16%) 5x its annual rate (3%) shows transactional, seasonal usage patterns
- Travel shows lowest weekly (3.4%) but strong annual (8%); users return for next big trip
- Gaming churners rarely return (6–8% across durations), once lost, gone forever
- Photo & Video monthly (20%) outperforms annual (8%) with project-based workflows vs. committed hobbyists

# Users reactivate when the problem comes back, not when your win-back email lands



**Dan Layfield**
Founder, Subscription Index

**The best products at win-back strategies serve a problem that reoccurs in the user's life.**

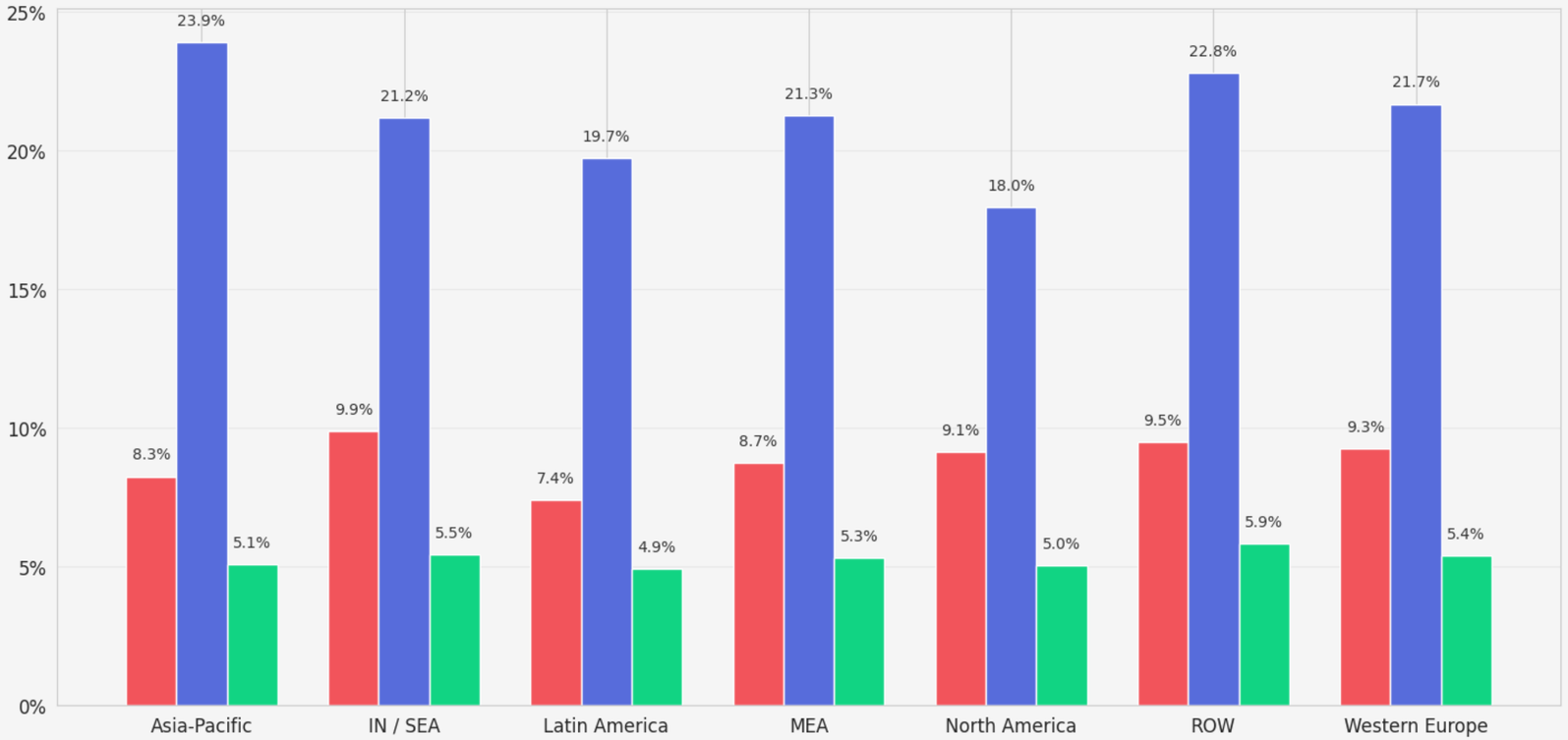
Think about dating apps — you cancel when you're in a relationship and come back when it ends. The same pattern plays out in fitness, entertainment, and any category where need is cyclical.

The brands winning at reactivation aren't optimizing campaigns — they delivered a great product, maintained a relationship after cancellation through ancillary value, and made it frictionless to return.

Let users pause instead of cancel, and don't make them dig out their credit card to come back.

# Reactivation rate within 1 year, by geography

Does user location influence the reactivation rate?




## Key takeaway

Monthly plans (often led by AI apps) consistently drive the highest reactivation across every geography, with a relatively tight band (18.0% – 23.9%), while yearly plans cluster narrowly around ~5%

## Benchmarks to know:

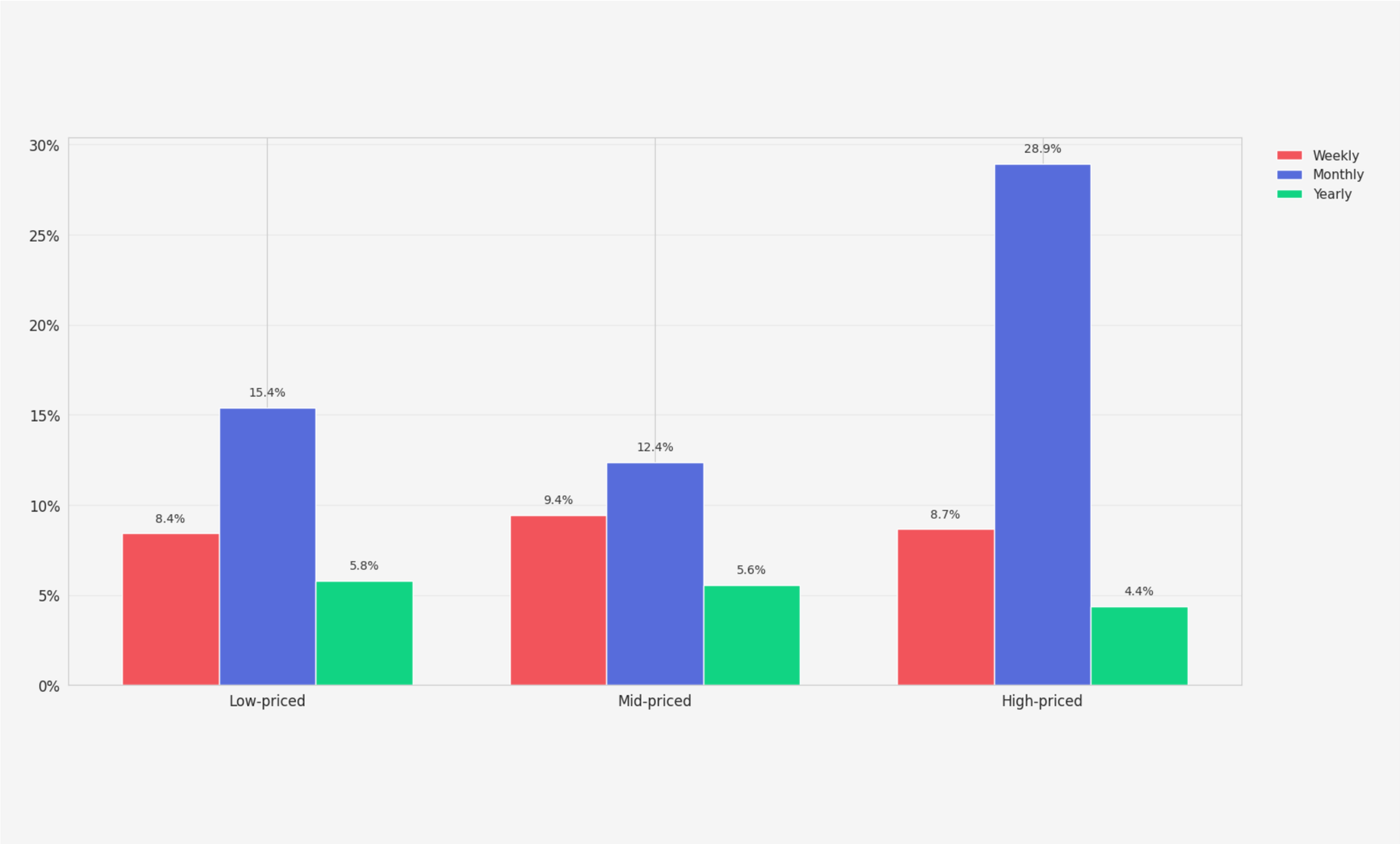
- Weekly: 7–10% across geographies
- Monthly: 18–24% across geographies
- Annual: 5–6% across geographies

## What stands out:

- Geographical variance is surprisingly narrow; reactivation behavior is more universal than acquisition or retention
- Asia-Pacific's 24% monthly + lowest yearly (5%) suggests higher churn tolerance in exchange for flexibility
- North America's 18% monthly is the global floor: US users are more decisive/permanent about cancellations
- Annual reactivation converges globally (4.9–5.9%) — churned annual subscribers rarely return regardless of geography

# Reactivation rate within 1 year, by pricepoint

Does pricing tier affect the likelihood of a user reactivating?




## Key takeaway

Monthly subscribers are the most likely to come back. High-priced apps see the strongest winback on monthly plans.

## Benchmarks to know:

- Weekly: 8–9% across price tiers
- Monthly: 12–29% by tier
- Annual: 4–6% by tier

## What stands out:

- High-priced monthly (29%) vs. annual (4%) is the widest gap
- Low-priced apps show most balanced reactivation (8/15/6%): price isn't the friction for return
- Mid-priced monthly (12%) underperforms both ends, likely a 'stuck in the middle' value perception challenge
- Weekly rates flat across tiers (8–9%): price irrelevant for ultra-short commitment winbacks
- High-priced annual churners (4.4%) are truly lost; they made a considered decision and won't revisit

# Retention and reactivation: key takeaways

Reactivation is meaningful, but highly plan-dependent. Globally, monthly plans show reactivation rates from 18–24% across regions, while weekly plans cluster around 7–10%. Annual plans sit much lower at 4–6%. Category spread is wide: monthly reactivation ranges from 6–36% depending on vertical. Geography matters just as much: Asia-Pacific leads on monthly reactivation (24%), while North America lags (18%). Pricing tier also shapes behavior: high-priced monthly subscriptions show 28.9% reactivation, vs. 15.4% for low-priced plans. Annual reactivation remains tightly constrained across regions and tiers (~4–6%), suggesting that long-term churn is structurally harder to reverse. Overall, reactivation benchmarks are drastically impacted by plan mix, region, and price band.

## What stands out

- Monthly plans dominate reactivation: across every geography, monthly reactivation (18–24%) materially exceeds weekly (7–10%) and annual (4–6%). Shorter commitments appear easier to restart, but not all short plans perform equally.
- Category variance is extreme: monthly reactivation ranges from as low as 6% in some categories to as high as 36.1% in Productivity. Shopping weekly reactivation reaches 15.7%, well above the 7–10% regional weekly range.
- Asia-Pacific leads; North America trails: Asia-Pacific has 24% monthly reactivation with 5.1% annual. North America shows 18% monthly and 5.0% annual — suggesting stronger cancellation finality in mature markets.
- High-priced monthly plans win back best: high-priced monthly subscriptions reactivate at 28.9%, versus 15.4% for low-priced and 12.4% for mid-priced. By contrast, high-priced annual reactivation is just 4.4%.
- Annual churn is largely permanent: whether by region (4.9–5.9%) or price tier (4.4–5.6%), annual reactivation remains consistently low. Once annual subscribers leave, very few return within a year.

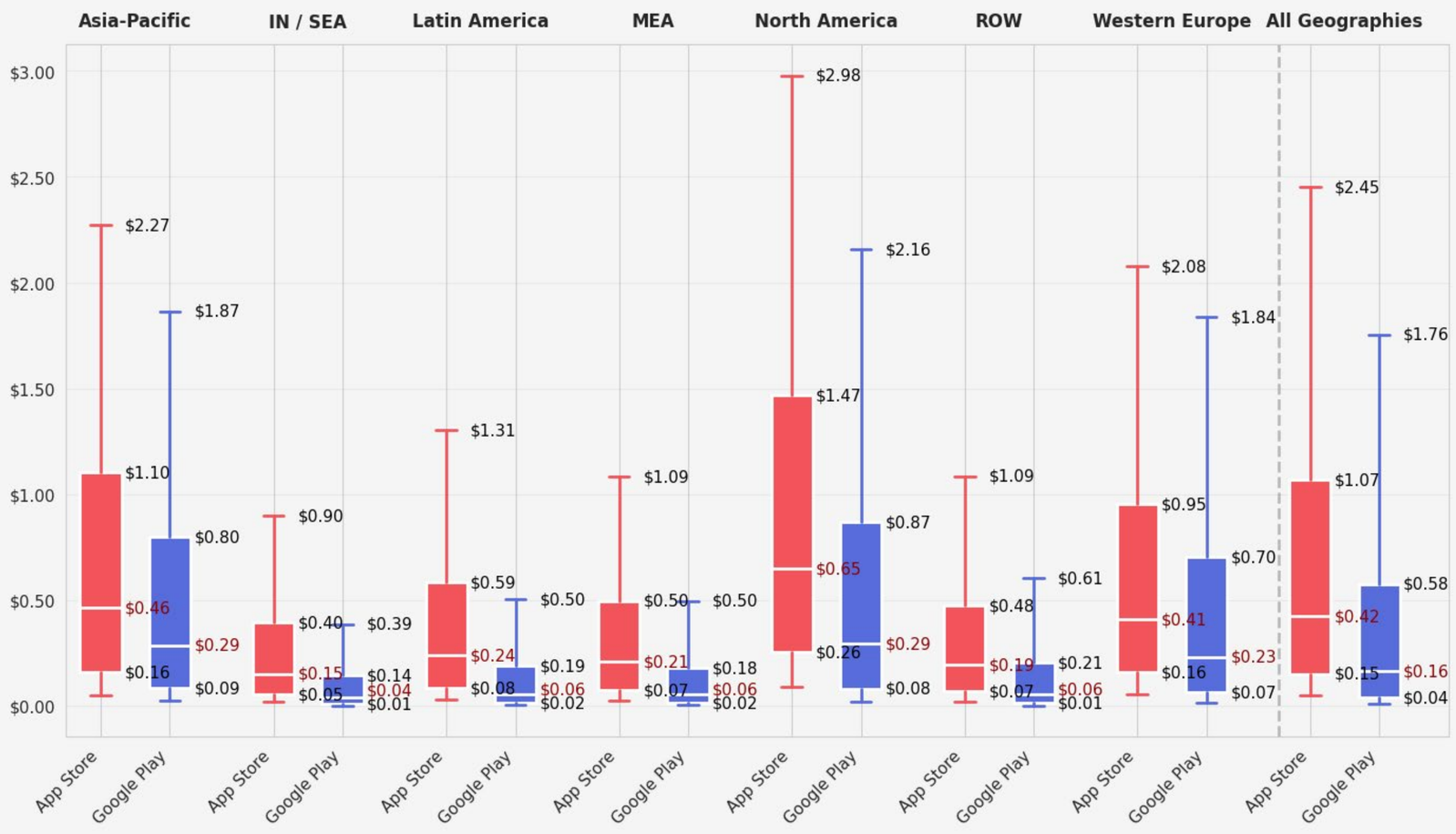
# 08 Categories, segments, and regions


Apple vs. Google 138–148
Native vs. cross-platform 149–156
AI vs. non-AI 157–167

CATEGORY BREAKOUTS

Business 170–183
Education 185–198
Gaming 199–212
Health & Fitness 213–226
Media & Entertainment 227–240
Photo & Video 241–254
Productivity 255–268
Shopping 269–282
Social & Lifestyle 283–296
Travel 297–310
Utilities 311–324

# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by store and geography




## Key takeaway

The App Store generates 2.6x higher D60 RPI globally, with a median of $0.42 compared to $0.16 on Google Play. North America leads performance on both stores, while IN/SEA trails behind on both iOS and Android.

## Benchmarks to know:

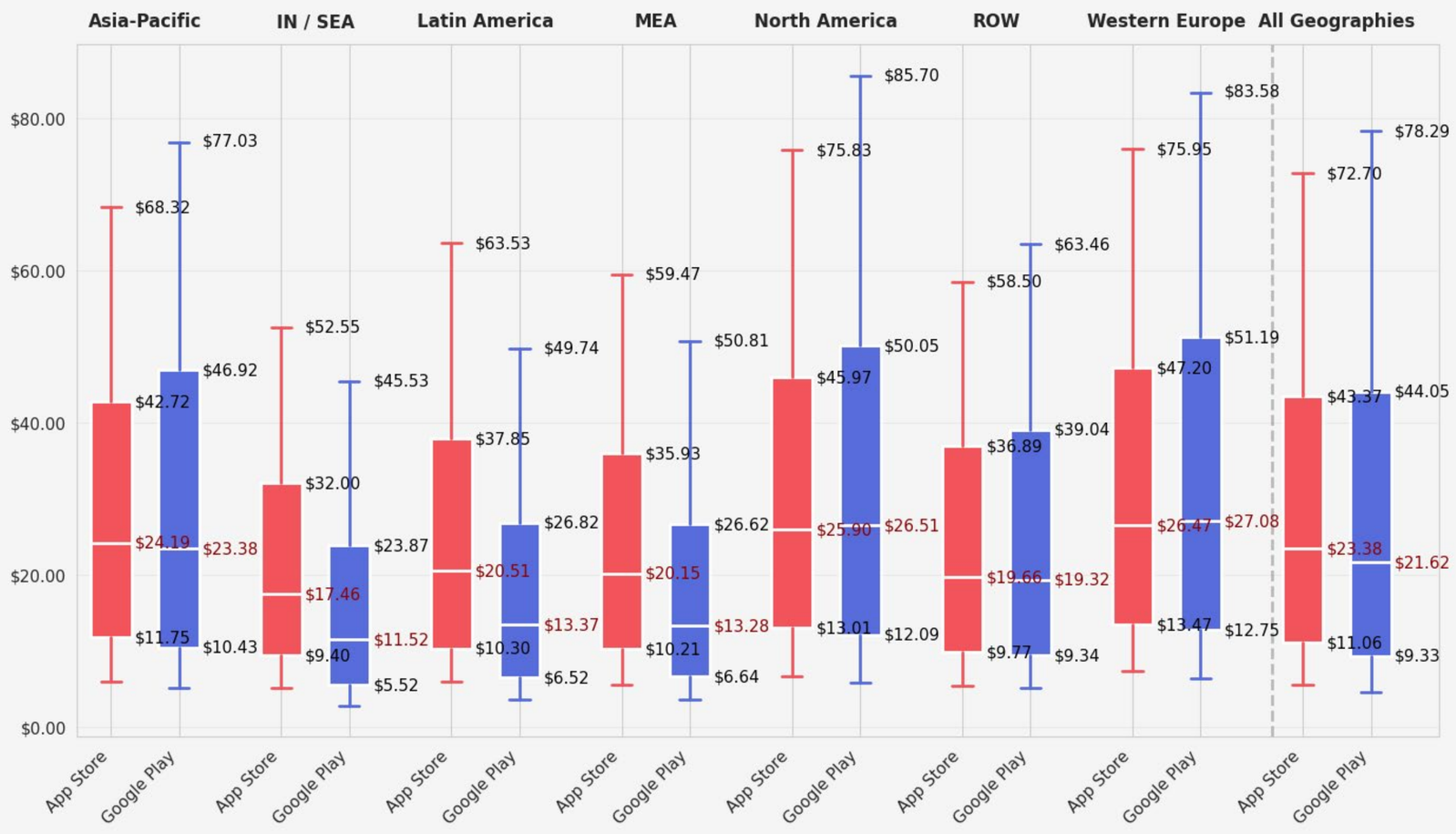
- Global median: App Store $0.42, Google Play $0.16
- North America highest: iOS $0.65, Android $0.26
- IN/SEA lowest: iOS $0.15, Android $0.04

## What stands out:

- iOS premium holds across all seven geographies without exception
- North America shows widest gap with 2.5× ratio at median
- Top-tier iOS in North America reaches $1.47, nearly 6× its Android counterpart

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 year, by store and geography

Does the App Store advantage persist in long-term payer value?




## Key takeaway

Y1 RLTV largely converges across stores. Globally, the median App Store lifetime value (LTV) is $23.38 vs. $21.62 on Google Play — an ~8% difference. This is a sharp compression from the ~2.6× gap seen at D60, suggesting monetization differences narrow materially over time.

## Benchmarks to know:

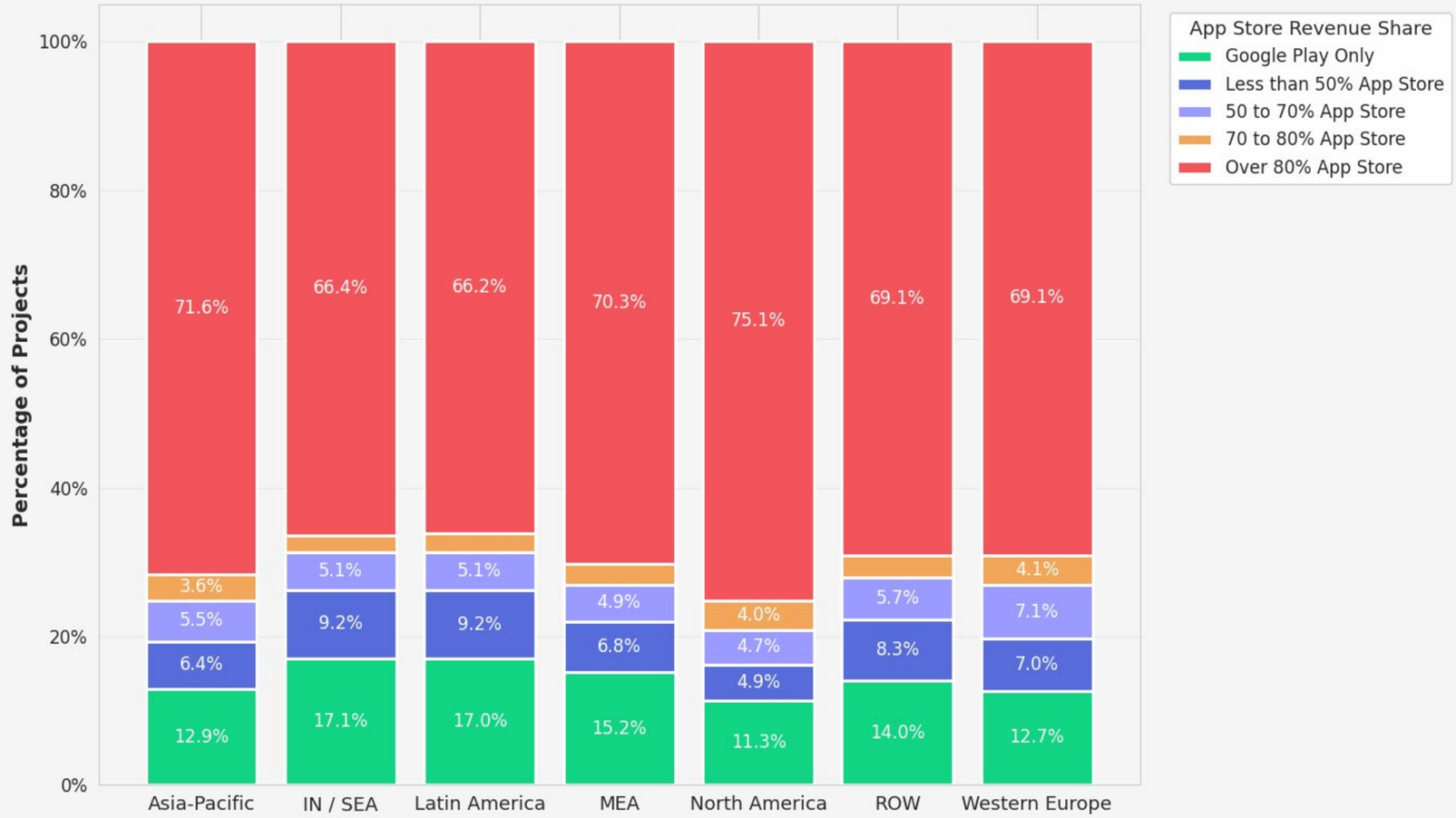
- Global median: App Store $23.38, Google Play $21.62
- Western Europe leads across both stores: $27.08 (Google Play) and $26.47 (iOS)
- IN/SEA has the lowest medians: $17.46 (iOS) and $11.52 (Google Play)

## What stands out:

- ROW shows near-parity: $19.66 vs. $19.32
- Top-tier Android payers in North America and Asia-Pacific exceed iOS ($85.70 and $77.03 respectively)
- Western Europe's Google Play slightly exceeds iOS at the median, reversing the early iOS advantage seen at D60.

# Platform revenue split, by geography

What share of revenue comes from App Store vs. Google Play in each geography?




## Key takeaway

Across every geography, 66–75% of projects derive over 80% of their revenue from the App Store. North America is the most iOS-concentrated (75.1%), while IN/SEA and Latin America are the least concentrated — though still with ~66% of projects heavily skewed toward iOS.

## Benchmarks to know:

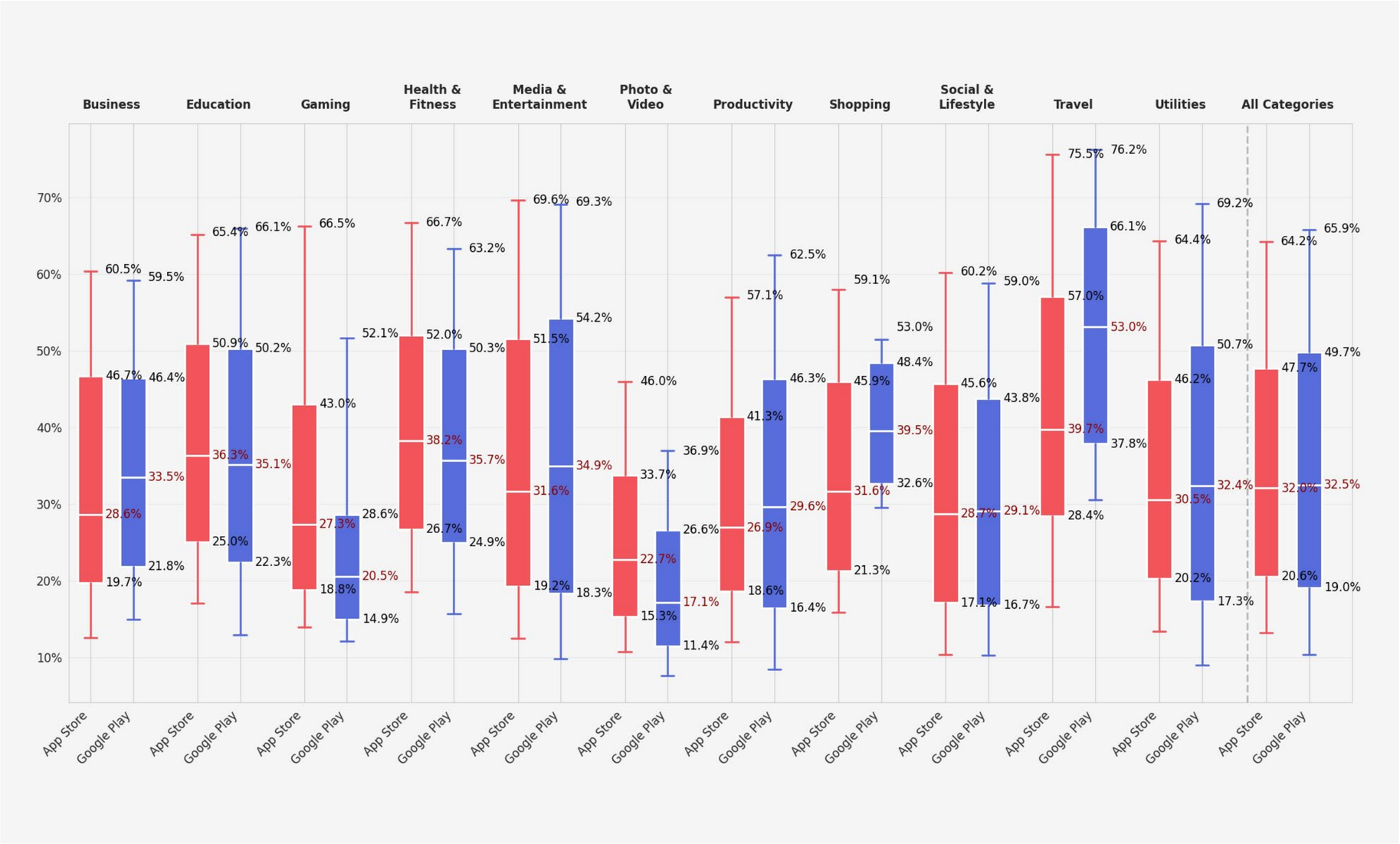
- Over 80% iOS revenue share: 66–75% of projects, depending on geography
- Android-leaning projects (<50% iOS share): 11–17% across geographies
- 70–80% iOS tier is thin: roughly 2–4% of projects sit in this middle band

## What stands out:

- Binary distribution: apps rarely split evenly between platforms, with a majority being iOS-dependent
- IN/SEA and Latin America have the highest Android-leaning share (~17%), though iOS still dominates overall
- MEA mirrors North America rather than other emerging markets, with 70.3% of projects deriving >80% of revenue from iOS

# Trial conversion-to-paid, by store and category

## Does the store gap persist in trial-to-paid conversion?




### Key takeaway

Trial conversion is nearly identical with App Store 32.6% vs. Google Play 32.5% median. The iOS monetization premium seen earlier in the funnel disappears at the trial stage.

### Benchmarks to know:

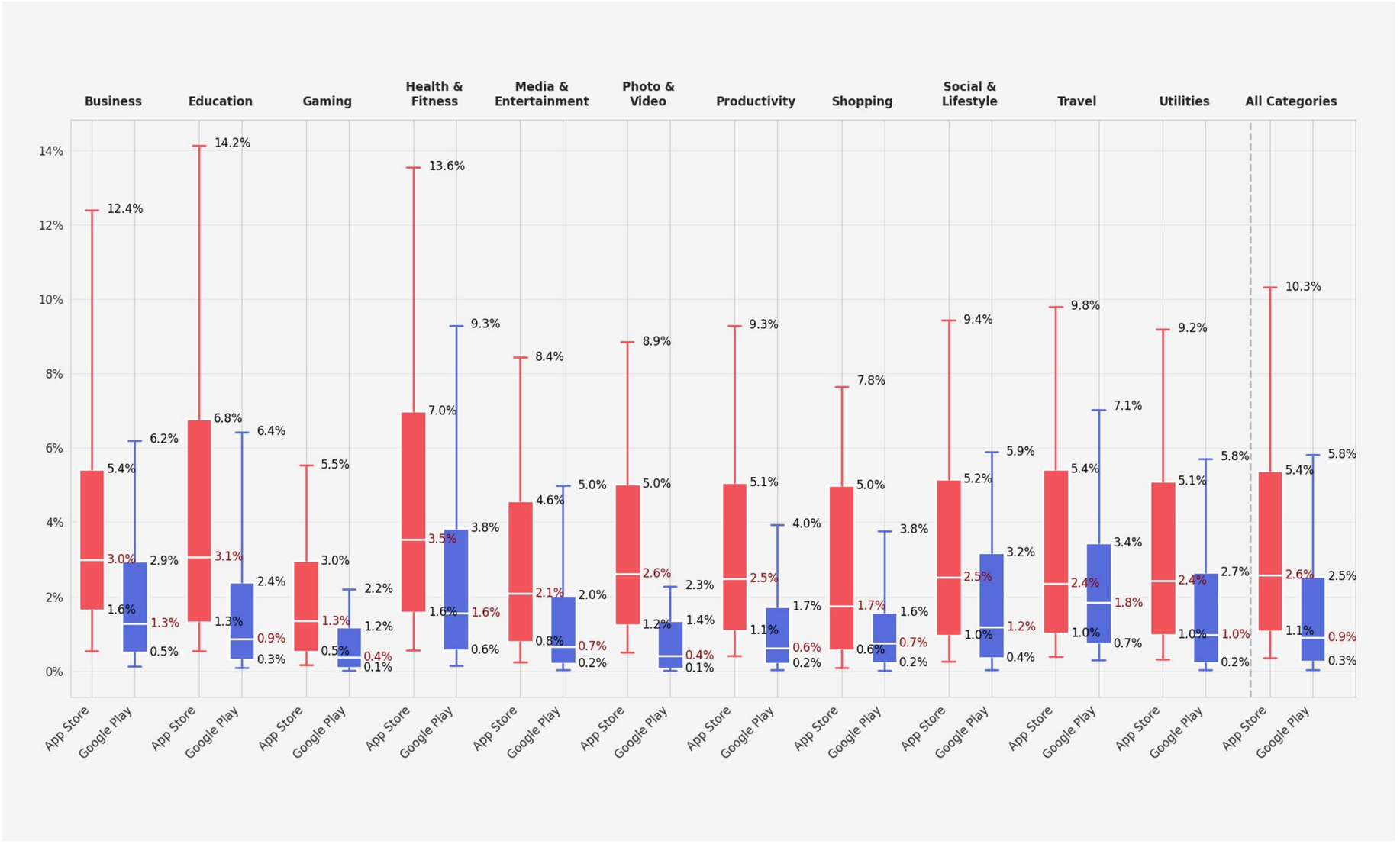
- Global median (all categories): 32.0% iOS vs. 32.5% Google Play
- Travel leads overall, with 39.7% median on iOS and 53.0% on Google Play
- Gaming is lowest on iOS at 27.3%, while Photo & Video is lowest on Google Play at 17.1%
- Top-tier Travel apps reach 75–76% trial conversion on both stores

### What stands out:

- Parity is striking given download-to-paid's 2.9× iOS advantage
- Android matches or exceeds iOS at the median in Education and Travel
- Travel shows the largest cross-store divergence, with Google Play leading iOS
- Upper-tier performance is tightly clustered across stores, with most categories topping out in the 60–70% range

# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion, by store and category

## How do D35 conversion rates compare between categories and stores?




### Key takeaway

The App Store converts at roughly 2.9× the rate of Google Play globally (2.6% vs. 0.9% median), and the iOS advantage holds across every category shown. While conversion gaps narrow in certain verticals, there is no category where Google Play surpasses iOS at the median.

### Benchmarks to know:

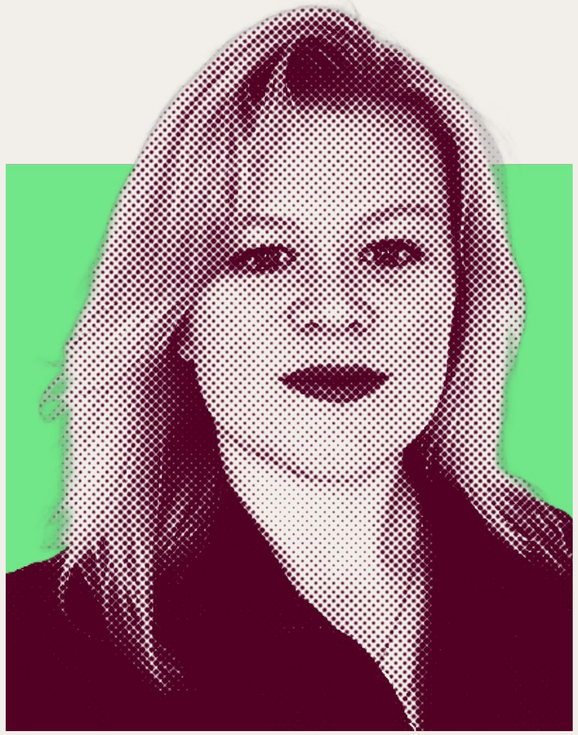
- Global median (all categories): 2.6% iOS vs. 0.9% Google Play
- Health & Fitness leads on iOS at 3.5% median, followed closely by Education (3.1%) and Business (3.0%)
- Gaming has the lowest median conversion at 1.3% on iOS and 0.4% on Google Play
- Travel upper-quartile apps reach 5.4% (iOS) vs. 3.4% (Google Play)

### What stands out:

- The iOS premium is universal across categories: even in lower-converting verticals like Gaming, iOS maintains a clear lead
- Category spread is significant: median conversion ranges from 1.3% (Gaming) to 3.5% (Health & Fitness) on iOS.
- Top-tier iOS apps dramatically outperform the median: in leading categories like Education and Health & Fitness, upper-end conversion reaches 12–14%, highlighting wide performance dispersion within verticals

StartApp School

# Lifecycle strategy for apps, by Alice Muir Kocourková



**Alice Muir Kocourková**
Growth Consultant

Discover how to design lifecycle systems that increase activation, retention, and lifetime value, with instructor Alice Muir Kocourková. Rather than chasing one-off conversion spikes, Alice teaches you how to build repeatable revenue engines through segmentation and behavior-based messaging — laying the foundation for sustainable, reliable growth.

Explore Alice's Course

**What you'll learn:**

- How to map users to lifecycle stages
- How to design onboarding that drives activation
- When to trigger upgrades
- How to reduce churn and re-engage drifting users
- How to build CRM flows that increase LTV
- How to treat lifecycle marketing as a revenue system

# How ElevenLabs Turns Feature Launches Into a Growth Engine

**Luke Harries**
ElevenLabs

Minisode

1 **Turn every feature launch into a full-funnel growth engine**

Don't just ship and announce. Coordinate each release across organic posts, landing pages, and refreshed ad creative simultaneously so earned attention compounds into paid efficiency.

2 **Train a custom GPT on your own winning ad copy**

Feed your top and bottom performing Meta and Google copy into a custom GPT, then use it to rapidly translate brand messaging into proven high-performing ad formats. It turns institutional knowledge into a scalable creative tool.

3 **Directing AI agents is the new core marketing skill**

The future of marketing isn't just using AI tools but directing agents to handle messaging, storyboarding, ad creation, and localization, all grounded in your creative taste and brand direction.

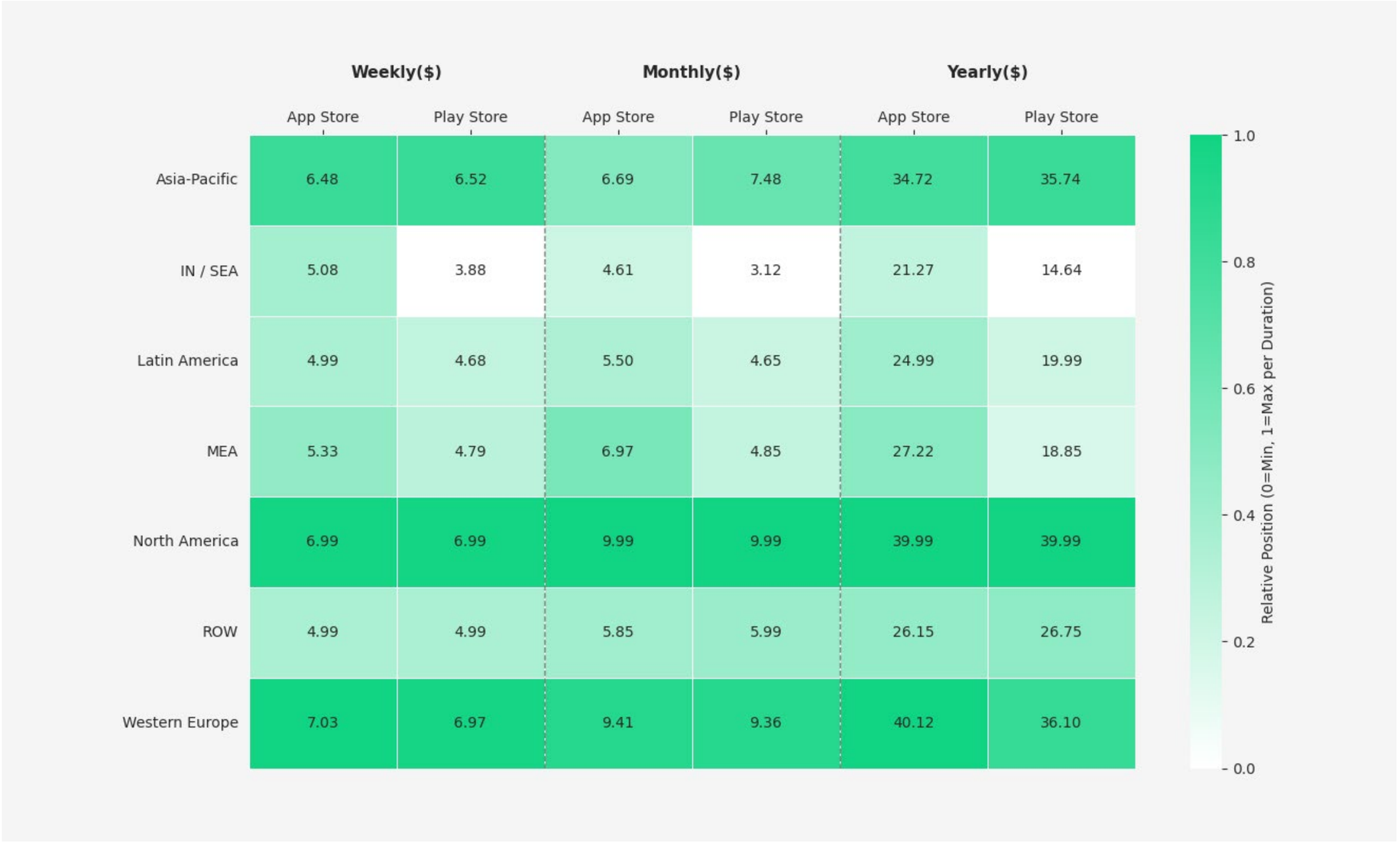
**Listen to Luke's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast**

$ub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

# Median price per plan duration, by store and geography

How do median subscription prices differ by store and geography?




## Key takeaway

Pricing is identical across stores in North America ($6.99 weekly, $9.99 monthly, $39.99 yearly), but diverges in emerging markets — especially on annual plans, where MEA shows a $27.22 vs. $18.85 gap and IN/SEA drops to $14.64 on Play Store.

## Benchmarks to know:

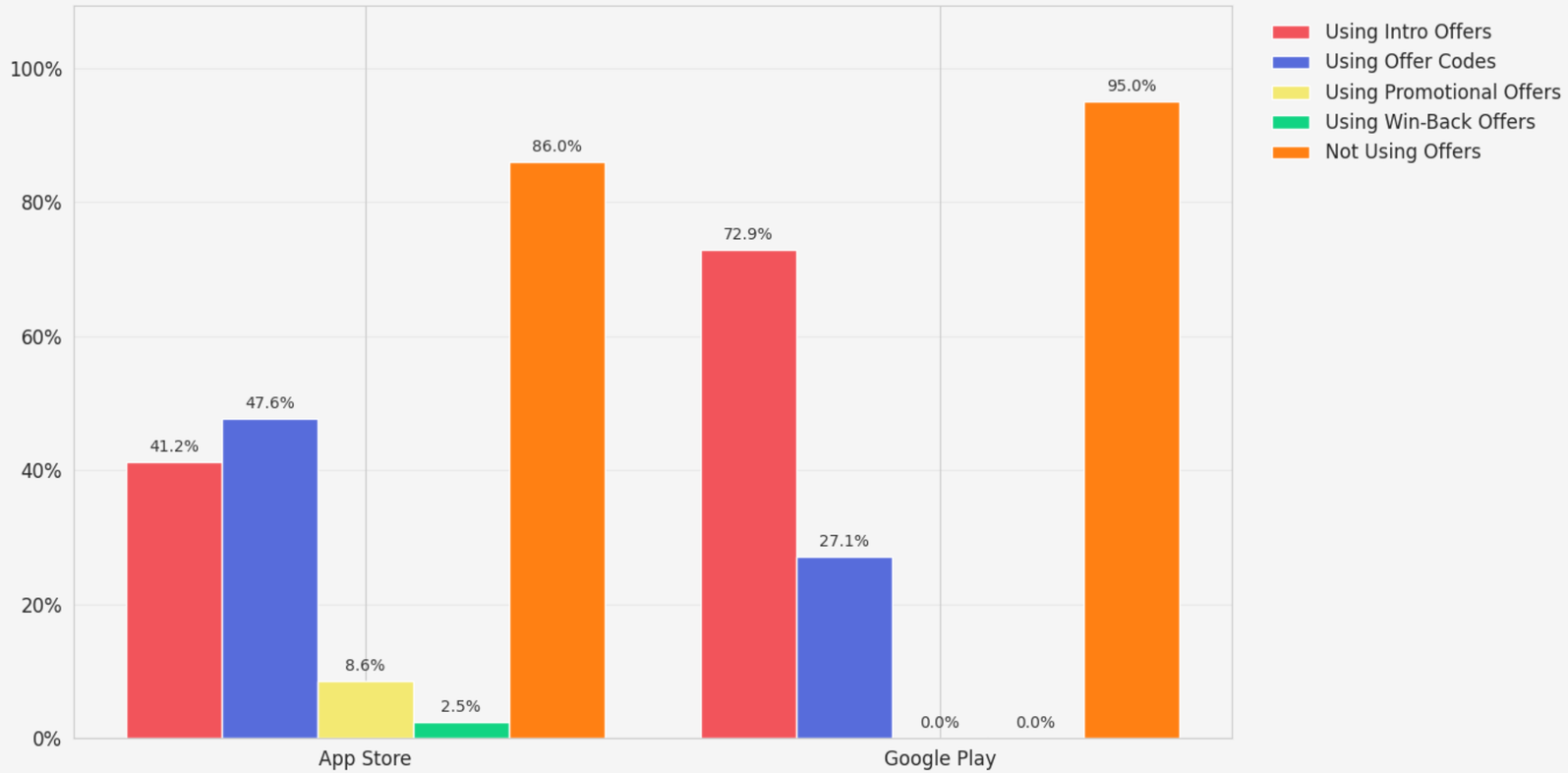
- North America: identical across stores — $6.99 weekly, $9.99 monthly, $39.99 yearly
- Western Europe (App Store): highest weekly at $7.03 and highest yearly at $40.12
- IN/SEA (Play Store): lowest monthly median at $3.12

## What stands out:

- Annual plans drive the largest store gaps: MEA shows an $8.37 annual spread ($27.22 App Store vs. $18.85 Play Store)
- IN/SEA Play Store annual pricing ($14.64) is nearly one-third of Western Europe App Store ($40.12)
- Asia-Pacific is the only geography where Play Store monthly pricing ($7.48) exceeds App Store monthly ($6.69)

# Offer usage, by store and offer type

## How does offer strategy differ between App Store and Google Play?




### Key takeaway

The App Store deploys a broader monetization toolkit, while Google Play usage concentrates heavily on intro offers, with no usage observed for promo or winback offers.

### Benchmarks to know:

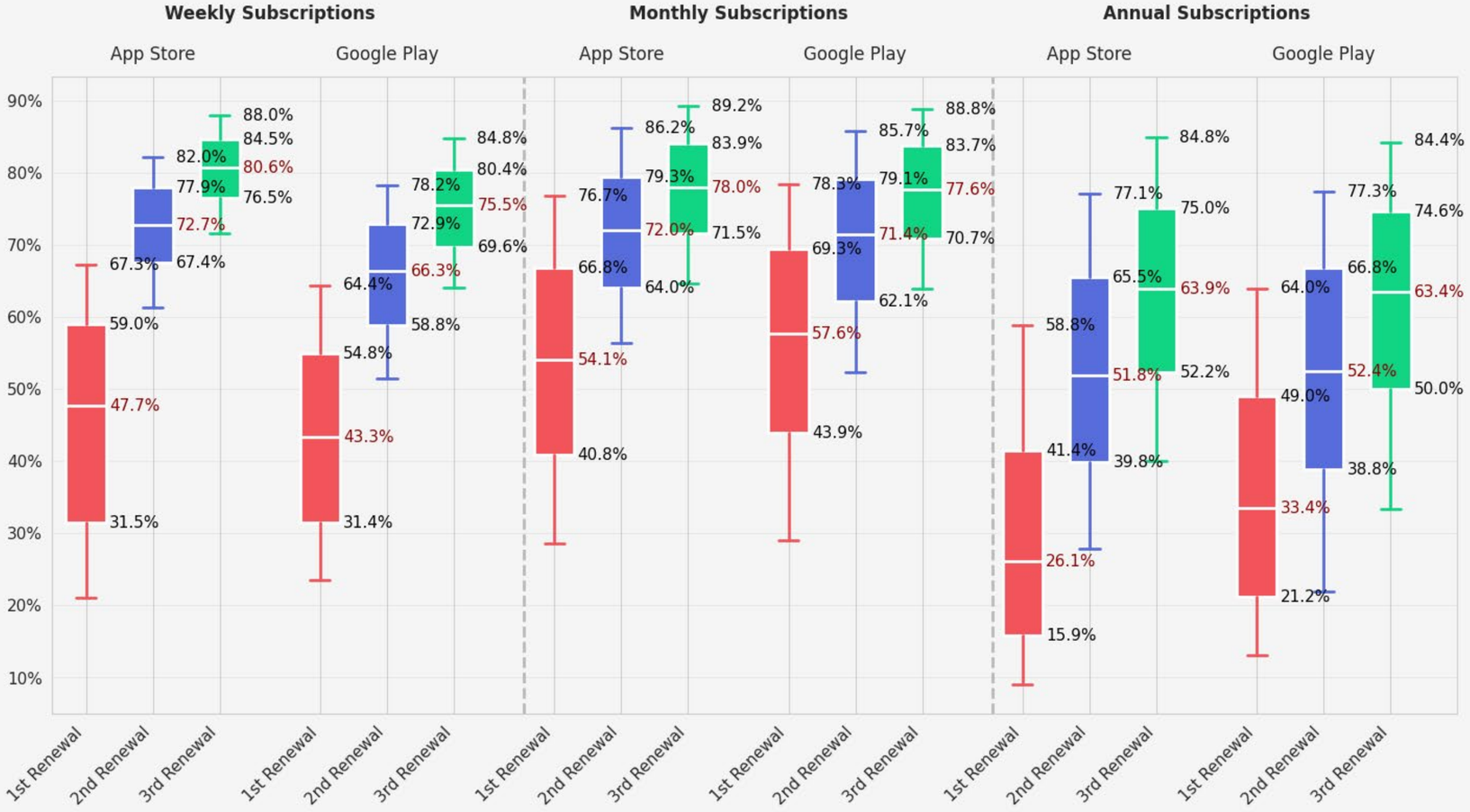
- Intro offers: 72.9% Google Play vs. 41.2% App Store
- Offer codes: 47.6% App Store vs. 27.1% Google Play
- Promotional and winback offers: 8.6% and 2.5% on iOS; 0% usage observed on Google Play
- Not using offers: 86.0% iOS, 95.0% Google Play

### What stands out:

- iOS shows more diversified offer usage — adoption of offer codes exceeds intro offers (47.6% vs. 41.2%).
- Google Play usage is concentrated on intro offers, with materially lower adoption of other mechanisms
- Offer penetration is not mutually exclusive, indicating many projects are not leveraging these tools at all

# First 3 renewals, by store and plan duration

## Do renewal rates differ between the App Store and Google Play?




### Key takeaway

Store advantage flips by duration at 1st renewal, but disappears by the third: Google Play leads on 1st renewals for monthly (+3.5pp) and annual (+7.6pp); iOS leads weekly (+4.4pp), then all converge by 3rd renewal.

### Benchmarks to know:

- 1st renewal: weekly iOS 47.7%, Monthly Android 57.6%, Annual Android 49.0%
- 3rd renewal: weekly/monthly converge to ~78–81% on both stores; annual to ~64%

### What stands out:

- The largest early gap is annual 1st renewal, where Android leads by 7.6pp
- Weekly is the only duration where iOS leads at 1st renewal
- By the 3rd renewal, store differences effectively disappear, suggesting long-term retention dynamics are platform-neutral once subscribers pass the initial churn window

# Apple vs. Google: key takeaways

Across monetization, pricing, and revenue mix, the App Store maintains a measurable advantage over Google Play — but the magnitude varies by stage. Apple leads on download-to-paid conversion (2.9% vs. 2.6% median), early revenue per install (RPI) ($0.42 vs $0.23 at D60), and Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ($23.38 vs. $21.62).

That said, the gap narrows meaningfully deeper down the funnel. Trial-to-paid show medians are near parity (32.6% vs. 32.5%), and by 3rd renewal, store differences compress to low single digits across durations.

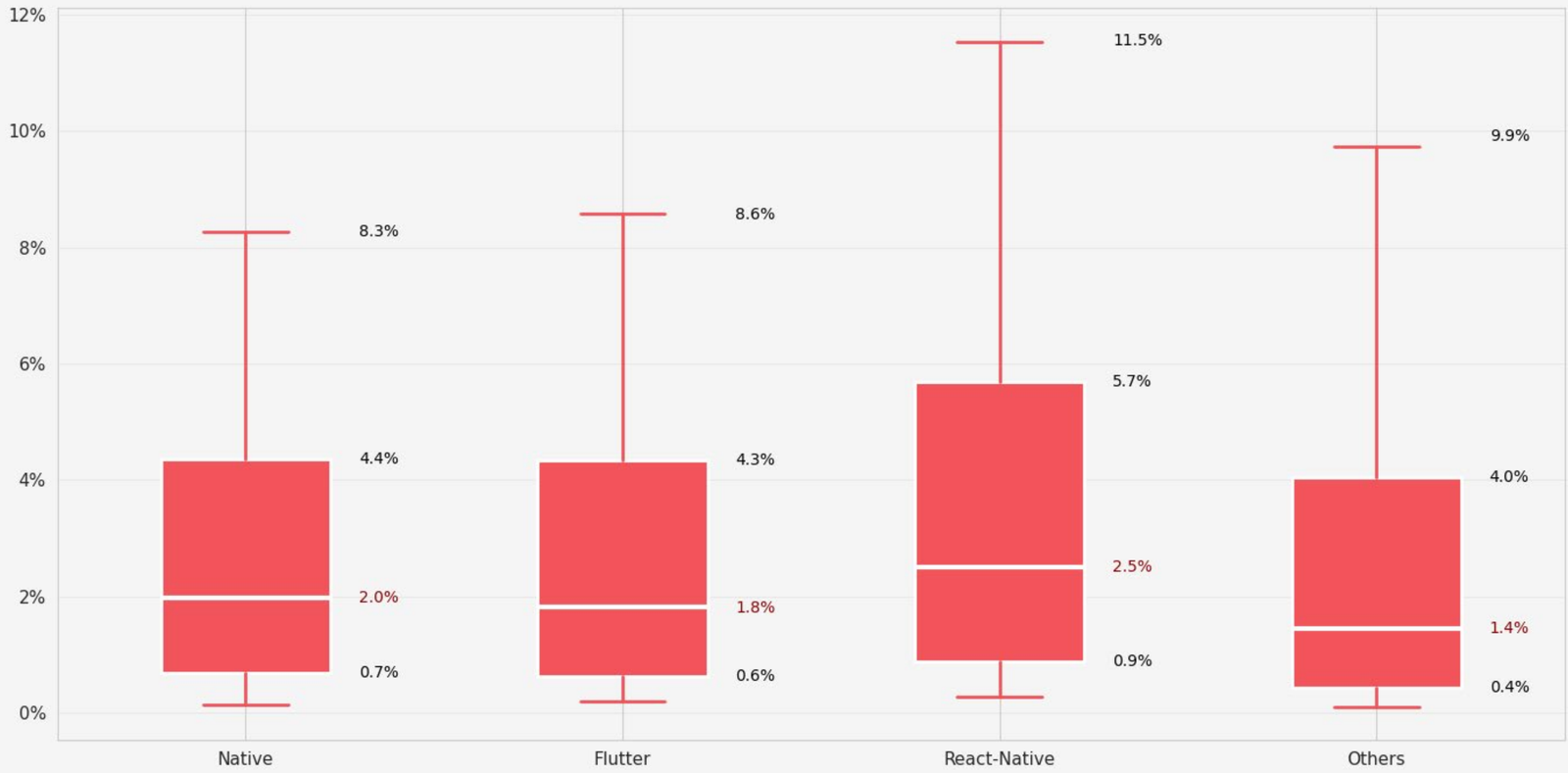
The takeaway is primarily structural: iOS tends to monetize earlier and at higher absolute levels, but long-term retention mechanics and subscription durability are broadly similar across stores. However, it's worth also considering implications from other chapters, such as Retention and billing health, that shed additional light on Apple vs. Google, i.e. e.g. Google Play's 2x billing error rate compared to App Store.

## What stands out

- → Conversion advantage starts at the top of the funnel: median download-to-paid conversion is 2.9% on App Store vs. 2.6% on Google Play. No category shows Android outperforming iOS at the median.
- → Trial parity reshapes the story: trial-to-paid medians are nearly identical (32.6% iOS vs 32.5% Android). The store premium largely disappears once a user starts a trial.
- → Early revenue gap is material — but compresses over time: D60 RPI is $0.42 on iOS vs. $0.23 on Google Play (1.8x). By Y1 RLTV per payer, the gap narrows to ~8% ($23.38 vs. $21.62).
- → Retention converges by renewal three: Google Play leads slightly on 1st renewals (e.g. weekly 47.7% vs. 41.4%), but by 3rd renewal, store differences shrink to roughly 1–2pp across durations.
- → Revenue concentration skews heavily toward iOS: 66–75% of apps generate over 80% of revenue from the App Store, depending on region. Android-leaning revenue mixes (≤50% iOS share) are comparatively rare (5–17%).

# Day 35 download-to-paid, by framework

## Does development framework affect download-to-paid conversion?




### Key takeaway

React-Native shows the highest median conversion at 2.5% — 25% above Native (2.0%) and ~39% above Flutter (1.8%). However, the absolute spread between frameworks is modest compared to within-framework variation.

### Benchmarks to know:

- React-Native median: 2.5% (upper quartile ~5.7%)
- Native median: 2.0% (upper quartile ~4.4%)
- Flutter median: 1.8% (upper quartile ~4.3%)
- Lower bound across frameworks: ~0.4–0.9%

### What stands out:

- Variance within frameworks (10×–14× from low to high) dwarfs differences between frameworks
- Native and Flutter medians are nearly identical, suggesting no clear cross-platform penalty at the median
- Top-end React-Native apps pull ahead, but the dispersion suggests execution matters far more than framework choice

# The framework doesn’t matter — until it does

**Sebastian Röhl**
Creator, HabitKit and FocusKit

**Framework choice barely moves the monetization needle. The real question isn’t which framework converts better. It’s which one lets you build what your users actually want.**

I built HabitKit in Flutter and shipped to iOS and Android from day one. The “one codebase, two platforms” pitch worked perfectly - until users started requesting home screen widgets, lock screen widgets, and iCloud sync. Suddenly I was maintaining three codebases anyway: Flutter, Swift, and Kotlin.

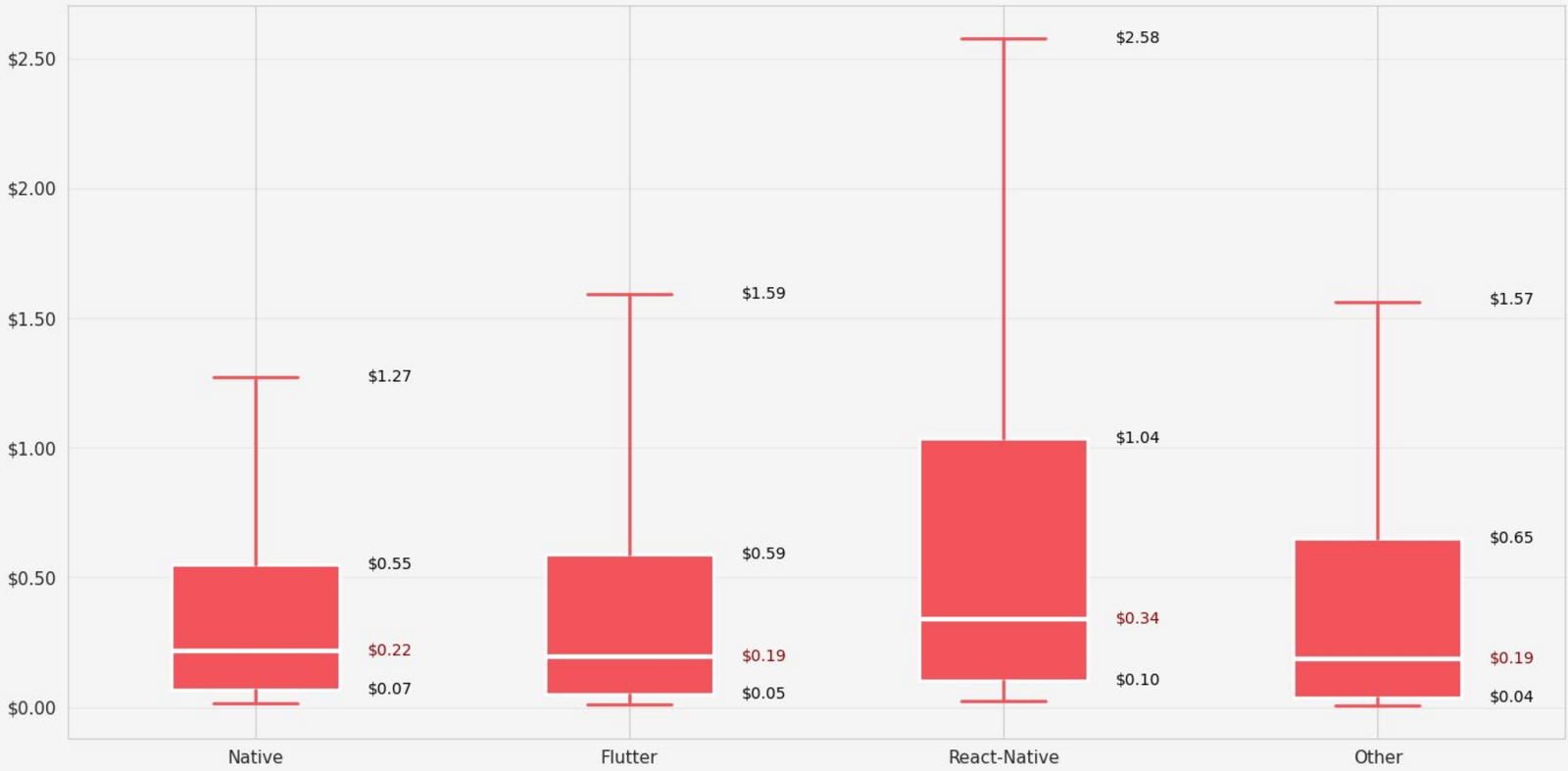
My revenue split shifted from 50-50 to 75-25 favoring iOS, and the gap keeps widening. Not because Flutter monetizes worse, but because native features became the differentiator for retention and willingness to pay.

For my newest app, FocusKit, I went fully native with SwiftUI. The framework didn’t change my conversion rate. But being able to ship Live Activities, Shortcuts, and Liquid Glass design without a bridge layer? That changes the product.

Pick the framework that lets you build the best product. The revenue will follow.

# Day 14 revenue per install, by framework

## Does framework choice impact D14 revenue per install?




### Key takeaway

React-Native leads at $0.34 median, 55% higher than Native ($0.22) and ~79% higher than Flutter ($0.19). However, the absolute differences between frameworks are modest relative to the dispersion within each group.

### Benchmarks to know:

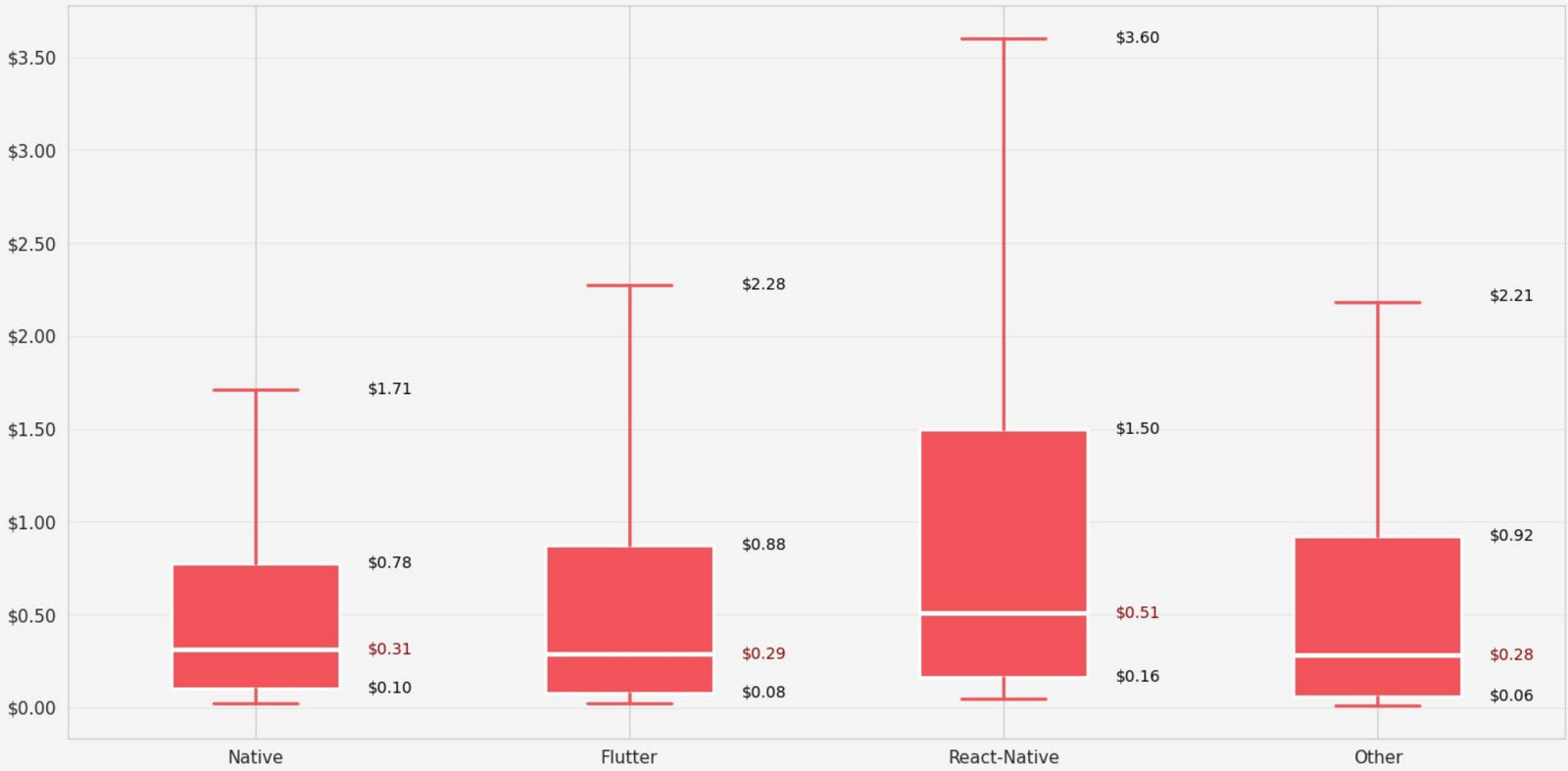
- React-Native median: $0.34; if you're above $1.04, you're in the top quartile
- Native median: $0.22; Flutter median: $0.19
- 'Other' frameworks track closely with Flutter at $0.19 median

### What stands out:

- React-Native has the highest upper bound, reaching $2.58 vs. $1.27 for Native
- Native and Flutter monetize very similarly at the median, suggesting limited framework penalty
- Within-framework dispersion (roughly 18×–30× from low to high) far exceeds the gap between medians, suggesting execution matters more than stack choice

# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by framework

## How does D60 RPI compare by framework?




### Key takeaway

React-Native leads at $0.51 median RPI — 65% above Native ($0.31) and 76% above Flutter ($0.29). As with earlier horizons, dispersion within each framework is far larger than the median gap between them.

### Benchmarks to know:

- React-Native median: $0.51; if you're above $1.50, you're in the top quartile
- Native median: $0.31; Flutter median: $0.29
- React-Native's advantage widens from D14 to D60

### What stands out:

- Native and Flutter monetize nearly identically at the median, suggesting no cross-platform revenue penalty
- React-Native has the highest ceiling, reaching $3.60 at the upper bound vs. $1.71 for Native
- Within-framework spread (roughly 20×–30× from low to high) materially exceeds differences between medians — stack choice matters less than execution

# React Native + Expo: native where it matters, fast everywhere

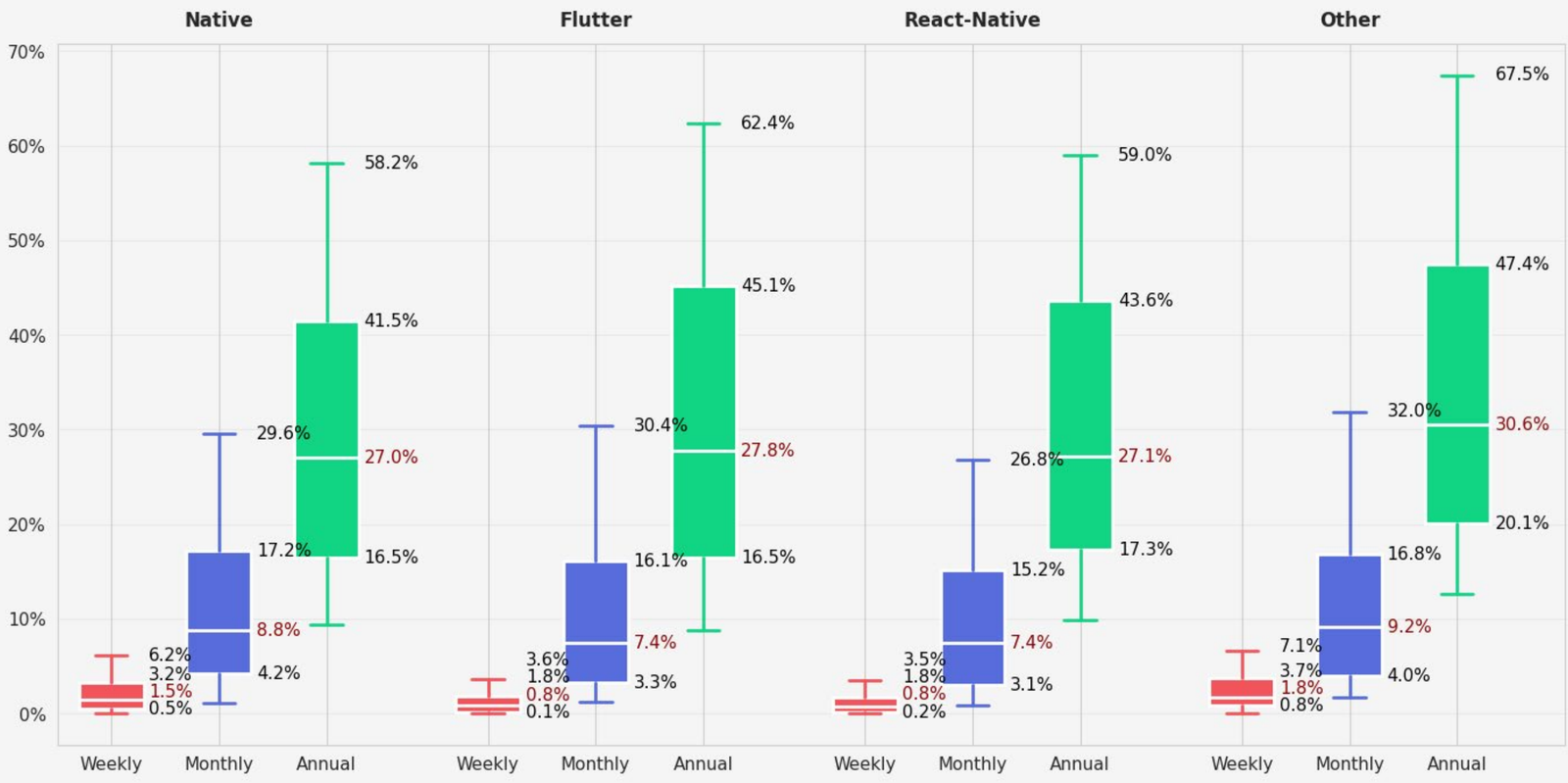
**Charlie Cheever**
CEO and Co-Founder, Expo

The key thing with React Native and Expo is that you get everything from native that you want—UI elements that look and feel right; the ability to write Swift and Kotlin when you want that level of customization—combined with the speed of writing React.

It's a perfect fit for agentic coding. It doesn't surprise me that the data is showing that React Native and Expo developers are making best in class apps right out of the gate. And then those apps perform even better over time, making more money than other apps and feeling better than other apps, since iteration is faster and easier with Expo + AI than any other way to do it.

# Year 1 retention per plan, by framework

## Does framework affect subscriber retention over a year?




### Key takeaway

Y1 retention is tightly clustered across frameworks. Annual medians range from 27.0% to 30.6% — a spread of just 3.6pp. Framework choice appears to have minimal impact on long-term retention.

### Benchmarks to know:

- Annual median: Other 30.6%, Flutter 27.8%, React-Native 27.1%, Native 27.0%
- Monthly median: 7.4–9.2% across frameworks
- Weekly median: 0.8–1.8% across frameworks

### What stands out:

- Differences are smallest at annual durations, where medians cluster tightly around ~27–31%
- Flutter and Native are very close at annual retention, though Native leads slightly at weekly and monthly durations
- React-Native's monetization lead does not translate to a retention advantage

# Year 1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer, by framework

Does framework choice impact long-term payer value?

## Key takeaway

React-Native apps generate materially higher Y1 RLTV. The median is $31.78, roughly 50%–52% above Native and Flutter, which cluster around $20–21.

## Benchmarks to know:

- React-Native median: $31.78; if you're above $95, you're in the top tier
- Flutter median: $21.18; Native median: $20.88
- Native, Flutter, and Others cluster tightly at $20–21

## What stands out:

- Native, Flutter, and Others cluster tightly, suggesting little cross-platform penalty in payer value
- React-Native's ceiling is 50%+ higher than Native's
- Once again, within-framework dispersion exceeds median differences — but React-Native consistently leads at both the midpoint and the top end

# Native vs. cross-platform: key takeaways

Across conversion, early revenue, retention, and Y1 lifetime value (LTV), framework choice matters less than execution — with one notable exception: React Native outperforms at the median on revenue metrics.

Download-to-paid conversion at D35 is tightly clustered (1.8–2.5% medians), and annual retention ranges just 27–31% across frameworks. Native and Flutter track almost identically on most metrics.

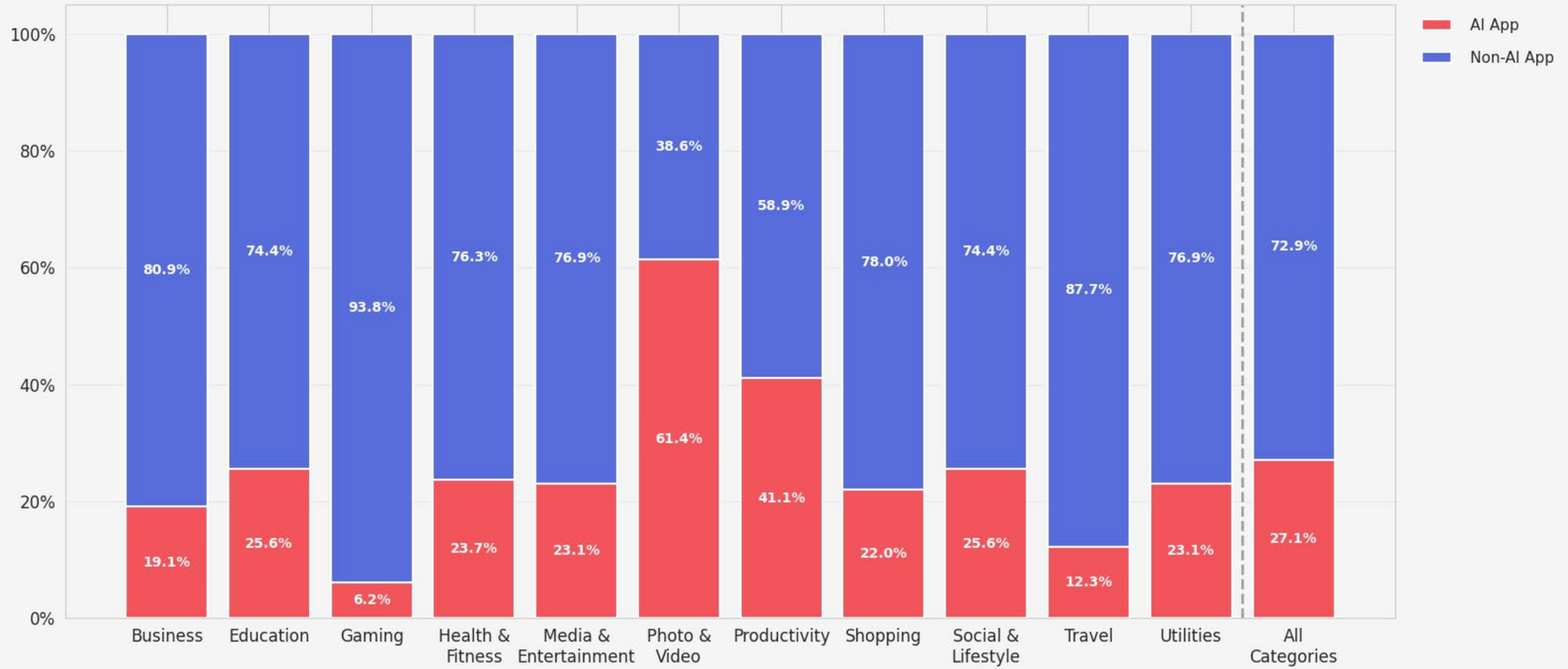
React Native, however, leads on early revenue per install (RPI) ($0.34 at Day 14; $0.51 at Day 60) and Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ($31.78 median). Within-framework variance often exceeds between-framework gaps, suggesting team-level execution and monetization strategy outweigh tooling decisions

## What stands out

- Conversion parity across frameworks: median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 1.8% (Flutter) to 2.5% (React Native), with Native at 2.0%. The spread is narrow relative to the roughly 10% within-framework variance shown.
- React Native leads early RPI: D14 median RPI is $0.34 for React Native versus $0.22 (Native) and $0.19 (Flutter). By D60, React Native reaches $0.51, compared to $0.31 and $0.29 respectively.
- Retention is effectively framework-agnostic: annual retention medians range from 27% (Native) to 30.6% (Other). Monthly retention clusters around 7–9%, and weekly around ~1–3%. No framework shows a structural loyalty advantage.
- Long-term payer value diverges at the top: median Y1 RLTV per payer is $31.78 for React Native vs. ~$20–21 for Native, Flutter, and Other. React Native's upper bound ($95.32) is materially higher than Native's ($61.81).
- Within-framework spread outweighs tooling choice: in multiple charts, the range within a single framework exceeds the gap between framework medians, suggesting performance differences are more execution-driven than stack-driven.

# Share of apps classified as AI-powered, by category

What category footprint do AI apps have?




## Key takeaway

Photo & Video and Productivity sit far above every other category. Overall, 1 in 4 subscription apps is AI-powered.

## Benchmarks to know:

- 27.1%: the all-category average — at this rate, 1 in 4 apps in a given space are AI-powered
- 40%+: at this level, AI apps approach majority status — only Photo & Video and Productivity reach this bar

## What stands out:

- Photo & Video at 61.4% is more than 2× the all-category average — the sharpest outlier
- Productivity at 41.1% is the only other category over the average by 10+ points
- Gaming at 6.2% is nearly 4× below the median — a distinct low-end outlier
- Travel (12.3%) and Business (19.1%) are the next lowest after Gaming

# Why App Economy Disruption Won't Happen As Fast As Everyone Thinks

**Eric Seufert**
Mobile Dev Memo

1 **Distribution is the moat, not code**

As AI lowers the barrier to building apps, it raises the barrier to getting discovered. More software competing for attention means user acquisition becomes harder and more expensive, not easier.

2 **Use AI to defend against copycats, not just to build faster**

Use AI to scan the app store daily for copycat apps, monitor rising competitors, and track their ads. Build automated defense processes that keep you ahead of clones.

3 **App economy disruption won't happen as fast as everyone thinks**

No-code tools, game engines like Unity, and now vibe coding have all promised to democratize app building. None eliminated the real barriers: distribution, product intuition, and the compounding advantage of iterating on user feedback over years.

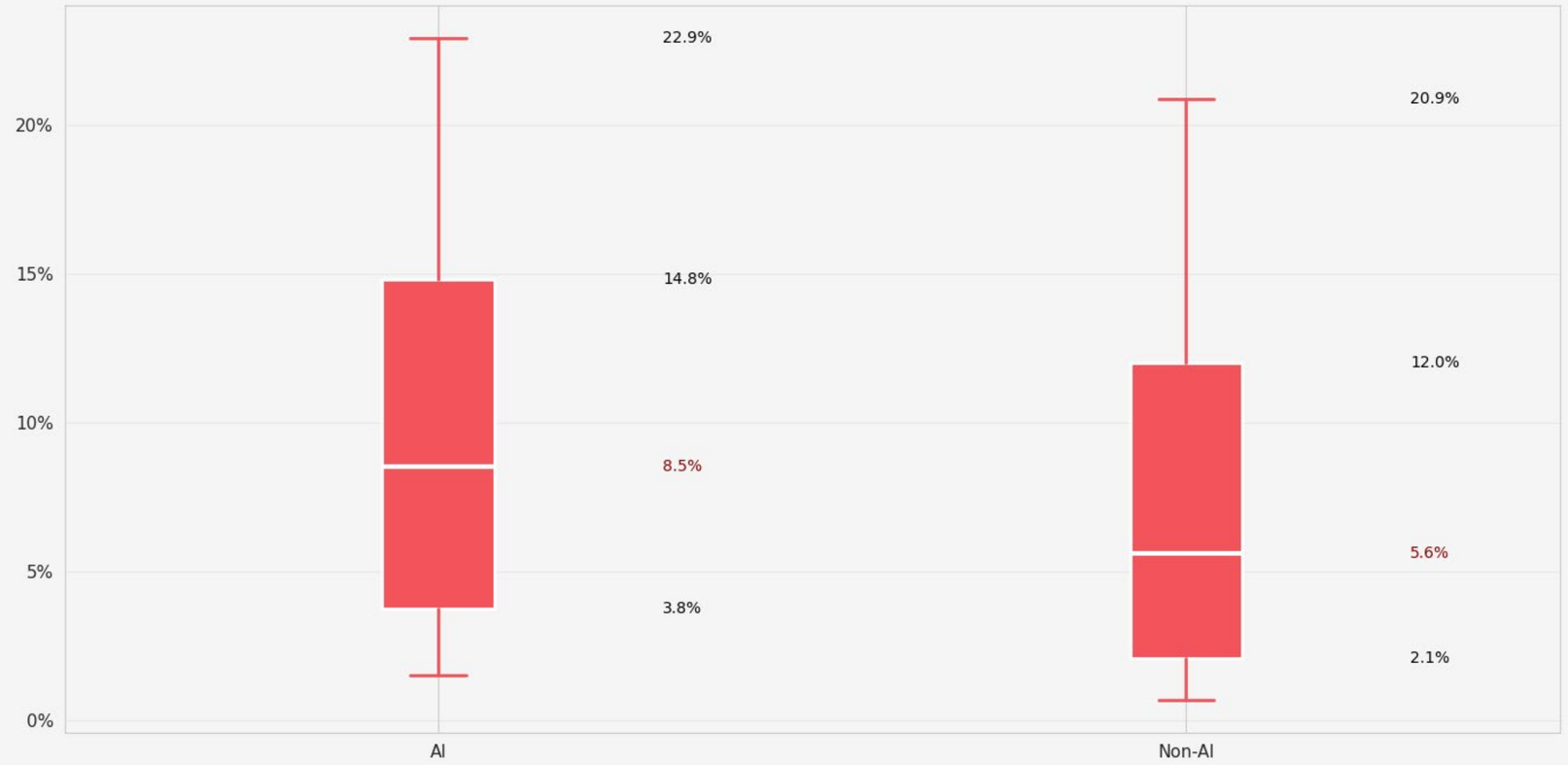
Listen to Eric's minisode (~15 minutes) on the Sub Club podcast

Sub Club

Apple Podcasts Spotify YouTube

# Trial start rate, by AI vs. non-AI

Do AI apps convert trials better than traditional apps?




## Key takeaway

AI apps start trials at a higher rate at the median: 8.5% vs. 5.6% for non-AI (+52%).

## Benchmarks to know:

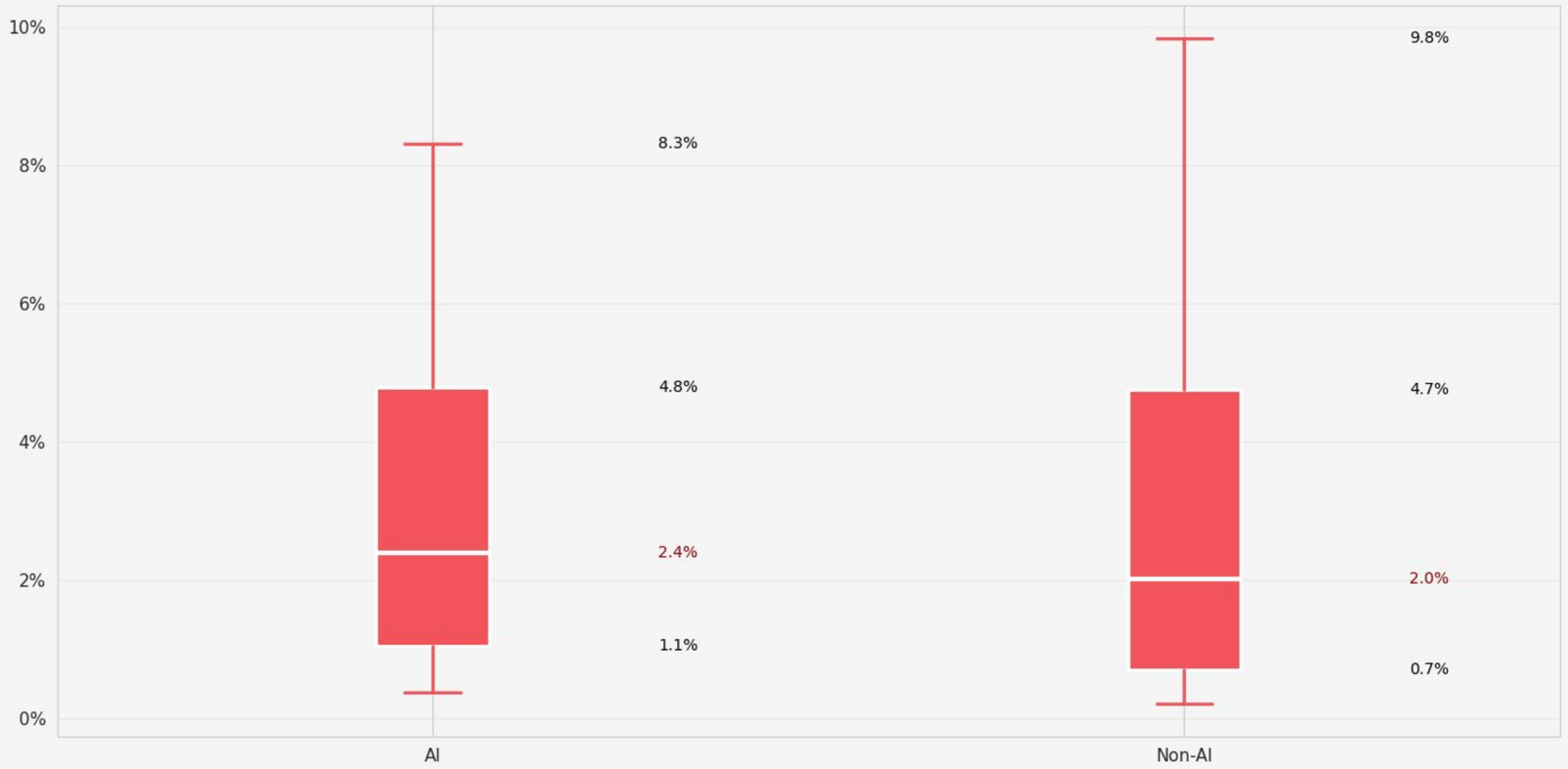
- AI median: 8.5%; if you're above 15%, you're in the top quartile
- Non-AI median: 5.6% , over 12% is the upper quartile
- Top end: AI reaches 22.9%; non-AI reaches 20.9%

## What stands out:

- The AI advantage is most visible around the middle of the distribution
- Top performers converge at similar levels — both segments reach ~21–23%, with AI slightly higher (22.9% vs. 20.9%)

# Time to first purchase (download-to-paid), by AI vs. non-AI

## Do AI apps monetize downloads more effectively?




### Key takeaway

AI converts downloads to paid 20% better at the median (2.4% vs. 2.0%), a smaller gap than trial starts.

### Benchmarks to know:

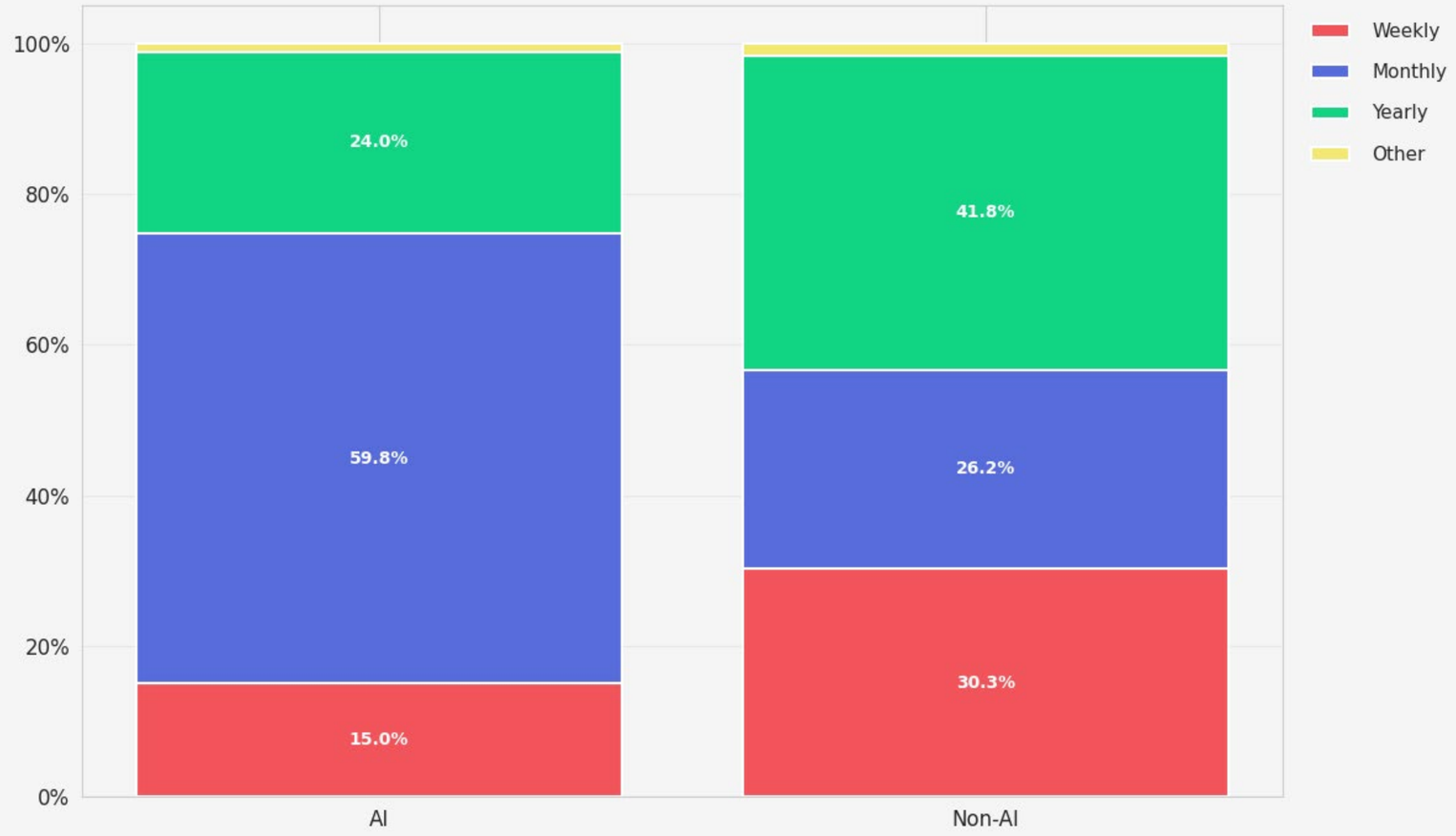
- AI median: 2.4%; if you're above 4.8%, you're in the top quartile
- Non-AI median: 2.0%
- Top end: AI reaches 8.3%; non-AI reaches 9.8%

### What stands out:

- Non-AI matches (and slightly exceeds) AI at the top end, despite trailing at the median
- Lower-end performance is similar across segments (floor below ~0.5%, not shown precisely)

# Plan mix (share of subscriptions sold), by AI vs. non-AI

How do AI apps structure their subscription durations?




## Key takeaway

AI apps overwhelmingly concentrate on monthly plans (59.8% vs. 26.2% for non-AI). Non-AI apps distribute more toward yearly (41.8% vs. 24%) and weekly (30.3% vs. 15%) durations.

## Benchmarks to know:

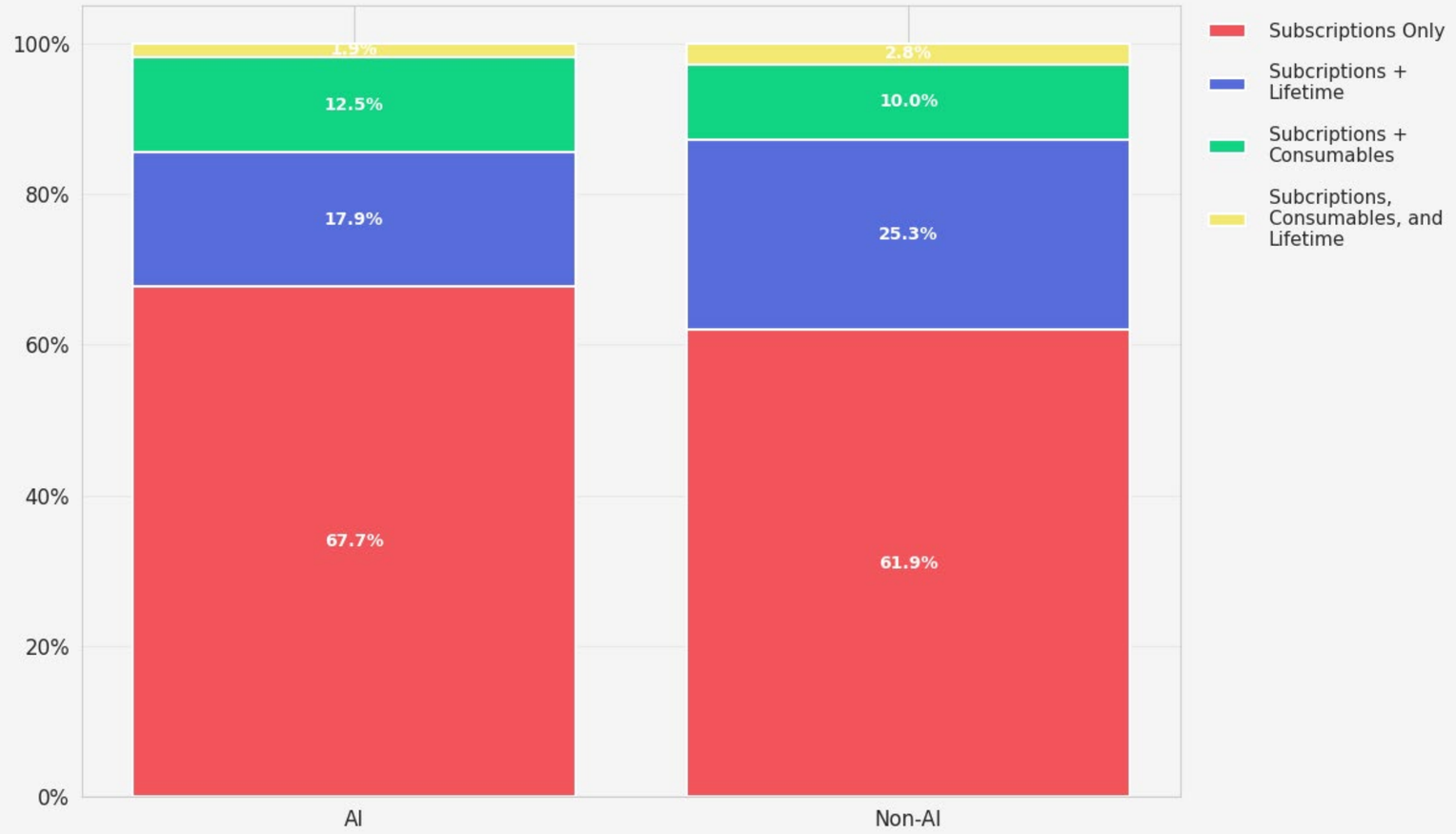
- AI mix: 59.8% monthly, 24% yearly, 15.0% weekly
- Non-AI mix: 41.8% yearly, 30.3% weekly, 26.2% monthly
- Monthly skew gap: +33.6pp toward AI

## What stands out:

- Monthly is the dominant plan for AI (nearly 60%), but only 26.2% for non-AI
- Non-AI weekly adoption (30.3%) is ~2x AI (15%)
- AI yearly adoption trails non-AI by 17.8pp (24% vs. 41.8%)
- Non-AI portfolios are balanced across durations; AI portfolios are structurally monthly-first

# Share of AI apps using hybrid monetization vs. subscriptions only

How does monetization mix differ between AI and non-AI apps?




## Key takeaway

AI apps skew more subscription-pure (67.7% vs.61.9%). Non-AI diversifies more into lifetime (+7.4pp).

## Benchmarks to know:

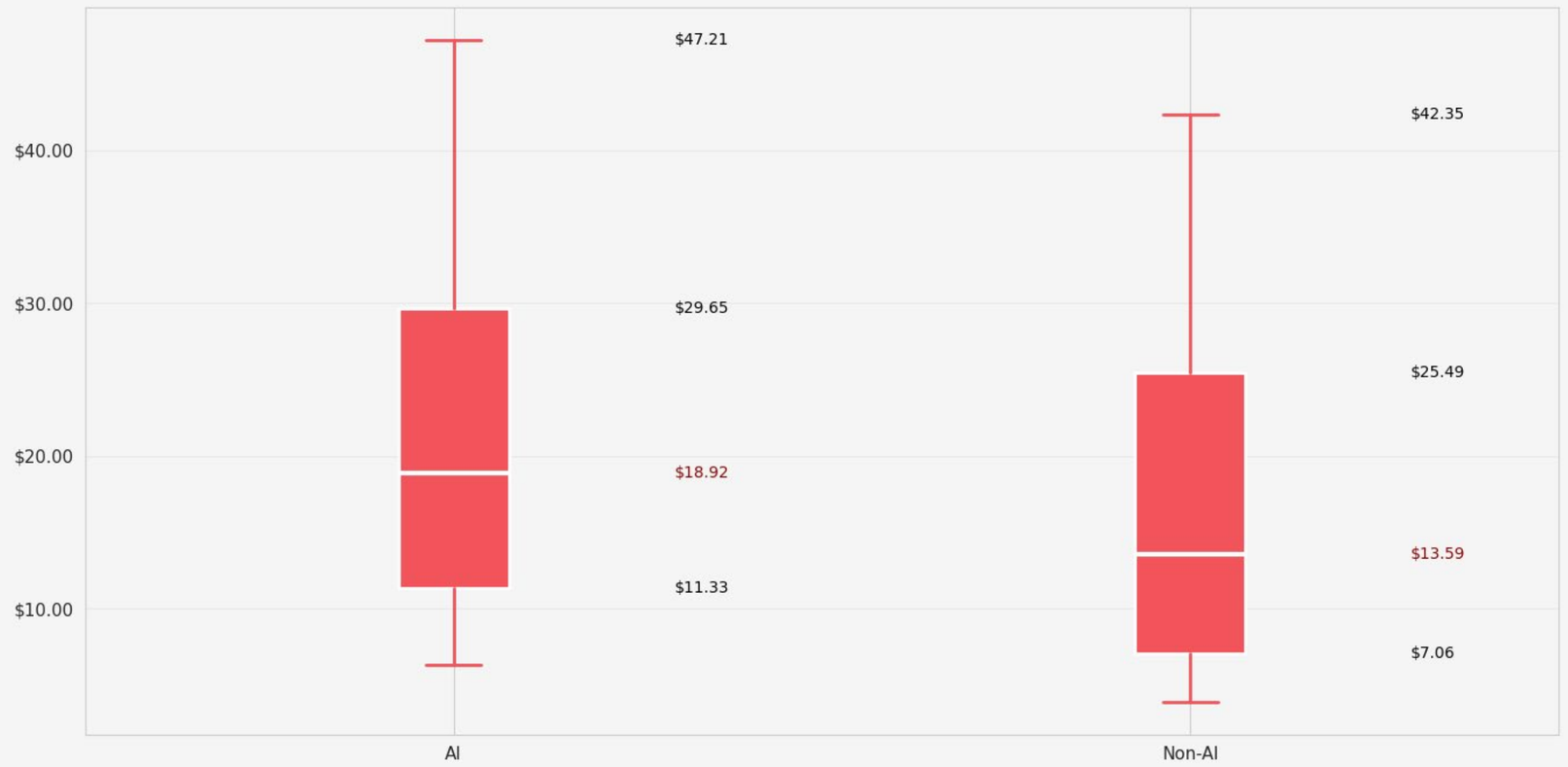
- AI: 67.7% subs-only, 17.9% + lifetime, 12.5% + consumables
- Non-AI: 61.9% subs-only, 25.3% + lifetime, 10.0% + consumables

## What stands out:

- Non-AI lifetime combos run +7.4pp higher (25.3% vs.17.9%)
- AI leads in consumable hybrids (+2.5pp)

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 30 days, by AI vs. non-AI

Do AI apps extract more value (monthly RLTV) per payer in the 1st month?




## Key takeaway

AI generates 39% higher monthly RLTV ($18.92 vs. $13.59 median).

## Benchmarks to know:

- AI median: $18.92; if you're above $29.65, you're in the top quartile
- Non-AI median: $13.59; top performers reach $42–47 for both segments

## What stands out:

- AI premium spans the entire distribution: the floor is $11 vs. $7 for non-AI apps
- The value gap narrows at top — elite apps converge around $45 regardless of AI status

# Defining success in the age of consumer AI

**Eric Crowley**
Partner, GP Bullhound

Everyday consumers and entrepreneurs are discovering magic they can do with AI tools. Investors are clamoring to get a piece of the pie, but false fears have slowed investment.

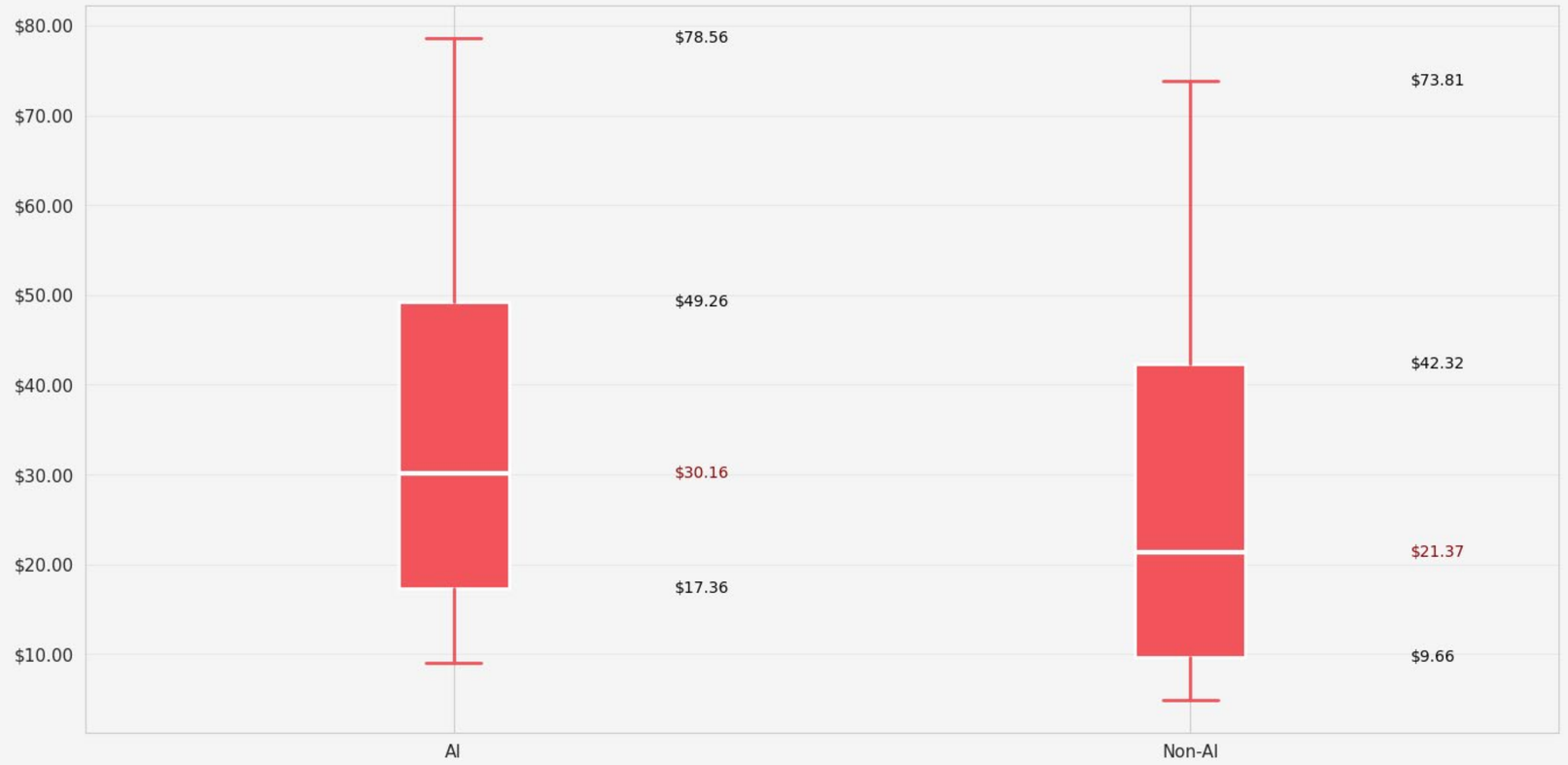
Consumers continue to be discerning on their purchases even as we have seen no sign of 'subscription fatigue' in the total number of subscriptions.

Even with all the choice available to consumers today (combined with growing efficiency in marketing), consumers are defaulting to the category leaders resulting in those companies' accelerating revenue over 3x vs. their competitors (even as their size increases). These category leaders continue to integrate new features, web checkout and functionality to delight consumers and encourage them to renew.

Fundraising and M&A in consumer continues forward as the category grows. Investors are amazed by the growth, profitability and scale of leading CSS companies. However, fears around ChatGPT / Claude remind me of previous false fears that Apple, Meta or Google were going to wipe out consumer technology companies. When investors realize that 99% of consumers don't want to build an app for a month vs. spend $100 and get it now, this fear will soon fade, and investment and M&A will follow.

# Realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer after 1 year, by AI vs. non-AI

Do AI apps maintain their revenue premium over a full year?




## Key takeaway

AI sustains a 41% Y1 RLTV premium ($30.16 vs. $21.37 median), slightly larger than the monthly gap (+39%).

## Benchmarks to know:

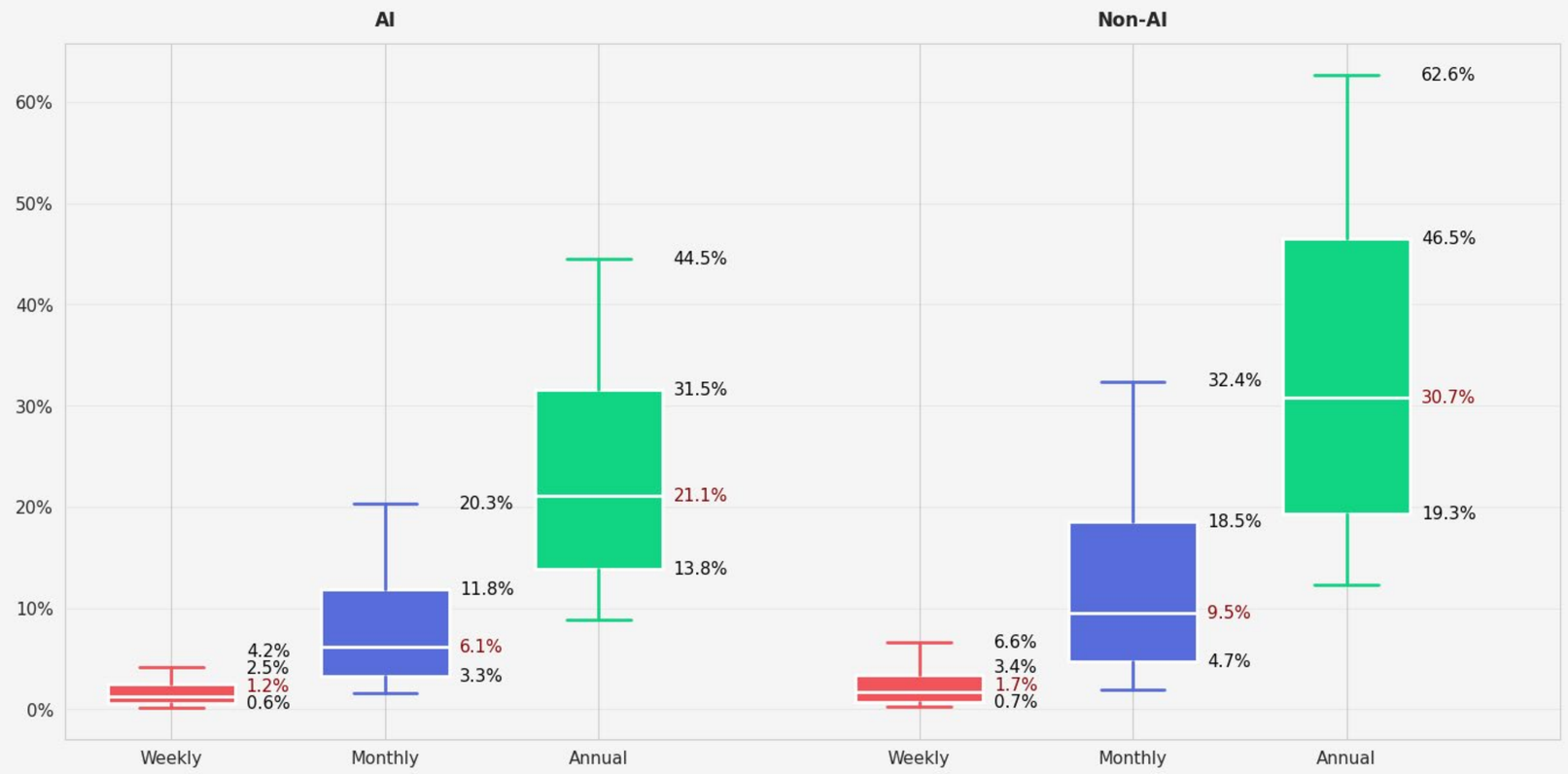
- AI median: $30.16; if you're above $49.26, you're in the top quartile
- Non-AI median: $21.37; top performers reach $74–79 for both segments

## What stands out:

- Both segments share a $75–80 ceiling where top performers converge
- AI floor is $17 vs. $10 for non-AI — premium spans the entire distribution

# Retained subscribers after 12 months, by AI vs. non-AI

Do AI apps retain subscribers as well as traditional apps?




## Key takeaway

Retention is lower for AI apps across all subscription durations.

## Benchmarks to know:

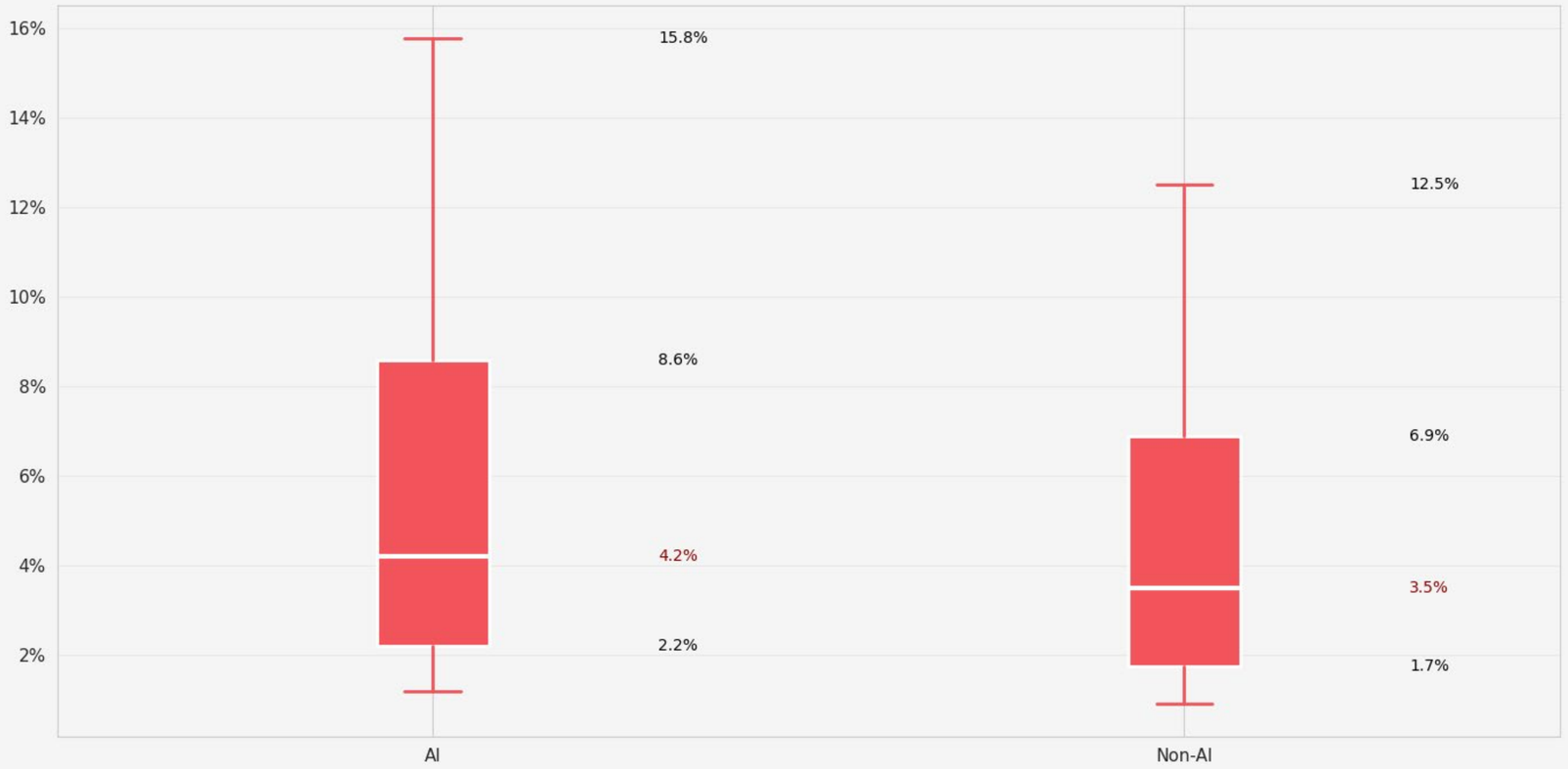
- Weekly: AI 1.2% vs. non-AI 1.7%
- Monthly: AI 6.1% vs. non-AI 9.5%
- Annual: AI 21.1% vs. non-AI 30.7%

## What stands out:

- The largest gap is monthly, where non-AI leads by 3.4pp (9.5% vs. 6.1%)
- AI's annual retention also trails materially (21.1% vs. 30.7%)
- Weekly retention is low across both categories, with non-AI slightly ahead at the median (1.7% vs. 1.2%)

# Refund rate, by AI vs. non-AI

## Do AI apps see more refund requests?




### Key takeaway

AI apps show 20% higher refund rates (4.2% vs.3.5% median), with wider variance and a higher ceiling.

### Benchmarks to know:

- AI median: 4.2%; if you're below ~2.2%, you're in the bottom quartile
- Non-AI median: 3.5%; best performers reach ~1% for both segments

### What stands out:

- AI ceiling is higher: 16% vs.12.5% for non-AI
- Both segments share a similar floor (~1%)

# AI vs. non-AI: key takeaways

Across categories, AI is no longer niche: 27.1% of apps are AI-powered. The largest category concentration of AI apps is in Photo & Video, where AI apps rise to 61.4%.

But the real question isn't adoption, it's performance: AI apps convert trial-to-paid 52% better at the median (8.5% vs. 5.6%) and monetize downloads 20% better (2.4% vs. 2%). They also generate meaningfully higher revenue per payer: +39% in month one ($18.92 vs. $13.59) and +41% over Y1 ($30.16 vs. $21.37).

However, retention is structurally weaker — AI underperforms on 12-month retention across weekly (2.5% vs. 3.4%), monthly (6.1% vs. 9.5%), and annual (21.1% vs. 30.7%) plans, and shows higher refund rates (4.2% vs. 3.5%).

The overarching takeaway is that while AI drives stronger early monetization, sustaining value remains the challenge.

## What stands out

- Adoption is concentrated — not universal: Photo & Video leads at 61.4% AI penetration. Productivity (41.1%) is the only other category above 40%. Gaming (6.2%), Travel (12.3%), and Business (19.1%) remain low-AI segments.
- Conversion advantage is median-driven: median trial-to-paid is 8.5% for AI vs. 5.6% for non-AI apps, but top performers converge (21–23% range shown). AI's edge is strongest around the middle, not the ceiling.
- Revenue premium persists beyond month one: AI's median first month lifetime value (LTV) is $18.92 vs. $13.59. At Y1, it grows to $30.16 vs. $21.37. The premium spans the distribution (floors and medians are higher) while top-end ceilings are similar.
- Retention is consistently lower across durations: AI retains 2.5% weekly, 6.1% monthly, and 21.1% annually at 12 months, compared to 3.4%, 9.5%, and 30.7% for non-AI. The largest gap appears in annual plans.
- Refunds are higher and more variable: AI apps' median refund rate is 4.2% vs. 3.5% for non-AI apps. The upper bound is higher as well (15.6% vs. 12.5%), suggesting greater volatility in realized revenue and deeper issues in user value, experience, and long-term quality.

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# 09
# Category breakouts

# Business

# Business: key takeaways

Business apps convert at moderate rates upfront, but their economics strengthen after install. The median D35 download-to-paid conversion rate is 2.7%, placing pressure on funnel efficiency. However, median revenue per install increases from $0.63 at D14 to $1.20 at D60, showing sustained monetization beyond the initial conversion window.

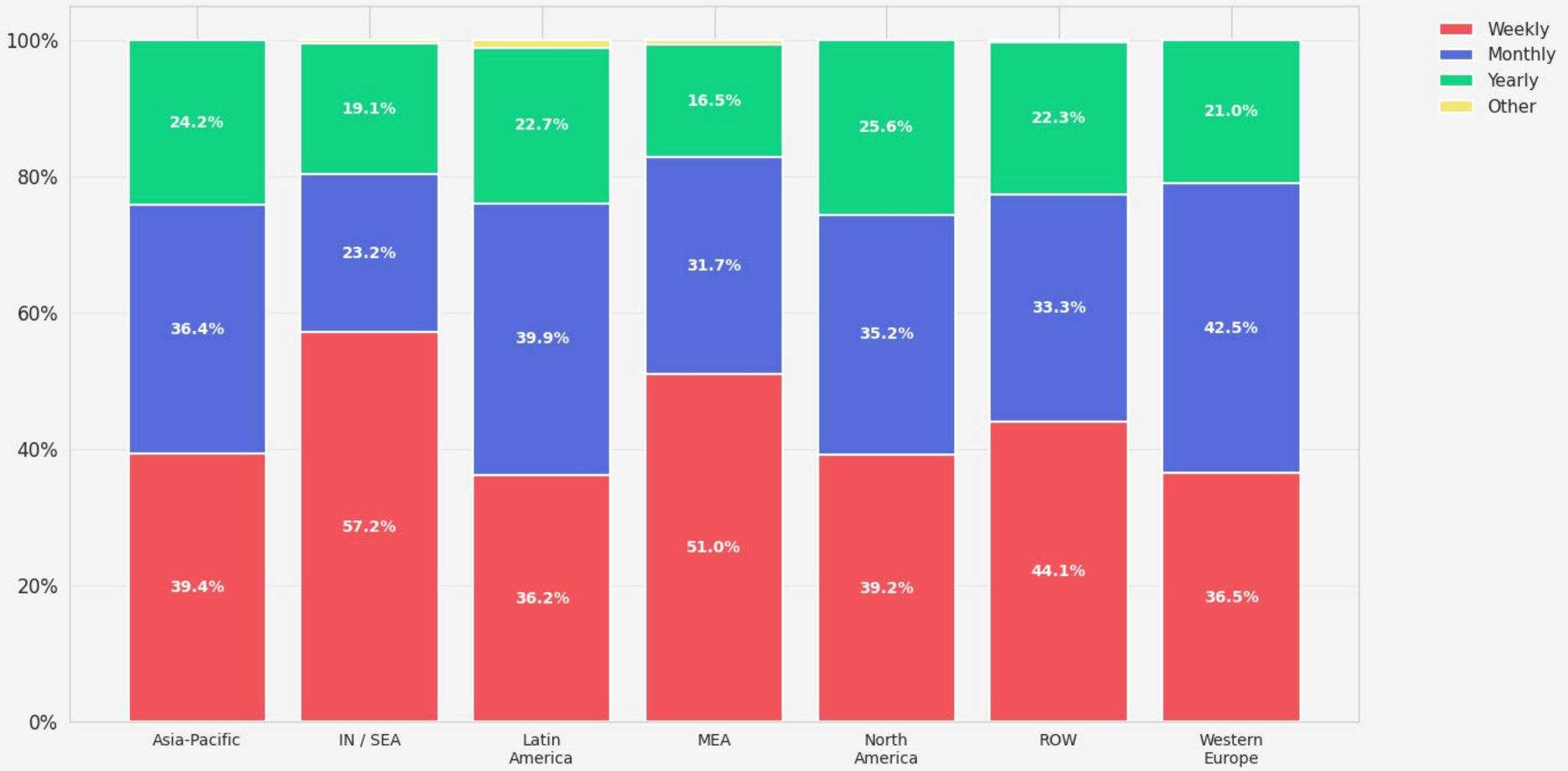
On a per-payer basis, the median Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) is $32.16 globally. North America leads at $39.15, with Western Europe close behind at $33.07. Price stratification is significant: high-priced Business apps generate a median $68.95 RLTV, compared to $9.48 for low-priced apps.

Business monetization is less about volume and more about value density — strong trial efficiency, pricing power, and surviving the 1st renewal.

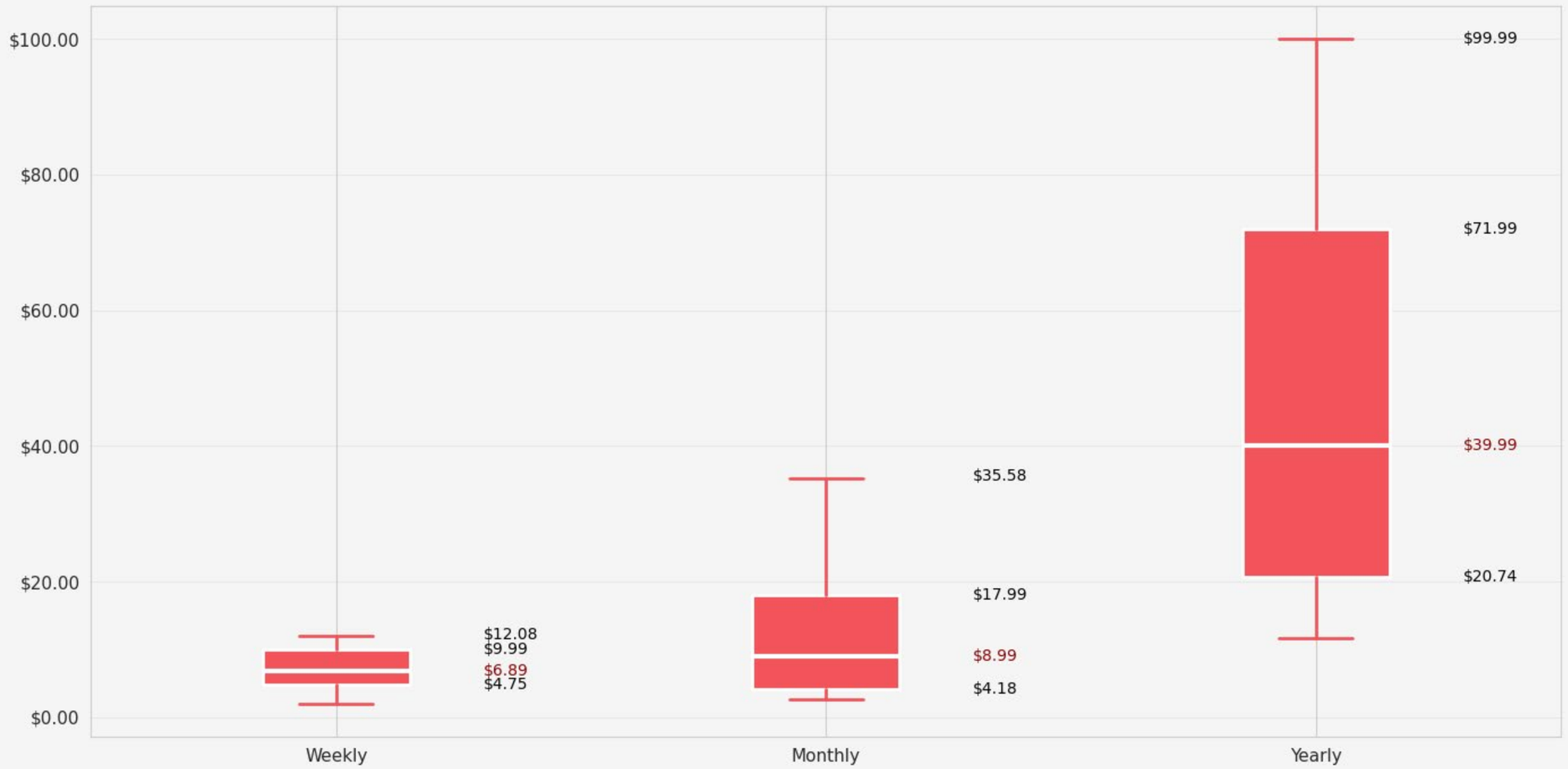
## What stands out

- North America compounds funnel strength: median trial start rate reaches 7.2% and trial-to-paid conversion hits 37.6%, roughly double IN/SEA. Strong entry and strong conversion amplify payer value.
- Revenue expands meaningfully after D14: median RPI nearly doubles by D60, signaling that monetization continues well beyond the initial install window.
- Price tier drives payer value dispersion: high-priced apps show a 7x median RLTV gap vs. low-priced apps ($68.95 vs. $9.48). Pricing materially reshapes unit economics.
- Weekly retention strengthens after renewal one: median weekly renewal improves from 52.2% at 1st renewal to 80.5% by the third, indicating strong loyalty among surviving subscribers.
- Day 0 still matters: in several geographies, ~40% of paid conversions occur on Day 0, reinforcing the importance of immediate value articulation.

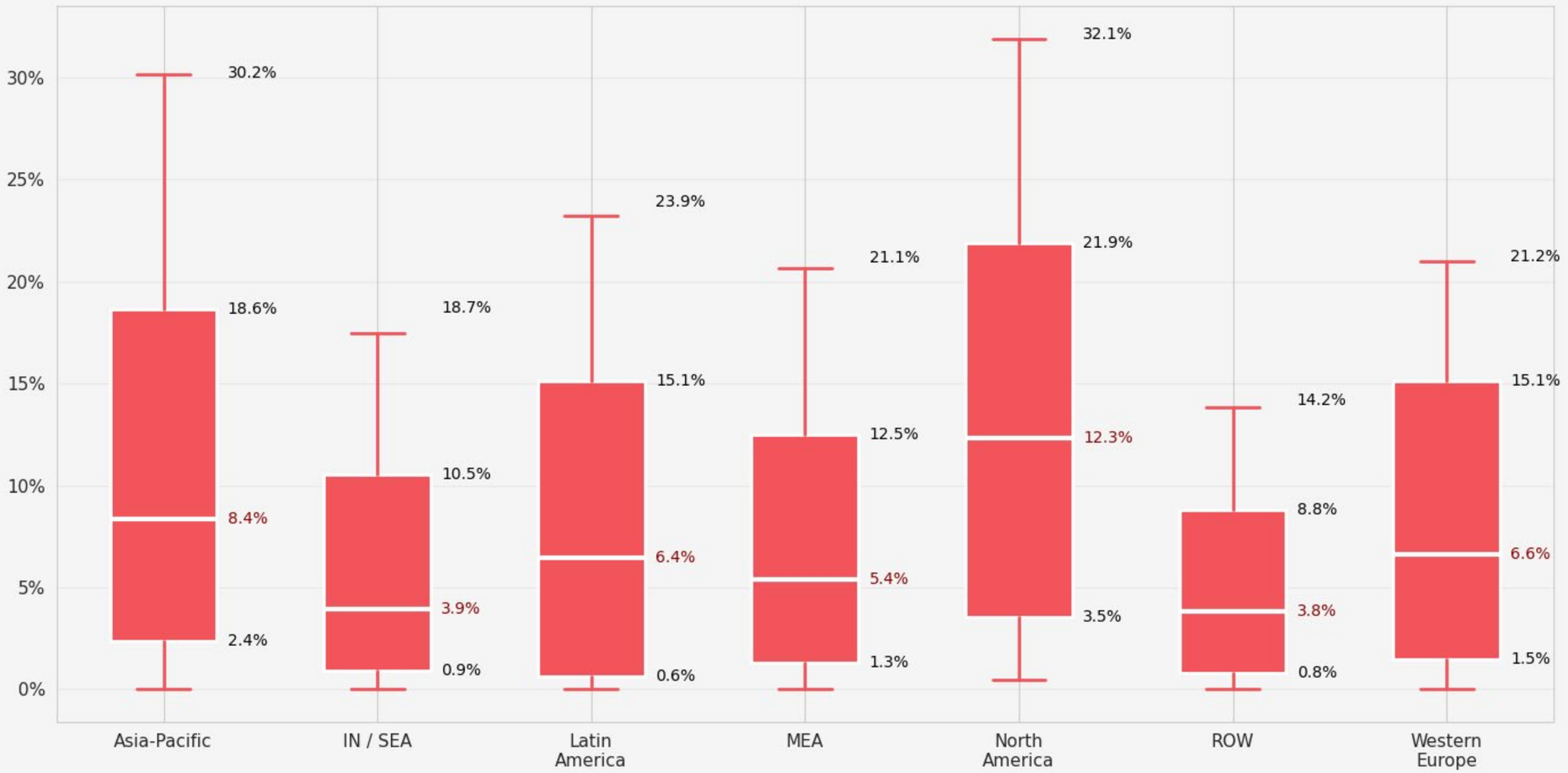
# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography



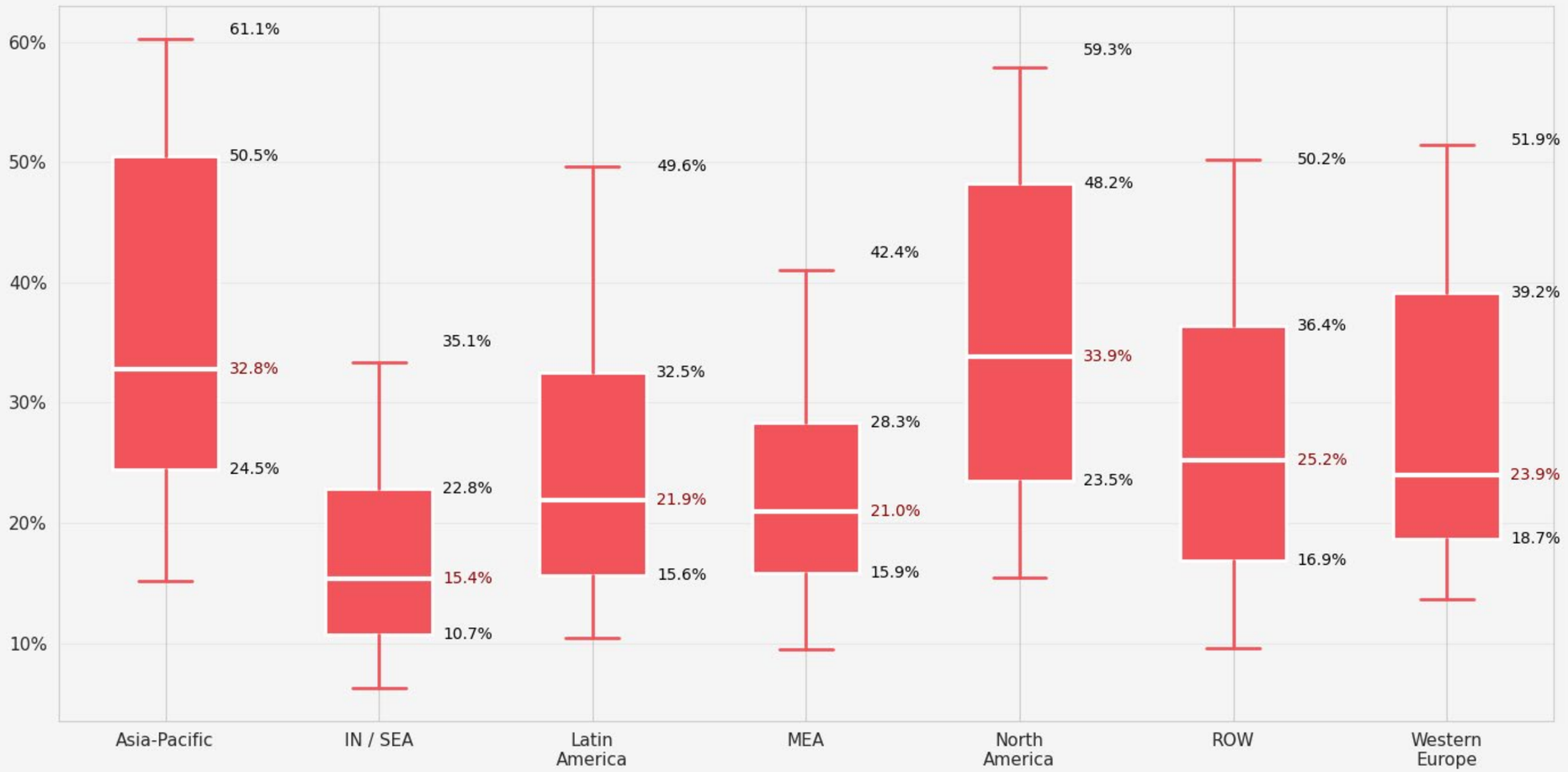
# Pricepoints per plan duration



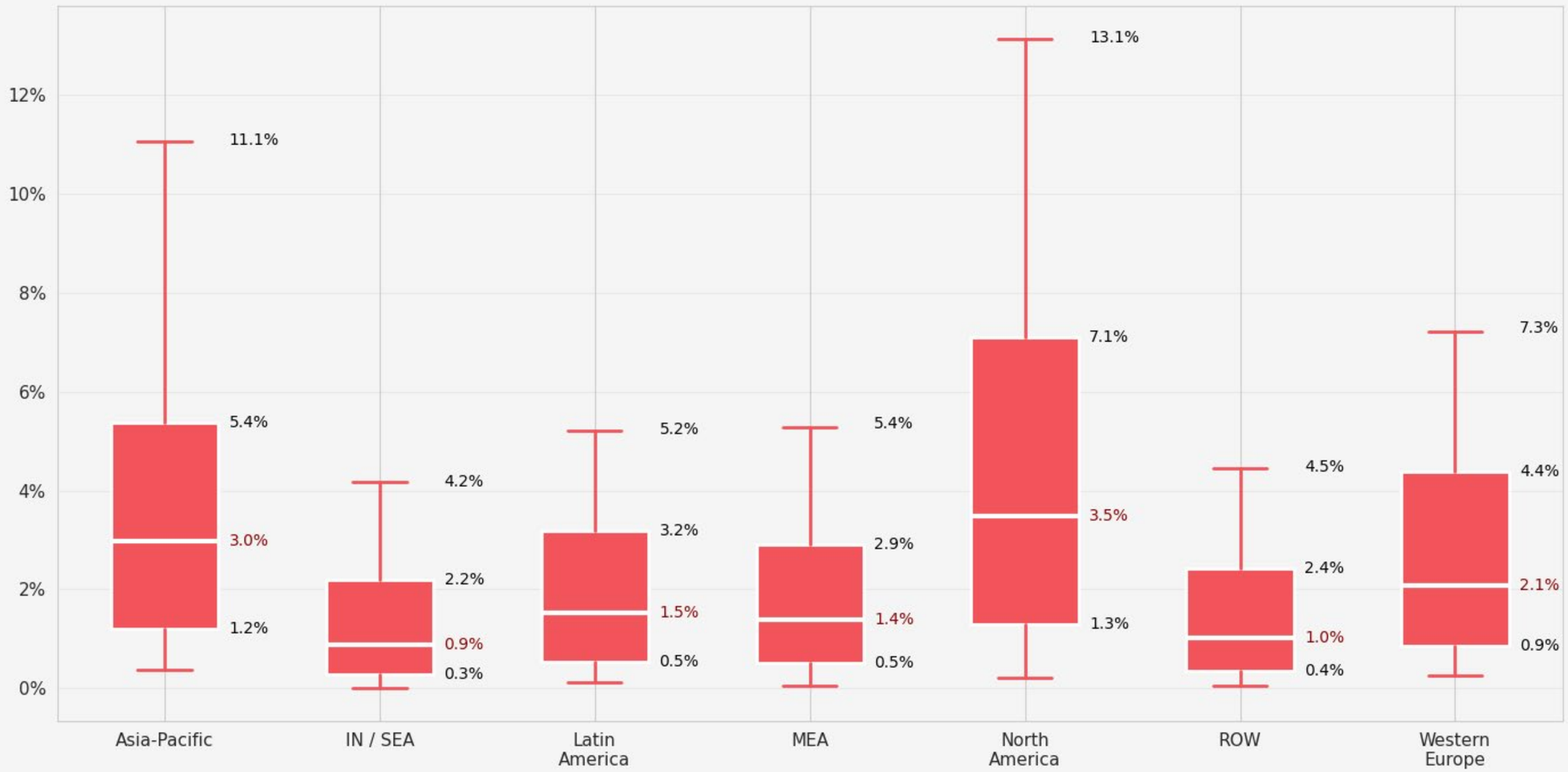
# Trial start rate, by geography



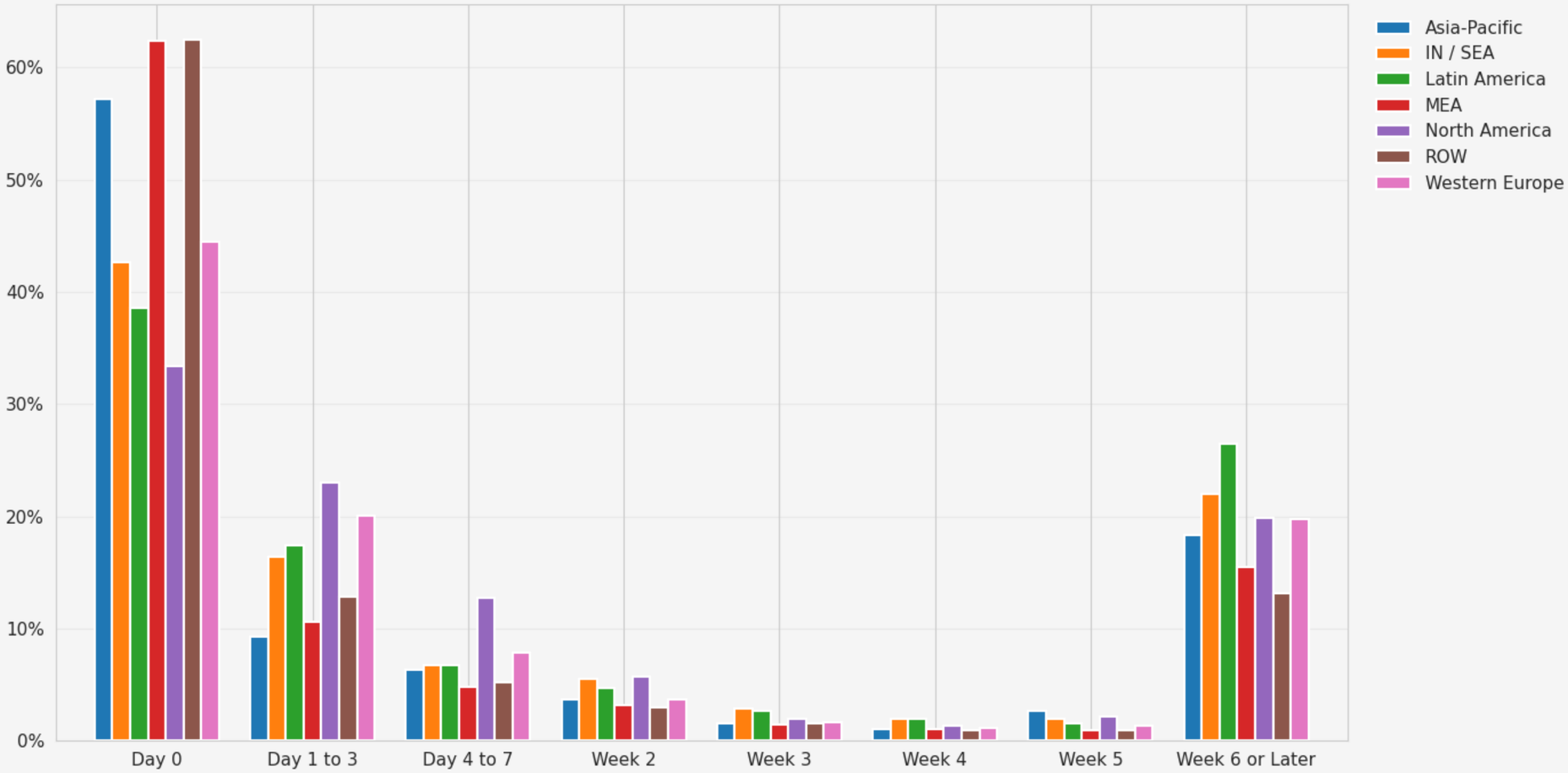
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



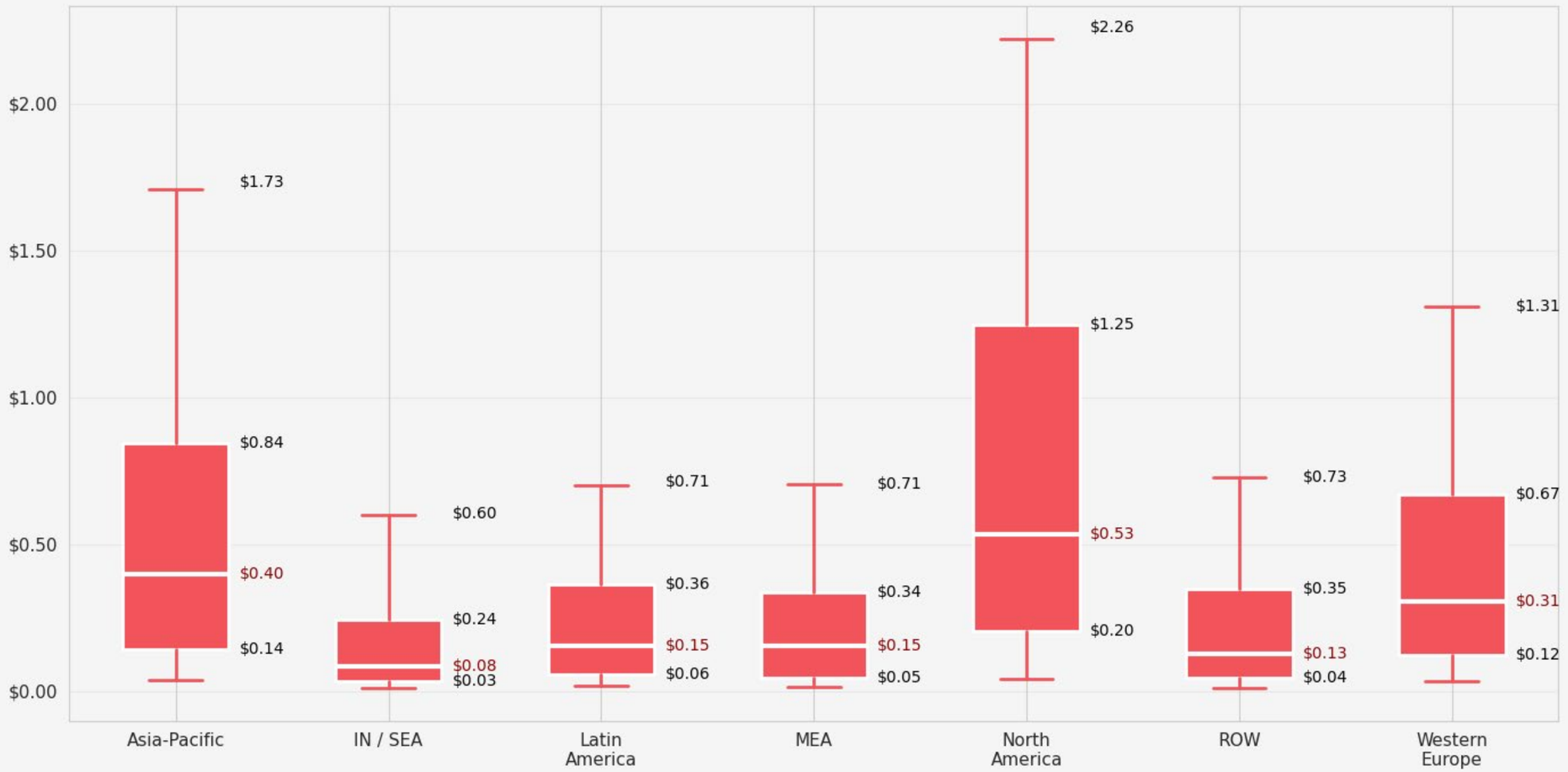
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



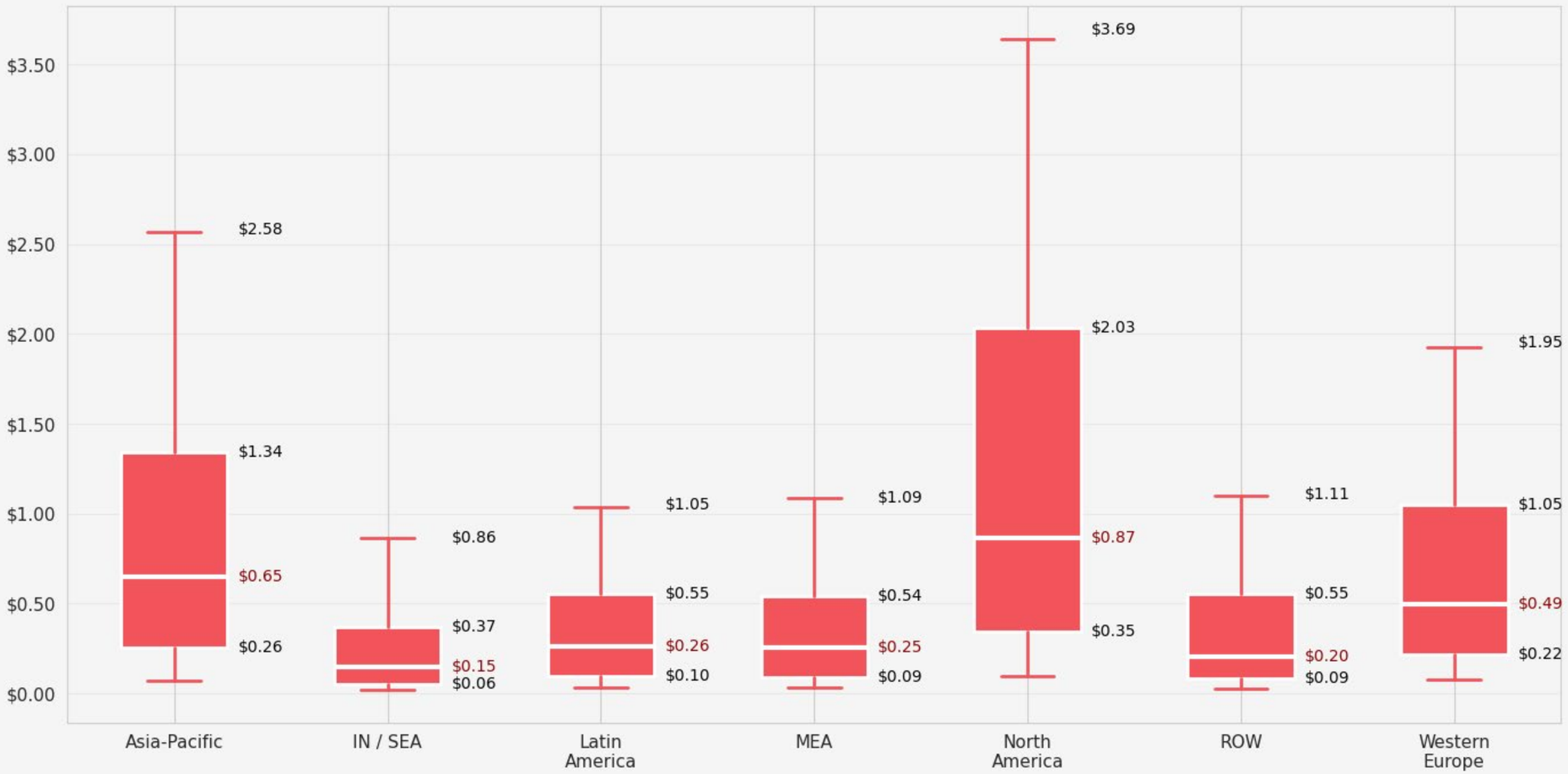
# Time-to-paid, by geography



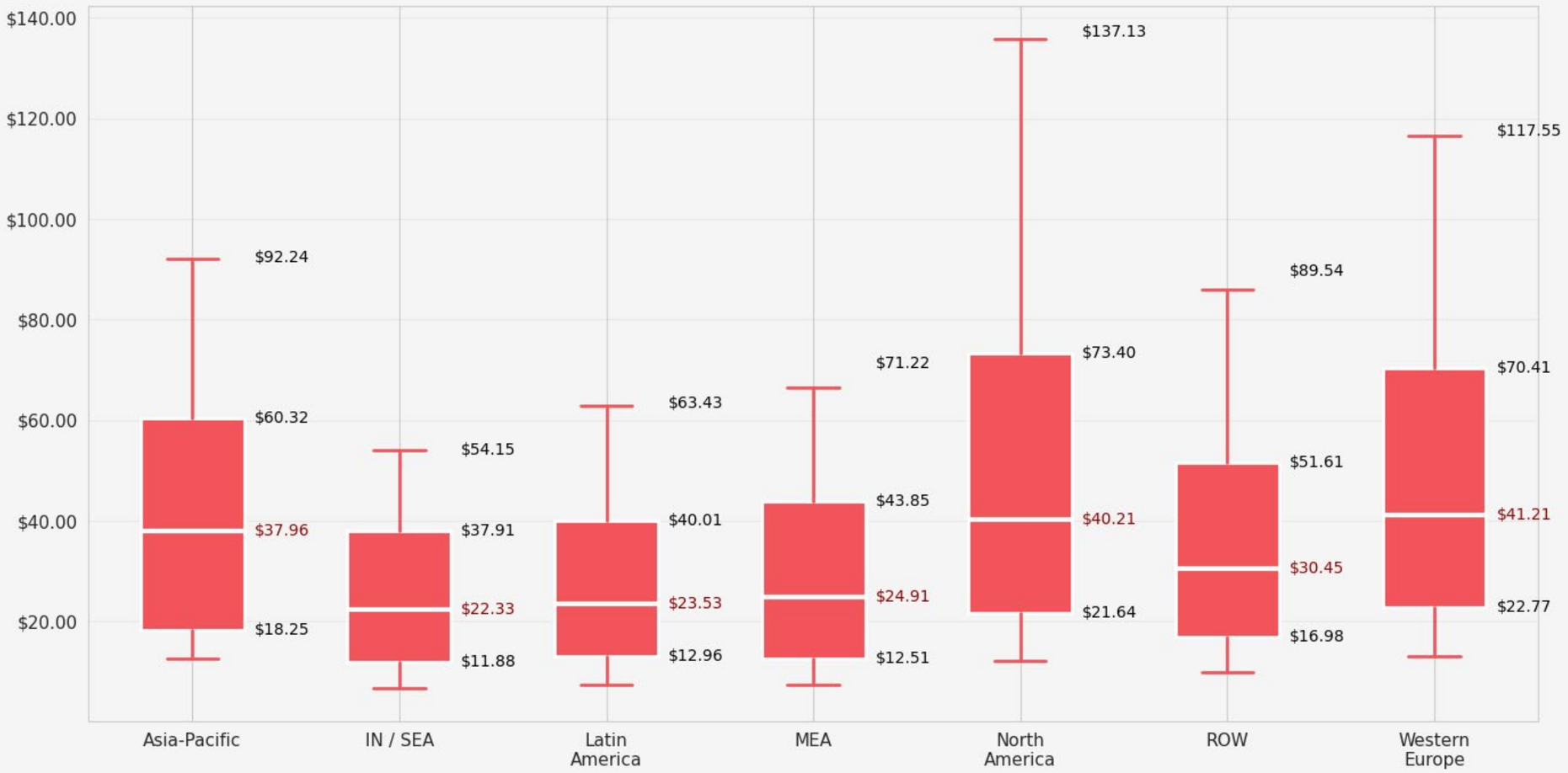
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



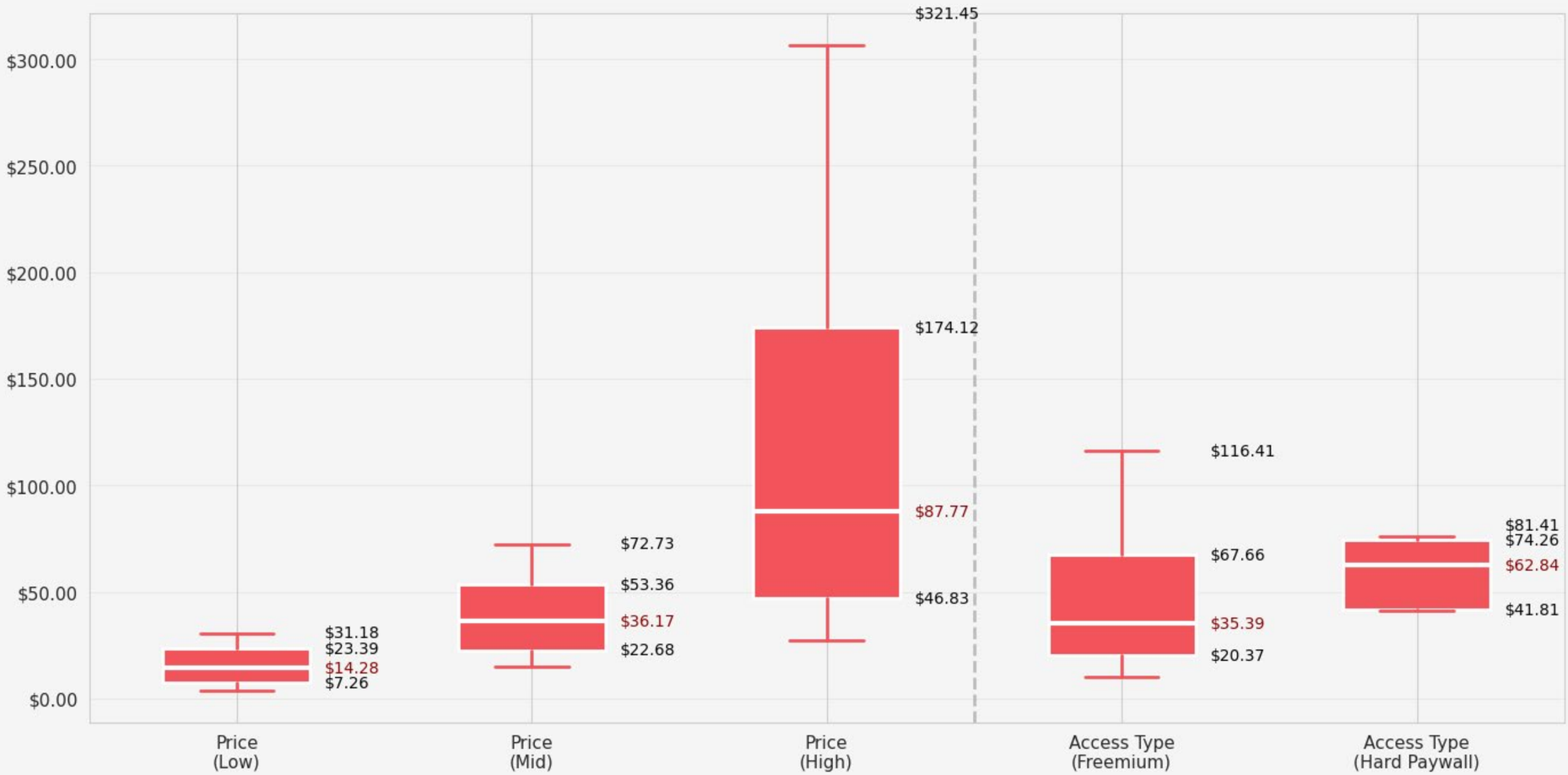
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



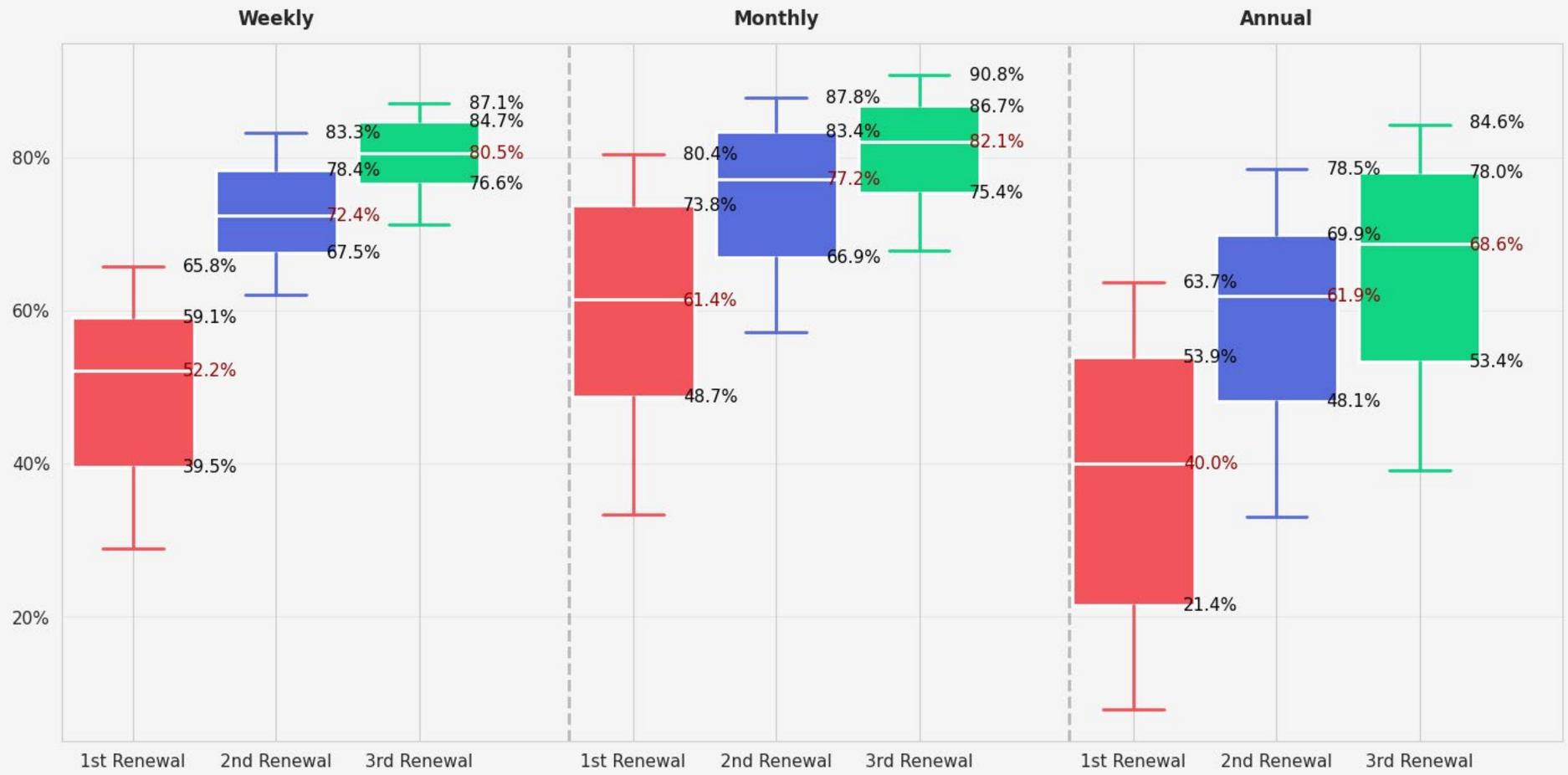
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



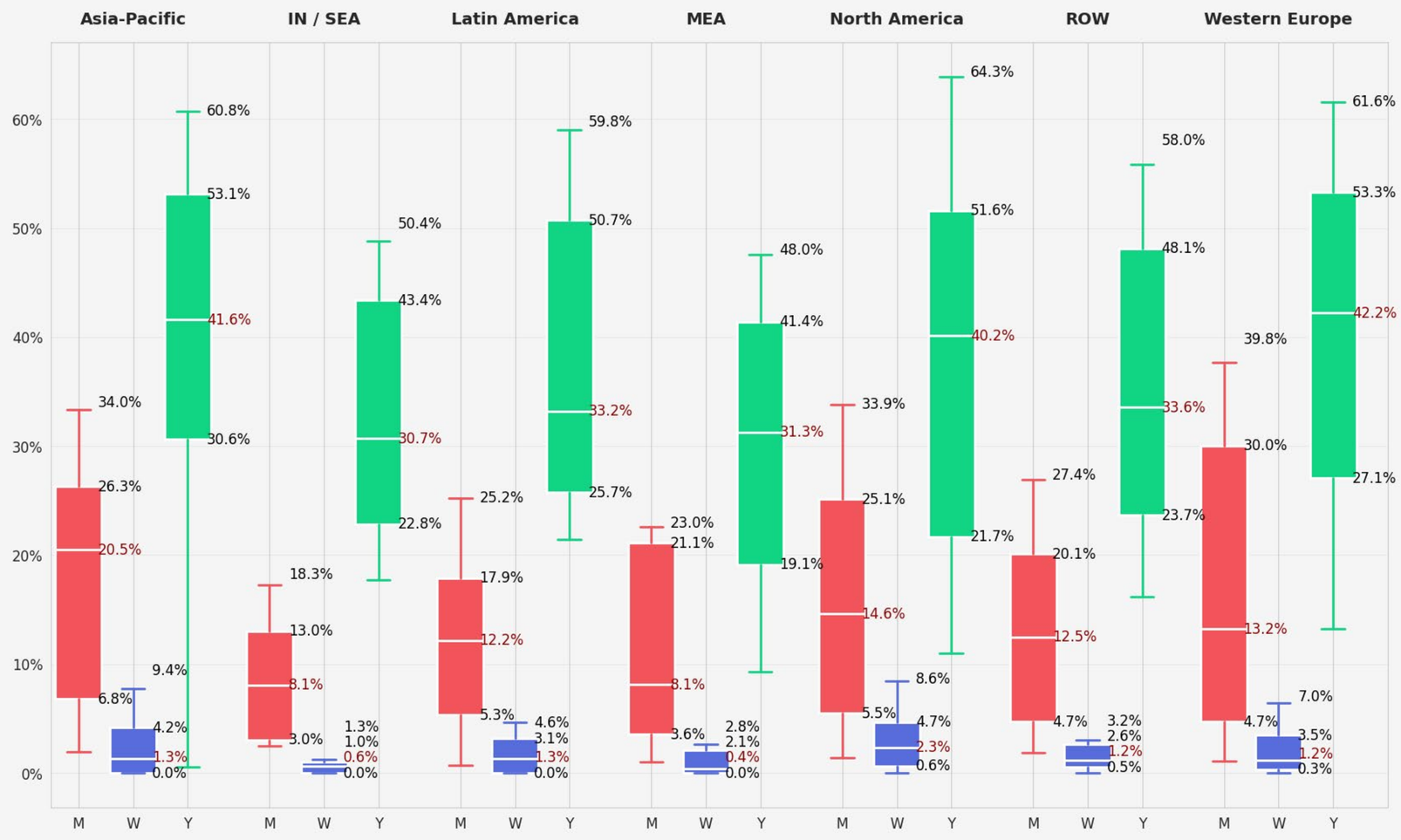
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Education

# Education: key takeaways

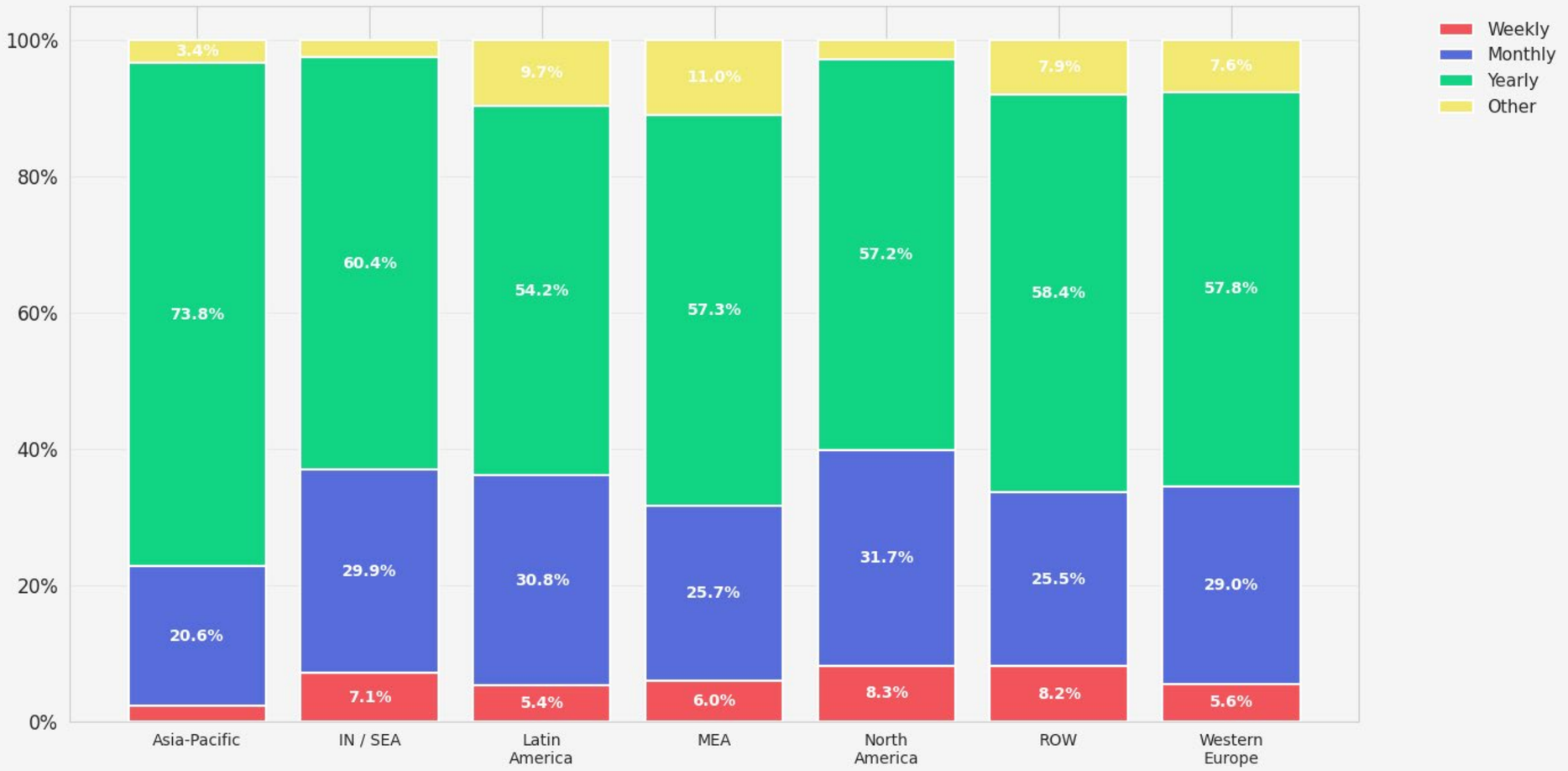
Education apps show modest median conversion and revenue density — but meaningful upside at the top end. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion clusters around ~0.7%–2.7% depending on geography, with North America highest at 2.7%. Revenue per install (RPI) expands post-install (e.g., North America $0.51 at D14 to $0.69 at D60), but absolute levels remain moderate relative to higher-monetizing categories.

Median Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ranges from $20.09 (MEA) and $18.30 (IN/SEA) to $39.15 (North America) and $33.07 (Western Europe). Dispersion is wide: North America's top percentile reaches $91.19. Education is not structurally low-value — but outcomes are highly execution-dependent, with significant spread between median and top performers.

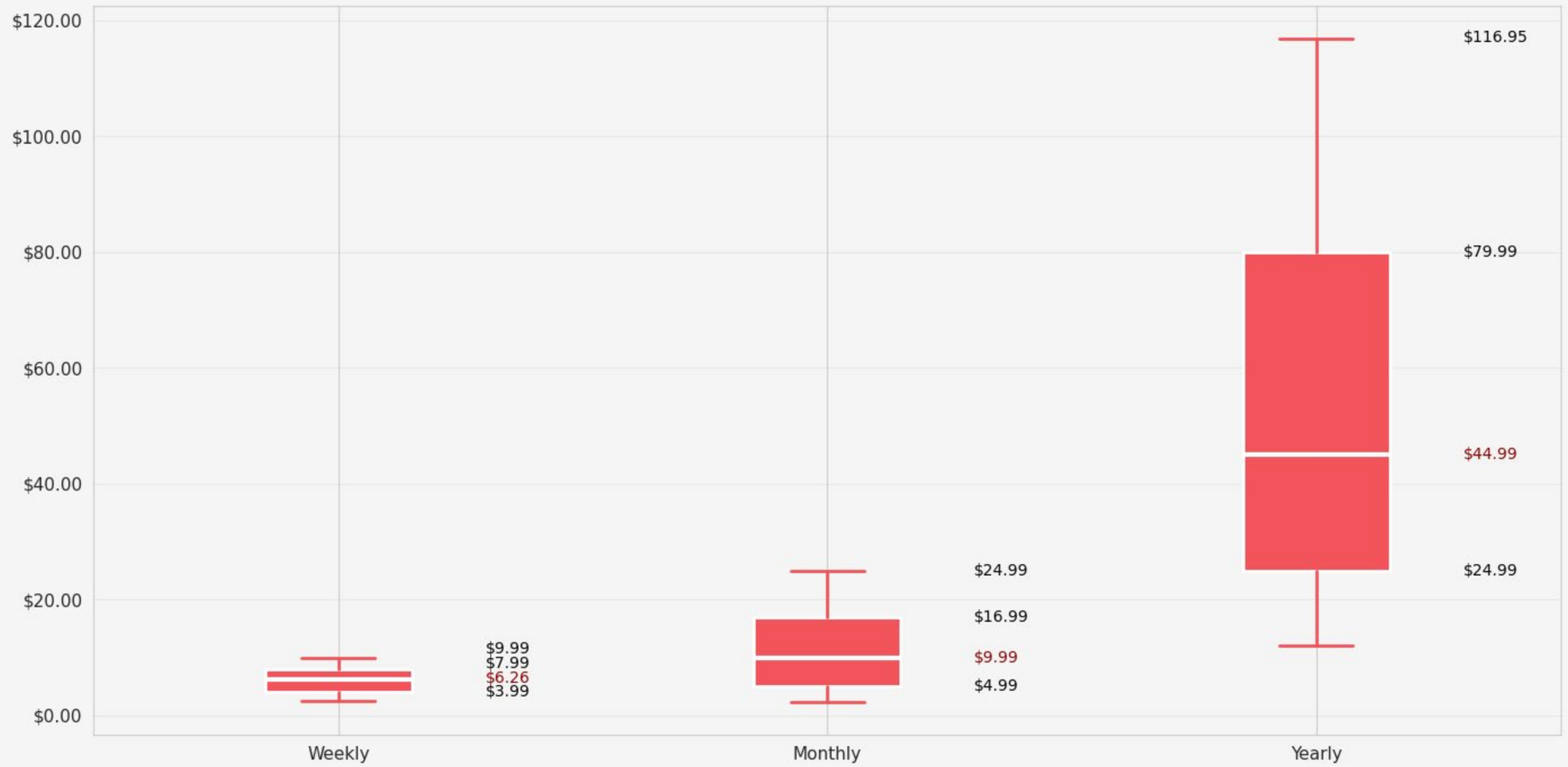
## What stands out

- North America defines the ceiling: median Y1 RLTV per payer reaches $39.15 in North America, vs. $31.29 in Asia-Pacific and $18.30 in IN/SEA. The top percentile in North America ($91.19) underscores how much headroom exists above the median.
- Conversion is modest — and geographically variable: median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.7% (IN/SEA) to 2.7% (North America). Western Europe sits at 1.8%. Education conversion is measurable, but not high-velocity.
- Trial efficiency drives separation: median trial-to-paid conversion spans from 18.3% (IN/SEA) and 24.9% (MEA) to 37.4% (North America) and 34.3% (Western Europe). Trial start rates are moderate — e.g., 7.2% median in North America, 5.8% in Asia-Pacific — so conversion quality matters.
- RPI expands — but at lower density: North America grows from $0.51 (D14) to $0.69 (D60). Asia-Pacific grows from $0.33 to $0.45. Expansion exists, but revenue accumulation per install remains relatively constrained.
- Annual plans dominate volume: across geographies, annual subscriptions represent the majority of units sold (e.g., 57.2% in North America, 58.4% in ROW, 57.8% in Western Europe). Weekly plans account for a small share (generally ~5%–8%), reinforcing Education's longer-term value orientation.

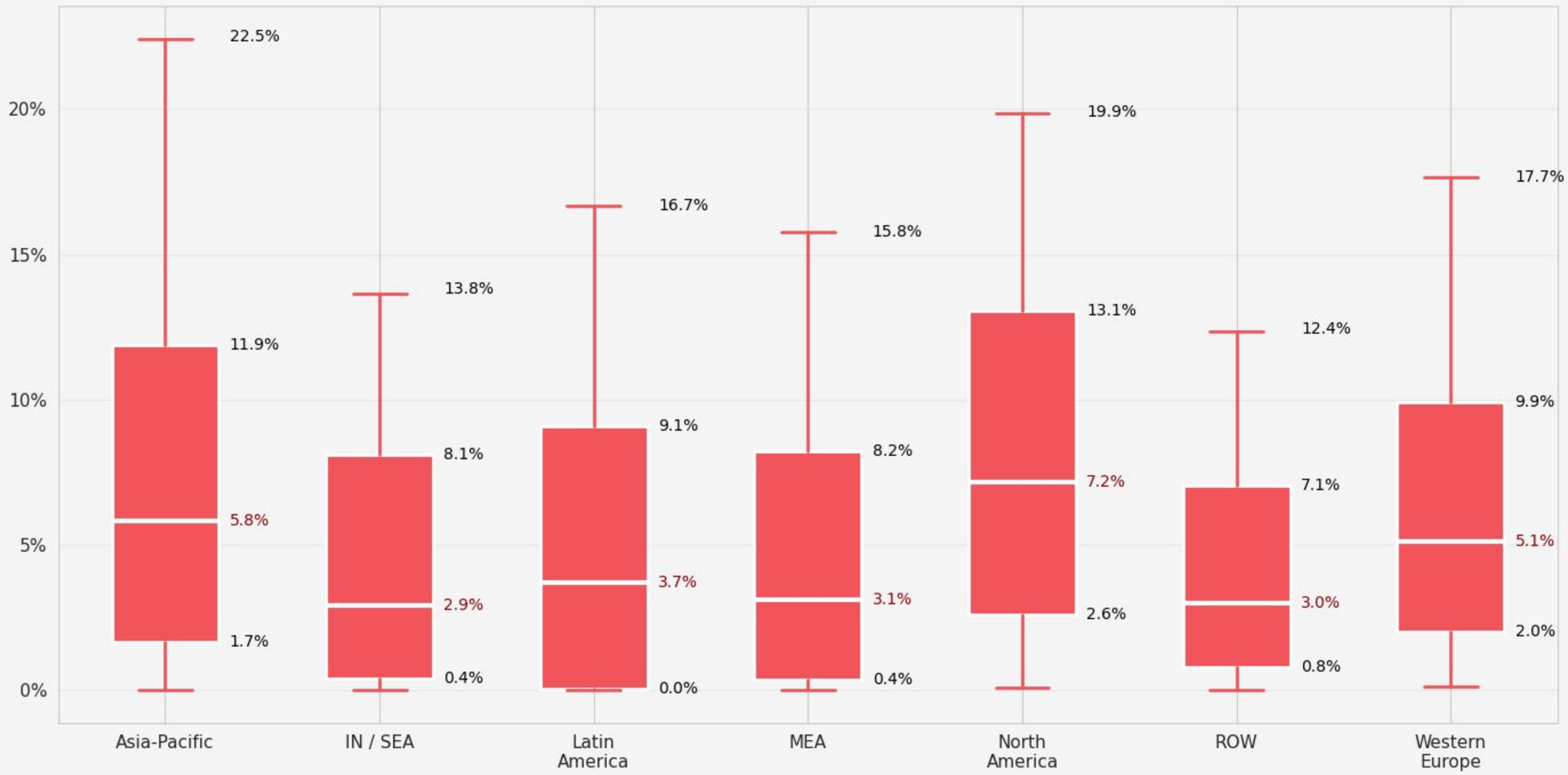
# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography



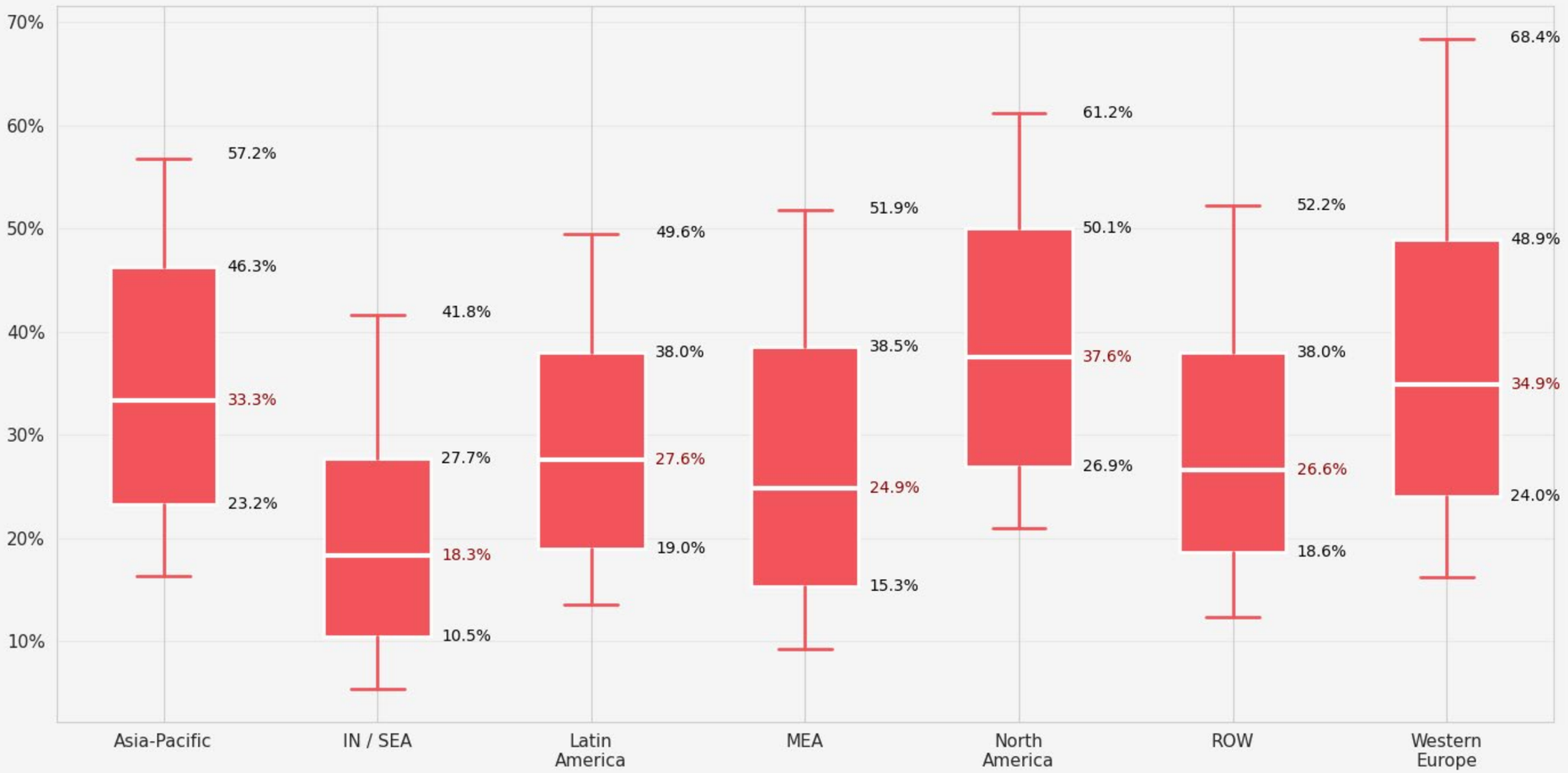
# Pricepoints per plan duration



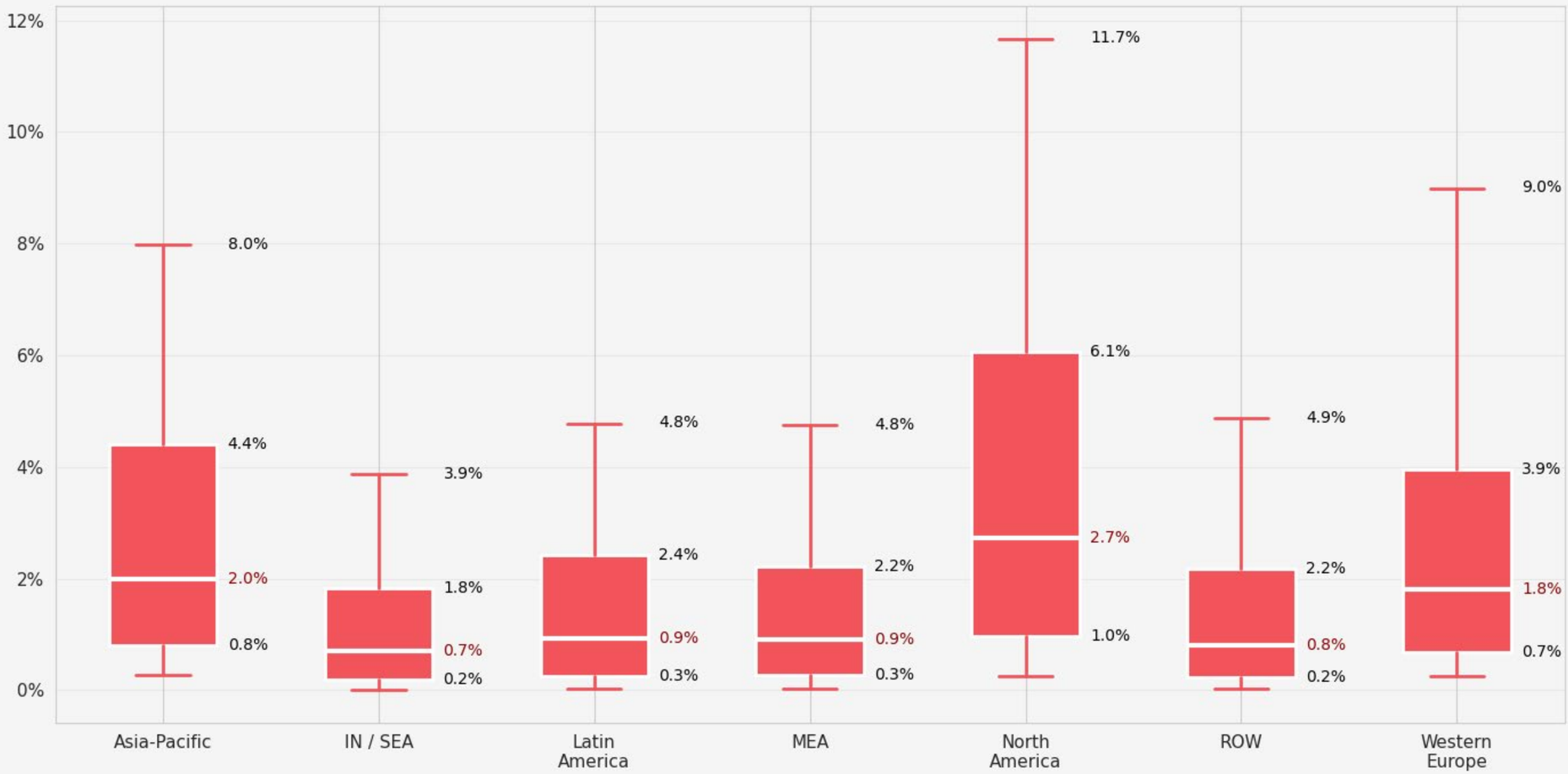
# Trial start rate, by geography



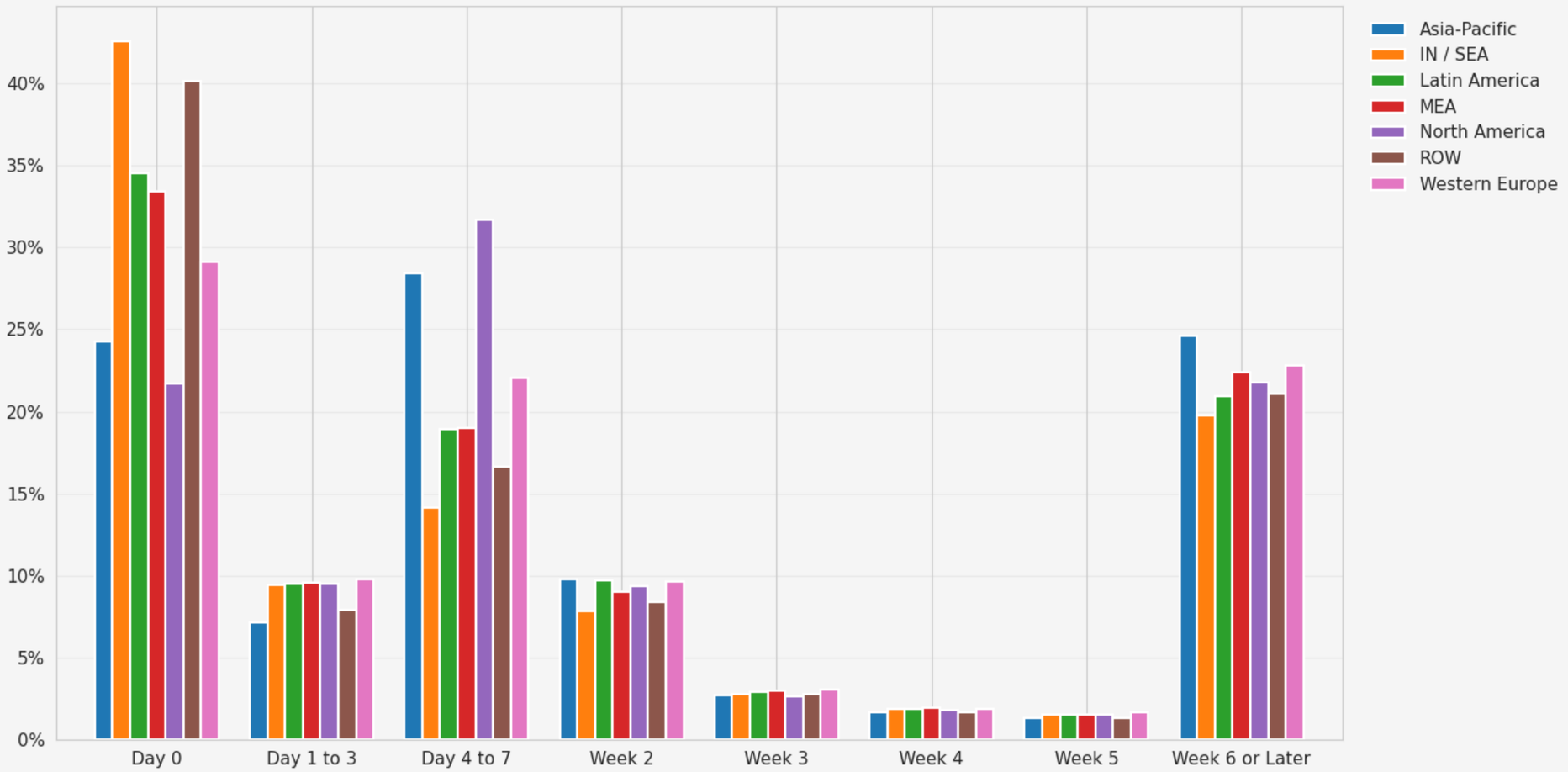
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



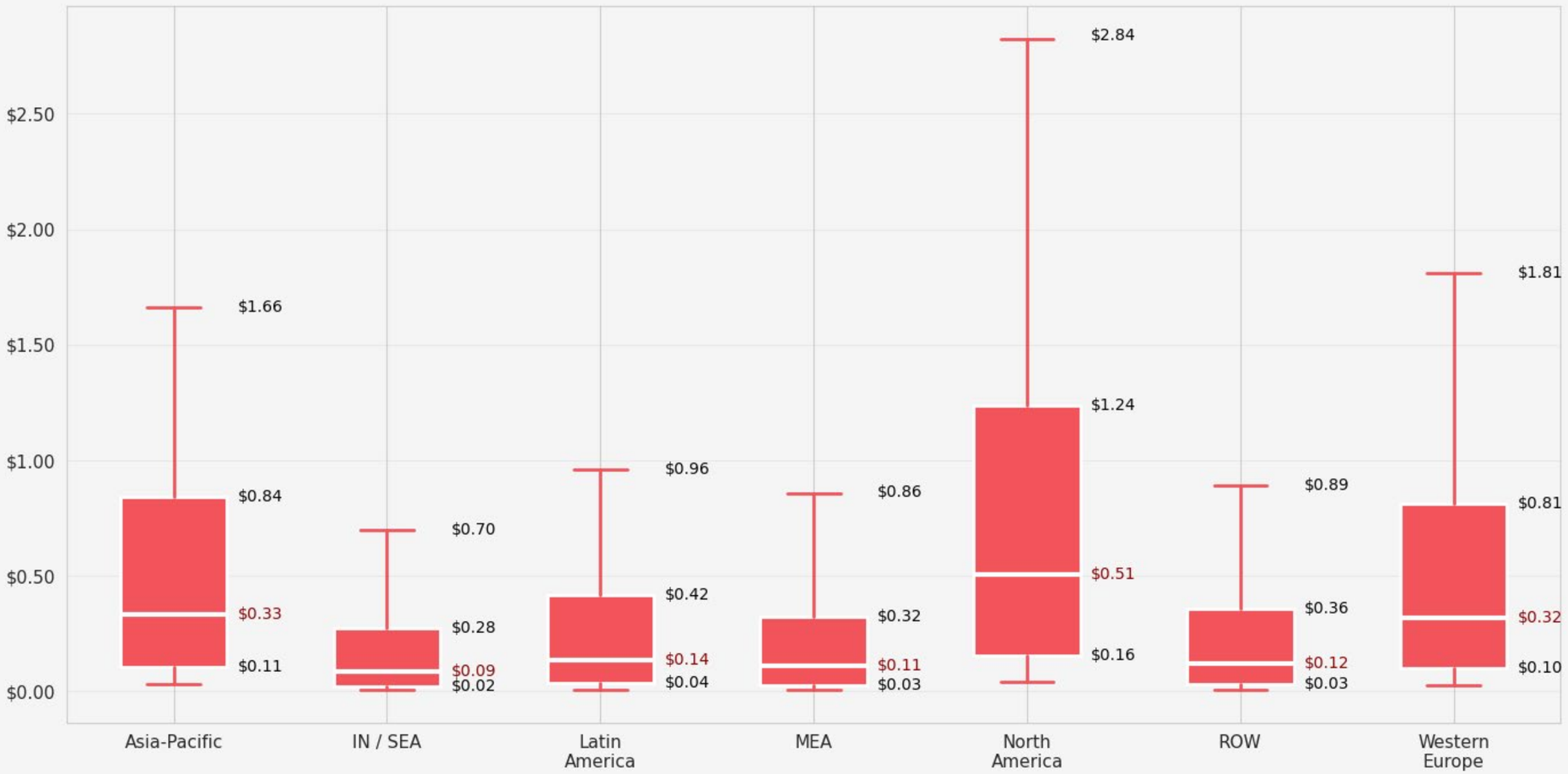
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



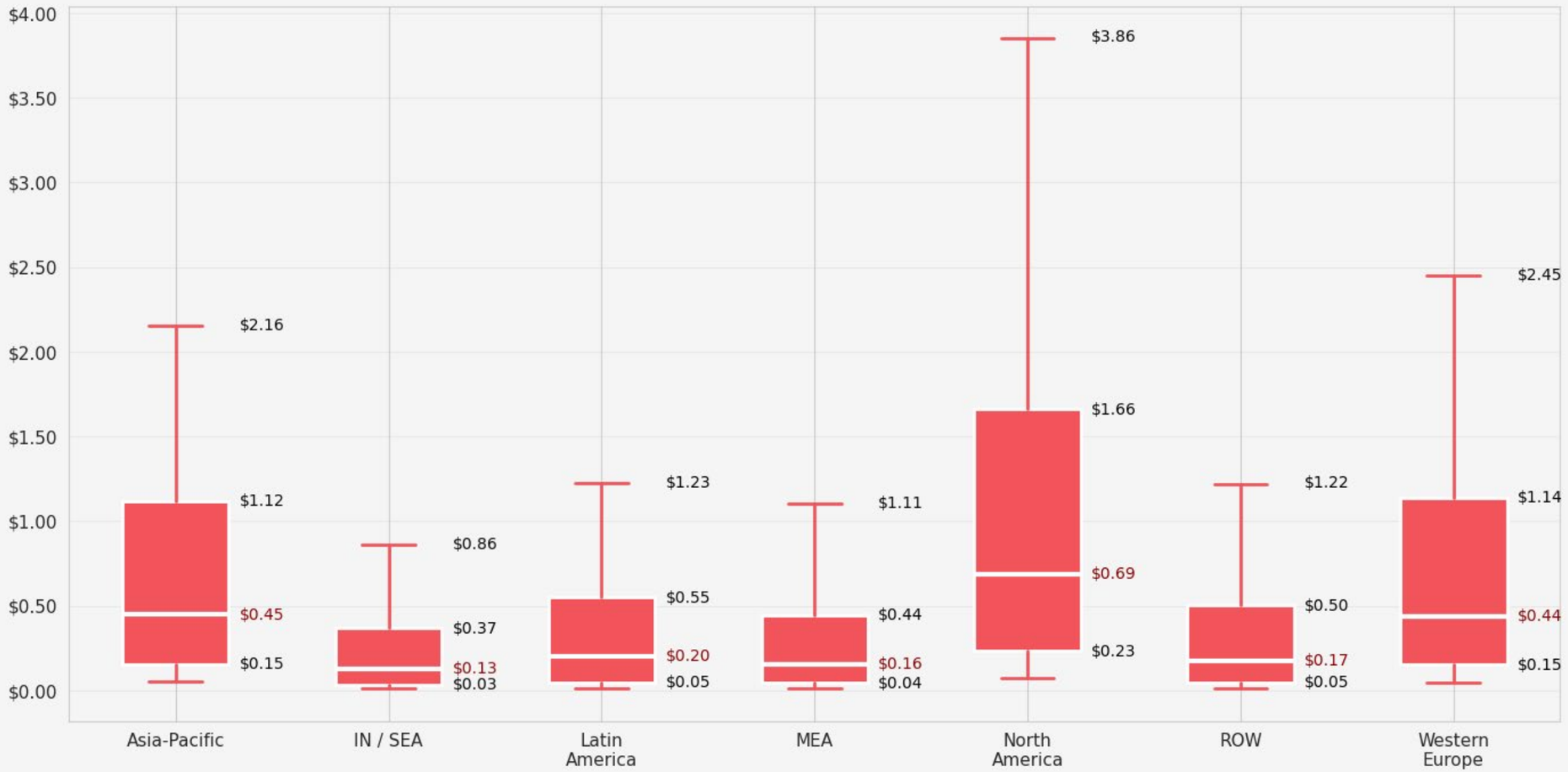
# Time-to-paid, by geography



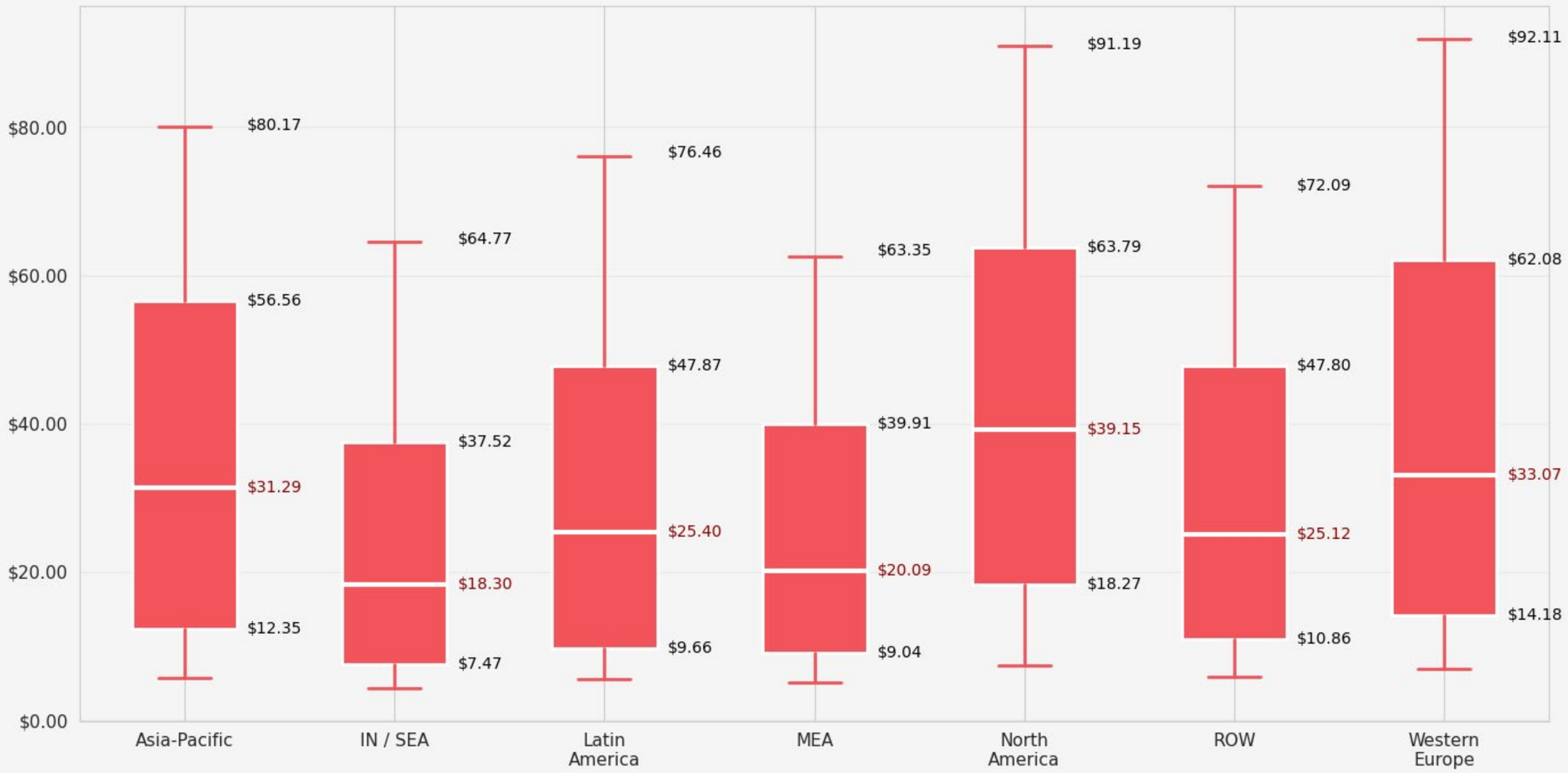
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



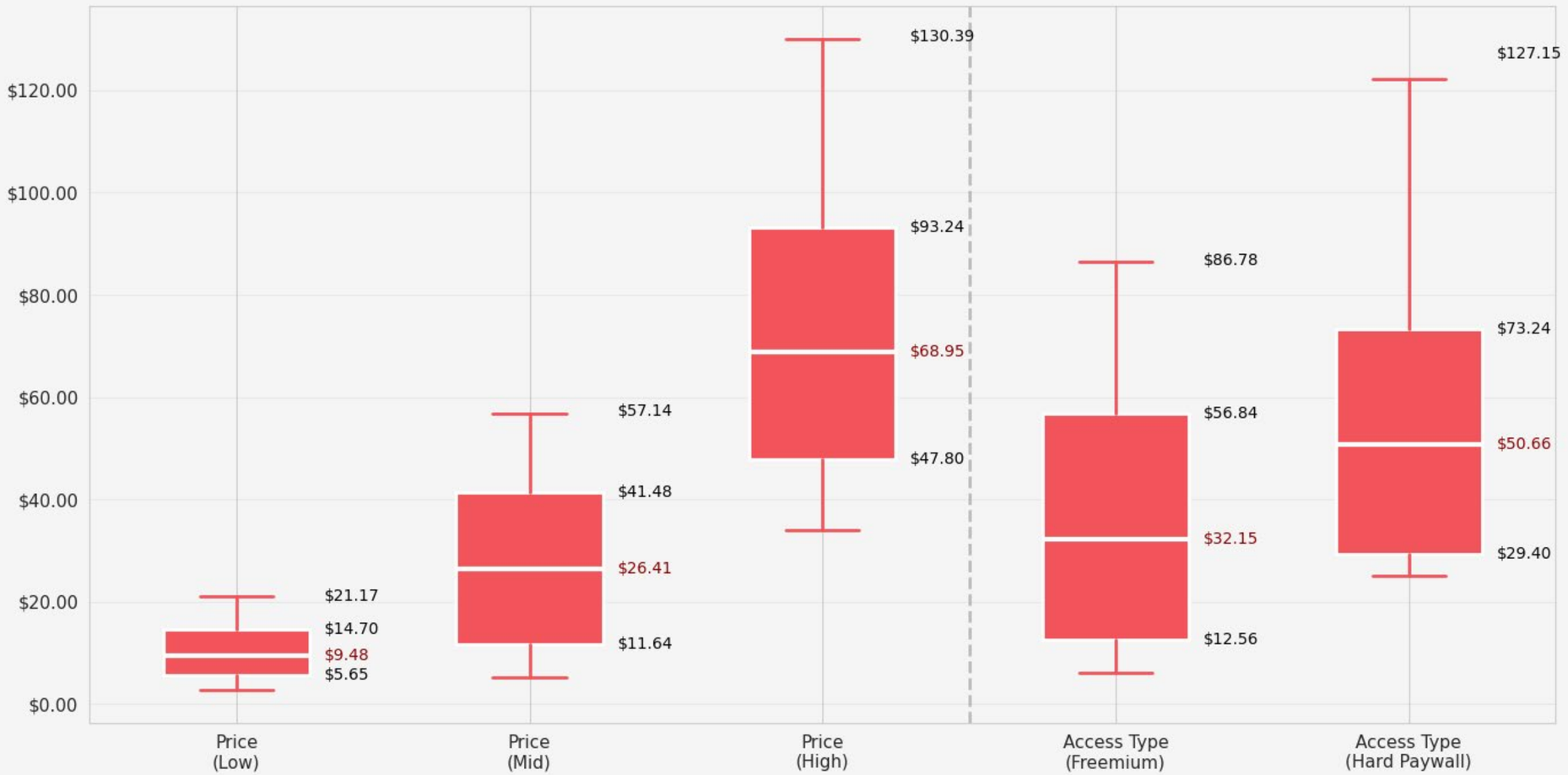
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



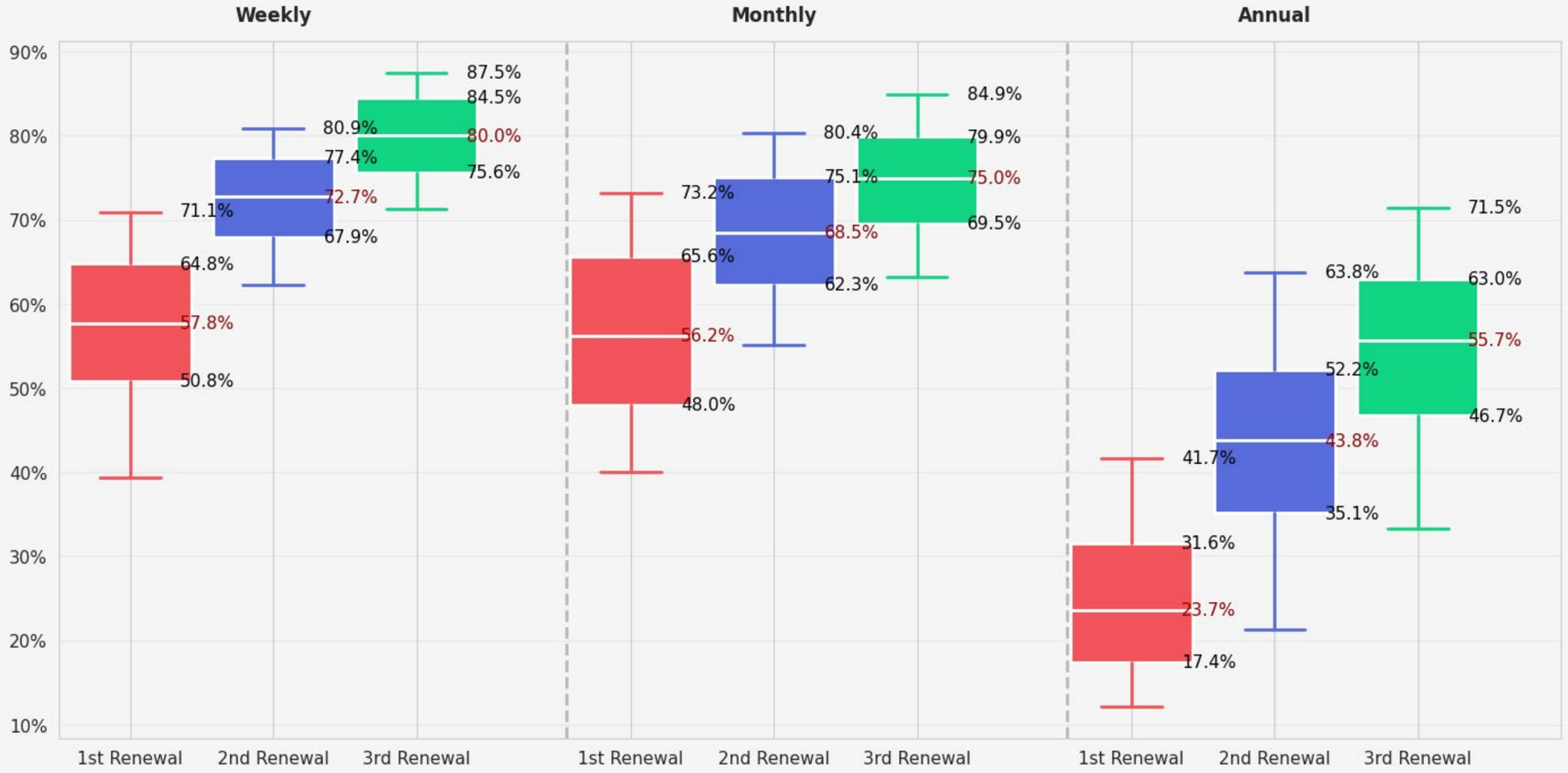
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



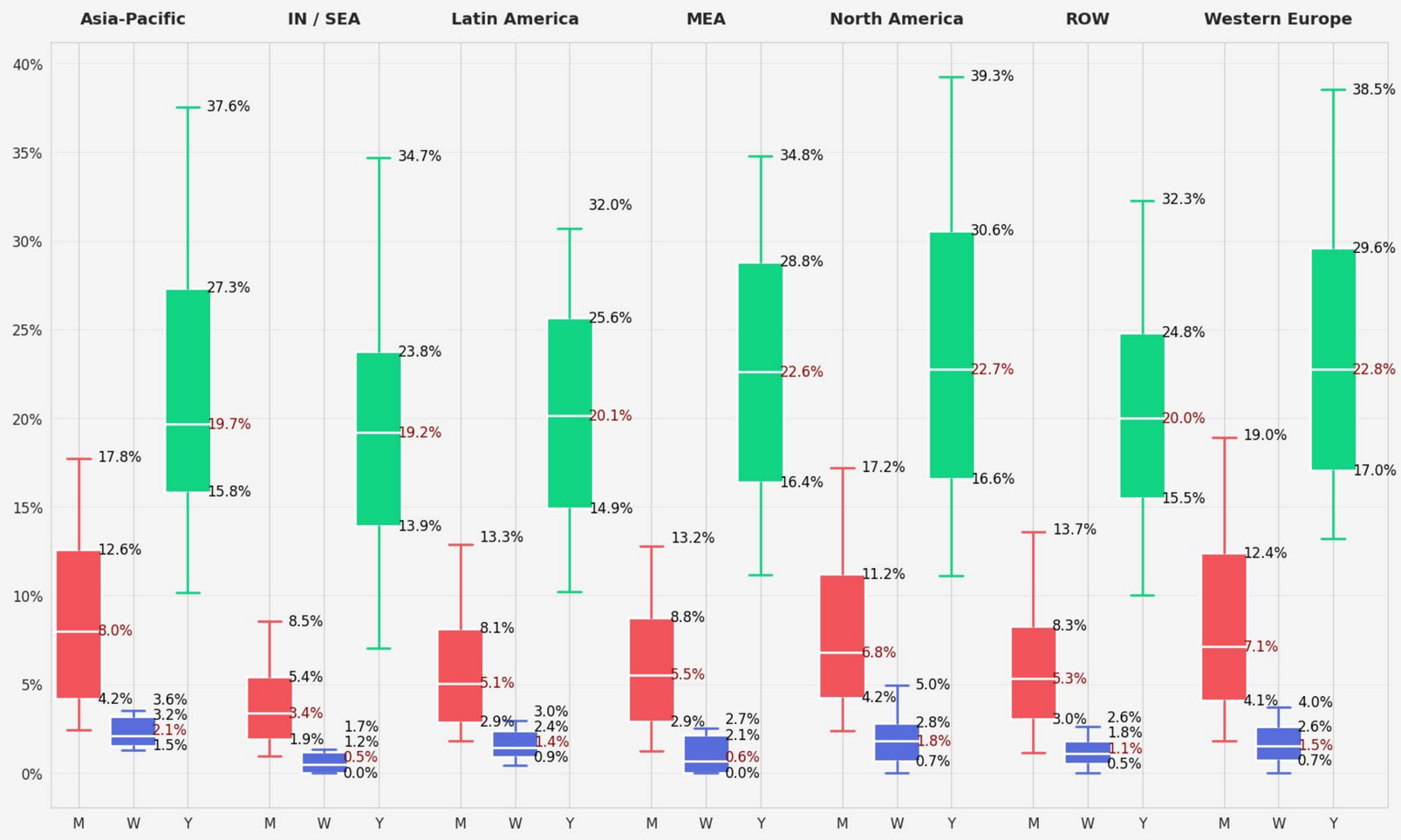
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Gaming

# Gaming: key takeaways

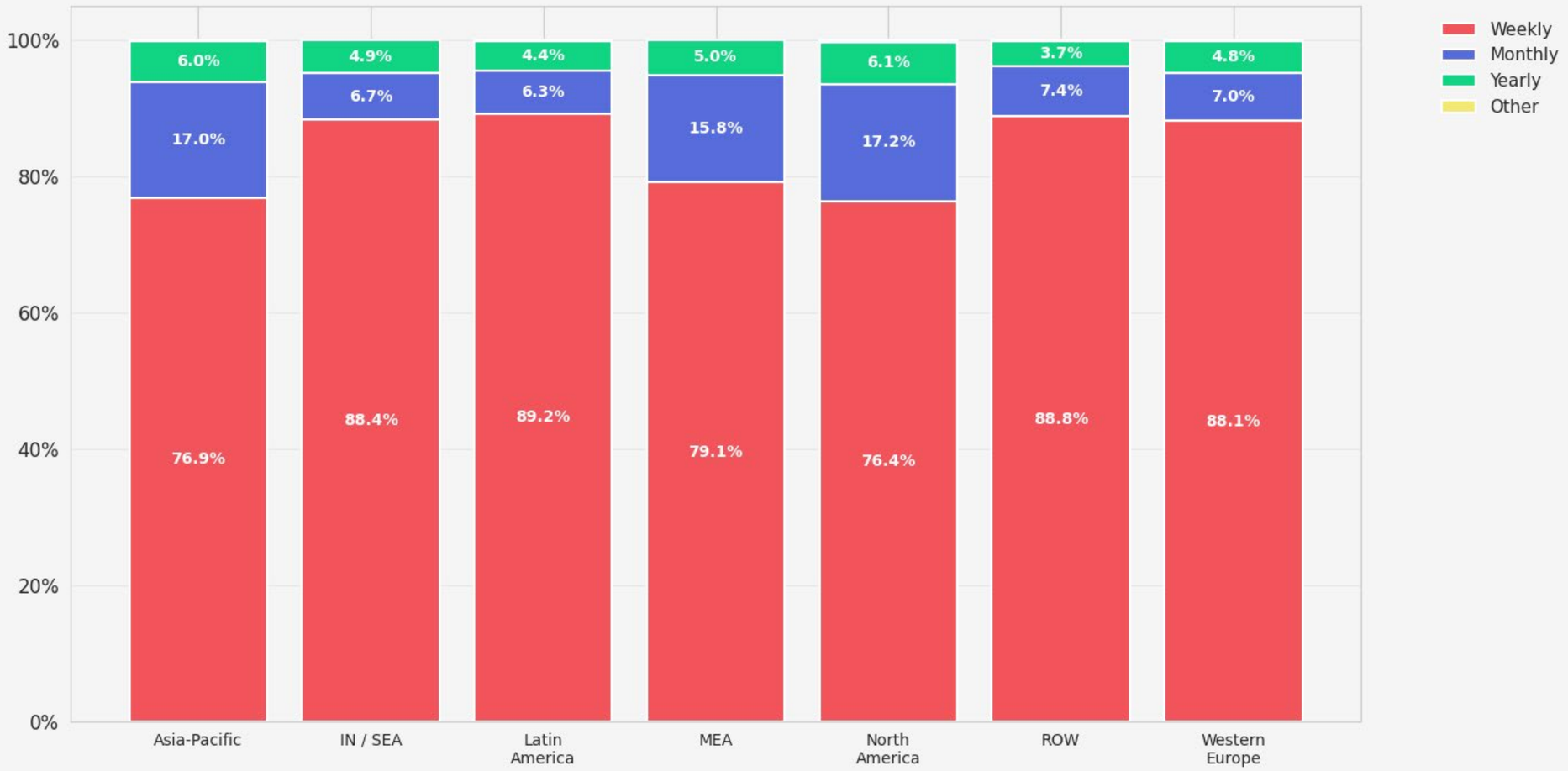
Gaming apps monetize fast, lean heavily on short subscription durations, and concentrate value among a small share of payers. The median download-to-paid rate at D35 is just 0.7%, with a significant portion of conversions happening immediately after install. Weekly plans dominate globally, and higher price tiers drive substantially higher Y1 lifetime value (LTV) per payer.

The pattern is clear: Gaming is a high-churn, front-loaded category where price positioning and geography shape outcomes more than almost anything else. Geographic variance in trial behavior, payer value, and revenue per install (RPI) creates wide performance bands. If you're benchmarking in Gaming, category medians are only part of the story — distribution and mix matter just as much.

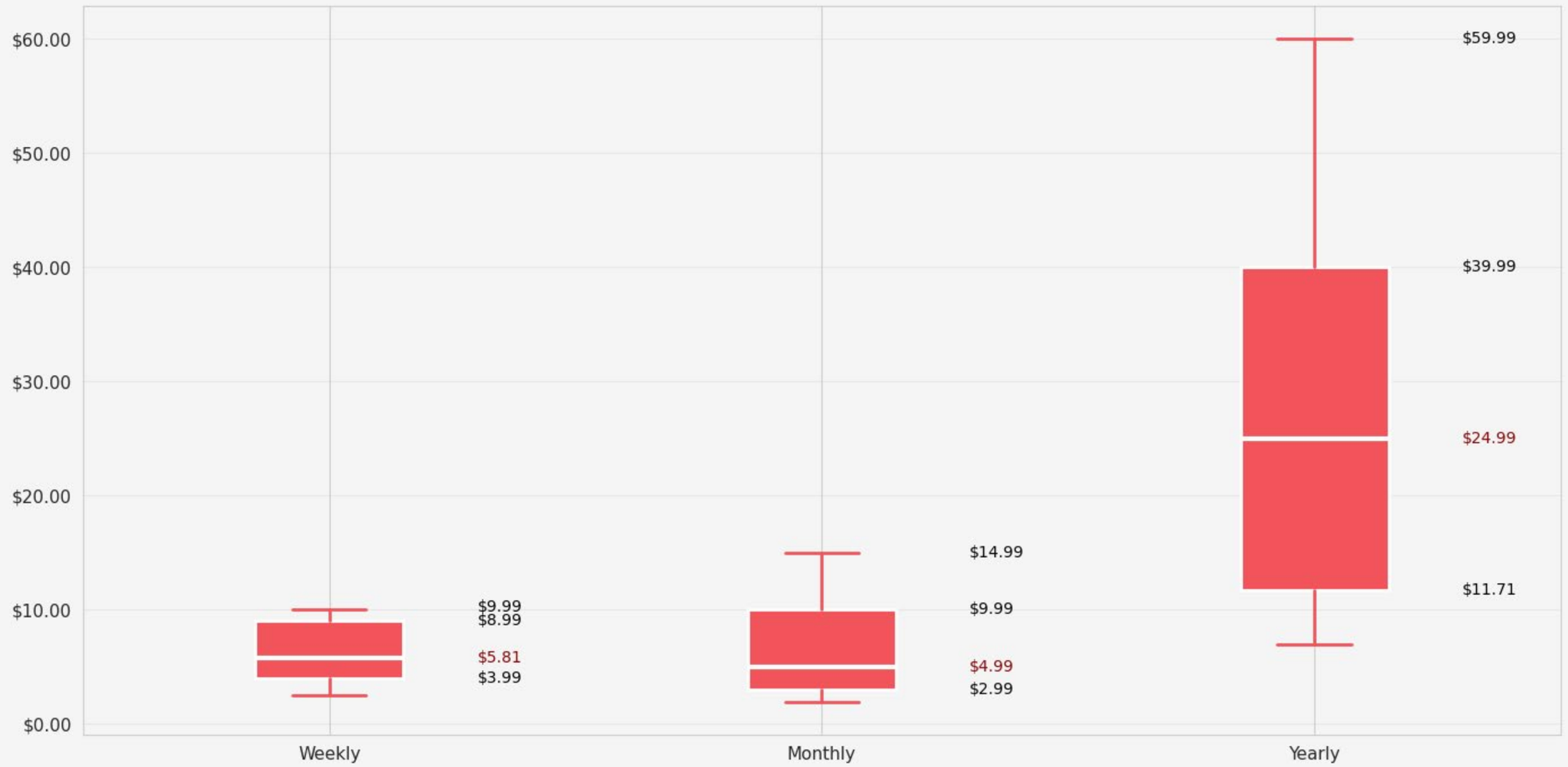
## What stands out

- Conversion is front-loaded — and thin by D35: the median D35 download-to-paid rate is 0.7%. In several geographies, roughly 40%+ of paid conversions occur on day 0 (e.g., 43% in IN/SEA; 40% in North America), reinforcing how critical immediate monetization is.
- Weekly subscriptions dominate the revenue model: weekly plans represent 73.8% of subscriptions in Asia-Pacific and 57–60% across North America, Western Europe, and ROW. Annual rarely exceeds ~11% in any geography shown.
- Price tier strongly separates payer value: median Y1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer increases from $9.48 (low) to $26.41 (mid) to $68.99 (high). Upper ranges for high-priced apps extend past $90 (max shown $130.39), creating meaningful spread.
- Geography drives payer depth and RPI: median Y1 LTV per payer ranges from $18.30 (IN/SEA) to $39.15 (North America). D60 RPI follows a similar pattern, with North America at $0.69 vs. $0.31 in IN/SEA.

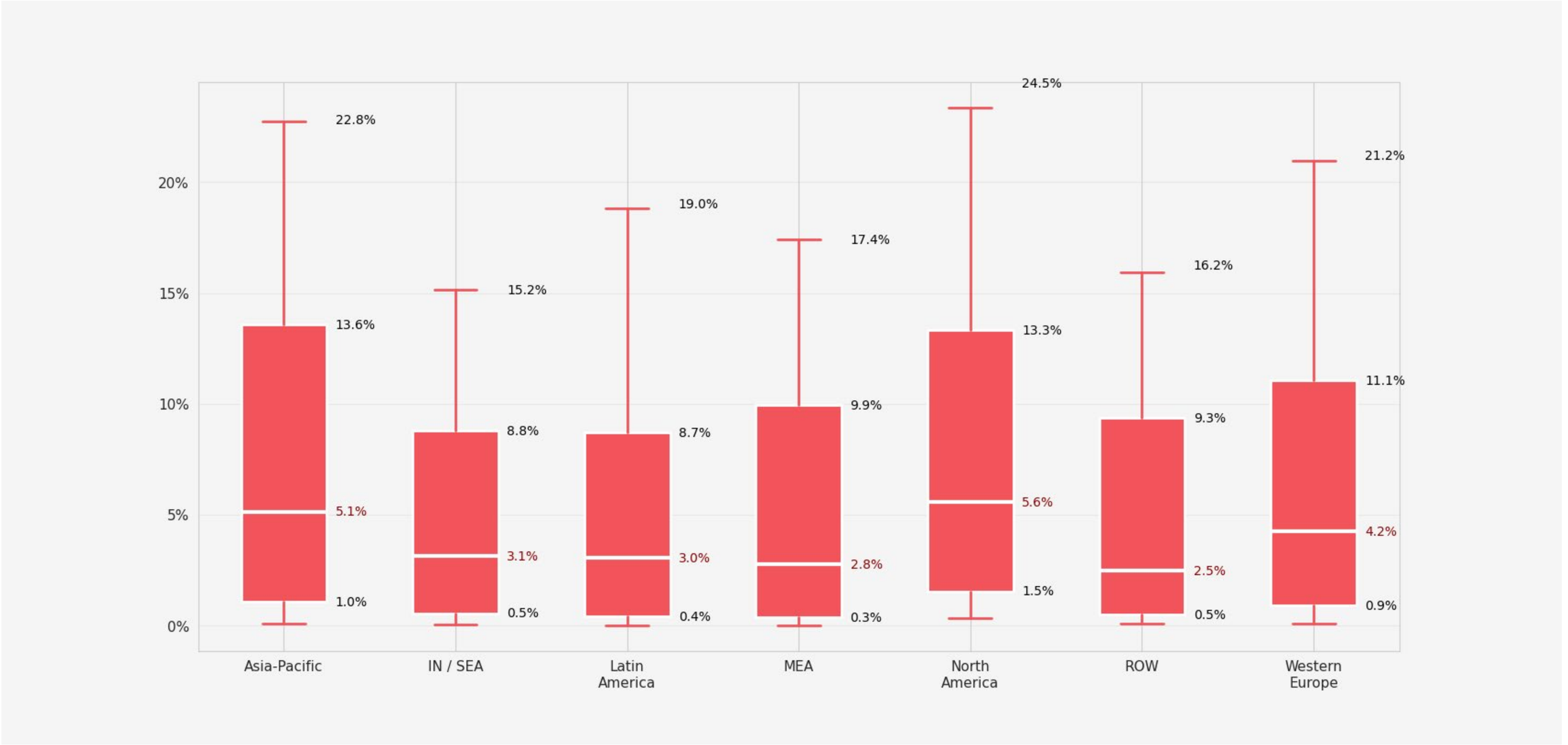
# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography



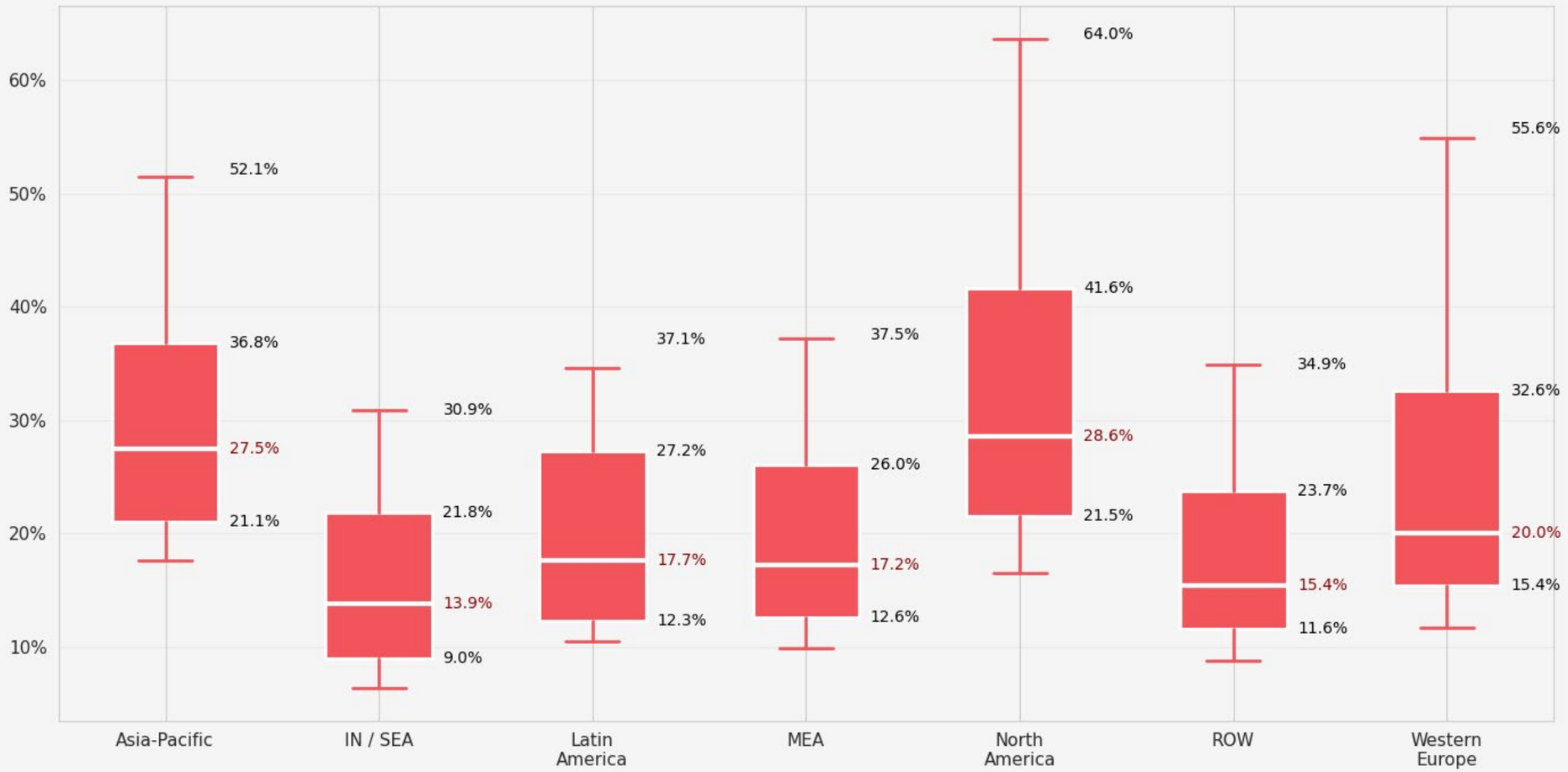
# Pricepoints per plan duration



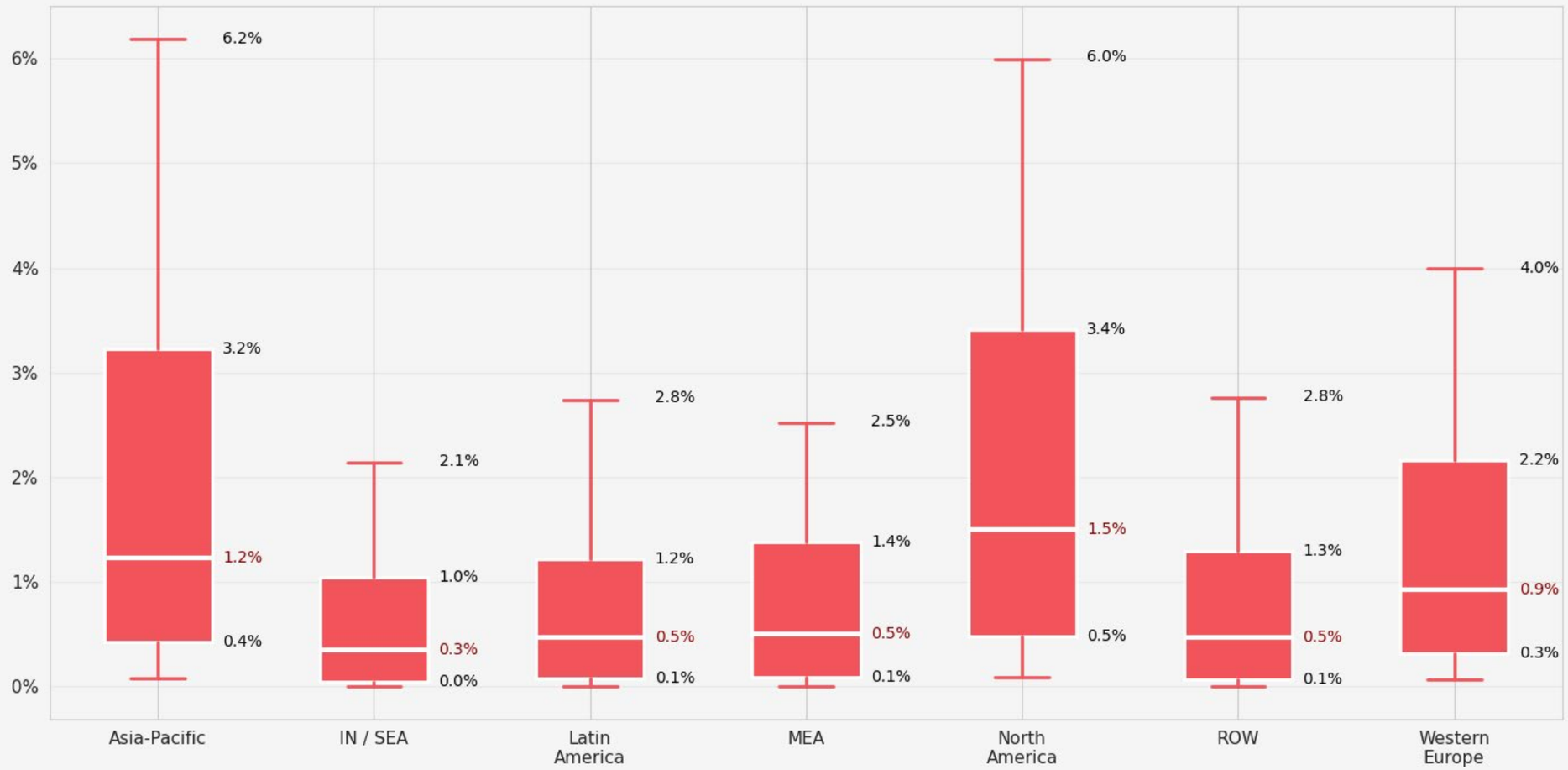
# Trial start rate, by geography



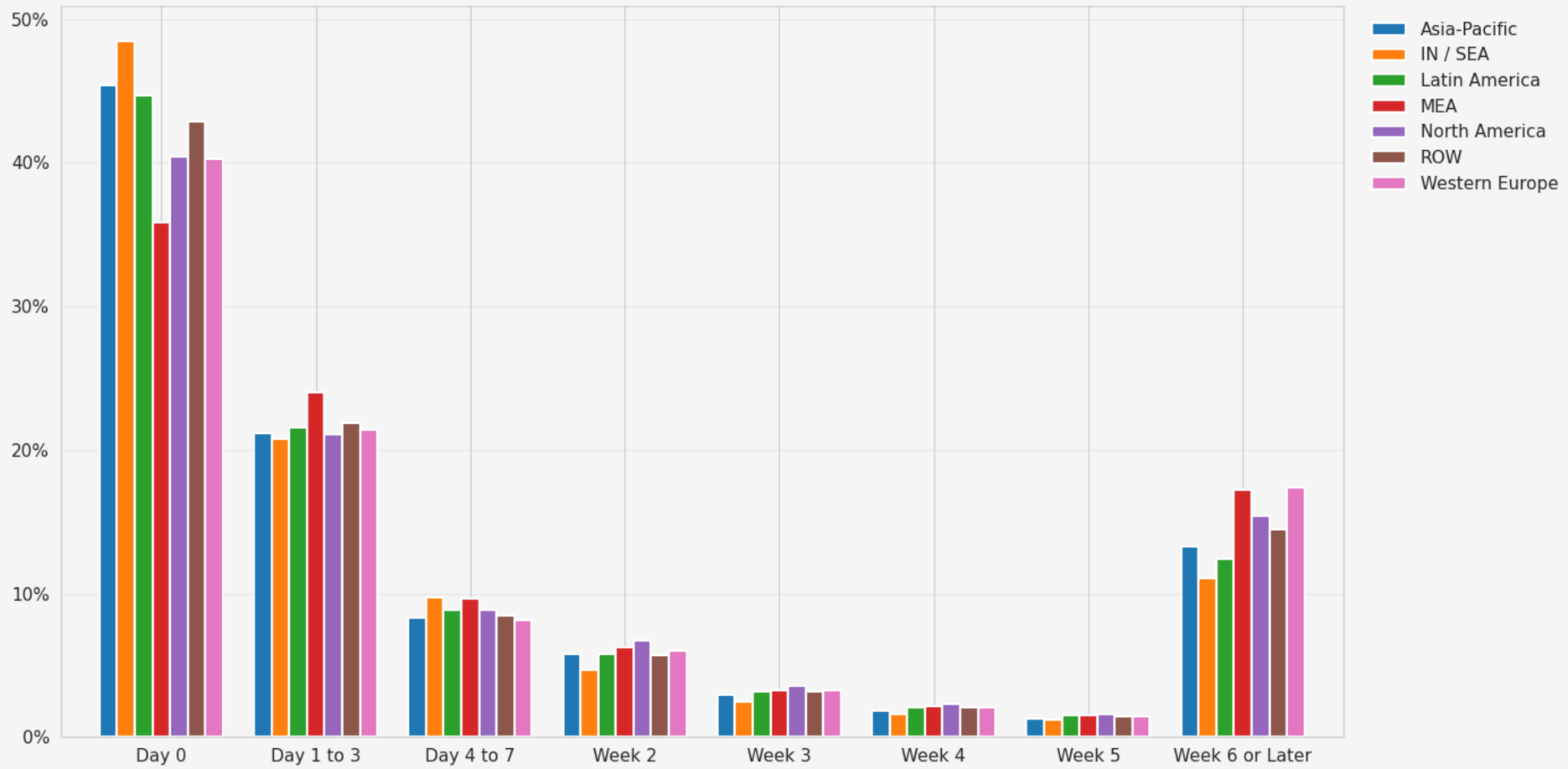
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



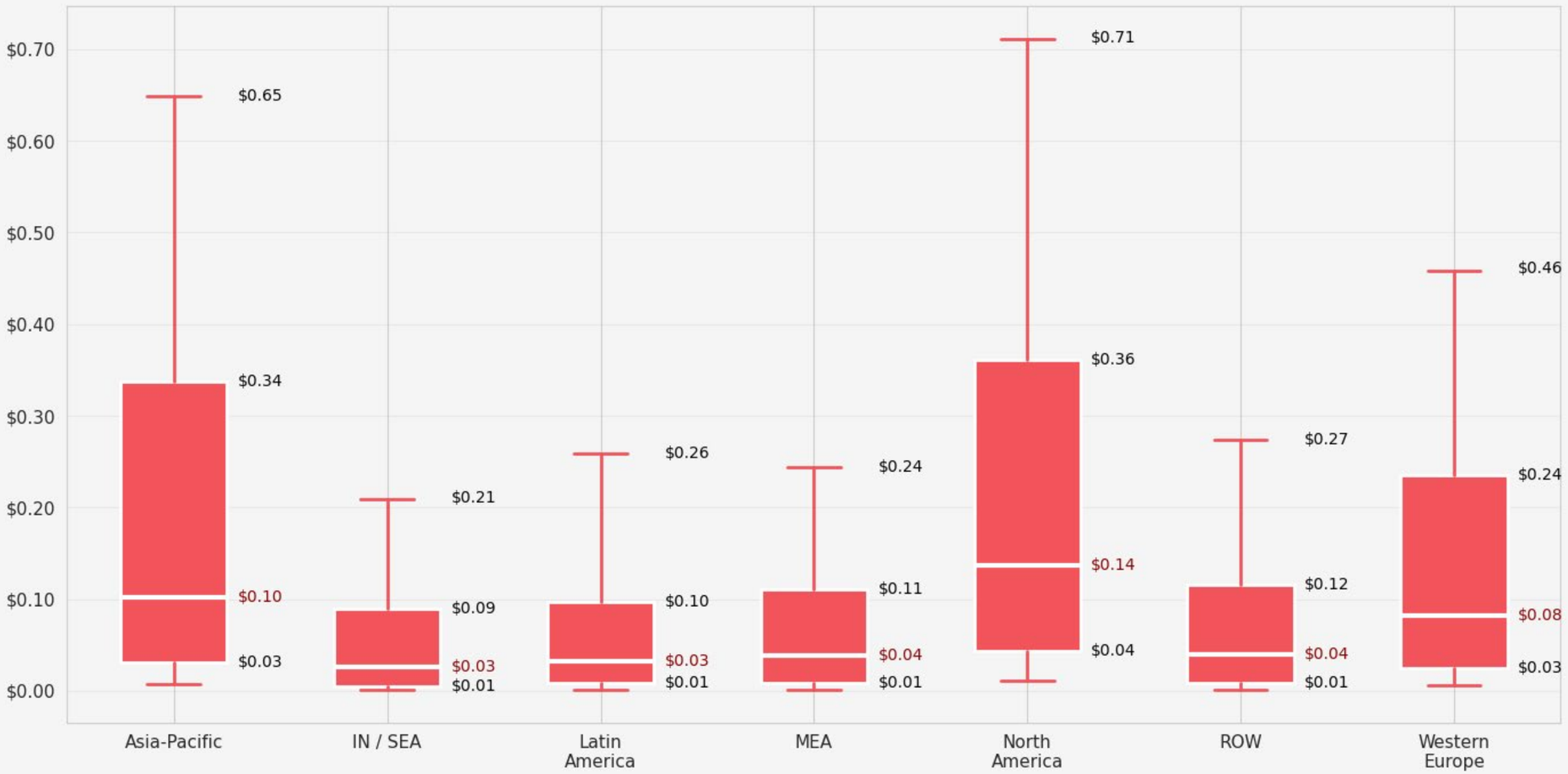
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



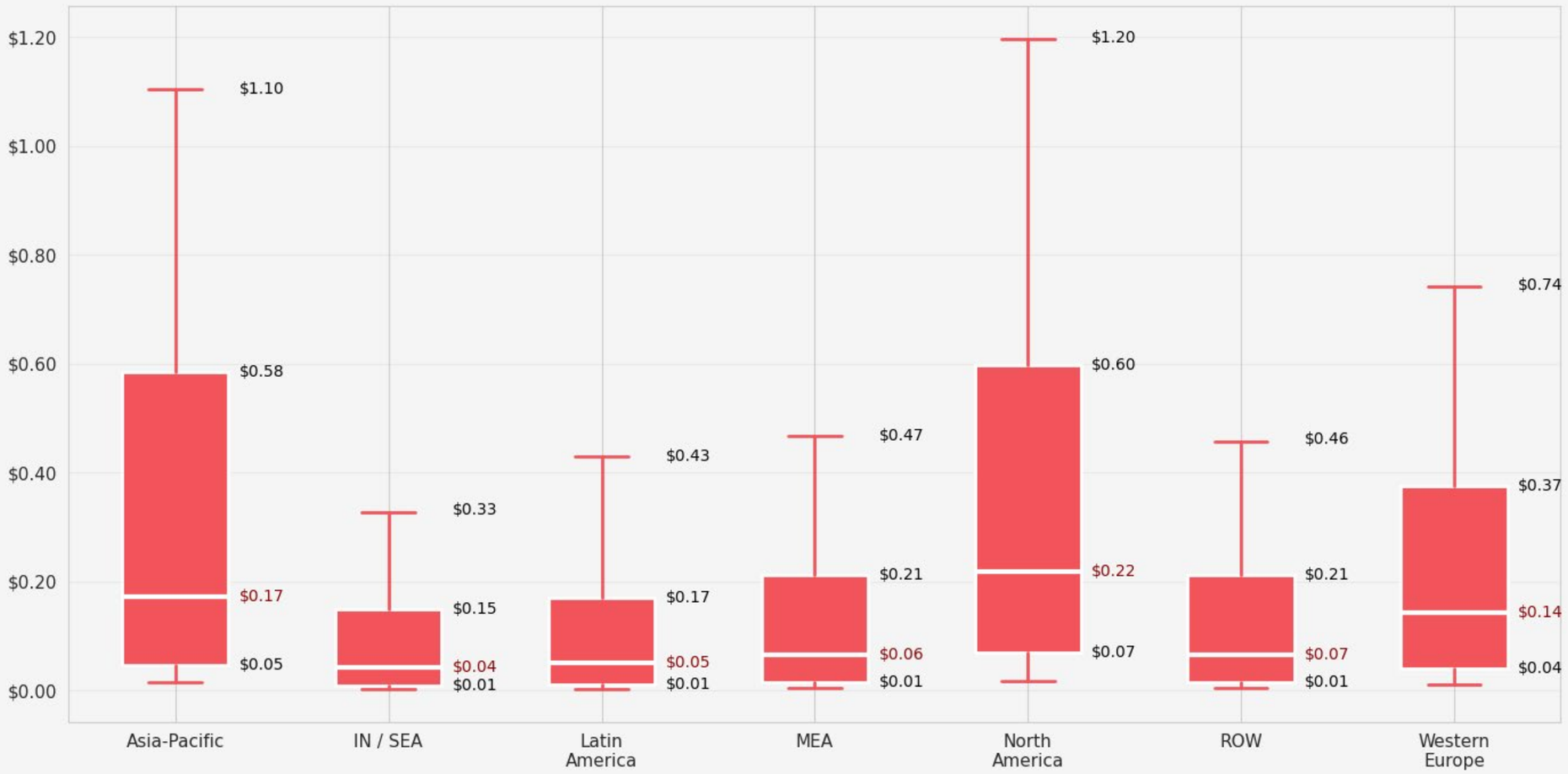
# Time-to-paid, by geography



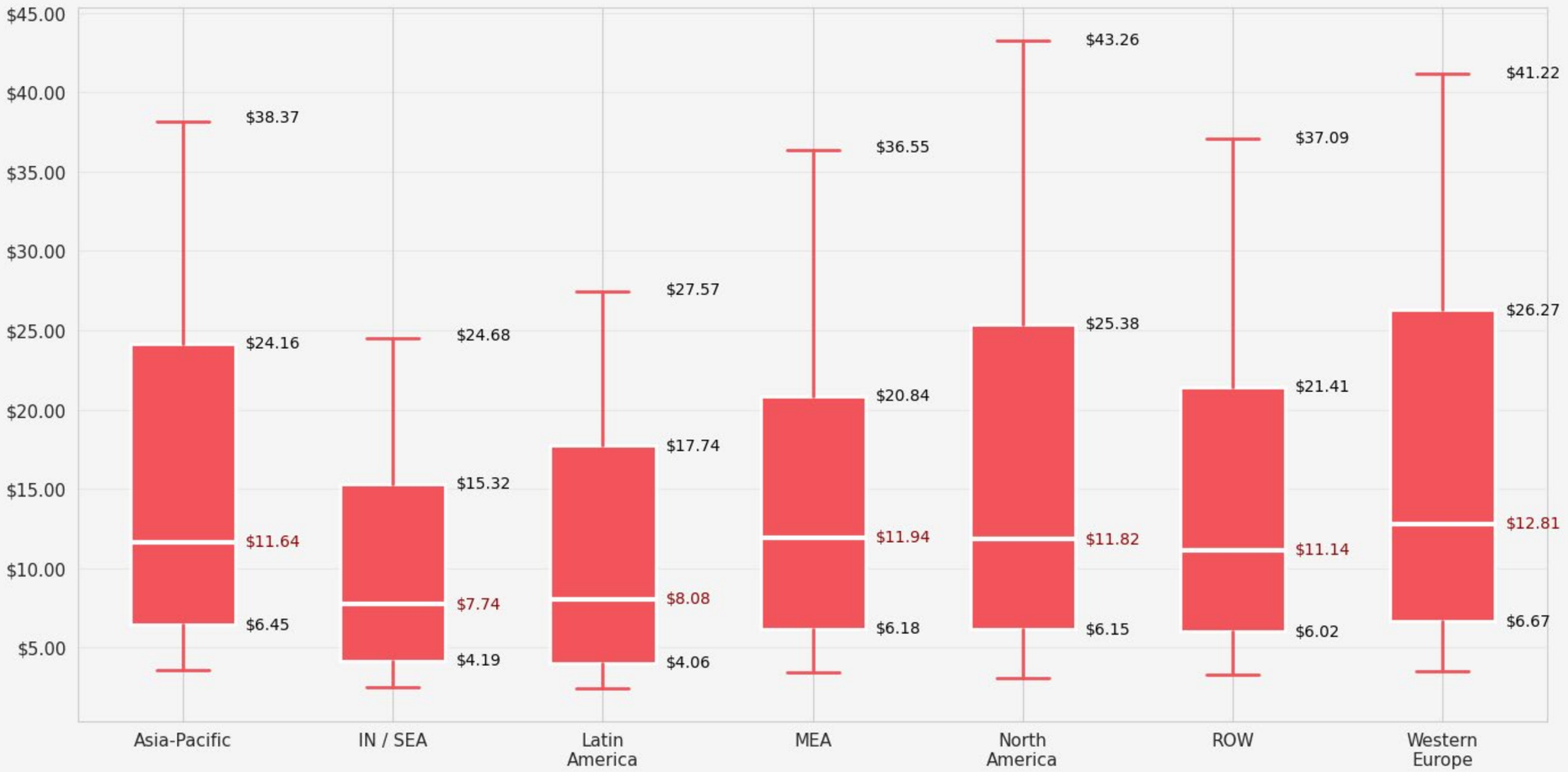
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



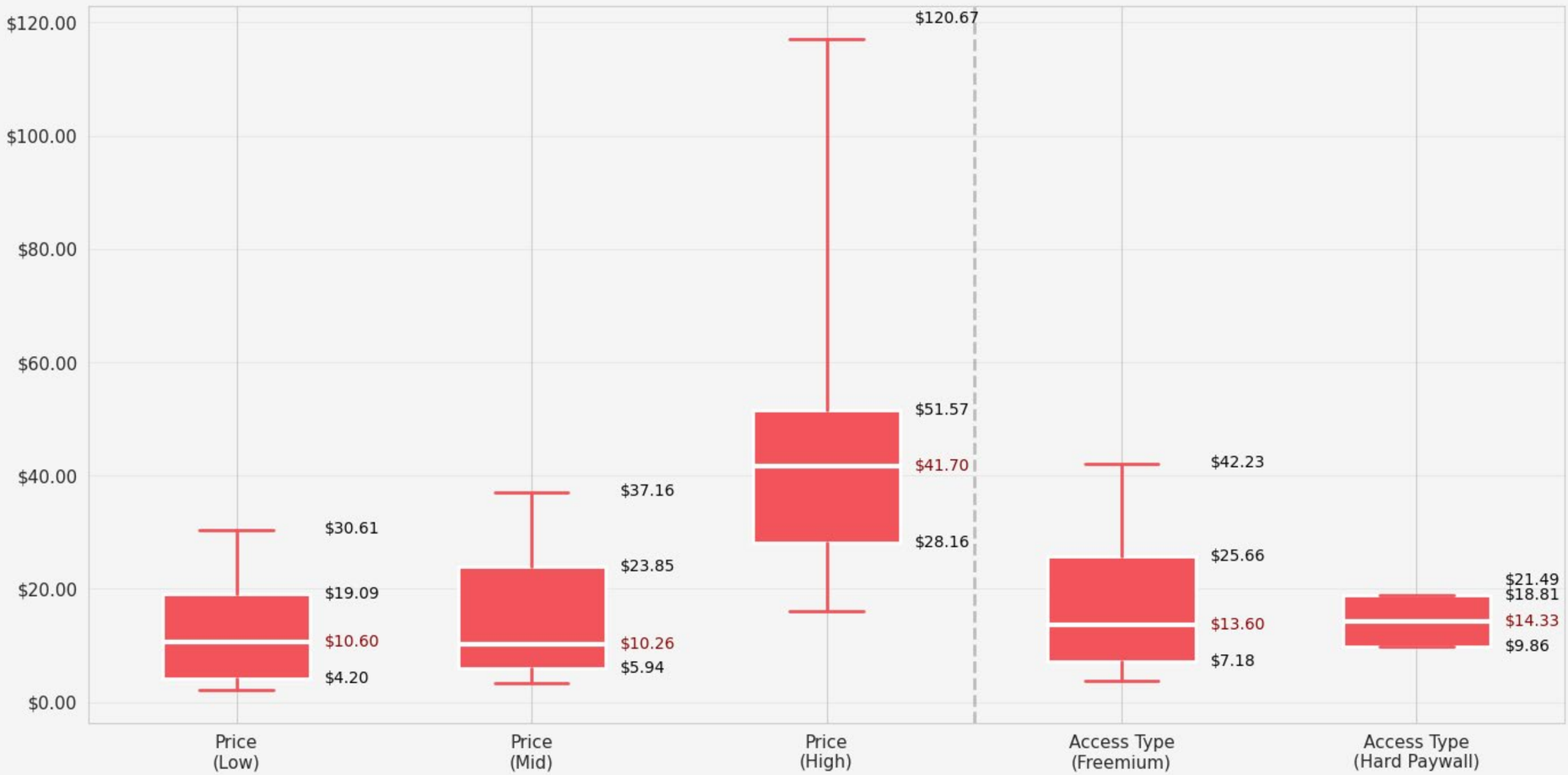
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



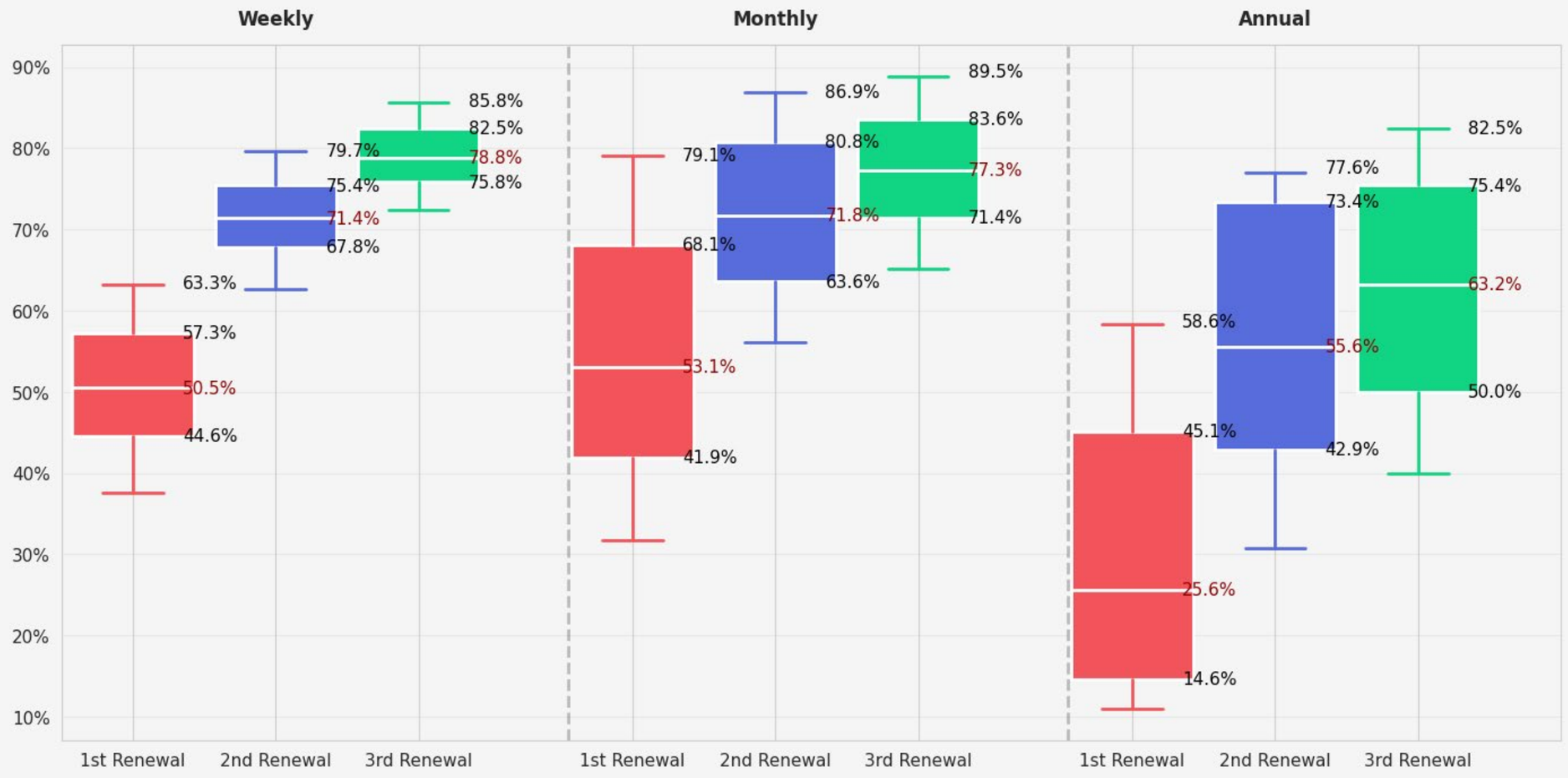
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



# First 3 weekly renewals

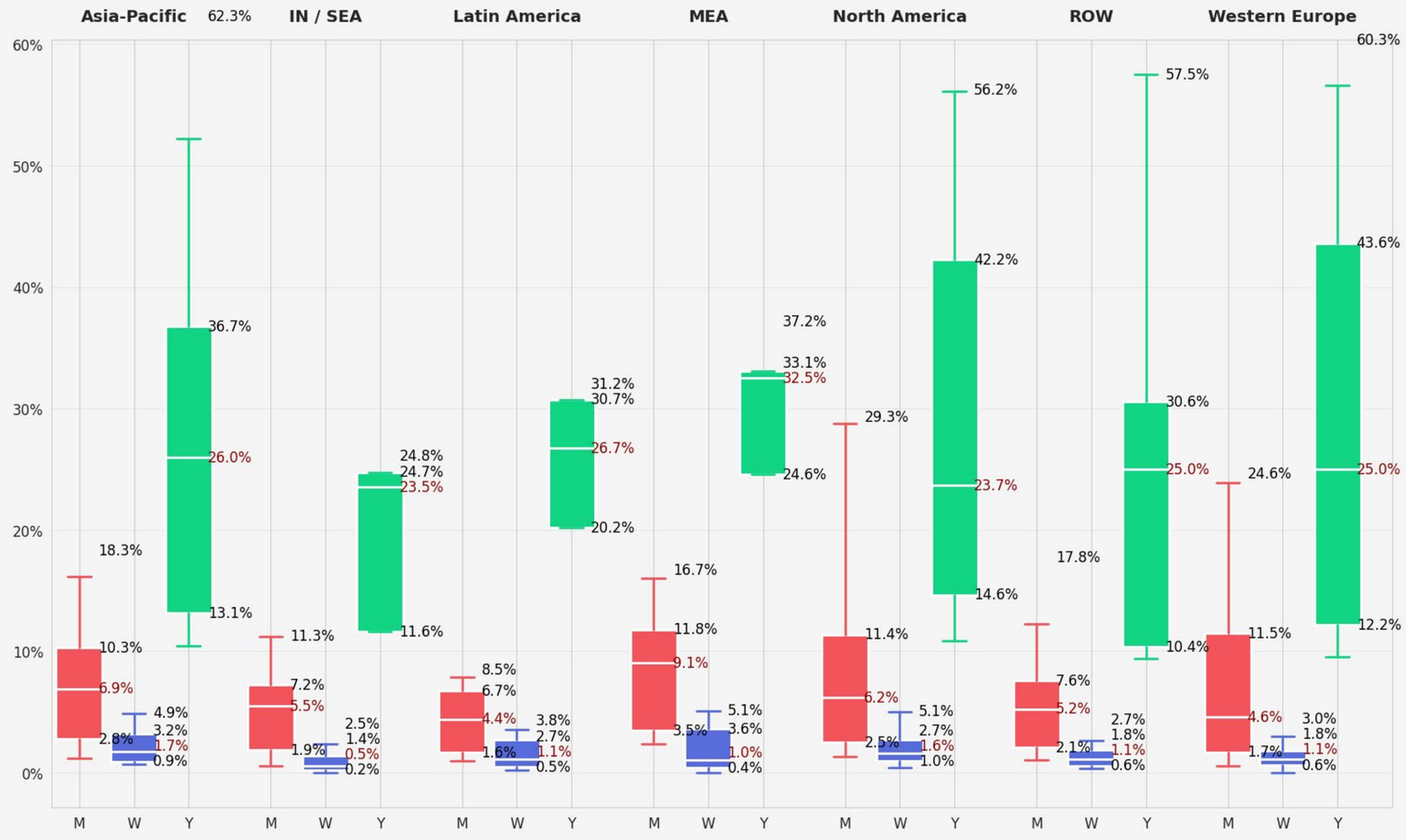


# First 3 annual renewals




Gaming

# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Health & Fitness

# Health & Fitness: key takeaways

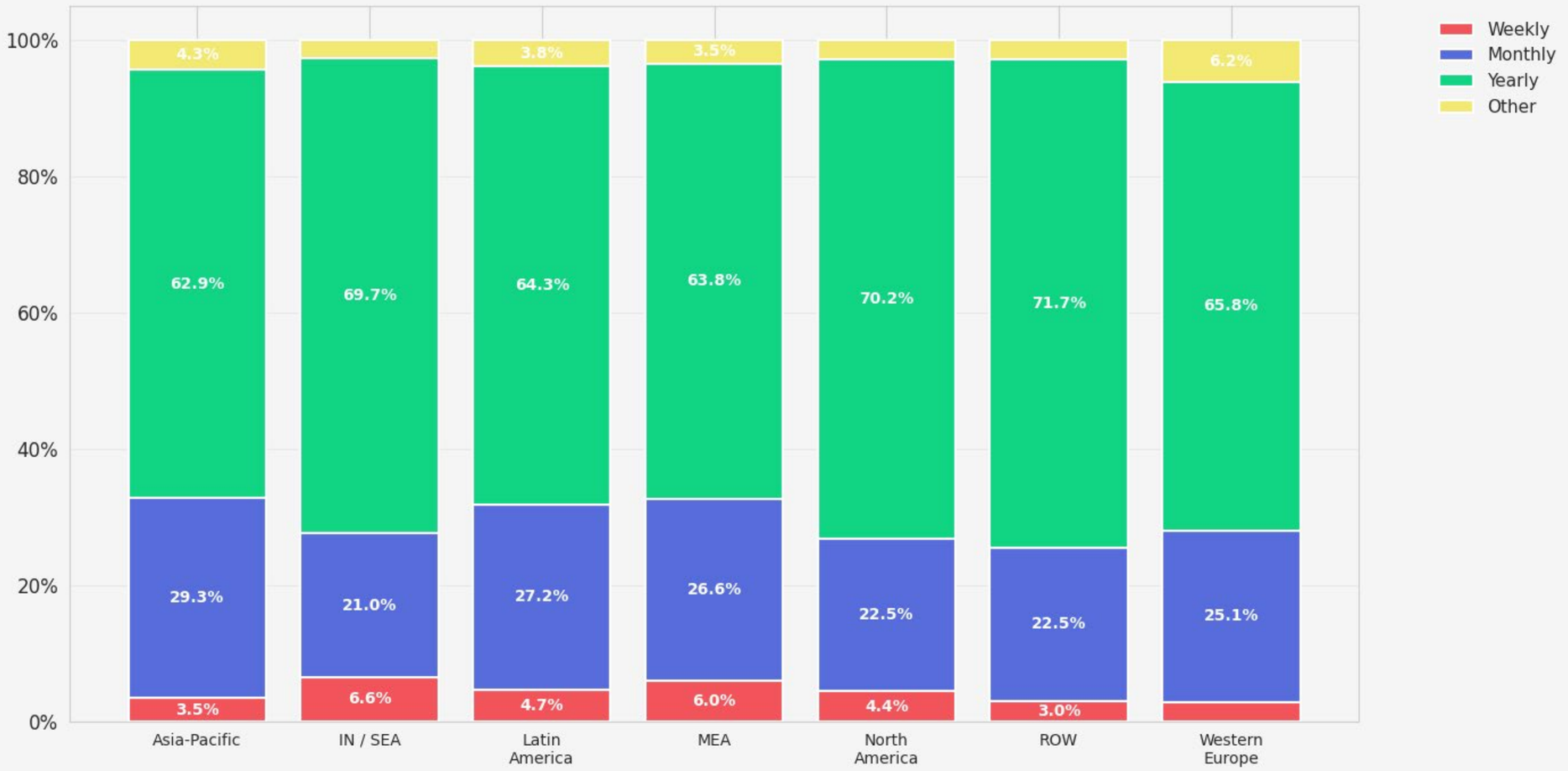
Health & Fitness sits in the upper tier of subscription performance, but outcomes vary sharply by geography and pricepoint. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.7% (IN/SEA) to 2.7% (North America). Revenue per install (RPI) expands meaningfully between D14 and D60 across geographies — for example, from $0.51 to $0.69 in North America and from $0.32 to $0.44 in MEA — reinforcing that monetization compounds post-install.

Annual plans dominate mix in every geography, consistently accounting for 54–58% of subscriptions sold. Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer spans from $20.09 (MEA median) to $39.15 (North America median), with Western Europe close behind at $33.07. Price architecture materially shapes outcomes: high-priced apps show a $68.95 median Y1 lifetime value (LTV) vs. $9.48 for low-priced apps.

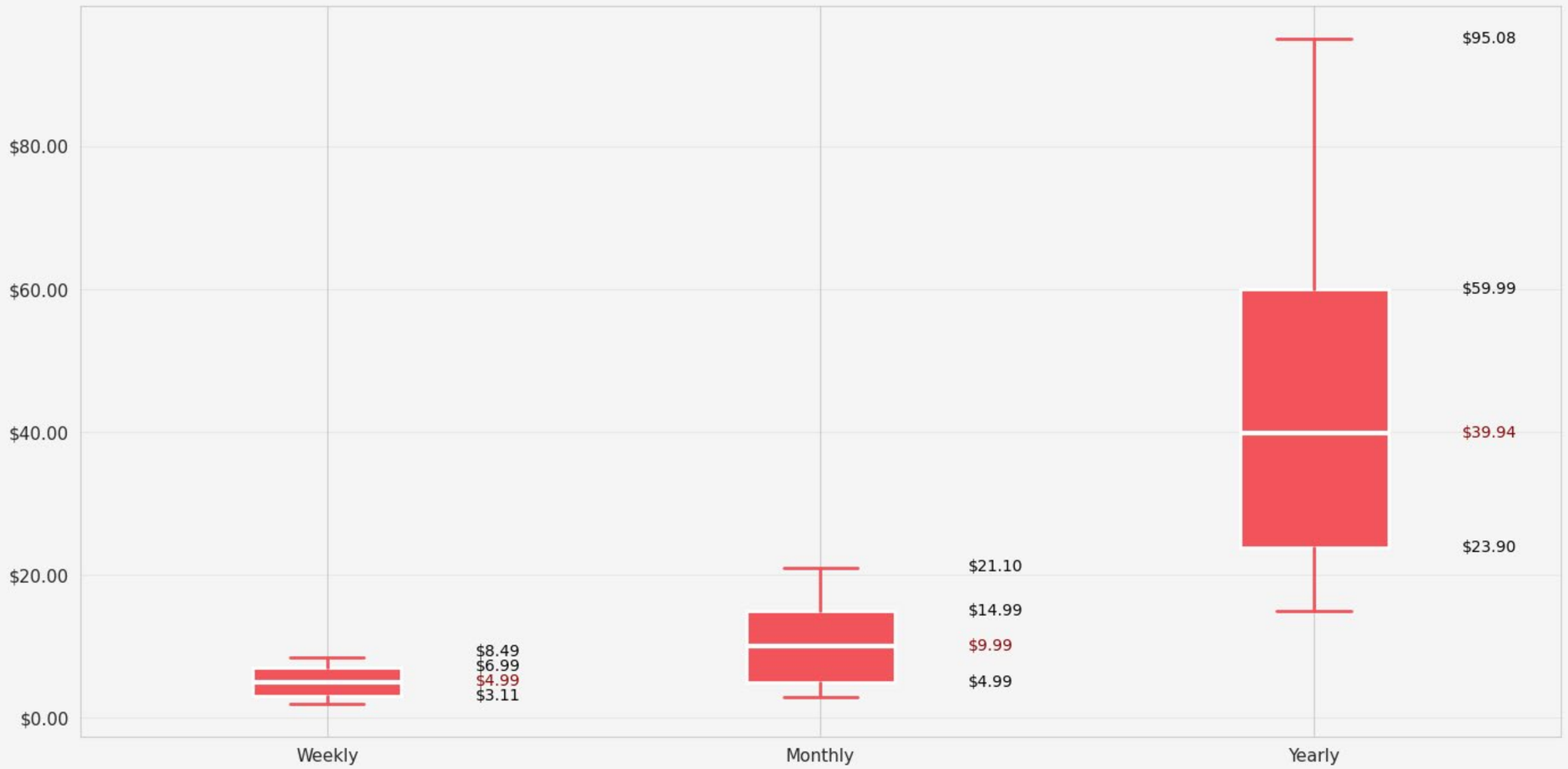
## What stands out

- North America leads on both conversion and value: median D35 conversion reaches 2.7%, and median Y1 LTV per payer hits $39.15 — the highest across geographies shown.
- Annual plans anchor the category: annual subscriptions account for 54.2%–58.4% of sales depending on geography (90.4% monthly share in IN/SEA is not shown; annual is 57.2% in North America and 57.8% in Western Europe). Health & Fitness is structurally annual-first.
- RPI continues to expand after D14: in every geography, D60 RPI exceeds D14. North America grows from $0.51 to $0.69; Western Europe from $0.32 to $0.44; Asia-Pacific from $0.33 to $0.45.
- Trial quality varies more than trial volume: median trial start rates range from 2.9% (IN/SEA) to 7.2% (North America). But trial-to-paid conversion ranges from 18.3% (IN/SEA) to 37.0% (North America), indicating conversion efficiency — not just trial volume — drives geographical gaps.
- Pricepoint drives realized LTV spread: median Y1 LTV per payer is $9.48 (low price), $26.41 (mid), and $68.95 (high). Upper quartile for high price reaches $93.24, with a 90th percentile of $130.39 — a materially different ceiling than low-priced apps.

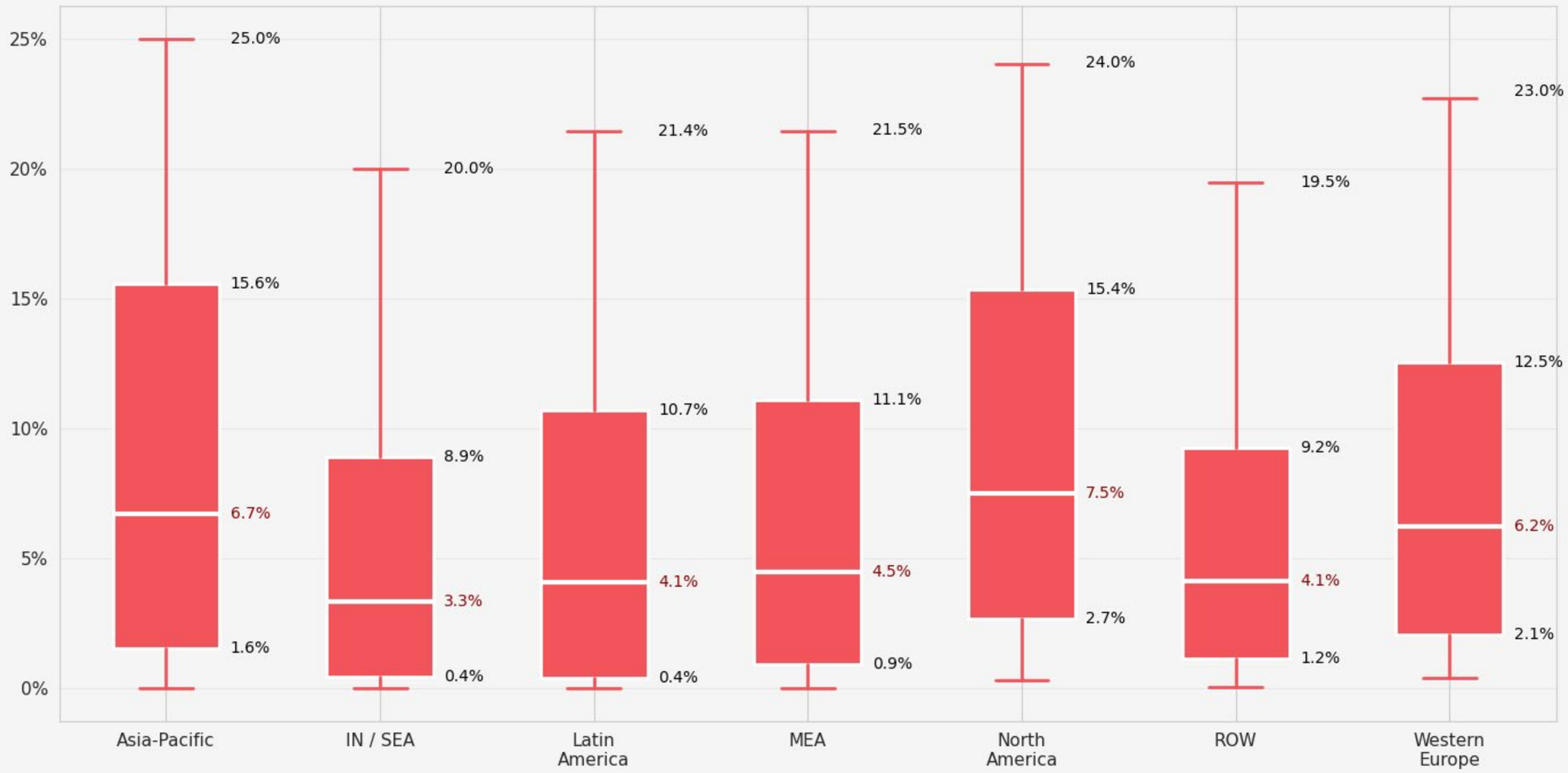
# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography



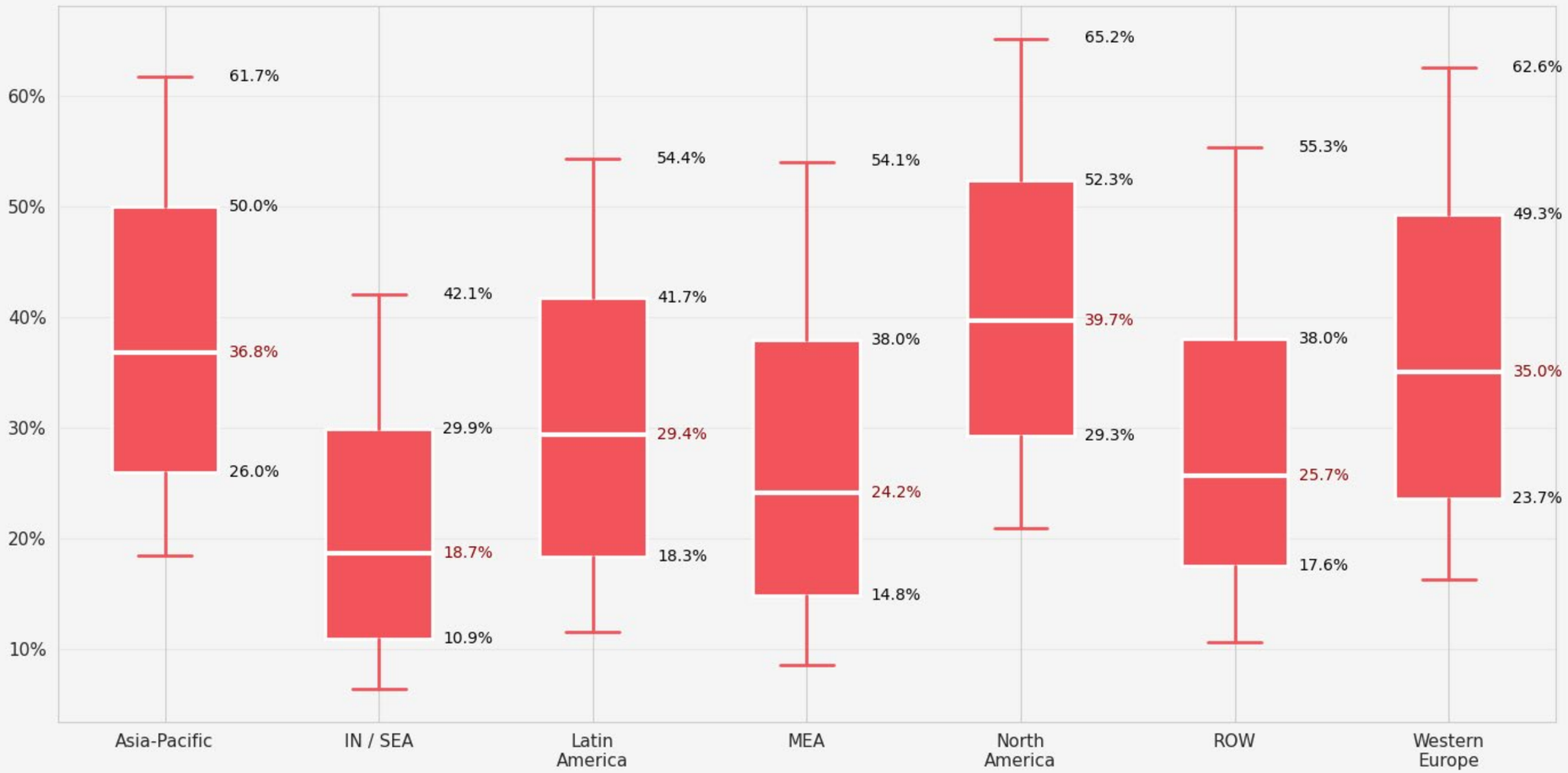
# Pricepoints per plan duration



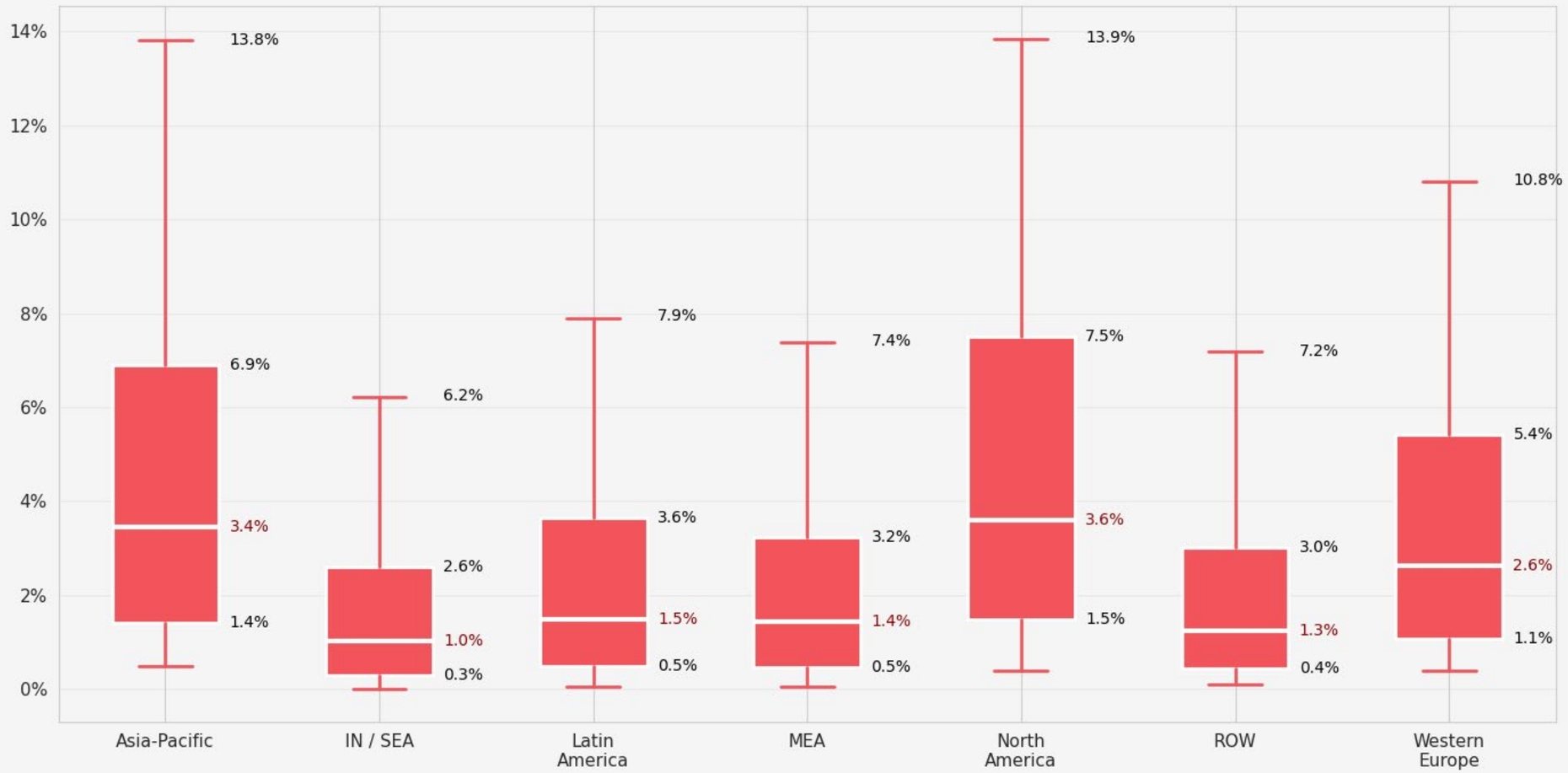
# Trial start rate, by geography



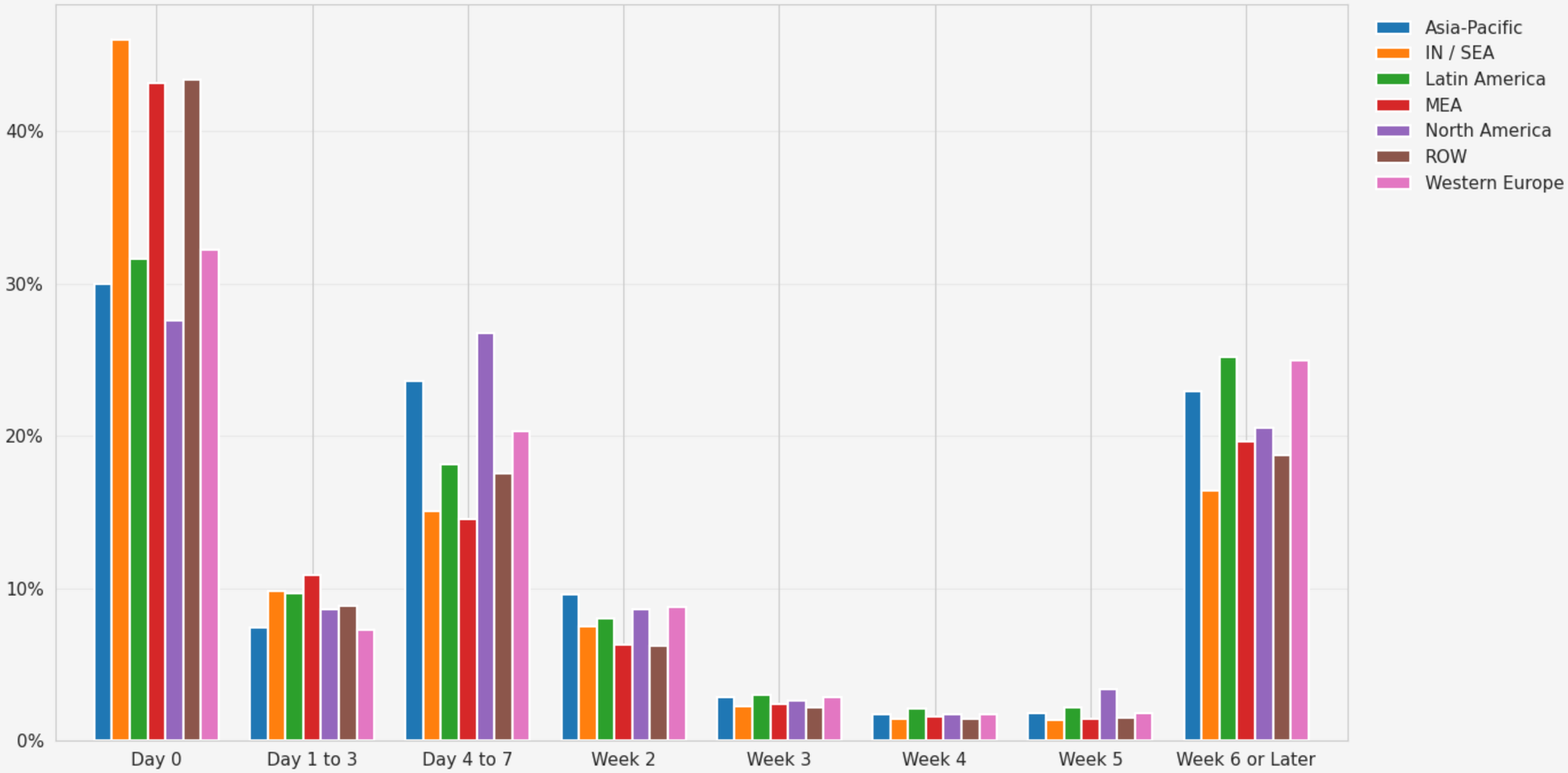
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



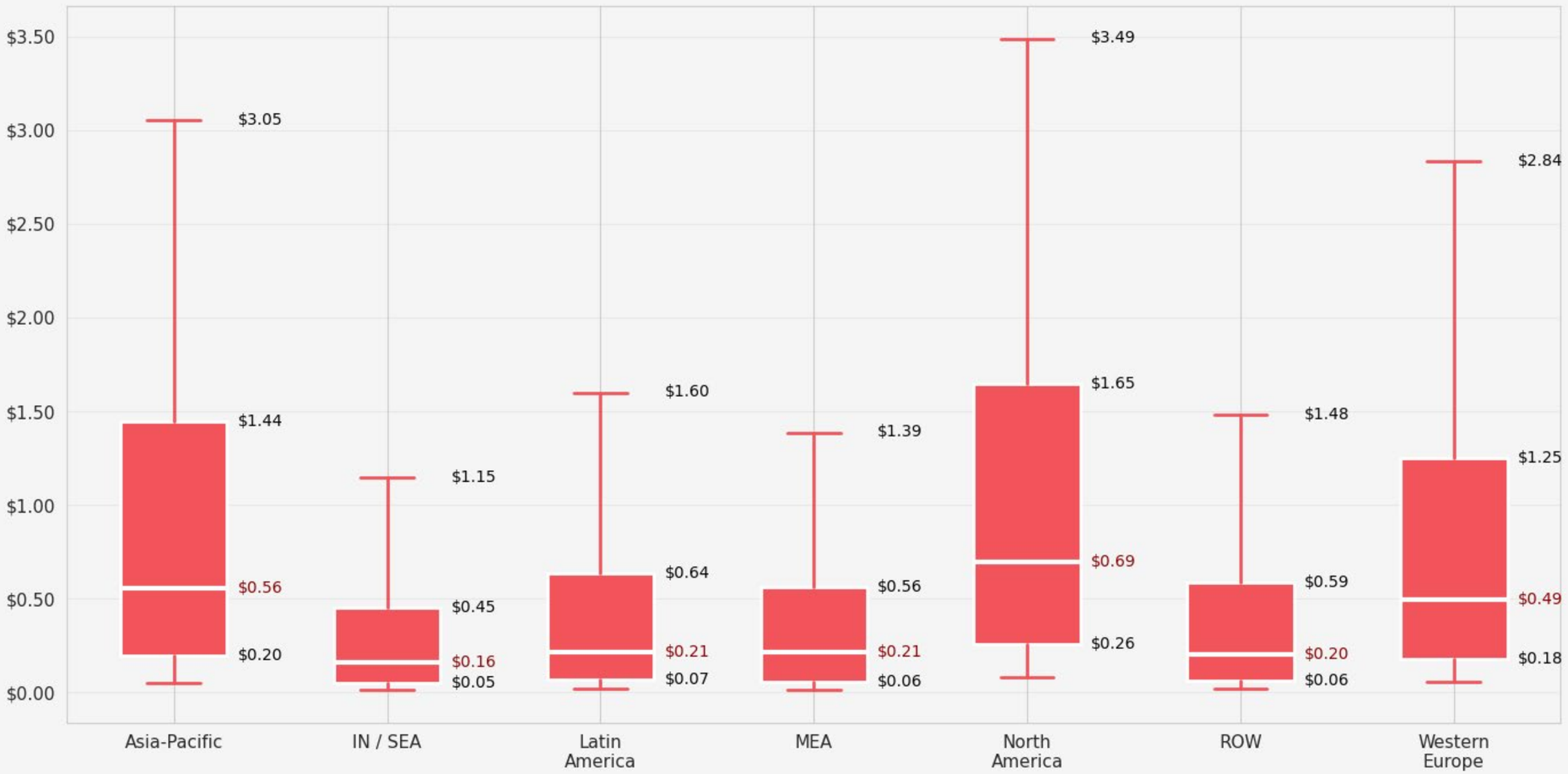
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



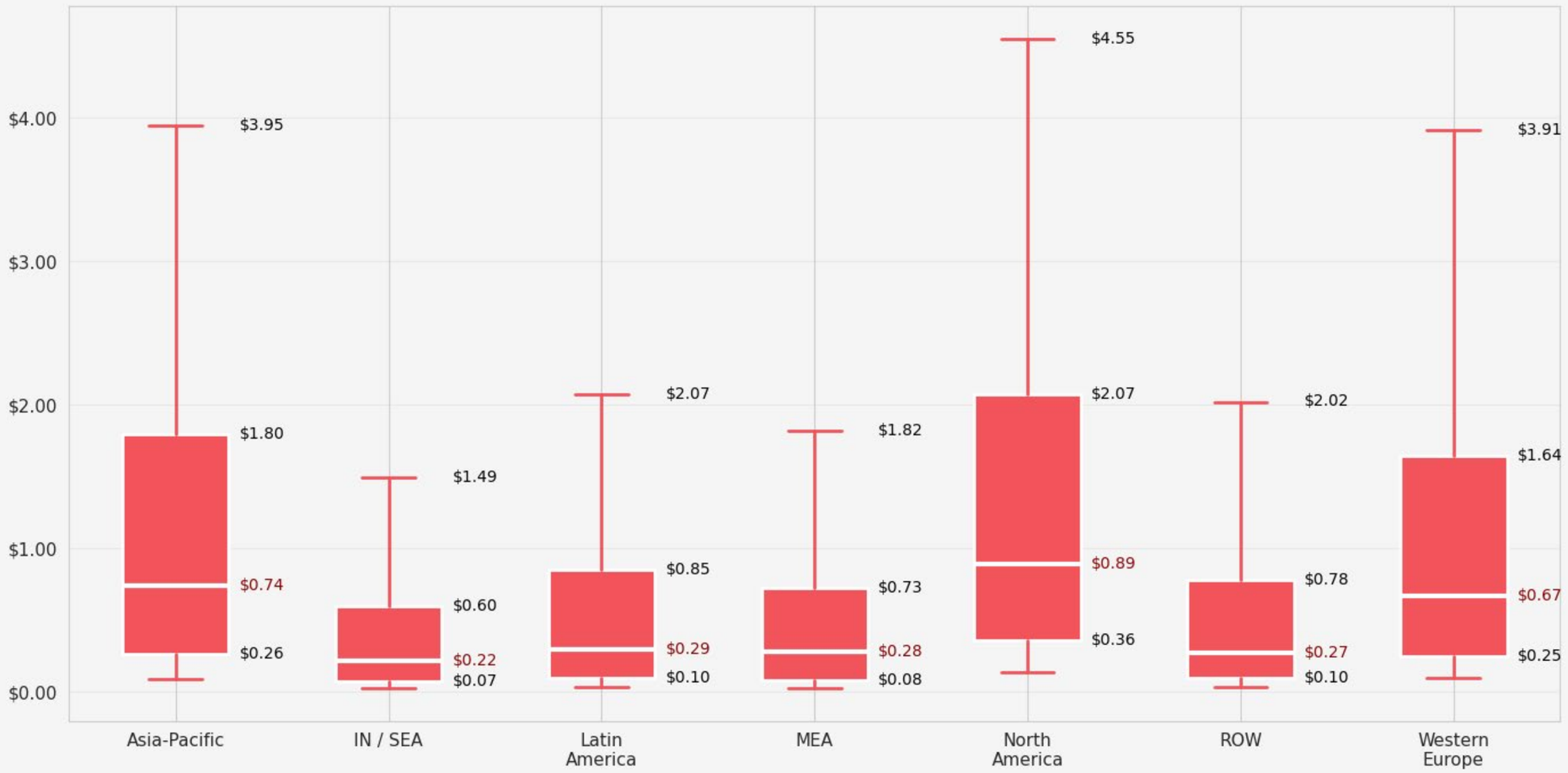
# Time-to-paid, by geography



# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography

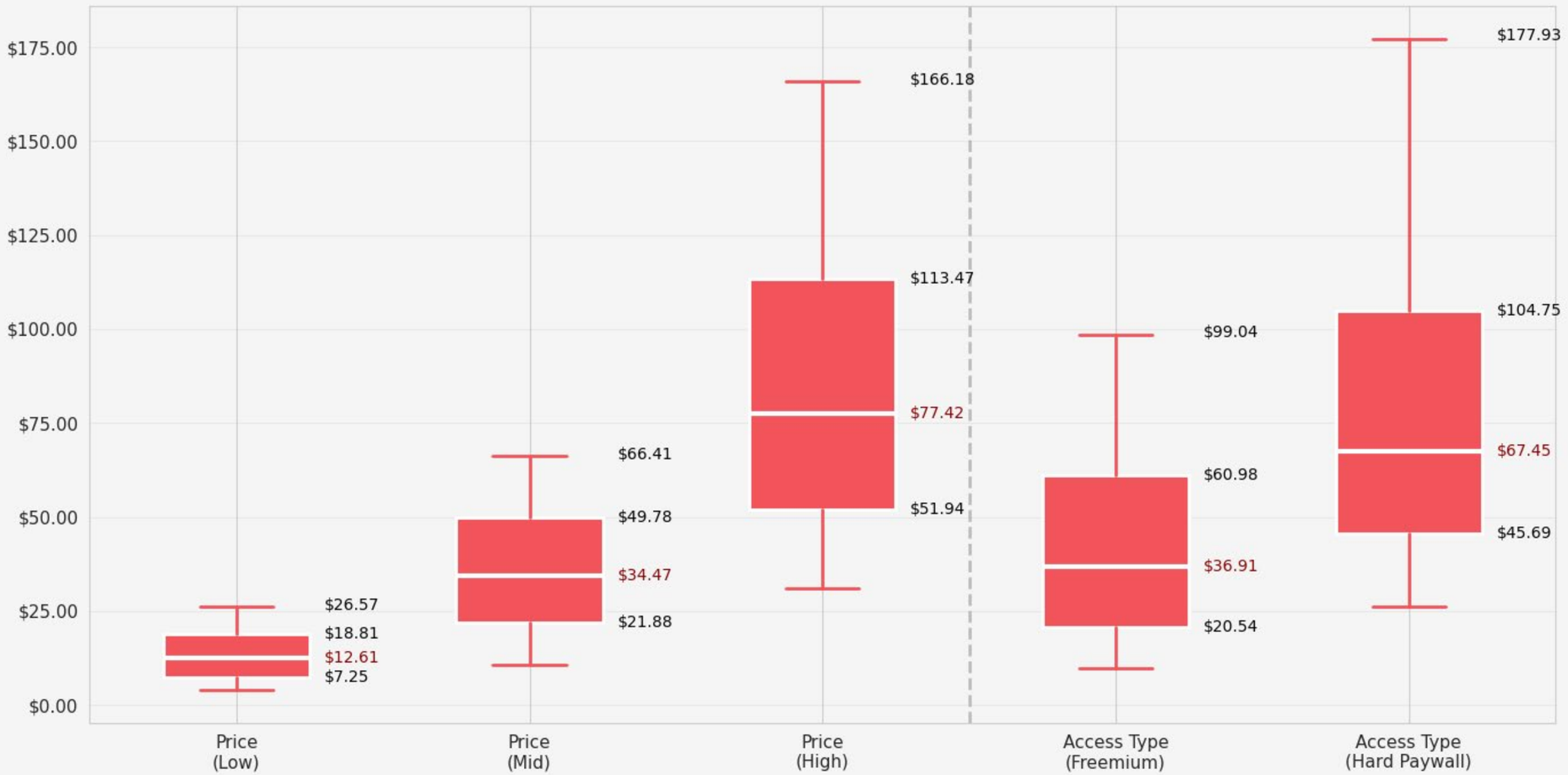


# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography

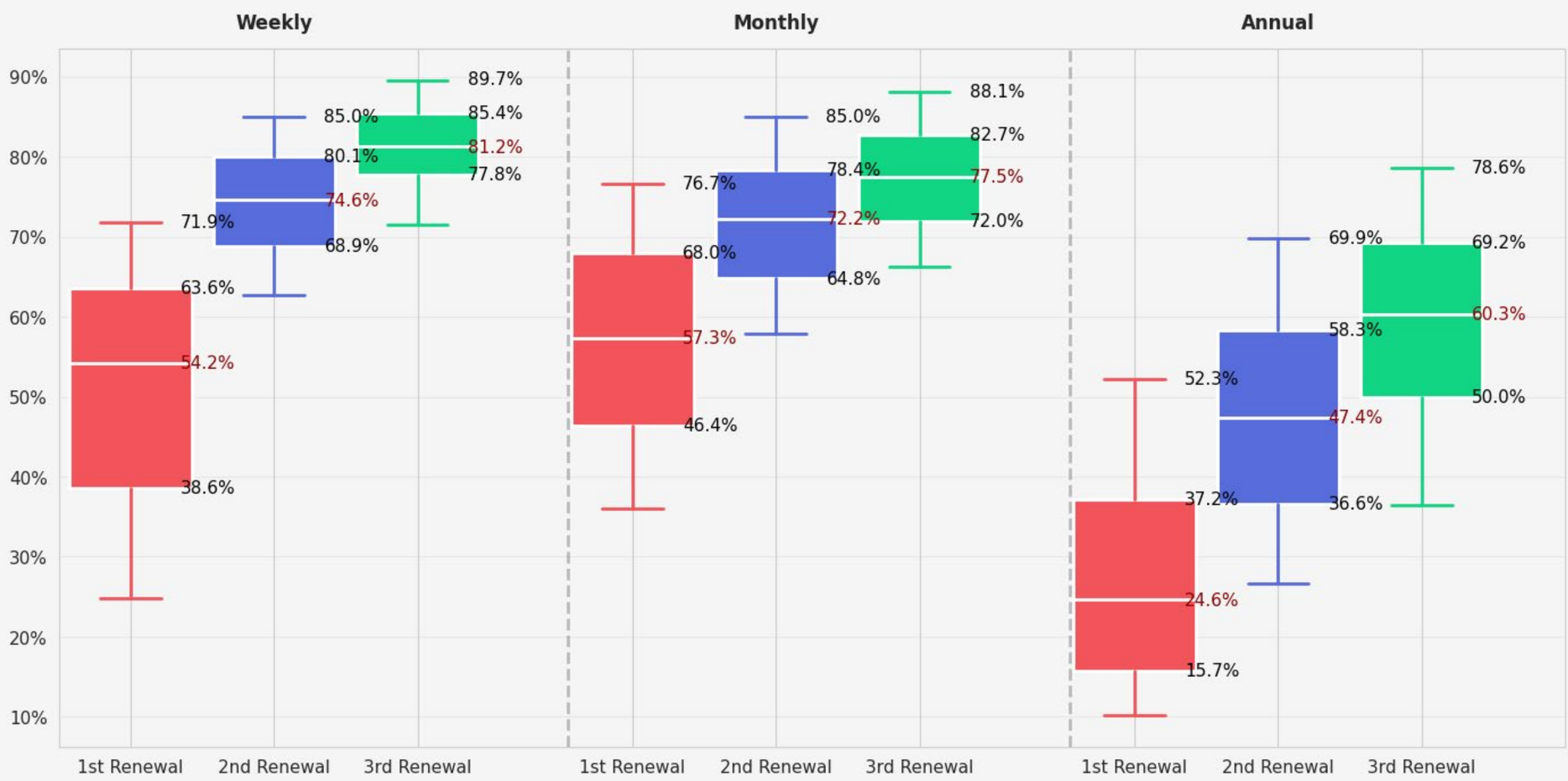


# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint

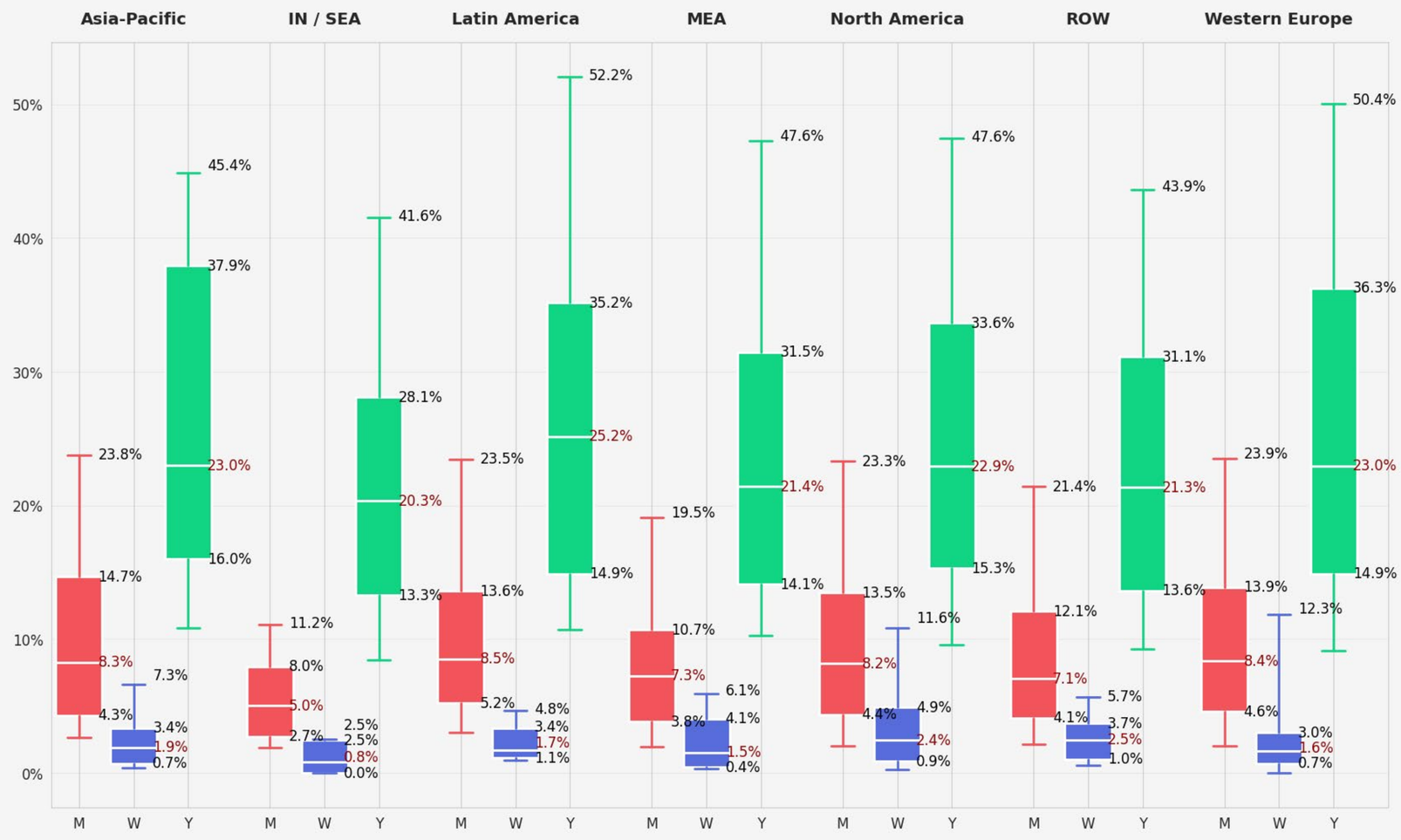
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Media & Entertainment

# Media & Entertainment: key takeaways

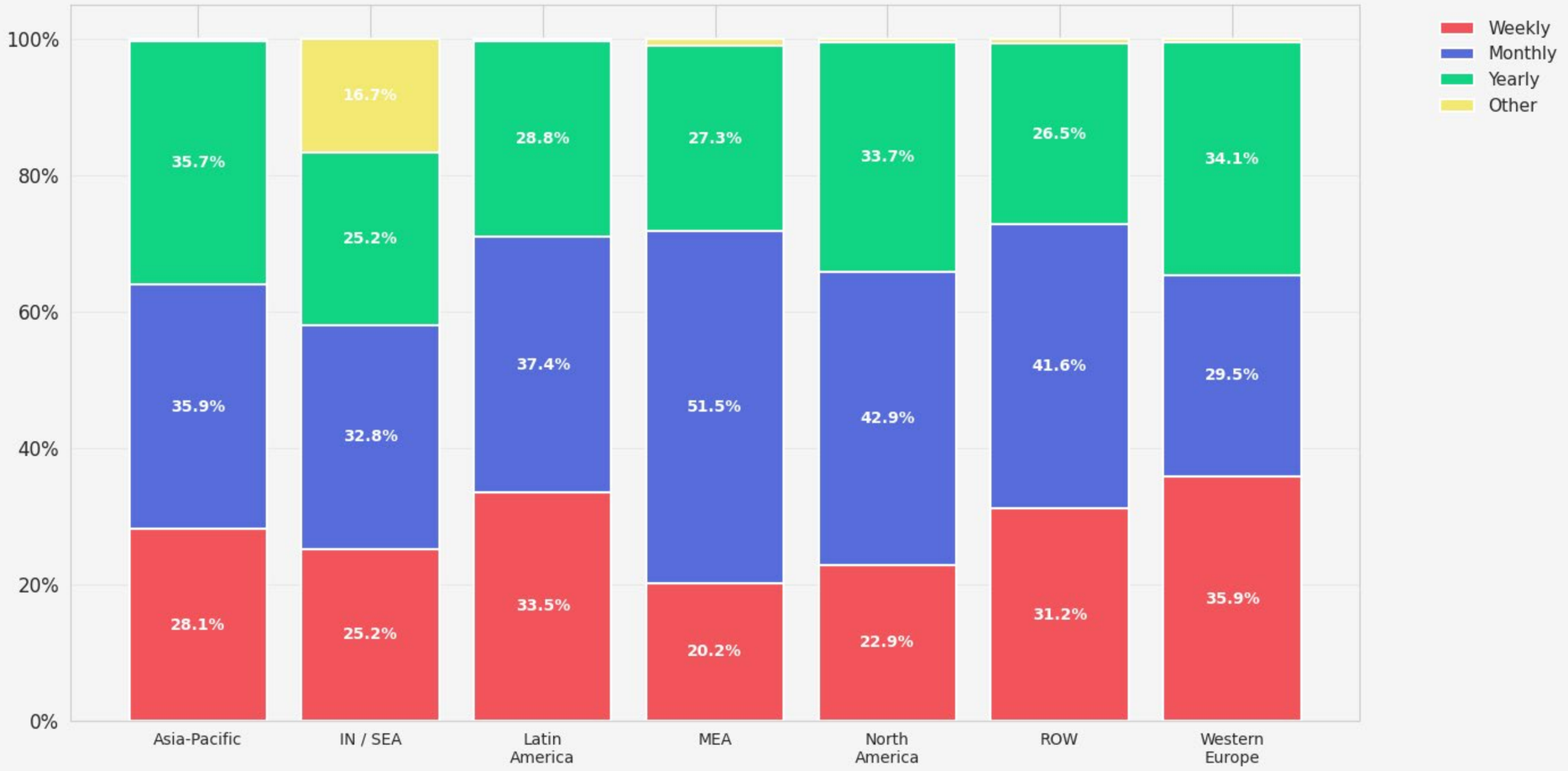
Media & Entertainment apps convert earlier and monetize deeper in a small number of geographies. The median D35 download-to-paid conversion rate ranges from 0.6% (IN/SEA) to 2.1% (North America). Revenue per install (RPI) nearly doubles from D14 to D60 across most geographies, with North America and Western Europe pulling ahead on both early and late monetization.

At the payer level, Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) varies materially by geography — from a median of $14.02 in IN/SEA to $25.35 in Western Europe and $23.44 in North America. Price segmentation is even more pronounced: high-priced apps show a median Y1 lifetime value (LTV) of $56.63 vs. $10.12 for low-priced apps. The category is front-loaded, trial-driven, and highly geographical in both plan mix and payer value.

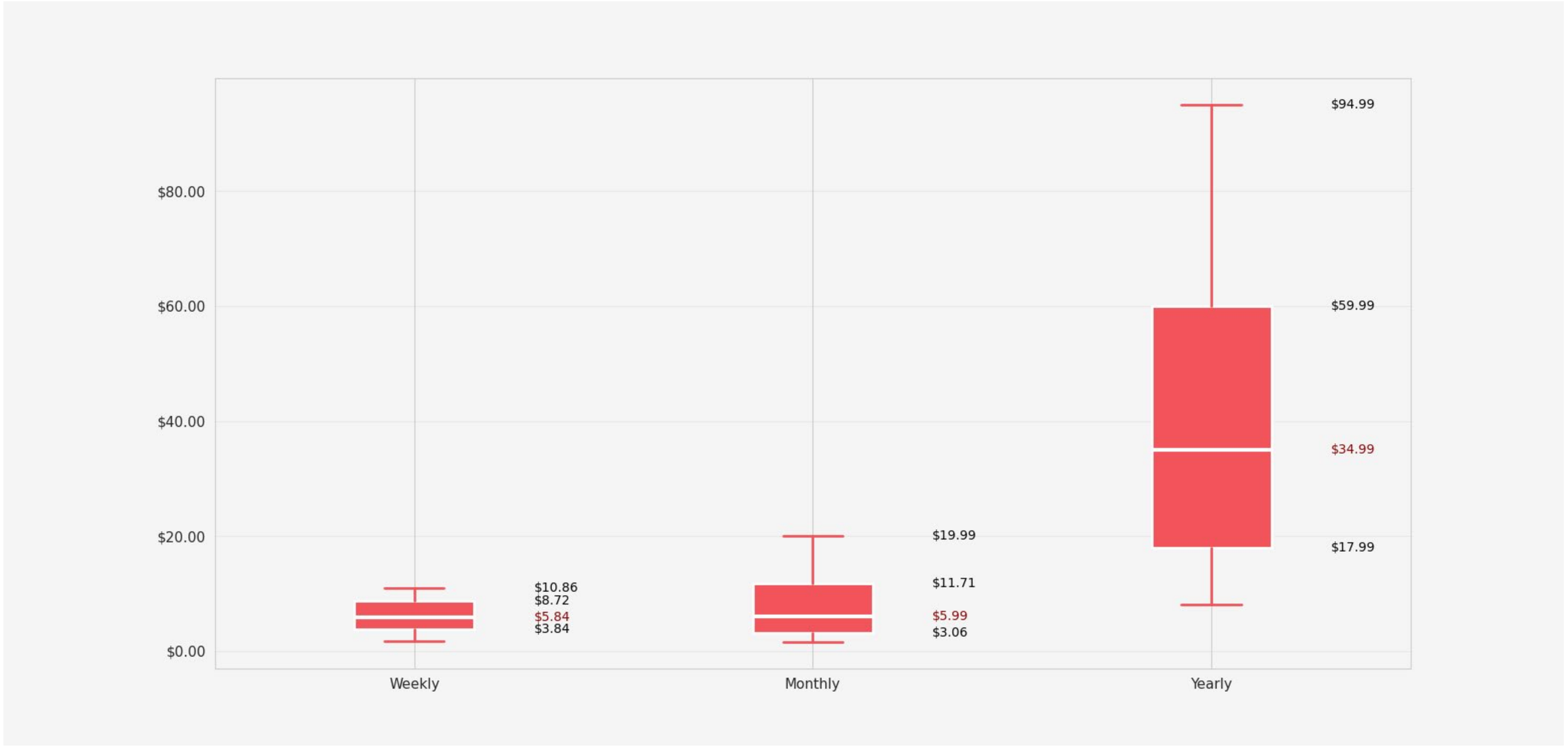
## What stands out

- North America leads the full funnel: median trial start rate (4.9%), trial-to-paid conversion (32.9%), and D35 download-to-paid conversion (2.1%) are all highest in North America. RPI at D60 reaches $0.37, ahead of all other geographies shown.
- Western Europe monetizes like North America — with a different plan mix: Western Europe matches North America on Y1 LTV per payer ($25.35 vs. $23.44) and shows strong D60 RPI ($0.25). Weekly plans account for 35.9% of subscriptions — the highest weekly share across geographies.
- Price tier drives payer value more than geography: median Y1 LTV per payer ranges from $10.12 (low price) to $56.63 (high price). That spread is larger than any geographical difference shown, reinforcing how price architecture shapes realized value.
- Conversion is concentrated early: a large share of payments occur on Day 0 (roughly 40–50% depending on geography, exact median not shown). After Week 1, conversion contribution drops sharply until a secondary spike at Week 6+ (roughly 20–27% across geographies).
- Retention stabilizes after the 1st renewal: weekly 1st renewal medians range from 45–56% depending on geography, rising to ~70–79% by the 2nd renewal. The biggest churn event is the first billing cycle; survivors behave materially differently thereafter.

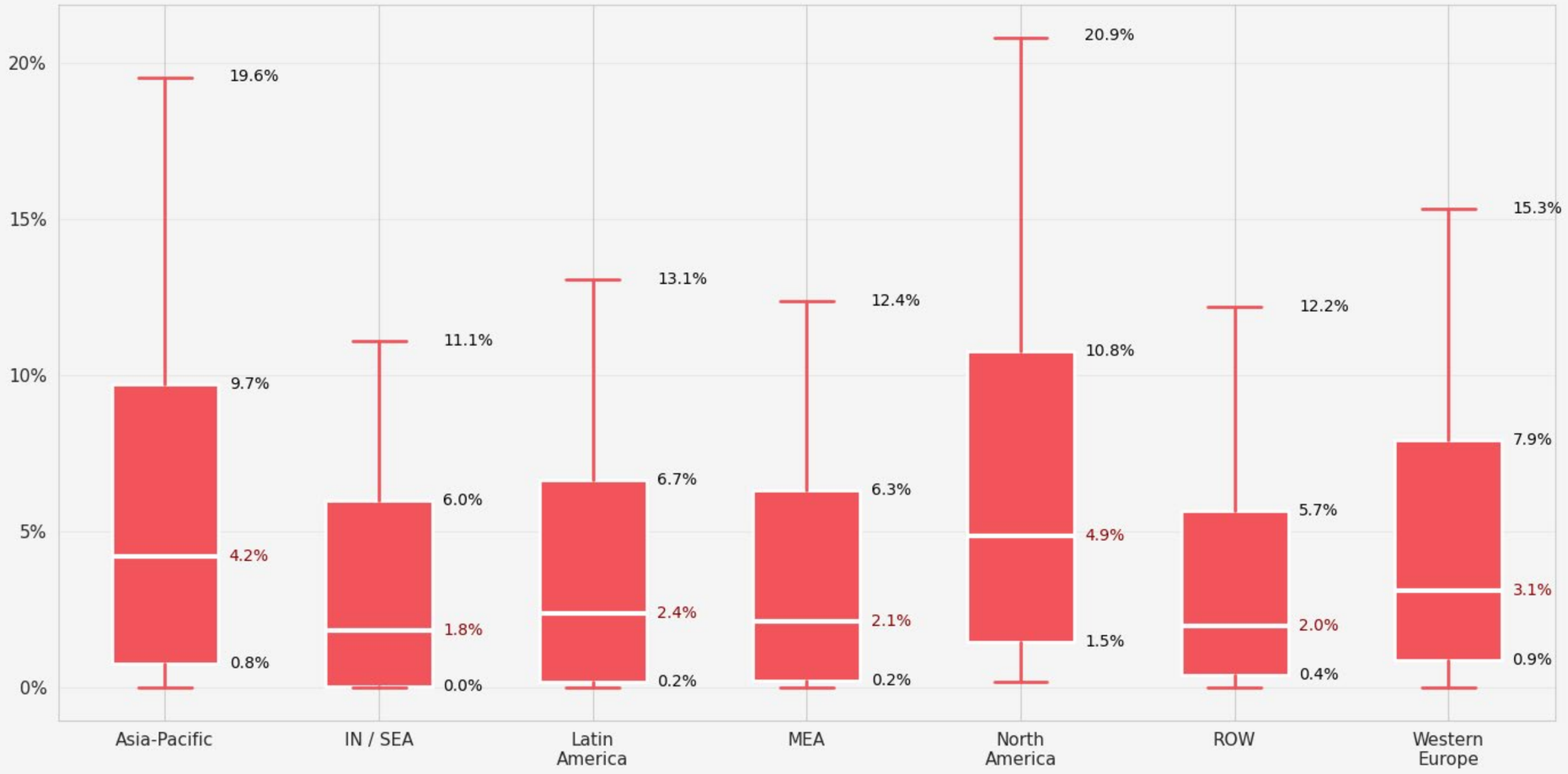
# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography



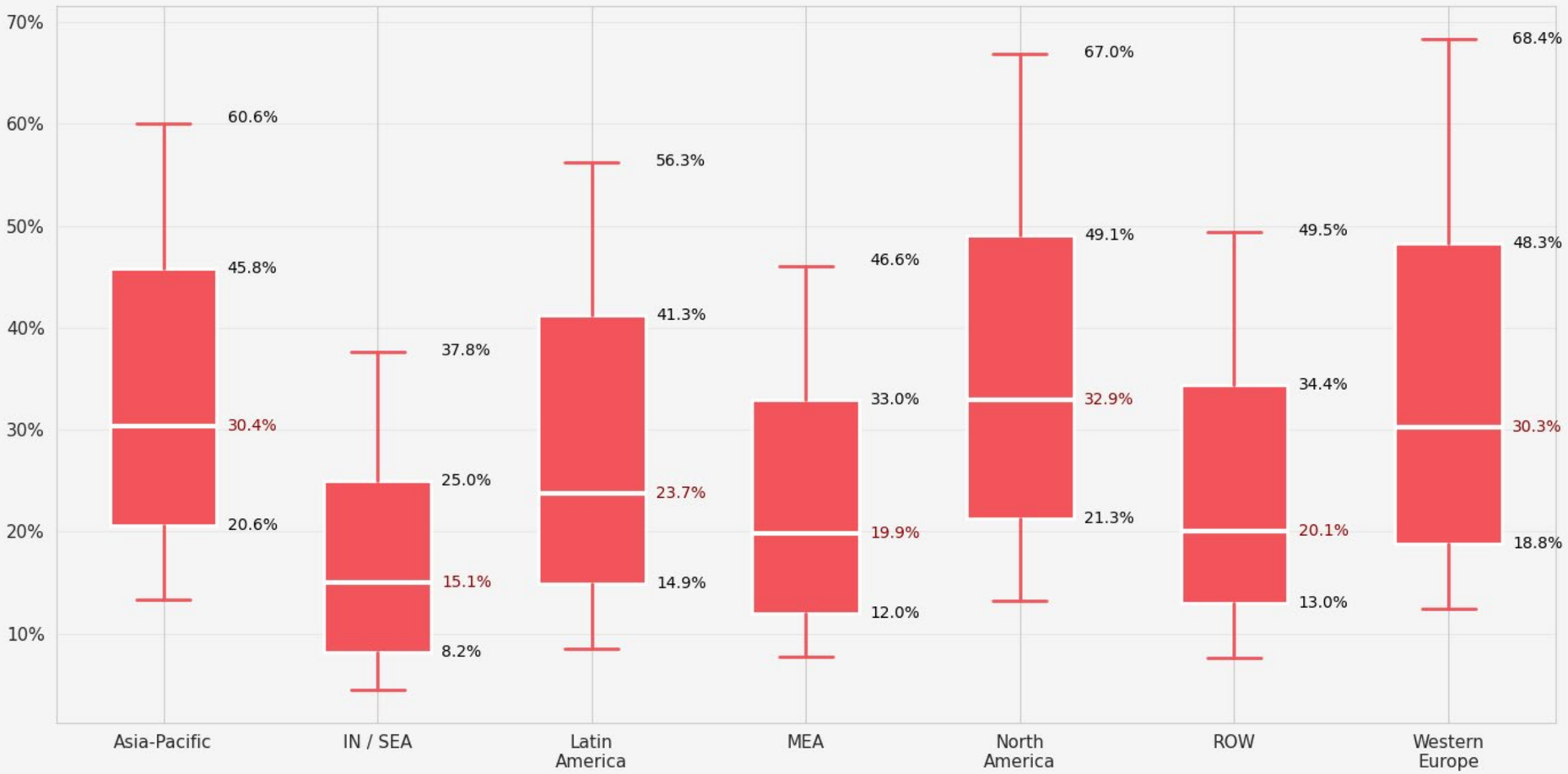
# Pricepoints per plan duration



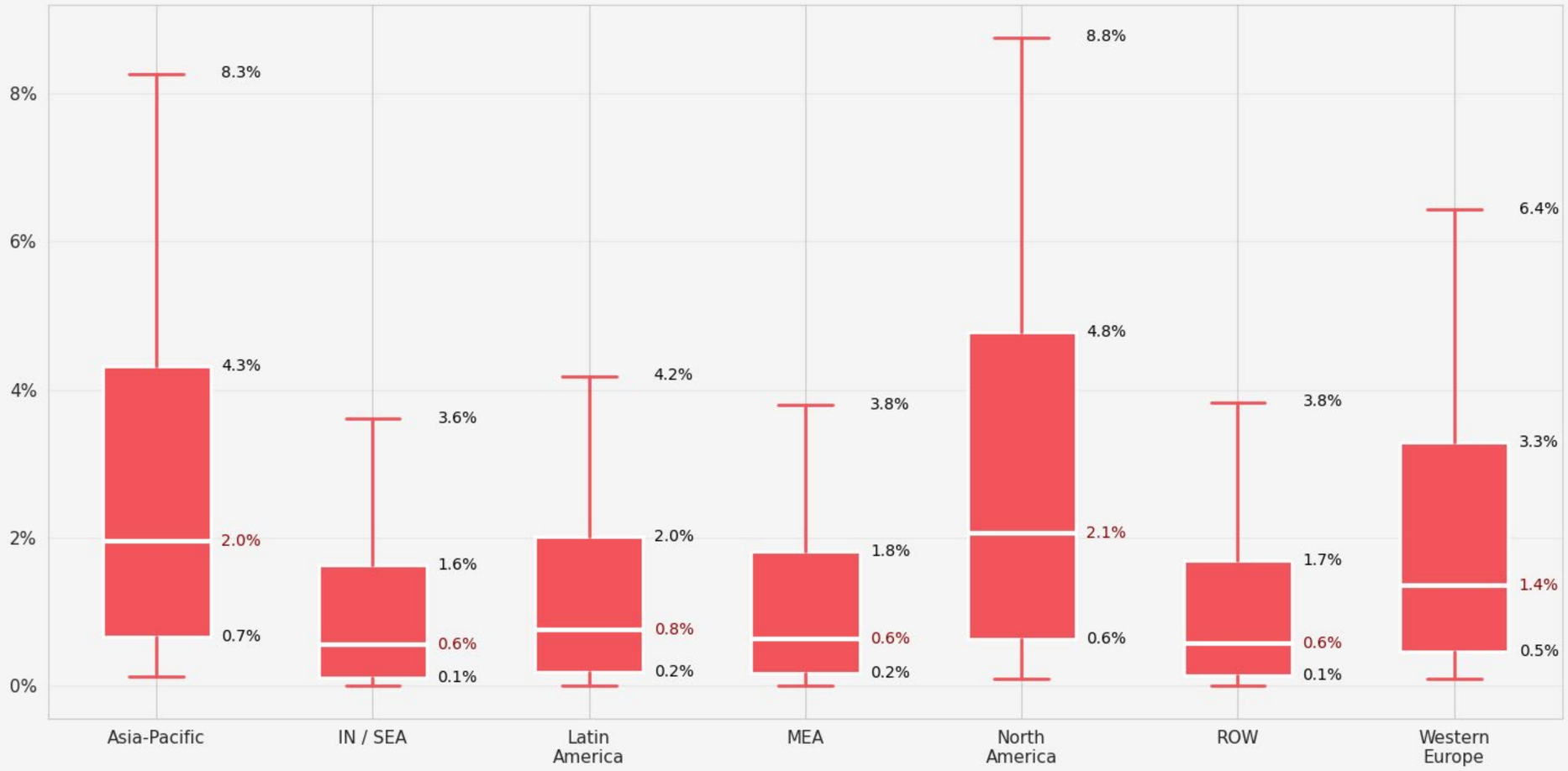
# Trial start rate, by geography



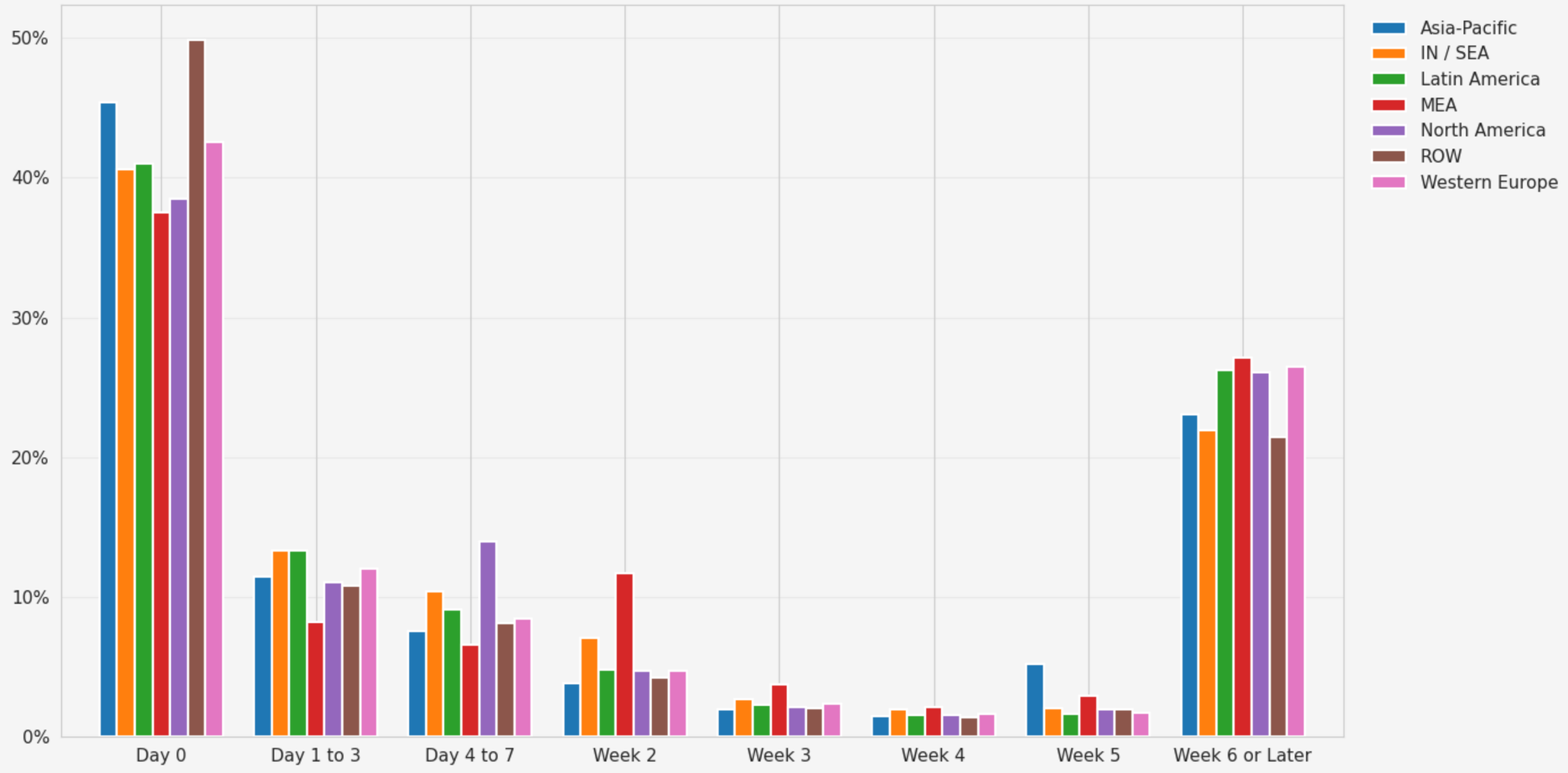
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



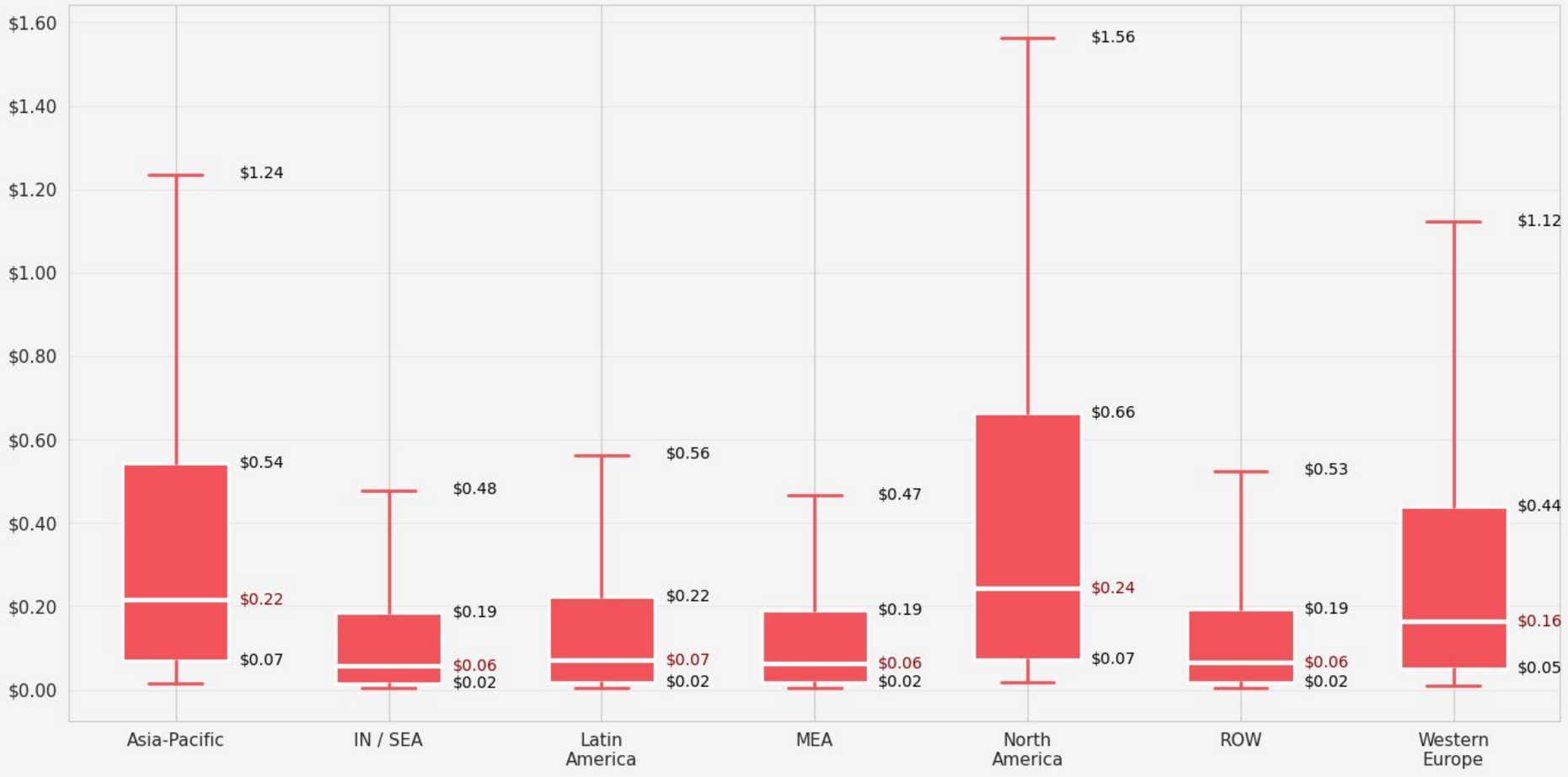
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



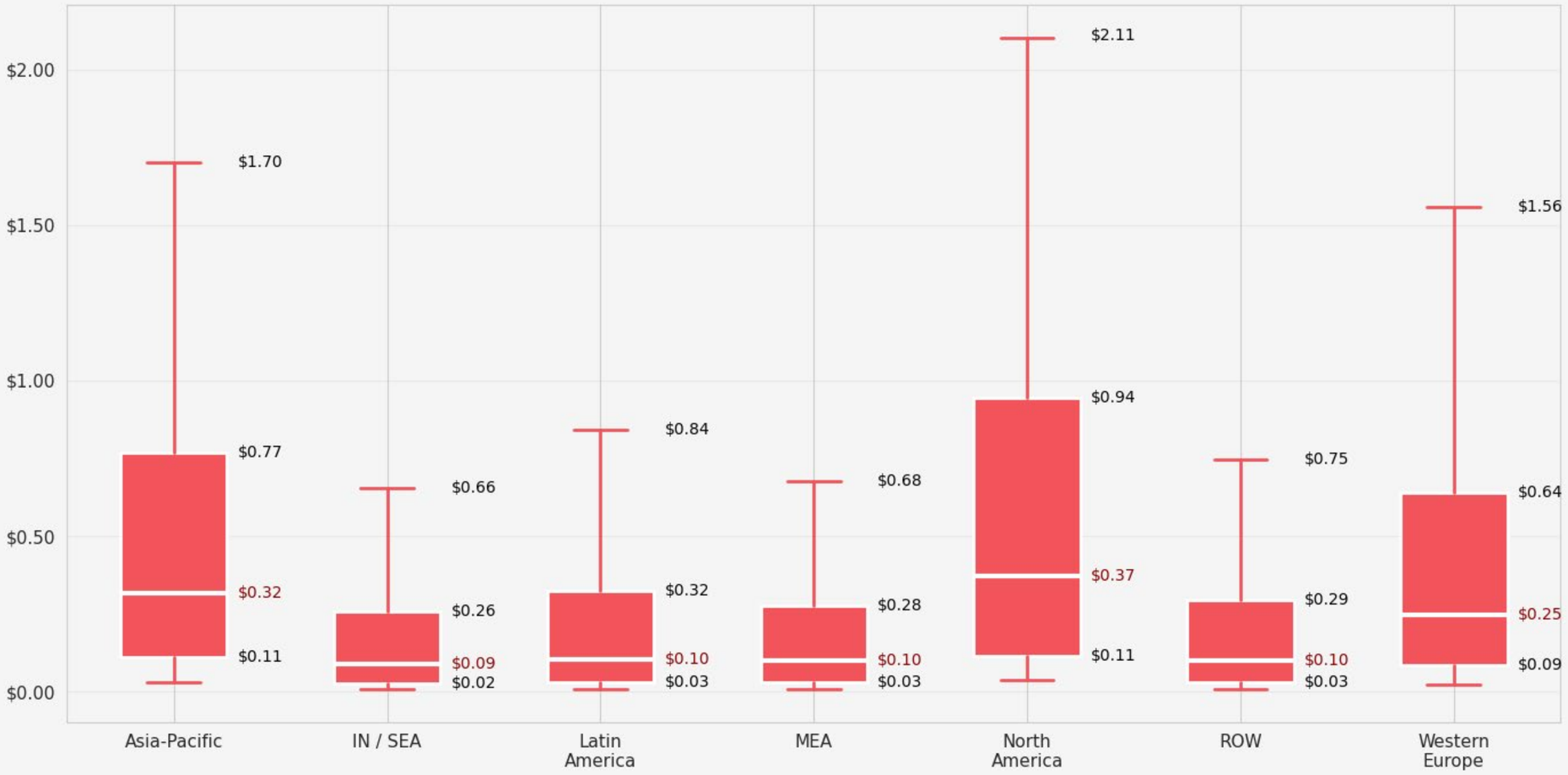
# Time-to-paid, by geography



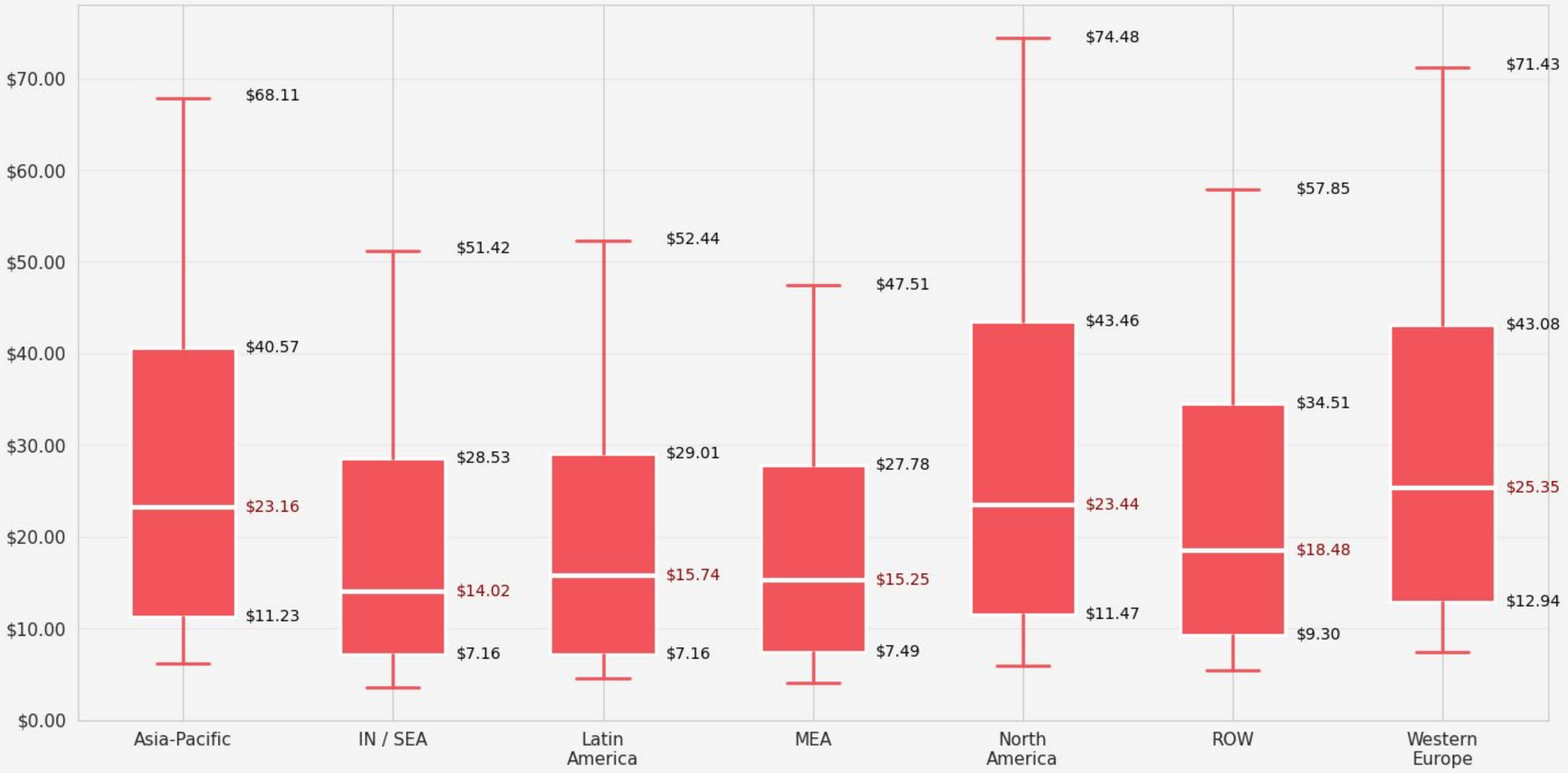
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



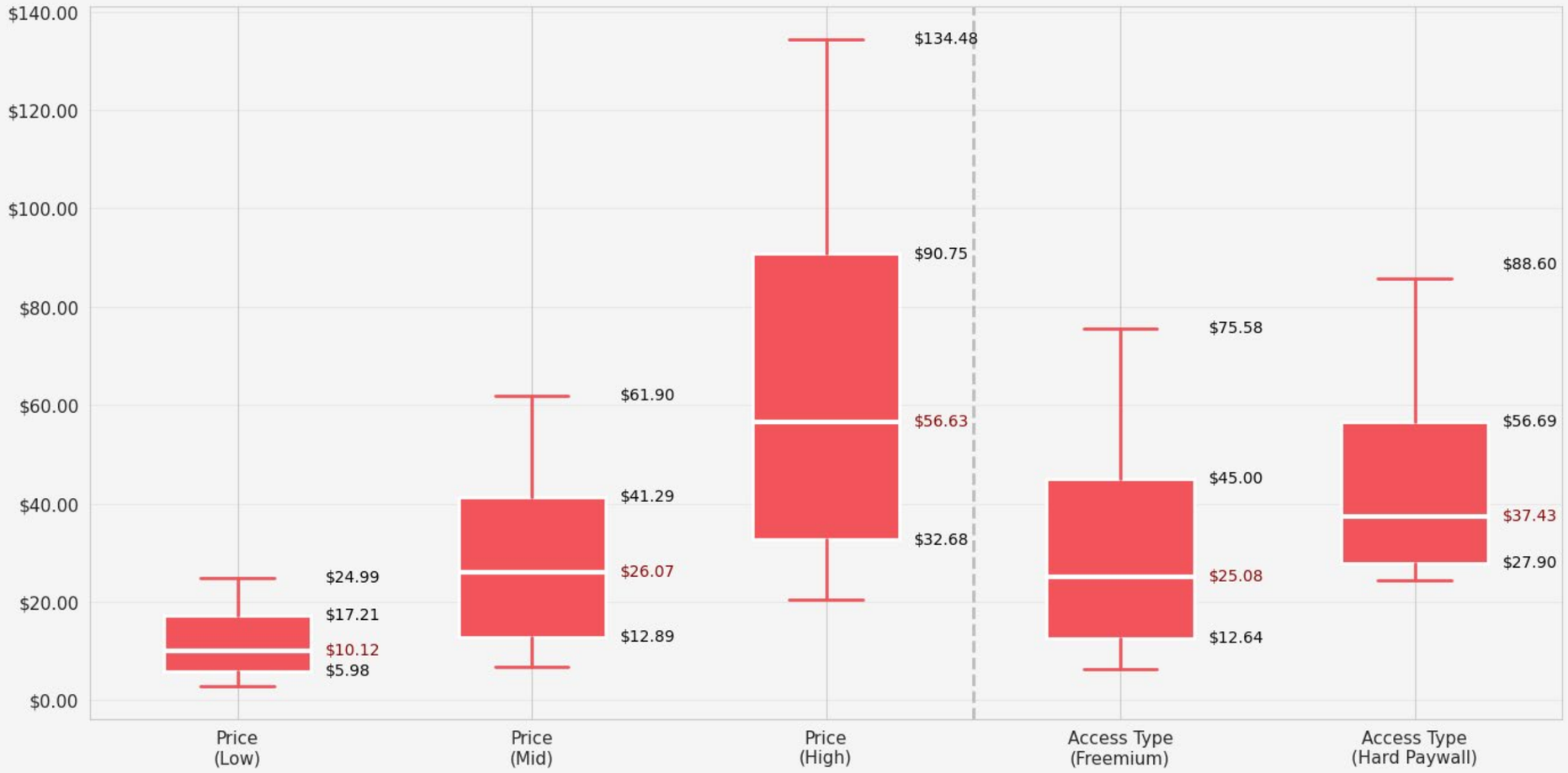
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



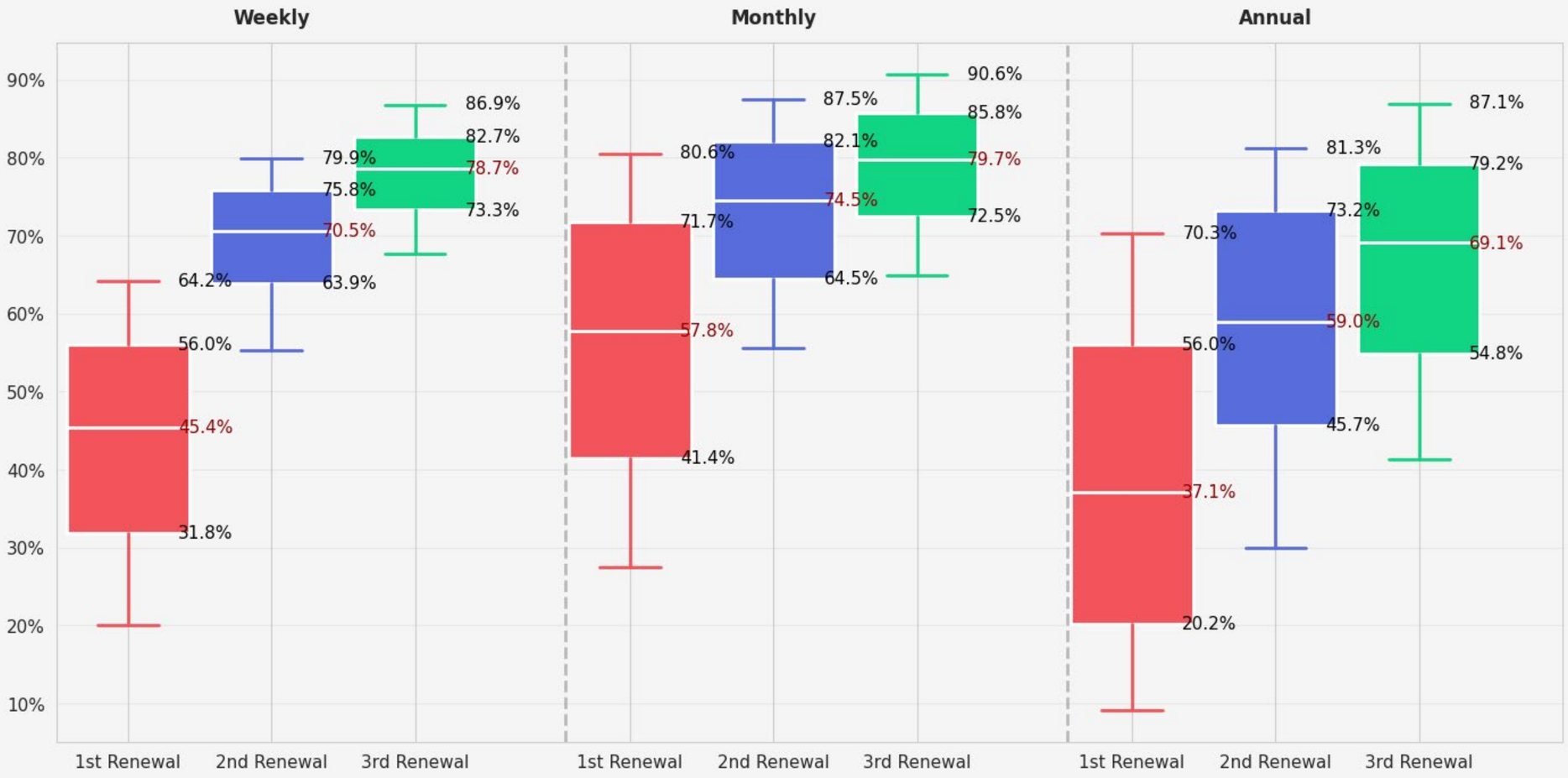
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



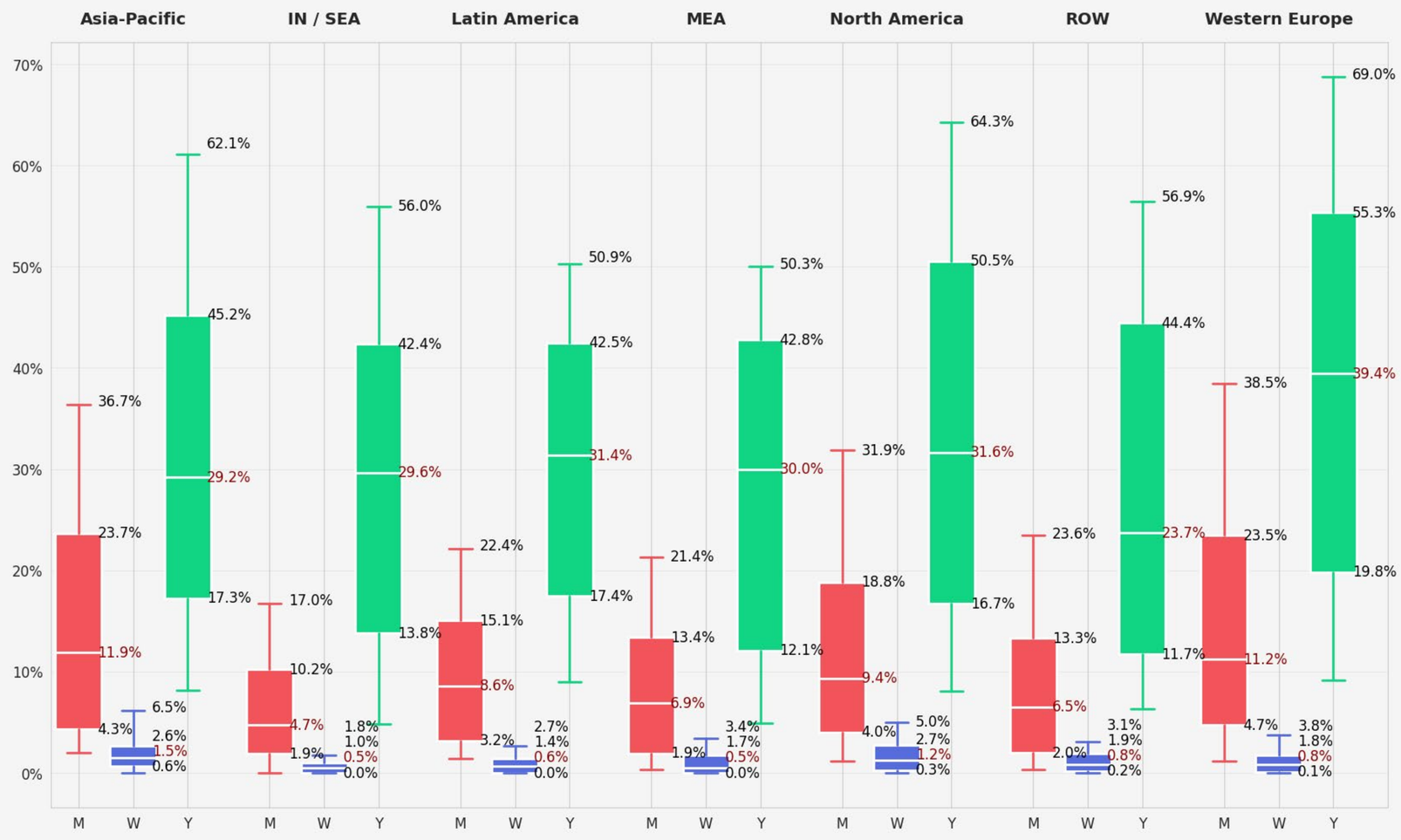
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Photo & Video

# Photo & Video: key takeaways

Photo & Video apps show meaningful monetization expansion after install — but performance varies sharply by geography and price tier. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.9% (IN/SEA) to 4.1% (North America). By D60, median revenue per install (RPI) reaches $0.62 in North America and $0.39 in Western Europe, vs. $0.11 in IN/SEA.

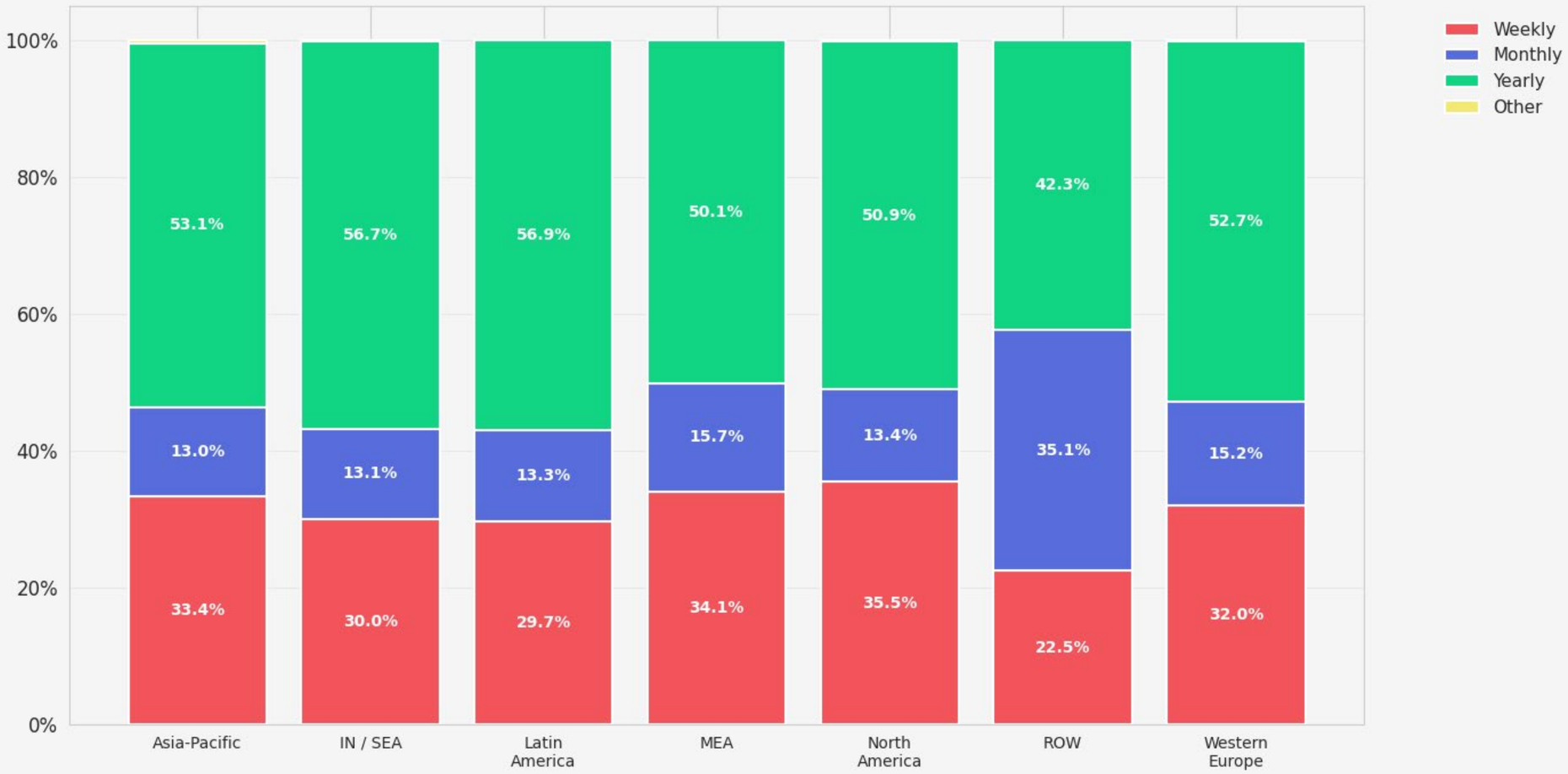
Annual plans dominate most geographies, typically accounting for ~50–57% of subscriptions sold (ROW is the exception, at 42.3%). Median Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ranges from $15.06 (IN/SEA) to $25.83 (Western Europe), with North America at $23.50.

Price segmentation is pronounced: median Y1 lifetime value (LTV) is $12.12 for low-priced apps, $23.53 for mid-priced, and $36.60 for high-priced — a 3x spread from low to high.

## What stands out

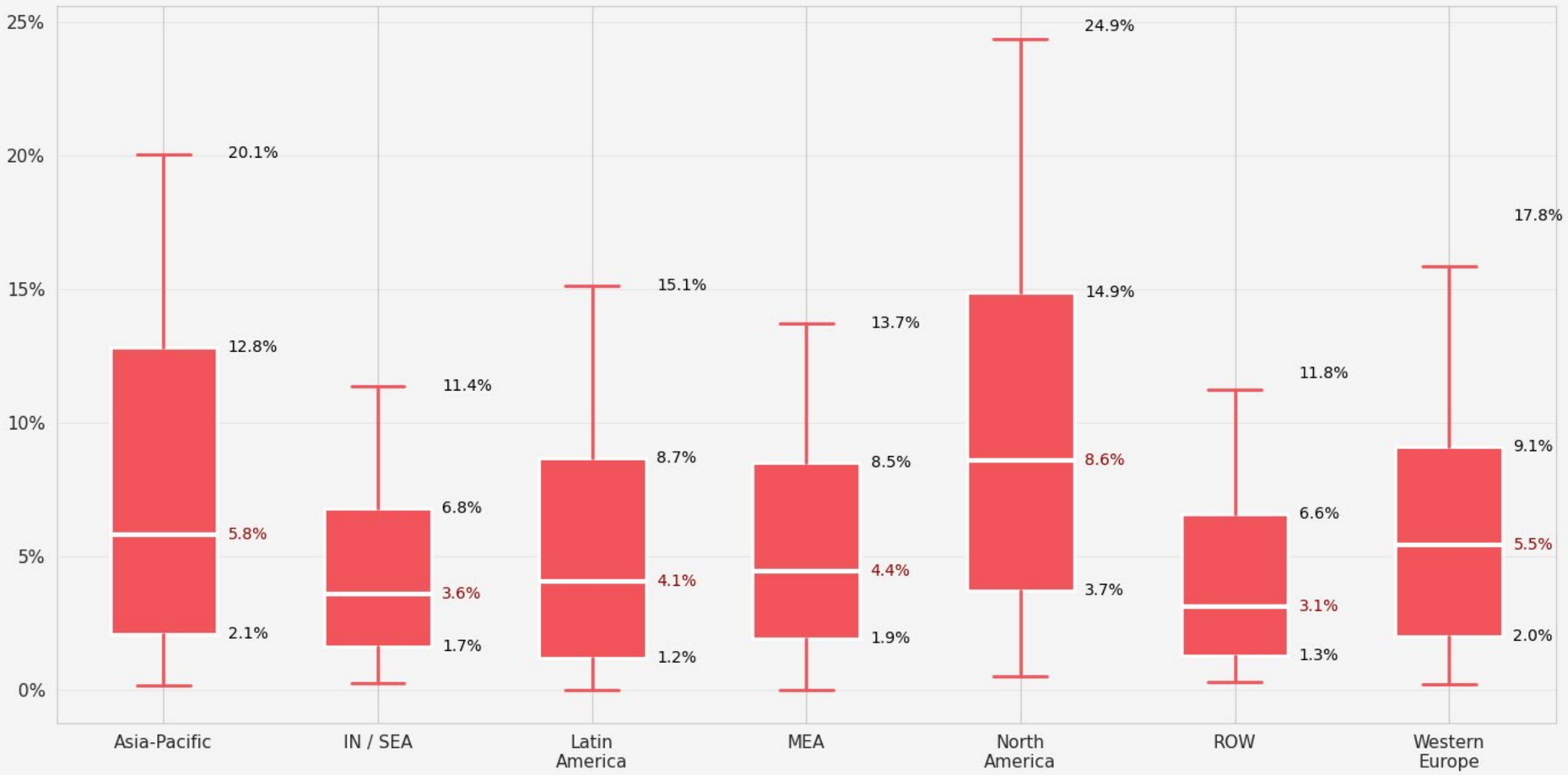
- North America sets the monetization ceiling: median D35 conversion is 4.1%, and D60 RPI reaches $0.62 — the highest shown. Trial-to-paid median is 27.8%, and median Y1 LTV per payer is $23.50. Upper bounds extend materially higher.
- Western Europe monetizes payers at the highest median: median Y1 RLTV per payer is $25.83 — above North America's $23.50. However, conversion and RPI trail North America (D35 median 2.3%; D60 RPI $0.39).
- Annual plans dominate — except in ROW: annual subscriptions represent 53.1% (Asia-Pacific), 56.7% (IN/SEA), 56.9% (Latin America), 50.1% (MEA), 50.9% (North America), and 52.7% (Western Europe). ROW skews monthly (35.1%), with annual at 42.3%.
- Price tier drives LTV more than access method: median Y1 LTV scales from $12.12 (low) to $36.60 (high). By access type, hard paywall median is $30.63 vs. $24.46 for freemium — narrower than the price-based spread.
- Trials are unevenly distributed — and so is full-funnel conversion: median trial start rate ranges from 3.1% (ROW) and 3.6% (IN/SEA) to 8.6% (North America). That gap translates downstream: D35 download-to-paid is 0.9% in IN/SEA vs. 4.1% in North America.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

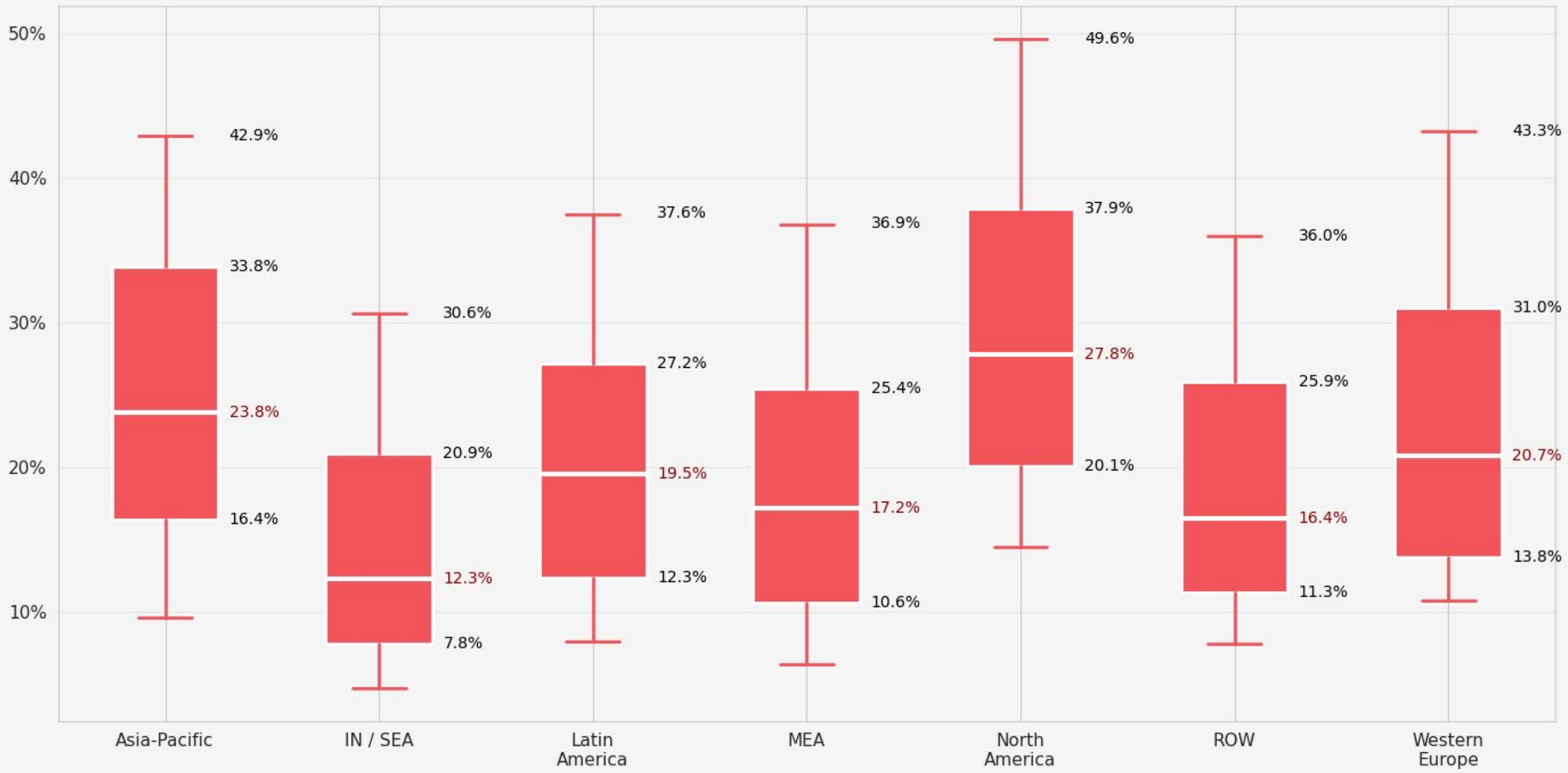


# Pricepoints per plan duration

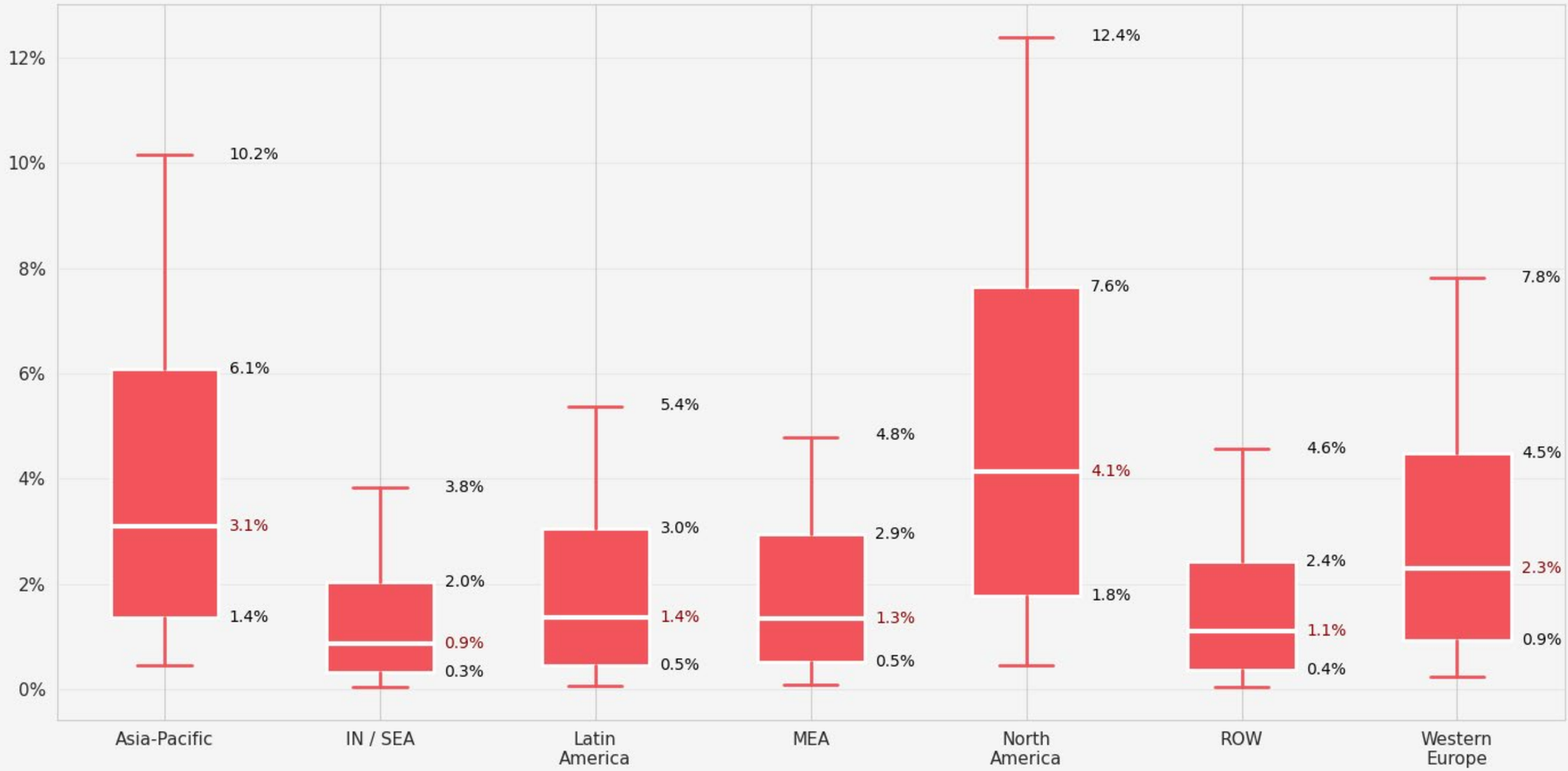
# Trial start rate, by geography



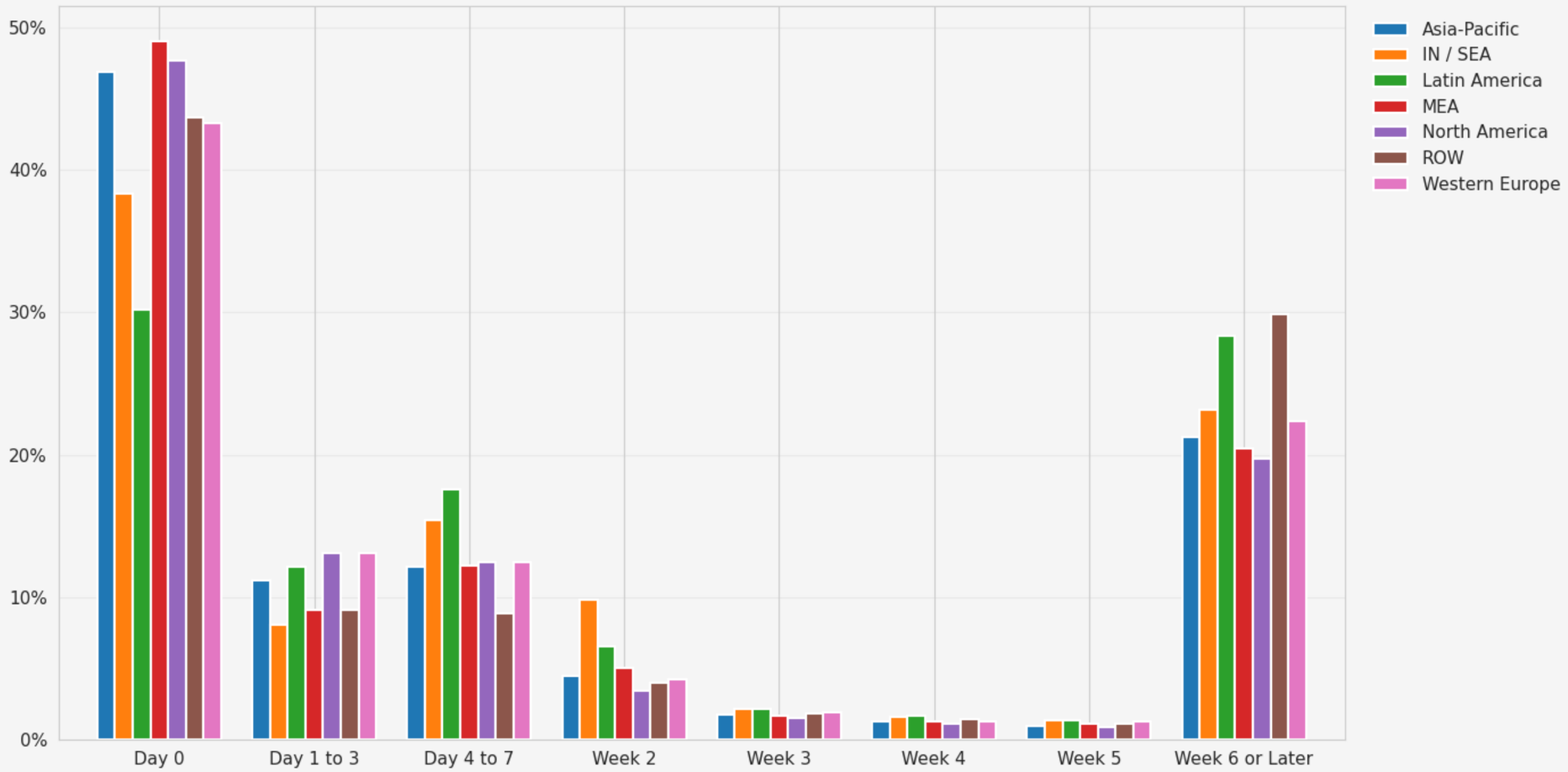
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



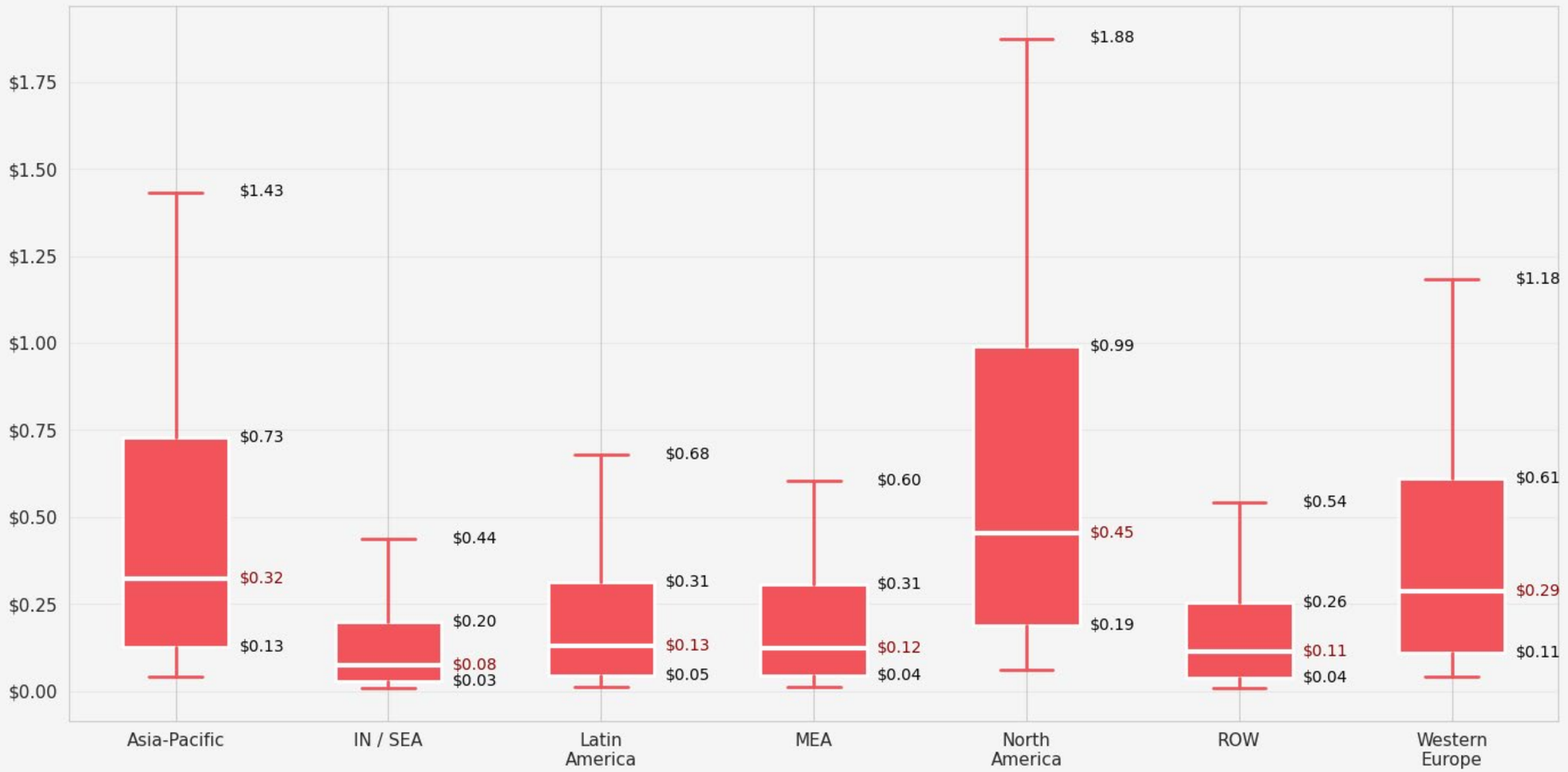
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



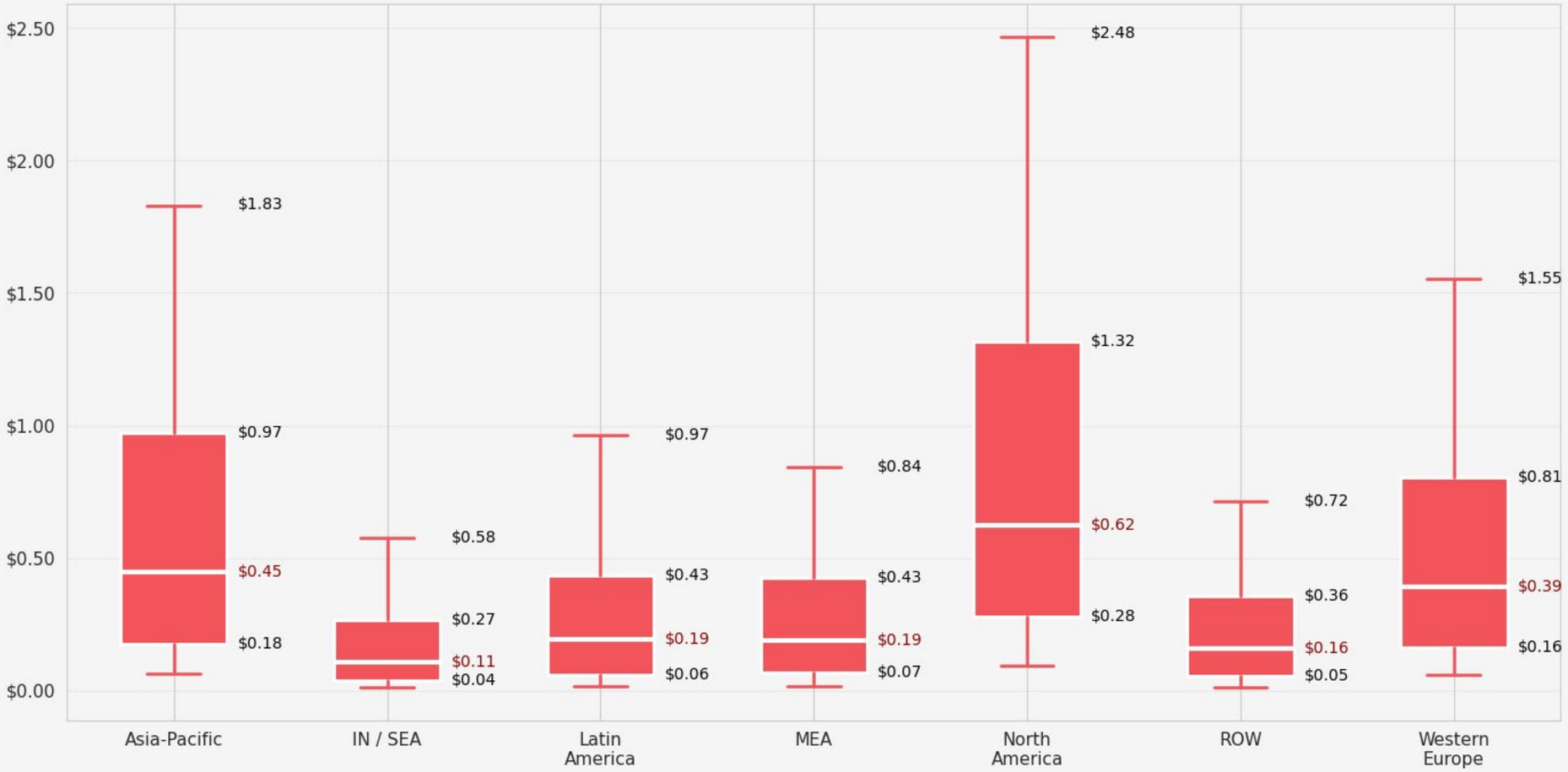
# Time-to-paid, by geography



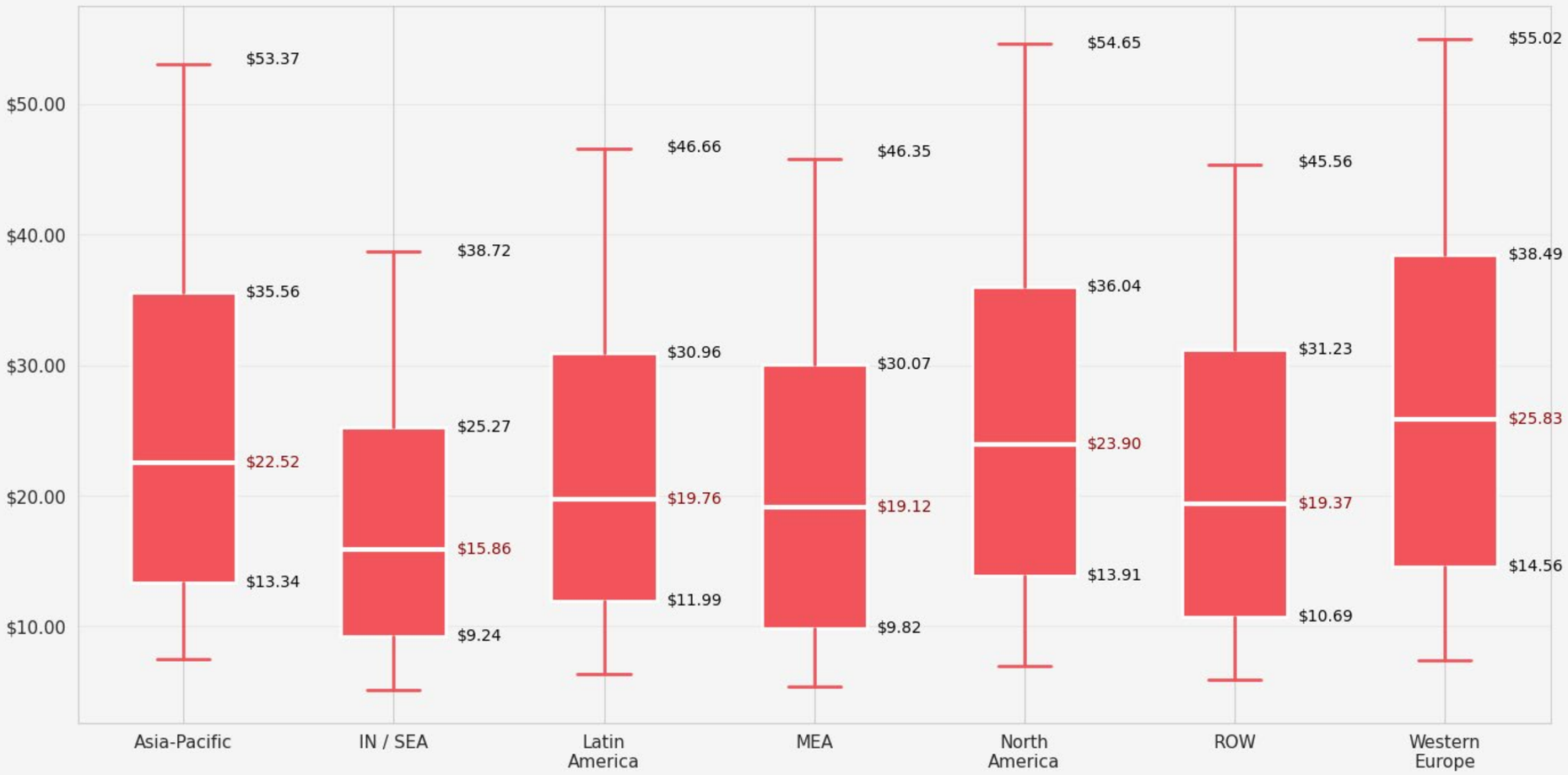
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



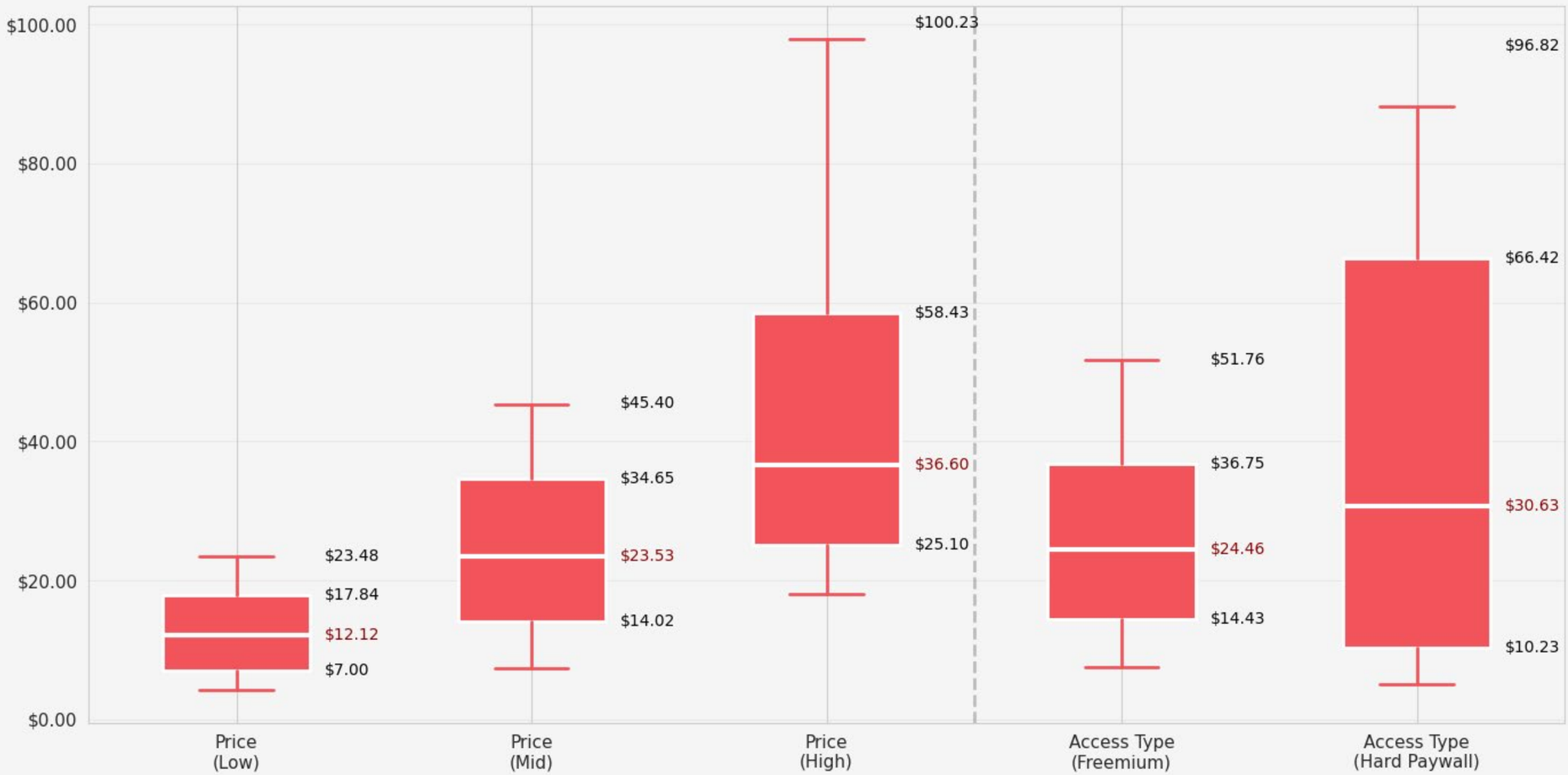
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



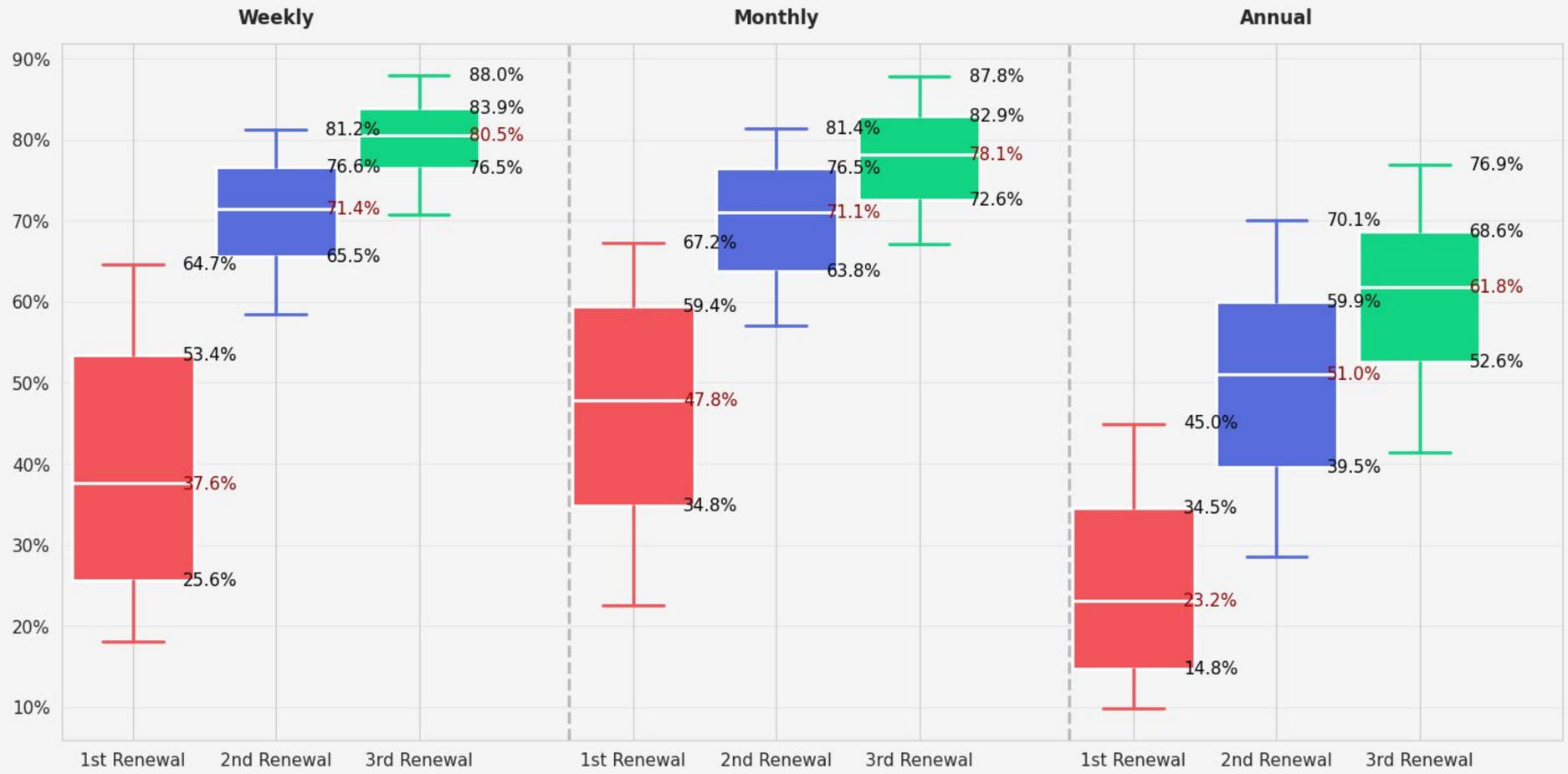
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



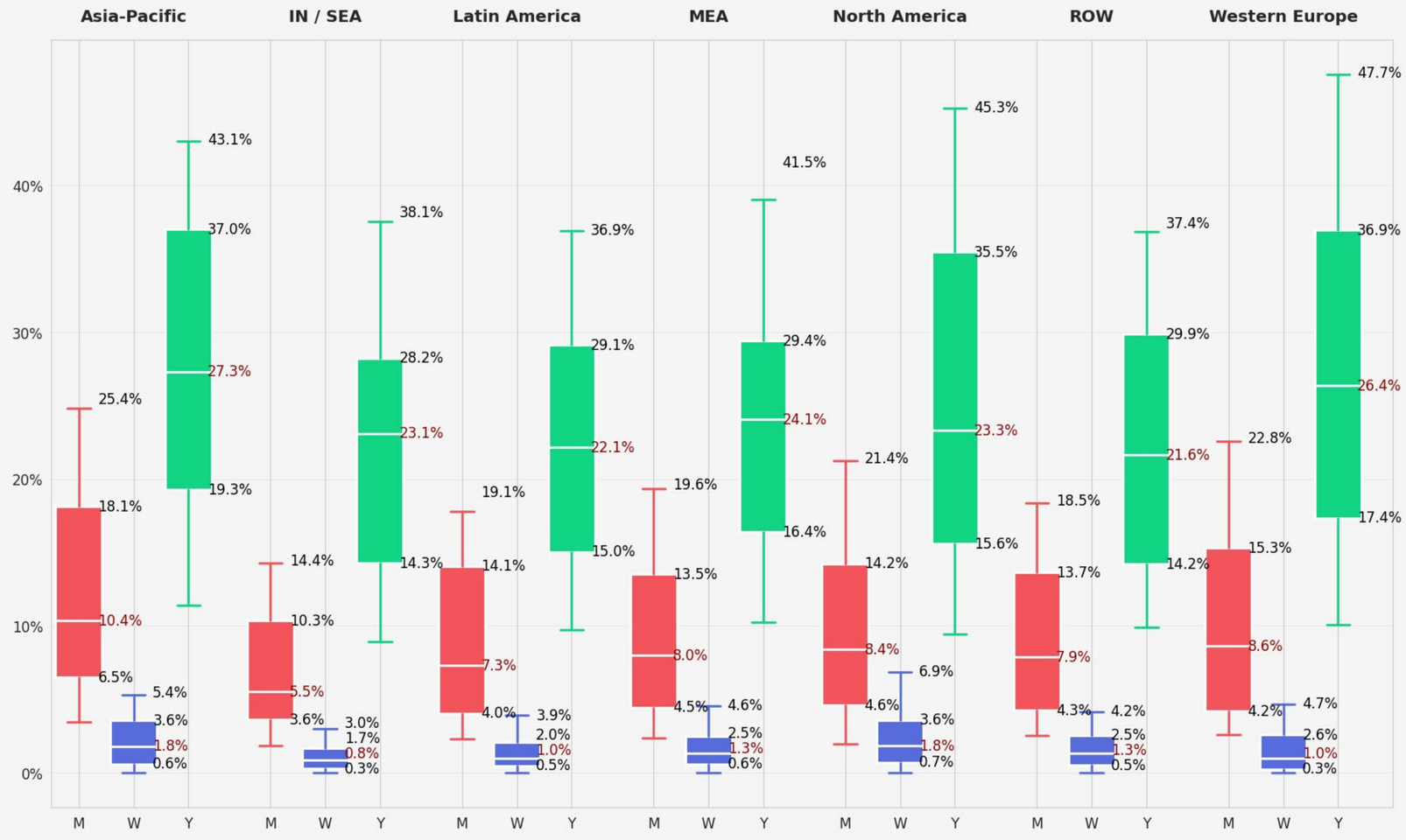
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Productivity

# Productivity: key takeaways

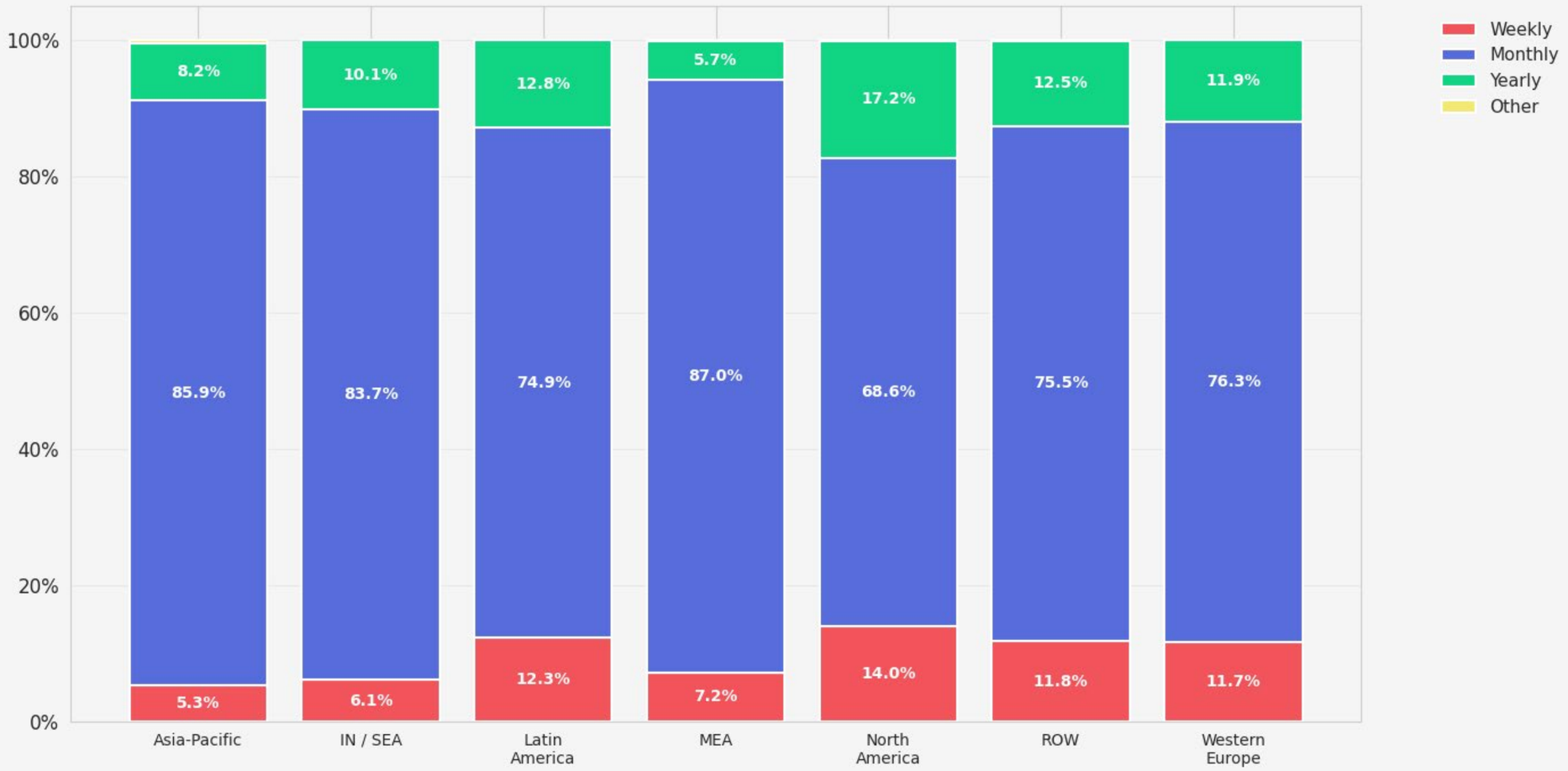
Productivity monetization is geographically stratified — but not evenly across the funnel. North America leads on trial engagement, trial-to-paid conversion, D35 download-to-paid conversion (3.4% median), and Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ($24.89 median). Western Europe follows closely on long-term value ($24.63 median), while Asia-Pacific sits mid-pack across most metrics. IN/SEA consistently under-index on conversion and value (1.0% median D35 conversion; $16.63 median Y1 lifetime value (LTV)).

Revenue per install (RPI) expands meaningfully between D14 and D60 across all geographies — but absolute levels remain tightly clustered outside North America. Subscription mix skews heavily monthly everywhere (66–87% share), with annual plans representing a minority of transactions even in higher-LTV geographies. Conversion is front-loaded: roughly 70%+ of paid conversions occur on day 0 across geographies.

## What stands out

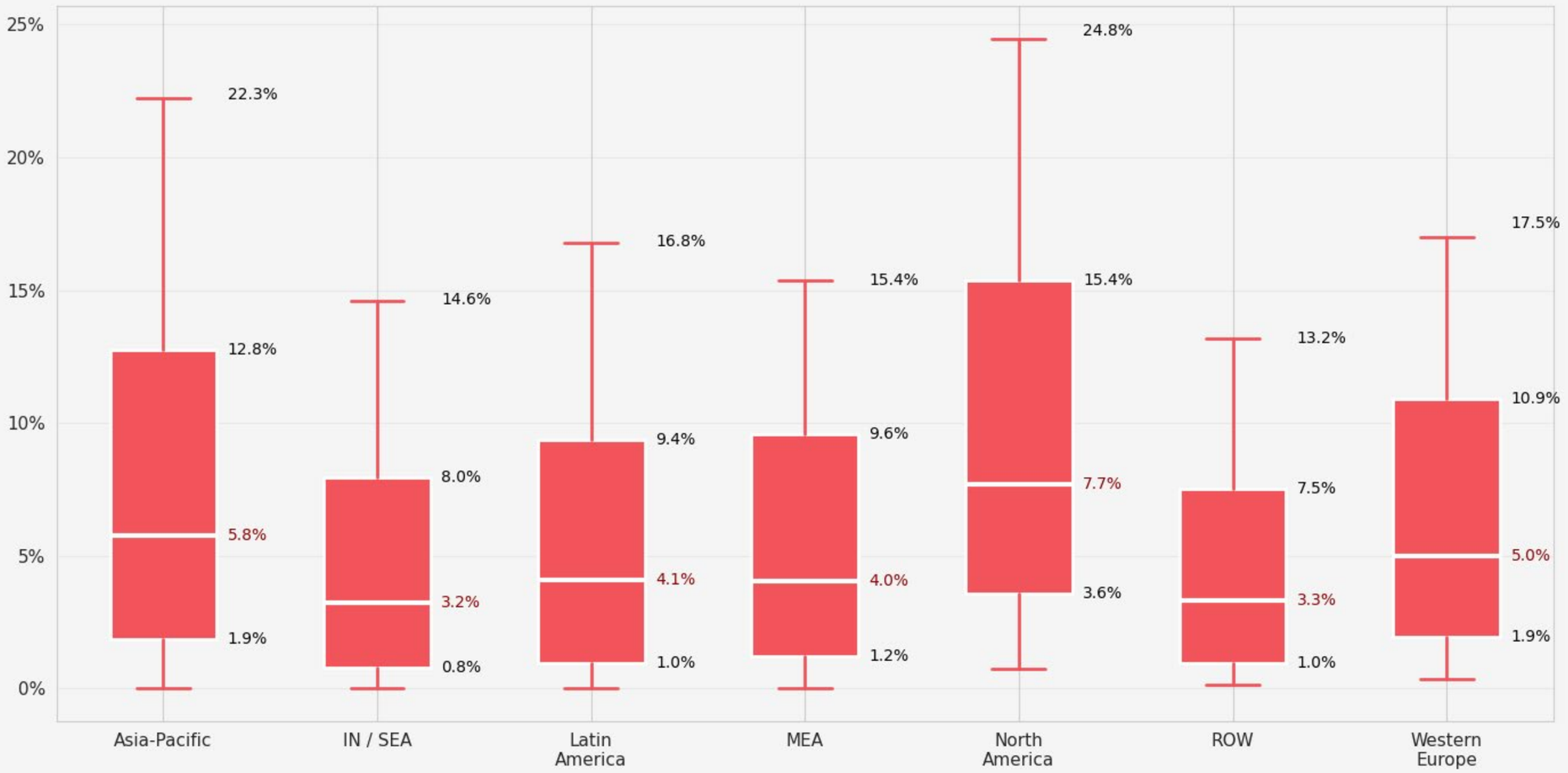
- North America leads across the full funnel: median trial start (7.7%), trial-to-paid (31.7%), D35 download-to-paid (3.4%), and Y1 RLTV per payer ($24.89) are all highest in North America. It's the only geography consistently above category medians at each stage.
- IN/SEA  under-index on paid conversion and LTV: median D35 download-to-paid conversion is 1.0%, and median Y1 LTV per payer is $16.63 — materially below North America and Western Europe.
- RPI grows post-install — but modestly: median RPI increases from D14 to D60 in every geography (e.g., North America $0.44 → $0.59; Asia-Pacific $0.30 → $0.41). Expansion exists, but the majority of value is established early.
- Monthly plans dominate globally: monthly subscriptions account for roughly 66–87% of subscriptions sold by geography (87.0% in MEA, 83.7% in IN/SEA). Annual share peaks at 17.2% in North America — and remains lower elsewhere.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

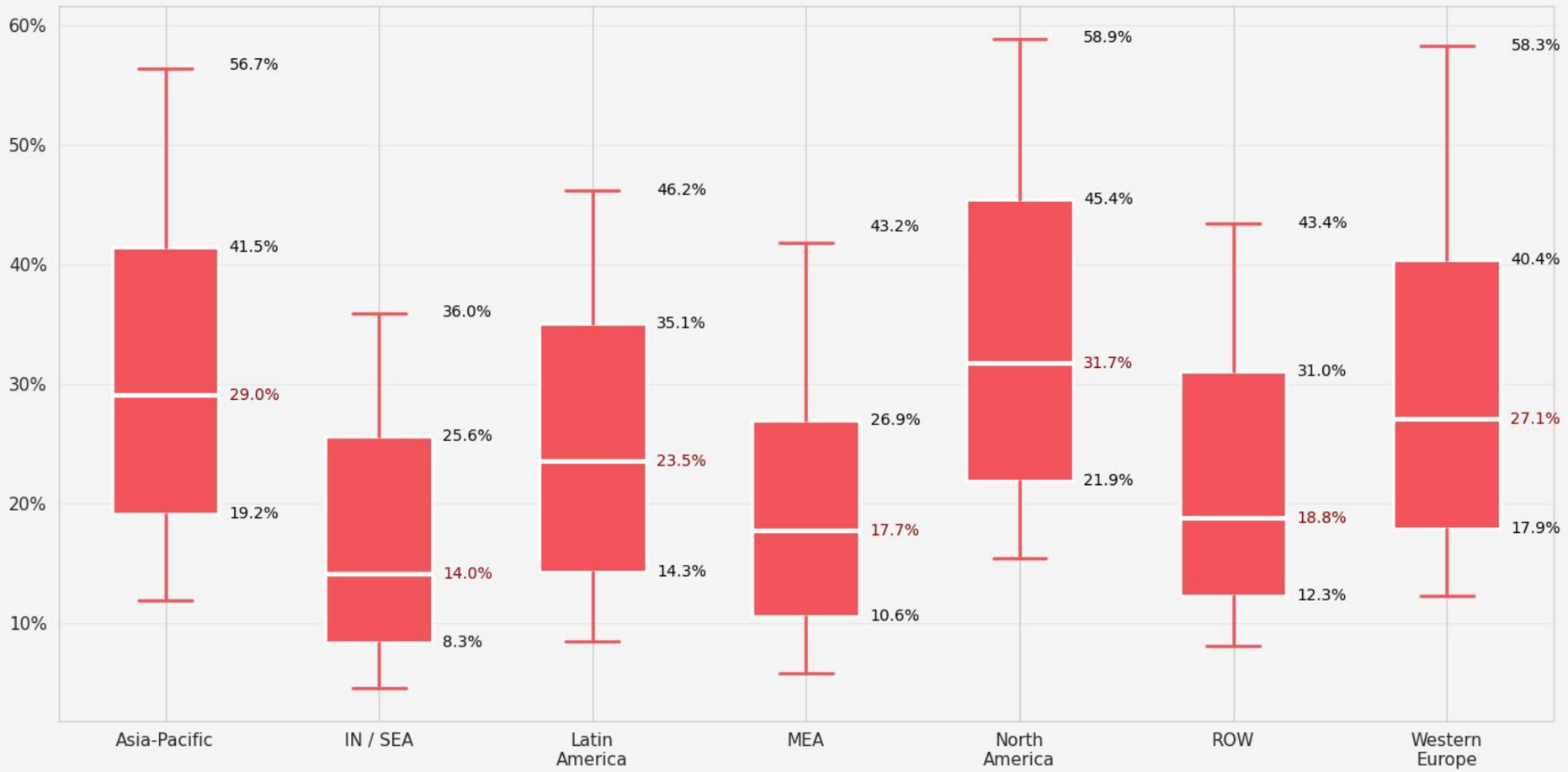


# Pricepoints per plan duration

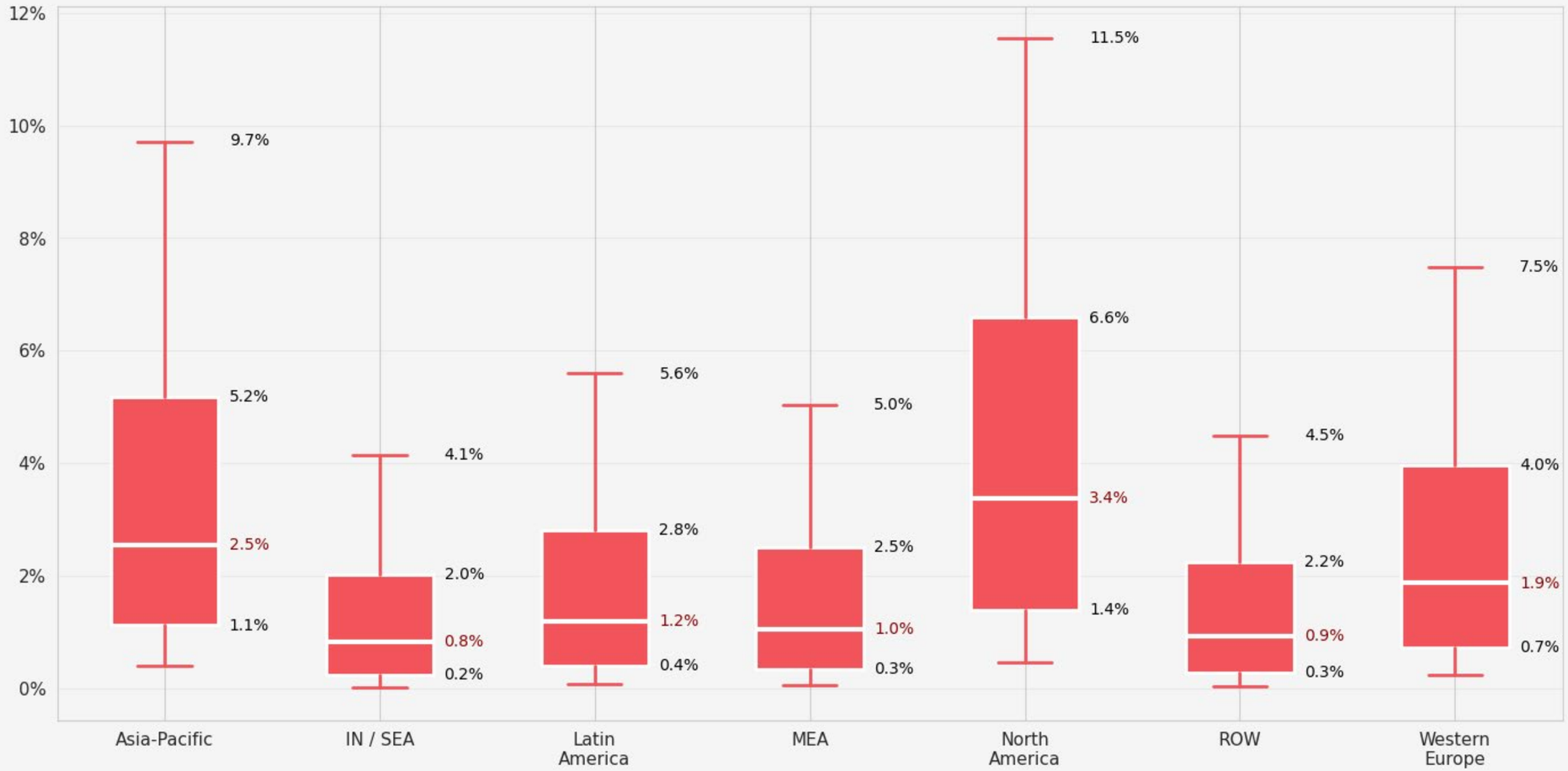
# Trial start rate, by geography



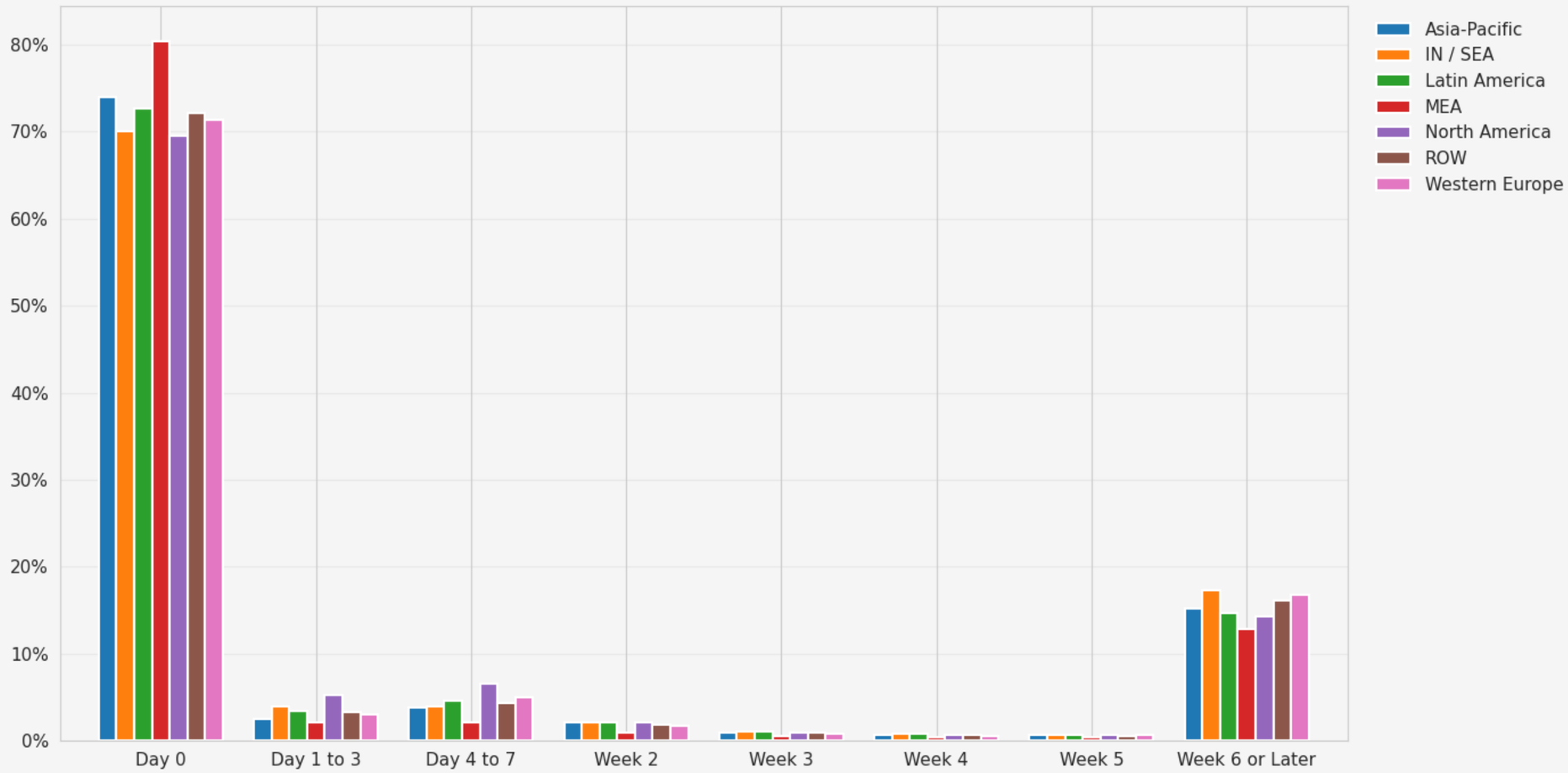
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



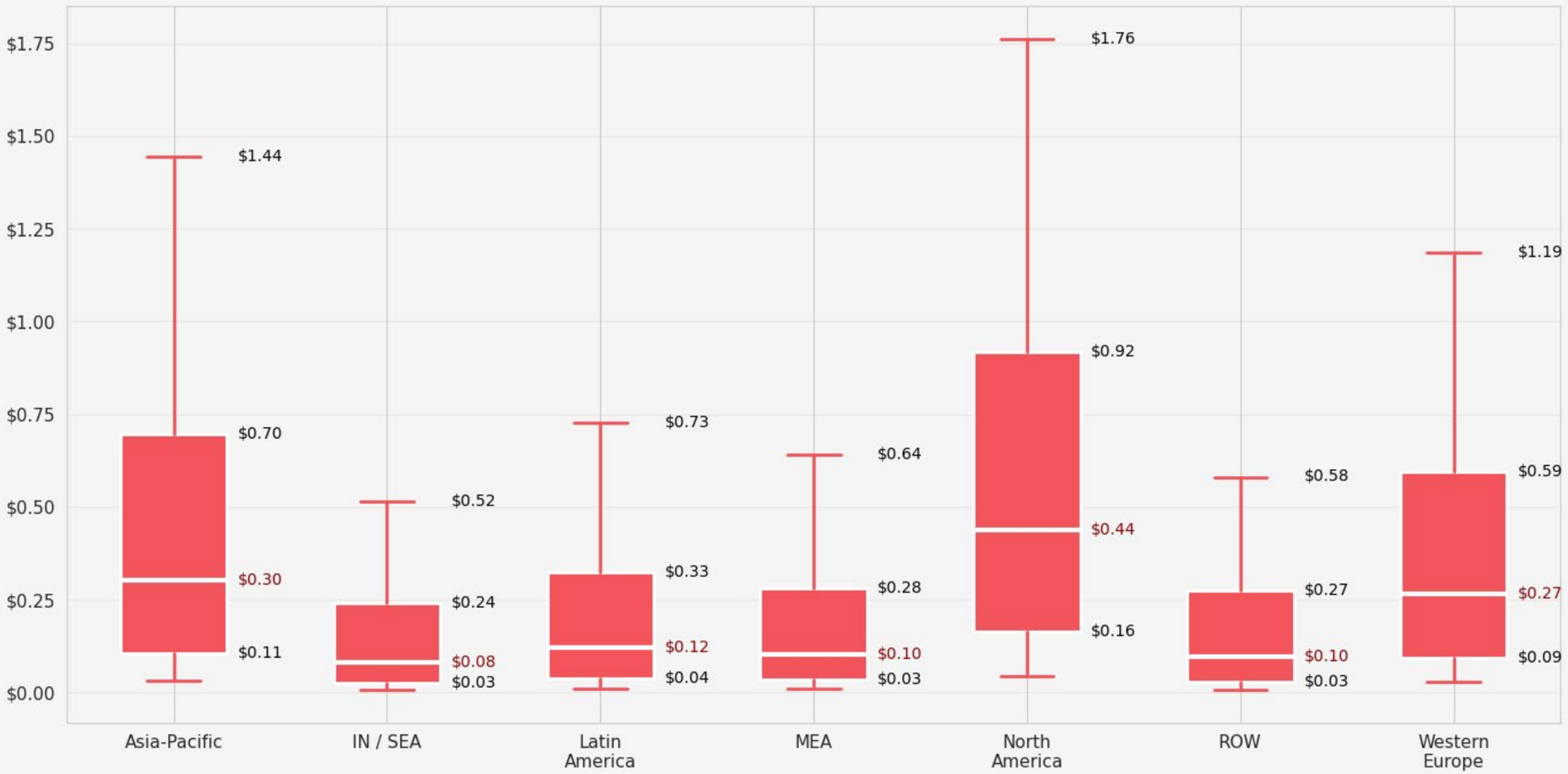
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



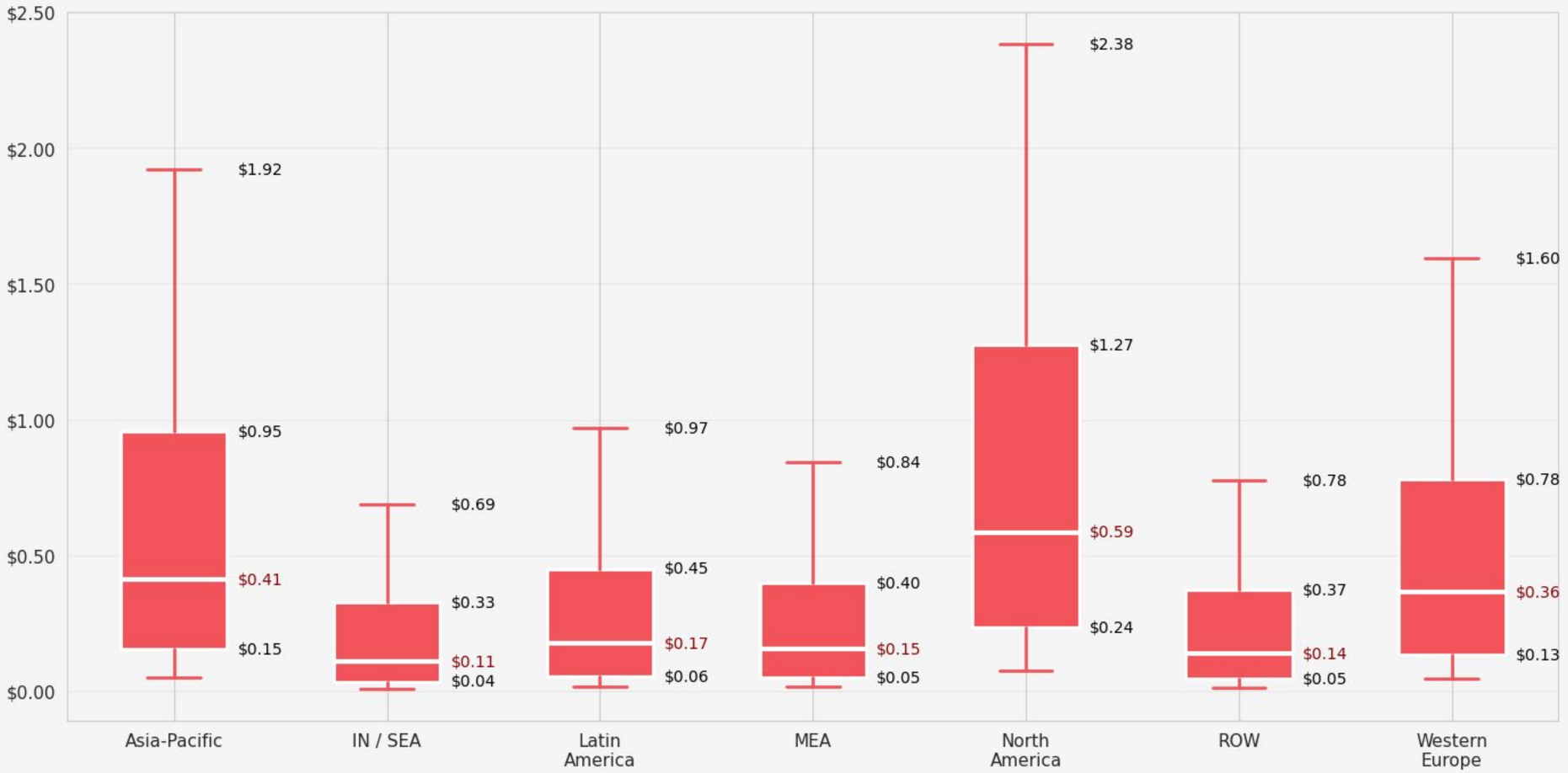
# Time-to-paid, by geography



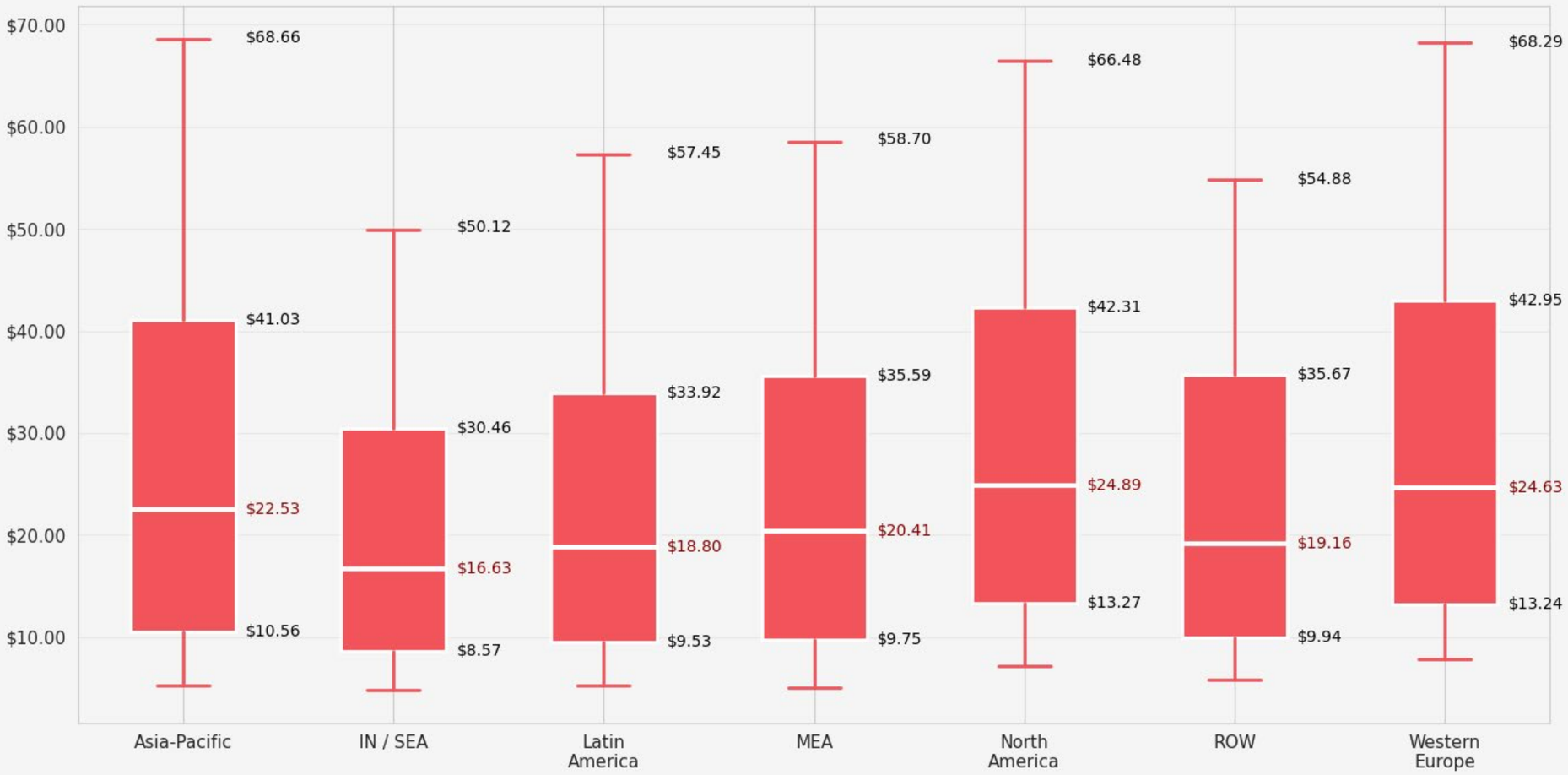
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



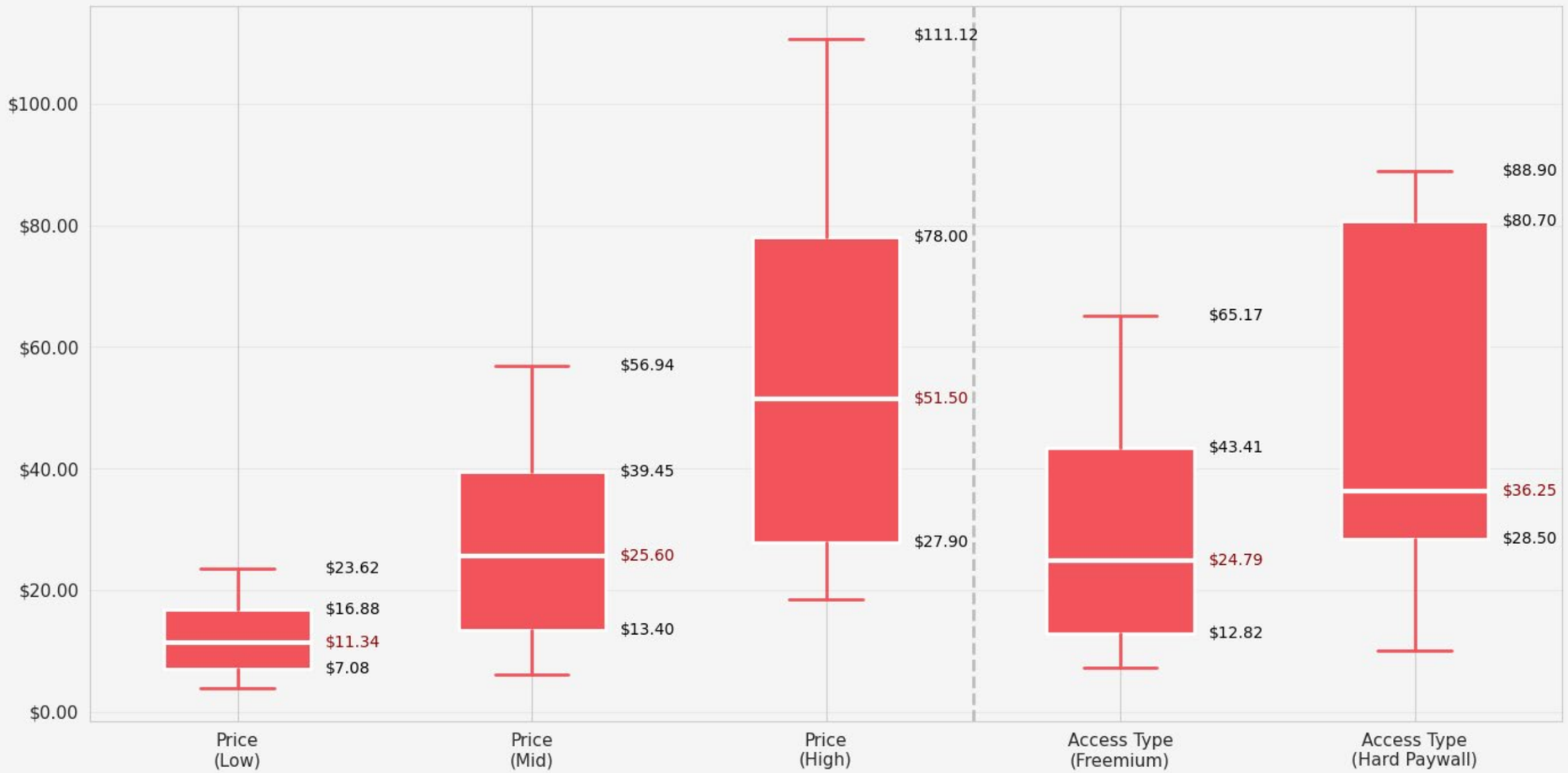
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



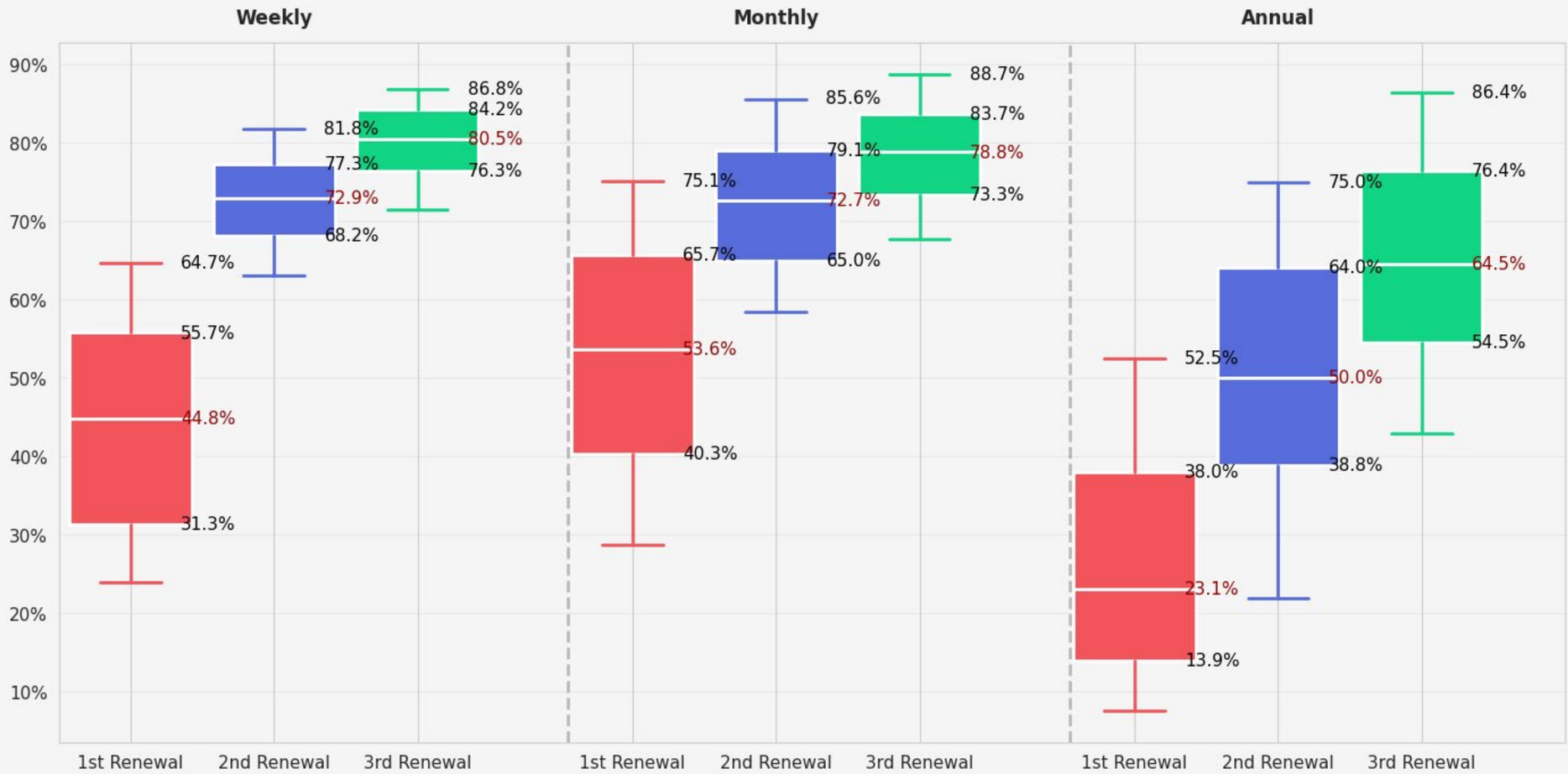
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



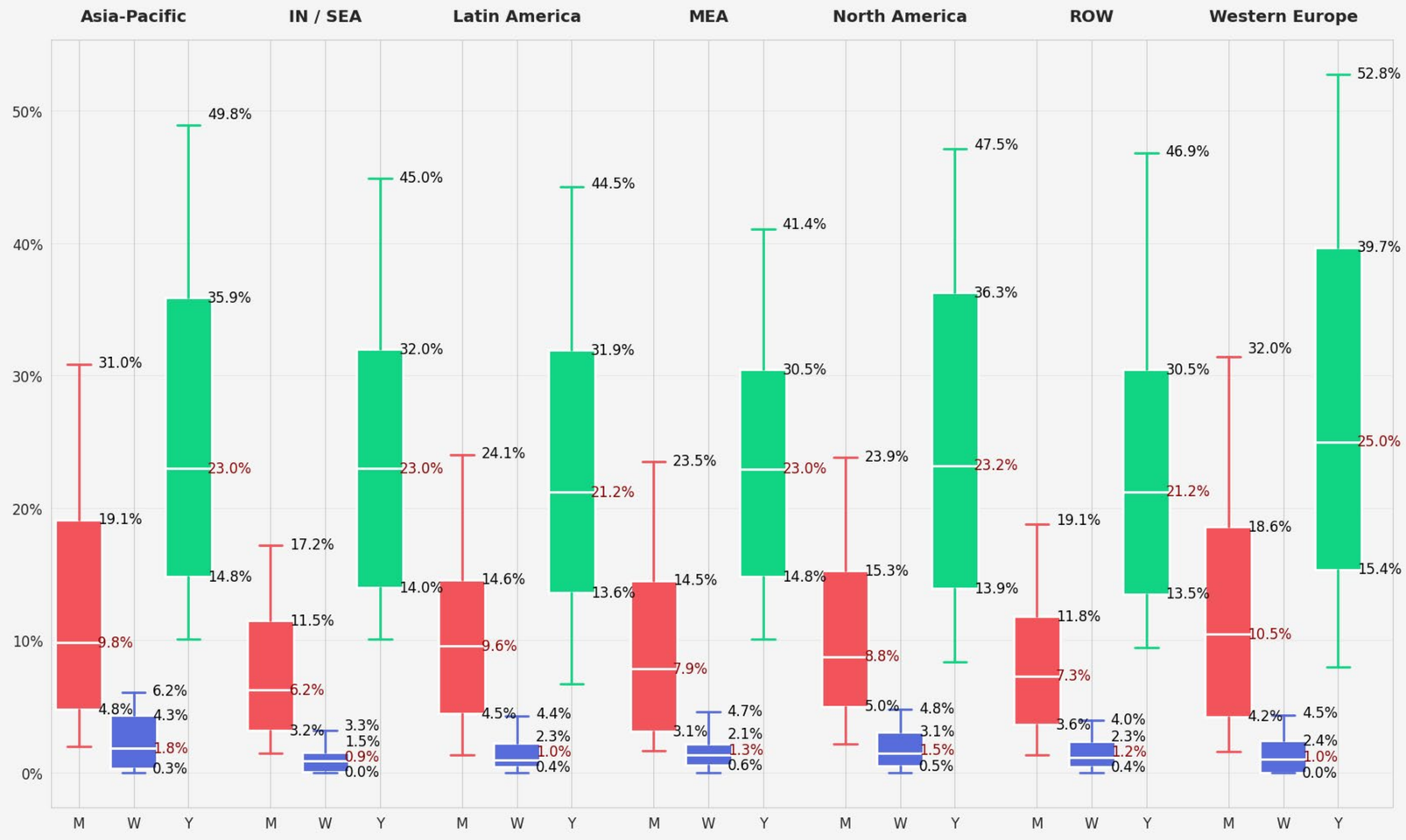
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Shopping

# Productivity: key takeaways

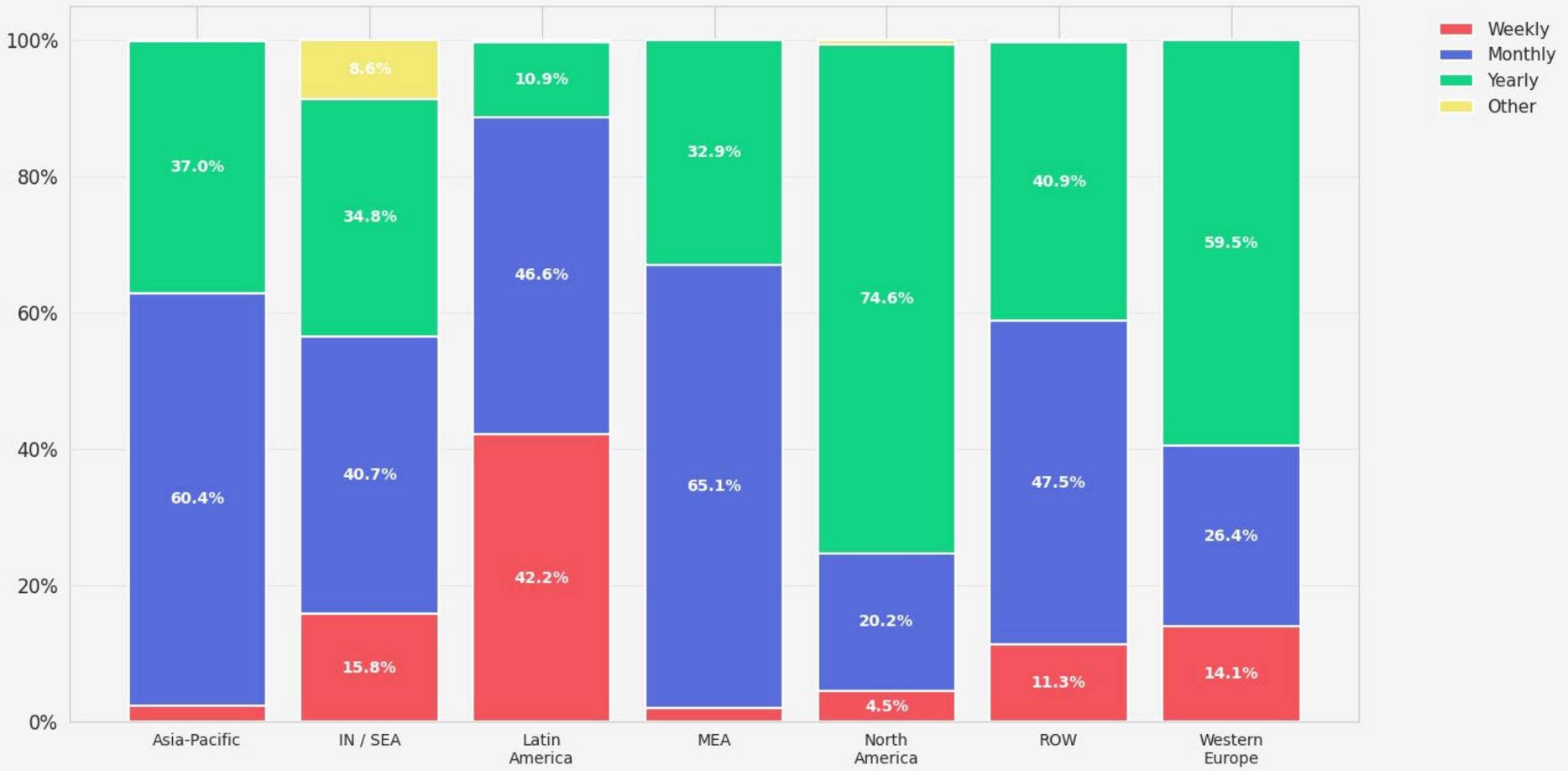
Shopping apps show modest top-of-funnel conversion, but meaningful dispersion by geography and pricepoint. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.9% (ROW) to 3.4% (North America). Revenue per install (RPI) expands materially between D14 and D60 across every geography — for example, from $0.30 to $0.41 in Asia-Pacific, and from $0.44 to $0.59 in North America.

Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer varies widely. The median ranges from $16.63 (IN/SEA) to $24.89 (North America), with upper quartile outcomes substantially higher (noted in chart). High price tiers materially outperform low price tiers on payer lifetime value (LTV). Meanwhile, subscription mix is heavily monthly across all geographies, though weekly share is non-trivial in Latin America and North America. Overall, monetization is back-loaded post-install, geographically uneven, and highly sensitive to pricing strategy.

## What stands out

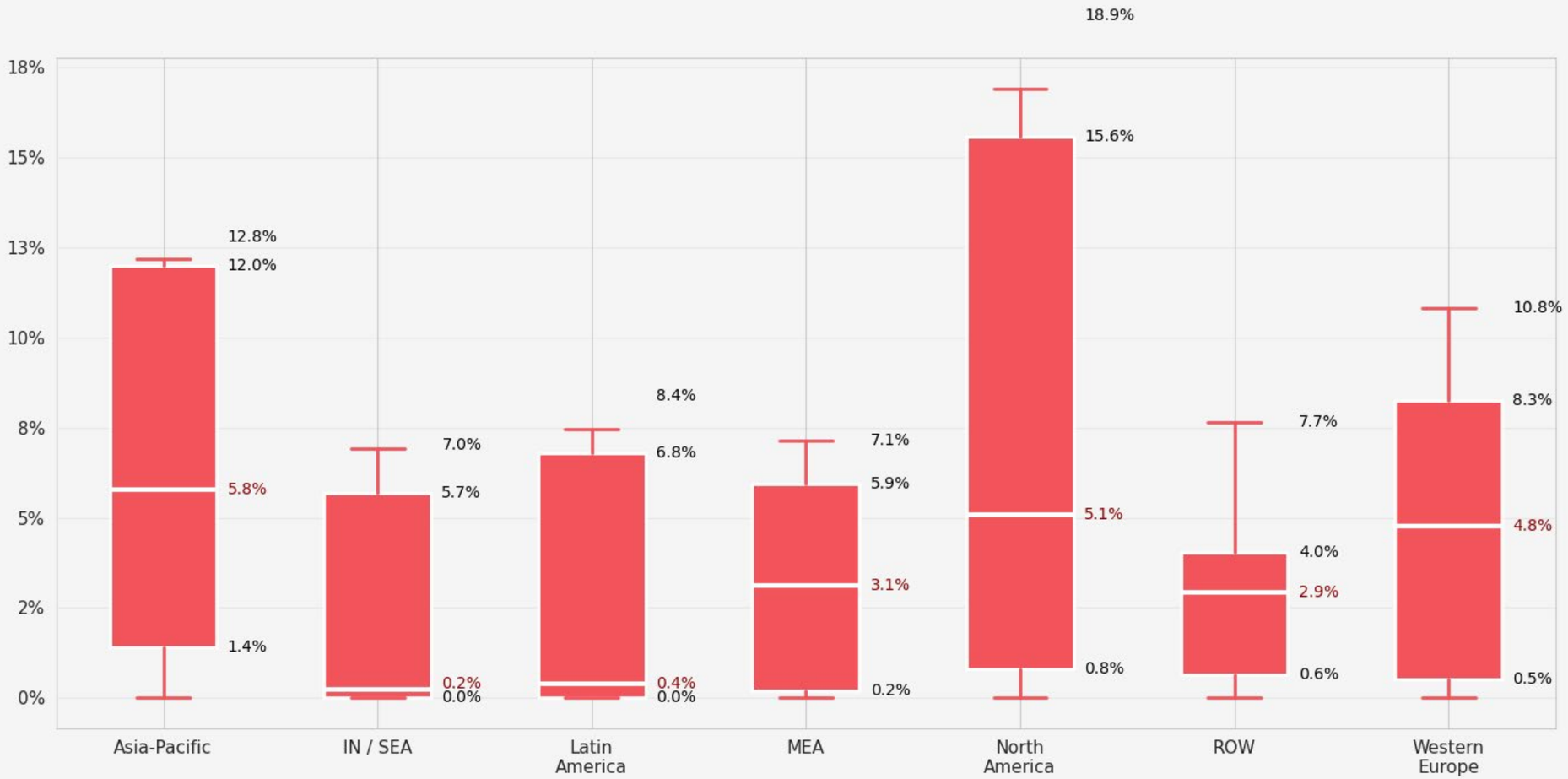
- North America leads across the funnel: it posts the highest median D35 conversion (3.4%), the highest D60 RPI ($0.59), and the highest median Y1 LTV per payer ($24.89). Benchmarking without segmenting by geography will distort performance expectations.
- RPI meaningfully expands after D14: every geography shows higher medians at D60 vs. D14 — e.g. Western Europe grows from $0.27 to $0.36, Latin America from $0.12 to $0.17. Monetization continues well beyond the first two weeks.
- Price tier drives LTV more than access method: median Y1 LTV per payer rises from $11.34 (low price) to $51.59 (high price). By contrast, freemium vs. hard paywall medians ($24.79 vs. $36.25) show a smaller gap. Pricing level has the strongest relationship with payer value.
- Monthly dominates, but weekly is meaningful in some geographies: monthly accounts for 75–87% of subscriptions across geographies. However, weekly reaches 12.3% in Latin America and 14.0% in North America. Plan mix is not globally uniform.
- Conversion is heavily front-loaded: roughly 70–80% of payments occur on Day 0 across geographies (exact percentages vary by geography). Later weeks contribute relatively little incremental volume. Early intent capture matters disproportionately.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

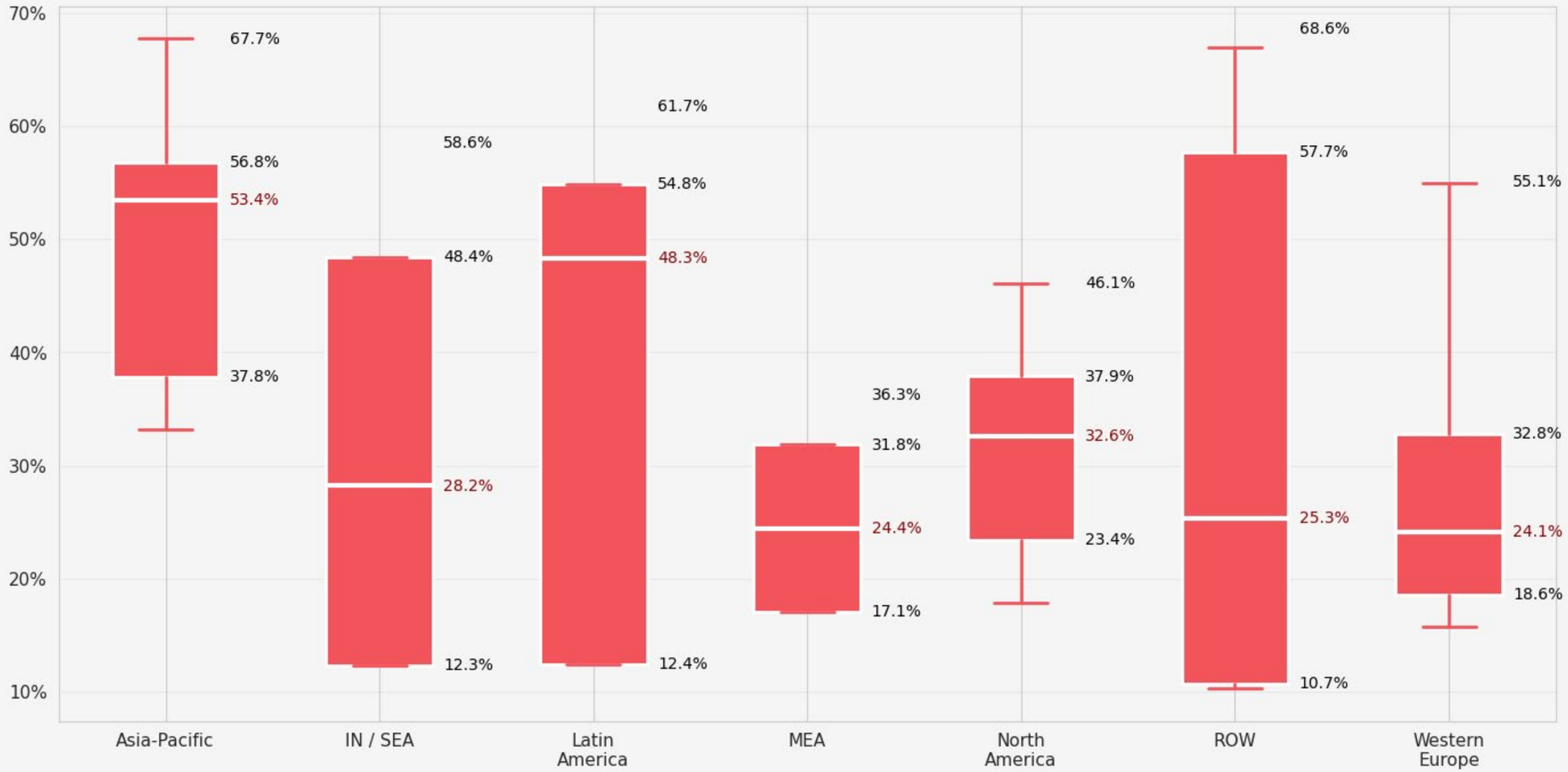


# Pricepoints per plan duration

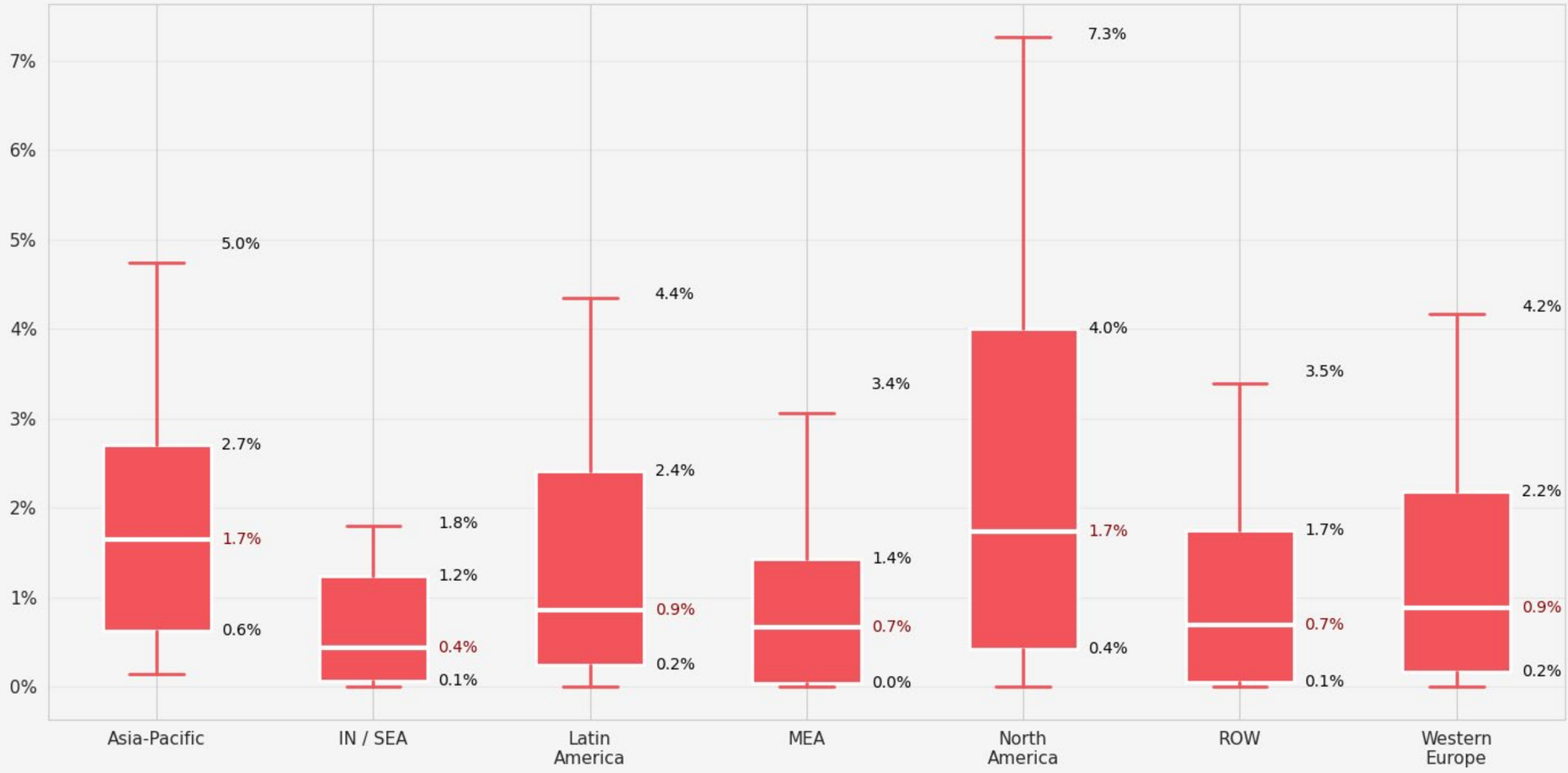
# Trial start rate, by geography



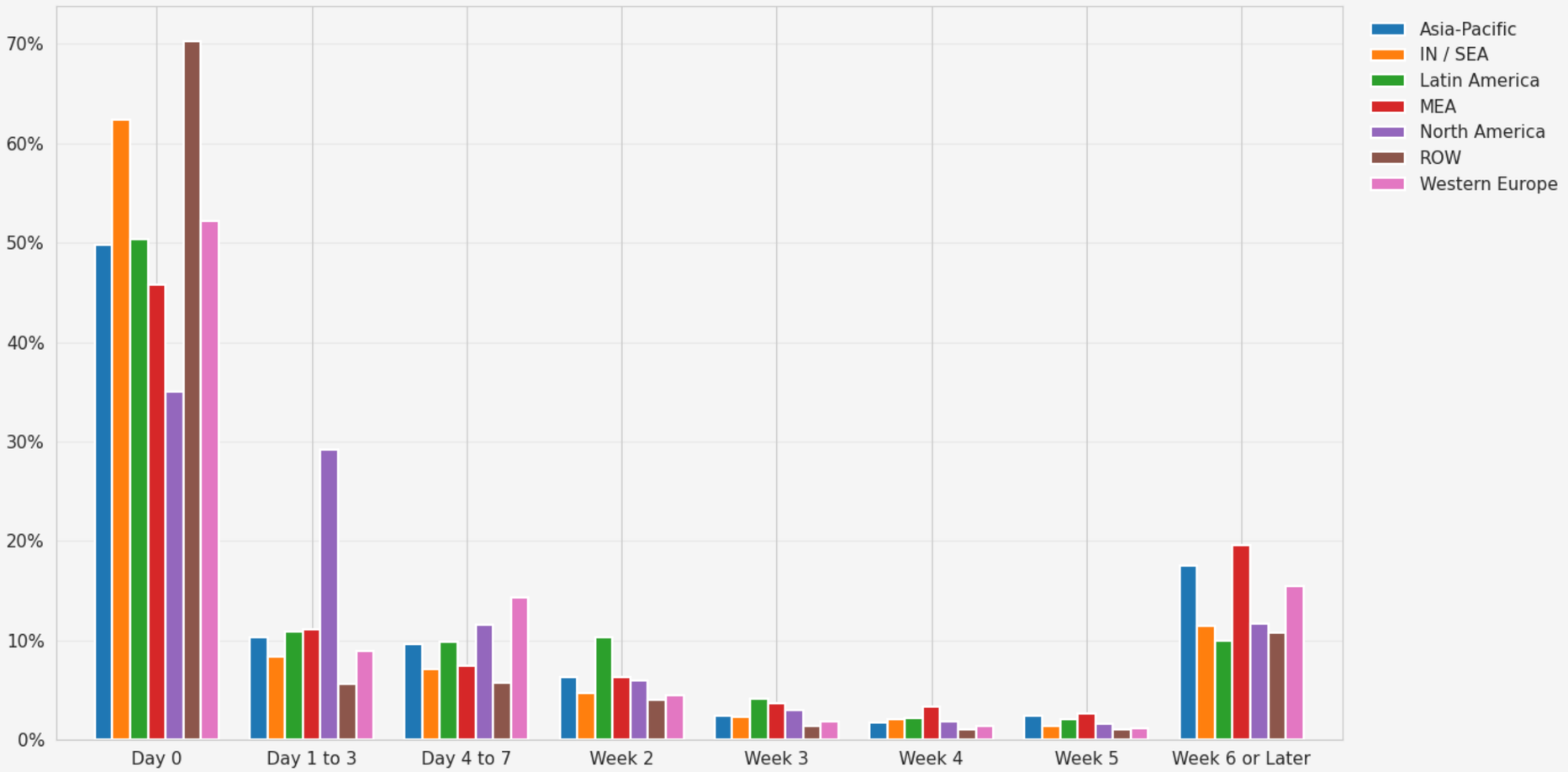
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



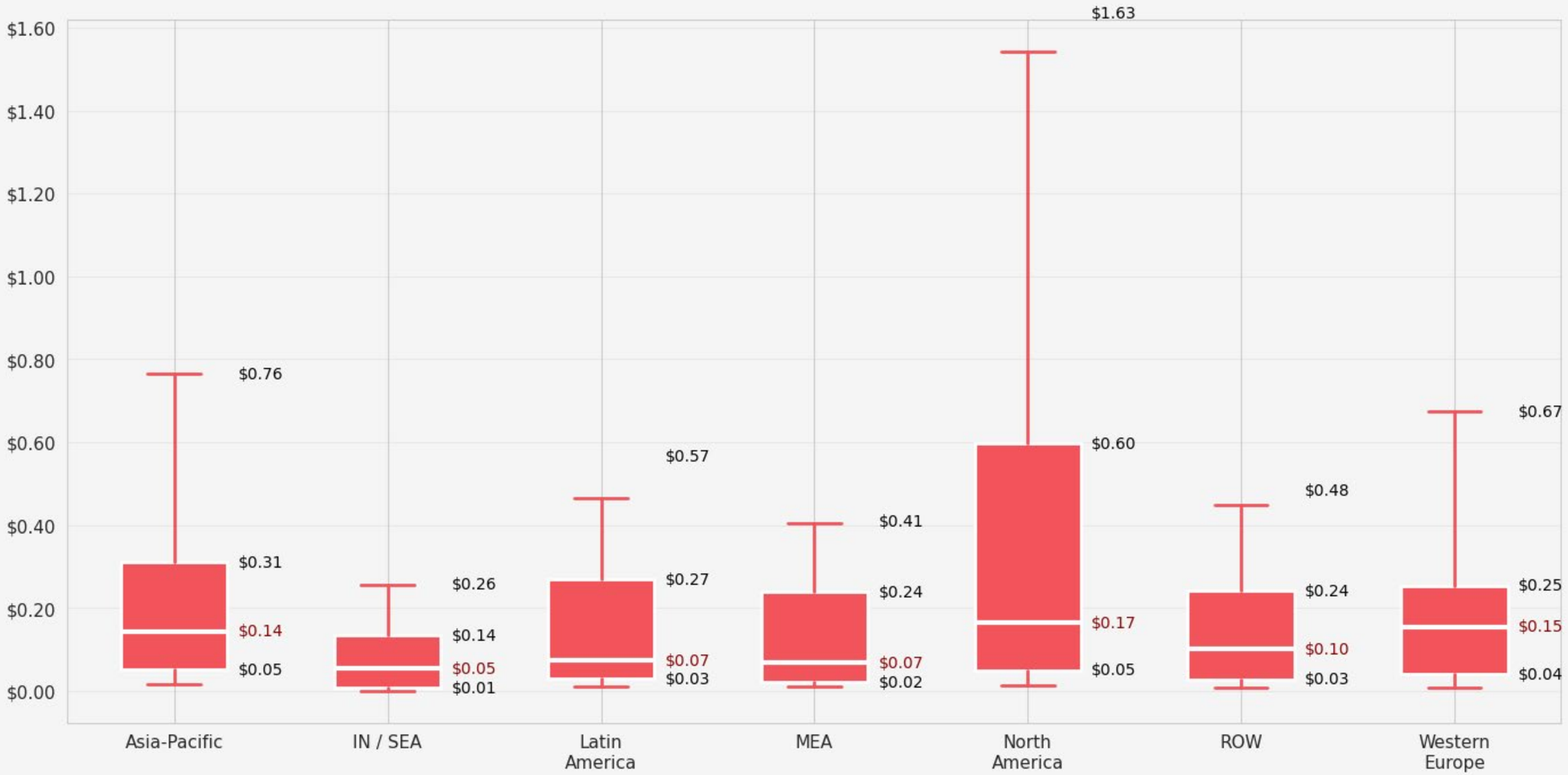
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



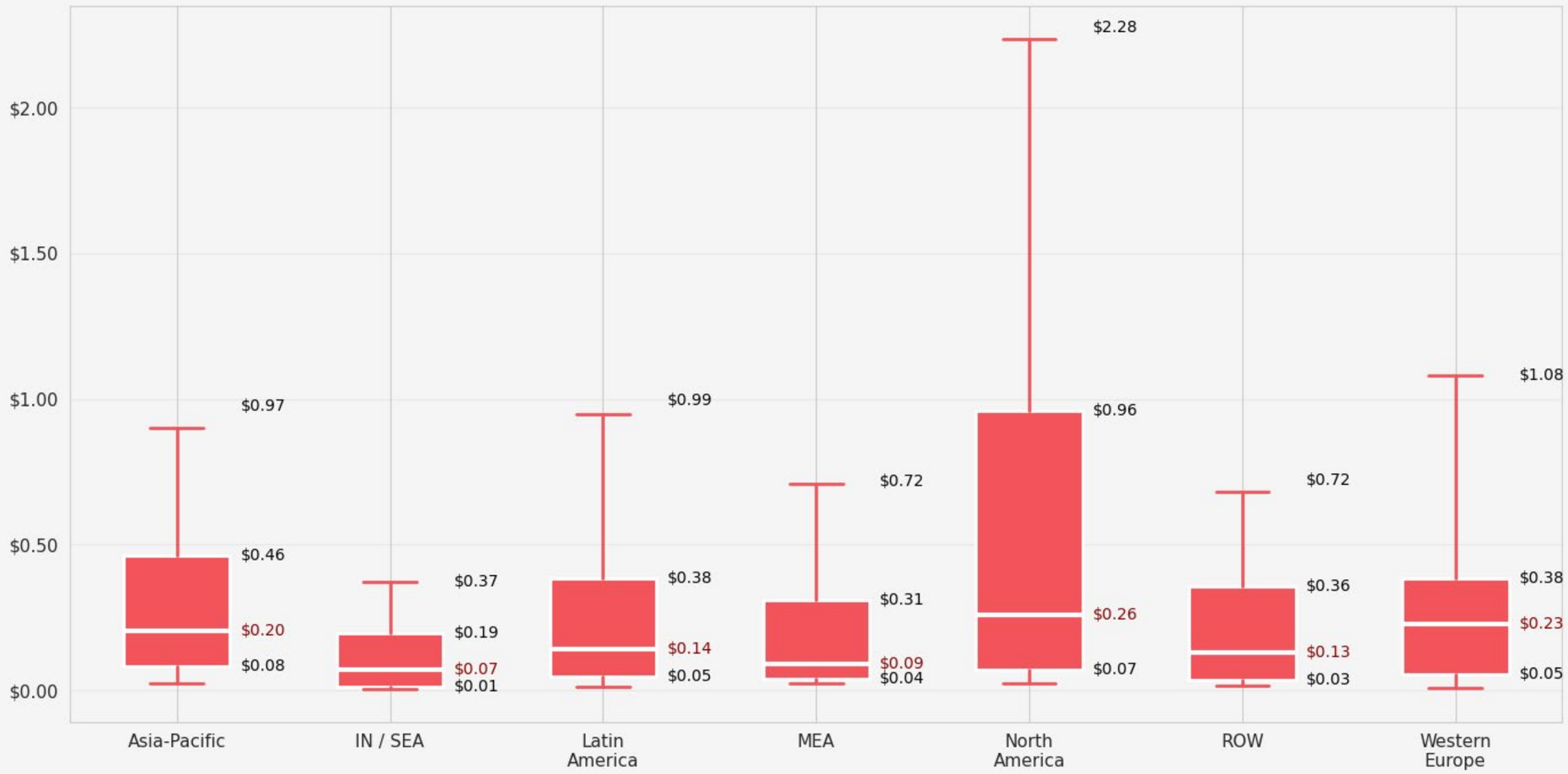
# Time-to-paid, by geography



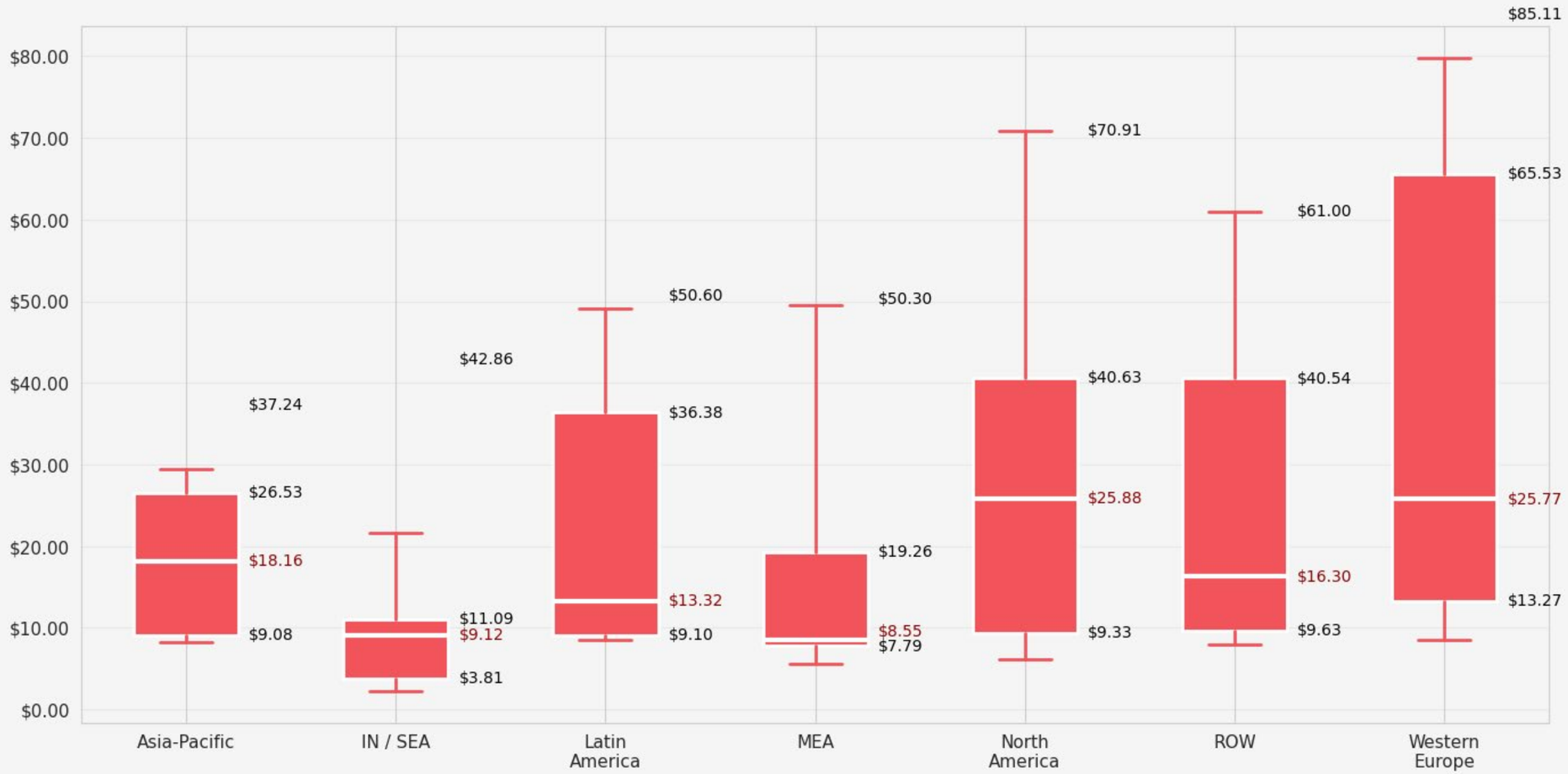
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography

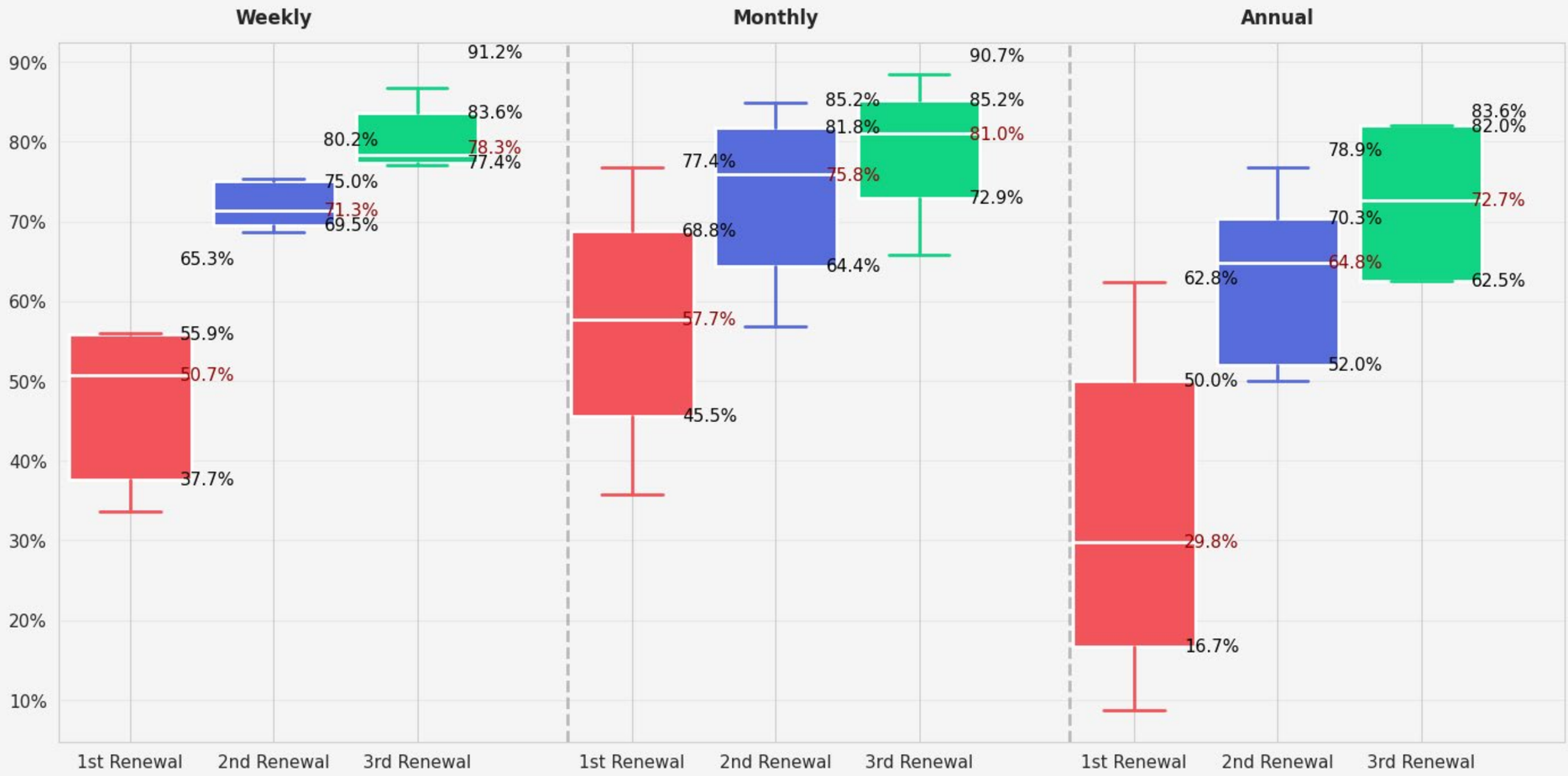


# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint

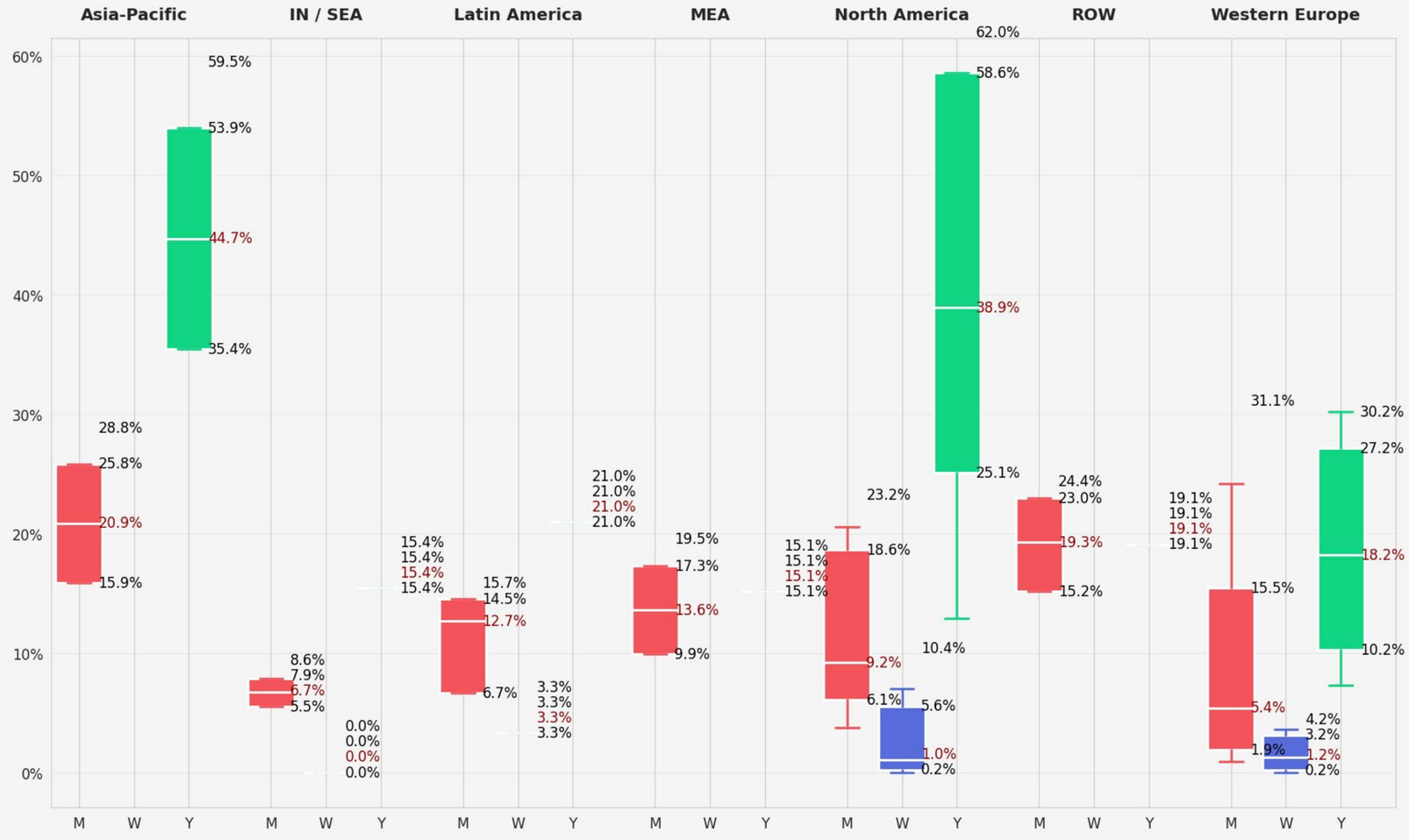


# First 3 weekly renewals

# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Social & Lifestyle

# Social & Lifestyle: key takeaways

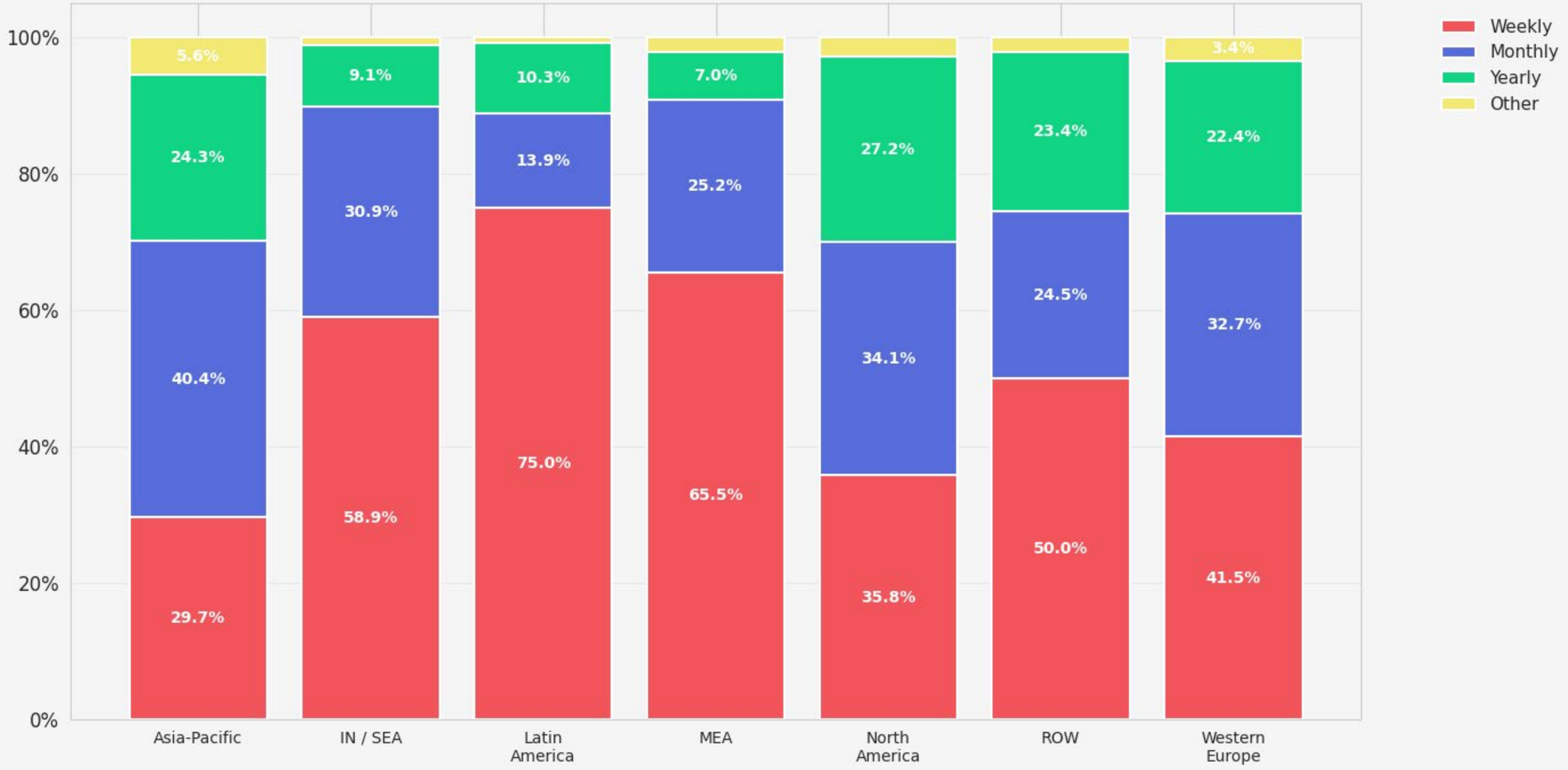
Social & Lifestyle monetization is highly geography-sensitive. Conversion rates, pricing mix, revenue per install (RPI), and payer lifetime value (LTV) vary materially by geography — and the spread between median and upper quartile performance is wide. North America consistently leads on trial starts, trial-to-paid conversion, RPI, and Y1 LTV per payer, with Western Europe close behind on long-term value. IN/SEA and ROW trail across most metrics, reflecting structural differences in purchasing power and subscription behavior.

Conversion is also front-loaded: the majority of paid conversions occur on Day 0 across geographies. But its downstream performance — trial-to-paid efficiency and long-term LTV — that ultimately separates markets. If you're below 1% D35 conversion or roughly $20 Y1 LTV per payer in North America or Western Europe, you're under the geographical median. For apps operating in IN/SEA or ROW, lower benchmarks reflect market context, not necessarily weaker execution.

## What stands out

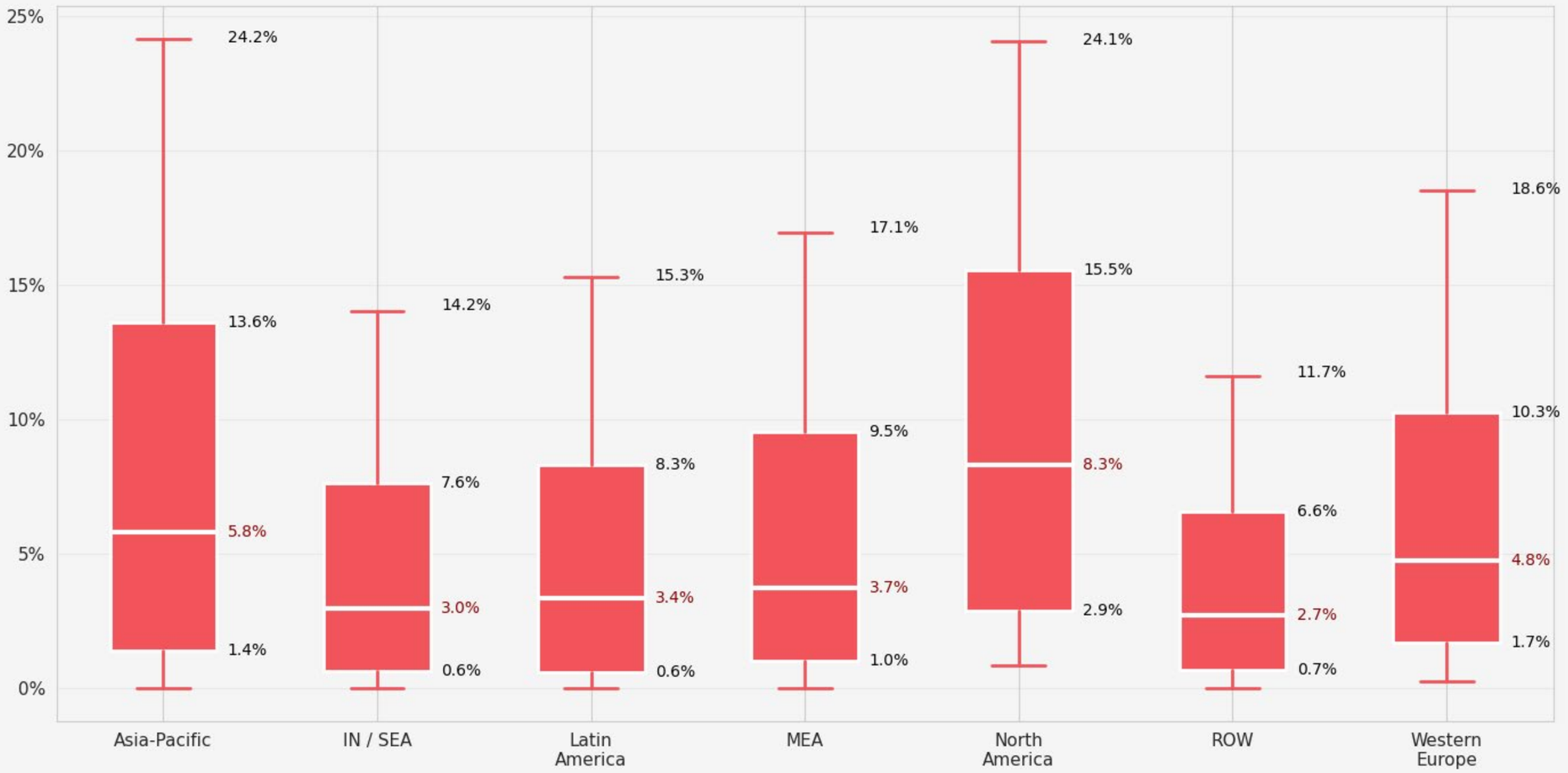
- North America leads nearly every revenue metric: median Y1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer is $24.89 in North America, vs. $22.53 in Asia-Pacific and $24.63 in Western Europe. D60 RPI reaches $0.59 in North America — materially ahead of other geographies (e.g. $0.41 Asia-Pacific, $0.36 Western Europe).
- Trial behavior varies more than top-line conversion: median trial start rate ranges from 3.2% in IN/SEA to 7.7% in North America. Trial-to-paid conversion ranges from 14.0% (IN/SEA) to 31.7% (North America). The relative gap between geographies is significant — more than 2x on conversion.
- Full-funnel conversion remains modest: median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.8% (IN/SEA) to 3.4% (North America). Most geographies cluster between ~1–2.5%. The interquartile spread is wide, suggesting execution — not just geography — drives outcomes.
- Revenue expansion continues post-install — but unevenly: in North America, median RPI grows from $0.44 at D14 to $0.59 at D60. Other geographies show smaller absolute gains (e.g. IN/SEA: $0.08 to $0.11). Long-term monetization power is concentrated in higher-income markets.
- High price tiers materially shift payer LTV: median Y1 LTV per payer increases from $11.34 (low price) to $51.58 (high price). Access type also matters: hard paywall apps show a $36.25 median vs. $24.79 for freemium. Price architecture meaningfully changes revenue ceilings.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

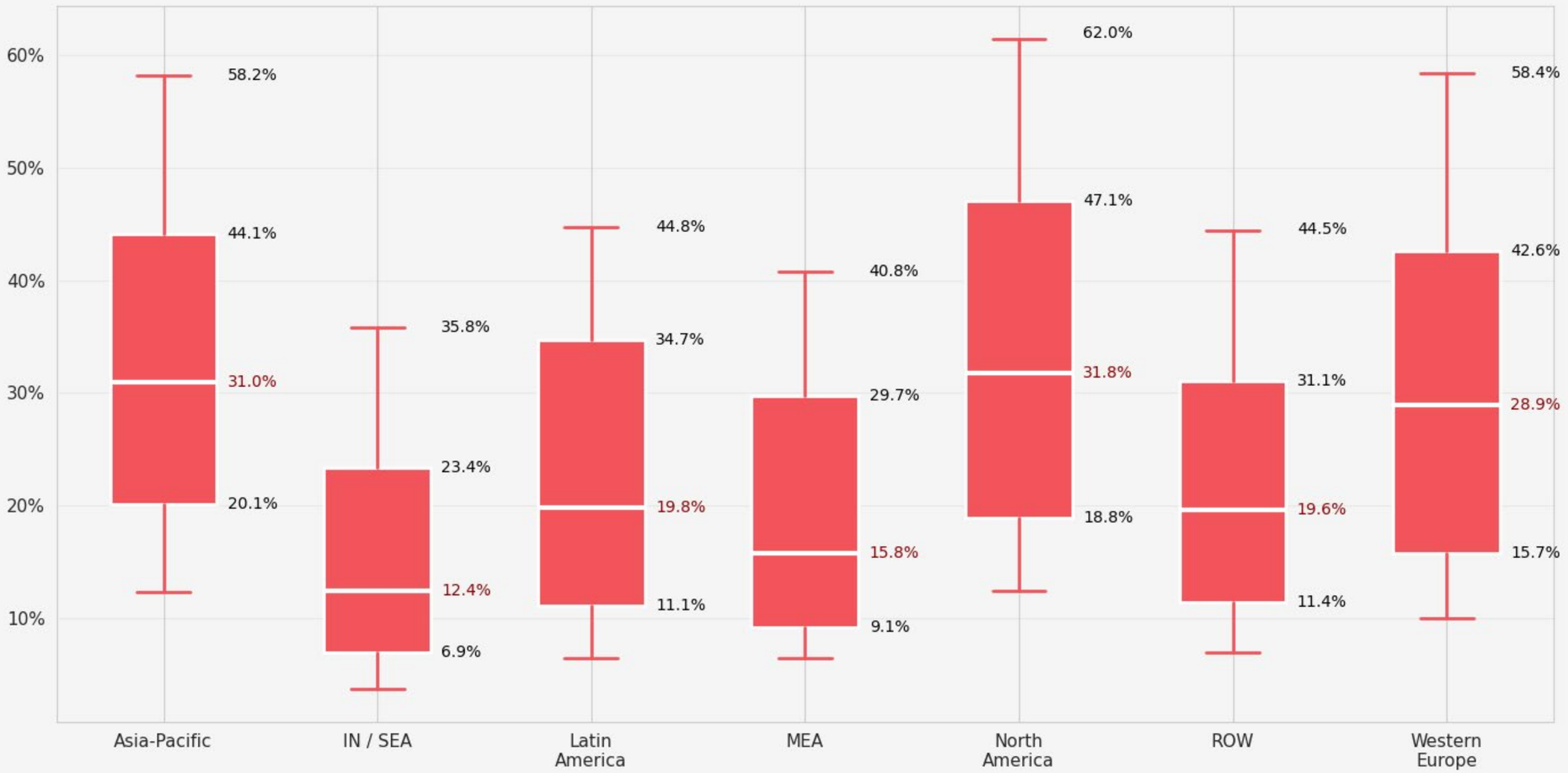


# Pricepoints per plan duration

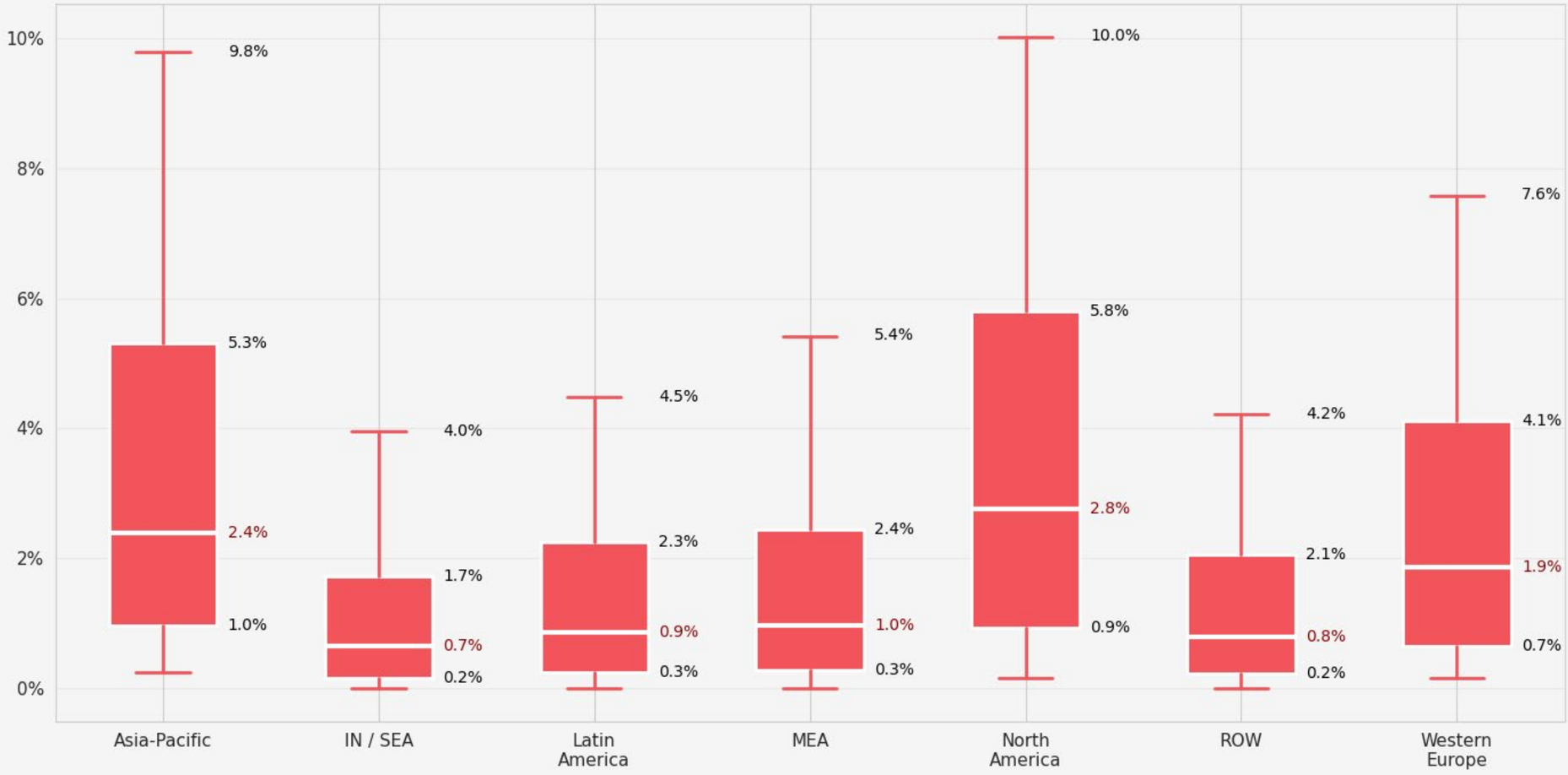
# Trial start rate, by geography



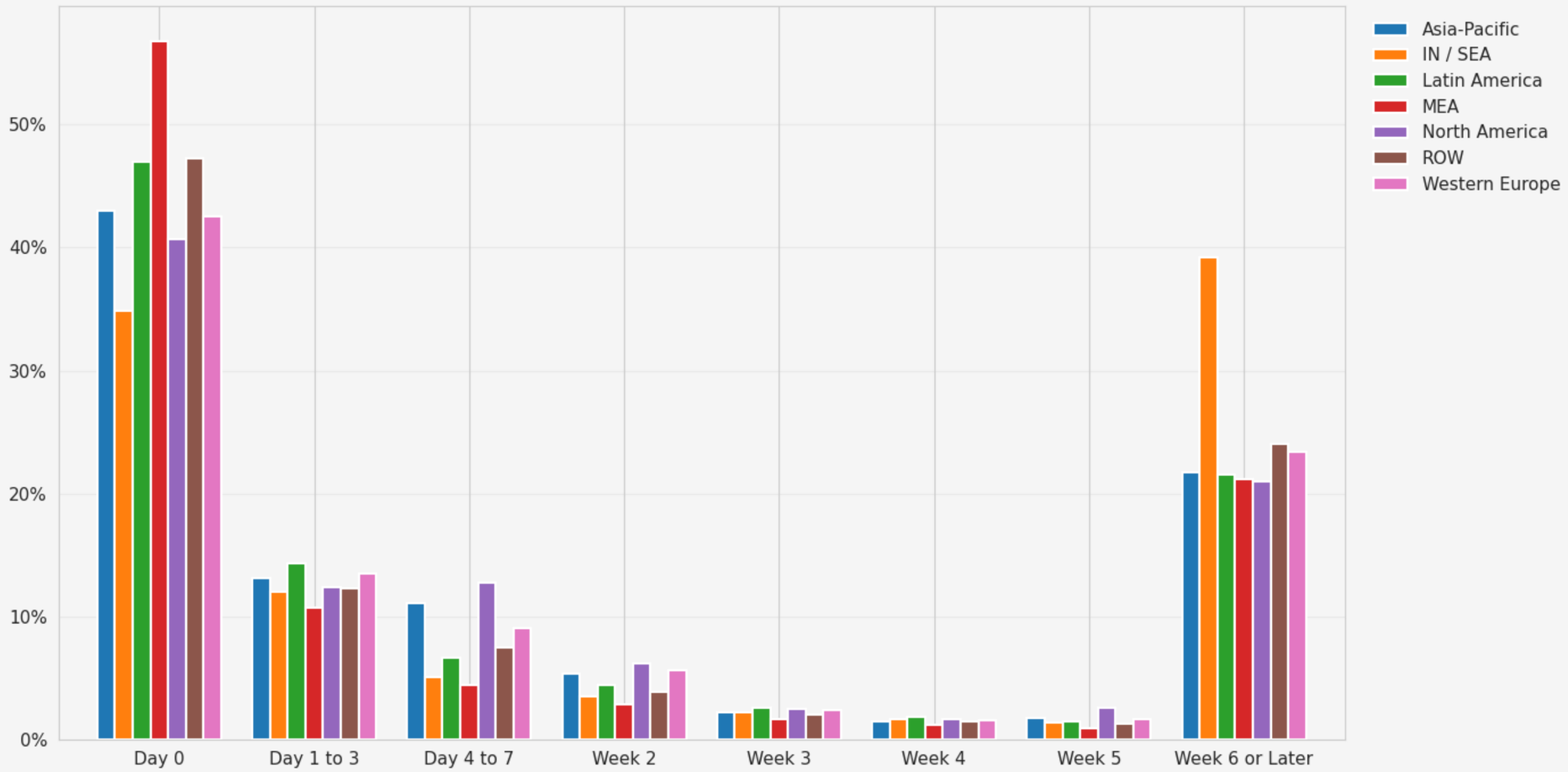
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



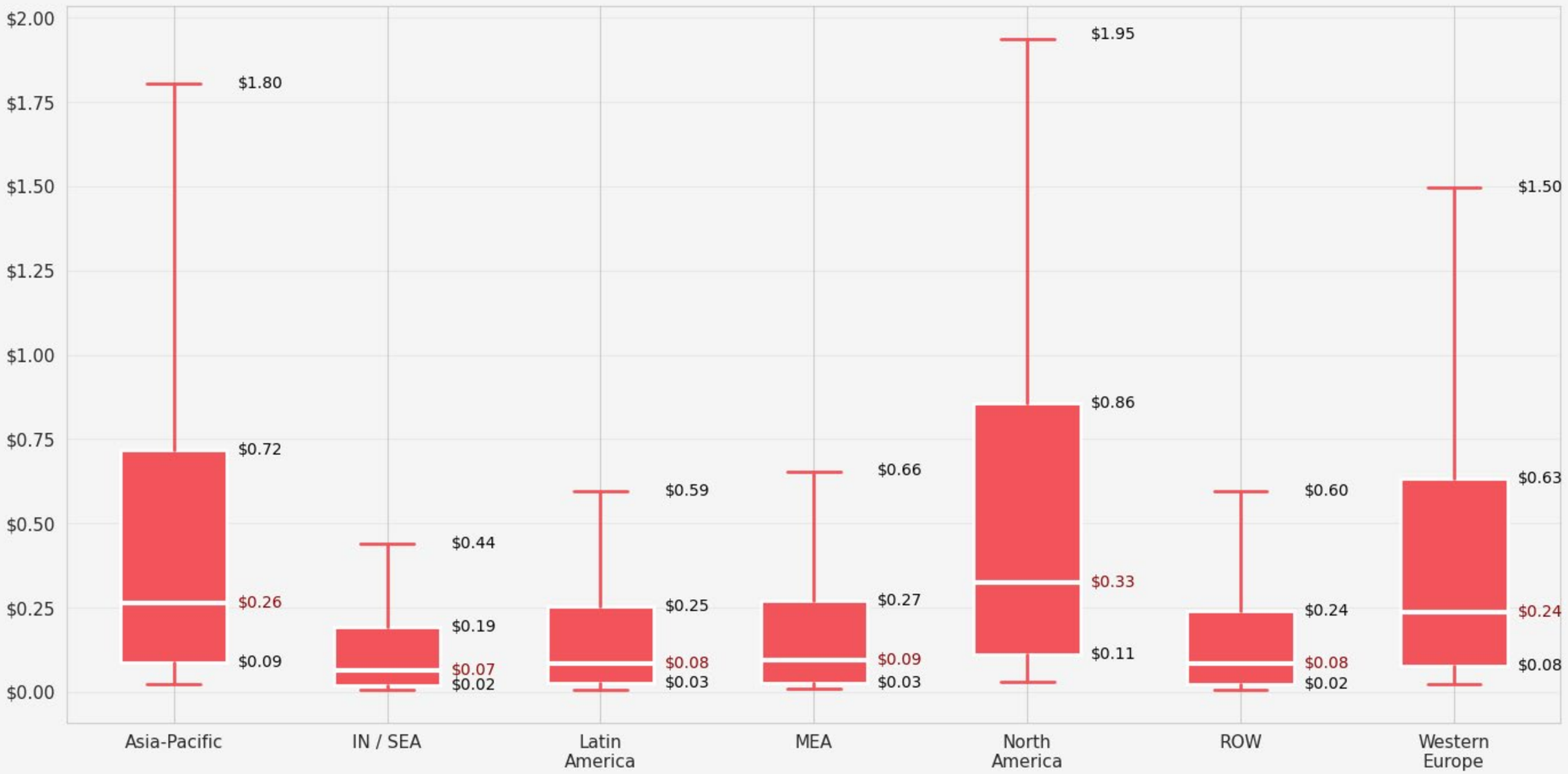
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



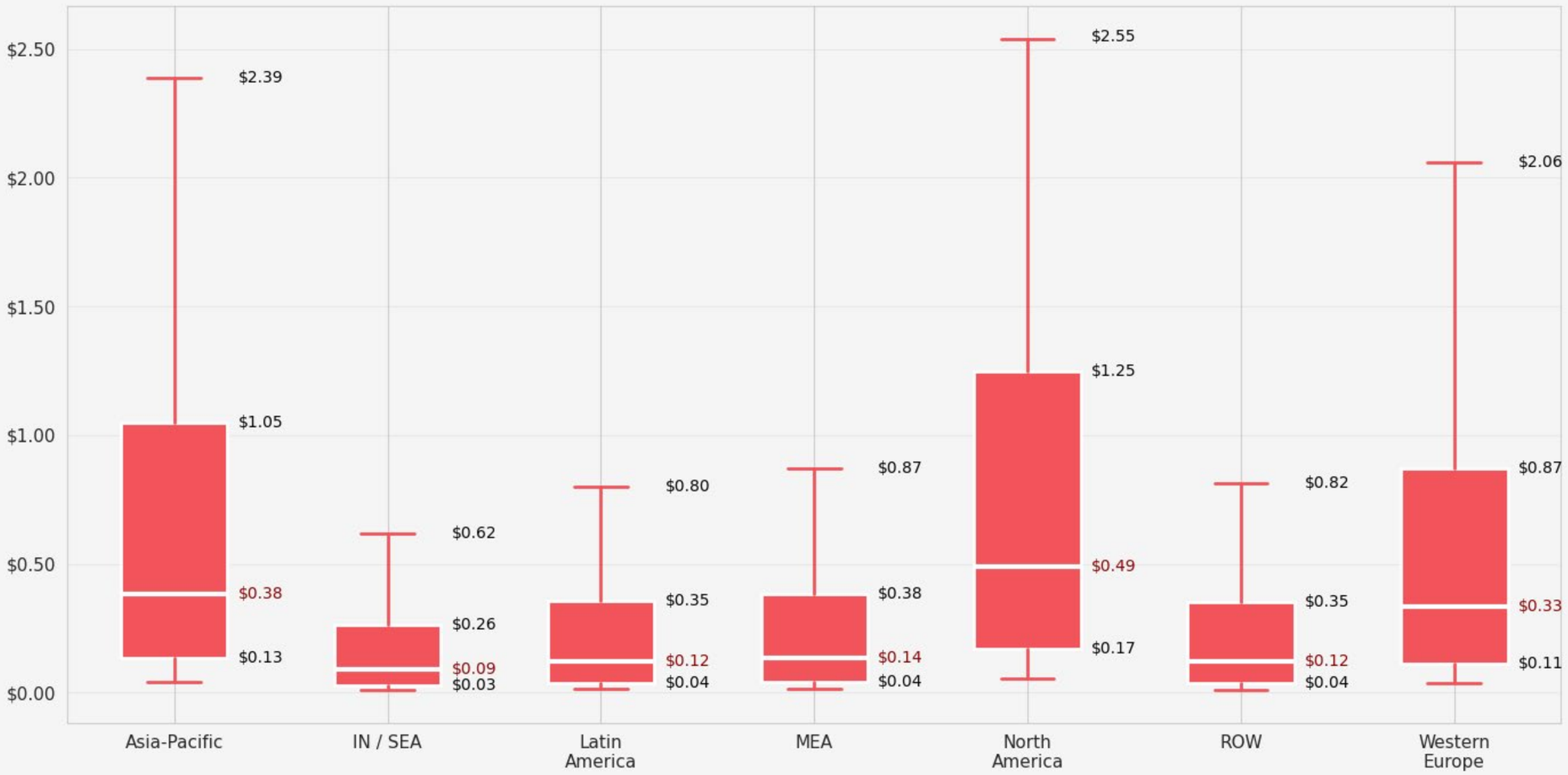
# Time-to-paid, by geography



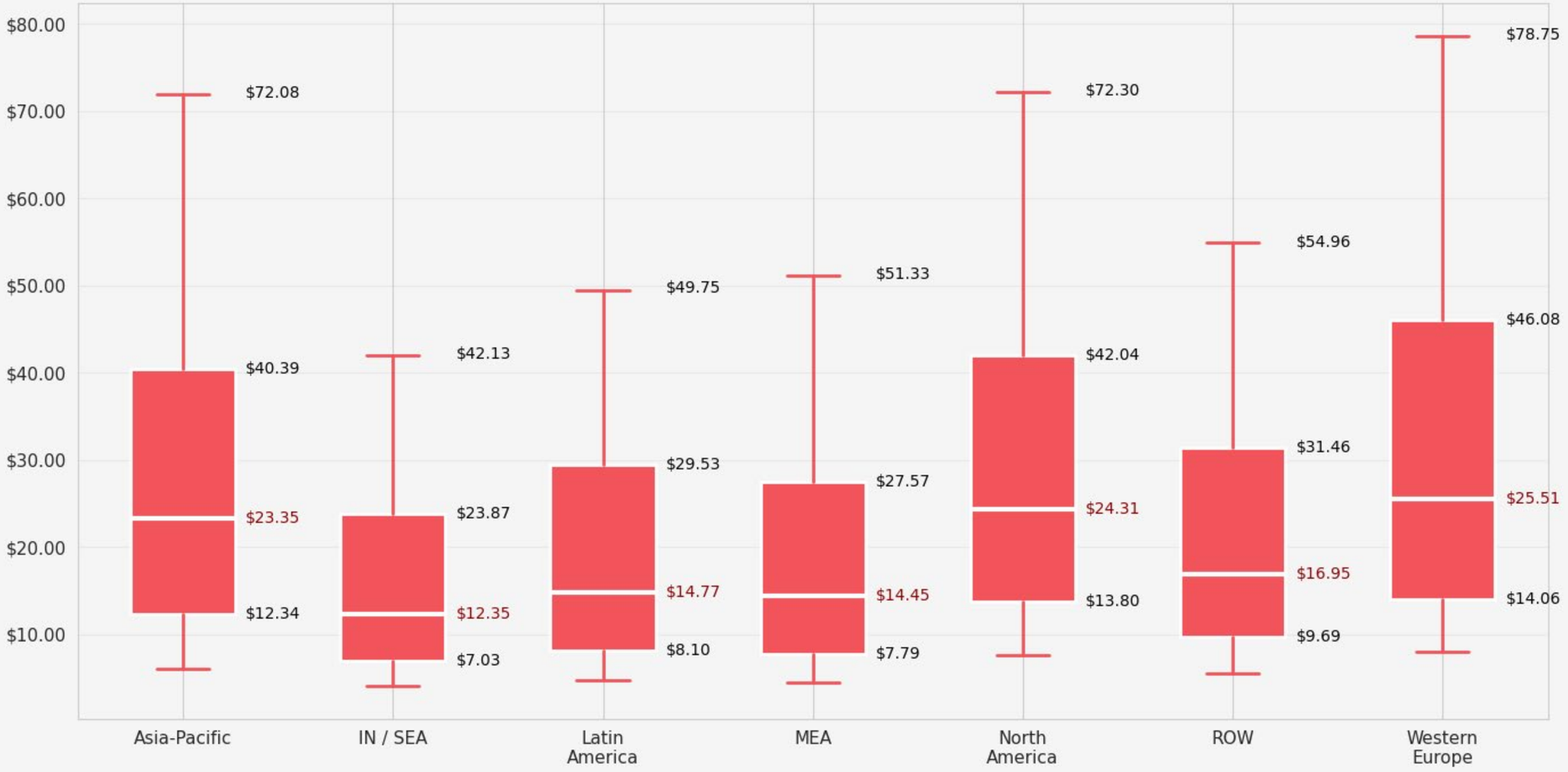
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



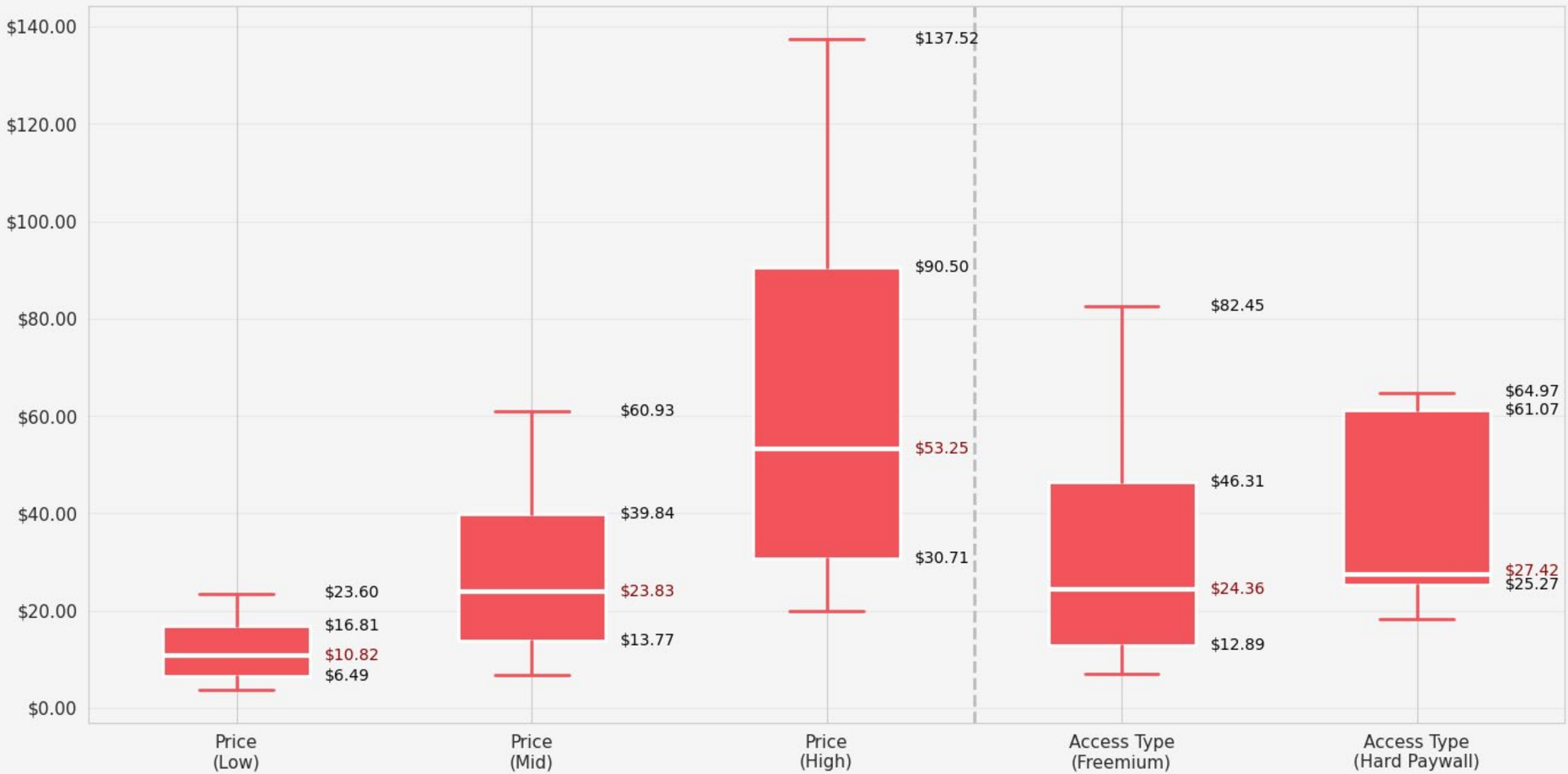
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



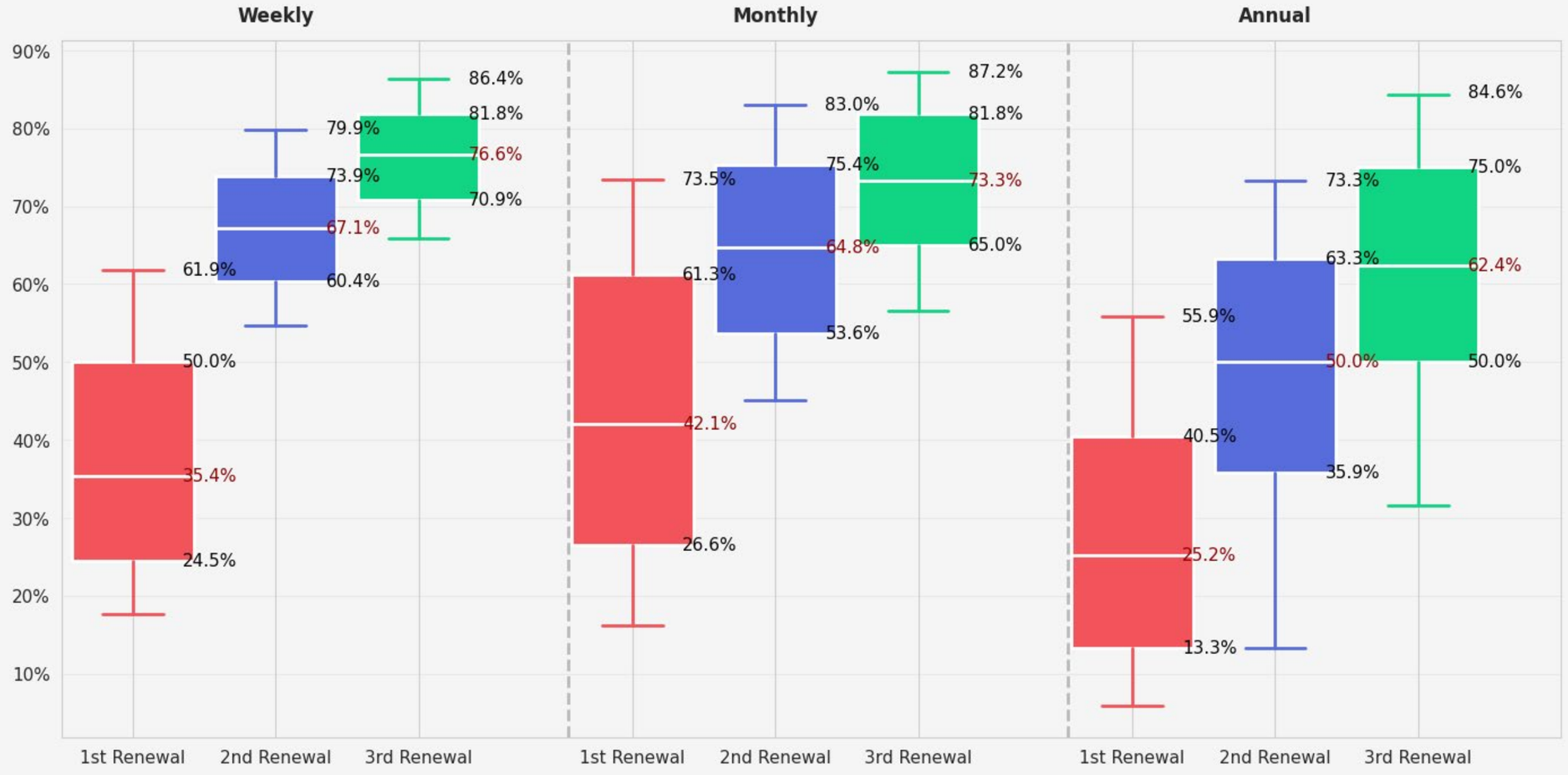
# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



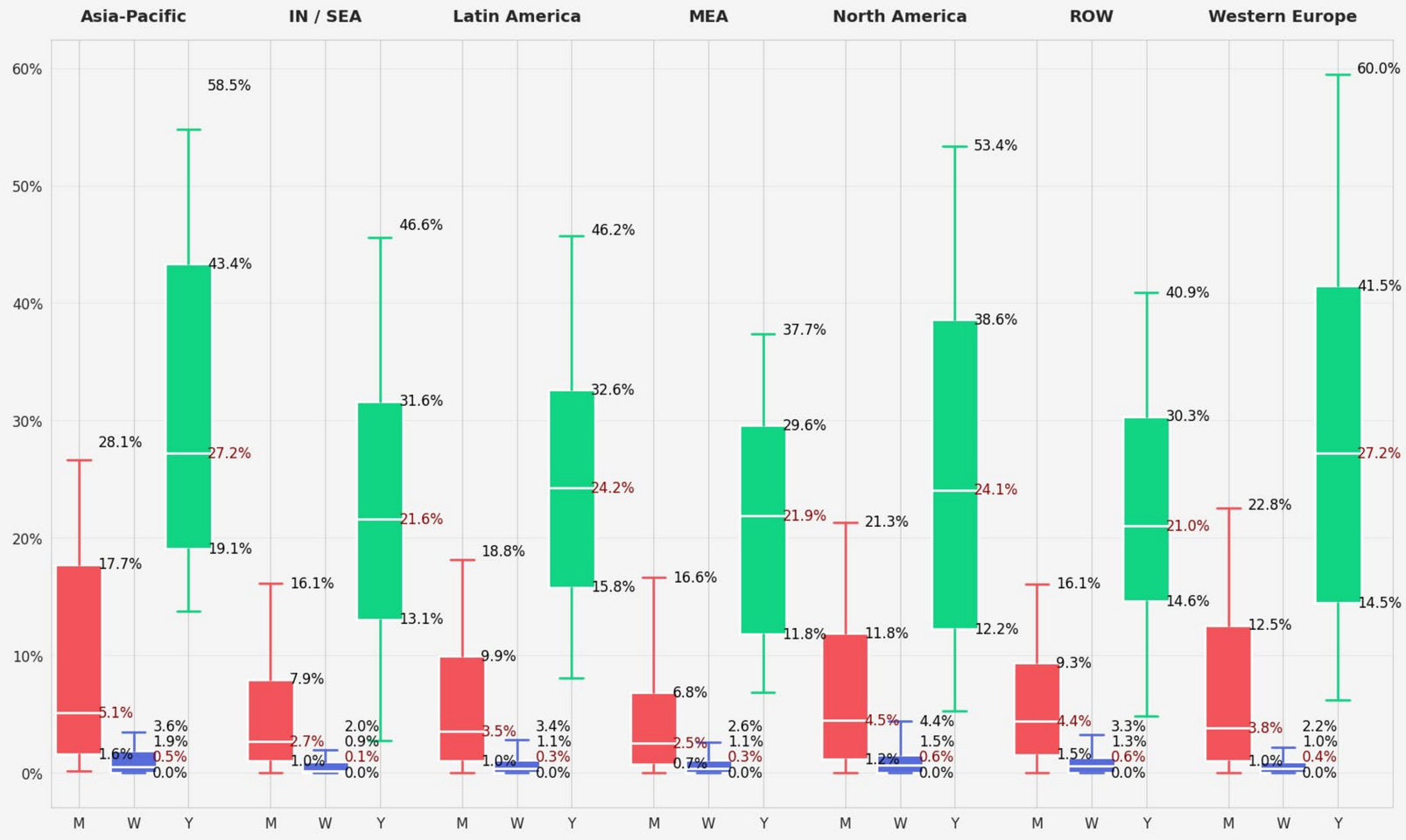
# First 3 weekly renewals



# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Travel

# Travel: key takeaways

Travel apps monetize earlier, and more unevenly, than most teams expect. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.9% in IN/SEA to 2.5% in North America. Trial-to-paid conversion is strong in several geographies (43.2% median in North America; 42.3% in Western Europe), but trial start rates remain modest (roughly 2.1–4.1% median across geographies).

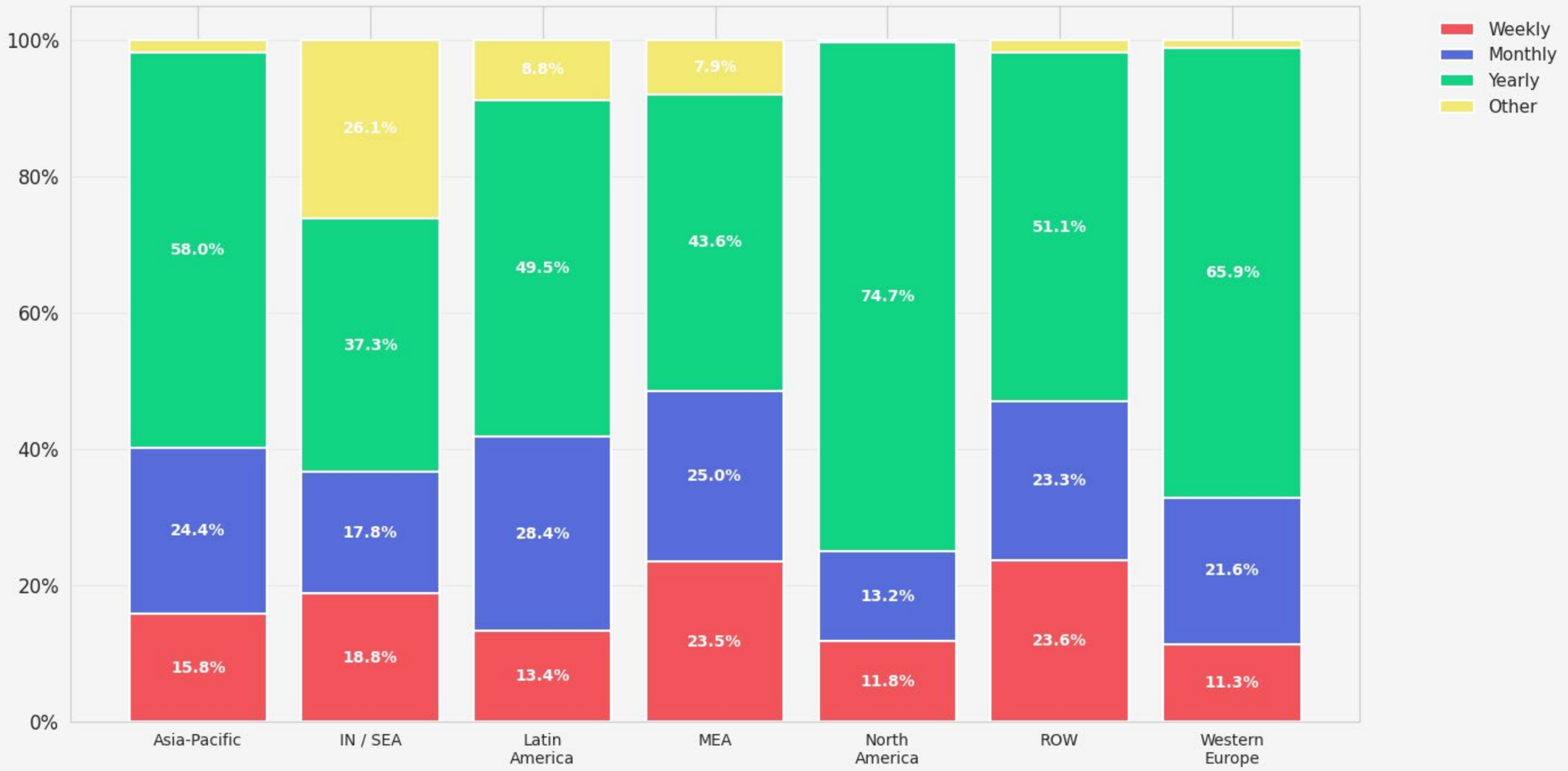
Revenue per install (RPI) expands meaningfully post-install. Median RPI grows from roughly $0.20–$0.38 at D14 (depending on geography) to $0.18–$0.50 at D60, with North America reaching $0.50.

Annual plans dominate subscription mix globally — exceeding 50% share in most geographies and reaching 74.7% in North America. Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer clusters between $11.50 (MEA median) and $20.09 (Western Europe median), with North America at $18.22.

## What stands out

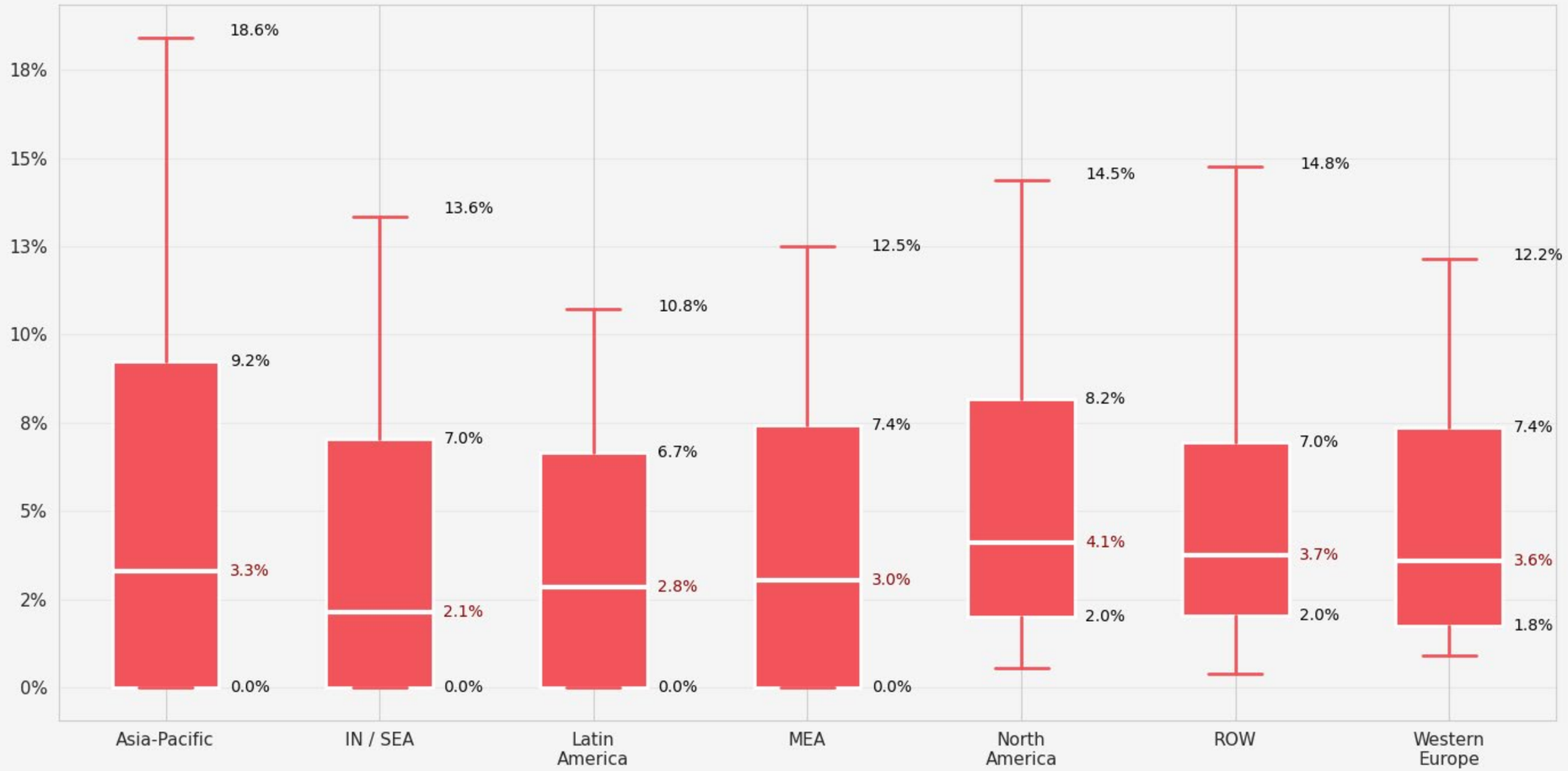
- North America leads on both conversion and monetization depth: median D35 conversion reaches 2.5%, highest across geographies. D60 RPI hits $0.50, and median Y1 lifetime value (LTV) per payer is $18.22 — near the top of the global range.
- Western Europe monetizes high-value payers: Western Europe shows the highest median Y1 LTV per payer at $20.09, alongside 42.3% median trial-to-paid conversion and 4.5% upper-range D35 conversion..
- IN/SEA lags on payer conversion despite meaningful annual mix: median D35 conversion is 0.9%, the lowest among geographies. Trial-to-paid median sits at 21.5%, roughly half North America's 43.2%, despite 37.3% of subscriptions being annual.
- High pricepoints materially lift payer LTV: median Y1 LTV per payer rises from $13.81 (low price) to $33.82 (high price). The upper range for high-priced plans extends to $63.63, indicating meaningful ceiling expansion at premium tiers.
- Conversion is heavily front-loaded: day 0 accounts for the largest share of paid conversions in every geography (roughly 38–62% depending on geography). Week 6+ conversions represent a secondary spike, particularly in Western Europe and North America.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

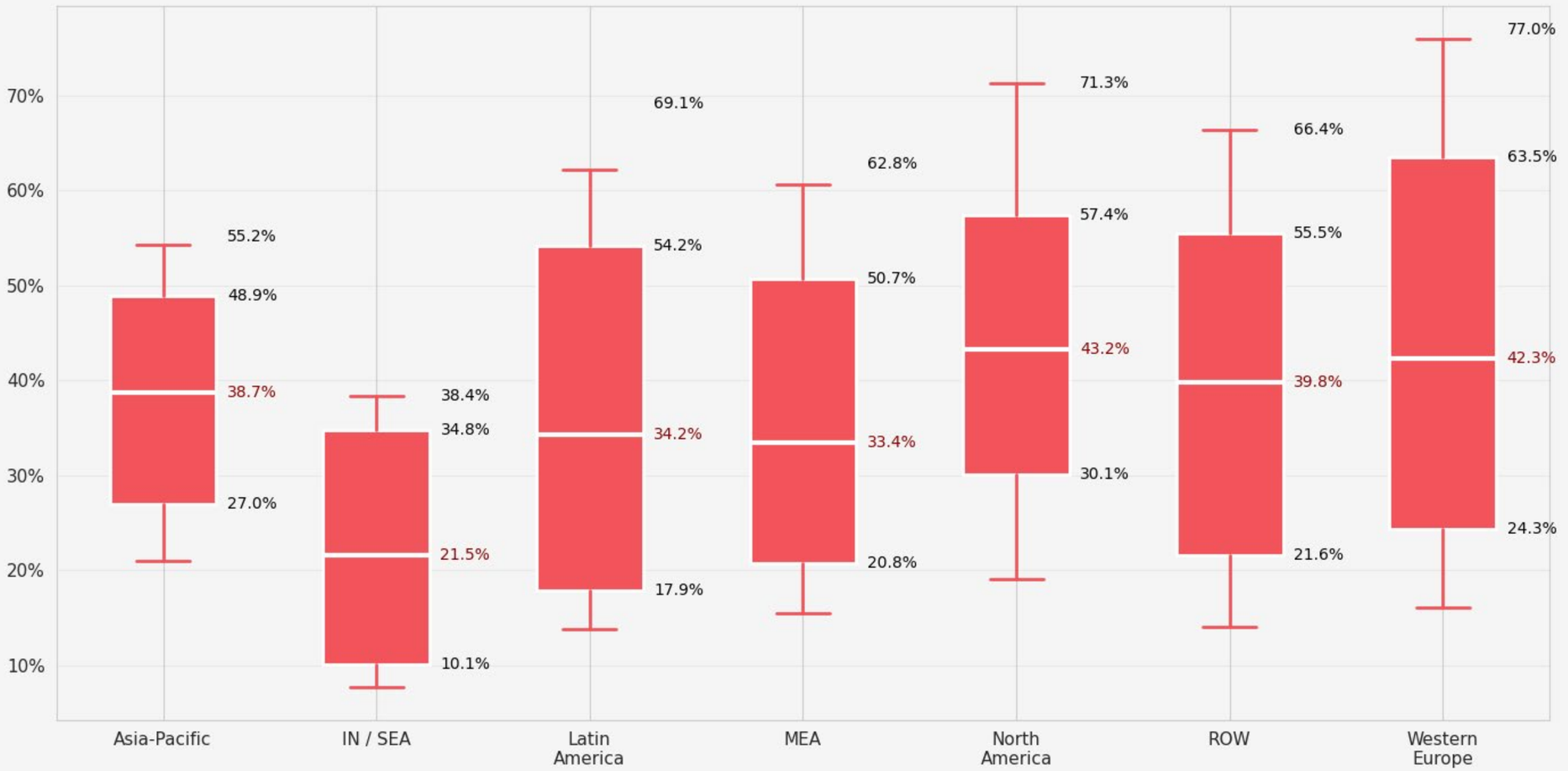


# Pricepoints per plan duration

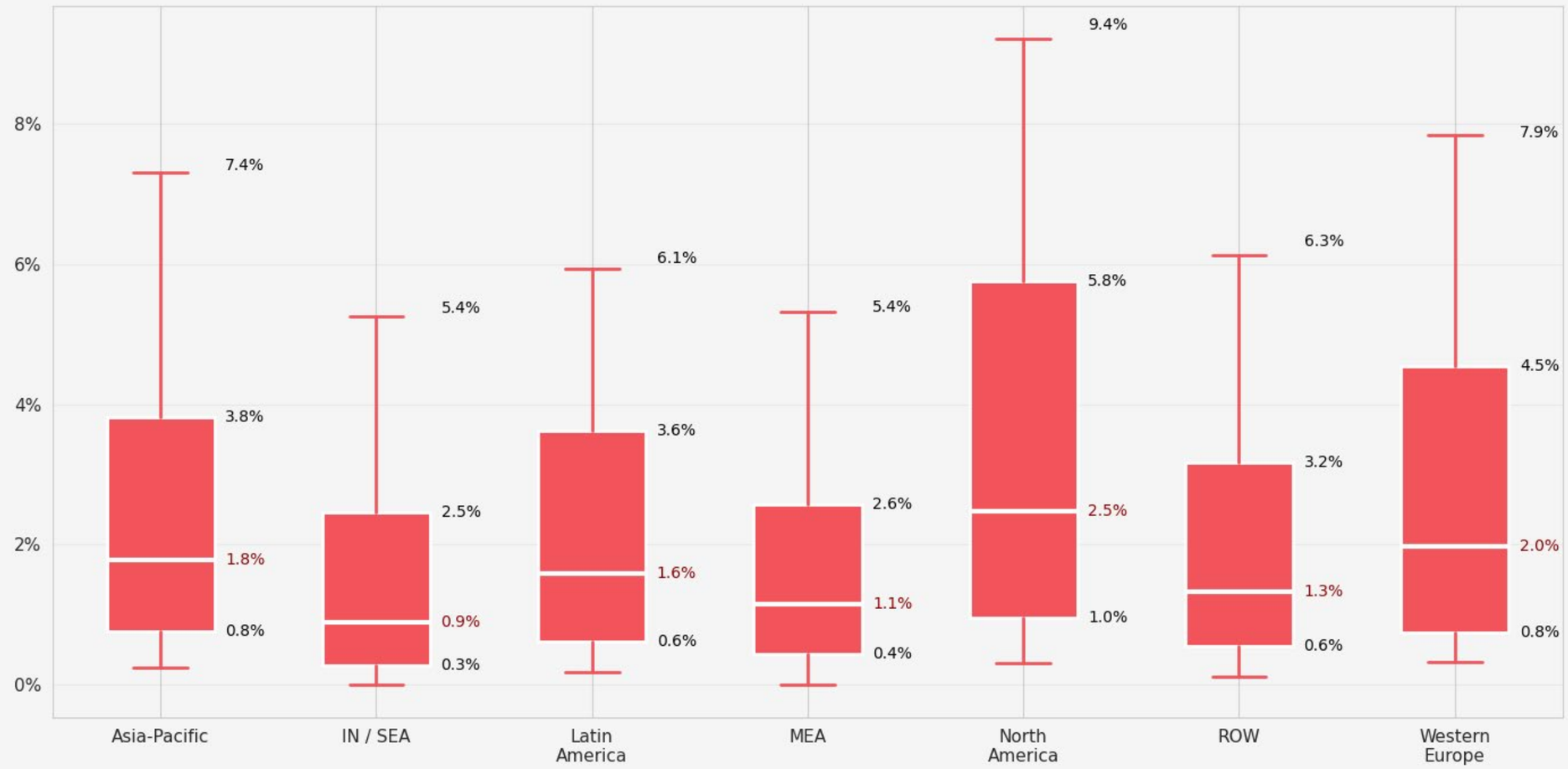
# Trial start rate, by geography



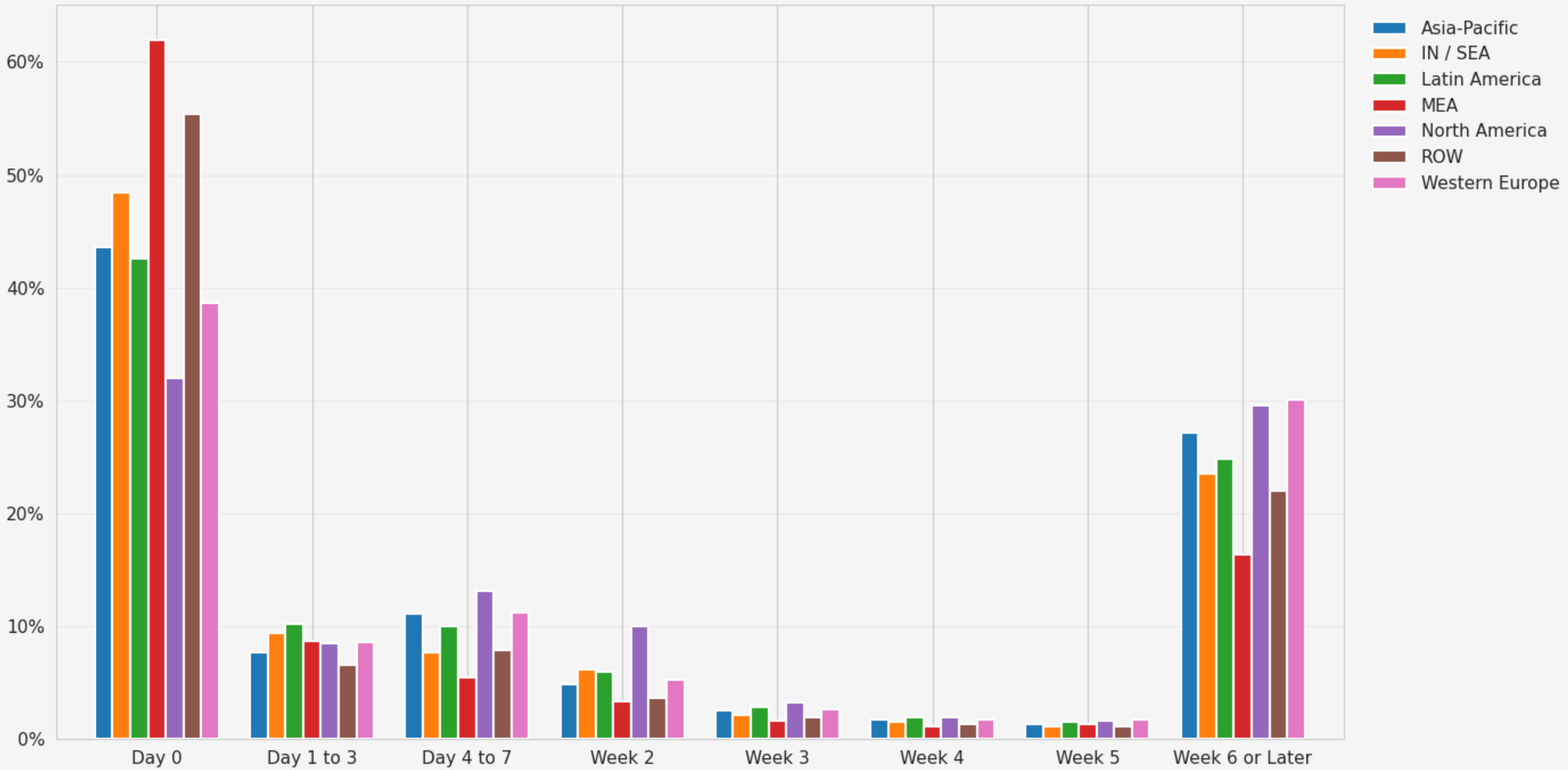
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



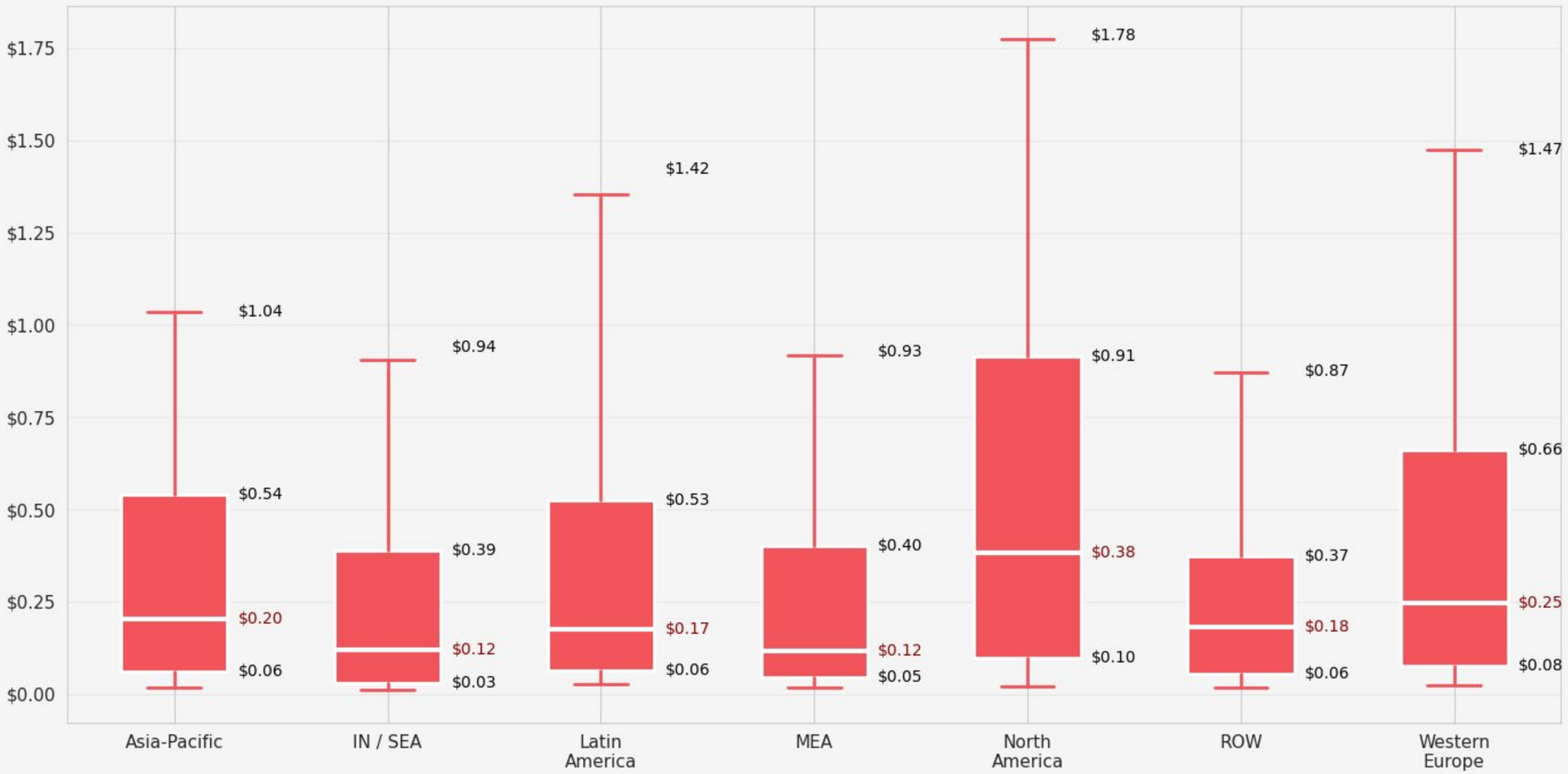
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



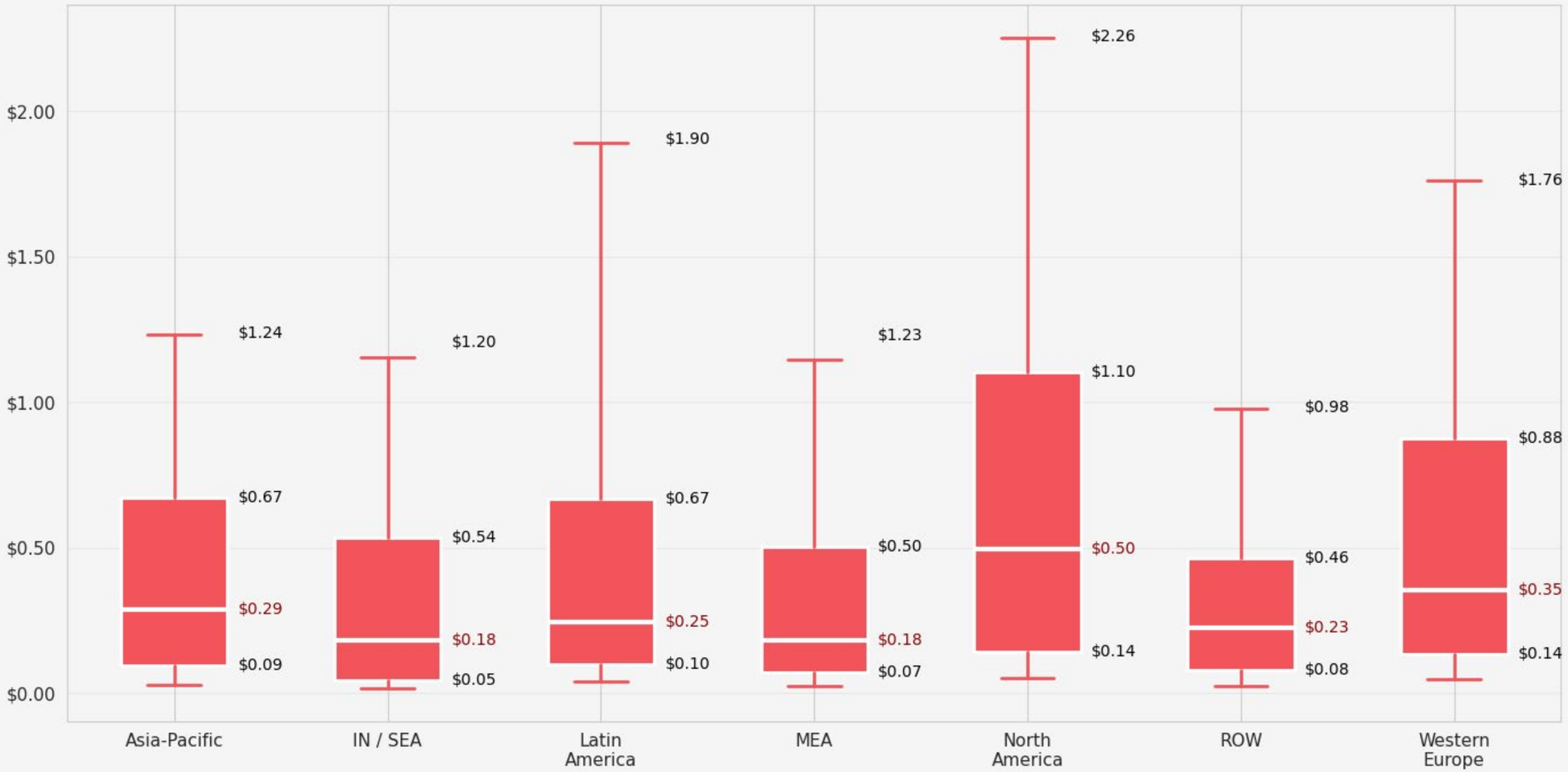
# Time-to-paid, by geography



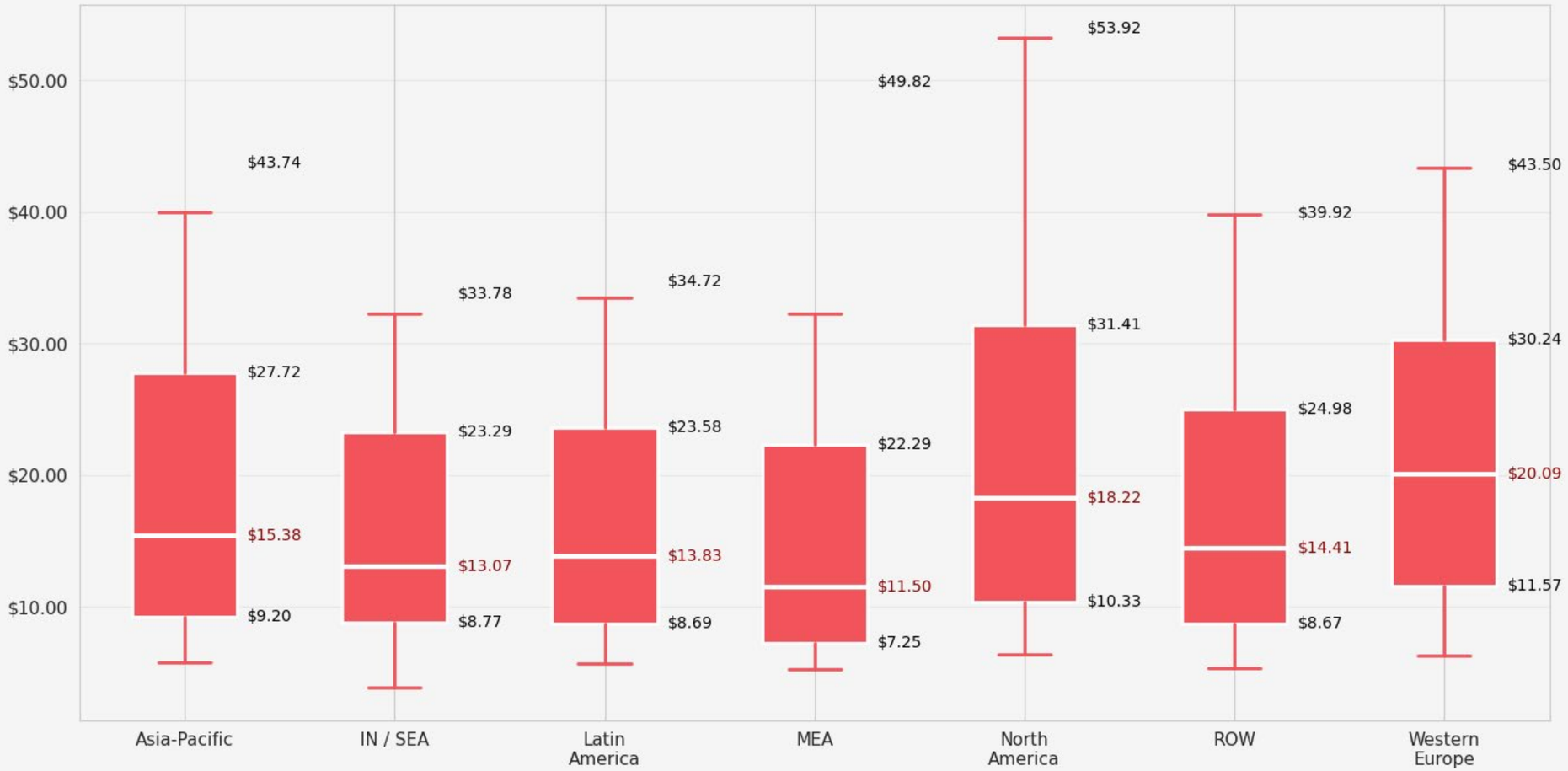
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography

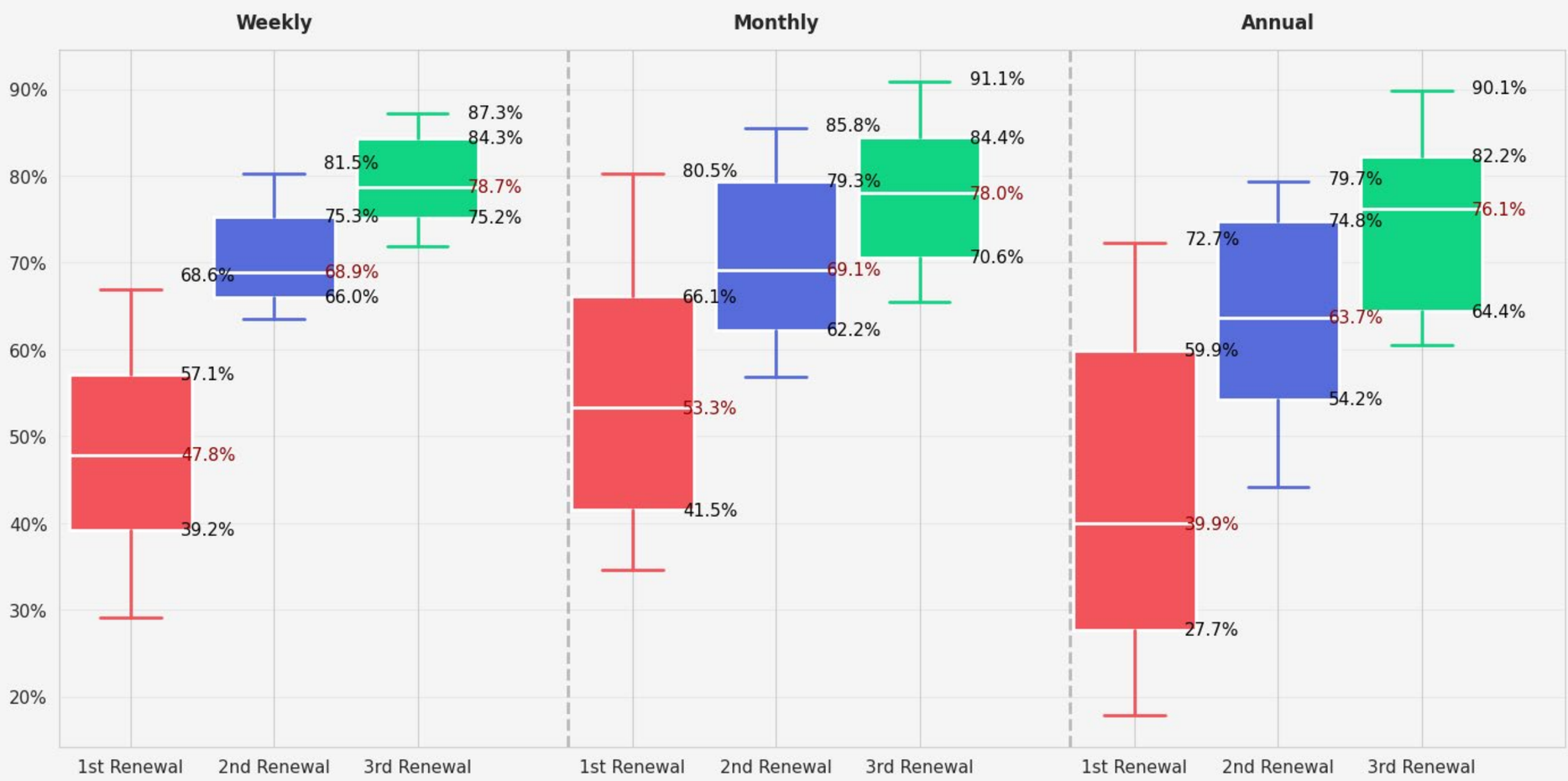


# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint

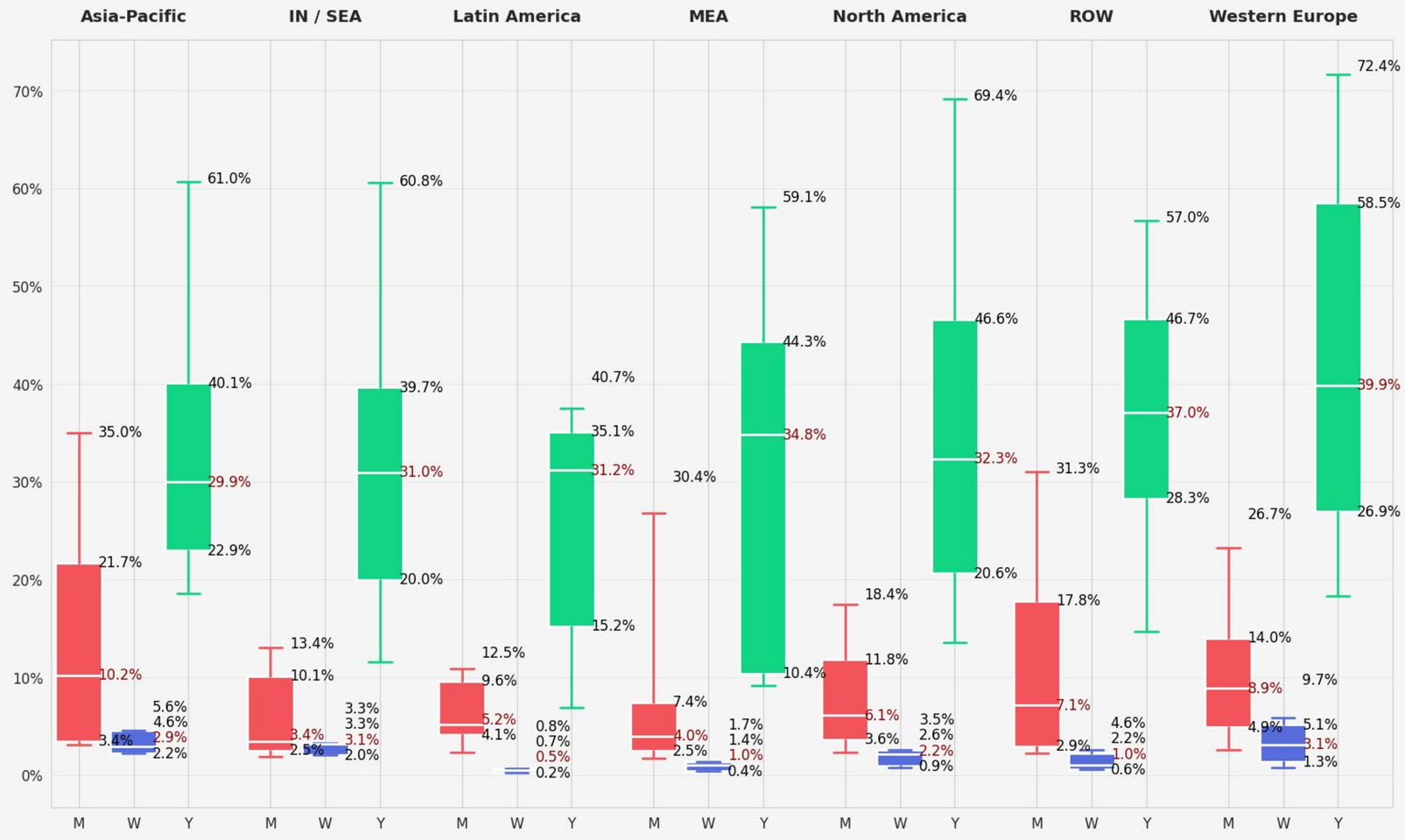


# First 3 weekly renewals

# First 3 annual renewals



# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# Utilities

# Utilities: key takeaways

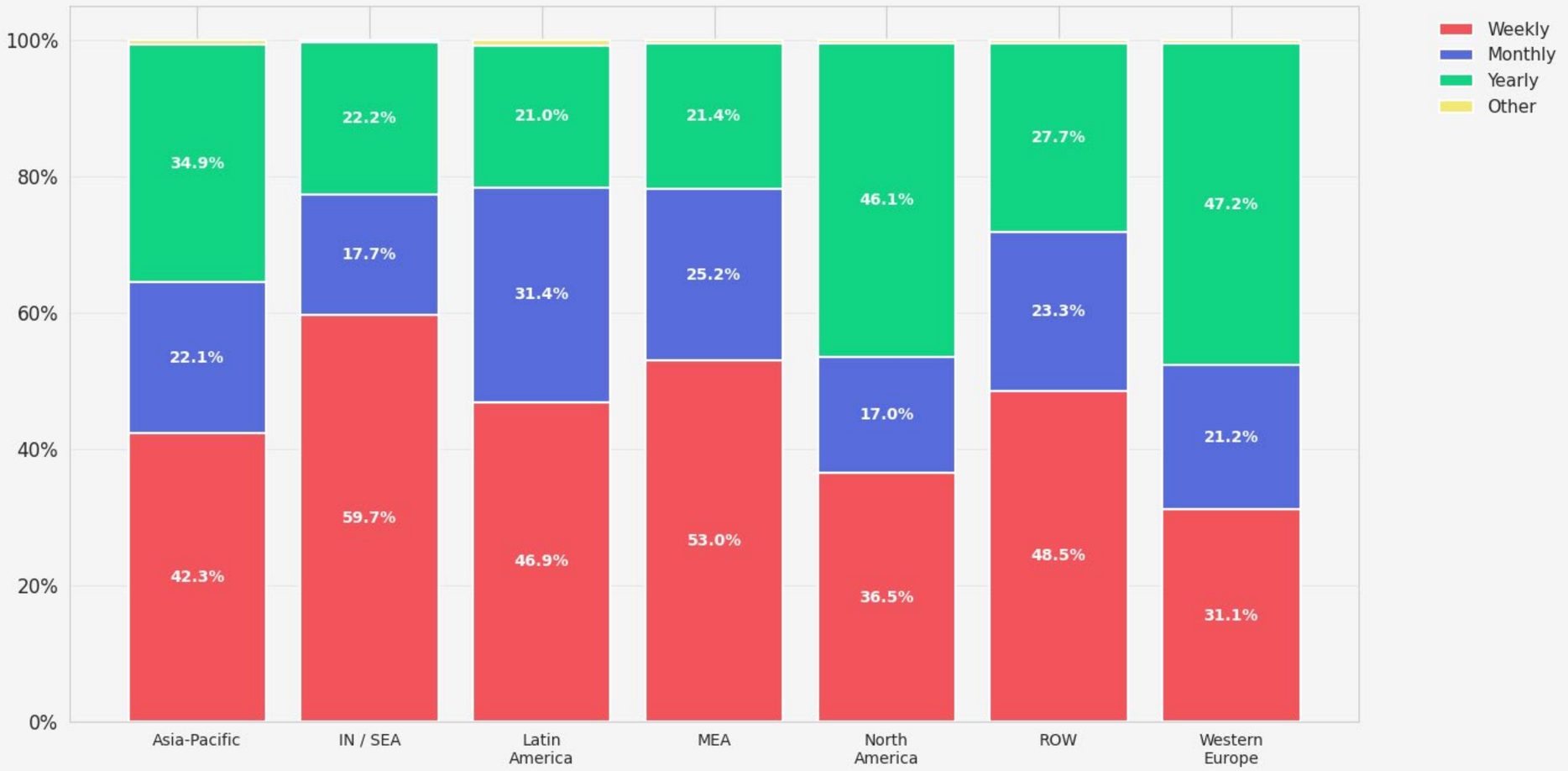
Utilities apps sit in the middle of the subscription spectrum: modest conversion, meaningful geographical dispersion, and clear pricing leverage at the top end. Median D35 download-to-paid conversion ranges from 0.7% (IN/SEA) to 2.7% (North America), with most geographies clustering around 1.0–1.6%. Revenue per install (RPI) expands materially post-install — for example, North America grows from a $0.31 median at D14 to $0.46 at D60.

Plan mix is geographically polarized: weekly plans dominate across Asia-Pacific (42.3%), IN/SEA (59.7%), Latin America (46.9%), MEA (53.0%), and ROW (48.5%), while annual plans lead in North America (46.1%) and Western Europe (47.2%). Median Y1 realized lifetime value (RLTV) per payer ranges from $13.31 (IN/SEA) to $22.87 (Western Europe), with meaningful upside in the upper quartile (not fully shown across all charts).

## What stands out

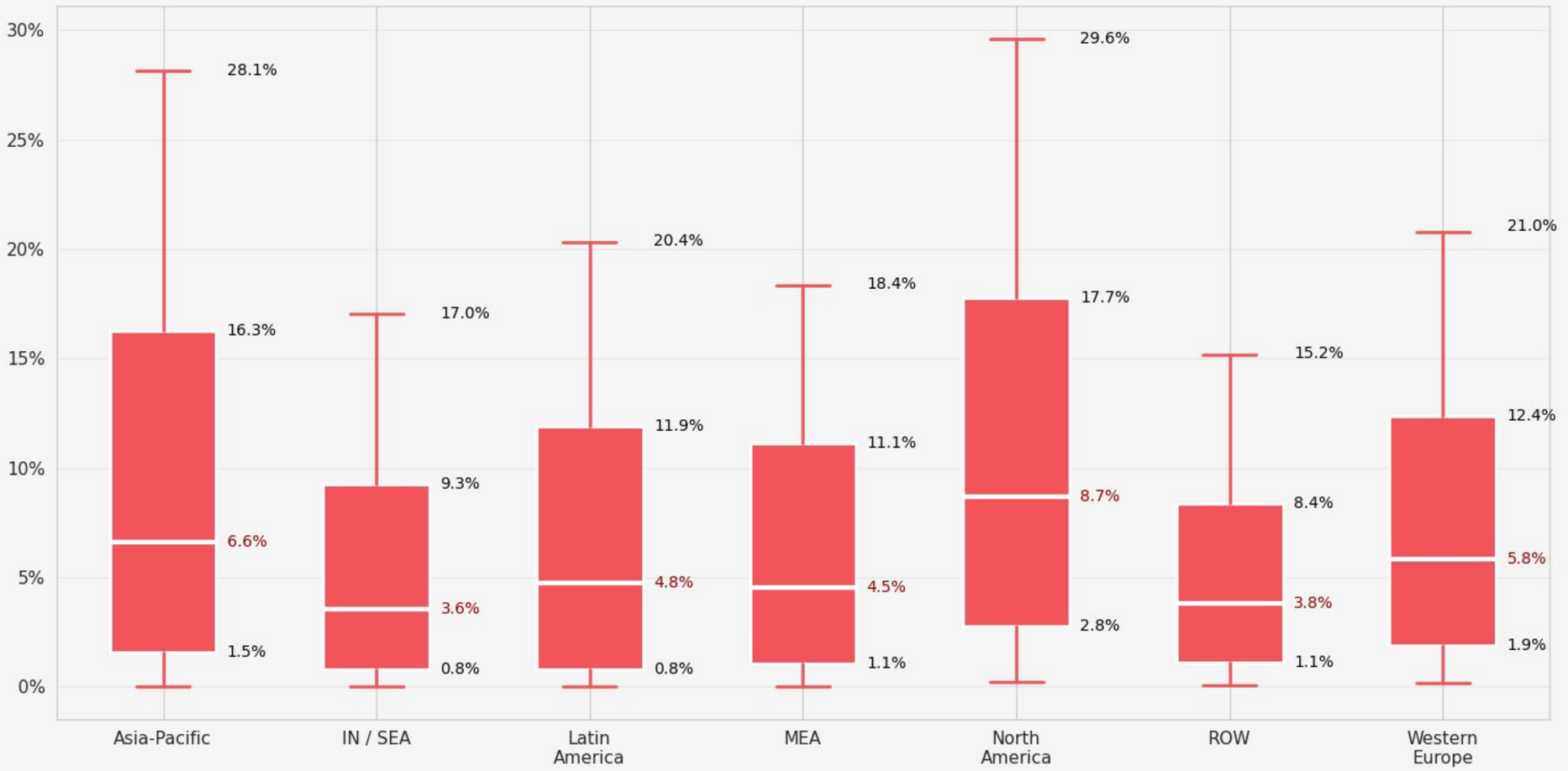
- Conversion is geographically uneven, but front-loaded everywhere: North America posts the highest median D35 conversion (2.7%), while IN/SEA trails at 0.7%. Across geographies, a large share of conversions happen on Day 0 (e.g. ~38–64% depending on geography), reinforcing how much monetization depends on immediate intent.
- Trial behavior varies more than trial conversion: Median trial start rates range from 3.6% (IN/SEA) to 8.7% (North America). Trial-to-paid medians are tighter but still dispersed — 14.8% (IN/SEA) vs. 32.6% (North America). The constraint in lower-monetizing geographies appears to be trial uptake, not just paywall efficiency.
- Post-install revenue expansion is consistent: every geography shows RPI growth from D14 to D60. North America increases from $0.31 to $0.46; Western Europe from $0.20 to $0.29; Asia-Pacific from $0.21 to $0.32. Utilities monetization compounds after the initial decision window.
- Price tiering drives disproportionate lifetime value (LTV): median Y1 LTV per payer rises from $10.21 (low price) to $50.81 (high price). Access method matters as well: hard paywalls show a $36.48 median vs. $21.51 for freemium. Monetization ceiling is largely defined by pricing architecture.
- Retention strengthens after the 1st renewal: weekly median renewal improves from 48.5% (first) to 78.6% (second) to 84.9% (third). Monthly follows a similar pattern (57.2% → 69.8% → 82.0%). Early churn is meaningful, but surviving subscribers stabilize quickly.

# Share of subscriptions sold, by geography

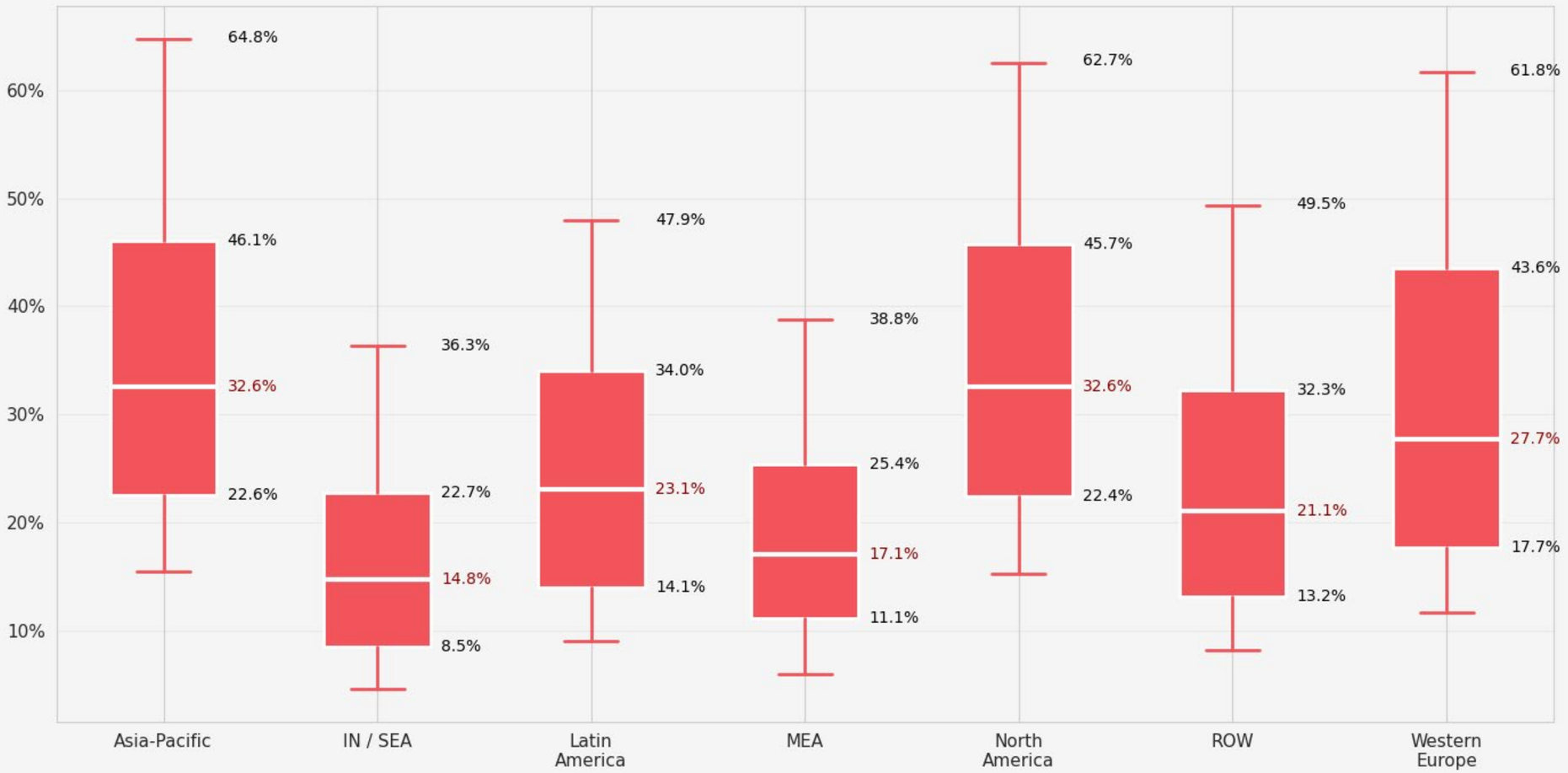


# Pricepoints per plan duration

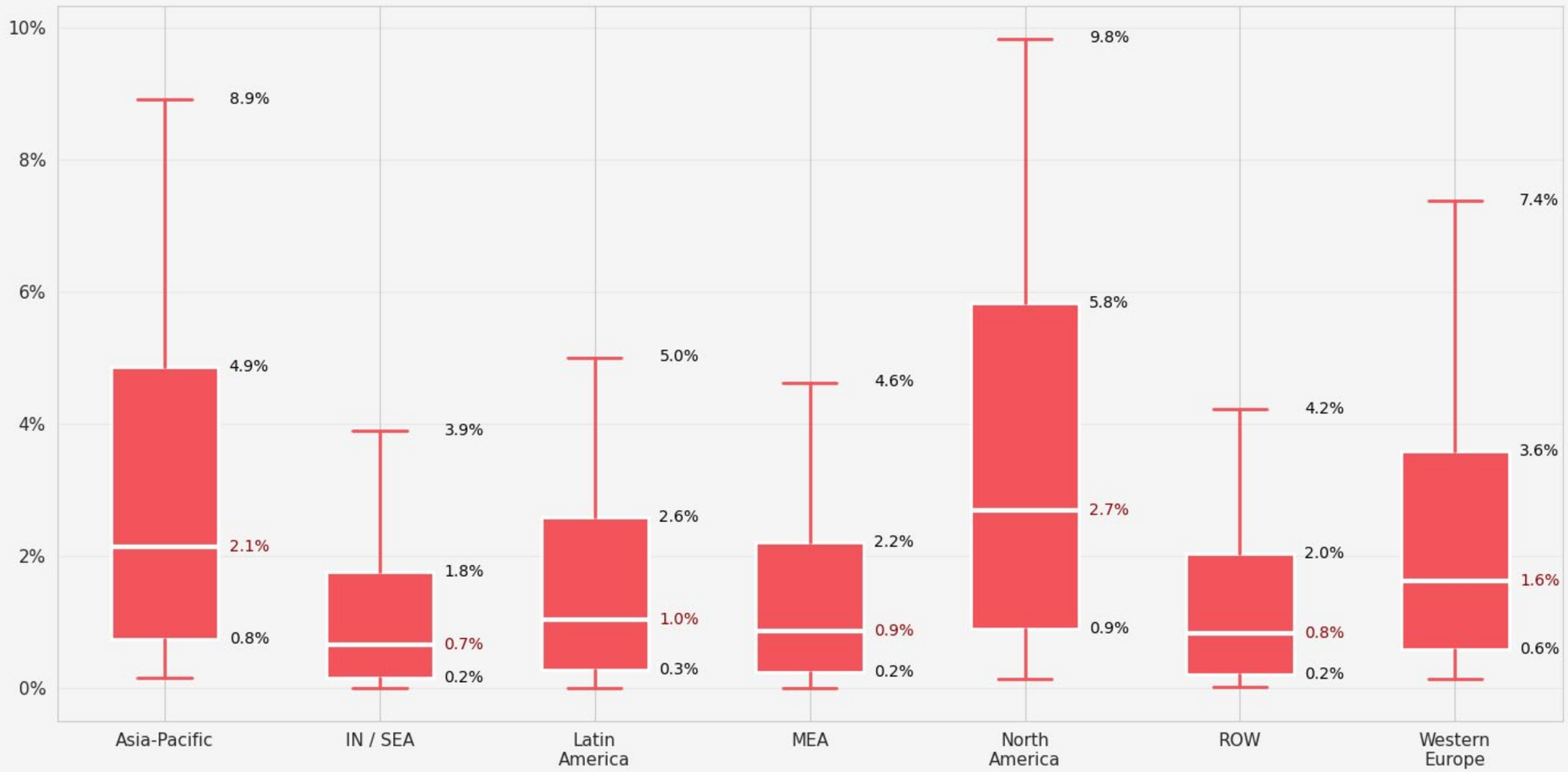
# Trial start rate, by geography



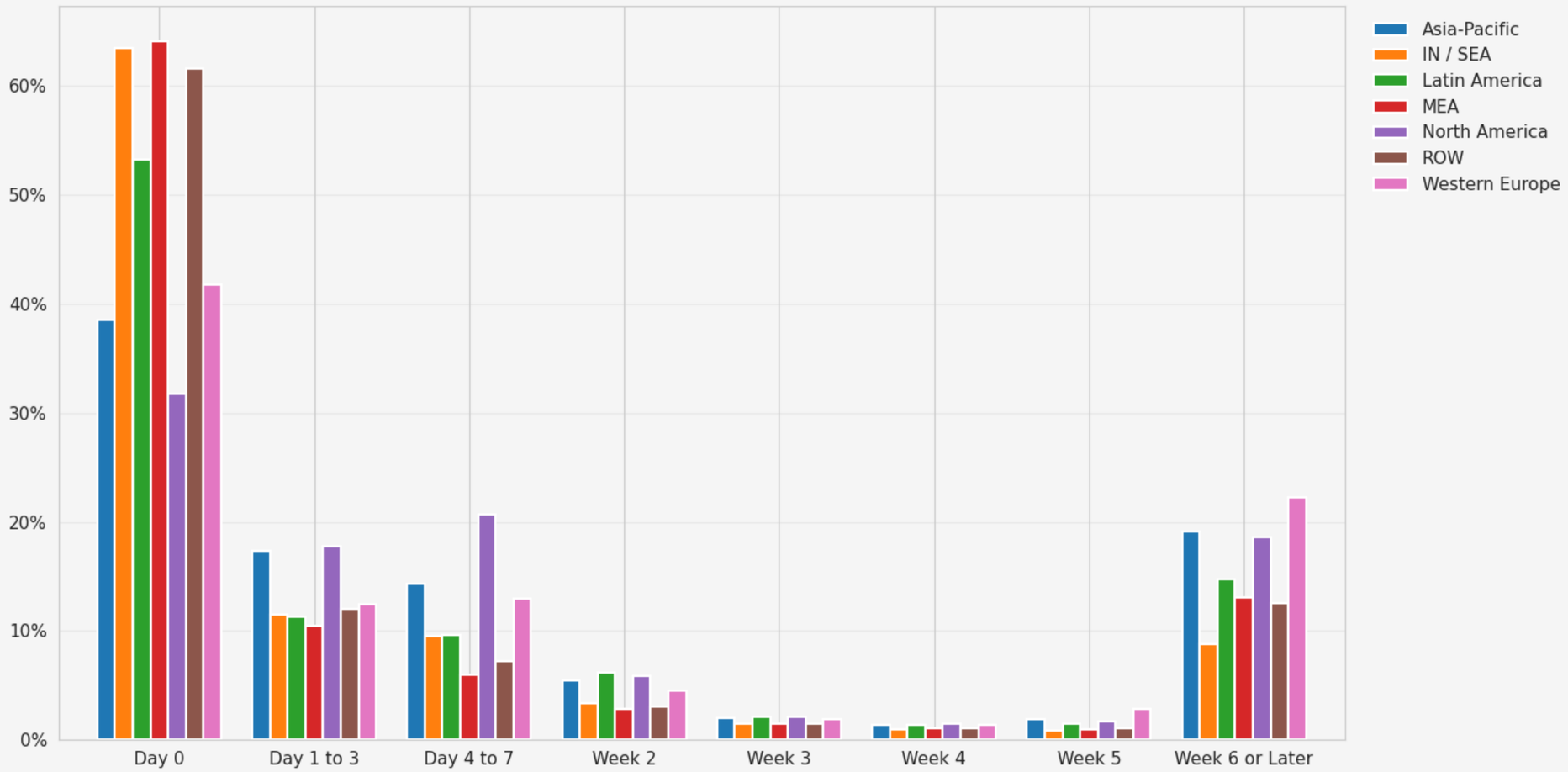
# Trial-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



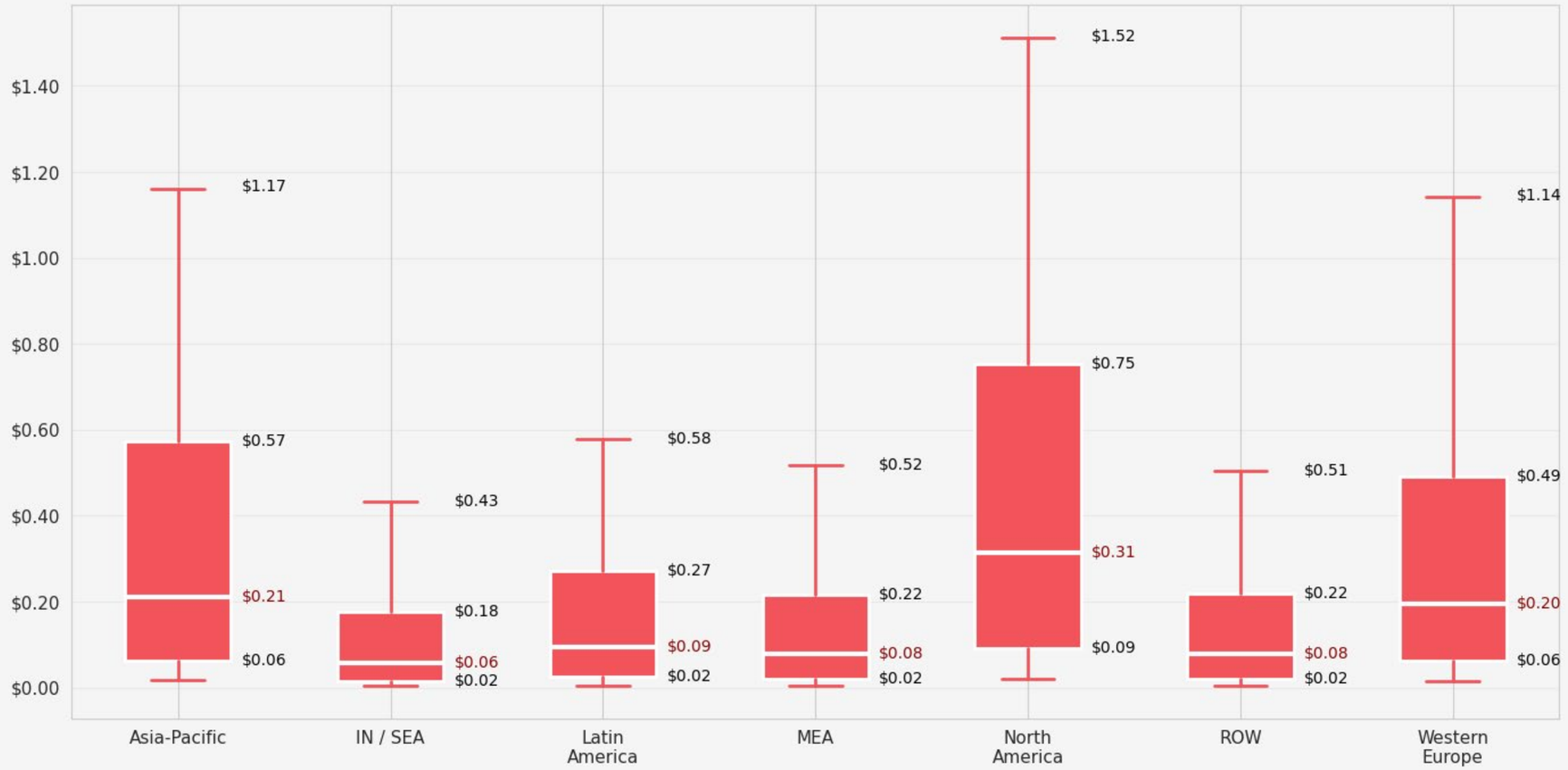
# Day 35 download-to-paid conversion rate, by geography



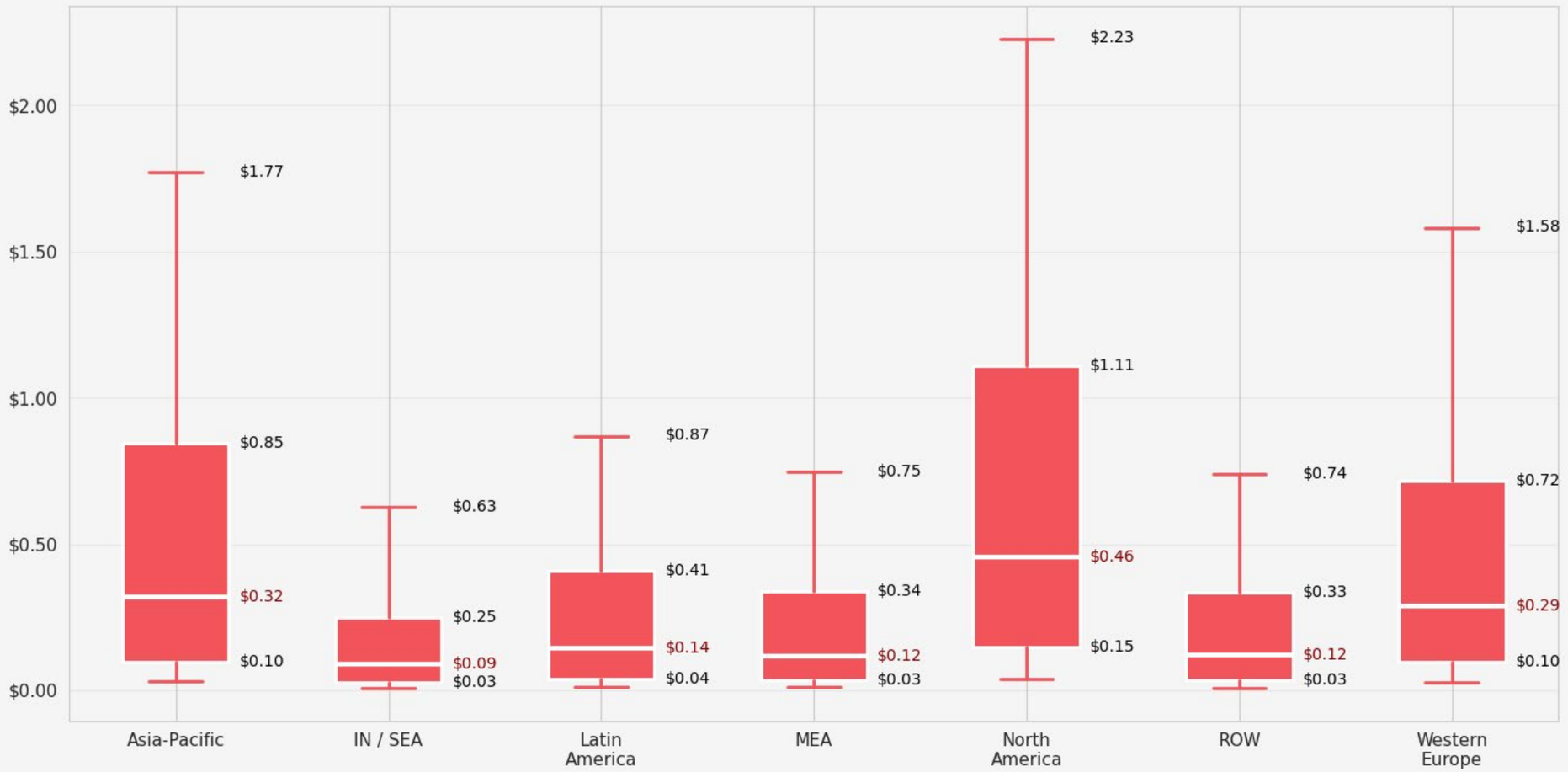
# Time-to-paid, by geography



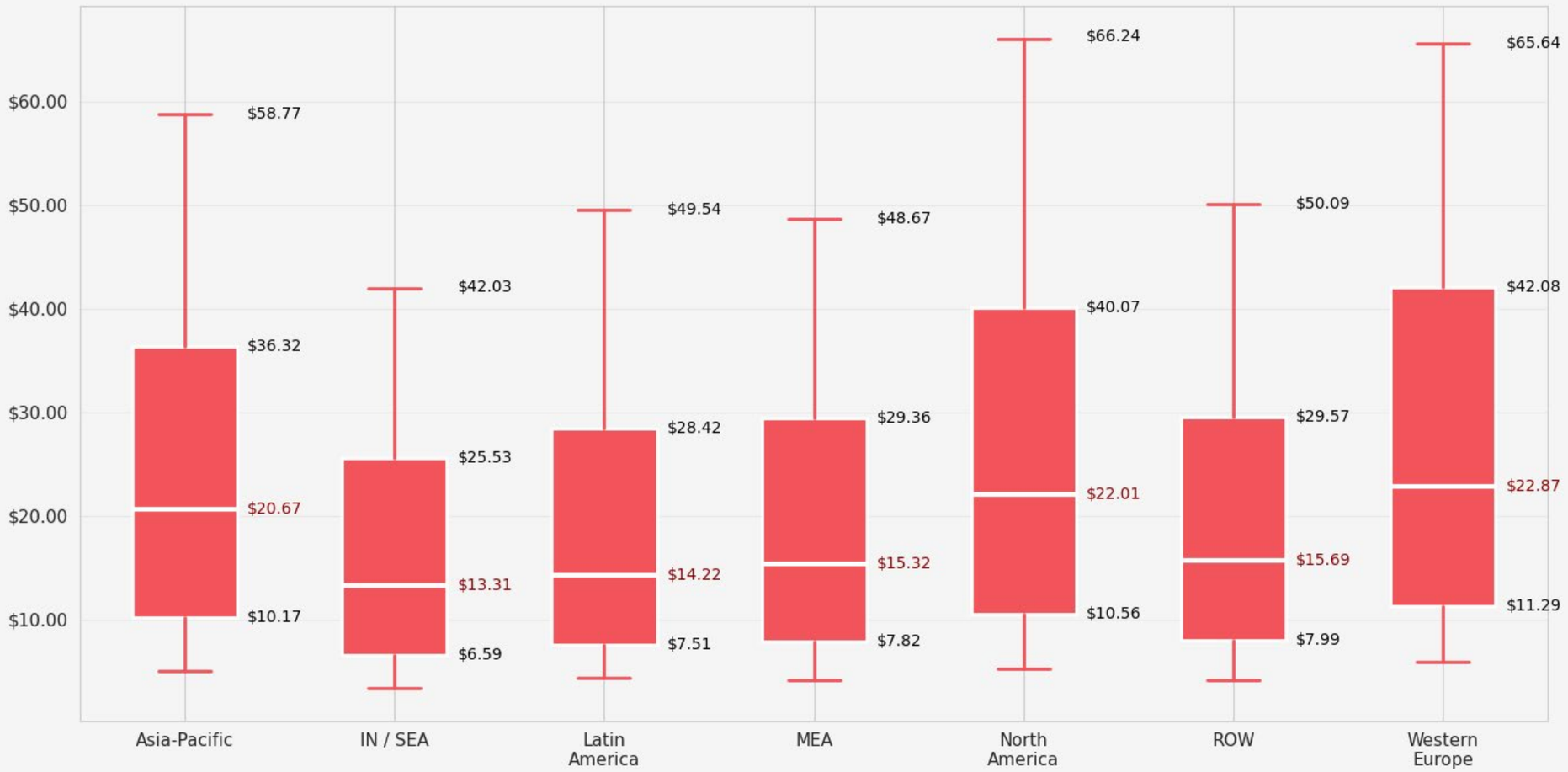
# Day 14 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



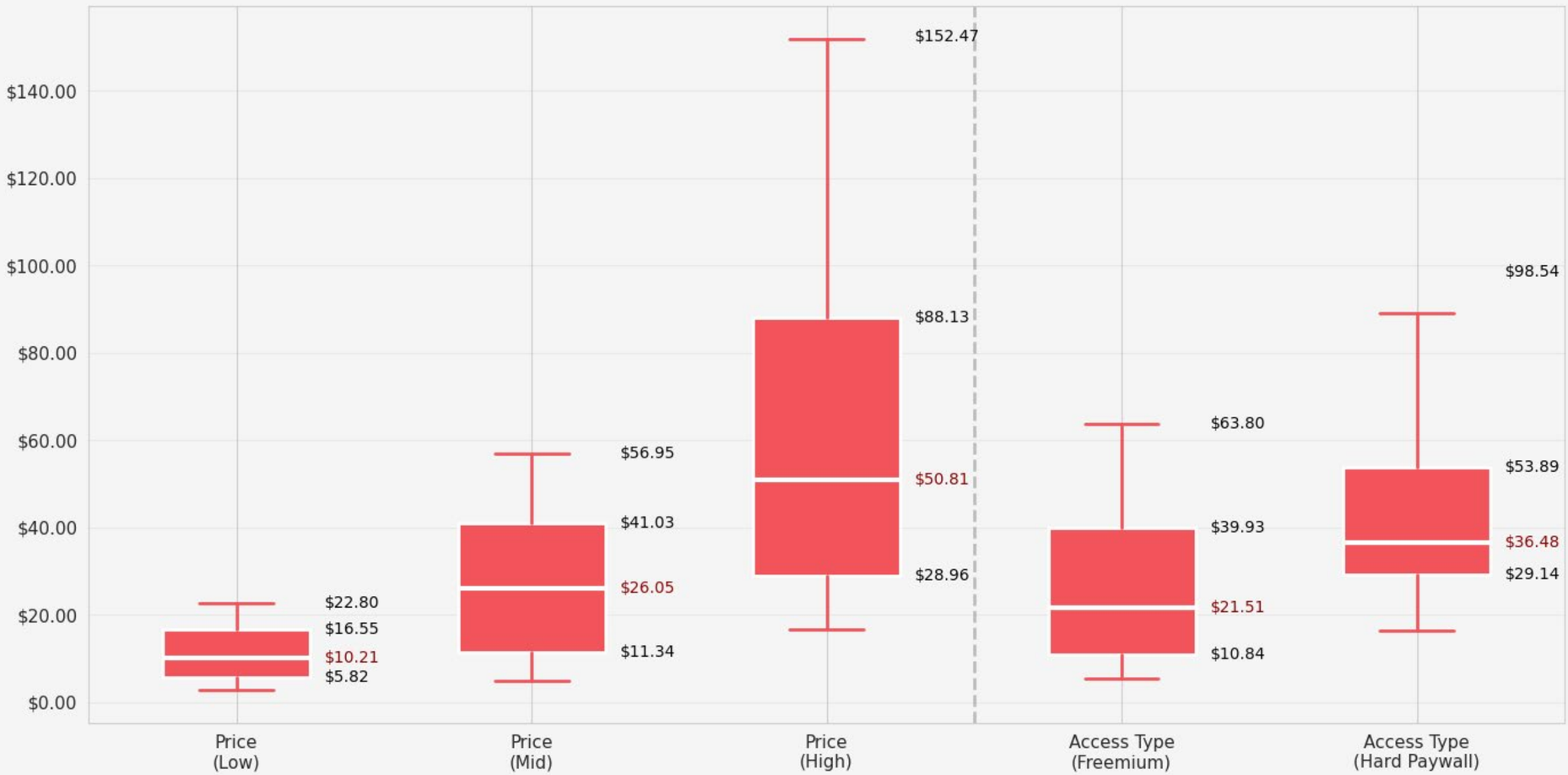
# Day 60 revenue per install (RPI), by geography



# Year 1 realized LTV (RLTV) per payer, by geography and pricepoint



# First 3 weekly renewals



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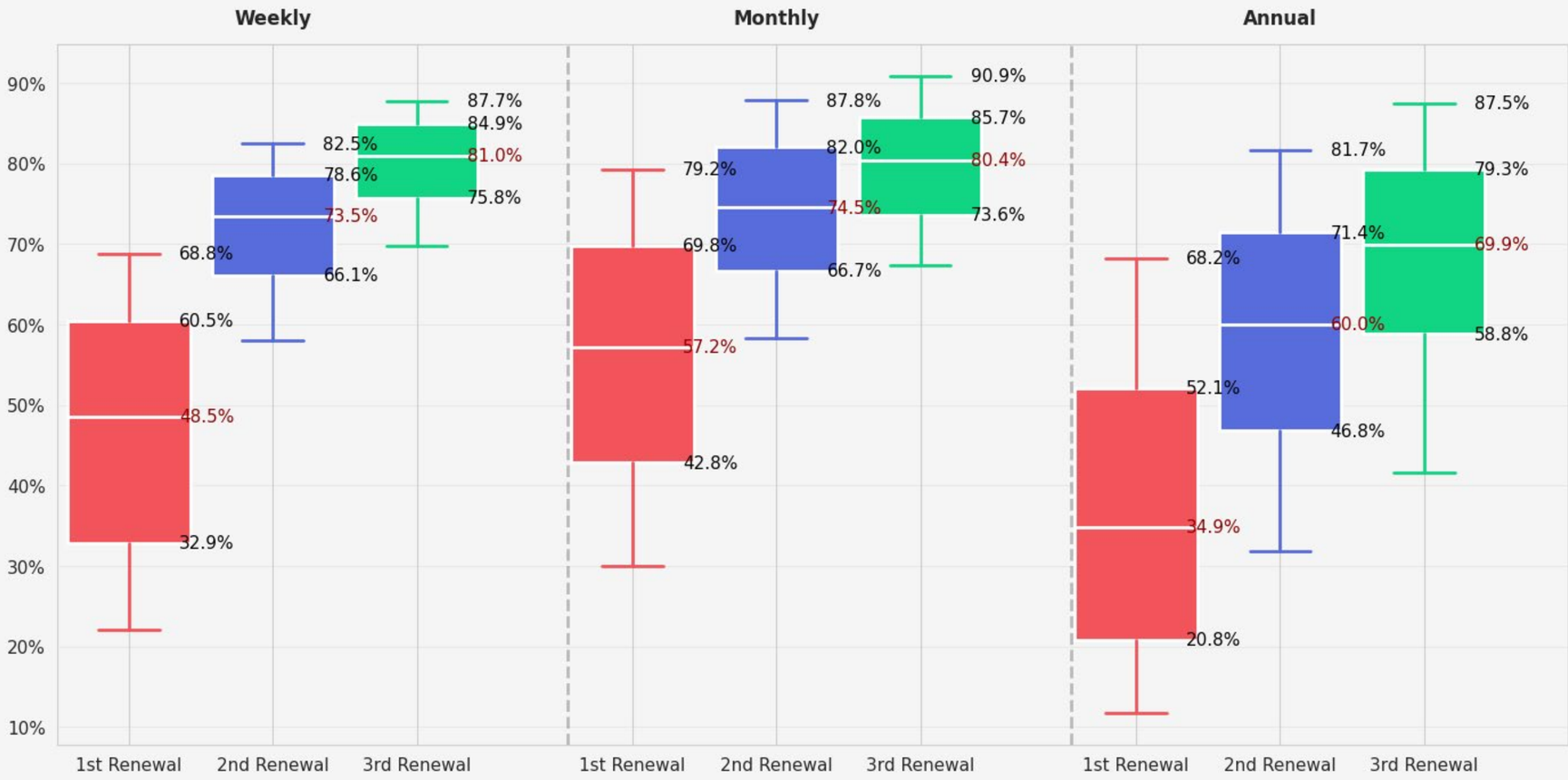
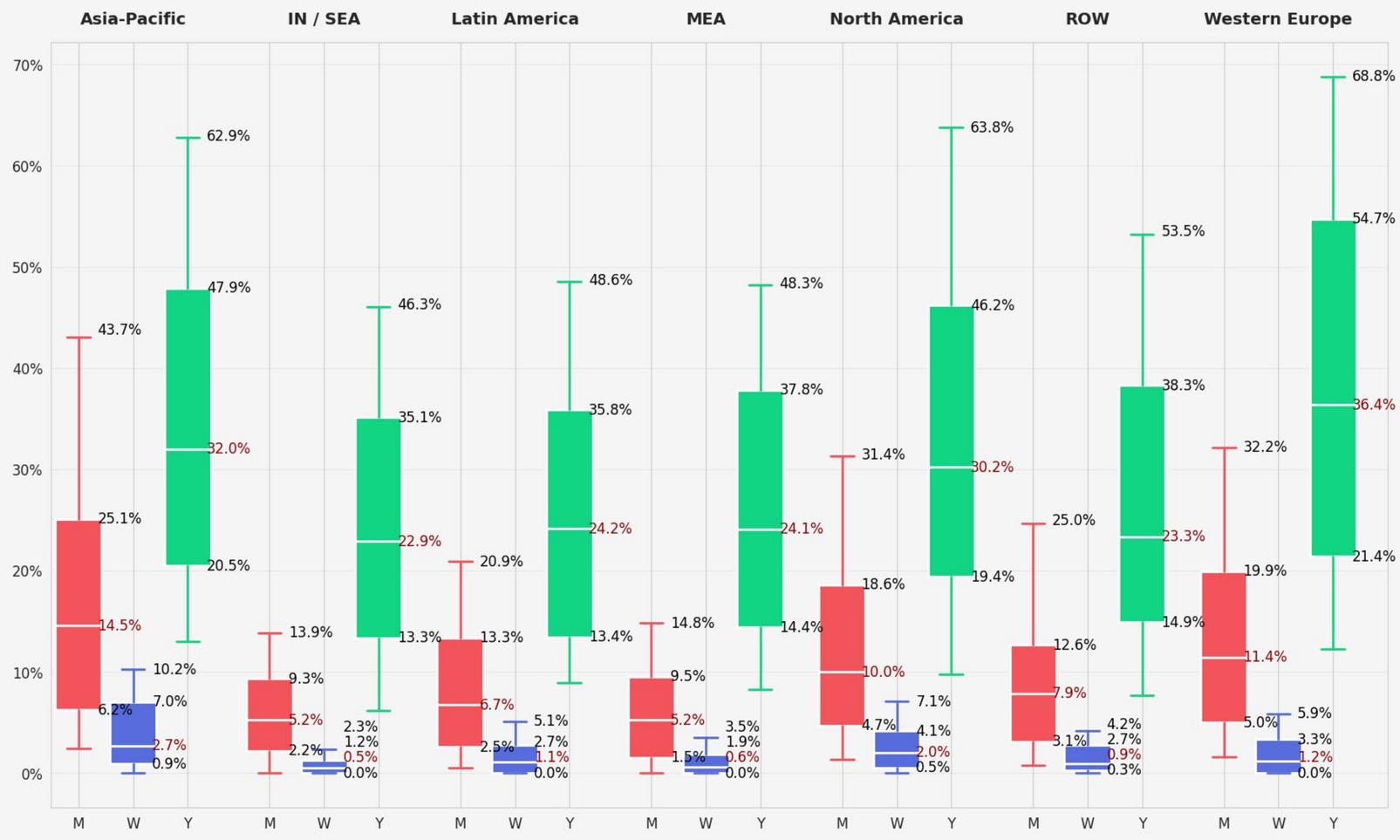


# Year 1 retained monthly subscribers, by geography



# FAQ and benchmark index

# FAQ and benchmark index

We've mapped every chart to the questions it answers, so you can quickly find the data you're looking for.

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| | | → Monthly revenue by app launch cohort across all storefronts (Jan 2026) | 13 |
| | | → Share of newly-launched apps that hit revenue milestones in their first 2 year | 46 |
| | Are new subscription apps actually succeeding? | → Monthly revenue by app launch cohort across all storefronts (Jan 2026) | 13 |
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*This chart is also available filtered to specific app categories — find it the Category breakouts section.

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# Metrics index

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***This chart is also available filtered to specific app categories — find it within the Category breakouts section.**

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